托福阅读真题·题型 3（学术阅读）

共 296 套 · 1465 题 · 日期 2026-01-21 ~ 2026-09-19

（本题库已将参考答案统一移至文末，便于自测练习）

2026-09-19（3 套）

2026-08-06 Traffic Psychology

原文（Passage）

Traffic Psychology

Traffic psychology explores how individual differences and social contexts shape driving behavior, often in counterintuitive ways. [A] While traits like impulsivity are frequently linked to risky driving, research shows that this connection is not always straightforward. [B] For instance, impulsive individuals may drive cautiously in familiar environments but exhibit recklessness when faced with novel or stressful situations. [C] Moreover, environmental cues - such as heavy traffic or aggressive drivers - can amplify underlying character traits. [D]

Social influences further complicate the picture. Young drivers, for example, may engage in riskier maneuvers when accompanied by peers, driven by a desire to impress or conform. However, this effect is not universal. The presence of a vigilant passenger - such as a parent or responsible friend - can counteract impulsive tendencies and promote safer driving. This raises questions about how social roles and expectations modulate behavior.

Some researchers argue that focusing too heavily on personality overlooks structural factors like road design or traffic law enforcement, which may exert a stronger influence on safety outcomes. Yet, understanding the psychological underpinnings of driving remains crucial for designing effective interventions. By integrating insights from personality psychology, social dynamics, and environmental design, traffic psychology offers a nuanced framework for improving road safety.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions all of the following as factors influencing road safety EXCEPT

A. personality traits
B. social influences
C. environmental conditions
D. vehicle maintenance

Q2. The word "vigilant" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. watchful
B. considerate
C. experienced
D. assertive

Q3. Based on the second paragraph, what can be inferred about the role of passengers in promoting safer driving?

A. Passengers usually encourage drivers to undertake riskier maneuvers.
B. Passengers can influence drivers in a positive way, but this is not always the case.
C. Passengers exert a stronger influence on drivers than structural factors do.
D. The presence of passengers has no measurable effect on driving behavior.

Q4. What does the passage suggest about structural factors?

A. They are the main cause of traffic accidents.
B. Their importance is debated by researchers.

C. They influence younger drivers the most.
D. They are the foundation of traffic psychology.

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. These findings suggest that drivers' behavior is not solely rooted in personality. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "Traffic psychology explores how individual differences and social contexts shape driving behavior, often in counterintuitive ways."
B. After "While traits like impulsivity are frequently linked to risky driving, research shows that this connection is not always straightforward."
C. After "For instance, impulsive individuals may drive cautiously in familiar environments but exhibit recklessness when faced with novel or stressful situations."
D. After "Moreover, environmental cues - such as heavy traffic or aggressive drivers - can amplify underlying character traits."

2026-09-19 Animal Cultures

原文（Passage）

The Question of Animal Cultures

Can animals be said to possess culture? Many scientists argue that certain species do exhibit cultural traits, defining culture broadly as behaviors learned socially and transmitted across generations. Classic examples include chimpanzees using tools in ways distinctive to their local community, or whales developing group-specific songs that evolve over time. These patterns suggest that at least some animals maintain traditions not rooted solely in genetics or instinct.

Others argue that applying the term "culture" to animals risks stretching the concept beyond usefulness. Human cultures involve symbolic meaning and cumulative innovation—the ability to build on previous discoveries so that knowledge and practices become more sophisticated over generations. Nonhuman species have not convincingly demonstrated these abilities. Animal behaviors that appear cultural may instead reflect adaptation to environmental pressures or simple imitation, not deeper shared understandings.

A middle position acknowledges that while animals may not possess culture in the sense humans do, they can still display rudimentary cultural phenomena. This view emphasizes a continuum rather than a strict divide, suggesting that cultural capacities evolved gradually and appear in varying degrees across species.

Ultimately, whether animals have culture depends on how culture is defined, but growing evidence of socially transmitted behaviors challenges long-held assumptions about the uniqueness of human societies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests which of the following about the songs of whales?

A. They can best be understood as instinctive behaviors related to aspects of whales' environments.
B. They evolve over time in ways that are not typical of behaviors generally accepted as cultural.
C. They are considered by some to be cultural phenomena because they are not uniform across whale groups.
D. They differ from tool use by chimpanzees, in that they reflect the influence of genetics on behavior.

Q2. The author mentions "cumulative innovation" primarily to

A. characterize one view about how culture should be defined

B. explain how some animal behaviors evolve over generations
C. specify which human abilities are shared by some animal species
D. cite one way in which some species adapt to environmental pressures

Q3. The passage indicates that those holding the "middle position"

A. have been accused of stretching the meaning of culture too far
B. differ from most scientists in their view of which behaviors are instinctive
C. consider symbolic meaning to be an essential element of cultures
D. recognize some elements of cultural phenomena in animal behavior

Q4. The word "rudimentary" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. distinct
B. basic
C. productive
D. interesting

Q5. The author would most likely agree that the "long-held assumptions" mentioned in the final paragraph

A. have largely been abandoned by scientists today
B. uphold a definition of culture that is too rigid
C. are supported by recent findings about animal behavior
D. reveal something important about socially transmitted behaviors

2026-09-19 The Getty Kouros

原文（Passage）

The Getty Kouros

In 1985, the J. Paul Getty Museum acquired what it believed to be a Greek kouros (a statue of a naked youth) dating from the Archaic period (650–480 B.C.E.), estimating the date of origin as approximately 530 B.C.E. The Getty Kouros's authenticity soon came into question, however. Supporters cited scientific analyses suggesting that the statue's marble is consistent with marble known to have come from ancient Greek quarries and that its surface shows chemical changes consistent with long-term burial. Some scholars also argue that peculiar inconsistencies in the statue's style—it incorporates features from different regions and periods—could reflect a transitional moment in Greek sculpture.

Skeptics contend that these inconsistencies undermine the case for authenticity. The Kouros combines traits from several other known sixth-century B.C.E. kouroi in a way that appears too eclectic to be genuine. To these observers, the statue looks like a modern forger's creation—a confused imitation of Greek Archaic elements rather than the genuine product of a coherent sculptural tradition. Furthermore, scientists recognize that modern forgers can artificially age marble.

Because neither scientific analysis nor stylistic evaluation yields decisive results, the question of the Kouros's authenticity remains unresolved.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about the "chemical changes" in the marble of the Getty Kouros?

A. They could not have occurred naturally.
B. They were caused by scientists testing the marble's age.
C. They explain some inconsistencies in features of the Getty Kouros.
D. They may suggest an ancient origin for the marble of the Getty Kouros.

Q2. The author mentions "a transitional moment in Greek sculpture" primarily in order to

A. question a claim about sixth-century B.C.E. kouroi
B. point out how some people explain the style of the Getty Kouros
C. characterize sculptures typical of the Greek Archaic period
D. support the view that artistic styles evolve over time

Q3. What is the main reason that the authenticity of the Getty Kouros is in doubt?

A. The Greeks did not create many sculptures during the sixth century B.C.E.
B. Modern forgers are known to have created similar sculptures.
C. Observers may have misunderstood Greek Archaic elements.
D. The Getty Kouros combines styles that are too diverse.

Q4. According to the passage, what is known about marble?

A. It can be quickly produced by forgers in large amounts.
B. It is difficult for forgers to imitate.
C. It can be made to appear older than it actually is.
D. Its traits could affect the style of Greek sculptures.

Q5. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?

A. The Getty Kouros is not typical of Greek kouroi and may or may not be genuine.
B. The Getty Kouros is composed of marble that has probably been artificially aged.
C. The Getty Kouros is probably of Greek origin but unlikely to be from the Archaic period.
D. The Getty Kouros was likely forged by a sculptor with limited knowledge of Greek sculptural traditions.

2026-09-13（3 套）

2026-09-13 Graphic Design Evolution

原文（Passage）

Evolutionary Trends in Graphic Design

Graphic design has transformed repeatedly throughout history, influenced by both cultural shifts and technological advancements. In Europe, during the Middle Ages (the fifth to fifteenth centuries), the creation of intricate manuscripts was predominant. The advent of the printing press in the fifteenth century altered these dynamics, facilitating mass production and broadening public access to designed materials. Such technological shifts not only changed the way art was produced but also how it was perceived.

By the mid-twentieth century, Swiss design emerged as a response to the chaotic visual landscape, introducing principles of minimalism and functionality. Heavily influenced by the Bauhaus movement, designers like Josef Müller-Brockmann advocated for simplicity and rationality. Their grid-based approach brought order and readability to what often seemed to be overwhelming visuals. Some critics argue that the rigid structure, while effective, limited expressive possibilities and emotional resonance in design.

Today, graphic design stands at the intersection of tradition and innovation. While digital tools democratize access and encourage experimentation, designers grapple with preserving artistic integrity. The challenge lies in blending the precision of technology with the warmth of human creativity. Thus, graphic design continues to evolve, reflecting broader cultural debates about art and technology.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about intricate manuscripts during the Middle Ages?

A. They were individually made.
B. They were produced using the printing press.
C. They were widely available to the general public.
D. They depicted mostly landscapes.

Q2. The phrase "advocated for" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. mentioned
B. promoted
C. debated
D. inspired

Q3. Why does the author discuss the "grid-based approach"?

A. To illustrate how Swiss designers introduced greater order and clarity into visual communication
B. To explain why technological advances made traditional design methods unnecessary
C. To show that Swiss designers rejected the principles associated with the Bauhaus movement
D. To provide an example of a design technique that was primarily intended to increase emotional expression

Q4. What does the passage suggest about Swiss design in the mid-twentieth century?

A. It developed primarily because designers wanted to imitate medieval manuscripts.
B. It attempted to make increasingly complex visual material easier to understand.
C. It was immediately replaced when digital design tools became widely available.
D. It placed emotional expression above clarity and functional organization.

Q5. Why does the author mention both the printing press and digital tools in the passage?

A. To argue that technological advances have generally reduced the artistic quality of graphic design
B. To compare two technologies that were developed specifically to make graphic design less expensive
C. To illustrate how technological change has repeatedly influenced the production and development of graphic design
D. To suggest that modern designers face essentially the same limitations as medieval manuscript makers

Passage - Expert Systems

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Expert Systems

Expert systems are a branch of artificial intelligence designed to imitate the decision-making abilities of human specialists. Rather than attempting to solve a broad range of problems, these systems generally operate within a narrowly defined domain. They rely on a **knowledge base**, which contains specialized information, and a set of rules that determines how that information should be applied. By comparing a particular case with the facts and rules stored in the system, an expert system can reach conclusions or make recommendations similar to those of a trained professional.

One of the best-known early expert systems was MYCIN, developed in the

1970s. MYCIN was designed to help diagnose bacterial infections and recommend appropriate antibiotics. It asked users a series of questions about a patient's symptoms and laboratory results and then applied its rules to identify likely causes of infection. Tests showed that its recommendations could approach the quality of those made by physicians specializing in infectious diseases. Although MYCIN was never widely adopted in clinical practice, it demonstrated that computers could apply highly specialized knowledge to complex decision-making tasks.
Despite this promise, traditional expert systems have an important limitation. Their knowledge bases are essentially static: the systems do not automatically revise what they know when new discoveries are made or conditions change. Experts must continually add, remove, or modify information and rules. This process, often called knowledge maintenance, can require considerable time and effort. [A] As a result, a system that is not regularly maintained may gradually become less accurate or useful. [B] The problem is especially serious in fields such as medicine, where accepted practices and available treatments can change rapidly. [C] Maintaining a large rule-based system can therefore become increasingly difficult as its domain grows more complex. [D]
Recent advances in machine learning and natural language processing may help overcome some of these limitations. Instead of depending entirely on specialists to enter every new fact or rule manually, future expert systems may be able to learn from newly available data and extract useful information from technical documents. Such systems could update portions of their knowledge more dynamically and adapt as circumstances change. Human oversight would still be important, particularly in high-stakes fields, but greater capacity for continuous learning could make expert systems more accurate, flexible, and easier to maintain.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, expert systems make decisions primarily by

A. reproducing the personal experiences of individual specialists
B. applying stored specialized knowledge according to established rules
C. collecting information from many unrelated professional fields
D. replacing narrow knowledge bases with general human reasoning

Q2. Why does the author mention MYCIN?

A. To illustrate an early system that successfully applied expert knowledge to a specialized problem
B. To show why physicians resisted the introduction of computers into hospitals
C. To identify the first artificial intelligence system capable of learning without human input
D. To demonstrate that antibiotic recommendations no longer require medical expertise

Q3. The word "static" in paragraph 3 is closest in meaning to

A. fixed
B. precise
C. extensive
D. accessible

Q4. What can be inferred about traditional expert systems from paragraph 3?

A. They become more reliable as the number of rules increases.

B. They are most useful in fields where professional knowledge changes frequently.
C. Their usefulness may decline if specialists do not regularly update them.
D. They can independently determine which parts of their knowledge are outdated.

Q5. Look at the four squares [▪] that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Consequently, the usefulness of the system depends not only on the quality of its original knowledge but also on continued human attention. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. First square
B. Second square
C. Third square
D. Fourth square

Passage - Graphic Design Evolution

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Evolutionary Trends in Graphic Design

Graphic design has transformed repeatedly throughout history, influenced by both cultural shifts and technological advancements. In Europe, during the Middle Ages (the fifth to fifteenth centuries), the creation of intricate manuscripts was predominant. The advent of the printing press in the fifteenth century altered these dynamics, facilitating mass production and broadening public access to designed materials. Such technological shifts not only changed the way art was produced but also how it was perceived.

By the mid-twentieth century, Swiss design emerged as a response to the chaotic visual landscape, introducing principles of minimalism and functionality. [A] Heavily influenced by the Bauhaus movement, designers like Josef Müller-Brockmann advocated for simplicity and rationality. [B] Their grid-based approach brought order and readability to what often seemed to be overwhelming visuals. [C] Some critics argue that the rigid structure, while effective, limited expressive possibilities and emotional resonance in design. [D]

Today, graphic design stands at the intersection of tradition and innovation. While digital tools democratize access and encourage experimentation, designers grapple with preserving artistic integrity. The challenge lies in blending the precision of technology with the warmth of human creativity. Thus, graphic design continues to evolve, reflecting broader cultural debates about art and technology.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about intricate manuscripts during the Middle Ages?

A. They were individually made.
B. They were produced using the printing press.
C. They were widely available to the general public.
D. They depicted mostly landscapes.

Q2. The phrase "advocated for" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. mentioned
B. promoted
C. debated

D. inspired

Q3. Why does the author discuss the "grid-based approach"?

A. To provide an example of how Swiss design created visual order and readability

B. To explain why the printing press became less important in the twentieth century

C. To show that Bauhaus designers rejected functional approaches to visual communication

D. To demonstrate that modern designers prefer rigid structures to digital experimentation

Q4. According to paragraph 2, what criticism has been made of Swiss design?

A. It depended too heavily on decorative details inherited from medieval manuscripts.

B. It made printed materials more difficult for the public to understand.

C. Its structured approach could restrict emotional and expressive qualities.

D. Its designers placed artistic expression above functionality and clarity.

Q5. Look at the four squares [▪] that indicate where the following sentence could be added. This emphasis on structure sought to make visual communication clearer and more universally understandable. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. First square

B. Second square

C. Third square

D. Fourth square

2026-09-12（2 套）

2026-09-12 Demographic Dynamics

原文（Passage）

Demographic Dynamics

The demographic transition model (DTM) illustrates the shifting patterns of birth and death rates as societies evolve from agrarian to industrialized economies. Initially, both rates are high, resulting in slow population growth due to limited access to healthcare and sanitation. As countries develop, death rates decline sharply with advances in medical care and improved living conditions. Yet, birth rates often remain high, spurring rapid population growth that can strain resources. This transition highlights the tension between demographic momentum and societal capability to meet the growing needs.

[A] A further decline in birth rates eventually occurs, influenced by greater access to education and changes in cultural norms. Families begin to view fewer children as advantageous, aligning with shifts toward economic and personal aspirations. [B] However, this stage brings its own challenges, including the potential for an aging population and workforce shortages. [C]

Some demographers postulate a fifth stage, characterized by persistently low birth rates that might lead to population contraction. The implications of this are complex, ranging from economic innovation driven by necessity to increased strain on social institutions and intergenerational support systems. [D] Understanding these transitions enables societies to better plan for future demographic realities, though the dynamic interplay of these factors is still unfolding.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, what does the demographic transition model primarily demonstrate?

A. Decreasing birth rates as societies industrialize

B. Changing rates of birth and death as economies develop

C. Differences in healthcare access among societies

D. Consequences of rising death rates in industrial societies

Q2. Which of the following can be inferred about agrarian societies?

A. They are more prosperous than industrialized societies.

B. They are an exception to the trends proposed by the demographic transition model.

C. They experience high birth rates and also high death rates.

D. They suffer sharp population declines as a result of high death rates.

Q3. The word "aspirations" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. goals

B. resources

C. changes

D. challenges

Q4. Which of the following is NOT mentioned about low birth rates?

A. Sustained low birth rates result in negative population growth.

B. Demographic changes brought about by low birth rates can lead to societal tensions.

C. Persistently low birth rates typically lead to economic decline.

D. Understanding demographic transitions linked to low birth rates helps societies plan for the future.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "As societies navigate this demographic shift, proactive policies and innovations become essential to sustain economic growth and promote well-being among older adults." Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1

B. Location 2

C. Location 3

D. Location 4

2026-09-12 Gamma-Ray Astronomy

原文（Passage）

Gamma-Ray Astronomy: Unveiling the Universe

Gamma-ray astronomy has transformed our view of the cosmos by enabling scientists to detect some of the universe's most energetic and extreme phenomena, including gamma-ray bursts (GRBs). GRBs have drawn intense interest due to their mysterious origins and immense energy output. Unlike visible light, gamma rays do not penetrate Earth's atmosphere. As a result, astronomers deploy space telescopes to capture signals from cosmic events like supernovae and neutron star collisions.

The launch of the Compton Gamma Ray Observatory in 1991 provided the first comprehensive map of the gamma-ray sky, similar to the way optical telescopes map the visible sky. This breakthrough allowed scientists to pinpoint the locations of GRBs and study their properties in detail. Scientists learned that these bursts occur randomly across the sky and are not confined to our galaxy alone.

Despite the advances, many questions remain. Some hypothesize that GRBs are the result of merging neutron stars, while others suggest they stem from hypernovae, explosive events that dwarf typical supernovae. Each explanation carries implications for our understanding of stellar evolution and cosmic history. New telescopes like the Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope may help astronomers uncover more secrets of these cosmic beacons.

题目（Questions）

Q1. It can be inferred from the passage that space telescopes are used for gamma-ray astronomy primarily because

A. gamma-ray sources produce signals that are too faint to detect with standard instruments
B. gamma rays have physical characteristics that prevent ground-based observation
C. gamma rays come from a region of the universe that is hard to observe from Earth
D. gamma-ray events occur unpredictably and require constant monitoring

Q2. The phrase "confined to" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. limited to
B. returned to
C. trapped by
D. created by

Q3. The Compton Gamma Ray Observatory enabled scientists to

A. create a more accurate map of the visible sky
B. prove that gamma rays come from neutron stars
C. find out where GRBs occur and learn more about them
D. discover regular patterns in the occurrence of GRBs

Q4. Based on the passage, which issue about GRBs remains unresolved?

A. How large GRBs are compared to other cosmic explosions
B. How frequent GRBs are in different regions of the universe
C. The specific processes that give rise to GRBs
D. The total amount of energy released during a typical GRB

Q5. Why does the author mention the Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope?

A. To emphasize the importance of international cooperation in gamma-ray research
B. To explain how gamma-ray bursts were first detected
C. To compare modern telescope technology with earlier optical instruments
D. To suggest that new observational tools can help resolve unanswered questions

2026-09-06（2 套）

2026-09-06 Coastal Erosion

原文（Passage）

Coastal Erosion Challenges

Coastal erosion, the gradual loss of shoreline due to natural forces, poses challenges worldwide. Waves, currents, and rising sea levels are primary contributors to the phenomenon. Strong storms can exacerbate erosion, reshaping coastlines abruptly. For countries with extensive coastal zones, such as Bangladesh and the Netherlands, managing erosion is not only an environmental issue but also an economic and social one. Coastal erosion threatens infrastructure, transportation, and residential areas, necessitating costly investments in protective measures.

One strategy to combat erosion is beach nourishment, the addition of sand or sediment to shorelines. While this method provides short-term benefits, frequent replenishment is required. Seawalls and breakwaters, solid structures designed to deflect wave energy and protect coastlines, are longer-term solutions but can alter natural sediment movement, unintentionally accelerating erosion in nearby areas.

Recent studies suggest that some natural approaches may be more sustainable. For instance, mangrove forests and dune systems serve as buffers, reducing wave energy before it reaches populated areas. Mangroves not only provide erosion control but also support diverse ecosystems. However, such methods require extensive space and careful planning, making them unsuitable for heavily urbanized coastal zones. This highlights the tension between maintaining natural landscapes and safeguarding human developments along vulnerable coastlines.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "exacerbate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. cause
B. contribute to
C. control
D. increase

Q2. Why does the author mention Bangladesh and the Netherlands?

A. To illustrate that strong storms pose threats to infrastructure in coastal areas
B. To give examples of countries for which coastal erosion presents challenges beyond environmental ones
C. To provide examples of countries that have recently invested in protecting their coastal infrastructure
D. To acknowledge that coastal erosion is a problem that affects countries in a variety of regions

Q3. The passage indicates which of the following about "beach nourishment"?

A. It involves an ongoing commitment to maintain the advantages it offers.
B. It is effective primarily in areas that already have natural dune systems.
C. It is a relatively expensive method of combating erosion.
D. It is primarily effective in areas where the coastal zones have little residential development.

Q4. What can be inferred about the "natural approaches" mentioned in the passage?

A. They offer significant protection of coastal areas but are short-term measures.
B. They are easier to implement in areas with high population density.
C. They are less likely than man-made structures to cause unintended harm to surrounding shorelines.
D. They are more effective as a way of protecting biodiversity than as a measure to combat erosion.

Q5. The passage indicates each of the following about erosion-control measures EXCEPT:

A. They can sometimes deflect wave energy.
B. They sometimes disrupt transportation in coastal areas.
C. They have greater economic impact in some countries than in others.
D. They vary in the amount of space they require.

2026-09-06 Kintsugi Repair

原文（Passage）

Kintsugi

Kintsugi is a Japanese method of repairing broken pottery while leaving the repair deliberately visible. Artisans rejoin fragments with lacquer paste and may dust the seams with powdered gold or other metals. Rather than return a vessel to an apparently untouched state, the process makes damage part of its design. The object retains evidence of both use and restoration.

Although its precise origins are uncertain, gilt-lacquer repairs became fashionable in Japan around the sixteenth century. Kintsugi is now often associated with wabi-sabi, an aesthetic outlook that regards imperfection, age, and transience as natural conditions, not defects to eliminate. Careful repair acknowledges change while preserving continuity; the metallic lines record where a vessel failed and how it was remade.

[A] This philosophy helps explain why kintsugi has traveled beyond specialist workshops. [B] Because the restored object remains visibly altered, it is often used as a metaphor for resilience: recovery need not erase the event that made recovery necessary. [C] Contemporary classes may therefore teach both the practical sequence and ideas about acceptance and renewal. [D]

Traditional kintsugi demands material knowledge, patience, and repeated curing; it is not simply the decorative application of gold paint. Understanding its craft alongside its symbolism prevents a complex practice from becoming only a slogan about personal improvement.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, which outlook is associated with kintsugi?

A. Minimalism, which favors eliminating decoration and excess
B. Formalism, which evaluates an object only by its shape
C. Wabi-sabi, which regards imperfection and transience as natural
D. A conservation principle requiring repairs to remain invisible

Q2. According to the passage, what does a visible repair symbolize?

A. A repair succeeds only when the object appears unchanged.
B. Recovery can acknowledge past damage without erasing it.
C. Breakage is desirable because it guarantees a more valuable object.
D. Precious materials alone give a repaired object symbolic meaning.

Q3. The word "transience" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. temporary nature
B. physical damage
C. artistic complexity
D. cultural popularity

Q4. Why does the author state that traditional kintsugi is "not simply the decorative application of gold paint"?

A. To explain why artisans sometimes use metals other than gold
B. To distinguish a demanding traditional craft from a superficial imitation
C. To argue that repaired pottery should not be displayed as art
D. To reject the connection between kintsugi and symbolic interpretation

Q5. There are four locations [▪] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. That metaphorical appeal, however, should not obscure the demanding material process discussed next. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [▪] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. First square
B. Second square
C. Third square
D. Fourth square

2026-09-05（3 套）

2026-09-05 Language in Primates

原文（Passage）

Language in Primates

Language has traditionally been considered a uniquely human trait; however, this assumption has been increasingly challenged. Research involving chimpanzees and bonobos reveals rudimentary linguistic abilities: symbolic communication, basic grammar, and even sentence formation. Kanzi, a bonobo, famously used lexigrams (symbols that stand for specific concepts) to convey desires and even to learn to comprehend grammar, suggesting a grasp of syntactic rules.

Yet, such abilities in nonhuman primates emerge only through intensive training and do not naturally evolve in primate communities. This distinction underscores a critical contrast: while humans spontaneously develop intricate language systems, other primates' communication

remains tethered to immediate needs and lacks the generative structure necessary for producing novel sentences and ideas.

[A] Some theorists propose that individual cognitive capacities are what constrains language development; others argue that social complexity plays a pivotal role. [B] Language, they contend, may have coevolved with the demands of maintaining social hierarchies and alliances. [C] While all primates, including humans, are social creatures, the fact remains that no known communication system among nonhuman primates rivals human language. [D] Comparative linguistic studies may blur the boundaries between species, but they ultimately reaffirm the singularity of human linguistic capacity.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that Kanzi's ability to communicate through language was limited in that it did not

A. succeed in expressing immediate needs
B. involve basic symbolic representation
C. arise naturally without training by humans
D. include an understanding of syntactic rules

Q2. According to the passage, nonhuman primates can do each of the following EXCEPT

A. convey meaning through symbols
B. teach each other basic grammar
C. respond to instruction by humans
D. live in groups with social structures

Q3. The phrase “tethered to” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. hindered by
B. useful for
C. secondary to
D. focused on

Q4. The author notes that "all primates, including humans, are social creatures" primarily to

A. suggest that nonhuman primates may eventually develop humanlike language
B. indicate a seeming commonality when it comes to prerequisites for developing language
C. argue that nonhuman primates are more intelligent than was previously believed
D. support the claim that no known animal communication system rivals human language

Q5. There are four locations [▪] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Yet social organization alone does not seem sufficient to explain the emergence of a fully generative language ability. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [▪] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-09-05 Wartime Women Workforce

原文（Passage）

The Second World War and American Women in the Workforce

The Second World War created an acute labor shortage in the United States as millions of men entered military service, forcing factories, shipyards, and aircraft plants to seek new workers. In response, women were recruited into industrial jobs such as welding aircraft frames, assembling munitions, and operating heavy machinery—work that had previously been performed almost

entirely by men. By 1945, women made up roughly 37 percent of the civilian labor force, an increase of about six million workers since 1940. Government campaigns framed this shift as both patriotic and temporary.

Historians debate the significance of this wartime transformation. Some argue that women's employment marked a lasting break with traditional gender roles, as women demonstrated their ability to perform skilled industrial labor. While the war did not produce immediate equality, they argue it helped lay the groundwork for later movements advocating equal pay and broader access to skilled occupations in the decades that followed.

Others stress the short-lived nature of the change. When the war ended and men returned home, defense contracts were canceled and women were often dismissed. Female labor-force participation fell sharply in 1945 and 1946, approaching prewar levels as many women were encouraged—or required—to leave their jobs.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “acute” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. unexpected
B. unwelcome
C. severe
D. growing

Q2. Why does the author mention “welding aircraft frames, assembling munitions, and operating heavy machinery”?

A. To acknowledge that certain kinds of work required specialized training
B. To draw attention to the sectors with the greatest labor shortages
C. To support the claim that 37 percent of the labor force worked in war industries
D. To indicate the kinds of work that women began to perform during the Second World War

Q3. What does the passage suggest about the government's attitude toward women performing industrial labor?

A. The government did not believe that women could perform industrial work as well as men.
B. The government expected women to work only during a brief period when men were unavailable.
C. The government was concerned that women were not fulfilling their patriotic duties.
D. The government began to send women back home in 1944 when the end of the war was in sight.

Q4. What is the nature of the debate among historians mentioned in the passage?

A. Some historians emphasize the lasting effects of women's wartime employment, while others see it as a short-lived phenomenon.
B. Some historians argue that the Second World War benefited women, while most historians point to the hardships experienced by women during the war.
C. Some historians criticize women for participating in war industries, while others praise them for their patriotism and bravery.
D. Some historians highlight the gains women achieved in the 1940s, while others stress the continuity of traditional gender roles during the war period.

Q5. The passage suggests that which of the following was a result of the end of the war?

A. Women were shifted into different industries after defense contracts ended.
B. Men replaced women in many industrial jobs.
C. Women gladly gave up their jobs to return to their families.
D. Employers lowered the pay of women.

KPO 32 - Microseism Applications

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Microseisms: The Earth's Subtle Vibrations

The Earth is constantly vibrating, even when there are no earthquakes. These subtle vibrations, known as microseisms, are typically caused by ocean waves. When waves collide, they create pressure variations that travel through the water and into the sea floor. This energy transfer generates seismic waves detectable by seismometers worldwide. Interestingly, microseisms are strongest during storms when ocean waves are more powerful.

Researchers have found these vibrations can provide important information about the Earth's interior. Microseisms travel through the Earth's crust and mantle, revealing details about the geological structures they pass through, including variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures. Another compelling use of microseisms is in climate studies. Scientists analyze historical data on these vibrations to reconstruct past ocean conditions and storm activities. This helps improve climate models and understand long-term weather patterns. Additionally, microseisms are used in oil and gas exploration. They identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures without more invasive techniques.

Studying microseisms is challenging. The mild signals are easily masked by other seismic noises. Advanced data analysis techniques and state-of-the-art equipment are essential for accurately interpreting microseisms. Researchers often employ filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "subtle" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. faint
B. sudden
C. irregular
D. dangerous

Q2. It can be inferred that microseisms are strongest during ocean storms because

A. storms cause changes in the density of rocks beneath the ocean floor
B. powerful ocean waves generate stronger pressure variations and seismic waves
C. seismometers are more sensitive during periods of severe weather
D. storms cause faults beneath the ocean floor to become more active

Q3. Why does the author mention "variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures"?

A. To give examples of geological information that microseisms can reveal
B. To explain why microseisms occur more frequently in some regions than others
C. To describe the main causes of earthquakes beneath the ocean floor
D. To show why climate researchers need to study the Earth's interior

Q4. According to the passage, how can microseisms help in oil and gas exploration?

A. By measuring the amount of oil and gas already extracted from a region
B. By predicting when underground drilling equipment is likely to fail
C. By identifying subsurface structures that may indicate promising drilling sites
D. By preventing seismic activity caused by oil and gas extraction

Q5. What does the author suggest about "filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers"?

A. They are mainly used to determine the exact location of ocean storms.
B. They help researchers distinguish weak microseismic signals from other seismic noise.

C. They allow scientists to generate microseisms artificially for research purposes.
D. They make advanced seismic equipment unnecessary in most studies.

2026-09-01（3 套）

Animal Cultures

原文（Passage）

The Question of Animal Cultures

Can animals be said to possess culture? Many scientists argue that certain species do exhibit cultural traits, defining culture broadly as behaviors learned socially and transmitted across generations. Classic examples include chimpanzees using tools in ways distinctive to their local community, or whales developing group-specific songs that evolve over time. These patterns suggest that at least some animals maintain traditions not rooted solely in genetics or instinct.

Others argue that applying the term "culture" to animals risks stretching the concept beyond usefulness. Human cultures involve symbolic meaning and cumulative innovation---the ability to build on previous discoveries so that knowledge and practices become more sophisticated over generations. Nonhuman species have not convincingly demonstrated these abilities. Animal behaviors that appear cultural may instead reflect adaptation to environmental pressures or simple imitation, not deeper shared understandings.

A middle position acknowledges that while animals may not possess culture in the sense humans do, they can still display rudimentary cultural phenomena. This view emphasizes a continuum rather than a strict divide, suggesting that cultural capacities evolved gradually and appear in varying degrees across species.

Ultimately, whether animals have culture depends on how culture is defined, but growing evidence of socially transmitted behaviors challenges long-held assumptions about the uniqueness of human societies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests which of the following about the songs of whales?

A. They can best be understood as instinctive behaviors related to aspects of whales' environments.
B. They evolve over time in ways that are not typical of behaviors generally accepted as cultural.
C. They are considered by some to be cultural phenomena because they are not uniform across whale groups.
D. They differ from tool use by chimpanzees, in that they reflect the influence of genetics on behavior.

Q2. The author mentions "cumulative innovation" primarily to

A. characterize one view about how culture should be defined
B. explain how some animal behaviors evolve over generations
C. specify which human abilities are shared by some animal species
D. cite one way in which some species adapt to environmental pressures

Q3. The passage indicates that those holding the "middle position"

A. have been accused of stretching the meaning of culture too far

B. differ from most scientists in their view of which behaviors are instinctive
C. consider symbolic meaning to be an essential element of cultures
D. recognize some elements of cultural phenomena in animal behavior

Q4. The word "rudimentary" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. distinct
B. basic
C. productive
D. interesting

Q5. The author would most likely agree that the "long-held assumptions" mentioned in the final paragraph

A. have largely been abandoned by scientists today
B. uphold a definition of culture that is too rigid
C. are supported by recent findings about animal behavior
D. reveal something important about socially transmitted behaviors

Polarized Light Applications

原文（Passage）

Polarized Light's Surprising Applications

Polarized light, characterized by waves vibrating in a single plane, offers applications beyond its familiar use in sunglasses, where it reduces glare from reflective surfaces like water and roads. In certain scientific fields, it is invaluable for revealing hidden properties of materials. For instance, when researchers study the internal structure of crystals, polarized light provides insights that normal light cannot, by interacting differently with the distinct optical paths within the crystal lattice.

[A] In biology, polarized light uncovers structural details of cells and tissues, facilitating breakthroughs in understanding cellular organization and disease mechanisms. [B] This is true for birefringent materials, which alter the polarization of light in ways that reveal microstructural patterns such as fiber alignment and intracellular organization, helping scientists assess variations in cell density and composition. [C] Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques in brain tissue, an indication of Alzheimer's disease. [D]

However, the use of polarized light is not universally beneficial. In aviation, pilots may avoid polarized lenses because they can obscure critical visual cues, such as instrument readings, that are essential for navigation. Thus, while polarized light can solve certain visibility issues by reducing glare, it may also interfere with necessary visual information, prompting careful consideration of context before implementation.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "invaluable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. recommended
B. convenient
C. extremely useful

D. very expensive

Q2. All of the following are mentioned as applications of polarized light EXCEPT:

A. It is used in sunglasses to reduce glare.

B. It can reveal hidden properties in crystals.

C. It can be used to alter cell structure.

D. It aids in analyzing cellular composition.

Q3. What can be inferred about the use of polarized light in medicine?

A. It can help doctors diagnose diseases.

B. It is still in its early stages of implementation.

C. It offers new ways to treat Alzheimer's disease.

D. Its use is somewhat controversial.

Q4. Polarized lenses are potentially dangerous in aviation because they can

A. give pilots a false sense of confidence.

B. increase glare in the cockpit.

C. become foggy at high altitudes.

D. make it difficult to see aircraft instruments.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "Applications are not limited to the inorganic world." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "In biology, polarized light uncovers structural details of cells and tissues..."

B. Before "This is true for birefringent materials..."

C. Before "Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques..."

D. After "Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques in brain tissue, an indication of Alzheimer's disease."

Two Lizards

原文（Passage）

Herpetology: A Tale of Two Lizards

Herpetologists have closely studied the interaction between two species of lizards---the native green anole (*Anolis carolinensis*) and the invasive brown anole (*Anolis sagrei*)---in the southeastern United States. Although the two species are similar in size, they occupy different vertical zones: green anoles are found in the tree canopy (treetops), while brown anoles dominate ground-level habitats.

Initially, this vertical separation was interpreted as a natural habitat preference, but further research suggests that it is a defensive response by green anoles to avoid direct competition. Scientists now believe that green anoles were displaced upward due to aggressive territorial behavior by brown anoles. One theory proposes that this forced shift has triggered rapid evolutionary changes in green anoles. Researchers have documented the development of larger toe pads and more lamellae---microscopic scales that enhance grip---allowing green anoles to navigate thinner branches more effectively.

Meanwhile, brown anoles have adapted as well, showing changes in limb length and body coloration in response to new environments and predators. In one Florida study, brown anoles exposed to higher predation developed shorter limbs, which may improve maneuverability in

dense vegetation. These findings reveal how competitive pressure can reshape species behavior and morphology within just a few generations, offering a real-time glimpse into evolutionary change.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be concluded from the passage about green anoles?

A. They lived on the ground before changes in their habitat.
B. They often become aggressive to defend their territory.
C. They encounter many competitors in the tree canopy.
D. They eat largely the same diet as brown anoles do.

Q2. Why does the passage mention "larger toe pads and more lamellae" in green anoles?

A. To emphasize a competitive advantage of green anoles over brown anoles
B. To illustrate an evolutionary response to environmental pressure
C. To indicate a general characteristic of lizard species living in trees
D. To suggest a reason for the decline in the green anole population

Q3. The word "scales" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. weights
B. plates
C. fibers
D. hooks

Q4. According to paragraph 3, brown anoles may develop shorter limbs to help them with

A. blending into their environment
B. catching fast-moving prey
C. escaping more easily from predators
D. hiding among thin branches

Q5. The passage indicates that studies of the relationship between green anoles and brown anoles are valuable for which of the following reasons?

A. They suggest a way to reduce the harmful effects of invasive species.
B. They allow researchers to witness evolutionary mechanisms at work.
C. They show that adaptations take much longer than previously thought.
D. They provide a glimpse of the complex interplay between predators and prey.

2026-08-29（2 套）

2026-08-29 Ancient Mars Climate

原文（Passage）

Water and Climate on Ancient Mars

Despite Mars's bleak, cold climate today, there is abundant geologic evidence that liquid water once flowed on the Martian surface. The evidence of past flows includes river channels, now dry, that were once carved by powerful floods, valley networks of branching streams and tributaries indicating precipitation falling over wide areas, and salt and other minerals that dissolved in liquid water and were left behind when water evaporated. When that ancient wet period existed and when it ended is difficult to say.

The other way to date a planetary surface, which is used when rock samples are unavailable, is by counting craters. The longer a surface has been exposed to meteorite bombardment, the more craters it will have. This gives the relative age, and allows one to determine which surfaces are older and which are younger. The general conclusion is that a wet period occurred early in Mars's 4.5-billion-year history.

This causes a problem for Mars climate science, because the Sun's luminosity was supposed to be lower — the Sun fainter, perhaps by 20 or 30 percent, during the Mars wet period. Yet a watery Mars arguably would have required relatively warm temperatures. The same problem exists for Earth, which appears to have been warmer billions of years ago than it is today. Geologists have called this the "faint young Sun paradox." The solution to the paradox probably lies in climate science and not in the theory of stellar evolution, but the issue has not been entirely settled.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary focus of the passage?

A. Evidence for ancient water on Mars and the climate difficulties this evidence raises
B. An explanation of why Mars's current climate is cold and dry
C. A comparison of dating methods used to study planetary surfaces
D. The role of the Sun's luminosity in shaping conditions on both Earth and Mars

Q2. According to the passage, what does crater counting reveal about a planetary surface?

A. The frequency with which underground aquifers released water
B. The precise calendar date on which the surface first formed
C. The relative age of the surface compared to other surfaces
D. The chemical composition of the minerals deposited on the surface

Q3. The word "luminosity" in paragraph 3 is closest in meaning to

A. distance
B. temperature
C. stability
D. brightness

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about the "faint young Sun paradox"?

A. It has been resolved primarily through advances in the theory of stellar evolution.
B. Scientists have not yet reached a definitive explanation for it.
C. It applies only to Mars and has no bearing on Earth's geological record.
D. It demonstrates that crater counting is an unreliable dating method.

Q5. Why does the author mention valley networks and river channels in the first paragraph?

A. To explain how crater counting can be applied to interpret Martian geology
B. To contrast the ancient Martian landscape with its present barren surface
C. To illustrate the variety of geologic features that support the presence of ancient water
D. To argue that Mars once had a climate warmer than Earth's current climate

2026-08-29 Polarized Light Applications

原文（Passage）

Polarized Light's Surprising Applications

Polarized light, characterized by waves vibrating in a single plane, offers applications beyond its familiar use in sunglasses, where it reduces glare from reflective surfaces like water and roads. In certain scientific fields, it is invaluable for revealing hidden properties of materials. For instance, when researchers study the internal structure of crystals, polarized light provides insights that normal light cannot, by interacting differently with the distinct optical paths within the crystal lattice.

[A] In biology, polarized light uncovers structural details of cells and tissues, facilitating breakthroughs in understanding cellular organization and disease mechanisms. [B] This is true for birefringent materials, which alter the polarization of light in ways that reveal microstructural patterns such as fiber alignment and intracellular organization, helping scientists assess

variations in cell density and composition. [C] Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques in brain tissue, an indication of Alzheimer's disease. [D] However, the use of polarized light is not universally beneficial. In aviation, pilots may avoid polarized lenses because they can obscure critical visual cues, such as instrument readings, that are essential for navigation. Thus, while polarized light can solve certain visibility issues by reducing glare, it may also interfere with necessary visual information, prompting careful consideration of context before implementation.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "invaluable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. recommended
B. convenient
C. extremely useful
D. very expensive

Q2. All of the following are mentioned as applications of polarized light EXCEPT:

A. It is used in sunglasses to reduce glare.
B. It can reveal hidden properties in crystals.
C. It can be used to alter cell structure.
D. It aids in analyzing cellular composition.

Q3. What can be inferred about the use of polarized light in medicine?

A. It can help doctors diagnose diseases.
B. It is still in its early stages of implementation.
C. It offers new ways to treat Alzheimer's disease.
D. Its use is somewhat controversial.

Q4. Polarized lenses are potentially dangerous in aviation because they can

A. give pilots a false sense of confidence
B. increase glare in the cockpit
C. become foggy at high altitudes
D. make it difficult to see aircraft instruments

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Applications are not limited to the inorganic world. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "In biology, polarized light uncovers structural details of cells and tissues..."
B. Before "This is true for birefringent materials..."
C. Before "Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques..."
D. After "Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques in brain tissue, an indication of Alzheimer's disease."

2026-08-25（2 套）

2026-08-25 Ancient Glacier Air

原文（Passage）

Ancient Air in Glaciers

Glaciers, repositories of ancient ice, serve as frozen libraries of Earth's climatic history. As snow accumulates and compresses over centuries, it traps air bubbles that create tiny atmospheric snapshots. These bubbles are crucial for understanding climate evolution. By analyzing the gases within the bubbles, researchers are able to reconstruct past concentrations of greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide and methane, revealing both natural climate cycles and the escalating impact of human activity.

Though many glaciers are retreating due to rising temperatures, surviving ones offer a window into the past. Scientists drill deep into the ice to extract cylindrical cores, whose layers, much like tree rings, correspond to distinct time periods. These layers contain more than just gases: They hold chemical and physical markers of past environmental events. Ice cores can reveal data about volcanic eruptions via ash and sulfate layers, solar activity via isotopic changes, and forest fires via trapped particulates and black carbon.

Recent studies underscore the precarious future of these icy archives. As glaciers melt, they contribute to rising sea levels, and the risk that invaluable climate data will be lost increases. The urgency to study and preserve these records grows. While scientists race against time, the question remains: what secrets do these frozen giants still hold?

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that explains the natural process by which climate data is preserved. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Glaciers, repositories of ancient ice, serve as frozen libraries of Earth's climatic history.

B. As snow accumulates and compresses over centuries, it traps air bubbles that create tiny atmospheric snapshots.

C. These bubbles are crucial for understanding climate evolution.

D. By analyzing the gases within the bubbles, researchers are able to reconstruct past concentrations of greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide and methane, revealing both natural climate cycles and the escalating impact of human activity.

Q2. The word "escalating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. increasing

B. continuing

C. powerful

D. damaging

Q3. According to the passage, all of the following are true about ice cores EXCEPT:

A. Ice cores are obtained by drilling far down into glaciers.

B. Each layer in an ice core formed at a different point in time.

C. Ice core layers are sometimes destroyed by severe environmental events.

D. Ice cores can be used to identify when volcanoes erupted in the past.

Q4. Why does the author mention "tree rings"?

A. To compare the usefulness of trees and ice cores for studying past climates

B. To highlight the extreme age of some layers of ice cores

C. To illustrate the layering that exists in ice cores

D. To contrast the physical markers present in tree rings with the chemical markers found in ice cores

Q5. The passage implies that scientists should

A. look quickly for other sources of valuable climate data

B. increase the size of the ice cores they drill

C. find ways to limit the rise of sea levels

D. work as quickly as possible to collect more ice cores

2026-08-25 Person-Centered Therapy

原文（Passage）

Person-Centered Therapy: A Shift in Focus

When American psychologist Carl Rogers first introduced person-centered therapy in the mid-twentieth century, the prevailing view was that therapists should be experts in diagnosis and

treatment. Instead, in his new approach, Rogers centered the patient as an individual who is able to discover and take steps toward personal growth. Counseling was viewed as a collaborative interaction between the professional and the patient, with the latter playing a key role in effecting change.

One of Rogers' core beliefs was that a nonjudgmental environment fosters self-discovery. The therapist acts as an empathetic facilitator, listening actively and using reflection—paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying the client's words—to elicit the client's feelings. Rogers claimed this approach allows individuals to gain the self-awareness and self-acceptance needed to grow personally and resolve issues. Rogers' research suggested that the most successful patients were those who experienced the highest degree of empathy in therapy.

Unlike Rogers' model, earlier clinical approaches foregrounded issues and behaviors of concern, with the therapist diagnosing them and specifying treatment courses. Critics question the effectiveness of Rogers' approach for patients seeking expert guidance, especially those with severe mental-health challenges who need structured intervention. However, Rogers' theories remain influential: The person-centered paradigm is seen in various therapeutic approaches.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "prevailing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. dominant
B. successful
C. traditional
D. scientific

Q2. According to the passage, all of the following were characteristics of Rogers' patient-centered approach EXCEPT

A. relying on each patient's own diagnostic expertise
B. creating a supportive context for treatment
C. listening carefully to the patient
D. promoting self-development by patients

Q3. Why does the author of the passage mention "paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying"?

A. To specify the note-taking that therapists do during patient sessions
B. To clarify the concept of reflection in patient-centered therapy
C. To illustrate some tools patients use to promote personal growth
D. To explain how Rogers conducted research on therapeutic models

Q4. The passage suggests which of the following about therapeutic approaches in the United States before the mid-twentieth century?

A. They were abandoned after Rogers became influential.
B. They were not effective for patients with severe mental-health challenges.
C. They were not backed by sufficient clinical research.
D. They did not view empathy as a key therapeutic methodology.

Q5. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that best explains the intended outcomes for a patient receiving person-centered therapy. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. One of Rogers' core beliefs was that a nonjudgmental environment fosters self-discovery.
B. The therapist acts as an empathetic facilitator, listening actively and using reflection—paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying the client's words—to elicit the client's feelings.
C. Rogers claimed this approach allows individuals to gain the self-awareness and self-acceptance needed to grow personally and resolve issues.
D. Rogers' research suggested that the most successful patients were those who experienced the highest degree of empathy in therapy.

2026-08-22（18 套）

KPO 14 - American Women at War

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Second World War and American Women in the Workforce

The Second World War created an acute labor shortage in the United States. As millions of men entered the armed forces, factories that produced ships, aircraft, weapons, and other military supplies urgently needed additional workers. Government agencies and private companies therefore encouraged women to enter jobs that had previously been considered unsuitable for them. Women welded aircraft frames, operated heavy machinery, inspected munitions, and worked in shipyards and aircraft plants. By 1945, women made up about 37 percent of the civilian labor force, an increase of roughly six million workers compared with 1940.

Government posters and newsreels often presented women's wartime labor as a patriotic duty. At the same time, many officials described this work as temporary. Women were praised for helping the nation during an emergency, but the public message frequently suggested that they would return to domestic life when the war ended and male soldiers came home. This mixed message shaped the way women's employment was understood during the war: it was both celebrated as necessary and limited by traditional expectations.

Historians disagree about the long-term significance of this period. Some argue that wartime employment permanently expanded women's sense of economic possibility and helped prepare later movements for workplace equality. Others point out that after the war, many women were dismissed from industrial jobs or encouraged to leave them so that returning men could be rehired. In many factories, male workers replaced women in the very positions women had held successfully during the war. The wartime experience was therefore both a breakthrough and a reminder of the barriers that still restricted women's work.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "acute" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. severe
B. brief
C. unusual
D. expected

Q2. Why does the passage mention that women "welded aircraft frames"?

A. To identify the kinds of industrial jobs women began doing during the war
B. To show that women were trained mainly for military service
C. To argue that aircraft production was the only industry affected by the war
D. To explain why women were unable to continue working after the war

Q3. What is suggested about the government's attitude toward women's wartime employment?

A. It believed women should permanently replace male workers in factories.
B. It expected women's industrial work to last only during the wartime emergency.
C. It opposed women's participation in industrial production.
D. It required women to remain in domestic roles throughout the war.

Q4. What is the main point of disagreement among historians mentioned in the passage?

A. Whether wartime factories produced enough military equipment
B. Whether women were physically able to perform industrial labor

C. Whether wartime employment had a lasting effect on women's work opportunities
D. Whether the government used posters to recruit women workers

Q5. According to the passage, what happened in many factories after the war ended?

A. Women were promoted to managerial positions.
B. Men took over many industrial jobs that women had held during the war.
C. Industrial production increased because women continued working.
D. Government agencies required factories to keep all female workers.

KPO 15 - Stretching Benefits

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Stretching: Benefits and Drawbacks

Stretching has long been recommended as a way to increase flexibility and reduce the risk of injury. Athletes, dancers, and casual exercisers often stretch before or after physical activity, but research has shown that the effects of stretching depend strongly on timing, context, and type. Treating all stretching as equally helpful can be misleading.

[A] Dynamic stretching uses controlled, flowing movements that gradually prepare muscles and joints for activity. Leg swings, arm circles, and walking lunges are examples. Because these movements resemble the motions used during exercise, dynamic stretching can raise body temperature, increase blood flow, and improve performance when done before training or competition. [B] Static stretching, by contrast, involves holding a position for an extended period. Although it can improve long-term flexibility, performing long static stretches immediately before intense activity may temporarily impair strength and power. [C] For this reason, many trainers recommend static stretching after exercise, when muscles are warm and the goal is recovery or flexibility rather than peak performance. [D]

The benefits and drawbacks of stretching therefore cannot be separated from how it is used. A routine that helps one athlete recover after training may reduce another athlete's explosiveness before a sprint. Effective stretching is less a single rule than a set of choices matched to the activity, the body, and the moment.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, all of the following are possible results of dynamic stretching EXCEPT

A. warming the body before activity
B. increasing blood flow
C. improving performance before exercise
D. reducing an athlete's range of motion

Q2. The word "impair" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. weaken
B. measure
C. increase
D. protect

Q3. According to the passage, when are athletes most likely to benefit from static stretching?

A. Immediately before a sprint
B. During a competitive event
C. After training has ended
D. Before the muscles are warm

Q4. Why does the author mention "timing, context, and type"?

A. To show that stretching has no reliable benefits
B. To describe three parts of a formal training schedule
C. To identify factors that influence the effect of stretching
D. To explain why athletes should avoid stretching before exercise

Q5. There are four locations [A]-[D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Not all stretching, however, prepares the body in the same way. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 16 - Visual Perception

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Vision: A Complex System

Vision may seem like a simple recording of the outside world, but it is actually a complex system of selection, interpretation, and reconstruction. The eyes receive enormous amounts of visual information, yet the brain cannot treat all of it with equal importance. Instead, specialized neural pathways filter incoming signals and give priority to information that may matter for survival. Sudden movement, for example, is often noticed more quickly than a stationary object because movement may indicate danger or opportunity.

Another sign of visual complexity is the blind spot, an area of the retina where no image is detected because the optic nerve leaves the eye there. Most people are unaware of its presence because the brain automatically fills in the missing information using surrounding visual patterns. This process happens so smoothly that the completed image feels continuous, even though part of the visual field has been reconstructed rather than directly seen.

Selective attention also shapes what people notice. In a crowded room, a person searching for a green book may overlook many objects that are simultaneously present. The brain does not become equally sensitive to every detail in the scene; instead, it emphasizes the features related to the task, such as color, shape, and location. Vision, then, is not passive seeing. It is an active process in which the brain organizes visual input according to need and expectation.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the passage mention stationary objects and sudden movement?

A. To show that the brain gives priority to information related to survival
B. To argue that stationary objects are easier to see than moving objects
C. To explain why people cannot see objects in bright light
D. To show that the eye records every object with equal accuracy

Q2. The phrase "its presence" in the passage refers to

A. the optic nerve
B. the blind spot
C. the surrounding visual pattern
D. the completed image

Q3. The word "simultaneously" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. at the same time
B. in a different place
C. with little effort

D. after careful planning

Q4. According to the passage, all of the following are involved when a person searches for a green book in a crowded room EXCEPT

A. attention to color

B. attention to shape

C. attention to location

D. increased sensitivity to green objects in shadows

Q5. How are paragraphs 2 and 3 related?

A. Paragraph 2 gives a historical example, and paragraph 3 challenges it.

B. Paragraph 2 explains the eye's anatomy, and paragraph 3 discusses only memory.

C. Both paragraphs provide examples showing that vision is more complex than passive recording.

D. Both paragraphs argue that visual perception is usually inaccurate.

KPO 17 - Data Visualization

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Data Visualization in Action

Data visualization has become an important tool for understanding large and complicated sets of information. Traditional charts, such as bar graphs and line graphs, can communicate basic relationships clearly, but they are often limited when the information contains many variables or changes over time. Modern visualization techniques therefore increasingly use dynamic forms, including heat maps, time-lapse animations, and network graphs.

These visual tools can reveal patterns and anomalies that might remain hidden in raw data. A heat map may show where customer activity is concentrated, while a time-lapse animation can show how traffic patterns change during a day. Network graphs can display relationships among people, organizations, or ideas that would be difficult to understand from a table alone. [A] Interactive dashboards add another layer of usefulness. They allow users to adjust variables, filter categories, and compare different scenarios. [B] A city planner, for example, might examine how changing bus frequency affects commute times in several neighborhoods. A business analyst might test how sales patterns differ by region or season. [C] The effectiveness of a dashboard, however, depends on the user's ability to interpret complex visual cues. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "anomalies" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. irregularities

B. instructions

C. measurements

D. similarities

Q2. According to the passage, what is one limitation of traditional charts?

A. They cannot show any relationship between numbers.

B. They may be limited when communicating complex information.

C. They are useful only for business analysts.

D. They always hide patterns in raw data.

Q3. There are four locations [A]-[D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Yet even these tools require careful design if viewers are to understand what they show. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]

B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

Q4. All of the following are mentioned as possible uses or features of interactive dashboards EXCEPT

A. allowing users to adjust variables
B. helping users compare scenarios
C. filtering categories of information
D. helping company leaders communicate better with one another

Q5. What is the primary purpose of the passage?

A. To argue that all traditional charts should be abandoned
B. To explain how visualization can reveal patterns in complex data
C. To describe the history of computer animation
D. To compare city planning with business analysis

KPO 18 - American Veganism

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Veganism in the United States

Veganism is a diet and lifestyle that excludes animal products, including meat, dairy, and eggs. In the United States, interest in veganism increased noticeably during the early twenty-first century. A 2020 study reported that the number of people adopting vegan diets rose sharply between 2004 and 2019. Many people were drawn to veganism because of concerns about animal welfare, the environmental effects of industrial agriculture, and the possible health benefits of eating more plant-based foods.

During the 2010s, plant-based meat substitutes became widely available in restaurants and supermarkets. These products were designed to make vegan or vegetarian eating easier for people who missed the taste and texture of meat. Vegan cheese substitutes served a similar purpose, although they also showed how difficult it can be to reproduce familiar animal-based foods without using animal ingredients. The production of commercial meat substitutes was sometimes involved, requiring processing, flavoring, and added ingredients. As a result, some consumers began to question whether such products were as healthy as they first appeared.

By the mid-2020s, the growth of veganism had slowed. A 2025 survey suggested that only about 3 to 4 percent of Americans identified as vegan. This did not mean that plant-based eating had disappeared; many people continued to reduce meat consumption without fully adopting veganism. The trend shows a shift from rapid enthusiasm toward a more complicated public attitude, in which ethical, environmental, practical, and health concerns all interact.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To analyze changes in American attitudes toward veganism
B. To argue that all Americans should become vegan
C. To describe the history of dairy farming in the United States
D. To explain why vegan products are no longer sold in supermarkets

Q2. All of the following are mentioned as reasons for interest in veganism EXCEPT

A. concern for animal welfare
B. concern about industrial agriculture's environmental effects
C. interest in possible health benefits

D. the high cost of meat

Q3. The word "involved" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. brief
B. complicated
C. natural
D. accidental

Q4. Why does the author mention vegan cheese substitutes?

A. To show that vegan products are always healthier than dairy products
B. To argue that cheese is the main reason people become vegan
C. To point out a practical difficulty in making vegan diets resemble familiar foods
D. To explain why restaurants stopped serving plant-based meals

Q5. What is suggested about commercial meat substitutes?

A. Their production made veganism illegal in some states.
B. Their methods of production caused some people to question their healthfulness.
C. They completely replaced traditional meat in the American diet.
D. They were unpopular throughout the 2010s.

KPO 19 - Smart Buildings

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Data Science and the Buildings of Tomorrow

Smart buildings use data science to make buildings more efficient, comfortable, and responsive. Sensors and Internet of Things devices, such as smart thermostats, collect information about energy use, temperature, air quality, lighting, and the movement of people through a building. Instead of treating a building as a static structure, designers can use this data to adjust systems in real time.

One common application is smart heating, ventilation, and air conditioning. A smart HVAC system can reduce energy use by cooling only the rooms that are occupied or by adjusting airflow when indoor air quality changes. In hospitals, such systems may help maintain stable temperatures and cleaner air in sensitive areas. In office spaces, data about occupancy can help managers reduce wasted energy while keeping workers comfortable.

These technologies can lower costs and reduce the environmental impact of buildings. However, they also raise privacy concerns. Sensors that track movement or room use may collect information that some building users do not recognize or approve of. For smart buildings to succeed, designers must balance efficiency with transparency, privacy, and user trust.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "static" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. unchanging
B. expensive
C. crowded
D. temporary

Q2. All of the following are mentioned about data science in buildings EXCEPT

A. It can help monitor energy use.
B. It can help improve comfort.
C. It can help adjust building systems in real time.
D. It requires architects to receive specialized training in data analysis.

Q3. What is one possible drawback of using sensors in smart buildings?

A. Some users may not approve of how information about them is collected.
B. Sensors prevent buildings from reducing energy use.
C. Sensors make indoor temperatures impossible to control.
D. Some users may be unable to enter smart buildings.

Q4. Why does the passage mention hospitals and office spaces?

A. To show that smart buildings are useful only in medical settings
B. To compare public buildings with private homes
C. To demonstrate how data systems can improve different kinds of infrastructure
D. To argue that hospitals use more energy than offices

Q5. According to the passage, what is one major benefit of smart buildings?

A. They eliminate the need for building managers.
B. They can reduce the environmental impact of buildings.
C. They prevent all privacy problems.
D. They make buildings independent of electricity.

KPO 20 - Floating Wind Turbines

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Floating Wind Turbines

Wind turbines are large devices with long blades that capture wind energy and convert it into electricity. Floating wind turbines are a special type of wind turbine because they are not fixed to the seabed but are anchored using advanced mooring systems, allowing placement in deeper waters where winds are more consistent. In this context, anchoring refers to securing the turbine in place using cables or chains connected to weighted structures or anchors on the ocean floor, ensuring stability despite the lack of a fixed foundation. The deeper placement means the wind turbines can harness untapped wind resources that traditional turbines cannot access.

Engineering floating turbines involves unique challenges. They rely on buoyancy principles rather than on solid ground, making their design and maintenance complex. Despite the increased costs, their ability to reduce visual and noise pollution makes them an attractive option for distant offshore locations. However, their long-term viability is threatened by harsh marine conditions that can accelerate wear and tear.

[A] Research continues to explore solutions for these problems. [B] Some experts are investigating materials and designs to enhance durability. [C] As efforts to capitalize on deeper offshore wind resources persist, floating turbines represent both a promising opportunity and a complex engineering puzzle. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "harness" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. limit
B. distribute
C. release
D. exploit

Q2. What unique advantage do floating wind turbines have over traditional turbines?

A. They are larger in size and have longer blades.
B. They require less maintenance.
C. They can be placed in deeper waters.
D. They are easier to design.

Q3. Why does the author mention "buoyancy principles"?

A. To point out a challenge of creating floating turbines
B. To suggest a new area for future research into floating turbines
C. To emphasize the greater flexibility of floating turbines compared with traditional turbines
D. To provide an example of cost-saving measures related to floating turbines

Q4. What can be inferred about the acceleration of "wear and tear" in floating turbines?

A. Any attempts to reduce it will likely prove unsuccessful.
B. Scientists are working to control it through better designs and materials.
C. It is prompting engineers to place floating wind turbines closer to shore.
D. It makes floating turbines especially unattractive to look at.

Q5. There are four locations [A]-[D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Others assess economic models that might offset higher initial expenses. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 21 - GMO Foods

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

GMO Foods

Genetically modified foods are produced with techniques that alter the genetic material of plants or animals. In agriculture, genetic modification can create crops that resist insects, tolerate drought, or contain enhanced nutrients. One well-known example is rice engineered to contain vitamin A, which was developed to address nutritional deficiencies in some populations. Other modified crops may require fewer chemical pesticides because they are better able to resist common pests.

Supporters argue that GM technology can increase food security by making crops more productive and persistent under difficult environmental conditions. If a crop can survive dry weather or resist insects for a longer period, farmers may lose fewer plants and harvest more food. Genetic modification can also allow scientists to develop traits more precisely than some traditional breeding methods.

Critics, however, raise concerns about ecological risks, corporate control, and the rapid pace of technological change. Patented GM seeds may require farmers to purchase seeds from large companies each year, giving those companies considerable influence over agricultural choices. Some people also worry that new varieties are introduced faster than communities and regulators can fully evaluate them. Debates about GMO foods therefore involve both scientific possibilities and social questions about who controls food production.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary purpose of the passage?

A. To summarize potential benefits and concerns related to GM technology
B. To argue that all traditional farming methods should be abandoned
C. To describe only the dangers of vitamin A rice
D. To explain why farmers refuse to use all new seeds

Q2. The word "persistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. expensive
B. long-lasting

C. artificial
D. unfamiliar

Q3. According to the passage, genetic modification can do all of the following EXCEPT

A. help crops resist insects
B. improve the nutritional content of crops
C. help crops tolerate drought
D. improve the natural fertility of soil

Q4. What concern is raised about patented GM seeds?

A. They are always less productive than traditional seeds.
B. They cannot be used in dry environments.
C. They may place farmers under unfair corporate control.
D. They prevent scientists from studying plant genetics.

Q5. Why does the author mention the rapid pace of technological change?

A. To show that GM crops are no longer being developed
B. To explain one reason some people resist the implementation of GM technology
C. To prove that regulators have already solved all GM-related concerns
D. To argue that traditional breeding is always faster than genetic modification

KPO 22 - Quilt Artistry

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Artistry of Quilts

Quilts have often been classified as household crafts rather than works of fine art. Because they were used as bed coverings and were commonly made by women in domestic settings, their artistic value was frequently overlooked. This distinction between craft and art has shaped the way museums, critics, and collectors have judged many objects made for everyday use.

The quilts made by African American women in Gee's Bend, Alabama, challenge this division. Although the quilts were rooted in daily life and practical need, they display deliberate design, cultural expression, and aesthetic innovation. Their bold improvisation, asymmetry, and unexpected color combinations have often been compared to modernist painting. Unlike many modernist works created within formal art institutions, however, the quilts emerged from a practice rooted in everyday experience.

Seeing these quilts as art does not require ignoring their usefulness. Instead, their usefulness is part of their meaning. They operate as records of community, labor, memory, and invention. These quilts therefore offer another choice beyond the rigid division between craft and art: they show that practical objects can also be works of aesthetic imagination.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main distinction discussed in the first paragraph?

A. Between museum collections and private collections
B. Between a work of craft and a work of art
C. Between modern painting and ancient sculpture
D. Between domestic labor and industrial production

Q2. Why does the author mention that the quilts came from a practice "rooted in everyday experience"?

A. To show that the quilts lacked deliberate design
B. To argue that domestic objects cannot be works of art
C. To contrast the quilts' practical origins with qualities associated with modernist art

D. To explain why the quilts were made only for museums

Q3. The phrase "operate as" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. serve as
B. depend on
C. compete with
D. disappear from

Q4. What is the author's view of the traditional distinction between craft and art?

A. It has helped all artists receive equal attention.
B. It has caused some artistically valuable works to be overlooked.
C. It proves that useful objects cannot have aesthetic value.
D. It is no longer relevant to any museum collection.

Q5. What is the function of the final sentence of the passage?

A. To reject the idea that quilts have practical uses
B. To describe the materials used to make Gee's Bend quilts
C. To argue that modernist painting was influenced only by quilts
D. To offer an alternative to a rigid division between craft and art

KPO 23 - Wartime Women

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Second World War and American Women in the Workforce

During World War II, the United States faced an acute labor shortage as millions of men entered military service. Employers therefore recruited women into jobs traditionally performed by men. Women welded aircraft frames, worked in shipyards and munitions plants, drove trucks, and operated heavy machinery. By 1945, women made up about 37 percent of the civilian labor force, roughly six million more than in 1940. Government campaigns presented this work as patriotic and necessary to victory, but they generally described women's industrial employment as a temporary response to wartime conditions.

The experience challenged assumptions about the kinds of work women could perform. Women successfully carried out skilled and physically demanding jobs that had previously been considered unsuitable for them, and many acquired technical skills and greater economic independence. Some historians therefore argue that wartime employment weakened traditional ideas about gender and helped prepare the way for later changes in women's participation in paid work.

Other historians emphasize the limits of this transformation. When the war ended and servicemen returned home, many employers dismissed or reassigned female workers so that men could resume their former positions. Women did not disappear from the labor force, but their presence in many heavy industrial occupations declined sharply. The historical debate therefore centers not on whether wartime employment changed women's lives, but on how permanent those changes were.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "acute" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. temporary

B. severe
C. regional
D. ordinary

Q2. Why mention women "welding aircraft frames"?
A. To identify wartime jobs women entered
B. To show women already had industrial training
C. To show factory work was safer
D. To explain why women earned more than men

Q3. What was the government's attitude?
A. Women's industrial work should become permanent.
B. Women's labor was needed, but largely as a temporary wartime measure.
C. Women should not enter men's occupations.
D. Employers should guarantee women's postwar jobs.

Q4. What is the historians' central disagreement?
A. Whether women could perform industrial work
B. Whether wartime employment had lasting effects
C. Whether labor shortages existed
D. Whether women supported the war

Q5. What happened after the war?
A. Women kept nearly all industrial jobs.
B. Industrial employment expanded further for women.
C. Women became most of the labor force.
D. Men replaced women in many industrial positions.

KPO 24 - Stretching Effects

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Stretching: Benefits and Drawbacks

Stretching is commonly included in exercise programs because it can increase flexibility and prepare the body for movement. Yet not all stretching produces the same effects. Dynamic stretching involves controlled, repeated movements that take muscles and joints through a useful range of motion. A runner, for example, might perform walking lunges or leg swings before a race. Such movements gradually raise muscle temperature, increase blood flow, and rehearse motions similar to those required during exercise. Dynamic stretching is therefore often recommended before activities demanding speed, jumping, or rapid changes in direction.

Static stretching is different. Instead of moving continuously, a person holds a muscle in an extended position for a period of time. Regular static stretching can improve flexibility, but [A] research suggests that prolonged static stretching immediately before demanding exercise may temporarily impair maximum strength or explosive power. [B] The effect is generally modest and short-lived, yet even a small decline can matter to an athlete preparing to sprint, jump, or lift a heavy weight. [C]

[D] This does not mean that static stretching is harmful. It may be useful after training, when an immediate reduction in force production matters

less, or as part of a long-term flexibility program. Dynamic stretching may be more appropriate immediately before vigorous activity. The evidence therefore shows why the timing, context, and type of stretching must all be considered rather than treating stretching as universally beneficial or harmful.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Dynamic stretching can do all EXCEPT

A. raise muscle temperature
B. prepare rapid movement
C. move joints through a range
D. reduce range of motion

Q2. The word "impair" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. weaken
B. measure
C. restore
D. delay

Q3. Athletes are most likely to benefit from static stretching

A. immediately before explosive activity
B. during competition
C. after training
D. before dynamic warm-up

Q4. Why mention "timing, context, and type"?

A. To identify factors determining stretching's effects
B. To prescribe one fixed routine
C. To reject static stretching
D. To prioritize flexibility over strength

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Sentence: "This temporary effect can matter greatly in activities that require an immediate burst of force."

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 25 - Visual Processing

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Vision: A Complex System

Vision may seem like a straightforward recording of the world, but the human visual system is highly selective. At any moment, the eyes receive far more information than the brain can analyze in detail. Specialized neural pathways therefore give priority to signals that may be important for immediate action or survival. Sudden movement, for example, often attracts attention more readily than a stationary object because unexpected motion could indicate an approaching animal, vehicle, or other potential threat.

This selectivity can create surprising gaps in awareness. In experiments, people concentrating intensely on one visual task sometimes

fail to notice an unexpected object that appears directly in front of them. The eyes may receive information about the object and parts of the brain may register its presence, yet the observer never becomes consciously aware of it. At the same time, the visual system automatically fills in incomplete information, allowing people to experience a stable scene even when sensory input contains gaps.
Selective attention also affects ordinary searches. A person looking for a green book in a crowded room may overlook it when many colors, shapes, and objects simultaneously compete for attention. Location, lighting, expectations, and surrounding objects can all affect what becomes noticeable. These examples show that vision is not a complete and neutral record of the environment. Instead, perception is an active process in which the brain filters, prioritizes, and interprets incoming information.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why contrast stationary objects and sudden movement?

A. Different organs process them
B. To illustrate visual prioritization
C. Movement is always dangerous
D. Stationary objects are invisible

Q2. "Its presence" refers to

A. the task
B. the brain
C. the unexpected object
D. awareness

Q3. The word "simultaneously" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. gradually
B. at the same time
C. deliberately
D. afterward

Q4. The green-book discussion mentions all EXCEPT

A. competing objects
B. shapes
C. visual context
D. special sensitivity to green objects in shadows

Q5. Paragraphs 2 and 3 primarily

A. contradict each other
B. give different examples of selective visual processing
C. compare healthy and impaired vision
D. describe different eye structures

KPO 26 - Data Visualization

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Data Visualization in Action
For much of the history of data analysis, researchers communicated results through tables, bar graphs, line graphs, and other static displays. These formats remain useful because they summarize large

quantities of information efficiently. Yet they become less effective when a data set contains many interacting variables or changes rapidly over time. Modern visualization techniques address this limitation. Heat maps can reveal geographic concentrations, time-lapse displays can show gradual change, and network graphs can expose relationships among individuals or organizations. Such displays may make patterns and anomalies visible that would otherwise remain hidden in rows of numbers.

Interactive dashboards extend this approach by allowing users to manipulate what they see. Rather than viewing one fixed graph, a user may filter observations, select variables, change a time period, or compare regions. A public-health analyst could examine disease rates by age and location, while a business manager could explore sales under different market conditions. The same underlying data can therefore be investigated from several perspectives.

Interactivity, however, does not automatically make information easier to understand. [A] A dashboard containing too many controls, colors, moving elements, or overlapping graphics may overwhelm the viewer. [B] Its usefulness depends partly on the user's ability to interpret complex visual cues and partly on the designer's ability to organize those cues clearly. [C] Interactive visualizations are powerful because they support exploration, but more information on a screen does not necessarily produce greater understanding. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "anomalies" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. irregularities
B. averages
C. comparisons
D. predictions

Q2. Traditional displays may be limited when

A. data are numerical
B. information is complex or changes over time
C. users are scientists
D. colors are absent

Q3. Why mention filtering and changing time periods?

A. To illustrate interactive exploration
B. To discourage access to raw data
C. To show automatic conclusions
D. To describe static charts

Q4. All are stated about dashboards EXCEPT

A. users can modify displays
B. they can support exploration
C. visual interpretation matters
D. they make business leaders communicate better

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Sentence: "The problem becomes especially serious when several visual signals compete for the viewer's attention."

A. [A]
B. [B]

C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 27 - U.S. Veganism

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Veganism in the United States

Veganism, which excludes meat, dairy products, eggs, and other animal-derived foods, became increasingly visible in the United States during the first two decades of the twenty-first century. Surveys and market studies reported substantial growth in interest between 2004 and 2019\. People adopted vegan diets for several reasons, including concern about animal welfare, the environmental effects of industrial livestock production, and perceived health benefits. Growing demand also encouraged restaurants and manufacturers to offer a wider range of plant-based foods.

During the 2010s, companies invested heavily in substitutes intended to resemble familiar animal products. Plant-based burgers became common, and manufacturers attempted to reproduce the taste and texture of milk, eggs, and cheese. This process can be surprisingly involved. Conventional cheese, for example, develops its texture and flavor through complex interactions among proteins, fats, moisture, microorganisms, and chemical processes. Producing a convincing vegan substitute requires manufacturers to create similar effects using very different ingredients.

By the middle of the 2020s, however, the rapid growth in veganism appeared to have slowed. A 2025 survey suggested that only about 3 to 4 percent of Americans identified as vegan. Cost and convenience remained obstacles for some people, while others questioned whether highly processed commercial meat substitutes were necessarily healthy. These concerns do not mean that interest in plant-based eating disappeared; rather, attitudes became more complicated as consumers distinguished between vegan diets in general and particular manufactured products.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Main purpose?

A. Predict veganism will replace meat
B. Analyze changes in U.S. veganism
C. Argue veganism is unhealthy
D. Compare recipes

Q2. All motivated veganism EXCEPT

A. animal welfare
B. environmental concerns
C. perceived health benefits
D. high meat prices

Q3. The word "involved" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. complicated
B. popular

C. cheap
D. familiar

Q4. Why mention vegan cheese?

A. To show dairy is healthier
B. To illustrate a difficulty in making animal-free substitutes
C. To criticize all processed foods
D. To explain why veganism began

Q5. Some commercial meat substitutes cause concern because

A. their processing raises questions about healthfulness
B. they contain hidden meat
C. they cannot be sold nationally
D. they are always more expensive

KPO 28 - Smart Buildings

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Data Science and the Buildings of Tomorrow

Most conventional buildings operate according to relatively static schedules. Heating, cooling, lighting, and ventilation may be adjusted at predetermined times whether or not rooms are occupied. Smart buildings take a different approach. Networks of sensors and Internet-connected devices collect information about temperature, energy consumption, air quality, lighting conditions, and occupancy. Computer systems can analyze these data and respond to changing conditions. An empty conference room, for example, may require little heating or cooling, while a crowded room may need increased ventilation.

The potential benefits extend beyond energy savings. In hospitals, sensors can help facility managers maintain appropriate environmental conditions in spaces with different requirements. In office buildings, data can reveal unusual patterns of electricity use, identify equipment beginning to fail, and help managers schedule maintenance. Similar systems can improve comfort by adjusting heating, ventilation, and air-conditioning more precisely. These examples illustrate how data science can improve urban infrastructure while reducing operating costs and environmental impact.

The same technology also raises concerns. Sensors capable of determining how many people occupy a room may reveal where individuals spend time or how they move through a workplace. Some users may not realize the extent to which their behavior is recorded. Smart-building design therefore requires decisions about which information is genuinely necessary, how long it should be retained, and who should have access to it. Efficiency and privacy must be considered together.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "static" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. unchanging
B. expensive
C. digital

D. efficient

Q2. All are mentioned EXCEPT

A. detecting unusual energy use
B. responding to occupancy
C. predicting maintenance
D. requiring architects to receive specialized data-analysis training

Q3. One drawback of sensors is

A. privacy concern
B. inability to measure temperature
C. higher energy use
D. lack of automation

Q4. Why mention hospitals and offices?

A. To compare their architecture
B. To illustrate how smart systems can improve infrastructure
C. To show only large buildings need sensors
D. To identify where sensors were invented

Q5. Smart-building technology may help

A. eliminate cities
B. reduce buildings' environmental impact
C. eliminate all privacy concerns
D. replace building occupants

KPO 29 - Floating Wind Turbines

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Floating Wind Turbines

Conventional offshore wind turbines are fixed to the seafloor. This design works well in relatively shallow coastal water, but construction becomes difficult and expensive as water depth increases. Floating wind turbines offer another approach. Their towers stand on buoyant platforms held in position by anchors and mooring lines rather than rigid foundations. Because they can be installed farther from shore, floating turbines can harness wind resources in deeper waters, where winds are often stronger and more consistent.

The technology creates new engineering problems. Designers must apply buoyancy principles so that a platform remains stable enough for the turbine to operate while still moving safely with waves. Mooring systems must prevent excessive drift without placing damaging loads on the structure. Installation and maintenance can also be complicated because the turbines may be located far from ports and in rougher seas.

Durability presents another challenge. Saltwater promotes corrosion, while repeated wave motion places cyclic stress on platforms, cables, and turbine components. Together these conditions can accelerate wear and tear. Engineers are investigating corrosion-resistant materials, protective coatings, improved monitoring systems, and platform designs that distribute mechanical loads more effectively. Floating turbines therefore offer access to valuable wind resources that fixed-bottom

turbines cannot easily reach, but their long-term success depends on controlling the demanding conditions of the deep-ocean environment.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "harness" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. exploit
B. avoid
C. weaken
D. measure

Q2. Main advantage of floating turbines?

A. No anchors
B. Placement in deeper water
C. No maintenance
D. No waves

Q3. Why mention "buoyancy principles"?

A. To identify an engineering challenge
B. To explain wind formation
C. To describe corrosion
D. To compare energy prices

Q4. Accelerated wear and tear implies scientists are

A. abandoning offshore wind
B. improving materials and design to control damage
C. moving turbines onshore
D. reducing turbine height

Q5. Main purpose?

A. History of wind power
B. Explain floating turbines' advantage and challenges
C. Compare wind and solar
D. Argue against offshore energy

KPO 30 - Genetically Modified Foods

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Genetically Modified Foods

Genetic modification allows scientists to alter crop traits more directly than is possible through conventional breeding alone. Some genetically modified crops resist insects or tolerate drought, while others are designed to improve nutritional value. Golden Rice, for example, was developed to produce beta-carotene, which the human body can convert to vitamin A. Supporters argue that such crops may reduce losses, improve food quality, and in some situations decrease the amount of pesticide farmers need to apply.

The technology nevertheless raises ecological concerns. Modified genes can potentially spread to related wild plants, and insects exposed repeatedly to pest-resistant crops may evolve resistance. Some environmental effects could be persistent and difficult to reverse once modified organisms have spread. These possibilities have led researchers and regulators to argue for continued monitoring rather than assuming

that all genetically modified crops will have identical effects.
Economic concerns are also important. Many genetically modified seeds are patented, which can restrict farmers' ability to save and replant seed from one season to the next. Critics worry that this arrangement may give large companies excessive control over agricultural production, especially where farmers have few alternative suppliers. At the same time, genetic technologies change rapidly, making it difficult for regulations and public understanding to keep pace. The debate over genetically modified food therefore involves not only biological safety but also questions about ownership, access, and the speed at which new technologies are introduced.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Main purpose?

A. Prove GM food is unsafe
B. Present potential benefits and concerns of GM technology
C. Explain only Golden Rice
D. Promote seed patents

Q2. The word "persistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. expensive
B. long-lasting
C. accidental
D. rare

Q3. GM technology can do all EXCEPT

A. improve nutrition
B. resist pests
C. sometimes reduce pesticide use
D. improve soil fertility directly

Q4. Patented seeds may

A. give farmers complete independence
B. increase farmer dependence on companies
C. eliminate regulation
D. prevent drought

Q5. Why does the author mention that genetic technologies change rapidly?

A. To explain some resistance to implementation
B. To prove all GM crops are new
C. To show breeding is faster
D. To show regulations are unnecessary

KPO 31 - Quilt Artistry

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Artistry of Quilts
Quilts have often been classified as household crafts because they were traditionally made for practical use and associated with domestic labor. This distinction between a work of craft and a work of art may appear straightforward, but critics argue that it has historically caused visually innovative objects to be overlooked by museums and art

historians. Objects made for everyday use were often evaluated primarily according to function and technique, while painting and sculpture were more readily treated as expressions of individual artistic creativity.
The quilts made by African American women in Gee's Bend, Alabama, challenge this division. Their makers worked within a practice rooted in everyday experience, using available cloth to create objects that served practical household needs. Yet many of the quilts display bold improvisation, asymmetry, unexpected color combinations, and striking geometric arrangements. These features resemble qualities admired in twentieth-century modernist painting, although the quilt makers did not simply imitate modernist artists. Their visual language developed from local traditions, available materials, individual choices, and the practical demands of quilt making.
When displayed in museums, the quilts can operate as works of art because viewers attend to their design, cultural expression, and aesthetic innovation as well as their practical history. Recognition of the Gee's Bend quilts therefore provides an alternative to a rigid separation between art and craft. Their example shows that classifications influence which objects receive serious aesthetic attention and that creative work rooted in ordinary life can possess artistic qualities equal to those of objects originally produced for galleries.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What major distinction does paragraph 1 establish?

A. Art versus craft
B. Rural versus urban art
C. Old versus new quilts
D. Painting versus sculpture

Q2. Why mention that the practice was "rooted in everyday experience"?

A. To argue the quilts lacked artistic purpose
B. To contrast their practical origins with qualities associated with modernist art
C. To show the makers studied modernist painters
D. To explain why the quilts were commercially unsuccessful

Q3. The phrase "operate as" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. be sold as
B. serve as
C. be copied by
D. compete with

Q4. What is the author's view of the traditional craft/art distinction?

A. It has sometimes caused significant creative works to be overlooked.
B. It should be strictly maintained.
C. It applies only to quilts.
D. It was created by the Gee's Bend artists.

Q5. Why emphasize bold improvisation, asymmetry, and color?

A. To prove the quilts copied modernist paintings
B. To provide an alternative basis for viewing the quilts as art
C. To show the quilts were difficult to use

D. To explain why all household crafts are modernist

2026-08-21（1 套）

2026-08-21 Arts Education Benefits

原文（Passage）

The Academic Benefits Of Arts

Several recent studies suggest that children's participation in arts programs, whether visual arts, music, drama, or dance, can foster cognitive development. Empirical studies have highlighted positive correlations between arts engagement and improvements in reading, mathematics, language development, and social skills. Similarly, comprehensive analyses emphasize that arts education contributes to both cognitive and emotional growth, which in turn supports academic success.

Broader educational reports reinforce these findings. Schools that integrate the arts into their core curricula often document more positive learning environments. When children collaborate in theater, music ensembles, or group visual arts projects, they build a sense of belonging and shared purpose—key components of motivation and engagement, factors known to influence academic achievement.

Though persuasive, the evidence is not uniformly conclusive. Some studies rely on correlational data—meaning that they demonstrate that arts program participation is related to academic success without proving that arts programs cause academic success. Researchers also note that the benefits of arts education often depend on factors such as teacher expertise and skillful integration of the arts with broader learning goals. And, in some cases, arts programs are too brief or inconsistently delivered to produce measurable academic effects, which may partly explain mixed findings in the literature.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "foster" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. reveal
B. support
C. predict
D. reflect

Q2. The passage mentions each of the following about children who participate in arts programs EXCEPT:

A. They develop lasting artistic abilities.
B. They improve their reading and math abilities.
C. They demonstrate improved emotional growth.
D. Their learning environments may be more positive.

Q3. Which of the sentences below best expresses the essential information in the highlighted sentence in the passage? Incorrect choices change the meaning in important ways or leave out essential information.

A. For children, building a sense of belonging and shared purpose is a more important benefit than improving academic achievement.
B. Different forms of arts programs promote varying levels of motivation, engagement, and academic achievement.
C. Participation in arts programs helps children develop greater motivation and engagement, which supports better academic achievement.
D. When children participate in arts programs, they may improve academic achievement despite being distracted from academic studies.

Q4. The passage indicates which of the following about the "studies"?

A. They do not clearly explain how they establish correlations between arts program participation and academic success.

B. They do not definitely show that academic success is a result of participating in arts programs.

C. They should have compared the effects of different kinds of arts programs on academic performance.

D. They do not use a persuasive way of measuring academic success.

Q5. According to the author, the "mixed findings" are partly due to

A. differences in the ages at which children first enroll in arts programs

B. differences in the ways in which teachers define learning goals

C. the limited expertise of researchers in arts education

D. the relatively brief duration of some arts programs

2026-08-20（3 套）

2026-08-20 Gamma Ray Astronomy

原文（Passage）

Gamma-Ray Astronomy: Unveiling the Universe

Gamma-ray astronomy has transformed our view of the cosmos by enabling scientists to detect some of the universe's most energetic and extreme phenomena, including gamma-ray bursts (GRBs). GRBs have drawn intense interest due to their mysterious origins and immense energy output. Unlike visible light, gamma rays do not penetrate Earth's atmosphere. As a result, astronomers deploy space telescopes to capture signals from cosmic events like supernovae and neutron star collisions.

The launch of the Compton Gamma Ray Observatory in 1991 provided the first comprehensive map of the gamma-ray sky, similar to the way optical telescopes map the visible sky. This breakthrough allowed scientists to pinpoint the locations of GRBs and study their properties in detail. Scientists learned that these bursts occur randomly across the sky and are not confined to our galaxy alone.

Despite the advances, many questions remain. Some hypothesize that GRBs are the result of merging neutron stars, while others suggest they stem from hypernovae, explosive events that dwarf typical supernovae. Each explanation carries implications for our understanding of stellar evolution and cosmic history. New telescopes like the Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope may help astronomers uncover more secrets of these cosmic beacons.

题目（Questions）

Q1. It can be inferred from the passage that space telescopes are used for gamma-ray astronomy primarily because

A. gamma-ray sources produce signals that are too faint to detect with standard instruments

B. gamma rays have physical characteristics that prevent ground-based observation

C. gamma rays come from a region of the universe that is hard to observe from Earth

D. gamma-ray events occur unpredictably and require constant monitoring

Q2. The phrase "confined to" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. limited to

B. returned to

C. trapped by

D. created by

Q3. The Compton Gamma Ray Observatory enabled scientists to

A. create a more accurate map of the visible sky
B. prove that gamma rays come from neutron stars
C. find out where GRBs occur and learn more about them
D. discover regular patterns in the occurrence of GRBs

Q4. Based on the passage, which issue about GRBs remains unresolved?

A. How large GRBs are compared to other cosmic explosions
B. How frequent GRBs are in different regions of the universe
C. The specific processes that give rise to GRBs
D. The total amount of energy released during a typical GRB

Q5. Why does the author mention the Fermi Gamma-ray Space Telescope?

A. To emphasize the importance of international cooperation in gamma-ray research
B. To explain how gamma-ray bursts were first detected
C. To compare modern telescope technology with earlier optical instruments
D. To suggest that new observational tools can help resolve unanswered questions

2026-08-20 Gravitational Physics Applications

原文（Passage）

Gravitational Physics and Its Practical Applications

The concept of gravity has evolved over time. In the seventeenth century, Isaac Newton described gravity as a universal force acting between masses, formalized in his law of universal gravitation. This theory provided a universal, mathematical framework for understanding both terrestrial and planetary motion. However, in 1915, Albert Einstein introduced general relativity, redefining gravity as the curvature of spacetime caused by mass and energy. This shift explained phenomena Newton's model could not, such as the bending of light near massive bodies (gravitational lensing). Einstein's theory, which marked a revolution in physics, also predicted black holes and gravitational waves, phenomena later confirmed by observation.

Theoretical advances in gravitational physics have led to practical applications, such as in drug development. Proteins often form crystals that can be analyzed to determine their molecular structure. [A] However, on Earth, gravity interferes with the uniform growth of crystals. [B] In microgravity environments, such as those aboard the International Space Station (ISS), gravitational effects are minimized. [C] Crystals grown in space tend to be larger, more uniform, and less flawed than those grown on Earth, enabling researchers to map the crystals' atomic structure with greater accuracy. [D] This is crucial for rational drug design, allowing scientists to develop medications that precisely target disease-related proteins.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions all of the following about Newton's law of universal gravitation EXCEPT:

A. It stated that all objects pull on each other.
B. It helped explain motion on Earth and in space.
C. It was later replaced by another theory.
D. It made predictions that were only confirmed later.

Q2. Why does the author mention "gravitational lensing" in the passage?

A. To help explain why Einstein's theory was superior to Newton's
B. To give an example of a prediction made by Einstein
C. To further illustrate Newton's law of universal gravitation
D. To contrast terrestrial and planetary motion

Q3. The word "minimized" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. eliminated
B. reduced
C. observed
D. applied

Q4. According to the passage, why is it important for drug developers to determine the molecular structure of crystals?

A. This helps researchers understand the effects of gravity on proteins in the human body.
B. This helps researchers create drugs that target specific proteins.
C. This helps create more perfect crystals that can be used in industrial applications.
D. This enables manufacturers to produce existing drugs more quickly and cheaply.

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "For instance, parts of a crystal will grow unevenly as heavier components settle, leading to distortions in its shape." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-08-20 Passage - Thermodynamics and Ecosystems

原文（Passage）

Thermodynamics and Ecosystems

When students first encounter the laws of thermodynamics, educators often rely on simplified analogies—billiard balls, falling stones—to convey foundational principles. Yet these laws extend far beyond mechanical systems, offering a powerful framework for interpreting complex phenomena such as energy flow in ecosystems. The first law, which asserts that energy cannot be created or destroyed but only transformed, is clearly exemplified in nature: sunlight becomes chemical energy via photosynthesis, which fuels plants, then herbivores and, ultimately, carnivores. This cascading energy transfer underscores the conservation principle while revealing the intricate interdependence among trophic (food chain) levels, with each organism depending on the energy efficiency of those occupying the level below.

In contrast, the second law—which states that entropy, or disorder, tends to increase—illuminates why ecosystems evolve toward less efficient energy use. While simple organisms at the base of the food chain convert energy with relative efficiency, larger animals lose much of their energy intake. This disparity is not merely a biological curiosity; it reflects a fundamental thermodynamic constraint. As ecosystems mature, energy becomes increasingly fragmented and less available for productive work. Exceptions exist—some top predators exhibit surprising metabolic efficiency—but the general trend remains: Complexity breeds energy loss.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that introduces the idea that thermodynamics has implications that the reader may not expect. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. When students first encounter the laws of thermodynamics, educators often rely on simplified analogies—billiard balls, falling stones—to convey foundational principles.
B. Yet these laws extend far beyond mechanical systems, offering a powerful framework for interpreting complex phenomena such as energy flow in ecosystems.

C. The first law, which asserts that energy cannot be created or destroyed but only transformed, is clearly exemplified in nature: sunlight becomes chemical energy via photosynthesis, which fuels plants, then herbivores and, ultimately, carnivores.

D. This cascading energy transfer underscores the conservation principle while revealing the intricate interdependence among trophic (food chain) levels, with each organism depending on the energy efficiency of those occupying the level below.

Q2. Why does the author note that "sunlight becomes chemical energy"?

A. To illustrate the claim that educators rely on simple analogies when teaching thermodynamics

B. To challenge the idea that thermodynamics offers a way of understanding complex phenomena

C. To provide an example of increasing entropy in a biological system

D. To show how the first law of thermodynamics is applicable to food chains

Q3. According to the passage, what principle explains the trend toward less efficient energy use in ecosystems?

A. Smaller systems tend to combine into larger ones.

B. As entropy increases, less energy is available for work.

C. Energy is never lost but takes on many different forms.

D. Top predators are vulnerable to changes in an ecosystem.

Q4. The word "disparity" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. tendency

B. difference

C. comparison

D. conclusion

Q5. What does the passage suggest about top predators?

A. They are the most complex organisms in an ecosystem.

B. They are metabolically more efficient than their prey.

C. Their metabolic efficiency depends on their habitat.

D. They use up their energy more slowly as they mature.

2026-08-15（2 套）

2026-08-15 Medieval Town Origins

原文（Passage）

The Rise of Medieval Towns

Two manifestations of the vitality of the Late Middle Ages were the rise of towns and the development of a new business and commercial class in Europe. Early medieval society had been traditional, agricultural, and rural, so the appearance of a new class that was none of these constituted a social revolution. The new class--artisans and merchants--came from the peasantry. They were landless younger sons of large families, driven away by land shortage. Or they were forced by war and famine to seek new possibilities.

Historians have proposed three basic theories to explain the origins of European towns. Some scholars believe towns began as boroughs--that is, as fortifications erected during the ninth-century Viking invasions. Belgian historian Henri Pirenne maintained that towns sprang up when merchants who engaged in long-distance trade gravitated toward favorable spots, such as a fort. A third explanation focuses on religious establishments such as monasteries and the great cathedrals, which represented a demand for goods and services. Traders and merchants settled near religious establishments to cater to the residents' economic needs.

All three theories have some validity, though none of them explains the origins of all medieval towns. Some medieval towns that became flourishing centers of trade by the mid-twelfth century had originally been Roman army camps. Pirenne's interpretation accurately describes the Flemish towns of Gent, Bruges, and Ypres but does not fit the course of development in the Italian cities or in such centers as London. Nor does the Pirenne thesis take into account the significance of local trade and markets in the growth of towns.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary focus of the passage?

A. A comparison of Viking invasions and their impact on European settlement patterns
B. The social status of merchants in medieval European society
C. The origins of medieval towns and competing scholarly explanations for their development
D. The economic relationship between rural farmers and urban merchants in the Late Middle Ages

Q2. According to the passage, what was the social background of the new commercial class that emerged in the Late Middle Ages?

A. They were primarily members of the clergy who left religious life to pursue trade.
B. They were nobles who lost their land holdings during Viking invasions.
C. They were foreign merchants who immigrated from outside Europe to establish trade routes.
D. They descended from the peasantry and included landless younger sons of large families.

Q3. The word "gravitated" in the passage is closest in meaning to which of the following?

A. were naturally drawn
B. competed
C. were forced
D. gradually departed

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about Pirenne's theory of town origins?

A. It applies to some towns but fails to account for all patterns of medieval urban development.
B. It was developed specifically to explain the growth of Italian seaport cities.
C. It has been entirely discredited because it ignores the role of Viking invasions.
D. It is considered the most widely accepted explanation among modern historians.

Q5. Why does the author mention monasteries and cathedrals in the second paragraph?

A. To argue that religious institutions were more influential than fortifications in shaping medieval society
B. To illustrate the hostility that church officials felt toward the merchant class
C. To introduce a third scholarly explanation for the origins of European towns
D. To provide an example of how Pirenne's theory applies to religious communities

2026-08-15 Modern Choreography

原文（Passage）

The New Dimensions of Choreography

Choreography (the composition and arrangement of dance), once a ceremonial and courtly discipline rooted in ritualistic precision, has undergone a profound metamorphosis shaped by cultural shifts and artistic redefinition. Initially governed by strict formalism--particularly in classical ballet--it emphasized symmetry, control, and hierarchy. However, the 20th century witnessed a radical departure from these conventions. Visionaries like Martha Graham redefined dance as a medium for emotional expression and psychological depth, challenging ballet's aesthetic rigidity and introducing vocabularies of movement that embraced tension, release, and groundedness, which emphasizes a strong connection to the earth or floor. This evolution

marked a transition from spectacle to narrative, with choreography becoming a conduit for storytelling and social commentary.
Today, choreography increasingly reflects a decentralization of artistic authority. [A] Rather than a single choreographer dictating movement, many contemporary works emerge from collaborative processes among dancers, composers, designers, and digital artists. [B] This co-creative model not only democratizes authorship but also fosters performances that are adaptive and responsive--sometimes even improvised or altered in real time. The boundaries between creator and performer blur, yielding works that resist fixed interpretation. [C] In this context, choreography becomes less a finished product and more a living dialogue among disciplines, identities, and ideas. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "profound" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. gradual
B. permanent
C. complex
D. fundamental

Q2. Why does the author discuss Martha Graham's approach to dance?

A. To illustrate an important shift from formalism to expressive movement
B. To highlight the continuity between ceremonial dance and modern techniques
C. To argue that ballet remains the dominant form of choreography
D. To suggest that Graham's style was more technically demanding than ballet

Q3. What does the author suggest about the role of the choreographer in contemporary dance?

A. The choreographer's role is increasingly shared with other contributors.
B. The choreographer is solely responsible for all artistic decisions.
C. The choreographer no longer participates in the creative process.
D. The choreographer's relation to collaborators has become more hierarchical.

Q4. Which of the following best describes the evolution of choreography over time?

A. A shift from narrative to social commentary
B. A movement toward stricter formalism
C. A transformation from rigid constraints to flexibility
D. A return to ceremonial traditions

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. In many cases, contributors shape the thematic and emotional direction of a piece, influencing its development from within the creative process. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-08-12（12 套）

2026-08-12 Acting Gestures

原文（Passage）

Acting Gestures
Gestures have always been integral to acting, serving as silent yet powerful tools for conveying emotions and intentions. Before the advent of sound in cinema, actors relied on exaggerated

gestures to communicate, creating a universal language that transcended spoken words. This visual communication was essential in silent films, allowing actors to express complex narratives through movement alone.

In modern theater and film, gestures have evolved into subtler devices, designed to complement spoken dialogue and enhance realism. A nuanced gesture, such as the slight arch of an eyebrow or a lingering touch, can reveal a character's inner conflict or emotional transitions, adding layers of meaning without overt expression. This transformation reflects a broader shift toward naturalism in acting, where authenticity is paramount, and even the smallest gesture is deliberate.

With such a great expressive power, as they say, comes great responsibility: cultural interpretations of gestures add complexity to acting in multicultural contexts. A gesture considered respectful in one culture might be misinterpreted in another as offensive or dismissive. Actors must adapt and modify their gestures to resonate with diverse audiences, a skill that distinguishes adept performers. This adaptability highlights how gestures are not merely physical movements but are deeply rooted in cultural understanding and empathy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "overt" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. direct
B. clever
C. concise
D. nuanced

Q2. Why does the author discuss silent films in paragraph 1?

A. To describe the impact of the advent of sound in cinema
B. To acknowledge that silent films limited actor expression
C. To critique the use of acting techniques in modern films
D. To show that gestures have always been crucial to acting

Q3. Paragraph 2 mentions all of the following about the use of gestures in modern theater and film EXCEPT:

A. It makes performances more genuine.
B. It enables actors to convey more meaning.
C. It can reveal a character's emotional transitions.
D. It is especially important for weaker actors.

Q4. The passage suggests that contemporary actors

A. minimize the use of gestures to avoid seeming old-fashioned
B. rely more on physical gestures than on spoken dialogue
C. employ gestures thoughtfully to enhance emotional authenticity
D. favor gestures whose meanings are shared across many cultures

Q5. According to paragraph 3, what is one skill that theater actors need in multicultural contexts?

A. Anticipating audience interpretations across cultures
B. Maintaining consistency in physical expression
C. Avoiding gestures that carry emotional intensity
D. Knowing when words alone cannot convey an emotion

2026-08-12 Anole Evolution

原文（Passage）

Anole Evolution

Herpetologists have closely studied the interaction between two species of lizards—the native green anole (Anolis carolinensis) and the invasive brown anole (Anolis sagrei)—in the southeastern United States. Although the two species are similar in size, they occupy different vertical zones: green anoles are found in the tree canopy (treetops), while brown anoles dominate ground-level habitats.

Initially, this vertical separation was interpreted as a natural habitat preference, but further research suggests that it is a defensive response by green anoles to avoid direct competition. Scientists now believe that green anoles were displaced upward due to aggressive territorial behavior by brown anoles. One theory proposes that this forced shift has triggered rapid evolutionary changes in green anoles. Researchers have documented the development of larger toe pads and more lamellae—microscopic scales that enhance grip—allowing green anoles to navigate thinner branches more effectively.

Meanwhile, brown anoles have adapted as well, showing changes in limb length and body coloration in response to new environments and predators. In one Florida study, brown anoles exposed to higher predation developed shorter limbs, which may improve maneuverability in dense vegetation. These findings reveal how competitive pressure can reshape species behavior and morphology within just a few generations, offering a real-time glimpse into evolutionary change.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be concluded from the passage about green anoles?

A. They lived on the ground before changes in their habitat.
B. They often become aggressive to defend their territory.
C. They encounter many competitors in the tree canopy.
D. They eat largely the same diet as brown anoles do.

Q2. Why does the passage mention “larger toe pads and more lamellae” in green anoles?

A. To emphasize a competitive advantage of green anoles over brown anoles
B. To illustrate an evolutionary response to environmental pressure
C. To indicate a general characteristic of lizard species living in trees
D. To suggest a reason for the decline in the green anole population

Q3. The word “scales” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. weights
B. plates
C. fibers
D. hooks

Q4. According to paragraph 3, brown anoles may develop shorter limbs to help them with

A. blending into their environment
B. catching fast-moving prey
C. escaping more easily from predators
D. hiding among thin branches

Q5. The passage indicates that studies of the relationship between green anoles and brown anoles are valuable for which of the following reasons?

A. They suggest a way to reduce the harmful effects of invasive species.
B. They allow researchers to witness evolutionary mechanisms at work.
C. They show that adaptations take much longer than previously thought.
D. They provide a glimpse of the complex interplay between predators and prey.

2026-08-12 Behavioral Economics

原文（Passage）

Behavioral Economics

Behavioral economics merges psychology and economics to understand financial decisions. Traditional theories assume individuals act rationally based on logical analysis. However, behavioral economists find human behavior often deviates from these expectations. Cognitive biases, emotions, and social factors can lead to irrational choices.

[A] One key concept is "loss aversion," where people prefer avoiding losses rather than acquiring gains. [B] For example, individuals might avoid selling a declining stock in the hope of recovering their losses, even when the stock is unlikely to rebound. [C] Rational theory would suggest selling the stock to minimize further losses. [D]

Another concept is "anchoring," where individuals rely too heavily on the first piece of information they receive (the "anchor") when making decisions. For example, if an investor learns a stock was priced at $100 last month but has dropped to $80, they might perceive the lower price as a bargain, regardless of the stock's actual value. The company's earnings may have dropped significantly, making $80 a fair or even high price. Anchoring can thus lead to suboptimal investment choices.

Behavioral economics has implications for financial markets and investment strategies. By understanding psychological factors, economists can design better tools to help people make informed choices.

题目（Questions）

Q1. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "This behavior is based primarily on emotion." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-08-12 Cybernetic Prosthetics

原文（Passage）

Cybernetic Prosthetics

Cybernetic prosthetics have revolutionized medical technology, offering hope to individuals who have lost limbs. Unlike traditional prosthetics, which are often cumbersome and limited in function, cybernetic versions are designed to integrate seamlessly with the human nervous system. This integration allows for more natural movement and even sensation. A key development in this field has been the use of myoelectric sensors, which detect electrical signals generated by muscle movements.

One example is a cybernetic hand that can perform delicate tasks such as picking up small objects or typing. This is achieved through advanced algorithms that translate muscle signals into controlled movements. Researchers are also exploring haptic feedback, which would enable users to feel textures and temperatures through their prosthetic limbs. It involves integrating sensors and actuators that mimic the sensation of touch by stimulating the user’s nerve endings or skin with electrical signals. This could significantly improve the quality of life for amputees.

[A] The high cost of these prosthetics makes them inaccessible to many. [B] Additionally, the technology requires regular maintenance and updates, which can be a barrier. [C] Current battery life is another limitation, as it restricts the user’s ability to wear the prosthetic for extended periods. Researchers are continually working to make these devices more affordable and user-friendly. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "seamlessly" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. generally
B. smoothly
C. repeatedly
D. slowly

Q2. What can be inferred about myoelectric sensors?

A. They function less effectively in traditional prosthetics.
B. They rely less on electric signals than other types of sensors do.
C. They allow for more natural movement in cybernetic prosthetics.
D. They make cybernetic prosthetics somewhat cumbersome.

Q3. What does the passage indicate about cybernetic hands?

A. They are currently limited in their range of motion.
B. They rely on algorithms that turn muscle signals into movements.
C. They can cause skin irritation if worn for extended periods.
D. They are used mainly for typing.

Q4. According to the passage, using haptic feedback in artificial limbs involves each of the following EXCEPT

A. feeling textures through prosthetic limbs
B. changing the temperatures of objects
C. stimulating skin and nerve endings
D. using multiple sensors and actuators

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "To take full advantage of these amazing new technologies, a few obstacles need to be overcome." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-08-12 Gestures in Acting

原文（Passage）

Gestures in Acting

Gestures have always been integral to acting, serving as silent yet powerful tools for conveying emotions and intentions. Before the advent of sound in cinema, actors relied on exaggerated gestures to communicate, creating a universal language that transcended spoken words. This visual communication was essential in silent films, allowing actors to express complex narratives through movement alone.

In modern theater and film, gestures have evolved into subtler devices, designed to complement spoken dialogue and enhance realism. A nuanced gesture, such as the slight arch of an eyebrow or a lingering touch, can reveal a character's inner conflict or emotional transitions, adding layers of meaning without overt expression. This transformation reflects a broader shift toward naturalism in acting, where authenticity is paramount, and even the smallest gesture is deliberate.

With such a great expressive power, as they say, comes great responsibility: cultural interpretations of gestures add complexity to acting in multicultural contexts. A gesture considered respectful in one culture might be misinterpreted in another as offensive or

dismissive. Actors must adapt and modify their gestures to resonate with diverse audiences, a skill that distinguishes adept performers. This adaptability highlights how gestures are not merely physical movements but are deeply rooted in cultural understanding and empathy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author discuss silent films in paragraph 1?

A. To describe the impact of the advent of sound in cinema
B. To acknowledge that silent films limited actor expression
C. To critique the use of acting techniques in modern films
D. To show that gestures were once essential for communicating meaning in acting

Q2. The word "overt" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. direct
B. clever
C. concise
D. nuanced

Q3. According to paragraph 2, what can subtle gestures in modern acting help reveal?

A. The technical limitations of spoken dialogue
B. A character's inner conflict or emotional transitions
C. The historical origins of naturalistic acting
D. The audience's preference for exaggerated movement

Q4. What is suggested about gestures in multicultural acting contexts?

A. They are understood in the same way by all audiences.
B. They should be avoided because they distract from spoken dialogue.
C. Their meanings may vary across cultures, so actors must adapt them.
D. They are useful only when actors perform without speaking.

Q5. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To argue that silent-film techniques should replace modern acting methods
B. To explain how gestures have changed in acting while remaining important for expression
C. To compare theater acting with film acting in different historical periods
D. To show that cultural differences make acting impossible for international audiences

2026-08-12 Kintsugi Art Repair

原文（Passage）

Kintsugi

Kintsugi is a Japanese method of repairing broken pottery while leaving the repair deliberately visible. Artisans rejoin fragments with lacquer paste and may dust the seams with powdered gold or other metals. Rather than return a vessel to an apparently untouched state, the process makes damage part of its design. The object retains evidence of both use and restoration.

Although its precise origins are uncertain, gilt-lacquer repairs became fashionable in Japan around the sixteenth century. Kintsugi is now often associated with wabi-sabi, an aesthetic outlook that regards imperfection, age, and transience as natural conditions, not defects to eliminate. Careful repair acknowledges change while preserving continuity; the metallic lines record where a vessel failed and how it was remade.

[A] This philosophy helps explain why kintsugi has traveled beyond specialist workshops. [B] Because the restored object remains visibly altered, it is often used as a metaphor for resilience: recovery need not erase the event that made recovery necessary. [C] Contemporary classes may therefore teach both the practical sequence and ideas about acceptance and renewal. [D]

Traditional kintsugi demands material knowledge, patience, and repeated curing; it is not simply the decorative application of gold paint. Understanding its craft alongside its symbolism prevents a complex practice from becoming only a slogan about personal improvement.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, which outlook is associated with kintsugi?

A. Minimalism, which favors eliminating decoration and excess
B. Formalism, which evaluates an object only by its shape
C. Wabi-sabi, which regards imperfection and transience as natural
D. A conservation principle requiring repairs to remain invisible

Q2. According to the passage, what does a visible repair symbolize?

A. A repair succeeds only when the object appears unchanged.
B. Recovery can acknowledge past damage without erasing it.
C. Breakage is desirable because it guarantees a more valuable object.
D. Precious materials alone give a repaired object symbolic meaning.

Q3. Why does the author state that traditional kintsugi is "not simply the decorative application of gold paint"?

A. To explain why artisans sometimes use metals other than gold
B. To distinguish a demanding traditional craft from a superficial imitation
C. To argue that repaired pottery should not be displayed as art
D. To reject the connection between kintsugi and symbolic interpretation

Q4. The word "transience" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. temporary nature
B. physical damage
C. artistic complexity
D. cultural popularity

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "That metaphorical appeal, however, should not obscure the demanding material process discussed next." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-08-12 Linguistic Structural Diversity

原文（Passage）

Linguistic Structural Diversity

Linguistic typology investigates structural features across languages, revealing both universal patterns and language-specific variation. A central area of study is word order--the arrangement of subjects, verbs, and objects. English follows a subject-verb-object (SVO) pattern, while Japanese uses subject-object-verb (SOV). Most languages conform to a limited set of dominant word orders, which may reflect cognitive efficiency: Placing the subject first helps listeners quickly identify the sentence's main actor, aiding comprehension.

Beyond syntax, languages differ in morphological complexity--the degree to which inflection (such as noun or verb endings) marks grammatical relationships. Turkish uses extensive inflection to express subtle distinctions, whereas Mandarin Chinese relies more on word order and context. These contrasts suggest that languages balance morphology and syntax based on communicative needs. Highly inflected languages can afford flexible word order because

grammatical roles are marked morphologically. In contrast, languages with minimal inflection often depend on fixed word order to maintain clarity.
[A] This trade-off reflects deeper functional pressures. [B] Languages evolve not randomly but in response to cognitive constraints and social factors, including contact with other languages and cultural shifts. [C] Studying this evolution helps linguists understand not only how languages differ but why certain grammatical strategies emerge and persist across communities. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as an aspect of the study of linguistic typology?

A. It has revealed both diversity and universality among structural linguistic features.
B. It includes the study of word order as a means of aiding comprehension.
C. It identifies three basic structural patterns across all languages.
D. It examines differences in morphological complexity among languages.

Q2. Why does the author note that placing the subject first in a sentence aids comprehension?

A. To provide an example of a structural feature that follows a universal pattern
B. To suggest that a larger set of available word orders increases cognitive efficiency
C. To help explain why there is only a small set of dominant word orders across languages
D. To suggest that languages that follow a different pattern are harder to learn

Q3. What is suggested about the morphological complexity of Turkish?

A. It is greater than the morphological complexity of Mandarin Chinese.
B. It is balanced by a relatively simple inflection system.
C. It developed independently of other elements of Turkish.
D. It requires Turkish to adhere to a relatively rigid word order.

Q4. The word "pressures" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. difficulties
B. conflicts
C. features
D. influences

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Such changes can alter the communicative priorities of a speech community, affecting which features are emphasized or simplified over time. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-08-12 Music Education Benefits

原文（Passage）

The Benefits Of Music Education

In the United States, music education has been consistently linked to enhanced cognitive development. Studies such as those by the National Association for Music Education (NAfME) and research published in Frontiers in Psychology have shown that children who study music often demonstrate improvements in memory, language acquisition, and spatial-temporal reasoning. These cognitive gains are attributed to the discipline and structured practice inherent in learning music, which strengthens neural pathways associated with attention and processing.

Beyond cognition, music education contributes meaningfully to social development. Participation in an ensemble—a group of musicians performing together—requires active collaboration, listening, and nonverbal communication, fostering empathy and cooperative behavior. This group dynamic differs from traditional classroom settings and can support the development of interpersonal skills. Moreover, music provides a safe space for emotional exploration. Students engage with complex emotions, both their own and those conveyed by others, through the expressive nature of music itself. This experience can enhance emotional intelligence and serve as a constructive outlet for stress.

Despite these documented benefits, music programs in U.S. schools are often viewed as nonessential compared to core academic subjects and thus vulnerable to budget cuts. This reduction may disproportionately affect students who could benefit most from music's holistic contributions, potentially limiting their cognitive, social, and emotional growth.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention "neural pathways associated with attention and processing"?

A. To explain one way in which music might improve certain mental skills
B. To highlight the parts of the brain used when listening to music
C. To contradict the results of a study in Frontiers in Psychology
D. To suggest that music education has little effect on cognitive development

Q2. Based on the discussion in the passage, what type of musical activity would be least likely to support social development?

A. Playing in an orchestra
B. Singing in a choir
C. Calming oneself with peaceful music
D. Being a band member

Q3. According to the passage, music education promotes social development in all of the following ways EXCEPT

A. by developing listening skills
B. by teaching students to communicate non-verbally
C. by encouraging cooperative behavior
D. by setting high standards for performance quality

Q4. What does the passage suggest about music education in the United States?

A. It is acknowledged to be a necessary part of the school curriculum.
B. It is at greater risk of losing its funding than other school subjects are.
C. Some parents fear that time and money spent on music programs will limit their children's academic growth.
D. Some parents want to see further studies done on the benefits of music education.

Q5. The word "holistic" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. documented
B. celebrated
C. comprehensive
D. well-known

2026-08-12 Octopus Intelligence

原文（Passage）

Octopus Intelligence And Behavior

Octopuses' behaviors reveal remarkably sophisticated cognition. Researchers have documented octopuses' use of tools—for example, gathering seashells to assemble temporary shelters. This behavior indicates not only problem-solving but also foresight, since the octopus must carry and later arrange the objects in a different context. Their ability to navigate mazes, remember solutions, and learn from experience further demonstrates a form of long-term memory unusual among invertebrates. In laboratory settings, octopuses have also been observed opening jars, manipulating latches, and escaping enclosures—tasks requiring both skill and an understanding of cause and effect.

Another striking ability of octopuses is their rapid camouflage. Octopuses can alter their skin color, texture, and pattern in milliseconds to match their surroundings. This strategy for evading predators reflects complex sensory processing: They must interpret visual information and translate it into precise bodily changes. These capabilities are especially surprising because the evolution of octopuses took a different course from that of vertebrates more than 500 million years ago, meaning that their intelligence evolved independently. This deep evolutionary separation suggests that complex cognition can arise through very different biological pathways. For researchers, octopuses offer a rare opportunity to study an entirely separate model of intelligence, expanding our understanding of how minds can develop across the tree of life.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is implied about the building of temporary shelters by octopuses?

A. It shows that octopuses can carry surprisingly heavy objects.
B. It has been observed in laboratories but not in the wild.
C. It reveals that octopuses are capable of complex planning.
D. It is an ineffective way for octopuses to protect themselves from predators.

Q2. The word “manipulating” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. understanding
B. operating
C. recognizing
D. hiding

Q3. Paragraph 2 indicates all of the following about octopuses EXCEPT:

A. They are able to understand how predators perceive color.
B. They can recognize the color of their surroundings.
C. They are able to perceive the patterns in their surroundings.
D. They can alter their appearance almost instantly.

Q4. The passage indicates which of the following about biological pathways?

A. Species that develop along very different pathways can come to possess surprisingly similar cognitive abilities.
B. The biological pathways of octopuses and vertebrates have been difficult for scientists to determine.
C. Octopuses' biological pathway came to resemble the pathway of vertebrates around 500 million years ago.
D. The cognitive abilities observed in certain species have caused scientists to reject a traditional way of understanding biological pathways.

Q5. The author mentions a “separate model of intelligence” primarily to

A. introduce a theory of intelligence proposed by researchers who study octopuses
B. emphasize that different biological pathways tend to lead to very different cognitive abilities
C. explain how octopuses can be capable of long-term memory
D. show how the study of octopuses has opened up new ways of thinking about intelligence

2026-08-12 Origins of Agriculture

原文（Passage）

Origins of Agriculture

Transitions from a glacial to interglacial world occurred many times during the last two million years. Through all but the most recent glaciation, people moved in response to environmental changes rather than staying put and adapting to a new ecosystem. Then, after living on the move for more than a million years, they started to settle down and become farmers. What was so different when the glaciers melted this last time that caused people to adopt a new lifestyle? Several explanations have been offered to account for this radical change. Some argue that the shift from a cool, wet glacial climate to less hospitable conditions put an environmental squeeze on early people in the Middle East. Others argue that agriculture evolved in response to an inevitable process of cultural evolution without any specific environmental pressure. Whatever the reasons, agriculture developed independently in Mesopotamia, northern China, and Mesoamerica.

Increasing population density provides an attractive explanation for the origin and spread of agriculture. When hunting and gathering groups grew beyond the capacity of their territory to support them, part of the group would split off and move to a new territory. Once there was no more productive territory to colonize, growing populations developed more intensive and time-consuming ways to extract a living from their environment. In this view, agriculture can be understood as a natural behavioral response to increasing population.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary purpose of the passage?

A. To argue that population pressure was the definitive cause of the agricultural transition
B. To trace the geographic spread of agriculture from Mesopotamia to other regions
C. To present competing explanations for why people began practicing agriculture
D. To describe the environmental conditions that characterized the last glacial period

Q2. According to the passage, what did people do in response to environmental changes during previous glaciations?

A. They relocated rather than remaining in place and adjusting to new ecosystems.
B. They split into smaller groups and colonized more productive territories.
C. They formed social bonds that eventually led to the domestication of plants.
D. They developed new agricultural techniques to survive shifting conditions.

Q3. The word "hospitable" in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to which of the following?

A. Geographically accessible
B. Favorable for survival
C. Densely populated
D. Agriculturally productive

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about the relationship between territory and the adoption of agriculture?

A. The availability of productive territory discouraged investment in agricultural methods.
B. Groups that controlled the most territory were the first to develop agricultural practices.
C. Agriculture became necessary only after populations could no longer expand into new lands.
D. Territorial competition between groups accelerated the independent development of farming.

Q5. Why does the author mention that agriculture developed independently in Mesopotamia, northern China, and Mesoamerica?

A. To support the claim that cultural evolution alone drove agricultural development
B. To demonstrate that environmental conditions were similar across these three regions
C. To argue that population pressure operated differently depending on geographic region
D. To illustrate that the phenomenon of agricultural origins was not confined to a single location

2026-08-12 The Discovery Of Vitamins

原文（Passage）

The Discovery of Vitamins

The first vitamin discovered was thiamine (vitamin B_1). It is found in pork, legumes, and rice bran—the outer layer of brown rice that is removed during the milling process to make white rice. Around 1900, researchers realized that rice bran could cure a disease called beriberi. In 1912, Casimir Funk isolated an extract from rice bran that he determined to be an amine (a type of nitrogen compound). Funk proposed that the absence of certain amines in the diet can cause beriberi as well as other diseases. Because these amines were essential for life (vita in Latin), Funk coined the term vitamine. The predominant belief about disease at the time was that it was caused by toxins or infections. The idea that disease could arise from the absence of nutrients was revolutionary.

Thiamine was indeed an amine whose absence can cause beriberi, but Funk's extract likely contained a mixture of substances, and his chemical analysis was incomplete. [A] Only later did researchers successfully isolate thiamine in its pure form.

[B] Additional life-essential nutrients were soon discovered. [C] The problem was that many of them were not amines. [D] The final e was thus dropped from vitamine to make the term less misleading.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about rice bran?

A. It is present in white rice.
B. It is more nutritious than pork and legumes.
C. It contains a life-essential nutrient.
D. It contains chemicals that cause disease.

Q2. Why does the author mention "The predominant belief about disease at the time"?

A. To cite a widely held belief about the importance of vitamins
B. To point out why Casimir Funk held a wrong assumption
C. To suggest that toxins or infections may cause the loss of nutrients
D. To explain why Casimir Funk's proposal was revolutionary

Q3. According to the passage, Casimir Funk was wrong about

A. whether thiamine was present in rice bran
B. whether thiamine was an amine
C. whether the absence of thiamine could cause beriberi
D. whether the substance he extracted was in its pure form

Q4. The passage supports all of the following statements about the term vitamine EXCEPT:

A. It was invented by Casimir Funk.
B. It was a combination of the words vita and amine.
C. It was changed after scientists discovered that not all vitamins were essential for life.
D. It was considered inaccurate because of its association with amines.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Vitamin C, for example, is an acid and contains no nitrogen at all." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-08-12 Video Evidence in Courts

原文（Passage）

Video Evidence in Courts

In the United States, as in some other countries, video evidence has become integral to the criminal justice system as technological advances have made cameras nearly ubiquitous. Police officers often wear body cameras, security cameras monitor public areas, and nearly everyone carries a smartphone capable of recording high-quality videos. While such recordings are widely seen as reliable evidentiary tools, they have certain limitations.

For example, videos are usually taken from a single vantage point, potentially giving viewers a misleading impression of events. A single camera angle might fail to capture what occurs just outside the frame, leading observers to misinterpret what they see. Additionally, video footage has no way of conveying interpersonal and emotional context: A person's actions might appear antagonistic even if the person was acting in self-defense.

Despite these limitations, legal experts emphasize that video evidence plays a significant role in courtrooms. Jurors (people chosen to consider evidence and decide a case) might dismiss eyewitness testimonies as unreliable or perceive oral accounts as inconsistent, while videos show events more directly. When multiple recordings are available from different angles, an even more reliable sense of an incident can emerge. Nevertheless, courts often remind jurors to evaluate video evidence cautiously.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the relationship between the first sentence and the second sentence of the passage?

A. The first sentence makes a generalization, and the second sentence introduces exceptions to the generalization.
B. The first sentence presents one view of a subject, and the second sentence presents a contrasting view.
C. The first sentence makes a claim, and the second sentence provides examples to illustrate that claim.
D. The first sentence introduces a question, and the second sentence offers possible answers to the question.

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about viewers of videos?

A. They are more likely to trust the accuracy of a video recorded on a police officer's body camera than one taken with a smartphone.
B. They may not find a video recording of an incident as revealing as an eyewitness account of the event.
C. They may not see actions that are critical to understanding an incident because of the way the video is framed.
D. They are likely to regard video recordings skeptically because they know that videos can be misleading.

Q3. What does the author point out when discussing "context"?

A. The setting in which a video is viewed may affect the way viewers perceive the recorded events.

B. People may draw incorrect conclusions about others' motivations from what they observe in a video.

C. Video recordings can be used either to defend an individual's actions or to depict the individual as an aggressor.

D. The reliability of video recordings of events should be compared to the reliability of oral accounts of those events.

Q4. The passage indicates that "legal experts" hold which of the following views?

A. Jurors are likely to accept videos as objective depictions of events whereas they view witness testimony with skepticism.

B. Recent improvements in technology have made it so easy to display video evidence to jurors that other kinds of evidence may be neglected.

C. Video recordings should not be used as evidence in courtrooms unless multiple recordings taken from different vantage points can be shown.

D. Courts should not undermine jurors' confidence in their abilities by overemphasizing the possibility of misinterpreting videos.

Q5. The word "cautiously" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. reluctantly

B. carefully

C. decisively

D. confidently

2026-08-09（2 套）

2026-08-09 Social Network Influence

原文（Passage）

Social Networks and Influence

Paragraph 1

[A] Computational sociology studies how social networks—like friendships, professional connections, or online communities—affect how people think and act. [B] Instead of just drawing diagrams of who is connected to whom, researchers now look more closely at how frequent interactions shape behavior. [C] If someone regularly chats with a group of friends who share strong opinions about climate change, they may gradually adopt similar views. [D] These influences are especially strong when the conversations are emotionally charged or align with the person's values. [▪1]

Paragraph 2

Interestingly, it is not always the most famous or powerful people who have the biggest impact. [▪2] Everyday conversations—like repeated exchanges between coworkers—can be more influential than a single message from a celebrity or expert. Researchers use computational models to analyze how messages spread. [▪3] An accurate model can predict which types of messages are likely to spread widely. [▪4]

Paragraph 3

Still, predicting human behavior is incredibly complex. People are shaped by their culture, social norms, and personal experiences, which makes it hard to build models that work universally. For example, a message that spreads quickly in one country might fall flat in another due to different cultural values. The real challenge lies in understanding how all these subtle factors interact to drive large-scale changes in behavior.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that illustrates how social network dynamics can affect personal beliefs. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Computational sociology studies how social networks—like friendships, professional connections, or online communities—affect how people think and act.

B. Instead of just drawing diagrams of who is connected to whom, researchers now look more closely at how frequent interactions shape behavior.

C. If someone regularly chats with a group of friends who share strong opinions about climate change, they may gradually adopt similar views.

D. These influences are especially strong when the conversations are emotionally charged or align with the person's values.

Q2. According to the passage, computational sociologists study

A. how having shared opinions strengthens a friendship

B. why it is important to develop complex diagrams of network connections

C. why emotionally charged conversations are ineffective at changing opinions

D. how human behavior is affected by frequent interactions

Q3. The word "incredibly" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. generally

B. extremely

C. somewhat

D. often

Q4. According to the passage, what makes it difficult to model human behavior?

A. The interaction of various factors that play a role in human behavior

B. The rapid spread of messages from one population to another

C. The frequent movement of humans among countries with different cultural values

D. The lack of cooperation among researchers from different cultural backgrounds

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. In fact, influence often emerges from the bottom up, rather than being imposed from the top down. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]

B. [■2]

C. [■3]

D. [■4]

2026-08-09 Thermodynamics and Ecosystems

原文（Passage）

Thermodynamics and Ecosystems

Paragraph 1

[A] When students first encounter the laws of thermodynamics, educators often rely on simplified analogies—billiard balls, falling stones—to convey foundational principles. [B] Yet these laws extend far beyond mechanical systems, offering a powerful framework for interpreting complex phenomena such as energy flow in ecosystems. [C] The first law, which asserts that energy cannot be created or destroyed but only transformed, is clearly exemplified in nature: sunlight becomes chemical energy via photosynthesis, which fuels plants, then herbivores and, ultimately, carnivores. [D] This cascading energy transfer underscores the conservation principle while revealing the intricate interdependence among trophic (food chain)

levels, with each organism depending on the energy efficiency of those occupying the level below.

Paragraph 2

In contrast, the second law—which states that entropy, or disorder, tends to increase—illuminates why ecosystems evolve toward less efficient energy use. While simple organisms at the base of the food chain convert energy with relative efficiency, larger animals lose much of their energy intake. This disparity is not merely a biological curiosity; it reflects a fundamental thermodynamic constraint. As ecosystems mature, energy becomes increasingly fragmented and less available for productive work. Exceptions exist—some top predators exhibit surprising metabolic efficiency—but the general trend remains: Complexity breeds energy loss.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that introduces the idea that thermodynamics has implications that the reader may not expect. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. When students first encounter the laws of thermodynamics, educators often rely on simplified analogies—billiard balls, falling stones—to convey foundational principles.

B. Yet these laws extend far beyond mechanical systems, offering a powerful framework for interpreting complex phenomena such as energy flow in ecosystems.

C. The first law, which asserts that energy cannot be created or destroyed but only transformed, is clearly exemplified in nature: sunlight becomes chemical energy via photosynthesis, which fuels plants, then herbivores and, ultimately, carnivores.

D. This cascading energy transfer underscores the conservation principle while revealing the intricate interdependence among trophic (food chain) levels, with each organism depending on the energy efficiency of those occupying the level below.

Q2. Why does the author note that “sunlight becomes chemical energy”?

A. To illustrate the claim that educators rely on simple analogies when teaching thermodynamics

B. To challenge the idea that thermodynamics offers a way of understanding complex phenomena

C. To provide an example of increasing entropy in a biological system

D. To show how the first law of thermodynamics is applicable to food chains

Q3. According to the passage, what principle explains the trend toward less efficient energy use in ecosystems?

A. Smaller systems tend to combine into larger ones.

B. As entropy increases, less energy is available for work.

C. Energy is never lost but takes on many different forms.

D. Top predators are vulnerable to changes in an ecosystem.

Q4. The word “disparity” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. tendency

B. difference

C. comparison

D. conclusion

Q5. What does the passage suggest about top predators?

A. They are the most complex organisms in an ecosystem.

B. They are metabolically more efficient than their prey.

C. Their metabolic efficiency depends on their habitat.

D. They use up their energy more slowly as they mature.

2026-08-08（8 套）

2026-08-08 Diane Arbus

原文（Passage）

Diane Arbus

Diane Arbus was an American photographer known for portraits that challenged conventional ideas of beauty, normality, and social acceptance. Rather than photographing celebrities or idealized scenes, Arbus often turned her camera toward people at the margins of mainstream society, including performers, twins, people with unusual appearances, and individuals whose identities seemed difficult to classify. Her photographs are usually direct and sharply focused, giving viewers little opportunity to keep a comfortable distance.

Critics have long disagreed about how to interpret Arbus's work. Susan Sontag argued that some of her photographs created an uneasy relationship between viewer and subject, suggesting that the viewer might feel invited to stare at people who were already socially vulnerable. From this perspective, Arbus's images could seem cold or exploitative. Other critics, however, have praised her photographs for their intimacy and seriousness. They argue that Arbus did not simply display difference but asked viewers to confront their own assumptions about who is considered ordinary.

Part of the power of Arbus's work comes from its ambiguity. Her subjects often look directly into the camera, appearing neither passive nor fully controlled by the photographer. This direct gaze can make the viewer feel both close to and unsettled by the person in the image. As a result, Arbus's photographs continue to provoke debate about empathy, representation, and the ethics of looking.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main topic of the passage?

A. Diane Arbus's technical innovations in color photography
B. The controversial nature and lasting impact of Diane Arbus's portraits
C. The history of celebrity photography in the United States
D. Susan Sontag's career as a photographer

Q2. According to the passage, what kinds of subjects did Arbus often photograph?

A. Famous political leaders and wealthy patrons
B. Idealized landscapes and city architecture
C. People who seemed outside conventional social categories
D. Abstract patterns made with light and shadow

Q3. Why does the passage mention Susan Sontag?

A. To present a critical view of Arbus's treatment of her subjects
B. To show that Arbus worked mainly as a writer
C. To explain how Arbus learned photography
D. To argue that all critics praised Arbus's work

Q4. The word "ambiguity" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. uncertainty
B. simplicity
C. popularity
D. brightness

Q5. What can be inferred about Arbus's photographs from the final paragraph?

A. They are easy to interpret in only one way.
B. They can make viewers question their own position as observers.

C. They avoid direct contact between subject and viewer.
D. They were intended mainly for advertising.

2026-08-08 Expert Systems

原文（Passage）

Expert Systems

Expert systems are an early branch of artificial intelligence designed to imitate the decision-making process of human specialists. Instead of learning from enormous quantities of data as many modern AI systems do, expert systems rely on a knowledge base and a set of rules. The knowledge base contains information supplied by specialists, while the rule system applies that information to specific cases. In this way, an expert system can produce recommendations that resemble those of a trained professional.

One famous early example was MYCIN, developed in the 1970s to help diagnose bacterial infections and recommend antibiotics. MYCIN asked users a series of questions about a patient's symptoms and laboratory results, then used rules to suggest possible infections and treatments. In some tests, its recommendations compared favorably with those of medical experts. However, MYCIN was never widely used in hospitals, partly because of legal, practical, and trust-related concerns.

Expert systems were also applied in engineering, finance, and equipment troubleshooting. Their strength was that they made specialized reasoning explicit and consistent. Their weakness was that they required extensive input from experts and constant updating as knowledge changed. If the rules were incomplete or outdated, the system could give poor advice. Although newer forms of AI have received more attention, expert systems remain important in the history of artificial intelligence because they showed that computer programs could represent and apply expert knowledge.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To explain how expert systems work and why they were important
B. To prove that expert systems are superior to all modern AI systems
C. To describe the invention of antibiotics in the 1970s
D. To argue that medical experts should be replaced by computers

Q2. According to the passage, expert systems differ from many modern AI systems because they

A. depend mainly on rule-based knowledge supplied by specialists
B. learn only by observing human emotions
C. are used exclusively for medical diagnosis
D. avoid giving recommendations to users

Q3. Why does the author discuss MYCIN?

A. To provide an example of an early expert system used for medical reasoning
B. To show that expert systems were created only after modern machine learning
C. To explain why antibiotics are no longer prescribed by doctors
D. To argue that hospitals immediately adopted expert systems

Q4. The word "explicit" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. clearly stated
B. privately owned
C. frequently ignored
D. highly uncertain

Q5. What is described as one weakness of expert systems?

A. They cannot store information.
B. They require continual expert input and updating.
C. They are unable to follow rules.
D. They were never used outside medicine.

2026-08-08 Feedback Systems

原文（Passage）

Feedback Systems

A feedback system is a self-regulating loop in which the output of a process is monitored and used to adjust future input. Such systems appear in machines, biological organisms, ecosystems, and social organizations. A familiar example is a thermostat. When a room becomes colder than the selected temperature, the heating system turns on; when the room becomes warm enough, the system turns off. By constantly comparing actual conditions with a target condition, the system helps maintain stability.

Not all feedback, however, produces smooth control. A feedback loop can respond too slowly or too strongly. If there is a delay between measurement and correction, the system may overcorrect. A thermostat that reacts slowly, for example, may continue heating after the room has already reached the desired temperature, producing uncomfortable temperature swings. Similarly, an unmanned aerial vehicle that encounters sudden gusts of wind must adjust quickly; if its control system responds too late, it may drift away from its planned path.

Feedback systems can be negative or positive. Negative feedback reduces deviation from a target and promotes stability, as in the thermostat example. Positive feedback, by contrast, amplifies change. In some situations, positive feedback can be useful, but it can also make a system unstable if unchecked. Understanding the difference between these feedback types is essential for designing systems that can regulate themselves without constant human intervention.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To describe how feedback systems regulate processes and why timing matters
B. To argue that thermostats are more complex than aircraft control systems
C. To explain why feedback systems cannot be used in machines
D. To compare human decision-making with animal behavior

Q2. According to the passage, what does a feedback system use to adjust future input?

A. The output of a process
B. Random external signals
C. Historical records only
D. Human emotion

Q3. Why can a delayed response cause problems in a feedback loop?

A. It may prevent the system from detecting any output.
B. It may cause the system to overcorrect.
C. It always turns negative feedback into positive feedback.
D. It removes the target condition from the system.

Q4. The word "amplifies" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. increases
B. measures
C. hides
D. prevents

Q5. What is indicated about negative feedback?

A. It increases deviation from a target condition.
B. It is useful only in biological systems.
C. It helps maintain stability by reducing deviation.
D. It prevents all changes from occurring.

2026-08-08 Music Education

原文（Passage）

Music Education

Research on music education suggests that studying music may support several areas of cognitive development. In the United States, studies of students who receive sustained musical training have found improvements in memory, language learning, and certain kinds of spatial reasoning. These benefits may arise because music requires students to recognize patterns, remember sequences, and connect sounds with symbols. Reading musical notation, for example, involves translating visual signs into coordinated physical actions and sounds.

Rhythm and structure are especially important. When students practice music, they must attend to timing, repetition, and variation. This structured practice may strengthen neural pathways involved in attention and prediction. Language learning may also benefit because both language and music require sensitivity to sound patterns, pitch, stress, and timing. Although music lessons do not automatically produce academic success, they can provide a form of training that overlaps with skills used in other domains.

Music education may also encourage social development. Ensemble performance requires students to listen to one another, adjust their timing, and contribute to a shared result. A student playing too loudly or too quickly must learn to respond to the group. These cooperative demands can build patience, discipline, and social awareness. For this reason, many educators argue that music should not be treated as a decorative addition to schooling but as a subject that develops both intellectual and interpersonal abilities.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Music education can support cognitive and social development.
B. Music education is useful only for students who become professional musicians.
C. Language learning is unrelated to musical training.
D. Ensemble performance reduces students' need for discipline.

Q2. According to paragraph 1, what does reading musical notation require students to do?

A. Memorize every instrument in an orchestra
B. Translate visual signs into coordinated actions and sounds
C. Avoid connecting sound with symbols
D. Focus only on social development

Q3. The word "sustained" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. continued
B. optional
C. accidental
D. silent

Q4. Why does the passage mention ensemble performance?

A. To show how music education can promote cooperation and social awareness
B. To argue that solo performance is not real music
C. To explain why music should be removed from schools

D. To suggest that rhythm is not important in music

Q5. What can be inferred from the passage about the academic benefits of music lessons?

A. They are automatic and guaranteed for every student.

B. They may occur because musical skills overlap with other cognitive skills.

C. They depend entirely on students performing in public concerts.

D. They come only from listening to music, not from practicing it.

2026-08-08 Origami

原文（Passage）

Origami

Origami, the Japanese art of paper folding, is often understood today as a recreational craft, but its history is far more complex. The word origami comes from the Japanese words ori, meaning "folding," and kami, meaning "paper." Although paper was first introduced to Japan from China, the practice of folding paper gradually developed distinctive Japanese forms and meanings. In the Edo period, when paper became less expensive and more widely available, folded-paper objects began to appear not only in religious ceremonies but also in daily entertainment and education.

Early origami was closely associated with ritual use. Folded paper was attached to gifts or offerings, and certain forms were thought to express respect, purity, or good fortune. The paper crane, for example, later became a symbol of peace and hope. These symbolic meanings helped origami remain culturally important even as it became more widely practiced outside formal ceremonies.

In the modern period, origami has influenced fields beyond art. Engineers and designers have studied folding patterns to solve practical problems involving compact storage and efficient deployment. Solar panels, medical stents, airbags, and space structures have all benefited from principles similar to those used in origami. A sheet that can be folded into a small shape and then expanded into a complex structure offers clear advantages in situations where space is limited. Thus, origami illustrates how a traditional art form can inspire modern technological design.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To compare Japanese origami with Chinese paper-making traditions

B. To explain the history, cultural meaning, and modern applications of origami

C. To argue that origami should be taught as an engineering course

D. To describe the decline of origami after the Edo period

Q2. According to the passage, why did origami become more common during the Edo period?

A. Paper became more affordable and available.

B. Religious ceremonies were no longer practiced.

C. Engineers began using folding patterns.

D. The paper crane became Japan's national symbol.

Q3. The word "distinctive" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. unusual

B. recognizable

C. temporary

D. expensive

Q4. Why does the passage mention solar panels, medical stents, airbags, and space structures?

A. To show that origami principles have practical uses in modern design

B. To argue that origami is mainly a scientific discipline

C. To contrast traditional Japanese paper with modern industrial materials
D. To explain why paper folding has lost its symbolic meaning

Q5. What can be inferred about the paper crane from the passage?

A. It was originally designed by engineers.
B. It became meaningful because of its symbolic associations.
C. It was used only during the Edo period.
D. It was introduced to Japan from Europe.

2026-08-08 Power of Music

原文（Passage）

Power of Music

Music has long been recognized as more than a form of entertainment. Across cultures, people have used rhythm, melody, and harmony to express emotion, coordinate group activity, and preserve collective memory. Researchers studying the effects of music have found that listening to or performing music can influence mood, attention, and even physical responses such as heart rate and breathing. These effects help explain why music is often used in ceremonies, education, therapy, and social gatherings.

One reason music is powerful is that it engages multiple areas of the brain at the same time. Processing rhythm involves systems related to movement and timing, while melody and harmony can activate regions associated with memory and emotion. Because music combines pattern, expectation, and surprise, listeners often experience strong emotional reactions when a musical phrase resolves or when a rhythm changes unexpectedly. This combination of mental and physical engagement makes music unusually effective at capturing attention.

Music can also strengthen social bonds. Group singing, dancing, or drumming requires people to coordinate their actions, and this coordination can increase feelings of trust and belonging. Some researchers suggest that music may have played an important role in early human societies by helping groups cooperate. Although the specific functions of music vary from one culture to another, its ability to connect emotion, memory, and social behavior appears to be widespread.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To explain why music has powerful emotional and social effects
B. To compare modern music with music in ancient societies
C. To argue that music should replace traditional education
D. To describe how musical instruments are manufactured

Q2. According to paragraph 2, why can music strongly capture attention?

A. It removes the need for memory.
B. It engages several brain systems at once.
C. It is usually performed in formal ceremonies.
D. It prevents unexpected emotional reactions.

Q3. The word "coordinate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. organize together
B. record permanently
C. perform separately
D. explain clearly

Q4. Why does the author mention group singing, dancing, and drumming?

A. To show that music can require shared action and strengthen social bonds
B. To argue that instrumental music is more important than vocal music

C. To explain why music has no practical value outside entertainment
D. To describe the earliest known musical instruments

Q5. What can be inferred from the passage about music in different cultures?

A. It has exactly the same function in all societies.
B. It is used only in religious ceremonies.
C. Its functions differ, but its social and emotional power is widespread.
D. It became important only after the development of written language.

2026-08-08 Urban Resilience

原文（Passage）

Urban Resilience

Urban resilience refers to a city's ability to withstand, adapt to, and recover from disruptions. These disruptions may include natural disasters, economic downturns, public health crises, or failures in transportation and energy systems. In the past, city planning often focused on efficiency: roads, utilities, and public services were designed to operate smoothly under normal conditions. However, recent crises have shown that efficiency alone is not enough. A city must also be able to continue functioning when conditions become unpredictable.

One strategy for increasing urban resilience is redundancy. If a city depends on a single transportation route, power source, or water supply, a failure in that one system can create widespread problems. Multiple routes, backup power systems, and distributed water storage can make a city less vulnerable. Another strategy is flexibility. Public spaces, for example, can be designed for everyday recreation but also serve as emergency shelters or distribution centers during a crisis.

Social resilience is equally important. Communities with strong local networks often recover more quickly because residents can share information, check on vulnerable neighbors, and coordinate assistance. For this reason, urban resilience is not simply a matter of stronger buildings or better technology. It also depends on public trust, communication, and the ability of institutions and citizens to respond together when difficulties arise.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Urban resilience involves physical systems, flexible planning, and social cooperation.
B. Cities should focus only on making transportation systems more efficient.
C. Natural disasters are the only major threat to modern cities.
D. Public spaces are useful only when they are designed for recreation.

Q2. According to the passage, why can excessive dependence on a single system be risky?

A. It makes normal conditions impossible to manage.
B. It can cause widespread problems if that system fails.
C. It prevents cities from building public spaces.
D. It reduces the need for communication.

Q3. The word "redundancy" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. backup capacity
B. decorative design
C. public disagreement
D. rapid expansion

Q4. Why does the passage mention public spaces that can become emergency shelters?

A. To illustrate how flexible design can improve resilience
B. To argue that parks should be closed during crises

C. To show that recreation is more important than safety
D. To explain why cities no longer need emergency planning

Q5. What can be inferred about social resilience?

A. It depends only on government technology.
B. It can help communities recover more quickly after disruptions.
C. It is unrelated to communication among residents.
D. It matters less than the design of buildings.

2026-08-08 Vitamin Discovery

原文（Passage）

Vitamin Discovery

Before the twentieth century, many diseases were explained as infections or as the result of poor living conditions. However, physicians gradually noticed that some illnesses could be prevented or cured simply by changing a person's diet. Beriberi, a disease that caused weakness and nerve problems, was common in populations that depended heavily on polished rice. Because polishing removed the outer layers of the grain, people who ate mostly polished rice were missing an essential nutrient.

The Polish-born biochemist Casimir Funk made an important contribution to understanding this problem. In 1912, Funk isolated a substance from rice bran that helped prevent beriberi. He believed that this substance belonged to a class of compounds containing amines, and he coined the term vitamine, combining vita, meaning "life," with amine. Although scientists later discovered that not all vitamins are amines, the shorter form vitamin remained in use.

Funk's work changed how researchers thought about nutrition. Instead of viewing food only as a source of calories, scientists began to understand that small quantities of particular substances were necessary for normal growth and health. Later research identified many other vitamins and linked their absence to specific deficiency diseases. The discovery of vitamins therefore helped establish nutrition as a modern scientific field and encouraged public health campaigns focused on balanced diets.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main topic of the passage?

A. The history of polished rice production
B. The discovery of vitamins and its importance for nutrition science
C. The spread of infectious diseases in the twentieth century
D. The chemical structure of all known vitamins

Q2. According to the passage, why was beriberi common among people who depended on polished rice?

A. Polished rice contained harmful bacteria.
B. Polished rice lacked an important nutrient found in rice bran.
C. Polished rice was difficult for the body to digest.
D. Polished rice contained too many amines.

Q3. The word "coined" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. invented
B. translated
C. rejected
D. shortened

Q4. Why was the original term "vitamine" later shortened to "vitamin"?

A. Scientists learned that not all vitamins are amines.

B. Funk discovered that vitamins did not come from food.
C. Public health officials wanted a simpler name for rice bran.
D. The term was first used only in Polish.

Q5. What did Funk's work help scientists realize?
A. Food should be valued only for the calories it provides.
B. Some diseases are caused by the absence of small but essential nutrients.
C. Rice bran is the only source of vitamins.
D. All illnesses can be cured through diet alone.

2026-08-06（1 套）

2026-08-06 Placebo Effect

原文（Passage）

The Power of Placebos

The placebo effect challenges conventional ideas about medical treatment efficacy. What is a placebo? [A] A patient's condition sometimes improves if they believe that they are receiving an effective treatment, even if they are in fact receiving a sugar pill. [B] In this example, the sugar pill, which has no active ingredient, is a placebo. Surprisingly, this effect can sometimes rival real medications in clinical trials. [C]

Recent studies suggest that the placebo effect might be rooted in the brain's complex chemistry. [D] When a patient anticipates positive effects, their brain can release chemicals like endorphins, which may cause genuine physiological changes. In one study, patients receiving placebo "painkillers" reported pain relief comparable to the one produced by actual painkillers, highlighting the brain's powerful role. Some researchers propose using the placebo effect deliberately to enhance therapy outcomes, arguing that the mind-body connection should be tapped into more.

However, ethical considerations arise: deceiving patients could undermine trust in healthcare. For example, even when a placebo leads to measurable improvement, knowingly administering it without full disclosure may violate principles of informed consent, raising questions about autonomy and transparency in patient care. This delicate balance between harnessing the placebo effect and maintaining ethical standards continues to be a topic of debate.

题目（Questions）

Q1. How does the placebo effect challenge traditional views on treatment?
A. By showing that patients should have more say in selecting their medications
B. By suggesting that a patient's belief can be as powerful as a medicine
C. By questioning existing measurements of the effectiveness of a treatment
D. By pointing out a possible way to reduce the costs of clinical trials

Q2. What does paragraph 2 indicate about the placebo effect?
A. It affects patients much more powerfully than actual painkillers do.
B. It may be related to the release of endorphins in the brain.
C. It has not been connected by researchers to any physiological changes.
D. It is enhanced when it is accompanied by actual painkillers.

Q3. The word "deliberately" in the passage is closest in meaning to
A. on purpose
B. with caution
C. efficiently
D. regularly

Q4. Why does the author mention "autonomy and transparency in patient care"?

A. To argue for the use of the placebo effect
B. To highlight an ethical challenge in using the placebo effect
C. To suggest that trust is less important than other considerations in healthcare
D. To explain how the placebo effect is misunderstood

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Researchers have long been puzzled by the mechanisms behind this phenomenon. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "What is a placebo?"
B. After "A patient's condition sometimes improves if they believe that they are receiving an effective treatment, even if they are in fact receiving a sugar pill."
C. After "Surprisingly, this effect can sometimes rival real medications in clinical trials."
D. After "Recent studies suggest that the placebo effect might be rooted in the brain's complex chemistry."

2026-08-05（2 套）

2026-08-05 Diane Arbus Portraits

原文（Passage）

Diane Arbus

Diane Arbus (1923-1971) occupies a singular place in the history of photography, celebrated and criticized for her stark, intimate portraits of a wide range of people, including some of unconventional appearance or marginalized social status. Her work has long provoked debate because it resists easy moral or aesthetic categorization. Some critics, such as Susan Sontag, argued that Arbus' photographs create a troubling distance between viewer and subject. Sontag claimed that Arbus' images risk turning people into spectacles of oddity, suggesting that her gaze could be predatory in its fascination with difference. Others, however, see Arbus as a profoundly empathetic artist. Writers like Arthur Lubow emphasize her ability to reveal her subjects' complexity and dignity, noting that many of them collaborated willingly and even joyfully in the creation of their portraits.

A further line of debate surrounds Arbus' style: her use of frontal composition, square format, and direct flash has been interpreted negatively - as a cold, clinical approach - and positively - as a method that strips away artifice to expose deeper truths. Ultimately, Arbus' work continues to inspire disagreement because it challenges viewers to confront their own assumptions about normalcy, beauty, and vulnerability. Her photographs remain powerful precisely because they refuse to resolve these tensions.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "stark" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. severe
B. graceful
C. classic
D. natural

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about Sontag?

A. She believed that Arbus called too much attention to her own technique in her portraits.
B. She admired Arbus' style but criticized her subject matter.
C. She viewed Arbus' photography as exploitive.
D. She felt that Arbus misunderstood her subjects.

Q3. The author mentions "complexity and dignity" primarily in order to

A. identify traits that Arbus looked for when choosing photographic subjects
B. illustrate how some viewers of Arbus' work have rebutted a negative view of her
C. highlight one way in which Arbus' photographs are unconventional
D. explain why Arbus preferred frontal composition to other ways of posing subjects

Q4. The passage indicates that Arbus' style

A. helps explain why Arbus' subjects often collaborated willingly in the creation of their portraits
B. reflected Arbus' preference for an unusual type of photographic film
C. influenced the way in which other photographers approached portraiture
D. has been viewed by some people as effective in revealing an authentic reality

Q5. It can be inferred that the author regards the disagreements created by Arbus' photographs as

A. evidence that Arbus has been misunderstood
B. essential to the photographs' power as works of art
C. a reflection of the influence of Sontag on Arbus' reputation
D. arising from false assumptions about Arbus' style

2026-08-05 Glacier Climate Records

原文（Passage）

Ancient Air in Glaciers

Glaciers, repositories of ancient ice, serve as frozen libraries of Earth's climatic history. As snow accumulates and compresses over centuries, it traps air bubbles that create tiny atmospheric snapshots. These bubbles are crucial for understanding climate evolution. By analyzing the gases within the bubbles, researchers are able to reconstruct past concentrations of greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide and methane, revealing both natural climate cycles and the escalating impact of human activity.

Though many glaciers are retreating due to rising temperatures, surviving ones offer a window into the past. Scientists drill deep into the ice to extract cylindrical cores, whose layers, much like tree rings, correspond to distinct time periods. These layers contain more than just gases: They hold chemical and physical markers of past environmental events. Ice cores can reveal data about volcanic eruptions via ash and sulfate layers, solar activity via isotopic changes, and forest fires via trapped particulates and black carbon.

Recent studies underscore the precarious future of these icy archives. As glaciers melt, they contribute to rising sea levels, and the risk that invaluable climate data will be lost increases. The urgency to study and preserve these records grows. While scientists race against time, the question remains: what secrets do these frozen giants still hold?

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that explains the natural process by which climate data is preserved. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Glaciers, repositories of ancient ice, serve as frozen libraries of Earth's climatic history.
B. As snow accumulates and compresses over centuries, it traps air bubbles that create tiny atmospheric snapshots.
C. These bubbles are crucial for understanding climate evolution.
D. By analyzing the gases within the bubbles, researchers are able to reconstruct past concentrations of greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide and methane, revealing both natural climate cycles and the escalating impact of human activity.

Q2. The word "escalating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. increasing

B. continuing
C. powerful
D. damaging

Q3. According to the passage, all of the following are true about ice cores EXCEPT:

A. Ice cores are obtained by drilling far down into glaciers.
B. Each layer in an ice core formed at a different point in time.
C. Ice core layers are sometimes destroyed by severe environmental events.
D. Ice cores can be used to identify when volcanoes erupted in the past.

Q4. Why does the author mention "tree rings"?

A. To compare the usefulness of trees and ice cores for studying past climates
B. To highlight the extreme age of some layers of ice cores
C. To illustrate the layering that exists in ice cores
D. To contrast the physical markers present in tree rings with the chemical markers found in ice cores

Q5. The passage implies that scientists should

A. look quickly for other sources of valuable climate data
B. increase the size of the ice cores they drill
C. find ways to limit the rise of sea levels
D. work as quickly as possible to collect more ice cores

2026-07-29（9 套）

2026-07-29 Ancient Mars Climate

原文（Passage）

Ancient Mars Climate

Water and Climate on Ancient Mars

Despite Mars's bleak, cold climate today, there is abundant geologic evidence that liquid water once flowed on the Martian surface. The evidence of past flows includes river channels, now dry, that were once carved by powerful floods, valley networks of branching streams and tributaries indicating precipitation falling over wide areas, and salt and other minerals that dissolved in liquid water and were left behind when water evaporated. When that ancient wet period existed and when it ended is difficult to say.

The other way to date a planetary surface, which is used when rock samples are unavailable, is by counting craters. The longer a surface has been exposed to meteorite bombardment, the more craters it will have. This gives the relative age, and allows one to determine which surfaces are older and which are younger. The general conclusion is that a wet period occurred early in Mars's 4.5-billion-year history.

This causes a problem for Mars climate science, because the Sun's luminosity was supposed to be lower—the Sun fainter, perhaps by 20 or 30 percent, during the Mars wet period. Yet a watery Mars arguably would have required relatively warm temperatures. The same problem exists for Earth, which appears to have been warmer billions of years ago than it is today. Geologists have called this the "faint young Sun paradox." The solution to the paradox probably lies in climate science and not in the theory of stellar evolution, but the issue has not been entirely settled.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary focus of the passage?

A. Evidence for ancient water on Mars and the climate difficulties this evidence raises
B. An explanation of why Mars's current climate is cold and dry

C. A comparison of dating methods used to study planetary surfaces
D. The role of the Sun's luminosity in shaping conditions on both Earth and Mars

Q2. According to the passage, what does crater counting reveal about a planetary surface?

A. The frequency with which underground aquifers released water
B. The precise calendar date on which the surface first formed
C. The relative age of the surface compared to other surfaces
D. The chemical composition of the minerals deposited on the surface

Q3. The word "luminosity" in paragraph 3 is closest in meaning to

A. distance
B. temperature
C. stability
D. brightness

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about the "faint young Sun paradox"?

A. It has been resolved primarily through advances in the theory of stellar evolution.
B. Scientists have not yet reached a definitive explanation for it.
C. It applies only to Mars and has no bearing on Earth's geological record.
D. It demonstrates that crater counting is an unreliable dating method.

Q5. Why does the author mention valley networks and river deltas in the first paragraph?

A. To explain how crater counting can be applied to interpret Martian geology
B. To contrast the ancient Martian landscape with its present barren surface
C. To illustrate the variety of geologic features that support the presence of ancient water
D. To argue that Mars once had a climate warmer than Earth's current climate ---

2026-07-29 Civic Education

原文（Passage）

The Importance Of Civic Education

A comprehensive civic education includes understanding the structure of a country's government, electoral processes, and system of laws. It equips citizens with knowledge about their rights and responsibilities, fostering informed participation in the political process. [A] Recent studies show a decline in civic knowledge among young people in the United States. [B] Many are unfamiliar with even the most basic concepts. [C] They struggle to describe how laws are made and name the roles of different government branches. [D] Who is more likely to actively participate in the democratic process: a young person who knows how the government functions or one who does not? A successful democracy depends on active participation by its citizens.

Efforts to address the problem include integrating civic education into school curriculums with activities that students find fun and exciting. Teachers can organize mock legislatures or congresses, where students role-play as members of a legislative body and draft, debate, and vote on bills. Students can also learn about the legal system by conducting mock trials. However, it should be noted that factors such as socioeconomic background and access to resources may limit access to high-quality civic education.

题目（Questions）

Q1. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "Understanding their rights and responsibilities helps citizens engage in society, advocate for change, and contribute to community development." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1

B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-29 Climate Change and Corals

原文（Passage）

The Impact Of Climate Change

Coral reefs are among the most diverse and valuable ecosystems on Earth, providing habitat for countless marine species. However, climate change poses a severe threat to these vibrant underwater communities. Rising sea temperatures lead to coral bleaching, a phenomenon where corals lose their color and essential symbiotic algae, resulting in weakened corals that are more susceptible to disease.

In addition to temperature changes, climate change contributes to ocean acidification through increased atmospheric CO2 levels. Ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium carbonate, a crucial component of coral skeletons. [A] As the acidity of seawater increases, corals struggle to maintain their structures, leading to diminished reef growth and stability. [B]

Efforts to mitigate these impacts include developing coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification. [C] Scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as potential solutions. Furthermore, initiatives to reduce CO2 emissions globally aim to alleviate the stress on coral reefs. [D] The survival of coral reefs depends largely on addressing climate change comprehensively.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is coral bleaching?

A. An increase in coral growth
B. An effect of high temperatures that harms coral
C. A method of coral reproduction
D. A protective mechanism used by corals

Q2. What is the effect of ocean acidification on coral reefs?

A. It leads to temperature changes in the surrounding waters.
B. It can increase atmospheric CO2 levels, resulting in bleaching.
C. It reduces the availability of the calcium carbonate needed for coral structures.
D. It leads to more stability within existing reefs.

Q3. The word "mitigate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. research
B. alleviate
C. measure
D. predict

Q4. What is suggested in the passage about selective breeding and genetic modification?

A. They are the only solutions to coral bleaching.
B. They are potential methods to develop resilient coral species.
C. They are proven to reverse ocean acidification.
D. They help reduce CO2 emissions.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "The absence of calcium carbonate also reduces the ability of corals to support diverse marine life and protect coastal ecosystems." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2

C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-29 Domestication of Maize

原文（Passage）

The Domestication of Maize

Maize, also known as corn, is one of the world's most important crops. Scholars studying its domestication have debated about how a wild grass with limited utility transformed into a globally significant staple. The dominant theory, supported by genetic and archaeological evidence, posits that maize was domesticated from wild teosinte (a species that, like modern maize, belongs to the Zea genus) in southwestern Mexico roughly 9,000 years ago. Proponents argue that early cultivators selectively bred plants exhibiting desirable traits - larger kernels, reduced seed casings, and more robust cobs - thereby accelerating the cultivated plants' divergence from teosinte. This model is reinforced by analyses demonstrating a close genetic relationship between modern maize and specific southwest Mexican teosinte populations. Alternative accounts have also been suggested. Some researchers propose a multiregional model, suggesting that while initial domestication occurred in Mexico, subsequent hybridization with other species of the Zea genus across Central America contributed to maize's eventual diversity. Another hypothesis highlights the possibility of protracted domestication, in which early foragers managed wild-growing teosinte long before fully domesticated maize emerged, blurring the boundary between cultivation and wild harvesting. Although consensus increasingly favors a single primary domestication event, ongoing discoveries continue to refine our understanding of one of the world's most transformative crops.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The author mentions "limited utility" primarily to

A. point out a shortcoming of maize as a globally significant staple
B. explain why the domestication of wild teosinte did not occur earlier
C. emphasize that wild teosinte was not an important nutritional source in Mexico 9,000 years ago
D. suggest that the domestication of maize was remarkable

Q2. What can be inferred about wild teosinte available to early cultivators in southwestern Mexico?

A. It grew more slowly than domesticated maize.
B. Its kernels were smaller than those of domesticated maize.
C. Its seed casings were thinner than the casings of domesticated maize.
D. There is no trace of it in the archaeological evidence from southwestern Mexico.

Q3. What does the multiregional model propose about maize's development?

A. Early cultivators bred plants with desirable traits.
B. Maize was domesticated much earlier than the dominant theory suggests.
C. Hybridization with other Zea species contributed to maize's eventual diversity.
D. Maize was first domesticated in Central America.

Q4. The word "subsequent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rapid
B. later
C. steady
D. frequent

Q5. The passage indicates which of the following about the protracted domestication hypothesis?

A. It suggests that early foragers managed teosinte before maize was fully domesticated.
B. It is proven wrong by evidence concerning foragers' utilization of wild-growing plants.
C. It may explain the genetic diversity of the Zea genus in Central America.
D. It is responsible for a change in the way researchers define the term "domestication."

2026-07-29 Gestures in Acting

原文（Passage）

The Evolving Role of Gestures in Acting

Gestures have always been integral to acting, serving as silent yet powerful tools for conveying emotions and intentions. Before the advent of sound in cinema, actors relied on exaggerated gestures to communicate, creating a universal language that transcended spoken words. This visual communication was essential in silent films, allowing actors to express complex narratives through movement alone.

In modern theater and film, gestures have evolved into subtler devices, designed to complement spoken dialogue and enhance realism. A nuanced gesture, such as the slight arch of an eyebrow or a lingering touch, can reveal a character's inner conflict or emotional transitions, adding layers of meaning without overt expression. This transformation reflects a broader shift toward naturalism in acting, where authenticity is paramount, and even the smallest gesture is deliberate.

With such a great expressive power, as they say, comes great responsibility: cultural interpretations of gestures add complexity to acting in multicultural contexts. A gesture considered respectful in one culture might be misinterpreted in another as offensive or dismissive. Actors must adapt and modify their gestures to resonate with diverse audiences, a skill that distinguishes adept performers. This adaptability highlights how gestures are not merely physical movements but are deeply rooted in cultural understanding and empathy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author discuss silent films in paragraph 1?

A. To describe the impact of the advent of sound in cinema
B. To acknowledge that silent films limited actor expression
C. To critique the use of acting techniques in modern films
D. To show that gestures have always been crucial to acting

Q2. The word "overt" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. direct
B. clever
C. concise
D. nuanced

Q3. Paragraph 2 mentions all of the following about the use of gestures in modern theater and film EXCEPT:

A. It makes performances more genuine.
B. It enables actors to convey more meaning.
C. It complements spoken dialogue.
D. It is especially important for weaker actors.

Q4. The passage suggests that contemporary actors

A. minimize the use of gestures to avoid seeming old-fashioned
B. rely more on physical gestures than on spoken dialogue

C. employ gestures thoughtfully to enhance emotional authenticity
D. favor gestures whose meanings are shared across many cultures

Q5. According to paragraph 3, what is one skill that theater actors need in multicultural contexts?

A. Anticipating audience interpretations across cultures
B. Maintaining consistency in physical expression
C. Avoiding gestures that carry emotional intensity
D. Knowing when words alone cannot convey an emotion

2026-07-29 Green Roof Benefits

原文（Passage）

Green Roof Benefits

Green roofs, or living roofs, are gaining prominence in urban areas due to their environmental benefits. These are roofs covered with vegetation to help manage stormwater by absorbing rainfall, decreasing runoff, and minimizing flooding risks. Another advantage of green roofs is their ability to improve air quality. Plants on the roof filter pollutants and capture dust. Additionally, green roofs reduce the urban heat island effect. Conventional roofs absorb and radiate heat, increasing urban temperatures. In contrast, green roofs keep buildings cooler by providing insulation and emitting moisture through their plants and soil.

Green roofs offer energy-efficiency benefits. The insulation provided by soil and plants reduces the need for heating in winter and cooling in summer, leading to energy savings. Green roofs can also extend the lifespan of the roof by shielding materials from UV radiation and extreme temperatures, keeping the underlying structure sound for longer.

Finally, green roofs support urban biodiversity. Their vegetative layers create habitats for insects and birds in cities where green spaces are limited. These microhabitats help sustain pollinator populations and promote ecological balance. [A] Green roofs can also grow food, contributing to food security in urban environments. [B] Despite these advantages, green roofs can be costly to install. [C] However, many cities offer incentives to encourage their adoption. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "minimizing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. monitoring
B. postponing
C. controlling
D. lowering

Q2. What is suggested about the urban heat island effect?

A. The characteristics of traditional roofs add to the problem.
B. Plants on roofs are not able to combat the problem effectively.
C. The problem is also starting to affect rural areas around the world.
D. The problem affects only the exterior spaces between buildings.

Q3. How do green roofs contribute to energy efficiency?

A. By eliminating the need for heating and air conditioning
B. By creating microhabitats for pollinators
C. By offering natural insulation and releasing moisture
D. By absorbing most of the Sun's UV radiation

Q4. Why does the author mention vegetative layers?

A. To support the claim that pollinator populations in cities are increasing
B. To show how insect and bird populations can be supported by green roofs

C. To discuss one potential way to provide access to food for urban residents
D. To address the concern that green roofs may be too costly to maintain

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Additionally, green roofs require ongoing maintenance to ensure proper drainage, plant health, and structural integrity." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-29 Polarized Light Applications

原文（Passage）

Polarized Light's Surprising Applications

Light waves usually vibrate in many directions. A polarizing filter admits waves oriented mainly along one plane, reducing reflections from flat surfaces such as water or glass. This familiar property makes polarized sunglasses useful, but the same control of light direction also provides invaluable evidence about materials that ordinary illumination cannot reveal.

When polarized light passes through certain crystals, its direction changes according to their internal structure. Viewed between crossed filters, these changes produce distinctive colors and patterns. Geologists use polarized light microscopes to identify minerals in thin rock sections and examine how crystals formed under pressure.

[A] Living tissues also alter polarization. [B] Collagen fibers, muscle cells, and some deposits associated with disease create signals that reveal organization not apparent under ordinary illumination. [C] Such images can guide analysis by showing where tissue structure differs from nearby areas, although those differences may have several causes. [D]

Yet a tool that improves vision in one setting may interfere in another. Some electronic flight displays use polarized light. If pilots wear lenses whose filtering direction conflicts with a display, the screen may darken or disappear at certain angles. Aviation guidance therefore discourages polarized lenses because glare reduction is not always beneficial in a cockpit.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "invaluable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. recommended
B. convenient
C. extremely useful
D. very expensive

Q2. All of the following are mentioned as applications of polarized light EXCEPT:

A. Reducing reflections from flat surfaces
B. Identifying minerals in thin rock sections
C. Changing the internal structure of living cells
D. Revealing differences in tissue structure

Q3. What can be inferred about the use of polarized light in biological analysis?

A. It may indicate areas that deserve closer examination.
B. It can identify the precise cause of each tissue difference on its own.
C. It is most useful when tissue looks the same under polarized and ordinary light.
D. It is intended mainly to change the organization of diseased tissue.

Q4. Why might polarized sunglasses be unsuitable for some pilots?

A. They prevent pilots from noticing reflections on water.

B. Their filters can make some electronic displays difficult to see.
C. They change the measurements produced by flight instruments.
D. They work only when displays are viewed from directly ahead.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "This limitation means that polarized images should supplement other biological evidence rather than replace it." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-29 Spider Silk Medicine

原文（Passage）

Spider Silk Medicine

Spider Silk in Medicine

Spider silk is one of nature's most remarkable materials, known for its strength and elasticity. Stronger than steel and highly stretchable, spider silk has inspired researchers to explore its medical potential.

Researchers have experimented with spider silk as a surgical suture material for use in stitching wounds, praising its strength and biocompatibility—a material's ability to interact with the human body without causing adverse reactions, such as inflammation or rejection. Spider silk meets this criterion exceptionally well. It integrates smoothly with human tissues, minimizing immune response and promoting faster healing. Additionally, its natural elasticity helps the sutures adapt to bodily movements, reducing the risk of sutures rupturing under tension.

Spider silk has been woven into advanced dressings for wounds that accelerate recovery. Spider silk's biocompatibility and ability to retain moisture make it ideal for treating chronic wounds and joint injuries. Spider silk-based bandages can also be infused with medications for localized drug delivery, reducing infection risk and improving treatment outcomes.

However, large-scale production is challenging. [A] Spiders are territorial and cannibalistic, making farming them for silk impractical. [B] Scientists have turned to synthetic methods of producing spider silk using genetically modified bacteria and yeast, but scaling up these techniques remains difficult. [C] Researchers continue refining techniques to make spider silk more accessible. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "remarkable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. mysterious
B. abundant
C. analyzed
D. extraordinary

Q2. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that contains the definition of a term. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Researchers have experimented with spider silk as a surgical suture material for use in stitching wounds, praising its strength and biocompatibility—a material's ability to interact with the human body without causing adverse reactions, such as inflammation or rejection.
B. Spider silk meets this criterion exceptionally well.
C. It integrates smoothly with human tissues, minimizing immune response and promoting faster healing.

D. Additionally, its natural elasticity helps the sutures adapt to bodily movements, reducing the risk of sutures rupturing under tension.

Q3. The passage indicates all of the following about spider silk-based sutures EXCEPT:

A. They are less likely to cause inflammation.
B. They are easily incorporated into human tissues.
C. They are less expensive than traditional sutures.
D. They are less likely to fail when placed under stress.

Q4. All of the following are benefits of wound dressings made from spider silk EXCEPT:

A. They speed up the recovery process.
B. They are simple to prepare and apply.
C. They do not dry out as quickly as other dressings.
D. They make localized drug delivery easy.

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. > By contrast, silkworms, traditionally used for obtaining silk, are domesticated and easy to manage. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]
B. [■2]
C. [■3]
D. [■4]

2026-07-29 The Getty Kouros

原文（Passage）

The Getty Kouros

In 1985, the J. Paul Getty Museum acquired what it believed to be a Greek kouros (a statue of a naked youth) dating from the Archaic period (650–480 B.C.E.), estimating the date of origin as approximately 530 B.C.E. The Getty Kouros's authenticity soon came into question, however. Supporters cited scientific analyses suggesting that the statue's marble is consistent with marble known to have come from ancient Greek quarries and that its surface shows chemical changes consistent with long-term burial. Some scholars also argue that peculiar inconsistencies in the statue's style—it incorporates features from different regions and periods—could reflect a transitional moment in Greek sculpture.

Skeptics contend that these inconsistencies undermine the case for authenticity. The Kouros combines traits from several other known sixth-century B.C.E. kouroi in a way that appears too eclectic to be genuine. To these observers, the statue looks like a modern forger's creation—a confused imitation of Greek Archaic elements rather than the genuine product of a coherent sculptural tradition. Furthermore, scientists recognize that modern forgers can artificially age marble.

Because neither scientific analysis nor stylistic evaluation yields decisive results, the question of the Kouros's authenticity remains unresolved.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about the "chemical changes" in the marble of the Getty Kouros?

A. They could not have occurred naturally.
B. They were caused by scientists testing the marble's age.
C. They explain some inconsistencies in features of the Getty Kouros.
D. They may suggest an ancient origin for the marble of the Getty Kouros.

Q2. The author mentions "a transitional moment in Greek sculpture" primarily in order to

A. question a claim about sixth-century B.C.E. kouroi

B. point out how some people explain the style of the Getty Kouros

C. characterize sculptures typical of the Greek Archaic period

D. support the view that artistic styles evolve over time

Q3. What is the main reason that the authenticity of the Getty Kouros is in doubt?

A. The Greeks did not create many sculptures during the sixth century B.C.E.

B. Modern forgers are known to have created similar sculptures.

C. Observers may have misunderstood Greek Archaic elements.

D. The Getty Kouros combines styles that are too diverse.

Q4. According to the passage, what is known about marble?

A. It can be quickly produced by forgers in large amounts.

B. It is difficult for forgers to imitate.

C. It can be made to appear older than it actually is.

D. Its traits could affect the style of Greek sculptures.

Q5. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?

A. The Getty Kouros is not typical of Greek kouroi and may or may not be genuine.

B. The Getty Kouros is composed of marble that has probably been artificially aged.

C. The Getty Kouros is probably of Greek origin but unlikely to be from the Archaic period.

D. The Getty Kouros was likely forged by a sculptor with limited knowledge of Greek sculptural traditions.

2026-07-25（4 套）

2026-07-25 Climate Geoengineering

原文（Passage）

Engineering Earth's Climate

Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM) focuses on manipulating Earth's processes to address environmental challenges. This field combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making to devise solutions for climate change and other issues. One method of ESEM is geoengineering, which involves deliberate intervention in Earth's climate system to counteract global warming.

Geoengineering techniques fall into two categories: solar radiation management (SRM) and carbon dioxide removal (CDR). SRM aims to reflect sunlight into space to cool the planet. Techniques include injecting aerosols into the stratosphere and deploying reflective mirrors. CDR focuses on reducing greenhouse gas concentrations through methods like afforestation, ocean fertilization, and direct air capture of CO2.

Implementing geoengineering presents challenges. [A] Technological feasibility is a concern, as many techniques are experimental. [B] There are ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions and how impacts are monitored. [C] Additionally, unintended consequences may arise, causing more harm than good. [D] Despite these challenges, ESEM offers solutions to mitigate climate change. Integrating engineering with environmental management can lead to innovative approaches for sustainability. Collaborative efforts between scientists, engineers, and policymakers are crucial to developing safe strategies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is true of Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM)?

A. It finds solutions for problems by allowing natural processes to work themselves out.

B. It uses the resources of multiple disciplines to accomplish its goals.

C. It focuses exclusively on counteracting global warming.
D. It is also known as geoengineering.

Q2. What is the basic difference between the two categories of geoengineering techniques?

A. SRM merely manages solar radiation, while CDR removes it altogether.
B. SRM injects aerosols into the stratosphere, while CDR deploys reflective mirrors.
C. SRM lowers greenhouse gas concentrations, while CDR directly captures CO2.
D. SRM reduces the effects of global warming, while CDR reduces its causes.

Q3. The word "feasibility" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. cost
B. workability
C. specialty
D. risk

Q4. What is one ongoing question raised by geoengineering?

A. What types of collaboration are required in order to develop safe strategies
B. Whether existing experimental techniques can be sustained
C. Who bears responsibility for implementing changes
D. Whether it can be integrated with environmental management

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Careful consideration is needed to assess the long-term impacts." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-25 Polarized Light Applications

原文（Passage）

Polarized Light's Surprising Applications

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2026-07-25 Psychology Of Laughter

原文（Passage）

Psychology Of Laughter

Laughter, a universal human behavior, plays a vital role in social harmony. Biologically, laughter triggers the release of endorphins, enhancing mood and resilience. This neurochemical response suggests an evolutionary advantage: laughter may have developed as a stress-coping mechanism, helping individuals endure hardship through shared emotional relief. This challenges the simplistic view of laughter as merely a reaction to humor. Instead, it reveals its deeper connection to emotional intelligence, mental health, and interpersonal communication.

Our laughter is often triggered when we hear others laugh, and this contagiousness makes it pivotal in group dynamics. For example, in social gatherings, laughter often spreads rapidly, reinforcing a sense of collective identity and emotional synchrony. However, this contagiousness is not always straightforward. In some contexts, such as forced laughter in professional settings or laughter used to mask discomfort, its role becomes ambiguous and subject to interpretation. While laughter can signal safety and shared understanding, it is complex and context-dependent. In relaxed environments, laughter often indicates trust and mutual comprehension. Yet, in tense situations, people may exhibit nervous laughter—such as during public speaking or conflict—which can mislead observers about their true emotional state. Research shows that identical laughter sounds can convey different meanings depending on social cues, tone, and setting, underscoring the importance of context in interpreting laughter.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What evidence does the passage present for the evolutionary advantages of laughter?

A. Laughter can be used to deceive people in social settings.

B. Laughter triggers the release of chemicals that improve mood.

C. Laughter can be a sign of awareness of one's social context.

D. Laughter is a necessary tool for interpersonal communication.

Q2. Why does the passage mention the contagiousness of laughter at social events?

A. To provide evidence for the claim that laughter is a universal human behavior

B. To illustrate the biological mechanism that causes laughter to spread among people in groups

C. To show how laughter strengthens social bonds through shared group experiences

D. To suggest that laughter primarily reflects individual emotional states

Q3. The word "straightforward" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. clear

B. significant

C. effective

D. consistent

Q4. What does the passage suggest about how observers interpret nervous laughter?

A. Observers may incorrectly interpret nervous laughter as a sign of amusement.

B. Observers usually interpret nervous laughter correctly in relaxed social environments.

C. Observers tend to interpret nervous laughter consistently across cultures.

D. Observers interpret nervous laughter primarily based on sound rather than on contextual cues.

Q5. Which of the following best summarizes the view of laughter presented in the passage?

A. Laughter is primarily a biological response that improves mood through chemical processes in the brain.

B. Laughter is a behavior whose meaning depends both on social context and on biological mechanisms.

C. Laughter spreads mainly because it is contagious and strengthens group identity in social settings.

D. Laughter reflects emotional intelligence by allowing individuals to express joy and relieve stress.

2026-07-25 The Flynn Effect

原文（Passage）

The Flynn Effect

Researchers have observed a phenomenon known as the Flynn Effect: a consistent increase in Intelligence Quotient (IQ) scores from one generation to the next. This trend, named after intelligence researcher James Flynn, shows that average IQ scores have risen by about three points per decade in many parts of the world.

Various theories have been proposed to explain this trend. One hypothesis is that improvements in nutrition and healthcare have enhanced brain development, leading to higher IQ scores. Another theory suggests that the complexity of modern life, with its increased cognitive demands, has driven this rise. The widespread use of technology and a more stimulating environment could also be contributing factors.

[A] However, the Flynn Effect does not necessarily indicate that people are becoming more intelligent. [B] Some researchers argue that the rise in IQ scores reflects better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests, rather than a genuine increase in cognitive abilities. [C] Recent studies have shown that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or

even reversing in some countries, challenging the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "consistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rapid
B. large
C. steady
D. recent

Q2. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as possible contributors to the trend of IQ scores EXCEPT

A. better eating habits and medical care
B. improvements in parental care
C. the cognitive demands of contemporary life
D. the extensive use of technology

Q3. According to some researchers, the Flynn Effect may be a sign that

A. people are becoming better at taking tests
B. IQ tests have become easier over time
C. test-takers thrive in stimulating environments
D. school systems have developed better examinations

Q4. Why does the author mention that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or reversing in some countries?

A. To suggest that there may not be a global increase in intelligence
B. To argue that cognitive abilities are declining around the world
C. To show that the Flynn Effect requires further research
D. To argue that the challenges of modern life can have negative effects on intelligence

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Changes in educational practices or shifts in societal values could account for the downturn." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-22（10 套）

2026-07-22 Adaptive Optics Revolution

原文（Passage）

Optical Astronomy's Adaptive Revolution

Optical astronomy, the study of celestial objects through visible light, has been revolutionized by adaptive optics, first developed in the late 1980s. [A] This technology, which allows ground-based telescopes at observatories to counteract atmospheric distortion, has enabled astronomers to observe the cosmos with exceptional clarity. Light waves from distant stars travel through Earth's atmosphere, creating a shimmering effect that distorts them. [B] Adaptive optics corrects these distortions in real time using a system of deformable mirrors controlled by computer algorithms. [C] The mirrors can change shape rapidly to counteract the distortion, with the algorithms calculating the needed adjustments thousands of times per second. [D]

However, the technology is not without controversy. Some argue that the energy consumption of adaptive optics contributes significantly to observatories' carbon footprints. Yet, proponents

counter that the potential discoveries outweigh environmental concerns, citing recent breakthroughs in identifying exoplanets potentially hospitable to life.
The debate highlights the complexities of balancing scientific advancement with environmental stewardship. Some researchers are actively exploring the use of solar panels and wind turbines to power these observatories, especially for daytime operations. Others are trying to optimize algorithms to reduce unnecessary computations and the need for constant high-speed corrections.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred from the passage about the capabilities of optical astronomy BEFORE the late 1980s?

A. Images of celestial objects from ground-based telescopes were often unclear.
B. Astronomers used adaptive optics to distort light waves.
C. Astronomers used the shimmering effect to find distant stars.
D. Telescopes used deformable mirrors to see farther into space.

Q2. How do proponents of adaptive optics counter criticism of the technology?

A. The observatories that use the technology have a lower carbon footprint than the critics maintain.
B. The usefulness of the technology is more important than its drawbacks.
C. The technology is only in its early stages and will improve over time.
D. The negative effects of the technology are localized and not globally significant.

Q3. The word "stewardship" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. supervision
B. achievement
C. enthusiasm
D. design

Q4. Why does the author mention attempts to optimize algorithms?

A. To give an example of how observatories could cut costs
B. To suggest that current algorithms still contain some errors when adjusting mirrors
C. To provide an example of how adaptive optics continues to evolve
D. To show one way researchers are trying to reduce observatories' energy consumption

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. > To understand this phenomenon, imagine looking through the heat waves seen over hot asphalt or desert sand. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]
B. [■2]
C. [■3]
D. [■4]

2026-07-22 Biofertilizer Dynamics

原文（Passage）

Biofertilizer Dynamics in Agrochemistry
One of the latest inventions in agrochemistry is biofertilizers. This innovation aims to provide an environmentally friendly alternative to traditional fertilizers, which are infamous for causing soil and water pollution. Biofertilizers use living microorganisms to improve soil fertility by fixing nutrients such as nitrogen, ensuring that these nutrients remain available for plant uptake.

Unlike conventional fertilizers that simply release nutrients into the soil, biofertilizers enhance the soil's own biological activity, creating a more sustainable agricultural practice.
Increased bioactivity results in improved soil structure. Microorganisms in biofertilizers produce substances that bind soil particles together, enhancing aeration and water retention. This mechanism is particularly vital in arid regions, where soil degradation poses a significant challenge. Yet, this ability makes the effectiveness of biofertilizers depend on specific soil types and crops, introducing complexities into their use.
Despite their potential, biofertilizers face hurdles, including skepticism from farmers accustomed to chemical fertilizers. Concerns about cost, availability, and the need for new agricultural knowledge contribute to their slow adoption. Moreover, the regulatory landscape for biofertilizers is still developing, affecting their market presence. Still, some regions have started to implement subsidies and educational programs to encourage the transition to these sustainable options, hinting at a shift in agricultural practices.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "uptake" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. evolution
B. harvest
C. absorption
D. diversity

Q2. What is one difference between biofertilizers and traditional fertilizers?

A. Biofertilizers are less expensive to produce.
B. Biofertilizers contain living microorganisms.
C. Biofertilizers require synthetic chemicals to work.
D. Biofertilizers are used only in arid regions.

Q3. According to the passage, what makes biofertilizers particularly effective?

A. They are compatible with multiple soil types.
B. They prevent soil particles from binding together.
C. They improve the movement of air through soil.
D. They begin to release nutrients immediately.

Q4. What does the author suggest about biofertilizers in the last paragraph?

A. Many farmers are already familiar with them.
B. Governmental rules affect their use in some areas.
C. They are readily available to farmers.
D. They do not work as well as chemical fertilizers.

Q5. What is the main focus of the last paragraph?

A. It describes new scientific research supporting biofertilizers.
B. It compares the effectiveness of different types of fertilizers.
C. It discusses barriers to adoption of biofertilizers by farmers.
D. It offers advice to farmers on best agricultural practices.

2026-07-22 Building Data Science

原文（Passage）

Data Science and the Buildings of Tomorrow
Once static structures, buildings increasingly function as dynamic systems thanks to applications of data science to the built environment. Building data science uses sensors and Internet of Things (IoT) devices, such as smart thermostats, to collect and interpret data from buildings. This

approach enables architects and planners to make informed decisions throughout a building's design, operation, and renovation phases.
Sensors embedded in modern buildings track variables such as energy consumption, temperature, air quality, and occupancy patterns. These insights help optimize energy use, reduce operational costs, and enhance comfort. Smart HVAC (heating, ventilation, and air-conditioning) systems can adjust airflow based on real-time occupancy, improving efficiency. Monitoring space usage may conflict, however, with occupants' privacy concerns and dislike of being tracked without their consent.
Despite high initial costs, building data science offers long-term benefits. Studies show that buildings using these systems can reduce energy consumption by up to 30 percent, making them attractive for sustainable development. As urban populations grow, building data science will be key to creating adaptable spaces. A skyscraper that adjusts its internal climate based on external weather conditions exemplifies this potential. Other applications include optimizing the layouts of hospitals for better patient flow or using occupancy data to redesign underutilized office spaces.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "static" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. impractical
B. unchanging
C. wasteful
D. simple

Q2. The passage indicates all of the following about building data science EXCEPT:

A. It uses data collected from Internet of Things devices.
B. It requires special training in data analysis for architects who use it.
C. It has an impact on how architects design new buildings.
D. It can be used as a basis for decisions about a building's operations.

Q3. According to the passage, what is one drawback of the use of sensors?

A. Sensors lead to greater energy use.
B. Sensors are known for supplying inaccurate data.
C. The data collected is frequently hard to interpret.
D. Some building occupants may not approve of their use.

Q4. Why does the author mention "hospitals" and "office spaces"?

A. To give examples of city structures that are often poorly designed
B. To demonstrate how building data science can improve urban infrastructure
C. To show the limitations of building data science
D. To contradict the claim that building data science will be key to creating adaptable spaces

Q5. Based on the passage, building data science can help most with which of the following?

A. Increasing a building's office space
B. Limiting a building's construction costs
C. Reducing a building's environmental impact
D. Enhancing a building's visual appeal

2026-07-22 Courtroom Video Evidence

原文（Passage）

Video Evidence in U.S. Courts
In the United States, as in some other countries, video evidence has become integral to the criminal justice system as technological advances have made cameras nearly ubiquitous. Police

officers often wear body cameras, security cameras monitor public areas, and nearly everyone carries a smartphone capable of recording high-quality videos. While such recordings are widely seen as reliable evidentiary tools, they have certain limitations.

For example, videos are usually taken from a single vantage point, potentially giving viewers a misleading impression of events. A single camera angle might fail to capture what occurs just outside the frame, leading observers to misinterpret what they see. Additionally, video footage has no way of conveying interpersonal and emotional context: A person's actions might appear antagonistic even if the person was acting in self-defense.

Despite these limitations, legal experts emphasize that video evidence plays a significant role in courtrooms. Jurors (people chosen to consider evidence and decide a case) might dismiss eyewitness testimonies as unreliable or perceive oral accounts as inconsistent, while videos show events more directly. When multiple recordings are available from different angles, an even more reliable sense of an incident can emerge. Nevertheless, courts often remind jurors to evaluate video evidence cautiously.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the relationship between the first sentence and the second sentence of the passage?

A. The first sentence makes a generalization, and the second sentence introduces exceptions to the generalization.

B. The first sentence presents one view of a subject, and the second sentence presents a contrasting view.

C. The first sentence makes a claim, and the second sentence provides examples to illustrate that claim.

D. The first sentence introduces a question, and the second sentence offers possible answers to the question.

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about viewers of videos?

A. They are more likely to trust the accuracy of a video recorded on a police officer's body camera than one taken with a smartphone.

B. They may not find a video recording of an incident as revealing as an eyewitness account of the event.

C. They may not see actions that are critical to understanding an incident because of the way the video is framed.

D. They are likely to regard video recordings skeptically because they know that videos can be misleading.

Q3. What does the author point out when discussing "context"?

A. The setting in which a video is viewed may affect the way viewers perceive the recorded events.

B. People may draw incorrect conclusions about others' motivations from what they observe in a video.

C. Video recordings can be used either to defend an individual's actions or to depict the individual as an aggressor.

D. The reliability of video recordings of events should be compared to the reliability of oral accounts of those events.

Q4. The passage indicates that "legal experts" hold which of the following views?

A. Jurors are likely to accept videos as objective depictions of events whereas they view witness testimony with skepticism.

B. Recent improvements in technology have made it so easy to display video evidence to jurors that other kinds of evidence may be neglected.

C. Video recordings should not be used as evidence in courtrooms unless multiple recordings taken from different vantage points can be shown.

D. Courts should not undermine jurors' confidence in their abilities by overemphasizing the possibility of misinterpreting videos.

Q5. The word "cautiously" in the passage is closest in meaning to:

A. reluctantly

B. carefully

C. decisively

D. confidently

2026-07-22 Gravitational Physics Applications

原文（Passage）

Gravitational Physics and Its Practical Applications

The concept of gravity has evolved over time. In the seventeenth century, Isaac Newton described gravity as a universal force acting between masses, formalized in his law of universal gravitation. This theory provided a universal, mathematical framework for understanding both terrestrial and planetary motion. However, in 1915, Albert Einstein introduced general relativity, redefining gravity as the curvature of spacetime caused by mass and energy. This shift explained phenomena Newton's model could not, such as the bending of light near massive bodies (gravitational lensing). Einstein's theory, which marked a revolution in physics, also predicted black holes and gravitational waves, phenomena later confirmed by observation.

Theoretical advances in gravitational physics have led to practical applications, such as in drug development. Proteins often form crystals that can be analyzed to determine their molecular structure. [A] However, on Earth, gravity interferes with the uniform growth of crystals. [B] In microgravity environments, such as those aboard the International Space Station (ISS), gravitational effects are minimized. [C] Crystals grown in space tend to be larger, more uniform, and less flawed than those grown on Earth, enabling researchers to map the crystals' atomic structure with greater accuracy. [D] This is crucial for rational drug design, allowing scientists to develop medications that precisely target disease-related proteins.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions all of the following about Newton's law of universal gravitation EXCEPT:

A. It stated that all objects pull on each other.

B. It helped explain motion on Earth and in space.

C. It was later replaced by another theory.

D. It made predictions that were only confirmed later.

Q2. Why does the author mention "gravitational lensing" in the passage?

A. To help explain why Einstein's theory was superior to Newton's

B. To give an example of a prediction made by Einstein

C. To further illustrate Newton's law of universal gravitation

D. To contrast terrestrial and planetary motion

Q3. The word "minimized" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. eliminated

B. reduced

C. observed

D. applied

Q4. According to the passage, why is it important for drug developers to determine the molecular structure of crystals?

A. This helps researchers understand the effects of gravity on proteins in the human body.

B. This helps researchers create drugs that target specific proteins.

C. This helps create more perfect crystals that can be used in industrial applications.

D. This enables manufacturers to produce existing drugs more quickly and cheaply.

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. **For instance, parts of a crystal will grow unevenly as heavier components settle, leading to distortions in its shape. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.**

A. [■1]

B. [■2]

C. [■3]

D. [■4]

2026-07-22 Medieval Town Origins

原文（Passage）

The Rise of Medieval Towns

Two manifestations of the vitality of the Late Middle Ages were the rise of towns and the development of a new business and commercial class in Europe. Early medieval society had been traditional, agricultural, and rural, so the appearance of a new class that was none of these constituted a social revolution. The new class—artisans and merchants—came from the peasantry. They were landless younger sons of large families, driven away by land shortage. Or they were forced by war and famine to seek new possibilities.

Historians have proposed three basic theories to explain the origins of European towns. Some scholars believe towns began as boroughs—that is, as fortifications erected during the ninth-century Viking invasions. Belgian historian Henri Pirenne maintained that towns sprang up when merchants who engaged in long-distance trade gravitated toward favorable spots, such as a fort. A third explanation focuses on religious establishments such as monasteries and the great cathedrals, which represented a demand for goods and services. Traders and merchants settled near religious establishments to cater to the residents' economic needs.

All three theories have some validity, though none of them explains the origins of all medieval towns. Some medieval towns that became flourishing centers of trade by the mid-twelfth century had originally been Roman army camps. Pirenne's interpretation accurately describes the Flemish towns of Gent, Bruges, and Ypres but does not fit the course of development in the Italian cities or in such centers as London. Nor does the Pirenne thesis take into account the significance of local trade and markets in the growth of towns.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary focus of the passage?

A. A comparison of Viking invasions and their impact on European settlement patterns

B. The social status of merchants in medieval European society

C. The origins of medieval towns and competing scholarly explanations for their development

D. The economic relationship between rural farmers and urban merchants in the Late Middle Ages

Q2. According to the passage, what was the social background of the new commercial class that emerged in the Late Middle Ages?

A. They were primarily members of the clergy who left religious life to pursue trade.
B. They were nobles who lost their land holdings during Viking invasions.
C. They were foreign merchants who immigrated from outside Europe to establish trade routes.
D. They descended from the peasantry and included landless younger sons of large families.

Q3. The word "gravitated" in the passage is closest in meaning to which of the following?

A. were naturally drawn
B. competed
C. were forced
D. gradually departed

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about Pirenne's theory of town origins?

A. It applies to some towns but fails to account for all patterns of medieval urban development.
B. It was developed specifically to explain the growth of Italian seaport cities.
C. It has been entirely discredited because it ignores the role of Viking invasions.
D. It is considered the most widely accepted explanation among modern historians.

Q5. Why does the author mention monasteries and cathedrals in the second paragraph?

A. To argue that religious institutions were more influential than fortifications in shaping medieval society
B. To illustrate the hostility that church officials felt toward the merchant class
C. To introduce a third scholarly explanation for the origins of European towns
D. To provide an example of how Pirenne's theory applies to religious communities ---

2026-07-22 Passage - Coastal Erosion Challenges

原文（Passage）

Coastal Erosion Challenges

Coastal erosion, the gradual loss of shoreline due to natural forces, poses challenges worldwide. Waves, currents, and rising sea levels are primary contributors to the phenomenon. Strong storms can exacerbate erosion, reshaping coastlines abruptly. For countries with extensive coastal zones, such as Bangladesh and the Netherlands, managing erosion is not only an environmental issue but also an economic and social one. Coastal erosion threatens infrastructure, transportation, and residential areas, necessitating costly investments in protective measures.

One strategy to combat erosion is beach nourishment, the addition of sand or sediment to shorelines. While this method provides short-term benefits, frequent replenishment is required. Seawalls and breakwaters, solid structures designed to deflect wave energy and protect coastlines, are longer-term solutions but can alter natural sediment movement, unintentionally accelerating erosion in nearby areas.

Recent studies suggest that some natural approaches may be more sustainable. For instance, mangrove forests and dune systems serve as buffers, reducing wave energy before it reaches populated areas. Mangroves not only provide erosion control but also support diverse ecosystems. However, such methods require extensive space and careful planning, making them unsuitable for heavily urbanized coastal zones. This highlights the tension between maintaining natural landscapes and safeguarding human developments along vulnerable coastlines.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "exacerbate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. cause
B. contribute to
C. control

D. increase

Q2. Why does the author mention Bangladesh and the Netherlands?

A. To illustrate that strong storms pose threats to infrastructure in coastal areas

B. To give examples of countries for which coastal erosion presents challenges beyond environmental ones

C. To provide examples of countries that have recently invested in protecting their coastal infrastructure

D. To acknowledge that coastal erosion is a problem that affects countries in a variety of regions

Q3. The passage indicates which of the following about "beach nourishment"?

A. It involves an ongoing commitment to maintain the advantages it offers.

B. It is effective primarily in areas that already have natural dune systems.

C. It is a relatively expensive method of combating erosion.

D. It is primarily effective in areas where the coastal zones have little residential development.

Q4. What can be inferred about the "natural approaches" mentioned in the passage?

A. They offer significant protection of coastal areas but are short-term measures.

B. They are easier to implement in areas with high population density.

C. They are less likely than man-made structures to cause unintended harm to surrounding shorelines.

D. They are more effective as a way of protecting biodiversity than as a measure to combat erosion.

Q5. The passage indicates each of the following about erosion-control measures EXCEPT:

A. They can sometimes deflect wave energy.

B. They sometimes disrupt transportation in coastal areas.

C. They have greater economic impact in some countries than in others.

D. They vary in the amount of space they require.

2026-07-22 Passage - Person-Centered Therapy

原文（Passage）

Person-Centered Therapy

Person-Centered Therapy: A Shift in Focus

When American psychologist Carl Rogers first introduced person-centered therapy in the mid-twentieth century, the prevailing view was that therapists should be experts in diagnosis and treatment. Instead, in his new approach, Rogers centered the patient as an individual who is able to discover and take steps toward personal growth. Counseling was viewed as a collaborative interaction between the professional and the patient, with the latter playing a key role in effecting change.

One of Rogers' core beliefs was that a nonjudgmental environment fosters self-discovery. The therapist acts as an empathetic facilitator, listening actively and using reflection—paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying the client's words—to elicit the client's feelings. Rogers claimed this approach allows individuals to gain the self-awareness and self-acceptance needed to grow personally and resolve issues. Rogers' research suggested that the most successful patients were those who experienced the highest degree of empathy in therapy.

Unlike Rogers' model, earlier clinical approaches foregrounded issues and behaviors of concern, with the therapist diagnosing them and specifying treatment courses. Critics question the effectiveness of Rogers' approach for patients seeking expert guidance, especially those with severe mental-health challenges who need structured intervention. However, Rogers' theories remain influential: The person-centered paradigm is seen in various therapeutic approaches.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "prevailing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. dominant
B. successful
C. traditional
D. scientific

Q2. According to the passage, all of the following were characteristics of Rogers' patient-centered approach EXCEPT

A. relying on each patient's own diagnostic expertise
B. creating a supportive context for treatment
C. listening carefully to the patient
D. promoting self-development by patients

Q3. Why does the author of the passage mention "paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying"?

A. To specify the note-taking that therapists do during patient sessions
B. To clarify the concept of reflection in patient-centered therapy
C. To illustrate some tools patients use to promote personal growth
D. To explain how Rogers conducted research on therapeutic models

Q4. The passage suggests which of the following about therapeutic approaches in the United States before the mid-twentieth century?

A. They were abandoned after Rogers became influential.
B. They were not effective for patients with severe mental-health challenges.
C. They were not backed by sufficient clinical research.
D. They did not view empathy as a key therapeutic methodology.

Q5. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that best explains the intended outcomes for a patient receiving person-centered therapy. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. One of Rogers' core beliefs was that a nonjudgmental environment fosters self-discovery.
B. The therapist acts as an empathetic facilitator, listening actively and using reflection—paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying the client's words—to elicit the client's feelings.
C. Rogers claimed this approach allows individuals to gain the self-awareness and self-acceptance needed to grow personally and resolve issues.
D. Rogers' research suggested that the most successful patients were those who experienced the highest degree of empathy in therapy.

2026-07-22 Passage - Traffic Psychology

原文（Passage）

Traffic Psychology

Traffic psychology explores how individual differences and social contexts shape driving behavior, often in counterintuitive ways. [▪1] While traits like impulsivity are frequently linked to risky driving, research shows that this connection is not always straightforward. [▪2] For instance, impulsive individuals may drive cautiously in familiar environments but exhibit recklessness when faced with novel or stressful situations. [▪3] Moreover, environmental cues—such as heavy traffic or aggressive drivers—can amplify underlying character traits. [▪4]

Social influences further complicate the picture. Young drivers, for example, may engage in riskier maneuvers when accompanied by peers, driven by a desire to impress or conform. However, this effect is not universal. The presence of a vigilant passenger—such as a parent or responsible friend—can counteract impulsive tendencies and promote safer driving. This raises questions about how social roles and expectations modulate behavior.

Some researchers argue that focusing too heavily on personality overlooks structural factors like road design or traffic law enforcement, which may exert a stronger influence on safety outcomes. Yet, understanding the psychological underpinnings of driving remains crucial for designing effective interventions. By integrating insights from personality psychology, social dynamics, and environmental design, traffic psychology offers a nuanced framework for improving road safety.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions all of the following as factors influencing road safety EXCEPT

A. personality traits
B. social influences
C. environmental conditions
D. vehicle maintenance

Q2. The word "vigilant" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. watchful
B. considerate
C. experienced
D. assertive

Q3. Based on the second paragraph, what can be inferred about the role of passengers in promoting safer driving?

A. Passengers usually encourage drivers to undertake riskier maneuvers.
B. Passengers can influence drivers in a positive way, but this is not always the case.
C. Passengers exert a stronger influence on drivers than structural factors do.
D. The presence of passengers has no measurable effect on driving behavior.

Q4. What does the passage suggest about structural factors?

A. They are the main cause of traffic accidents.
B. Their importance is debated by researchers.
C. They influence younger drivers the most.
D. They are the foundation of traffic psychology.

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. **These findings suggest that drivers' behavior is not solely rooted in personality. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.**

A. [■1]
B. [■2]
C. [■3]
D. [■4]

2026-07-22 Roman Political Legacy

原文（Passage）

The Political Legacy of the Roman Empire

The fall of the Roman Empire reshaped the geopolitical landscape of Europe and the Mediterranean in profound ways. One widely accepted hypothesis is that the collapse of Roman administrative and military structures led to the fragmentation of centralized authority. Without Rome's unifying legal framework, power devolved to local warlords and tribal leaders, paving the way for feudalism and a mosaic of competing kingdoms. This decentralization fostered chronic instability, as seen in the frequent conflicts among the Franks, Visigoths, and Lombards.

However, some scholars argue that this fragmentation was not purely detrimental. The absence of a dominant empire may have encouraged regional innovation and adaptability. For instance, the Carolingian Renaissance under Charlemagne suggests that localized rule could still produce cultural and intellectual flourishing. The emergence of monastic communities during this period also played a crucial role in preserving classical knowledge and fostering educational continuity across fragmented territories. [A]

Another compelling example is the Byzantine Empire, which retained Roman governance in the East and acted as a stabilizing force for centuries. [B] Its survival challenges the notion that imperial collapse inevitably leads to disorder. [C] While the fall of Rome dismantled a centralized system, it also opened space for diverse political experiments—some chaotic, and others surprisingly resilient. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "fostered" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. accepted
B. revealed
C. preceded
D. promoted

Q2. Which of the following best describes the main purpose of paragraph 1?

A. To highlight the cultural achievements that followed the Roman Empire's collapse
B. To argue that the fall of Rome had minimal impact on European governance
C. To present a common explanation for the political fragmentation after Rome's fall
D. To contrast the Roman Empire's decline with the rise of local kingdoms

Q3. Why does the author mention the Carolingian Renaissance?

A. To illustrate that cultural growth was still possible despite political fragmentation
B. To show how Charlemagne attempted to restore the Roman Empire's boundaries
C. To argue that feudalism was a direct result of the Roman Empire's policies
D. To emphasize the role of military conflicts in shaping post-Roman Europe

Q4. The passage mentions each of the following as a consequence of the Roman Empire's collapse EXCEPT

A. the rise of feudalism and competing regional kingdoms
B. the expansion of the Byzantine Empire into Western Europe
C. the preservation of classical knowledge in monastic communities
D. the transfer of political authority to local leaders

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. > Such developments suggest that decentralization may have inadvertently laid the groundwork for a more pluralistic and resilient intellectual tradition. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]
B. [■2]
C. [■3]
D. [■4]

2026-07-18（4 套）

2026-07-18 Origins Of Agriculture

原文（Passage）

The Origins of Agriculture

Transitions from a glacial to interglacial world occurred many times during the last two million years. Through all but the most recent glaciation, people moved in response to environmental changes rather than staying put and adapting to a new ecosystem. Then, after living on the move for more than a million years, they started to settle down and become farmers. What was so different when the glaciers melted this last time that caused people to adopt a new lifestyle? Several explanations have been offered to account for this radical change. Some argue that the shift from a cool, wet glacial climate to less hospitable conditions put an environmental squeeze on early people in the Middle East. Others argue that agriculture evolved in response to an inevitable process of cultural evolution without any specific environmental pressure. Whatever the reasons, agriculture developed independently in Mesopotamia, northern China, and Mesoamerica.

Increasing population density provides an attractive explanation for the origin and spread of agriculture. When hunting and gathering groups grew beyond the capacity of their territory to support them, part of the group would split off and move to a new territory. Once there was no more productive territory to colonize, growing populations developed more intensive and time-consuming ways to extract a living from their environment. In this view, agriculture can be understood as a natural behavioral response to increasing population.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary purpose of the passage?

A. To argue that population pressure was the definitive cause of the agricultural transition
B. To trace the geographic spread of agriculture from Mesopotamia to other regions
C. To present competing explanations for why people began practicing agriculture
D. To describe the environmental conditions that characterized the last glacial period

Q2. According to the passage, what did people do in response to environmental changes during previous glaciations?

A. They relocated rather than remaining in place and adjusting to new ecosystems.
B. They split into smaller groups and colonized more productive territories.
C. They formed social bonds that eventually led to the domestication of plants.
D. They developed new agricultural techniques to survive shifting conditions.

Q3. The word “hospitable” in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to which of the following?

A. Geographically accessible
B. Favorable for survival
C. Densely populated
D. Agriculturally productive

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about the relationship between territory and the adoption of agriculture?

A. The availability of productive territory discouraged investment in agricultural methods.
B. Groups that controlled the most territory were the first to develop agricultural practices.
C. Agriculture became necessary only after populations could no longer expand into new lands.
D. Territorial competition between groups accelerated the independent development of farming.

Q5. Why does the author mention that agriculture developed independently in Mesopotamia, northern China, and Mesoamerica?

A. To support the claim that cultural evolution alone drove agricultural development
B. To demonstrate that environmental conditions were similar across these three regions
C. To argue that population pressure operated differently depending on geographic region
D. To illustrate that the phenomenon of agricultural origins was not confined to a single location

2026-07-18 Passage - Circadian Rhythm Disruption

原文（Passage）

Circadian Rhythm Disruption

Circadian rhythms, the internal clocks regulating organisms' physiological processes, are primarily driven by light exposure. These rhythms may be disrupted by the increased artificial light of urban environments, leading to what scientists call “circadian misalignment.” This misalignment not only affects sleep patterns but is linked to a higher prevalence of metabolic disorders. Interestingly, research on nocturnal animals reveals that these creatures have evolved mechanisms, such as unique melatonin production cycles, for thriving in conditions that disrupt human circadian rhythms. Such adaptations could inform potential human therapies.

Recent studies suggest that manipulating light exposure can help reset circadian clocks. Experiments demonstrated that disrupted rhythms can be realigned by the simulation of natural light cycles. However, this approach is not universally effective. Some individuals experience persistent misalignment, suggesting that other environmental or genetic factors may play significant roles.

Moreover, the factors affecting circadian regulation extend beyond light: temperature, diet, and social interactions all influence these rhythms. This complex causal web requires a multidisciplinary approach to develop comprehensive solutions. Cutting-edge research is now exploring therapeutic drugs that can rectify disruptions to the natural circadian rhythmic cycles. Whether these efforts will yield sustainable treatment options remains to be seen.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention the “higher prevalence of metabolic disorders”?

A. To explain why circadian misalignment is increasing in urban environments

B. To suggest a causal relationship between metabolic illness and sleep disturbances

C. To support the claim that circadian misalignment affects sleep patterns

D. To describe one effect of the disruption of circadian rhythms by artificial light

Q2. Why might some nocturnal animal adaptations be important for human therapies?

A. They provide evidence that light exposure is the greatest driver of circadian rhythms.

B. They offer clues about thriving in conditions that cause circadian misalignment in people.

C. They show that melatonin is not always effective in regulating sleep patterns.

D. They prove that animals' melatonin production cycles closely resemble those of humans.

Q3. What does the author suggest about simulating natural light cycles as a way of resetting circadian clocks?

A. Most people experiencing circadian misalignment have seen no benefit from the treatment.

B. Most researchers agree that this treatment is currently the only effective approach.

C. The approach is most effective for people with a genetic predisposition for sleep disorders.

D. This approach has been successfully used to help many individuals restore their sleep patterns.

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraph 2 and paragraph 3?

A. Paragraph 2 defines a concept; paragraph 3 provides more detail by discussing specific examples.

B. Paragraph 2 evaluates a focused approach; paragraph 3 points to broader challenges and solutions.

C. Paragraph 2 proposes a theory; paragraph 3 notes potential objections to it and suggests responses.

D. Paragraph 2 outlines a methodology; paragraph 3 reports the results of applying it to a problem.

Q5. The word “rectify” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. disclose
B. approve
C. relieve
D. document

2026-07-18 Passage - Decision-Making in Groups

原文（Passage）

Decision-Making in Groups

Group decision-making is often praised for its potential to foster creativity and innovation through diverse perspectives. However, this collaborative strength can paradoxically become a liability when the pursuit of consensus suppresses critical thinking. A well-known example is the phenomenon of “groupthink,” whereby individuals, fearing conflict or exclusion, withhold dissenting opinions. This can result in decisions that are not only irrational but also poorly aligned with the group's original goals.

One might argue that groupthink is simply a failure of leadership or facilitation, yet even in well-structured environments, the pressure to conform can subtly influence behavior. Interestingly, some studies suggest that groups composed of individuals with varied backgrounds and viewpoints are less prone to groupthink, though this diversity can also introduce friction that slows decision-making. Alternatively, some theorists propose that the issue lies not in consensus-seeking itself, but in the lack of mechanisms to encourage constructive disagreement. For instance, assigning a “devil's advocate” role or using anonymous feedback tools can help surface hidden concerns.

Ultimately, while collaboration holds immense promise, its success depends on deliberate strategies to balance unity with intellectual rigor. Without such safeguards, the very process meant to enhance group cohesion may inadvertently undermine it.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions “well-structured environments” primarily to

A. highlight the role of leadership in fostering good organization
B. emphasize the difference between leadership and facilitation
C. describe groups in which there will be the least pressure to conform
D. show that good leadership does not eliminate social pressures

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about “individuals with varied backgrounds and viewpoints”?

A. They may help reduce the tendency to suppress dissenting opinions.
B. They are more likely to agree quickly on important decisions.
C. They tend to avoid conflict by deliberately seeking consensus.
D. They often struggle to be heard in structured environments.

Q3. The word “surface” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. promote
B. eliminate
C. question
D. identify

Q4. The passage suggests which of the following about “intellectual rigor”?

A. It emerges naturally in diverse groups without intervention.

B. It is less important than achieving consensus in decision-making.
C. It can be promoted by avoiding disagreement within the group.
D. It requires intentional strategies to be attained in collaborative settings.

Q5. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as a possible cause of groupthink?

A. Group members' fear of conflict or exclusion
B. Group members' pressure on each other to conform
C. Group members' lack of experience in decision-making
D. Group members' inability to promote constructive disagreement ---

2026-07-18 Social Network Influence

原文（Passage）

Social Networks and Influence

Computational sociology studies how social networks—like friendships, professional connections, or online communities—affect how people think and act. Instead of just drawing diagrams of who is connected to whom, researchers now look more closely at how frequent interactions shape behavior. If someone regularly chats with a group of friends who share strong opinions about climate change, they may gradually adopt similar views. These influences are especially strong when the conversations are emotionally charged or align with the person's values. [A]

Interestingly, it is not always the most famous or powerful people who have the biggest impact. [B] Everyday conversations—like repeated exchanges between coworkers—can be more influential than a single message from a celebrity or expert. Researchers use computational models to analyze how messages spread. [C] An accurate model can predict which types of messages are likely to spread widely. [D]

Still, predicting human behavior is incredibly complex. People are shaped by their culture, social norms, and personal experiences, which makes it hard to build models that work universally. For example, a message that spreads quickly in one country might fall flat in another due to different cultural values. The real challenge lies in understanding how all these subtle factors interact to drive large-scale changes in behavior.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that illustrates how social network dynamics can affect personal beliefs. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. “Computational sociology studies how social networks—like friendships, professional connections, or online communities—affect how people think and act.”
B. “Instead of just drawing diagrams of who is connected to whom, researchers now look more closely at how frequent interactions shape behavior.”
C. “If someone regularly chats with a group of friends who share strong opinions about climate change, they may gradually adopt similar views.”
D. “These influences are especially strong when the conversations are emotionally charged or align with the person's values.”

Q2. According to the passage, computational sociologists study

A. how having shared opinions strengthens a friendship
B. why it is important to develop complex diagrams of network connections
C. why emotionally charged conversations are ineffective at changing opinions
D. how human behavior is affected by frequent interactions

Q3. The word “incredibly” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. generally

B. extremely
C. somewhat
D. often

Q4. According to the passage, what makes it difficult to model human behavior?

A. The interaction of various factors that play a role in human behavior
B. The rapid spread of messages from one population to another
C. The frequent movement of humans among countries with different cultural values
D. The lack of cooperation among researchers from different cultural backgrounds

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. > In fact, influence often emerges from the bottom up, rather than being imposed from the top down. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]
B. [■2]
C. [■3]
D. [■4]

2026-07-16（2 套）

2026-07-16 Passage - Thermoelectricity

原文（Passage）

Thermoelectricity

Thermoelectric materials offer a promising solution for converting waste heat into usable electrical energy, making them a valuable option for sustainable energy generation. Thermoelectric devices consist of thermoelectric materials arranged so that one side is heated while the other is cooled; the ensuing temperature difference generates an electric current (the Seebeck effect). Waste heat sources include industrial exhaust or even body heat. In the automotive industry, thermoelectric generators have been integrated into hybrid and electric vehicles to recover heat from exhaust systems and convert it into electricity. That electricity can then be used to power onboard electronics or charge the battery, improving the car's efficiency. [A] Many of the most effective thermoelectric material types, however, rely on rare or environmentally harmful elements, such as lead and tellurium, which limits their practicality for large-scale use. [B] Additionally, the amount of electricity that can be produced from heat is still relatively low compared to other energy technologies. [C] Researchers are working to overcome these issues by developing safer, more abundant materials—such as modified forms of silicon that can be engineered to exhibit thermoelectric properties—and by optimizing device architecture to improve energy conversion efficiency and scalability. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be concluded about "waste heat" based on the passage?

A. It is produced by the Seebeck effect.
B. It is produced as a result of thermoelectric energy generation.
C. It is a byproduct of various processes and typically goes unused.
D. It is usually produced in quantities that are too small to be of use.

Q2. The word "ensuing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. resulting
B. instant
C. large
D. weakening

Q3. Why does the author discuss the automotive industry in the passage?

A. To argue that car exhaust systems do not produce enough heat to be a practical source of energy

B. To contrast the use of thermoelectric generators in hybrid vehicles with their use in electric vehicles

C. To give an example of a successful application of thermoelectricity

D. To illustrate the difficulties of implementing thermoelectricity in consumer products

Q4. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as drawbacks of thermoelectric technology EXCEPT:

A. Components of thermoelectric materials can be difficult to source.

B. Converting existing infrastructure will be expensive.

C. Thermoelectric materials often contain toxic elements.

D. It does not produce large quantities of energy.

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. > Thermoelectric devices typically achieve conversion efficiencies of 5-8%, whereas solar panels reach 15-22%, and natural gas power plants can attain efficiencies of 45-50%, or even more. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]

B. [■2]

C. [■3]

D. [■4] ---

2026-07-16 Power Of Placebos

原文（Passage）

The Power of Placebos

The placebo effect challenges conventional ideas about medical treatment efficacy. What is a placebo? [A] A patient's condition sometimes improves if they believe that they are receiving an effective treatment, even if they are in fact receiving a sugar pill. [B] In this example, the sugar pill, which has no active ingredient, is a placebo. Surprisingly, this effect can sometimes rival real medications in clinical trials. [C]

Recent studies suggest that the placebo effect might be rooted in the brain's complex chemistry. [D] When a patient anticipates positive effects, their brain can release chemicals like endorphins, which may cause genuine physiological changes. In one study, patients receiving placebo "painkillers" reported pain relief comparable to the one produced by actual painkillers, highlighting the brain's powerful role. Some researchers propose using the placebo effect deliberately to enhance therapy outcomes, arguing that the mind-body connection should be tapped into more.

However, ethical considerations arise: deceiving patients could undermine trust in healthcare. For example, even when a placebo leads to measurable improvement, knowingly administering it without full disclosure may violate principles of informed consent, raising questions about autonomy and transparency in patient care. This delicate balance between harnessing the placebo effect and maintaining ethical standards continues to be a topic of debate.

题目（Questions）

Q1. How does the placebo effect challenge traditional views on treatment?

A. By showing that patients should have more say in selecting their medications.

B. By suggesting that a patient's belief can be as powerful as a medicine

C. By questioning existing measurements of the effectiveness of a treatment
D. By pointing out a possible way to reduce the costs of clinical trials

Q2. What does paragraph 2 indicate about the placebo effect?

A. It affects patients much more powerfully than actual painkillers do.
B. It may be related to the release of endorphins in the brain
C. It has not been connected by researchers to any physiological changes.
D. It is enhanced when it is accompanied by actual painkillers.

Q3. The word "deliberately" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. on purpose
B. with caution
C. efficiently
D. regularly

Q4. Why does the author mention "autonomy and transparency in patient care"?

A. To argue for the use of the placebo effect
B. To highlight an ethical challenge in using the placebo effect
C. To suggest that trust is less important than other considerations in healthcare
D. To explain how the placebo effect is misunderstood

Q5. There are four locations [■] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. > Researchers have long been puzzled by the mechanisms behind this phenomenon. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [■] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. [■1]
B. [■2]
C. [■3]
D. [■4]

2026-07-08（2 套）

2026-07-08 Ancient Written Records

原文（Passage）

Written Records in Ancient Societies

For those ancient civilizations that used writing--for instance, all the great civilizations in Mesoamerica, China, Egypt, and the Near East--written historical records can answer many social questions. A prime goal of the archaeologist studying these societies is therefore to find appropriate texts. Many of the early excavations of the great sites of the Near East had the recovery of clay writing tablets as the main goal.

In each early literate society, writing had its own function and purpose. For instance, the clay tablets of Mycenaean Greece, dating from around 1200 B.C., were all, without exception, primarily records of commercial transactions at the Mycenaean palaces. This discovery gives us an impression of many aspects of the Mycenaean economy and a glimpse into craft organization, as well as introducing the names of the offices of state. But here, as in other cases, accidents of preservation may be important. It could be that the Mycenaeans wrote on clay only for their commercial records and used other perishable materials for literary or historical texts now lost to us.

Written records undoubtedly contribute greatly to our knowledge of the society in question. But one should not accept them uncritically at face value. Nor should one forget the bias introduced by the accidents of preservation and the particular uses of literacy in a society. The great risk with historical records is that they can impose their own perspective so that they begin not only

to supply the answers to our questions but subtly to determine the nature of those questions and even our concepts and terminology.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the primary focus of the passage?

A. The techniques archaeologists use to excavate ancient writing tablets
B. The commercial and economic functions of writing in Mycenaean Greece
C. The differences in writing systems among Mesoamerican and Near Eastern civilizations
D. The role and limitations of written records in understanding ancient societies

Q2. According to the passage, what did the clay tablets found at Mycenaean palaces primarily document?

A. Commercial transactions involving goods
B. Religious ceremonies and the deeds of rulers
C. The names and titles of military officers
D. Literary texts and historical narratives

Q3. The word "perishable" in paragraph 2 is closest in meaning to

A. rare
B. impermanent
C. costly
D. sacred

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about the surviving written records of ancient societies?

A. They are most reliable when they deal with commercial rather than political matters.
B. They represent a complete and balanced account of each society's activities.
C. They reflect the types of materials and purposes for which writing was used in each society.
D. They were deliberately selected by rulers to preserve favorable portrayals.

Q5. Why does the author mention that the Mycenaeans may have used perishable materials for literary or historical texts?

A. To argue that clay tablets were an inferior writing medium compared to other materials
B. To demonstrate that Mycenaean literary culture was more advanced than previously believed
C. To explain why archaeologists prioritize the excavation of clay tablets over other artifacts
D. To suggest that the surviving tablets offer only a partial view of Mycenaean writing practices

2026-07-08 Basic Income Debate

原文（Passage）

Universal Basic Income Debate

The concept of universal basic income (UBI) is gaining attention worldwide. UBI provides all citizens with a regular, unconditional sum of money. Proponents argue that UBI can reduce poverty, streamline welfare, and offer a safety net in an era of automation and job loss. In Finland, a two-year pilot program gave 2,000 unemployed citizens a monthly payment. The results showed improved mental well-being and a modest increase in employment, but the findings were not definitive. Similarly, an experiment in Ontario, Canada, showed promising social benefits but was cut short due to cost concerns.

Critics raise several concerns. One major argument against UBI is its cost. Implementing it could require significant tax increases or reallocating government resources, straining public finances. There are also concerns about the impact on labor markets. Opponents suggest that a guaranteed income might disincentivize work, leading to reduced productivity and economic

stagnation. The relationship between UBI and inflation is another common concern. While most pilot programs have not reported noticeable inflation in local prices, the programs are limited in scale and have not injected enough money into economies to significantly affect prices. Some economists note that certain sectors, like housing or groceries, could see localized price increases due to increased demand.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What best characterizes UBI as described in the passage?

A. An idea whose popularity has peaked and is now disappearing
B. An unpopular idea that is now being tested on large populations
C. An interesting idea that has been tried only on a small scale
D. A popular idea that is still purely theoretical

Q2. What is meant by an "unconditional sum of money" in the second sentence?

A. A sum of money that has no limit
B. A sum of money offered to a random group of people
C. A sum of money that increases over time
D. A sum of money given with no requirements placed on the recipient

Q3. How did the UBI experiments mentioned in the passage affect labor markets?

A. A pilot program led to a small increase in employment.
B. All of the programs described led to higher unemployment.
C. The programs showed no noticeable effect on employment.
D. A few of the pilot programs led to lower productivity and lower wages.

Q4. The passage mentions all of the following as concerns about UBI raised by critics EXCEPT:

A. its effect on public finances
B. its effect on economic productivity
C. its effect on prices
D. its effect on international trade

Q5. What is suggested about UBI and inflation?

A. Pilot programs have not adequately tested a possible relation between UBI and inflation.
B. Evidence shows that increased demand would lead to somewhat higher localized prices.
C. Most pilot programs suggest that UBI would dramatically increase inflation.
D. The larger pilot programs did not report noticeable inflation in local prices.

2026-07-05（1 套）

2026-07-05 Floating Wind Turbines

原文（Passage）

Floating Wind Turbines

Wind turbines are large devices with long blades that capture wind energy and convert it into electricity. Floating wind turbines are a special type of wind turbines because they are not fixed to the seabed but are anchored using advanced mooring systems, allowing placement in deeper waters where winds are more consistent. In this context, anchoring refers to securing the turbine in place using cables or chains connected to weighted structures or anchors on the ocean floor, ensuring stability despite the lack of a fixed foundation. The deeper placement means the wind turbines can harness untapped wind resources that traditional turbines cannot access.

Engineering floating turbines involves unique challenges. They rely on buoyancy principles rather than on solid ground, making their design and maintenance complex. Despite the increased costs, their ability to reduce visual and noise pollution makes them an attractive option for

distant offshore locations. However, their long-term viability is threatened by harsh marine conditions that can accelerate wear and tear.
[A] Research continues to explore solutions for these problems. [B] Some experts are investigating materials and designs to enhance durability. [C] As efforts to capitalize on deeper offshore wind resources persist, floating turbines represent both a promising opportunity and a complex engineering puzzle. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "harness" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. limit
B. distribute
C. release
D. exploit

Q2. What unique advantage do floating wind turbines have over traditional turbines?

A. They are larger in size and have longer blades.
B. They require less maintenance.
C. They can be placed in deeper waters.
D. They are easier to design.

Q3. Why does the author mention "buoyancy principles"?

A. To point out a challenge of creating floating turbines
B. To suggest a new area for future research into floating turbines
C. To emphasize the greater flexibility of floating turbines compared with traditional turbines
D. To provide an example of cost-saving measures related to floating turbines

Q4. What can be inferred about the acceleration of "wear and tear" in floating turbines?

A. Any attempts to reduce it will likely prove to be unsuccessful.
B. Scientists are working to control it through better designs and materials.
C. It is prompting engineers to place floating wind turbines closer to shore.
D. It makes floating turbines especially unattractive to look at.

Q5. Look at the four squares that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. Others assess economic models that might offset higher initial expenses. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-07-04（5 套）

2026-07-04 Computational Fluid Dynamics

原文（Passage）

Evolving Trends In Computational Fluid

Computational fluid dynamics (CFD) is transforming the study of how fluids, including air, move. With CFD, digital models can offer insights previously limited to physical models like wind tunnels. This digital approach uses algorithms to simulate complex fluid interactions, pushing boundaries in fields from aerospace engineering to oceanography. In aerospace engineering, CFD enables the design of more efficient aircraft by modeling airflow over wings and fuselage, reducing drag and improving fuel efficiency, while in oceanography, it helps predict ocean currents, wave dynamics, and climate patterns with greater precision, aiding environmental monitoring and disaster preparedness.

Renewable energy is another area where CFD is proving invaluable. In designing wind farms, CFD simulations predict airflow patterns, enabling improved turbine placement for energy maximization. Yet, this benefit is often counterbalanced by the computational intensity required, which can limit accessibility and rapid prototyping.
The integration of machine learning and artificial intelligence into CFD promises to alleviate some of these computational demands. These technologies can optimize algorithms, enhancing simulation speed and accuracy. However, this integration is not without hurdles. The reliability of machine learning models in accurately reflecting physical phenomena is still a topic of ongoing research, as flawed models could yield misleading results.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that explains how CFD works. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Computational fluid dynamics (CFD) is transforming the study of how fluids, including air, move.

B. With CFD, digital models can offer insights previously limited to physical models like wind tunnels.

C. This digital approach uses algorithms to simulate complex fluid interactions, pushing boundaries in fields from aerospace engineering to oceanography.

D. In aerospace engineering, CFD enables the design of more efficient aircraft by modeling airflow over wings and fuselage, reducing drag and improving fuel efficiency, while in oceanography, it helps predict ocean currents, wave dynamics, and climate patterns with greater precision, aiding environmental monitoring and disaster preparedness.

Q2. According to the passage, all of the following are true about CFD EXCEPT:

A. It offers insights comparable to those offered by wind tunnels.

B. It improves the accuracy of climate pattern forecasting.

C. It has supported innovations in aircraft design that enhance overall efficiency.

D. It has replaced physical experimentation in the field of aerospace engineering.

Q3. Why does the author mention “improved turbine placement”?

A. To describe a specific application of CFD in the field of renewable energy

B. To emphasize the computational demands associated with using CFD

C. To examine the limitations of wind farms as sources of renewable energy

D. To highlight the role of rapid prototyping in wind turbine design

Q4. The word “alleviate” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. support

B. meet

C. reduce

D. modify

Q5. What can be inferred about the current state of machine learning models in CFD?

A. They are more reliable than traditional models.

B. They still face challenges in modeling real-world physical systems.

C. They have been widely used in renewable energy optimization.

D. They have not been known to improve algorithms.

2026-07-04 Consumer Rationality Myth

原文（Passage）

The Myth Of Consumer Rationality

For decades, the common wisdom in economics held that consumers acted with near-perfect rationality: Armed with access to information and precise calculations, they would make informed decisions that produced maximum individual benefit. The main models of consumer choice assumed this planning ability as a basis for predicting market behavior.
However, recent research in behavioral economics has put this idealized vision of the rational consumer into doubt. Studies by scholars such as Daniel Kahneman and Richard Thaler have demonstrated that many psychological biases and mental shortcuts often skew consumer decision-making. These irrational tendencies can lead to choices that deviate from the optimal path suggested by traditional economic theory. For instance, the "anchoring bias" can cause consumers to rely too heavily on the first piece of information they come across when making decisions.
The challenge in accepting these findings lies in their disruption of long-held economic models and theories. Such models have influenced policy and business strategies for years, and to reconsider their basic assumptions is no small task. Yet, as the field progresses, the acknowledgment of consumer irrationality paves the way for more careful and effective approaches to understanding and predicting market dynamics.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?

A. Recognizing pervasive consumer biases improves the ability to anticipate market behaviors.
B. Giving consumers more accurate information improves their decision-making abilities.
C. Accepting Kahneman's and Thaler's findings has been difficult for modern economists.
D. Anchoring chiefly drives consumer choices, validating established economic strategies.

Q2. The word "Armed" in the passage is closest in meaning to:

A. burdened
B. engaged
C. equipped
D. charged

Q3. According to the passage, all of the following are true of traditional economic models of consumer choice EXCEPT:

A. They assumed that consumers made informed, calculation-based choices.
B. They assumed the use of rational foresight to anticipate market behavior.
C. They significantly influenced policy and corporate strategy for many years.
D. They explicitly incorporated biases like anchoring into their predictions.

Q4. The passage indicates that the anchoring bias can have which of the following effects on consumers?

A. Make them less capable of performing precise benefit calculations
B. Cause them to cling to initial impressions even when better data emerges
C. Give them too much confidence in the rational nature of markets
D. Induce them to resist policy initiatives aimed at improving economic efficiency

Q5. The passage presents the two scholars named in the passage as examples of

A. economists who defended traditional models of consumer behavior
B. researchers who challenged widely held assumptions in economic theory
C. policymakers who worked on maintaining consensus among economists
D. agents who tried to make optimal decisions with incomplete information

2026-07-04 Green Roof Benefits

原文（Passage）

Green Roof Benefits

Green roofs, or living roofs, are gaining prominence in urban areas due to their environmental benefits. These are roofs covered with vegetation to help manage stormwater by absorbing rainfall, decreasing runoff, and minimizing flooding risks. Another advantage of green roofs is their ability to improve air quality. Plants on the roof filter pollutants and capture dust.

Additionally, green roofs reduce the urban heat island effect. Conventional roofs absorb and radiate heat, increasing urban temperatures. In contrast, green roofs keep buildings cooler by providing insulation and emitting moisture through their plants and soil.

Green roofs offer energy-efficiency benefits. The insulation provided by soil and plants reduces the need for heating in winter and cooling in summer, leading to energy savings. Green roofs can also extend the lifespan of the roof by shielding materials from UV radiation and extreme temperatures, keeping the underlying structure sound for longer.

Finally, green roofs support urban biodiversity. Their vegetative layers create habitats for insects and birds in cities where green spaces are limited. These microhabitats help sustain pollinator populations and promote ecological balance. [A] Green roofs can also grow food, contributing to food security in urban environments. [B] Despite these advantages, green roofs can be costly to install. [C] However, many cities offer incentives to encourage their adoption. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "minimizing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. monitoring
B. postponing
C. controlling
D. lowering

Q2. What is suggested about the urban heat island effect?

A. The characteristics of traditional roofs add to the problem.
B. Plants on roofs are not able to combat the problem effectively.
C. The problem is also starting to affect rural areas around the world.
D. The problem affects only the exterior spaces between buildings.

Q3. How do green roofs contribute to energy efficiency?

A. By eliminating the need for heating and air conditioning
B. By creating microhabitats for pollinators
C. By offering natural insulation and releasing moisture
D. By absorbing most of the Sun's UV radiation

Q4. Why does the author mention vegetative layers?

A. To support the claim that pollinator populations in cities are increasing
B. To show how insect and bird populations can be supported by green roofs
C. To discuss one potential way to provide access to food for urban residents
D. To address the concern that green roofs may be too costly to maintain

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Additionally, green roofs require ongoing maintenance to ensure proper drainage, plant health, and structural integrity." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-07-04 Guardians Of Time

原文（Passage）

Guardians Of Time

For much of human history, caretakers of any physical objects—from books and paintings to roads and buildings—repaired damage as it became evident. The contemporary shift is to preventive conservation: treating deterioration as a manageable risk, not an inevitability. In museums, for example, curators wage a daily struggle against what are known as the "agents of deterioration." Museum staff calibrate light, stabilize temperature and humidity, limit exposure to pollutants, and choose inert display materials so fragile dyes and reactive metals are not stressed in the first place. The result is quietly successful: Artifacts require fewer invasive treatments and their original surfaces endure.

Public infrastructure is subject to a similar strategy of asset management. Rather than waiting for corrosion to force closures, bridge engineering teams model life-cycle performance, deploy sensors, and schedule predictive maintenance—dehumidifying essential components, applying protective paint coatings, and isolating salt exposure before rust spreads. The payoff is fewer surprises and lower total cost.

What links these practices are the shared principles of stewardship: Watch closely, act early, and control the environment so the chemistry of decay slows. Success is marked not by dramatic rescues but by uneventful years in which nothing buckles, fades, or flakes—and continuity itself becomes the achievement.

题目（Questions）

Q1. It can be inferred from paragraph 1 that in the past, caretakers

A. believed environmental control could reliably prevent deterioration
B. assumed that physical objects would deteriorate over time
C. prioritized continuous monitoring over repair work
D. replaced original materials proactively to avoid future treatments

Q2. The word "calibrate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. adjust
B. increase
C. repair
D. focus

Q3. Why does the author describe the work of museum curators as "quietly successful"?

A. To argue that museum staff prefer minor tasks to complex restoration projects
B. To suggest that conservation work is done in secrecy and should receive more public attention
C. To indicate that preventive measures are less important than emergency repairs
D. To emphasize that the conservation work is successful in a way that most people would not notice

Q4. Based on paragraph 2, what can be inferred about bridges?

A. Moisture is a key source of bridge deterioration.
B. Many bridge failures are caused by improper installation of sensors.
C. Bridge components require frequent replacement to prevent rust.
D. Corrosion mainly occurs when bridges are exposed to direct rainfall.

Q5. The author implies that the "dramatic rescues" of art or bridges

A. demonstrate the need for more public funding for emergency interventions
B. show how quickly deterioration can escalate when materials are unusually fragile
C. indicate a failure to apply preventive conservation

D. represent the most successful form of stewardship

2026-07-04 Kintsugi Art Repair

原文（Passage）

Kintsugi

Kintsugi is a Japanese method of repairing broken pottery while leaving the repair deliberately visible. Artisans rejoin fragments with lacquer paste and may dust the seams with powdered gold or other metals. Rather than return a vessel to an apparently untouched state, the process makes damage part of its design. The object retains evidence of both use and restoration.

Although its precise origins are uncertain, gilt-lacquer repairs became fashionable in Japan around the sixteenth century. Kintsugi is now often associated with wabi-sabi, an aesthetic outlook that regards imperfection, age, and transience as natural conditions, not defects to eliminate. Careful repair acknowledges change while preserving continuity; the metallic lines record where a vessel failed and how it was remade.

[A] This philosophy helps explain why kintsugi has traveled beyond specialist workshops. [B] Because the restored object remains visibly altered, it is often used as a metaphor for resilience: recovery need not erase the event that made recovery necessary. [C] Contemporary classes may therefore teach both the practical sequence and ideas about acceptance and renewal. [D] Traditional kintsugi demands material knowledge, patience, and repeated curing; it is not simply the decorative application of gold paint. Understanding its craft alongside its symbolism prevents a complex practice from becoming only a slogan about personal improvement.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, which outlook is associated with kintsugi?

A. Minimalism, which favors eliminating decoration and excess
B. Formalism, which evaluates an object only by its shape
C. Wabi-sabi, which regards imperfection and transience as natural
D. A conservation principle requiring repairs to remain invisible

Q2. According to the passage, what does a visible repair symbolize?

A. A repair succeeds only when the object appears unchanged.
B. Recovery can acknowledge past damage without erasing it.
C. Breakage is desirable because it guarantees a more valuable object.
D. Precious materials alone give a repaired object symbolic meaning.

Q3. Why does the author state that traditional kintsugi is "not simply the decorative application of gold paint"?

A. To explain why artisans sometimes use metals other than gold
B. To distinguish a demanding traditional craft from a superficial imitation
C. To argue that repaired pottery should not be displayed as art
D. To reject the connection between kintsugi and symbolic interpretation

Q4. The word "transience" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. temporary nature
B. physical damage
C. artistic complexity
D. cultural popularity

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "That metaphorical appeal, however, should not obscure the demanding material process discussed next." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1

B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-06-27（5 套）

2026-06-27 Class Size Effects

原文（Passage）

The Effects Of Class Size

Class size remains one of the most debated variables in education. Studies consistently show that smaller classes can enhance student learning by enabling more individualized attention and reducing classroom disruptions. For example, a 2025 study found that reduced student-to-teacher ratios tend to improve academic performance. However, the magnitude of these gains is often modest and accompanied by substantial financial costs.

Of course, academic performance is not the only factor affected by class size. Classroom dynamics, student engagement, and students' satisfaction with their experience are also affected. Researchers Wang and Calvano argue that evidence about the effects of class size remains incomplete because many investigations focus narrowly on academic outcomes rather than broader educational experiences.

Many regions have implemented class-size reduction initiatives, but fiscal pressures have forced reconsideration of these policies. Given the financial constraints on schools, a nuanced approach seems advisable. Research has shown that reducing student-to-teacher ratios in the early years of education, such as in preschool and primary levels, and in higher poverty areas, as well as implementing strategies like small-group tutoring, offer a preferable cost-benefit ratio compared to general class size reduction.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage indicates which of the following about classroom disruptions?

A. They tend to have a greater impact on less experienced teachers.
B. They have less impact on academic outcomes than does class size.
C. They sometimes increase in frequency when class sizes are reduced.
D. They can be decreased by having fewer students in a class.

Q2. The author mentions "the magnitude of these gains" primarily to

A. support an approach to improve academic outcomes
B. point out limitations to a statement about the effect of class size
C. cite a factor that a research study failed to measure
D. acknowledge that a study's findings appear contradictory

Q3. Which of the following best describes the relationship between paragraph 1 and paragraph 2?

A. Paragraph 2 summarizes competing arguments on the topic introduced in paragraph 1.
B. Paragraph 2 confirms a widely held view mentioned in paragraph 1.
C. Paragraph 2 presents evidence that contradicts the findings discussed in paragraph 1.
D. Paragraph 2 points out that the findings presented in paragraph 1 are not complete.

Q4. The passage identifies each of the following as an effect of reducing class sizes EXCEPT:

A. The costs to schools increase.
B. Students can receive more individualized attention.
C. Teachers' job satisfaction increases.
D. Students' academic performance improves.

Q5. The word "nuanced" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. refined
B. good
C. traditional
D. ambitious

2026-06-27 Complex Vision System

原文（Passage）

Vision A Complex System

Far from functioning as a simple and faithful recording of what is in front of us, vision involves parts of the brain that engage in a complex interplay of processes. Specialized pathways filter enormous amounts of visual stimuli, prioritizing elements necessary for survival. For example, we are more likely to notice sudden motion than still objects.

You may be familiar with the blind spot, the small portion of our visual field where the optic nerve passes through the retina. No photoreceptor cell exists in this region to detect incoming light. Yet, most people are entirely unaware of its presence. The brain compensates for this missing visual data, filling it in based on patterns and colors from surrounding areas.

Also consider the role of attention in vision. If you are searching for a green book in a crowded room, your visual mechanisms amplify sensitivity to green wavelengths while simultaneously suppressing red or blue wavelengths. This ability, while useful, can lead to perceptual errors because heightened sensitivity comes at the cost of reduced tolerance for variation. This is why you might overlook a green object that falls under shadow.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention still objects and sudden motion?

A. To explain why it is important for the brain to faithfully record what is in front of us
B. To emphasize the enormous amounts of visual stimuli that enter the brain
C. To illustrate how the human brain prioritizes elements necessary for survival
D. To provide an example of a flaw of the filtering mechanism

Q2. The phrase "its presence" in the passage refers to the presence of

A. the photoreceptor cell
B. the blind spot
C. incoming light
D. the brain

Q3. The word "simultaneously" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. by mistake
B. at the same time
C. eventually
D. unfortunately

Q4. According to the passage, when you are looking for a green book in a crowded room, each of the following is true EXCEPT:

A. You become sensitive to green wavelengths.
B. You may overlook objects of other colors.
C. You may experience perceptual errors.
D. You become sensitive to green objects that are in a shadow.

Q5. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 2 presents a theory of how vision works, and paragraph 3 presents a different theory.

B. Paragraph 2 discusses an example of the complexity of vision, and paragraph 3 discusses another example.

C. Paragraph 2 introduces a familiar phenomenon, and paragraph 3 explains what causes this phenomenon.

D. Paragraph 2 describes the advantages of having a blind spot, and paragraph 3 describes the disadvantages.

2026-06-27 Discrete Geometry Structures

原文（Passage）

Hidden Structures in Discrete Geometry

Discrete geometry is a fascinating branch of mathematics that explores the hidden patterns formed by distinct geometric objects. Unlike continuous geometry—which deals with shapes and structures that are smooth and unbroken, like curves and surfaces—discrete geometry focuses on objects that are finite or countable like points, lines, and polygons. These distinct components reveal unexpected structures and relationships. Such revelations occur particularly in packing and tiling problems.

Packing problems involve finding the most efficient arrangement of objects in a given space. While this might sound like a simple exercise—such as fitting oranges into boxes—it has far-reaching applications in fields like computer-chip design, where components must be arranged to maximize performance and minimize space, and in data storage, where digital information is packed efficiently to save memory and speed up access. Researchers have discovered intriguing connections between the arrangement of shapes and space utilization, challenging assumptions about efficiency.

[A] Tiling problems further illustrate the depth of discrete geometry. [B] Penrose tiling, for instance, creates a pattern with non-repeating shapes that fill a plane, revealing underlying symmetrical properties. [C] The insights gained from such tiling patterns have influenced architectural designs and artworks. [D]

The challenging, abstract nature of discrete geometry can all too easily belie its practical value. Mathematicians continue to show how these hidden structures drive innovation across fields.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that contrasts two branches of mathematics.

A. Discrete geometry is a fascinating branch of mathematics that explores the hidden patterns formed by distinct geometric objects.

B. Unlike continuous geometry—which deals with shapes and structures that are smooth and unbroken, like curves and surfaces—discrete geometry focuses on objects that are finite or countable like points, lines, and polygons.

C. These distinct components reveal unexpected structures and relationships.

D. Such revelations occur particularly in packing and tiling problems.

Q2. Why does the author mention “fitting oranges into boxes”?

A. To help describe the historical development of packing problems

B. To help communicate the idea that packing problems are not as simple as they sound

C. To explain the basic principles of discrete geometry to nonspecialists

D. To highlight one of the challenges faced by researchers in discrete geometry

Q3. The study of computer chip design and data storage has revealed that

A. traditional assumptions about efficiency are still valid

B. the principles of continuous geometry are surprisingly relevant

C. there are interesting connections between how shapes are arranged and how spaces are used

D. there are new ways of enhancing the security of digital information

Q4. The word “belie” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. hide

B. confirm

C. enhance

D. undermine

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. For example, Penrose-inspired patterns have been used in mosaic art and floor designs to create visually striking compositions that evoke mathematical harmony. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1

B. Location 2

C. Location 3

D. Location 4

2026-06-27 Green Chemistry Innovations

原文（Passage）

Green Chemistry Innovations

Green chemistry, an area of study within organic chemistry, aims to design products and processes that reduce or eliminate hazardous substances. This field promotes sustainable practices and renewable resources in chemical production. One breakthrough is biodegradable plastics. Traditional plastics are derived from petroleum, a non-renewable resource, and can take centuries to decompose. Biodegradable plastics, made from renewable materials like corn starch, can break down in months under composting conditions, reducing pollution and landfill burden. Another advancement is the use of catalysis to increase reaction efficiency.

Catalysts speed up chemical reactions without being consumed and can often replace hazardous chemicals. Researchers have developed metal-organic frameworks (MOFs) that serve as efficient catalysts in various organic reactions. For example, they can be applied in the process of degrading pollutants into harmless compounds, which can aid in water and air purification. In addition to catalysts, green chemistry also studies solvents. A solvent is a liquid that dissolves other substances and provides a medium for these substances to react. For example, using water as a solvent instead of organic solvents, which are often toxic, creates safer and more sustainable processes. Additionally, reactions in water can sometimes proceed faster than in organic solvents.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The phrase "This field" in the passage refers to

A. green chemistry

B. organic chemistry

C. resource management

D. conservation biology

Q2. The word "breakthrough" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. source

B. damage

C. advancement

D. revision

Q3. What is one difference between traditional plastics made from petroleum and plastics made from corn starch?

A. The types of products they can be used for
B. The conditions needed for their production
C. The length of time it can take for them to break down
D. The amount of catalysts used in their production

Q4. What use of MOFs is mentioned in the passage?

A. Identifying hazardous chemicals
B. Combining with other catalysts
C. Stopping harmful chemical reactions
D. Making water and air cleaner

Q5. The passage indicates that using water as a solvent is beneficial for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

A. It can produce catalysts more safely.
B. It can reduce the need for toxic solvents.
C. It can result in more sustainable processes.
D. It can increase the speed of reactions.

2026-06-27 Whale Strandings

原文（Passage）

Whale Strandings

Few wildlife phenomena are as perplexing as mass strandings of whales. Sometimes, hundreds of whales or dolphins beach themselves on shores, often with fatal results. Scientists have sought explanations for decades, but as of yet, little is understood. Several theories suggest possible reasons for the strandings. Some researchers believe that disruptions to Earth's magnetic field may interfere with marine mammals' navigational abilities, while others point to changes in oceanic environments, such as temperature fluctuations or pollution, as factors that might drive the animals off course.

Humans may play a more direct role, too. In recent years, there has been growing evidence linking naval sonar systems to whale strandings. The powerful sound waves emitted by these systems can cause disorientation, making it difficult for whales to navigate underwater. Startled by the noise, whales may panic and rapidly ascend to the surface, causing serious injuries. Because whales travel in pods, disorientation in one whale can draw others toward shore, increasing the risk of a mass stranding.

Efforts to prevent strandings have yielded mixed results. While some countries now regulate naval sonar near whale habitats, requiring ships to lower sound levels or avoid critical areas, strandings continue to occur, reminding us that the reasons behind such events are complex.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "perplexing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rare
B. puzzling
C. disturbing
D. predictable

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about scientists' research into whale strandings?

A. It has produced explanations for strandings that point primarily to changing environmental conditions.

B. It has revealed that causes for strandings vary based on whale species and habitats.
C. It has proposed several explanations for strandings but has not found a conclusive understanding of the phenomenon.
D. It has been able to provide a clearer picture of whale navigation by utilizing naval sonar.

Q3. The passage suggests that whales' ability to navigate

A. has declined over the last few decades
B. is enhanced when whales travel large pods
C. is partly dependent on their proximity to familiar coastal regions
D. may be sensitive to fluctuations in the planet's magnetic field

Q4. The passage indicates all of the following about naval sonar EXCEPT:

A. It can prevent whales from forming pods.
B. It can produce reactions in whales that lead to physical harm.
C. It has been identified as a factor that may contribute to strandings.
D. It has been subject to governmental restrictions in certain locations.

Q5. The author mentions "critical areas" in order to

A. identify reasons that some countries have resisted the regulation of naval sonar
B. provide a specific example of how regulations aim to reduce threats to whales
C. explain why whale strandings are particularly common in some regions
D. suggest that certain marine habitats are more important than others

2026-06-23（2 套）

2026-06-23 Gene Editing Ethics

原文（Passage）

Navigating Gene Editing Ethics

Gene editing technologies, particularly CRISPR-Cas9, have transformed agricultural biotechnology by enabling precise modifications to plant genomes (genetic material). This allows scientists to enhance crop traits such as drought tolerance, pest resistance, and nutritional content without introducing foreign DNA (DNA from another species), distinguishing it from traditional genetic modification. For example, researchers have used CRISPR to develop rice varieties with improved yields and resistance to bacterial blight, a plant disease that is a major threat to global food security. In another case, gene-edited soybeans have been engineered to produce oil with reduced saturated fat and increased oleic acid-an unsaturated fat associated with heart health-making them more appealing for both consumers and food manufacturers. Despite its promise, gene editing in agriculture raises important concerns. [A] Unintended off-target effects, where edits occur in nontarget regions of the genome, could potentially alter plant metabolism or reduce resilience to environmental stress. [B] Additionally, widespread adoption of uniform edited traits may diminish genetic diversity, making crops more vulnerable to future pests or diseases. [C] Such outcomes highlight the need for comprehensive field testing and multi-season trials to mitigate risks before commercial release. Scientists must evaluate not just the intended trait but also how gene edits affect overall plant health and adaptability. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, how is CRISPR-Cas9 technology superior to traditional genetic modification?

A. It is supported by more extensive research.
B. It is easier for scientists to implement.
C. Its modifications do not involve foreign DNA.
D. Its modifications are only temporary.

Q2. Why does the passage mention "soybeans"?

A. To illustrate CRISPR-Cas9's potential to improve the nutritional content of crops
B. To show that CRISPR-Cas9 technology works better in soybeans than in rice
C. To highlight the role of food manufacturers in agricultural biotechnology
D. To explain how crop traits relate to heart health

Q3. The passage mentions all of the following potential negative effects of gene editing in agriculture EXCEPT

A. a decreased ability to survive in harsh conditions
B. an increased chance of being harmed by pests
C. a greater likelihood of suffering from diseases
D. a higher risk of harming the wider environment

Q4. The word "mitigate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. determine
B. lessen
C. describe
D. warn about

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: One study about this danger cited the Irish Potato Famine, in which genetically similar varieties were all susceptible to late blight, causing a major catastrophe. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-23 Thermoelectricity Energy

原文（Passage）

Thermoelectricity

Thermoelectric materials offer a promising solution for converting waste heat into usable electrical energy, making them a valuable option for sustainable energy generation. Thermoelectric devices consist of thermoelectric materials arranged so that one side is heated while the other is cooled; the ensuing temperature difference generates an electric current (the Seebeck effect). Waste heat sources include industrial exhaust or even body heat. In the automotive industry, thermoelectric generators have been integrated into hybrid and electric vehicles to recover heat from exhaust systems and convert it into electricity. That electricity can then be used to power onboard electronics or charge the battery, improving the car's efficiency. [A] Many of the most effective thermoelectric material types, however, rely on rare or environmentally harmful elements, such as lead and tellurium, which limits their practicality for large-scale use. [B] Additionally, the amount of electricity that can be produced from heat is still relatively low compared to other energy technologies. [C] Researchers are working to overcome these issues by developing safer, more abundant materials-such as modified forms of silicon that can be engineered to exhibit thermoelectric properties-and by optimizing device architecture to improve energy conversion efficiency and scalability. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be concluded about "waste heat" based on the passage?

A. It is produced by the Seebeck effect.
B. It is produced as a result of thermoelectric energy generation.

C. It is a byproduct of various processes and typically goes unused.
D. It is usually produced in quantities that are too small to be of use.

Q2. The word "ensuing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. resulting
B. instant
C. large
D. weakening

Q3. Why does the author discuss the automotive industry in the passage?

A. To argue that car exhaust systems do not produce enough heat to be a practical source of energy
B. To contrast the use of thermoelectric generators in hybrid vehicles with their use in electric vehicles
C. To give an example of a successful application of thermoelectricity
D. To illustrate the difficulties of implementing thermoelectricity in consumer products

Q4. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as drawbacks of thermoelectric technology EXCEPT:

A. Components of thermoelectric materials can be difficult to source.
B. Converting existing infrastructure will be expensive.
C. Thermoelectric materials often contain toxic elements.
D. It does not produce large quantities of energy.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: Thermoelectric devices typically achieve conversion efficiencies of 5-8%, whereas solar panels reach 15-22%, and natural gas power plants can attain efficiencies of 45-50%, or even more. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-22（2 套）

2026-06-22 Bird Migration Patterns

原文（Passage）

Bird Migration

Every year, millions of birds travel huge distances to wintering grounds, and then back to breeding grounds when warmer weather returns there. Bird migration evolved in response to climatic changes. During the Ice Age, when average temperatures were frigid, migrating birds had a survival advantage, and the behavior became widespread.

Migration is also linked to resource availability. Arctic terns, which undertake the longest migrations of any animal by flying from their summer breeding grounds in Earth's north polar (Arctic) regions to their wintering grounds in Earth's south polar regions, feed primarily on small fish and other small marine animals. This prey is most abundant when increased sunlight results in the increased availability of algae, the microscopic marine plantlike organisms that are food for the tiny marine animals known as zooplankton, which are in turn consumed by terns' prey.

Not all birds migrate. Rock ptarmigans also live in Arctic and sub-Arctic regions. Instead of flying to warmer climes in winter, they shelter in snow burrows and reduce activity to conserve energy. They feed on plants like birch and willow trees, which are available in their habitat year-round.

The divergence between migratory and sedentary species represents different adaptations to environmental pressures.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage implies that bird migration began when

A. wintering grounds were closer to breeding grounds than they are now.
B. areas suitable for breeding were smaller than they are now.
C. there were many more birds than there are now.
D. climates were generally much colder than they are now.

Q2. What is the passage explaining when it mentions that "increased sunlight results in the increased availability of algae"?

A. Why terns' migrations result in increased food availability for them.
B. Why some tiny marine organisms migrate for long distances.
C. Why terns depend on sunlight while traveling long distances.
D. Why terns benefit from the migration of zooplankton.

Q3. The passage supports all of the following statements about Arctic terns EXCEPT:

A. They take different migration routes depending on resource availability.
B. They migrate over longer distances than all other birds do.
C. They spend much of their lives in regions around Earth's poles.
D. They eat mostly small animals living in seawater.

Q4. Why does the passage provide information about rock ptarmigans?

A. To emphasize the usefulness of snow burrows in their habitat.
B. To contrast their behavior to that of Arctic terns.
C. To show that birch and willow trees provide food to both migratory and sedentary birds.
D. To provide another example of migratory birds.

Q5. The word "shelter" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. move
B. land
C. seek food
D. take protection

2026-06-22 Gravitational Physics Evolution

原文（Passage）

Gravitational Physics and Its Practical Applications

The concept of gravity has evolved over time. In the seventeenth century, Isaac Newton described gravity as a universal force acting between masses, formalized in his law of universal gravitation. This theory provided a universal, mathematical framework for understanding both terrestrial and planetary motion. However, in 1915, Albert Einstein introduced general relativity, redefining gravity as the curvature of spacetime caused by mass and energy. This shift explained phenomena Newton's model could not, such as the bending of light near massive bodies (gravitational lensing). Einstein's theory, which marked a revolution in physics, also predicted black holes and gravitational waves, phenomena later confirmed by observation.

Theoretical advances in gravitational physics have led to practical applications, such as in drug development. Proteins often form crystals that can be analyzed to determine their molecular structure. [A] However, on Earth, gravity interferes with the uniform growth of crystals. [B] In microgravity environments, such as those aboard the International Space Station (ISS), gravitational effects are minimized. [C] Crystals grown in space tend to be larger, more uniform, and less flawed than those grown on Earth, enabling researchers to map the crystals' atomic

structure with greater accuracy. [D] This is crucial for rational drug design, allowing scientists to develop medications that precisely target disease-related proteins.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions all of the following about Newton's law of universal gravitation EXCEPT:

A. It stated that all objects pull on each other.
B. It helped explain motion on Earth and in space.
C. It was later replaced by another theory.
D. It made predictions that were only confirmed later.

Q2. Why does the author mention "gravitational lensing" in the passage?

A. To help explain why Einstein's theory was superior to Newton's.
B. To give an example of a prediction made by Einstein.
C. To further illustrate Newton's law of universal gravitation.
D. To contrast terrestrial and planetary motion.

Q3. The word "minimized" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. eliminated
B. reduced
C. observed
D. applied

Q4. According to the passage, why is it important for drug developers to determine the molecular structure of crystals?

A. This helps researchers understand the effects of gravity on proteins in the human body.
B. This helps researchers create drugs that target specific proteins.
C. This helps create more perfect crystals that can be used in industrial applications.
D. This enables manufacturers to produce existing drugs more quickly and cheaply.

Q5. There are four locations [A] [B] [C] [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. For instance, parts of a crystal will grow unevenly as heavier components settle, leading to distortions in its shape. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location in the passage.

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-20（3 套）

2026-06-20 Microseisms Earth Vibrations

原文（Passage）

Microseisms: The Earth's Subtle Vibrations

The Earth is constantly vibrating, even when there are no earthquakes. These subtle vibrations, known as microseisms, are typically caused by ocean waves. When waves collide, they create pressure variations that travel through the water and into the sea floor. This energy transfer generates seismic waves detectable by seismometers worldwide. Interestingly, microseisms are strongest during storms when ocean waves are more powerful.

Researchers have found these vibrations can provide important information about the Earth's interior. Microseisms travel through the Earth's crust and mantle, revealing details about the geological structures they pass through, including variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures. Another compelling use of microseisms is in climate studies. Scientists analyze

historical data on these vibrations to reconstruct past ocean conditions and storm activities. This helps improve climate models and understand long-term weather patterns. Additionally, microseisms are used in oil and gas exploration. They identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures without more invasive techniques.
Studying microseisms is challenging. The mild signals are easily masked by other seismic noises. Advanced data analysis techniques and state-of-the-art equipment are essential for accurately interpreting microseisms. Researchers often employ filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "subtle" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. faint.
B. quick.
C. strong.
D. constant.

Q2. It can be inferred that microseisms are strongest during ocean storms because

A. the Earth's crust and mantle are more active during such storms.
B. ocean waves are larger and collide more vigorously during such storms.
C. seismometers are designed to work most effectively during such storms.
D. the details of geological structures become more apparent during such storms.

Q3. Why does the author mention "variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures"?

A. To suggest that more research is needed to understand the relationship between microseisms and earthquakes.
B. To identify the most important features of Earth's crust and mantle.
C. To help explain how microseisms can alter the geological structures that they pass through.
D. To highlight the kinds of information microseisms can provide about Earth's interior.

Q4. According to the passage, how can microseisms help in oil and gas exploration?

A. By providing historical data on ocean conditions.
B. By pinpointing potential drilling sites.
C. By measuring the strength of seismic waves.
D. By reducing the need for seismometers.

Q5. What does the author suggest about "filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers"?

A. They are techniques used to study microseisms.
B. They demonstrate the outdatedness of seismometers.
C. They are popular ways of studying various types of seismic noises.
D. They highlight a flaw in current research methods.

2026-06-20 Polarized Light Applications

原文（Passage）

Polarized Light's Surprising Applications

Polarized light, characterized by waves vibrating in a single plane, offers applications beyond its familiar use in sunglasses, where it reduces glare from reflective surfaces like water and roads. In certain scientific fields, it is invaluable for revealing hidden properties of materials. For instance, when researchers study the internal structure of crystals, polarized light provides insights that normal light cannot, by interacting differently with the distinct optical paths within the crystal lattice.

[A] In biology, polarized light uncovers structural details of cells and tissues, facilitating breakthroughs in understanding cellular organization and disease mechanisms. This is true for birefringent materials, which alter the polarization of light in ways that reveal microstructural patterns such as fiber alignment and intracellular organization, helping scientists assess variations in cell density and composition. [B] Such techniques have been instrumental in identifying amyloid plaques in brain tissue, an indication of Alzheimer's disease. [C] However, the use of polarized light is not universally beneficial. In aviation, pilots may avoid polarized lenses because they can obscure critical visual cues, such as instrument readings, that are essential for navigation. Thus, while polarized light can solve certain visibility issues by reducing glare, it may also interfere with necessary visual information, prompting careful consideration of context before implementation. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "invaluable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. recommended.
B. convenient.
C. extremely useful.
D. very expensive.

Q2. All of the following are mentioned as applications of polarized light EXCEPT:

A. It is used in sunglasses to reduce glare.
B. It can reveal hidden properties in crystals.
C. It can be used to alter cell structure.
D. It aids in analyzing cellular composition.

Q3. What can be inferred about the use of polarized light in medicine?

A. It can help doctors diagnose diseases.
B. It is still in its early stages of implementation.
C. It offers new ways to treat Alzheimer's disease.
D. Its use is somewhat controversial.

Q4. Polarized lenses are potentially dangerous in aviation because they can

A. give pilots a false sense of confidence.
B. increase glare in the cockpit.
C. become foggy at high altitudes.
D. make it difficult to see aircraft instruments.

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Sentence: "Applications are not limited to the inorganic world."

A. Before the paragraph beginning "In biology".
B. Before the sentence beginning "Such techniques".
C. Before the paragraph beginning "However".
D. At the end of the paragraph about biological applications.

2026-06-20 Shifting Playwriting Art

原文（Passage）

The Shifting Art of Playwriting

Innovative playwriting techniques have transformed the theatrical landscape by challenging linear storytelling and passive spectatorship. Nonlinear narratives, seen in plays like Harold Pinter's Betrayal, disrupt chronological order to reflect the fragmented nature of memory and emotion. This structure invites audiences to actively reconstruct the story, deepening their engagement.

Another innovation is the so-called breaking of the fourth wall, where characters directly address the audience. Used by Bertolt Brecht in Mother Courage and Her Children, this technique encourages viewers to reflect critically rather than become absorbed in illusion. Fully interactive theater, exemplified by the British production Sleep No More, goes further by allowing viewers to physically move through the performance space, personalizing the experience and making each viewing unique.

These techniques suggest a broader hypothesis: that theatrical form is not merely a container for content but a vital part of creating meaning. By reshaping narrative structure and audience dynamics, playwrights can evoke new emotional and intellectual responses, revealing complex aspects of the human condition.

Of course, such innovations may confuse rather than enlighten more traditional-minded theater audiences and also disrupt their emotional immersion and fragment the narrative. Thus, while these techniques can serve as powerful tools, their success depends on how carefully they are integrated into the dramatic work.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the passage mainly about?

A. The influence of traditional theater on modern audiences.
B. The role of audience participation in theatrical performances.
C. New approaches to theatrical storytelling and audience involvement.
D. The challenges of interpreting nonlinear narratives in drama.

Q2. According to the passage, what is a key difference between Mother Courage and Her Children and Sleep No More?

A. Mother Courage and Her Children uses audience interaction to create emotional immersion, while Sleep No More avoids direct engagement.
B. Mother Courage and Her Children involves some interaction with the audience, while Sleep No More involves actual audience participation.
C. Mother Courage and Her Children presents a fragmented narrative, while Sleep No More follows a linear storyline.
D. Mother Courage and Her Children is based on historical events, while Sleep No More is entirely fictional.

Q3. Which of the following best describes the function of paragraph 3 in the passage?

A. It offers a conjecture about what new playwriting techniques mean for theater.
B. It summarizes the historical development of experimental theater techniques.
C. It critiques the effectiveness of audience-centered performance styles.
D. It introduces a counterargument to the use of nonlinear narratives in drama.

Q4. The word "evoke" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. measure.
B. produce.
C. compare.
D. anticipate.

Q5. The passage introduces all of the following innovative approaches to playwriting EXCEPT

A. presenting events out of order.
B. actors speaking to audiences.
C. viewers walking onto the stage.
D. playwrights joining the cast.

2026-06-17（13 套）

KPO 13 - Ocean Acidification Impacts

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Ocean Acidification

Ocean acidification is a significant environmental issue resulting from increased carbon dioxide (CO2) levels in the atmosphere. When CO2 dissolves in seawater, it forms carbonic acid, which lowers the ocean's pH. This change in acidity affects marine life, particularly organisms with calcium carbonate shells, such as corals, mollusks, and some plankton species.

Coral reefs are among the most affected by ocean acidification. The acidic water makes it difficult for corals to maintain their calcium carbonate skeletons, leading to weakened structures and increased vulnerability to erosion and breakage. This process also disrupts the symbiotic relationships between corals and algae, further harming reef ecosystems.

Mollusks, including oysters and clams, struggle to develop their shells in acidic conditions, which can lead to reduced survival rates and impact the aquaculture industry. Plankton, at the base of the marine food web, also faces challenges, as their shells become more fragile, affecting their ability to reproduce and survive.

Efforts to mitigate ocean acidification include reducing CO2 emissions, protecting marine areas, and researching adaptive strategies for marine life. Addressing this issue is crucial for preserving biodiversity and maintaining the health of marine ecosystems.

题目（Questions）

Q1. How does ocean acidification affect corals?

A. It enhances their growth.
B. It strengthens their calcium carbonate skeletons.
C. It causes their structures to break more easily.
D. It improves their symbiotic relationships with algae.

Q2. Mollusks are impacted by ocean acidification because

A. they rely on plankton for food
B. they struggle to develop their shells in acidic conditions
C. they need carbon dioxide for their survival
D. they depend on coral reefs for habitat

Q3. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 introduces a new problem not discussed in paragraph 2.
B. Paragraph 3 adds to the list of the effects of ocean acidification begun in paragraph 2.
C. Paragraph 3 presents a solution to the problems discussed in paragraph 2.
D. Paragraph 3 provides examples that contradict the information in paragraph 2.

Q4. Why does the author mention "adaptive strategies for marine life" in the last paragraph?

A. To emphasize the importance of reducing CO2 emissions
B. To suggest that current mitigation efforts are ineffective
C. To argue that protecting marine areas is unnecessary
D. To highlight potential solutions to help marine organisms cope with ocean acidification

Q5. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To explain how ocean acidification occurs, affects marine organisms, and may be addressed
B. To compare the economic value of coral reefs, mollusks, and plankton
C. To argue that aquaculture is the primary cause of changing ocean chemistry

D. To describe the historical discovery of carbonic acid in seawater

TPO1 - Agricultural Economics Shifts

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Agricultural Economics

Agricultural economics has undergone significant changes, driven by advancements in technology and shifts in consumer demand. Precision farming utilizes satellite imagery to enhance crop yields by analyzing soil and weather conditions. This allows farmers to make informed decisions about planting, watering, and harvesting, which in turn increase efficiency and reduce waste.

Another development is the rise of organic farming, which responds to consumer preference for sustainable products. Organic farming avoids synthetic pesticides and fertilizers, focusing on crop rotation, composting, and biological pest control. This practice has environmental benefits and creates niche markets for farmers.

Global trade also impacts agricultural economics. Nations depend on importing and exporting food to meet domestic needs and take advantage of international prices. However, this interdependency can lead to economic vulnerability when global supply chains are disrupted by political instability or natural disasters.

Innovations and global dynamics can also pose other challenges. Precision farming requires significant investment in technology, which can be prohibitive for small-scale farmers. Organic farming often yields lower outputs than conventional methods, complicating the balance between sustainability and food security. Additionally, reliance on global trade exposes countries to fluctuations in international markets, necessitating robust economic policies to manage these risks.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "enhance" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. maintain
B. imitate
C. predict
D. improve

Q2. What is suggested in the passage about organic farming?

A. It uses synthetic pesticides and fertilizers.
B. It does not create niche markets for farmers.
C. It focuses on natural and sustainable practices.
D. It is just as efficient as conventional farming.

Q3. What does the passage suggest is an economic vulnerability of global trade in agricultural economics?

A. Precision farming techniques.
B. Consumer demand for organic products.
C. Dependency on international markets.
D. Investment in new technology.

Q4. Why does the author mention "political instability or natural disasters"?

A. To identify situations in which dependence on global trade can have negative consequences
B. To provide examples of factors that have an insignificant influence on agricultural economics
C. To emphasize the importance of organic farming
D. To demonstrate how technological advancements can solve problems

Q5. The passage mentions all of the following challenges related to new agricultural practices EXCEPT

A. environmental problems
B. a need for investments that small-scale farmers cannot afford
C. a possible decrease in food security
D. too much dependence on international markets

TPO1 - Power Of Music

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

The Power of Music

Music has the remarkable ability to influence our emotions, behavior, and physical health. Studies show that listening to music can reduce stress, alleviate pain, and improve cognitive function. It is no surprise that music therapy has become an integral part of treatment for various conditions.

Music affects the brain by triggering the release of neurotransmitters such as dopamine and serotonin, which are associated with pleasure and mood regulation. Fast-paced music can energize us, while slower tempos can calm us down. This is why workout playlists often feature upbeat songs, while relaxation playlists include soothing melodies.

Beyond personal well-being, music also plays a crucial role in social interactions. It can strengthen bonds, create a sense of unity, and influence social movements. Chanting and singing have been used in protests and rallies to motivate and unify participants. Despite its benefits, not all music has a positive impact. Loud and aggressive music can sometimes increase stress and anxiety levels. Understanding the power of music and its effects can help us make informed choices about what we listen to and how we use it in our daily lives.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "alleviate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. delay
B. ease
C. monitor
D. predict

Q2. Why does the author mention neurotransmitters?

A. To provide some examples of chemicals in our bodies
B. To identify the mechanisms by which music influences pleasure and mood
C. To explain how music increases physical health
D. To imply that music affects social interactions

Q3. The passage suggests that fast-paced music might be included in workout playlists for which of the following reasons?

A. It helps to calm down the listener.
B. It reduces stress levels.
C. It energizes the listener.
D. It improves cognitive function.

Q4. What does the passage mention as one way that music influences social interactions?

A. Music calms tense situations involving many people.
B. Music makes the bonds between people more powerful.
C. Music allows for a greater variety of social interactions.
D. Music can help stimulate more movement during large social gatherings.

Q5. Why does the author mention chanting and singing?

A. To illustrate how music is used in personal well-being
B. To highlight the role of music in social movements
C. To emphasize the negative impact of music
D. To discuss the effects of music on cognitive function

TPO2 - Cognitive Mapping Process

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Cognitive Mapping

Cognitive mapping is a term used to describe the mental process by which humans and animals acquire, code, store, recall, and decode information about their spatial environment. This concept, first proposed by psychologist Edward Tolman in the 1940s, revolutionized the understanding of navigation and spatial awareness. Tolman suggested that individuals create internal maps that help them navigate their surroundings efficiently.

Recent research indicates that cognitive mapping is more complex than initially thought. Neuroscientists have discovered that the hippocampus, a region of the brain associated with memory, plays a crucial role in this process. Studies involving brain imaging have shown that when people navigate through unfamiliar environments, the hippocampus becomes highly active. This suggests that cognitive mapping is not just a mental representation but also involves distinct neural pathways.

Moreover, cognitive maps are not static; they evolve with new experiences and information. For instance, if you take a different route to work, your brain updates the existing map to include this new pathway. This dynamic nature of cognitive mapping underscores its importance in learning and adaptation. Despite these advances, many questions remain about the precise mechanisms governing cognitive maps and how they vary across species.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is cognitive mapping?

A. The process of creating physical maps
B. The mental process of understanding spatial environments
C. The storage of information in the hippocampus
D. The act of navigating familiar environments

Q2. The word "crucial" in the second paragraph is closest in meaning to

A. significant
B. complex
C. optional
D. rare

Q3. What role does the hippocampus play in cognitive mapping?

A. It stores physical maps.
B. It codes memories about familiar routes.
C. It decodes information about spatial environments.
D. It functions when navigating new environments.

Q4. How do cognitive maps change over time?

A. They remain static.
B. They update with new experiences.
C. They become less detailed.
D. They are replaced by complex maps.

Q5. What is the purpose of the third paragraph?

A. It explains an additional feature of cognitive mapping.

B. It provides evidence contradicting the information presented in the passage.

C. It concludes the passage by stating that cognitive mapping is now well studied and understood.

D. It describes examples illustrating the numerous features discussed in paragraph 2.

TPO2 - Nineteenth Century Urbanization

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Urbanization in the Nineteenth Century

The nineteenth century witnessed a dramatic shift in population dynamics because of urbanization. Industrialization played a crucial role in this transformation, drawing people from rural areas to cities in search of employment and better living conditions. The proliferation of factories and the promise of higher wages attracted a diverse workforce, including women and children.

Cities expanded rapidly, leading to overcrowded living conditions and inadequate infrastructure. Housing was often substandard, and sanitation issues were prevalent. As a result, urban areas became hot spots for diseases such as cholera and tuberculosis. Despite the challenges faced by urban planners and legislators, urbanization brought significant advancements in public transportation, communication, and commerce.

The influx of people into cities also led to major cultural shifts and the rise of new social classes. A burgeoning middle class emerged, distinguished by its economic power and influence. This class played a pivotal role in advocating for social reforms, including improved working conditions and public-health measures. While urbanization presented numerous obstacles, it undeniably laid the groundwork for modern society.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "proliferation" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. replacement

B. reduction

C. increase

D. movement

Q2. What was a significant effect of industrialization in the nineteenth century?

A. Decreasing populations in rural areas

B. Improved sanitation in cities

C. Reduced employment opportunities for women in cities

D. The development of improved agricultural practices for rural areas

Q3. Why does the author mention diseases such as cholera and tuberculosis?

A. To illustrate the health challenges faced by urban areas

B. To emphasize the need for modern health care

C. To compare urban and rural health conditions

D. To suggest that these diseases were almost eradicated in the nineteenth century

Q4. How did urbanization impact public transportation?

A. It led to a decline in the quality of public transportation.

B. It brought various improvements to public transportation.

C. It caused a reduction in public transportation options.

D. It made public transportation more expensive for city residents.

Q5. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 contradicts the points made in paragraph 2.

B. Paragraph 3 offers solutions to the problems mentioned in paragraph 2.

C. Paragraph 3 provides evidence to support the claims made in paragraph 2.

D. Paragraph 3 discusses the social changes that resulted from the conditions described in paragraph 2.

TPO2 - Vibrio Bacteria Risks

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Vibrio Bacteria

Vibrio bacteria are a type of bacteria commonly found in coastal waters. These bacteria are known for their ability to cause a variety of infections in humans, ranging from mild gastroenteritis to severe wound infections. Vibrio species thrive in warm, salty environments, making them particularly prevalent in tropical and subtropical regions. There are more than twenty different species of Vibrio bacteria, with Vibrio cholerae, Vibrio parahaemolyticus, and Vibrio vulnificus being the most well-known.

One of the most concerning aspects of Vibrio bacteria is their increasing resistance to antibiotics. Over time, some strains of Vibrio have developed mechanisms to evade the effects of commonly used antibiotics. Researchers are working to understand the genetic mutations that contribute to this resistance, which could lead to the development of more effective treatments.

Additionally, climate change is amplifying the risks associated with Vibrio bacteria. Rising sea temperatures and changing salinity levels create ideal conditions for these bacteria to multiply. As a result, there has been a noticeable increase in Vibrio-related infections in regions previously unaffected. This trend underscores the importance of monitoring environmental changes and implementing public-health strategies to mitigate the impact of these bacteria.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "prevalent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. widespread

B. limited

C. dangerous

D. rare

Q2. All of the following are true of Vibrio bacteria species EXCEPT:

A. Most species are located in the waters along coastlines.

B. All species cause severe infections.

C. There are more than twenty total species.

D. Certain species are more well known than others.

Q3. What does the passage identify as an important concern about Vibrio bacteria today?

A. They are becoming less common in tropical regions.

B. They are causing fewer health problems in humans.

C. Certain kinds are mutating more rapidly than other kinds.

D. Certain kinds have become resistant to an important drug.

Q4. Why does the author mention "climate change"?

A. To suggest that it has no effect on Vibrio bacteria

B. To explain why Vibrio bacteria are not found in cold waters

C. To help explain why certain types of infections have been spreading to formerly unaffected areas

D. To indicate another reason that antibiotics contribute to bacterial resistance

Q5. Click on the sentence in paragraph 3 that identifies specific environmental conditions associated with a contemporary concern about Vibrio bacteria.

A. Additionally, climate change is amplifying the risks associated with Vibrio bacteria.

B. Rising sea temperatures and changing salinity levels create ideal conditions for these bacteria to multiply.

C. As a result, there has been a noticeable increase in Vibrio-related infections in regions previously unaffected.

D. This trend underscores the importance of monitoring environmental changes and implementing public-health strategies to mitigate the impact of these bacteria.

TPO3 - Indigenous Cultural Adaptation

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Cultural Adaptation

Social anthropology examines how cultures adapt to changing environments. Indigenous communities in the Amazon have changed agricultural practices over time. Historically, these communities practiced slash-and-burn agriculture, cutting down vegetation and burning it to clear fields for crops. This method suited the nutrient-poor soils but required constant movement as plots became infertile after a few years.

Recently, there has been a shift towards agroforestry--a system that integrates trees and shrubs into agricultural lands. Agroforestry helps maintain soil fertility and supports biodiversity, providing habitats for various species. This approach allows communities to stay in one place longer, preserving traditional knowledge tied to specific locations.

Economic factors play a role in these adaptations. As global demand for sustainable products grows, these communities find new markets for their agroforestry goods. Modern tools improve yields and reduce labor, making agroforestry a viable alternative.

However, these changes are not without challenges. The transition requires education and resources, which can be difficult to access in remote areas. Balancing traditional practices with new methods can lead to cultural shifts, affecting community dynamics and identity. Despite these challenges, the benefits of sustainable agriculture and economic opportunities are leading more communities to embrace agroforestry, showcasing the resilience of indigenous cultures.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is suggested in the passage about agroforestry?

A. It requires constant movement like slash-and-burn agriculture.

B. It helps maintain soil fertility and supports biodiversity.

C. It reduces the need for modern tools and techniques.

D. It is less beneficial than traditional slash-and-burn methods.

Q2. What does the passage suggest is a benefit of the shift to agroforestry?

A. Increased need for relocation.

B. Preservation of traditional knowledge.

C. Higher use of synthetic fertilizers.

D. Decreased economic opportunities.

Q3. The word "resilience" at the end of the passage is closest in meaning to

A. growth

B. confidence

C. toughness

D. diversity

Q4. Why does the author mention modern tools?

A. To illustrate how they can complicate traditional practices.
B. To suggest they are unnecessary in agroforestry.
C. To emphasize their role in slash-and-burn agriculture.
D. To provide reasons for improved yields and reduced labor.

Q5. What is the relationship between paragraphs 3 and 4?

A. Paragraph 4 introduces challenges to the ideas presented in paragraph 3.
B. Paragraph 4 explains a concept introduced in paragraph 3.
C. Paragraph 4 provides evidence for a theory presented in paragraph 3.
D. Paragraph 4 provides an example of a problem discussed in paragraph 3.

TPO3 - Prehistoric Cave Art

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Prehistoric Cave Art

Prehistoric cave art is a form of art that was created thousands of years ago. Prehistoric cave art offers a glimpse into the lives of early humans and the way they lived. Found in caves across Europe, Asia, and Africa, these artworks depict animals, human figures, and abstract symbols. The Lascaux Cave in France and the Altamira Cave in Spain are among the most famous sites. Researchers believe cave art served various purposes. Some theories suggest the paintings were part of hunting rituals. Others propose the art taught younger generations about animals. Additionally, some argue the artworks had religious significance.

The techniques used to create cave art were advanced for the time. Early humans employed tools made from bone, stone, and wood to carve images into the rock. They used natural pigments like ochre and charcoal to paint scenes. The placement of the art in hard-to-reach areas suggests creating these images was a deliberate act. Despite the mystery surrounding their exact purpose, cave art remains a vital link to understanding human history and cultural development.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "depict" in the first paragraph is closest in meaning to

A. hide
B. show
C. combine
D. move

Q2. What is suggested about the Lascaux and Altamira caves?

A. They are the only sites where cave art is found.
B. They contain some of the most famous cave art.
C. Their paintings were created for educational purposes.
D. Their artworks represent deities or ancestral spirits.

Q3. All of the following are true about prehistoric cave art EXCEPT:

A. It depicts animals, human figures, and abstract symbols.
B. It served various purposes, including hunting rituals.
C. It was created using natural pigments.
D. It is found mostly in Europe.

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 provides examples of animals mentioned in paragraph 2.
B. Paragraph 3 challenges the theories mentioned in paragraph 2.

C. Paragraph 3 discusses what was used to create cave art while paragraph 2 discusses the purpose for its creation.

D. Paragraph 3 discusses a different kind of prehistoric art very similar to prehistoric cave art discussed in paragraph 2.

Q5. Why does the author mention hard-to-reach areas in the caves?

A. To suggest that the cave art was created by highly skilled individuals

B. To indicate that cave art was an intentional and meaningful act

C. To propose that the artwork represented deities

D. To explain the difficulty in finding these artworks

TPO4 - Bioluminescent Organisms

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Bioluminescent Organisms

Bioluminescence is the production and emission of light by living organisms. Observed in fireflies, jellyfish, and certain fungi, this light is generated through a chemical reaction involving luciferin and luciferase. Fireflies use bioluminescence to communicate, facilitating mating and deterring predators. Jellyfish use light to startle predators, providing an opportunity to escape. Some deep-sea organisms use bioluminescence for hunting, emitting light to attract prey.

Bioluminescence is not limited to animals. Certain fungi, like the ghost fungus, glow in the dark to attract insects that help disperse their spores. Scientists study bioluminescence to develop new technologies, exploring bioluminescent proteins for medical imaging and environmental monitoring. The exact mechanisms of bioluminescence are still not fully understood, despite its intriguing applications.

Ongoing research aims to uncover more about how organisms produce light and why this ability evolved. One area of interest is understanding the genetic and molecular basis of bioluminescence. As scientists delve deeper into the mysteries of bioluminescence, they may discover even more ways to harness this natural phenomenon. This has led to breakthroughs in several scientific fields, including genetics and biotechnology, demonstrating the wide-ranging potential of studying bioluminescence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "emission" in the first paragraph is closest in meaning to

A. concealing

B. release

C. prevention

D. disruption

Q2. What is suggested about fireflies?

A. They use bioluminescence to blind predators.

B. They use bioluminescence for hunting.

C. They use bioluminescence to communicate.

D. They use bioluminescence primarily for healing.

Q3. All of the following are true about bioluminescence EXCEPT:

A. It is observed in both animals and fungi.

B. It involves a chemical reaction with luciferin and luciferase.

C. It is used by jellyfish to startle predators.

D. It is fully understood by scientists.

Q4. What can be concluded about paragraph 2?

A. It provides an example of bioluminescence in non-animal organisms.
B. It challenges an idea presented earlier in the passage.
C. It elaborates on the chemical reactions mentioned earlier.
D. It introduces a theory explained in the next paragraph.

Q5. Why does the author mention medical imaging in the second paragraph?

A. To indicate that bioluminescence evolved primarily for scientific use
B. To highlight one of the potential applications of bioluminescence
C. To show the complexity of luciferin and luciferase reactions
D. To suggest ongoing research in environmental monitoring

TPO4 - Understanding Risk Perception

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Understanding Risk Perception

Risk perception is a fascinating aspect of human psychology, influencing decisions from daily activities to major life choices. Individuals often misjudge risks, either exaggerating or underestimating them. For instance, flying is statistically safer than driving, yet many are more apprehensive about flying. This disparity is largely due to what psychologists refer to as the availability heuristic, a type of mental shortcut wherein memorable events, such as incidents involving planes, dominate our thoughts.

Cultural factors also play a role in risk perception. Some societies embrace risk-taking by valuing adventure and innovation, while others prioritize safety and caution. These attitudes are shaped by historical experiences, economic stability, and societal norms. In countries with high economic inequality, people may take more risks because they have fewer resources, fewer opportunities, and feel they have little to lose. In contrast, affluent societies might avoid risks to maintain their status quo and protect assets.

Moreover, media coverage drastically alters perceived risks. Sensational stories about rare but catastrophic events create a distorted image of reality. Public campaigns and education counteract this by providing balanced information, helping individuals make informed decisions. Understanding the psychology behind risk perception allows policymakers to design better strategies for public safety and health.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is indicated in the passage about air travel?

A. Many people fear it because of notable events that remain in the memory.
B. The media discusses it more frequently than they do driving.
C. It is less well regulated than other forms of transportation.
D. It is subject to a large disparity between those who fear it and those who do not.

Q2. The word "exaggerating" in the passage is closest in meaning to:

A. praising
B. ignoring
C. ridiculing
D. expanding

Q3. How do cultural factors influence risk perception?

A. By determining the availability of reliable safety measures
B. By forming various societal attitudes toward risk-taking
C. By regulating how risky events are covered in the news
D. By influencing personal relationships and decision-making habits that are considered risky

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 2 introduces a concept that is further analyzed in paragraph 3.

B. Paragraph 2 presents historical data, while paragraph 3 challenges its reliability.

C. Paragraph 2 mentions cultural factors and paragraph 3 provides examples of these factors.

D. Paragraph 2 discusses cultural influences on risk perception, while paragraph 3 discusses another influence on perceived risk.

Q5. How might public campaigns and education alter risk perception?

A. By teaching the psychology of risk perception

B. By limiting media coverage of sensational stories

C. By providing accurate information about risks

D. By discouraging risk-taking behaviors in society

TPO5 - Stealth Technology Advancements

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Stealth Technology

Stealth technology is designed to make military assets, like aircraft, ships, and missiles, harder to detect by radar. This goal is achieved by reducing the reflection and emission of radar waves. One method involves using materials that absorb radar waves. Another method shapes the surfaces of these assets to deflect radar waves away from the radar receiver.

The F-117 Nighthawk, developed during the 1970s, was the first operational stealth aircraft. Its angular design made it difficult for radar to detect, though it had limitations. Subsequent advancements led to aircraft like the B-2 Spirit bomber, which features smoother surfaces and radar-absorbing paint. These improvements not only enhanced stealth but also influenced designs of other military vehicles. Stealth technology extends beyond aircraft. Modern naval vessels employ angled surfaces and radar-absorbent coatings to minimize their radar signature. Submarines utilize stealth through hulls that are designed to reduce sonar detection.

Despite its advantages, the complexity and cost of stealth technology limit its availability to only a few countries. Ongoing research aims to improve effectiveness and affordability, potentially expanding its usage in future military applications. However, these advancements also raise concerns about an escalating arms race and the ethical implications of increasingly undetectable weaponry.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following are true about stealth technology EXCEPT:

A. It reduces radar reflection and emission.

B. It is used in aircraft, ships, and missiles.

C. It is affordable for many countries.

D. It frequently involves the use of radar-absorbing materials.

Q2. What does the passage indicate about the F-117 Nighthawk?

A. It was developed after the B-2 Spirit bomber.

B. It used radar-absorbing paint like the B-2 Spirit did.

C. It was the first stealth aircraft to be operational.

D. It featured advanced materials for stealth.

Q3. Why does the author mention submarines in the passage?

A. To help demonstrate that stealth technology is being used in ways that do not involve aircraft

B. To argue that stealth technology from submarines has been used in other types of naval vessels

C. To describe the differences between modern naval vessels and older naval vessels
D. To discuss ongoing research in sonar detection

Q4. The word "potentially" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. quickly
B. greatly
C. easily
D. possibly

Q5. Which of the following best describes the purpose of the third paragraph?

A. Paragraph 3 provides examples of stealth technology beyond aircraft.
B. Paragraph 3 discusses some drawbacks of advancing stealth technology.
C. Paragraph 3 argues that stealth technology should be shared among different countries.
D. Paragraph 3 explains why recent advancements in stealth technology were successful.

TPO6 - Fungi In Ecosystems

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

The Role of Fungi in Ecosystems

Fungi play a crucial role in ecosystems, often working behind the scenes to decompose organic matter and recycle nutrients. Unlike plants, fungi do not photosynthesize; instead, they obtain energy by breaking down dead plants and animals. This decomposition process is essential for nutrient cycling, as it releases vital elements like nitrogen and phosphorus back into the soil, supporting new plant growth. Their role in nutrient cycling is indispensable for healthy ecosystems.

One fascinating group of fungi is mycorrhizal fungi, which form symbiotic relationships with plant roots. These fungi extend the root system of plants, allowing them to access water and nutrients more efficiently. In return, the plants provide the fungi with carbohydrates produced through photosynthesis. This mutually beneficial relationship enhances plant growth and resilience, particularly in nutrient-poor soils.

Not all fungi are beneficial. Some pathogenic fungi cause diseases in plants and animals, leading to significant agricultural and ecological impacts. For example, the chytrid fungus has devastated amphibian populations worldwide. Understanding the diverse roles of fungi in ecosystems can help scientists develop strategies to mitigate their negative effects while leveraging their benefits for environmental sustainability.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, fungi are beneficial to plants in terms of

A. helping plants to decompose organic matter
B. making it possible for plants to photosynthesize
C. reducing the amount of nitrogen and phosphorus inside plants
D. helping plants to obtain nutrients

Q2. The word "indispensable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. similar
B. well-known
C. essential
D. useful

Q3. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as a process performed by fungi?

A. Decomposing organic matter
B. Releasing nitrogen and phosphorus into the soil

C. Forming important relationships with plant roots
D. Producing their own food

Q4. What can be inferred about the diverse roles of fungi?

A. This diversity makes fungi especially difficult for scientists to understand.
B. This diversity is considered to be important for the ongoing health of the environment.
C. This diversity will decline when harmful fungi are eliminated.
D. This diversity has been linked to the sustainability of amphibian populations.

Q5. What can be inferred about mycorrhizal fungi?

A. They compete with plants for carbohydrates.
B. They help plants absorb nutrients.
C. They decompose dead plants and animals.
D. They can cause diseases in plants.

TPO6 - Renewable Energy Sources

来源：TPO

原文（Passage）

Renewable Energy Sources

Renewable energy sources, such as solar, wind, and hydroelectric power, are increasingly gaining attention as alternatives to fossil fuels. Solar panels convert sunlight into electricity, providing a clean and abundant energy source. Wind turbines harness the power of wind, while hydroelectric plants use flowing water to generate electricity. These technologies offer significant environmental benefits, including reduced greenhouse gas emissions and decreased reliance on non-renewable resources.

However, renewable energy is not without its challenges. Solar and wind energy are intermittent, meaning they can be inconsistent depending on weather conditions. This intermittency requires the development of advanced storage solutions to ensure a steady supply of electricity. Additionally, the initial cost of installing renewable energy infrastructure can be high, although long-term savings and environmental benefits often outweigh this investment.

Recent innovations are addressing these issues. For instance, researchers are developing more efficient solar panels and energy storage systems that can store excess power generated during peak times. Wind turbines are being designed to operate in lower wind speeds, increasing their efficiency. Governments and private companies are also investing in renewable energy projects, recognizing the importance of transitioning to sustainable energy sources.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is mentioned in the passage as one environmental benefit of renewable energy sources?

A. They lower the amount of greenhouse gas produced.
B. They provide a steady supply of electricity.
C. They are easy to install.
D. They can operate in all weather conditions.

Q2. What challenge is associated with solar and wind energy?

A. High greenhouse gas emissions
B. Inconsistent energy production
C. Excessive reliance on fossil fuels
D. Limited technological development

Q3. How are researchers addressing the issue of energy intermittency?

A. By developing more efficient solar panels

B. By decreasing the cost of installation
C. By using fossil fuels as a backup
D. By limiting the use of renewable energy

Q4. The word "reliance" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. dependence
B. trust
C. use
D. production

Q5. What is the author's purpose in mentioning "recent innovations"?

A. To highlight the drawbacks of renewable energy
B. To suggest that fossil fuels are still necessary
C. To describe solutions to the challenges of renewable energy
D. To argue that the cost of renewable energy is too high

2026-06-15（12 套）

2026-06-15 Free Will Debate

原文（Passage）

Free Will and Determinism

The debate over free will asks whether our decisions come from independent thought or are shaped by factors beyond our control. Although we may feel like we choose freely, influences such as genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits suggest our freedom may be limited. The key question is whether these influences simply guide our choices or actually determine them. If they determine them, then our sense of control may be more of a story we tell ourselves after the fact than something that drives our actions.

Some philosophers maintain that even within a causally determined world, we can still act freely so long as our choices reflect our own reasoning and desires. Yet this view raises questions about whether those desires are truly ours or merely the result of prior conditions. Others push further, suggesting that even our capacity to reflect on our actions is shaped by forces beyond our control, leaving little room for genuine autonomy. These tensions are not just theoretical; they shape how we think about responsibility in law, education, and relationships. If the assumption that someone might have acted differently begins to unravel, then our notions of accountability may need to be reimagined.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main issue discussed in the passage?

A. How laws punish criminals.
B. Whether human choices are freely made or determined by prior factors.
C. Why genetics is more important than education.
D. How philosophers conduct experiments.

Q2. According to the passage, what may limit freedom?

A. Only government rules.
B. Only conscious reasoning.
C. Only education.
D. Genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits.

Q3. Why does the author mention law, education, and relationships?

A. To list unrelated fields of study.
B. To show that free will is only a legal issue.
C. To show that the debate affects practical ideas about responsibility.

D. To argue that schools should teach philosophy every day.

Q4. The word "unravel" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. fall apart.

B. gather strength.

C. form.

D. evolve.

Q5. What can be inferred about the author's view of the free-will debate?

A. It has already been completely solved.

B. It matters only to scientists.

C. It has practical consequences for how people judge responsibility.

D. It proves that choices never matter.

2026-06-15 Free Will Debate

原文（Passage）

Free Will and Determinism

The debate over free will asks whether our decisions come from independent thought or are shaped by factors beyond our control. Although we may feel like we choose freely, influences such as genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits suggest our freedom may be limited. The key question is whether these influences simply guide our choices or actually determine them. If they determine them, then our sense of control may be more of a story we tell ourselves after the fact than something that drives our actions.

Some philosophers maintain that even within a causally determined world, we can still act freely so long as our choices reflect our own reasoning and desires. Yet this view raises questions about whether those desires are truly ours or merely the result of prior conditions. Others push further, suggesting that even our capacity to reflect on our actions is shaped by forces beyond our control, leaving little room for genuine autonomy. These tensions are not just theoretical; they shape how we think about responsibility in law, education, and relationships. If the assumption that someone might have acted differently begins to unravel, then our notions of accountability may need to be reimagined.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention genetics and upbringing in paragraph 1?

A. To name the factors that contribute to the unconscious habits people form

B. To list factors we may be unaware of that shape our decision-making

C. To argue that some people have more freedom to act than others do

D. To note two factors that contribute to the formation of people's personalities

Q2. According to the passage, what may limit freedom?

A. Only government rules.

B. Only conscious reasoning.

C. Only education.

D. Genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits.

Q3. In the second paragraph, what is the relationship between sentence 1 and sentence 2?

A. Sentence 1 presents an argument, and sentence 2 restates it in simpler terms.

B. Sentence 1 makes a claim, and sentence 2 supports it with evidence.

C. Sentence 1 presents an idea, and sentence 2 challenges an assumption behind the idea.

D. Sentence 1 introduces a viewpoint, and sentence 2 considers its implications.

Q4. The word "unravel" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. fall apart.

B. gather strength.
C. form.
D. evolve.

Q5. According to the author, why is it important to consider questions about the meaning of free will?

A. Ideas about free will affect how we hold each other responsible for our actions.
B. Free will is an important part of what it means to be a modern human being.
C. The debate over free will and determinism is one of the fundamental questions of our time.
D. Without genuine autonomy, there is little value in institutions such as law and education.

2026-06-15 Linguistic Typology Study

原文（Passage）

Linguistic Structural Diversity

Linguistic typology investigates structural features across languages, revealing both universal patterns and language-specific variation. A central area of study is word order, the arrangement of subjects, verbs, and objects. English follows a subject-verb-object (SVO) pattern, while Japanese uses subject-object-verb (SOV). Most languages conform to a limited set of dominant word orders, which may reflect cognitive efficiency. Placing the subject first helps listeners quickly identify the sentence's main actor, aiding comprehension.

Beyond syntax, languages differ in morphological complexity, the degree to which inflection, such as noun or verb endings, marks grammatical relationships. Turkish uses extensive inflection to express subtle distinctions, whereas Mandarin Chinese relies more on word order and context. These contrasts suggest that languages balance morphology and syntax based on communicative needs. Highly inflected languages can afford flexible word order because grammatical roles are marked morphologically. In contrast, languages with minimal inflection often depend on fixed word order to maintain clarity.

This trade-off reflects deeper functional pressures. Languages evolve not randomly but in response to cognitive constraints and social factors, including contact with other languages and cultural shifts. Studying this evolution helps linguists understand not only how languages differ but why they follow certain structural patterns.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To argue that all languages should use the same word order.
B. To explain how typology compares structural features across languages.
C. To prove that morphology is more important than syntax.
D. To describe the history of English grammar.

Q2. The word "conform" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. follow.
B. reject.
C. invent.
D. measure.

Q3. What can be inferred about languages with minimal inflection?

A. They often need fixed word order for clarity.
B. They cannot express subtle meanings.
C. They are always easier to learn.
D. They do not change over time.

Q4. Why does the author compare Turkish and Mandarin Chinese?

A. To show that one language is older.
B. To criticize fixed word order.
C. To illustrate contrasting ways of marking grammatical relationships.
D. To describe two unrelated writing systems.

Q5. The phrase "This trade-off" refers to the relationship between

A. English and Japanese.
B. cognition and culture.
C. morphology and syntax.
D. contact and isolation.

KPO 10 - The Little Ice Age

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Little Ice Age

Following the relatively mild climate of the Medieval Warm Period, the Earth experienced a pronounced cooling phase known as the Little Ice Age, which lasted roughly from the fourteenth to the mid-nineteenth century. During this era, average global temperatures dropped significantly, particularly across the Northern Hemisphere. Researchers generally attribute this extensive climatic shift to a combination of decreased solar activity and increased volcanic eruptions, which worked together to alter the global climate system.

Historical and geological evidence suggests that prolonged periods of low solar activity, most notably the Maunder Minimum, severely reduced the amount of solar energy reaching the Earth. [A] Simultaneously, a series of massive volcanic eruptions expelled enormous quantities of ash and sulfur dioxide high into the stratosphere. [B] These volcanic aerosols formed a dense atmospheric veil that reflected incoming solar radiation back into space, further depressing global temperatures. [C]

The cascading effects of this prolonged cooling were devastating for Northern European agriculture and socio-economic structures. [D] Unpredictable weather patterns, characterized by shortened growing seasons and relentless summer rains, caused consecutive crop failures. In mountainous regions like the Alps, advancing glaciers literally swallowed entire villages and traditional farmlands. Consequently, the severe food shortages triggered widespread famine and fueled economic instability. This forced rural populations to drastically adapt their agricultural practices and shift their trade networks simply to survive the harsher, unpredictable environmental conditions.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To explain the causes and consequences of a historical climatic shift
B. To compare the Little Ice Age with the Medieval Warm Period
C. To argue that volcanic eruptions are the primary driver of global cooling
D. To describe how Northern European populations developed modern agriculture

Q2. The word "pronounced" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. noticeable
B. sudden
C. prolonged
D. unexpected

Q3. What can be inferred from the passage about the Maunder Minimum?

A. It occurred simultaneously with a sharp decrease in atmospheric sulfur dioxide.

B. It contributed to a drop in global temperatures by limiting the solar radiation Earth received.
C. It was the single most destructive weather event during the Medieval Warm Period.
D. It caused volcanic aerosols to remain trapped in the Earth's stratosphere for centuries.

Q4. Why does the author mention "advancing glaciers" in the third paragraph?

A. To argue that mountainous regions experienced the coldest temperatures during the Little Ice Age
B. To highlight a specific impact of the cooling climate on human settlements and food supply
C. To illustrate how populations successfully adapted to unpredictable environmental conditions
D. To explain the geological mechanism behind the formation of deep valleys in the Alps

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

"This combination of reduced sunlight and blocked heat resulted in unusually harsh winters across much of the globe."

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 11 - Neolithic Revolution Paradox

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Paradox of the Neolithic Revolution

The transition from foraging to agriculture, known as the Neolithic Revolution, is widely considered a monumental leap in human history. [A] However, skeletal remains from early agricultural communities reveal a surprising paradox. [B] Bioarchaeologists have found that compared to their hunter-gatherer predecessors, early farmers suffered from a notable decline in overall health. [C] Their bones show widespread evidence of nutritional deficiencies, stunted growth, and an increased incidence of infectious diseases. [D] This deterioration was largely due to a heavy reliance on a single starch-heavy crop, which provided ample calories but lacked essential nutrients.

Despite these physiological setbacks, agriculture provided a crucial evolutionary advantage: a predictable food surplus. This surplus allowed early farming societies to support significantly larger populations than nomadic groups could sustain. With an abundance of stored calories, women in agricultural communities could have children more frequently, leading to rapid demographic expansion. Furthermore, because not everyone was required to participate in food production, surplus resources catalyzed the development of specialized labor. Artisans, merchants, and administrators emerged, eventually paving the way for complex social stratification and the rise of the first urban civilizations. Ultimately, while agriculture exacted a heavy toll on the health of early farmers, it established the structural foundation for modern human societies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To explain how the shift to agriculture negatively affected individual health but enabled societal growth
B. To argue that hunter-gatherer societies were culturally more advanced than early agricultural communities
C. To describe the scientific methods bioarchaeologists use to analyze the skeletal remains of ancient farmers
D. To compare the nutritional value of various crops cultivated during the Neolithic Revolution

Q2. The word "catalyzed" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. stimulated
B. justified
C. delayed
D. replaced

Q3. What can be inferred from paragraph 2 about nomadic hunter-gatherer groups?

A. They lacked the stored food necessary to support rapid population growth.
B. They experienced frequent internal conflicts over surplus agricultural resources.
C. They possessed complex social stratification prior to the Neolithic Revolution.
D. They were entirely immune to the infectious diseases that affected farmers.

Q4. Why does the author mention "Artisans, merchants, and administrators"?

A. To provide examples of the specialized labor that resulted from agricultural surplus
B. To identify the groups that suffered the most from nutritional deficiencies
C. To illustrate the types of leaders who historically organized early nomadic groups
D. To argue that early cities were established primarily by wealthy individuals

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], and [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

****Instead of improving human health, farming initially had the opposite effect.****

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 12 - Infantile Amnesia Enigma

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Enigma of Infantile Amnesia

Most adults experience a profound inability to consciously recall events from the first three to four years of their lives, a phenomenon psychologists term infantile amnesia. For decades, researchers have debated the underlying causes of this memory gap. One prominent biological explanation focuses on the delayed maturation of the hippocampus, a brain structure essential for forming and storing episodic memories. During infancy, the brain is rapidly generating new neurons in this region. While this high rate of neurogenesis is crucial for early learning, researchers believe it disrupts existing neural circuits. Consequently, memories formed during this period are overwritten or rendered inaccessible before the infant's brain can securely consolidate them into long-term storage.

However, biological immaturity alone does not fully explain the complexities of early memory loss. A competing psychological framework, the linguistic theory, argues that the retention of autobiographical memories relies heavily on language acquisition. [A] According to this view, early experiences are encoded as nonverbal sensory impressions. [B] Because toddlers lack the vocabulary to narrate their experiences, they cannot mentally structure these events into cohesive, retrievable stories. [C] Once a child develops sufficient linguistic skills—typically around age three—they begin to frame memories within a verbal context. [D] As language becomes the primary vehicle for human thought, the earlier, nonverbal memories become incompatible with the older child's language-dependent memory system, making them virtually impossible to retrieve later in life.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, how does the rapid generation of new neurons affect memory in infants?

A. It interferes with existing neural circuits and prevents long-term storage.
B. It permanently damages the hippocampus and delays its maturation.
C. It allows infants to store episodic memories more securely than adults.
D. It speeds up the brain's ability to recall nonverbal sensory impressions.

Q2. The word "prominent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. leading
B. surprising
C. controversial
D. outdated

Q3. What can be inferred from paragraph 2 about the autobiographical memories of an adult?

A. They are primarily stored in a format that relies on language.
B. They are identical in structure to the sensory impressions of infants.
C. They are mostly formed before the development of advanced vocabulary.
D. They remain completely unaffected by the loss of early neural circuits.

Q4. Why does the author mention that "early experiences are encoded as nonverbal sensory impressions"?

A. To establish the foundation for why toddlers struggle to mentally organize early events into retrievable stories.
B. To challenge the biological theory that the hippocampus is responsible for memory storage.
C. To argue that toddlers actually possess a better memory for physical sensations than older children do.
D. To highlight the specific age at which a child's brain stops relying on physical interactions with the world.

Q5. In paragraph 2, there are four choices marked with letters. Where would the following sentence best fit?

Without this narrative framework, isolated sensory details quickly fade from the mind.

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 4 - The Core Accretion Model

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Core Accretion Model

In the study of planetary formation, the core accretion model is the most widely accepted mechanism for explaining how our solar system developed from a swirling disk of gas and dust known as the solar nebula. A crucial concept in this model is the "frost line," a boundary determined by distance from the young star where temperatures drop low enough for hydrogen compounds, such as water, to condense into solid ice grains. Inside the frost line, only metal and rock can remain solid. Because these materials are relatively scarce, the inner planets—Mercury, Venus, Earth, and Mars—could only grow into small, rocky terrestrial worlds.

[A] Beyond the frost line, however, the conditions for planetary growth are profoundly different. [B] The abundance of ice allows solid planetesimals to accumulate mass much more rapidly. [C] Once a planetary embryo reaches about ten times the mass of Earth, its gravity becomes strong enough to capture large amounts of hydrogen and helium directly from the solar nebula. [D] This rapid accumulation of gas leads to the formation of massive gas giants like Jupiter and Saturn.

Recent observations of exoplanets—planets orbiting other stars—have provided substantial evidence for the core accretion model, though they have also introduced new complexities. For instance, astronomers have discovered "hot Jupiters," immense gas giants orbiting extremely close to their host stars. Since gas giants cannot form inside the frost line, scientists infer that these planets must have formed farther out and subsequently migrated inward over millions of years.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, why did the inner planets remain small and rocky?

A. They were unable to attract any hydrogen and helium from the solar nebula.
B. The metals and rocks available to form them were relatively rare.
C. The temperatures inside the frost line melted all available ice grains.
D. They migrated inward toward the star over millions of years.

Q2. The word "scarce" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rare
B. complex
C. dense
D. valuable

Q3. What can be inferred from the passage about hydrogen and helium in the early solar nebula?

A. They were the only materials present inside the frost line.
B. They condensed into solid ice grains beyond the frost line.
C. They could only be captured by planets with a certain amount of mass.
D. They formed the solid cores of the gas giant planets.

Q4. Why does the author mention "hot Jupiters" in the final paragraph?

A. To suggest that the core accretion model is entirely incorrect.
B. To explain how terrestrial planets could eventually become gas giants.
C. To provide an example of a planetary phenomenon that requires an additional explanation beyond simple formation.
D. To identify the specific type of exoplanet most commonly found beyond the frost line.

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], and [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

This early advantage allows these distant cores to grow to enormous sizes.

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 5 - Forest Mycorrhizal Networks

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Mycorrhizal Networks in Forest Ecosystems

Traditionally, ecologists viewed forest ecosystems primarily through the lens of competition, assuming that trees battled one another for limited resources like sunlight, water, and soil nutrients. However, recent discoveries have revealed a hidden, cooperative dynamic beneath the forest floor: mycorrhizal networks. These extensive networks are formed by symbiotic fungi that colonize the roots of most plant species. In this mutualistic relationship, trees provide the fungi with energy-rich carbohydrates produced through photosynthesis. In return, the fungal mycelium—a vast, branching web of microscopic threads—scavenges the soil for water and essential minerals, such as phosphorus and nitrogen, delivering them back to the host trees. Without this fungal partnership, many tree species would struggle to survive in nutrient-poor soils.

The remarkable extent of this cooperation was demonstrated when researchers introduced carbon isotopes into individual trees to track nutrient flow. [A] They discovered that these chemical markers did not remain confined to the original host. [B] For instance, older "hub trees" with extensive root systems were observed channeling surplus carbon to younger seedlings growing in heavily shaded areas, significantly boosting their survival rates. [C] By ensuring the health of vulnerable saplings, the network enhances the resilience of the entire forest. [D] This profound interconnectedness suggests that forests operate less like collections of isolated, competing individuals and more like highly integrated biological communities.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To describe how mycorrhizal networks facilitate cooperative resource sharing among trees
B. To argue that traditional ecological models of forest competition are completely inaccurate
C. To explain the biochemical process by which trees produce energy-rich carbohydrates
D. To compare the nutrient needs of older hub trees with those of younger seedlings

Q2. The word "confined" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. restricted
B. connected
C. exposed
D. harmful

Q3. What can be inferred from the passage about the "younger seedlings growing in heavily shaded areas"?

A. They are unable to produce sufficient carbohydrates on their own due to a lack of sunlight.
B. They primarily supply water and minerals to older hub trees in exchange for carbon.
C. They require fewer nutrients to survive than seedlings growing in direct sunlight.
D. They act as the primary producers of energy-rich carbohydrates for the fungal network.

Q4. Why does the author mention "carbon isotopes" in the passage?

A. To provide evidence that nutrients are transferred between different trees
B. To explain how fungi extract phosphorus and nitrogen from the soil
C. To describe a harmful chemical that disrupts mycorrhizal networks
D. To illustrate the process of photosynthesis in older hub trees

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

****Instead, the isotopes traveled through the underground network to neighboring trees, including those of entirely different species.****

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 6 - Deciphering Linear B

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Decipherment of Linear B

The discovery of clay tablets inscribed with a mysterious script, later known as Linear B, at Mycenaean archaeological sites fundamentally challenged historians' understanding of the ancient Aegean. [A] For decades, scholars assumed these Bronze Age texts represented an unknown language completely unrelated to Greek. [B] This linguistic isolation made the inscriptions seem impossible to read. [C] Fortunately, an innovative analytical approach applied in the mid-twentieth century finally began to unlock their secrets. [D]

The breakthrough came through the meticulous application of a grid methodology by Michael Ventris. Rather than guessing the meanings of individual symbols, Ventris created a statistical grid that mapped the frequency and phonetic relationships of the characters. By organizing the signs into a matrix based on shared vowels and consonants, he deduced that the script was actually a syllabary—a system where each symbol represents a syllable rather than a single letter.

When the phonetic values were finally plugged into the grid, the resulting words were unequivocally an archaic form of Greek. This revelation had profound implications for the historical timeline. It proved that Greek-speaking populations were present in the Aegean centuries earlier than previously believed, effectively pushing back the dawn of Greek civilization into the second millennium BCE and transforming our comprehension of ancient Mediterranean history.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, what did scholars originally believe about the Linear B tablets?

A. They were written in a language that had no connection to Greek.
B. They were brought to Mycenaean sites by Greek-speaking populations.
C. They were created in the mid-twentieth century as a historical hoax.
D. They contained an advanced alphabet used throughout the ancient Aegean.

Q2. The word "deduced" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. concluded

B. predicted
C. denied
D. ignored

Q3. What can be inferred from the passage about the Greek language?

A. It was spoken in the Aegean region during the Bronze Age.
B. It was heavily influenced by an older, unknown language.
C. It was initially written using a system where each symbol represented a single letter.
D. It evolved primarily from languages outside the Mediterranean region.

Q4. Why does the author mention that each symbol represents a "syllable rather than a single letter"?

A. To clarify the specific nature of a syllabary.
B. To explain why Linear B was so difficult to translate into English.
C. To compare the Linear B script with modern Greek alphabets.
D. To argue that grid methodology can only be used on simple writing systems.

Q5. Look at the four squares that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

"This false assumption led early researchers to look for linguistic connections in entirely the wrong places."

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 7 - Convergent Evolution of Echolocation

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Convergent Evolution of Echolocation

Echolocation is a biological sonar used by certain animals to navigate and forage in environments where vision is ineffective. [A] The development of this ability in both bats and toothed whales is one of the most notable examples of convergent evolution—a process where unrelated organisms independently evolve similar traits. [B] Although their last common ancestor was a terrestrial mammal that lacked this ability, both groups eventually evolved to emit high-frequency sound waves and interpret the returning echoes. [C]

Despite sharing the same basic acoustic principles, the physical demands of their respective environments required different biological adaptations. [D] Because sound travels faster and farther in water than in air, toothed whales process echoes much more quickly. They generate clicks using specialized tissues near their blowholes and focus these sounds through a fat-filled organ in their foreheads called the melon. Bats, facing the rapid attenuation of high-frequency sound in the air, rely on intricate vocal cord modifications and highly sensitive ears. Yet, even with these physical differences tailored to distinct mediums, their sensory processing mechanisms are fundamentally alike.

Recent research indicates that this convergent evolution extends deep into their DNA. Biologists have discovered that bats and toothed whales share identical mutations in *prestin*, a gene that encodes a protein crucial for high-frequency hearing. This molecular evidence demonstrates that

natural selection can push completely different species toward the exact same genetic solutions when faced with similar environmental challenges.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To argue that bats and whales share a recent common ancestor.

B. To explain how convergent evolution resulted in similar echolocation systems in bats and whales.

C. To contrast the habitats of toothed whales and bats to show why their diets differ.

D. To describe the role of a specific gene in the embryonic development of mammals.

Q2. The word "intricate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. hidden

B. temporary

C. complex

D. powerful

Q3. What can be inferred from paragraph 2 about the echoes received by toothed whales compared to those received by bats?

A. They require larger ear structures to be detected properly.

B. They travel a much shorter distance before dying out.

C. They return to the animal with a shorter time delay.

D. They are generated primarily by vocal cord modifications.

Q4. Why does the author mention the "melon" in the second paragraph?

A. To demonstrate how genetic mutations alter the physical appearance of whales.

B. To explain why sound travels faster in water than in air.

C. To highlight an anatomical feature that bats and whales share.

D. To provide an example of a specialized physical adaptation for aquatic echolocation.

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

****By timing how long it takes for these sound waves to bounce back, these animals can pinpoint the location of prey.****

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]

B. [B]

C. [C]

D. [D]

KPO 8 - The Messinian Salinity Crisis

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Messinian Salinity Crisis

Around 5.96 million years ago, the Mediterranean Sea became effectively disconnected from the world's oceans, triggering an event known as the Messinian Salinity Crisis. Tectonic movements shifted the African and Eurasian plates, gradually closing the narrow strait connecting the Mediterranean to the Atlantic Ocean. Because the Mediterranean region experiences high evaporation rates and receives limited freshwater runoff from rivers, the sea level dropped drastically once this vital connection was severed. [A] Over hundreds of thousands of years, the

basin largely desiccated, leaving behind a profound geological anomaly: massive deposits of evaporites, primarily rock salt and gypsum, accumulating up to three kilometers thick in some areas. [B]

The discovery of these extensive salt layers beneath the Mediterranean seafloor provided the first concrete evidence of the crisis. [C] Core samples revealed terrestrial fossils and deeply incised river canyons, indicating that large portions of the sea floor were exposed as dry land. The extreme salinity devastated marine ecosystems, rendering the Mediterranean uninhabitable for most marine life. However, this period of isolation was geologically brief. About 5.33 million years ago, a catastrophic event called the Zanclean flood breached the barrier at the Strait of Gibraltar. [D] Ocean water rushed back into the basin, refilling the Mediterranean in what scientists believe may have taken only a few months to a couple of years, permanently ending the salinity crisis and restoring its marine environment.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, what caused the Mediterranean Sea level to drop drastically?

A. Tectonic shifts that closed its connection to the Atlantic Ocean combined with high evaporation.

B. The accumulation of massive salt deposits over hundreds of thousands of years.

C. An unprecedented increase in freshwater runoff from surrounding rivers.

D. The sudden occurrence of a catastrophic flood at the Strait of Gibraltar.

Q2. The word "desiccated" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. dried out

B. expanded

C. heated up

D. collapsed

Q3. What can be inferred from paragraph 2 about the rivers flowing into the Mediterranean basin during the Messinian Salinity Crisis?

A. They carved deeper channels than they had previously because the sea level was dramatically lower.

B. They supplied enough freshwater to support isolated marine ecosystems.

C. They were entirely blocked by the accumulation of salt and gypsum deposits.

D. They reversed their flow into the Atlantic Ocean instead of the Mediterranean.

Q4. Why does the author mention "deeply incised river canyons" in the passage?

A. To provide evidence that much of the Mediterranean seafloor was exposed as dry land.

B. To explain how thick layers of salt and gypsum were transported into the basin.

C. To illustrate the destructive power of the Zanclean flood.

D. To describe the main geographic features surrounding the Strait of Gibraltar.

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

Without the continuous inflow of Atlantic waters to replenish it, the sea simply could not sustain its volume.

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]

B. [B]

C. [C]

D. [D]

KPO 9 - The Roman Architectural Revolution

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Roman Architectural Revolution

Prior to the Roman Empire, monumental architecture was largely defined by the post-and-lintel system, in which horizontal beams were supported by vertical columns. While effective, this method strictly limited the amount of open interior space that could be created, as stone beams would snap under their own weight if stretched too far. The Romans revolutionized building practices by fully exploiting the structural advantages of the arch and combining it with a highly durable new material: Roman concrete.

Unlike modern concrete, the Roman mixture relied on pozzolana, a volcanic ash. When combined with lime and rubble, pozzolana triggered a chemical reaction that allowed the material to harden even underwater. [A] This extraordinary property facilitated the construction of harbor structures and bridge foundations in deep rivers. [B] Furthermore, Roman concrete was incredibly adaptable. [C] When poured into wooden molds shaped like arches or vaults, it dried into a rigid, unified mass. [D] This solid structure distributed weight outward and downward, eliminating the need for internal columns.

The synergy of the arch and pozzolana concrete liberated Roman architects from earlier structural constraints. They engineered sprawling aqueducts that carried fresh water across miles of uneven terrain by stacking arches atop one another. Additionally, they constructed vast, uninterrupted interior spaces, most notably the Pantheon. Its massive dome, spanning over 140 feet without a single supporting pillar, remains a testament to the enduring strength of Roman engineering.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To explain how the invention of Roman concrete and the arch transformed architectural capabilities

B. To compare the aesthetic differences between early post-and-lintel buildings and Roman domes

C. To argue that pozzolana ash was the most valuable natural resource in the ancient Roman Empire

D. To describe the chemical process by which ancient Roman buildings are preserved today

Q2. The word "facilitated" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. enabled

B. delayed

C. replaced

D. supervised

Q3. What can be inferred from paragraph 1 about the post-and-lintel system?

A. It was frequently used to construct vast, unsupported interior spaces in early Roman structures.

B. It prevented builders from creating wide interior rooms due to the inherent weakness of horizontal beams.

C. It was primarily utilized for bridges and harbors where columns were unnecessary.

D. It relied on a combination of volcanic ash and carved stone to support immensely heavy weights.

Q4. Why does the author mention "the Pantheon" in paragraph 3?

A. To provide an example of a structure that was built primarily over a deep river
B. To contrast the design of religious buildings with that of practical structures like aqueducts
C. To illustrate the impressive interior scale made possible by Roman architectural innovations
D. To suggest that Roman engineers initially struggled to build massive domes without supporting pillars

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], and [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

Builders could form the material into virtually any structural design they required.

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-13（4 套）

2026-06-13 Carthage Maritime Trade

原文（Passage）

Carthage's Trade Network

Carthage, founded by Phoenician merchants around 814 B.C.E., became a powerful city-state due to its strategic location on the Mediterranean. This position allowed Carthage to establish a vast trade network that extended across the Mediterranean and into Africa, Europe, and Asia. Carthaginian traders dealt in goods such as silver, gold, tin, and textiles. The Carthaginians excelled in maritime technology, constructing advanced ships for long-distance journeys and bulky cargo transport. They developed efficient trade routes and set up colonies, expanding their economic reach. Their prowess in navigation and trade transformed Carthage into one of the wealthiest cities in the ancient world.

Carthage's wealth was also built on innovations in agriculture. Carthaginian farmers employed advanced irrigation techniques and crop rotation, leading to abundant harvests that supported both local consumption and export.

However, Carthage's rise did not come without challenges. Its growing wealth and dominance in trade led to rivalry with Rome. The Punic Wars, a series of three wars fought against Rome from 264 to 146 B.C.E., were rooted in competition for control of Mediterranean trade routes. Despite initial successes, Carthage was ultimately defeated. The final blow came when the Romans launched a brutal siege on Carthage, culminating in the city's destruction.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following contributed to the status of Carthage as a wealthy and powerful city-state EXCEPT

A. its geographic position.
B. its trade network across three continents.
C. its large fishing industry.
D. its ship-building technology.

Q2. The passage indicates which of the following about Carthage's maritime technology?

A. Carthage's ships were designed primarily for small items of high value.
B. Carthage's ships were not as advanced as Roman ships.
C. Carthaginians developed a system of switching ships at colonial ports.

D. Carthaginians were skilled at navigating over long distances.

Q3. What can be concluded from the passage about Carthaginian agriculture?

A. It was far inferior to Carthaginian maritime technology.

B. It produced more than enough food to feed the Carthaginians.

C. Its innovations borrowed much from Roman technical knowledge.

D. It was transformed by farmers from Africa, Europe, and Asia.

Q4. What can be inferred about the consequences of Carthage's success?

A. It led to mutually beneficial relations with Rome.

B. It caused internal strife among Carthaginian traders.

C. It led to a neglect of the military.

D. It contributed to external conflicts.

Q5. The phrase "culminating in" in the final sentence is closest in meaning to

A. revealing.

B. ending with.

C. coinciding with.

D. following.

2026-06-13 Coastal Erosion Solutions

原文（Passage）

Coastal Erosion Challenges

Coastal erosion poses a significant threat to communities, ecosystems, and infrastructure along shorelines. [A] Rising sea levels, stronger storm surges, and human activities such as construction and deforestation can make vulnerable areas even more exposed. Engineers and environmental scientists therefore look for innovative solutions that can protect the land while preserving natural coastal systems.

One popular method is beach nourishment, which involves adding sand to eroding beaches. [B] This approach helps beaches absorb wave energy, but it can be expensive and must be repeated regularly. Other structural interventions include seawalls and groynes. Seawalls are constructed parallel to the shore to protect the land from wave impact, while groynes are built perpendicular to the shoreline to trap sand and slow erosion. [D]

Apart from structural interventions, ecological solutions are also increasingly important. Wetlands, dunes, and mangrove forests can stabilize the coast and absorb wave energy while supporting wildlife. [C]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "vulnerable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. certain.

B. at-risk.

C. affected.

D. exposed.

Q2. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that explains why coastal erosion is becoming worse.

A. Coastal erosion poses a significant threat to communities, ecosystems, and infrastructure along shorelines.

B. Rising sea levels, stronger storm surges, and human activities such as construction and deforestation can make vulnerable areas even more exposed.

C. Engineers and environmental scientists therefore look for innovative solutions.

D. These solutions can protect the land while preserving natural coastal systems.

Q3. According to the passage, all of the following are true about beach nourishment EXCEPT:

A. It adds sand to eroding beaches.
B. It is expensive and needs to be maintained on a regular basis.
C. It helps beaches to combat waves.
D. It involves the installation of groynes.

Q4. According to the passage, why are wetlands, dunes, and mangrove forests useful?

A. They replace all structural coastal interventions.
B. They stabilize the coast and absorb wave energy.
C. They increase construction along shorelines.
D. They prevent all erosion permanently.

Q5. Insert Text: They also contribute to climate resilience by mitigating the impacts of sea-level rise and storm surges. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After the first sentence of paragraph 1.
B. After the sentence about beach nourishment.
C. After the sentence about wetlands, dunes, and mangrove forests.
D. At the end of paragraph 2.

2026-06-13 Ecological Systems Theory

原文（Passage）

Understanding Ecological Systems Theory

Ecological Systems Theory, introduced by Urie Bronfenbrenner, revolutionized our perception of human psychological development. [A] It posits that individuals are shaped by interactions among multiple overlapping environmental systems. [B] This theory reshaped developmental research, offering a multifaceted lens that surpasses earlier, linear models. [C] By considering the dynamic interplay between a person and their environment, it highlights the multifactorial nature of psychological growth. [D]

The theory delineates several environmental layers, beginning with the microsystem, which refers to the institutions and groups that most directly impact the child's development, such as family and school. The mesosystem encompasses the relationships among the microsystems, such as the impact of a teacher's communication with parents on a child's education. Beyond these, the exosystem consists of indirect influences like a parent's workplace stress subtly affecting the home environment. The macrosystem, encompassing broader cultural and societal contexts, frames these interactions with underlying norms and policies.

While Bronfenbrenner's model offers an intricate framework, it is not without critique. Some argue that the model underestimates the role of technology, which has created virtual microsystems that transcend geographical limits. Despite these critiques, the theory remains influential in fields ranging from education to public policy, prompting continuous exploration of its applications and adaptations.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention a teacher's communication with parents in paragraph 2?

A. To illustrate the interactions among microsystems that characterize the mesosystem
B. To support the claim that the institutions of the microsystem affect children directly
C. To show that Bronfenbrenner's theory is primarily linear
D. To suggest that microsystems are more important than the mesosystem

Q2. The phrase "subtly affecting" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. affecting in harmless but unpredictable ways
B. affecting in long-lasting ways
C. affecting in ways both positive and negative

D. affecting in small, barely noticeable ways

Q3. The passage suggests that criticisms of Bronfenbrenner's model call for which of the following?

A. Its replacement with a less intricate framework

B. Its modification to include virtual interactions

C. Its replacement with a model that gives greater consideration to geographical boundaries

D. Its exclusion from fields such as education and public policy

Q4. Which of the following best describes the influence of Ecological Systems Theory?

A. It has had little impact on psychology but has unexpectedly affected other fields.

B. It revolutionized the field of human psychology but is not taken seriously in other fields.

C. It changed the way human psychology is understood and continues to influence other fields.

D. It has gone mostly unnoticed among psychologists and has had little impact on other fields.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage marked [A], [B], [C], and [D]. Where could the sentence "Each one plays a distinct role in shaping behavior" best be added?

A. [A]

B. [B]

C. [C]

D. [D]

2026-06-13 Roman Political Legacy

原文（Passage）

The Political Legacy of the Roman Empire

The political legacy of the Roman Empire has shaped later governments in Europe and beyond. Roman ideas about citizenship, written law, public administration, and representative institutions continued to influence societies long after the empire declined.

One of Rome's most important contributions was the idea that laws should be written, publicly known, and applied to citizens through recognizable procedures. Later legal systems adapted this principle to create codes, courts, and civic rights. Roman administration also left a model for organizing large territories through roads, provincial officials, taxation, and communication networks.

However, the Roman legacy was not copied without change. Later societies selected the parts that served their own needs. Some emphasized republican traditions and civic duty, while others drew on imperial symbols to justify centralized authority. For that reason, Rome's political influence is best understood as a flexible set of ideas rather than a single fixed system.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main idea of the passage?

A. Roman art was more influential than Roman law.

B. The Roman Empire declined because its laws were weak.

C. Roman roads were the empire's only lasting achievement.

D. Roman political ideas continued to influence later governments.

Q2. Why does the author mention written laws?

A. To show that Rome had no courts.

B. To contrast Roman law with modern law.

C. To identify a principle later legal systems adapted.

D. To argue that only citizens could read laws.

Q3. What does the passage suggest about Roman administration?

A. It provided a model for governing large territories.

B. It prevented all local conflicts.
C. It depended entirely on elected officials.
D. It ended as soon as the empire declined.

Q4. The word flexible in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. fragile
B. adaptable
C. ancient
D. official

Q5. What can be inferred about later societies' use of Roman ideas?

A. They chose and reshaped Roman ideas for their own purposes.
B. They rejected every Roman political idea.
C. They preserved Roman government exactly as it was.
D. They used only Roman military practices.

2026-06-10（4 套）

2026-06-10 Building Data Science

原文（Passage）

Data Science and the Buildings of Tomorrow

Once static structures, buildings increasingly function as dynamic systems thanks to applications of data science to the built environment. Building data science uses sensors and Internet of Things (IoT) devices, such as smart thermostats, to collect and interpret data from buildings. This approach enables architects and planners to make informed decisions throughout a building's design, operation, and renovation phases.

Sensors embedded in modern buildings track variables such as energy consumption, temperature, air quality, and occupancy patterns. These insights help optimize energy use, reduce operational costs, and enhance comfort. Smart HVAC (heating, ventilation, and air-conditioning) systems can adjust airflow based on real-time occupancy, improving efficiency. Monitoring space usage may conflict, however, with occupants' privacy concerns and dislike of being tracked without their consent.

Despite high initial costs, building data science offers long-term benefits. Studies show that buildings using these systems can reduce energy consumption by up to 30 percent, making them attractive for sustainable development. As urban populations grow, building data science will be key to creating adaptable spaces. A skyscraper that adjusts its internal climate based on external weather conditions exemplifies this potential. Other applications include optimizing the layouts of hospitals for better patient flow or using occupancy data to redesign underutilized office spaces.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "static" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. impractical
B. unchanging
C. wasteful
D. simple

Q2. The passage indicates all of the following about building data science EXCEPT:

A. It uses data collected from Internet of Things devices.
B. It requires special training in data analysis for architects who use it.
C. It has an impact on how architects design new buildings.
D. It can be used as a basis for decisions about a building's operations.

Q3. According to the passage, what is one drawback of the use of sensors?

A. Sensors lead to greater energy use.
B. Sensors are known for supplying inaccurate data.
C. The data collected is frequently hard to interpret.
D. Some building occupants may not approve of their use.

Q4. Why does the author mention "hospitals" and "office spaces"?

A. To give examples of city structures that are often poorly designed
B. To demonstrate how building data science can improve urban infrastructure
C. To show the limitations of building data science
D. To contradict the claim that building data science will be key to creating adaptable spaces

Q5. Based on the passage, building data science can help most with which of the following?

A. Increasing a building's office space
B. Limiting a building's construction costs
C. Reducing a building's environmental impact
D. Enhancing a building's visual appeal

2026-06-10 Dark Galaxy Mysteries

原文（Passage）

The Mystery of Dark Galaxies

Ultraviolet (UV) astronomy has unveiled numerous cosmic phenomena. An especially intriguing discovery is that of dark galaxies. Unlike typical galaxies, which are gravitationally bound systems of stars, gas, and other particles, dark galaxies emit little to no visible light, making them nearly impossible to detect using conventional optical telescopes. However, these galaxies emit UV radiation, providing astronomers with a unique window to study them. [A] Dark galaxies challenge our understanding of galaxy formation. [B] Traditional models suggest that galaxies form through gas accumulation and star formation. [C] But although dark galaxies contain vast amounts of gas, they have few, if any, stars. [D] This raises questions about the processes that inhibit star formation. Some researchers propose that turbulence within the gas clouds might prevent the gas from collapsing to form stars.

Observations from the Hubble Space Telescope and other UV-sensitive instruments have revealed that dark galaxies were more common in the early universe. These findings suggest that dark galaxies may represent a primordial phase in galaxy evolution. One hypothesis is that high levels of UV radiation in the early universe prevented the gas in dark galaxies from cooling and condensing into stars. Observations of regions with high UV radiation support this theory.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that astronomers discovered dark galaxies by

A. studying numerous cosmic phenomena caused by them
B. observing their gravitational effects on other galaxies
C. seeing them through conventional optical telescopes
D. detecting UV radiation emitted by them

Q2. What might prevent the formation of stars in dark galaxies?

A. The accumulation of too much gas
B. The turbulence inside gas clouds
C. The presence of nearby galaxies
D. The collapse of gas clouds

Q3. Observations from the Hubble Space Telescope and other UV-sensitive instruments indicate that

A. the number of dark galaxies in the universe increased over time
B. dark galaxies contain more gas than previously believed
C. dark galaxies emit more UV radiation than previously believed
D. dark galaxies represent an early stage in galaxy development

Q4. Observations of dark-galaxy regions with high UV radiation indicate that

A. dark galaxies evolved very slowly
B. stars in the early universe were fairly cool and dense
C. UV radiation in the early universe kept gas temperatures high
D. a traditional theory of how dark galaxies formed is incorrect

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: Therefore, one might expect all galaxies to have a significant number of stars. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-10 Free Will Debate

原文（Passage）

Free Will and Determinism

The debate over free will asks whether our decisions come from independent thought or are shaped by factors beyond our control. Although we may feel like we choose freely, influences such as genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits suggest our freedom may be limited. The key question is whether these influences simply guide our choices or actually determine them. If they determine them, then our sense of control may be more of a story we tell ourselves after the fact than something that drives our actions.

Some philosophers maintain that even within a causally determined world, we can still act freely, so long as our choices reflect our own reasoning and desires. Yet this view raises questions about whether those desires are truly ours or merely the result of prior conditions. Others push further, suggesting that even our capacity to reflect on our actions is shaped by forces beyond our control, leaving little room for genuine autonomy.

These debates matter because ideas about free will shape how we think about responsibility in law, education, and relationships. If the assumption that someone might have acted differently begins to unravel, then our notions of praise, blame, and punishment may also need to evolve.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention genetics and upbringing in paragraph 1?

A. To suggest that biology and family background are the only real causes of habits.
B. To name the factors that contribute to the unconscious habits people form.
C. To list factors we may be unaware of that shape our decision-making.
D. To argue that some people have more freedom to act than others do.

Q2. What does the author suggest may be true of "our sense of control" over our choices?

A. It can drive our actions if we train ourselves to think independently.
B. It helps us develop narratives that shape our choices.
C. It is the product of unconscious habits.
D. It may be nothing more than an illusion.

Q3. In the second paragraph, what is the relationship between sentence 1 and sentence 2?

A. Sentence 1 presents an argument, and sentence 2 restates it in simpler terms.

B. Sentence 1 makes a claim, and sentence 2 supports it with evidence.
C. Sentence 1 presents an idea, and sentence 2 challenges an assumption behind the idea.
D. Sentence 1 introduces a viewpoint, and sentence 2 considers its historical background.

Q4. The word "unravel" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. fall apart
B. gather strength
C. form
D. evolve

Q5. According to the author, why is it important to consider questions about the meaning of free will?

A. Ideas about free will affect how we hold each other responsible for our actions.
B. Free will is an important part of what it means to be a modern human being.
C. The debate over free will and determinism is one of the fundamental questions of our time.
D. Without genuine autonomy, there is little value in institutions such as law and education.

2026-06-10 Linguistic Structural Diversity

原文（Passage）

Linguistic Structural Diversity

Linguistic typology investigates structural features across languages, revealing both universal patterns and language-specific variation. A central area of study is word order--the arrangement of subjects, verbs, and objects. English follows a subject-verb-object (SVO) pattern, while Japanese uses subject-object-verb (SOV). Most languages conform to a limited set of dominant word orders, which may reflect cognitive efficiency: Placing the subject first helps listeners quickly identify the sentence's main actor, aiding comprehension.

Beyond syntax, languages differ in morphological complexity--the degree to which inflection (such as noun or verb endings) marks grammatical relationships. Turkish uses extensive inflection to express subtle distinctions, whereas Mandarin Chinese relies more on word order and context. These contrasts suggest that languages balance morphology and syntax based on communicative needs. Highly inflected languages can afford flexible word order because grammatical roles are marked morphologically. In contrast, languages with minimal inflection often depend on fixed word order to maintain clarity.

[A] This trade-off reflects deeper functional pressures. [B] Languages evolve not randomly but in response to cognitive constraints and social factors, including contact with other languages and cultural shifts. [C] Studying this evolution helps linguists understand not only how languages differ but why certain grammatical strategies emerge and persist across communities. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as an aspect of the study of linguistic typology?

A. It has revealed both diversity and universality among structural linguistic features.
B. It includes the study of word order as a means of aiding comprehension.
C. It identifies three basic structural patterns across all languages.
D. It examines differences in morphological complexity among languages.

Q2. Why does the author note that placing the subject first in a sentence aids comprehension?

A. To provide an example of a structural feature that follows a universal pattern
B. To suggest that a larger set of available word orders increases cognitive efficiency
C. To help explain why there is only a small set of dominant word orders across languages
D. To suggest that languages that follow a different pattern are harder to learn

Q3. What is suggested about the morphological complexity of Turkish?

A. It is greater than the morphological complexity of Mandarin Chinese.

B. It is balanced by a relatively simple inflection system.

C. It developed independently of other elements of Turkish.

D. It requires Turkish to adhere to a relatively rigid word order.

Q4. The word "pressures" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. difficulties

B. conflicts

C. features

D. influences

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Such changes can alter the communicative priorities of a speech community, affecting which features are emphasized or simplified over time. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "This trade-off reflects deeper functional pressures."

B. After "This trade-off reflects deeper functional pressures."

C. After "Languages evolve not randomly but in response to cognitive constraints and social factors, including contact with other languages and cultural shifts."

D. After "Studying this evolution helps linguists understand not only how languages differ but why certain grammatical strategies emerge and persist across communities."

2026-06-07（7 套）

2026-06-07 Dark Galaxy Mysteries

原文（Passage）

The Mystery of Dark Galaxies

Ultraviolet (UV) astronomy has unveiled numerous cosmic phenomena. An especially intriguing discovery is that of dark galaxies. Unlike typical galaxies (gravitationally bound systems of stars, gas, and other particles), dark galaxies emit little to no visible light, making them nearly impossible to detect using conventional optical telescopes. However, these galaxies emit UV radiation, providing astronomers with a unique window to study them. [A] Dark galaxies challenge our understanding of galaxy formation. [B] Traditional models suggest that galaxies form through gas accumulation and star formation. [C] But although dark galaxies contain vast amounts of gas, they have few, if any, stars. [D] This raises questions about the processes that inhibit star formation. Some researchers propose that turbulence within the gas clouds might prevent the gas from collapsing to form stars.

Observations from the Hubble Space Telescope and other UV-sensitive instruments have revealed that dark galaxies were more common in the early universe. These findings suggest that dark galaxies may represent a primordial phase in galaxy evolution. One hypothesis is that high levels of UV radiation in the early universe prevented the gas in dark galaxies from cooling and condensing into stars. Observations of regions with high UV radiation support this theory.

题目（Questions）

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A. studying numerous cosmic phenomena caused by them

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D. dark galaxies represent an early stage in galaxy development

Q4. Observations of dark-galaxy regions with high UV radiation indicate that

A. dark galaxies evolved very slowly
B. stars in the early universe were fairly cool and dense
C. UV radiation in the early universe kept gas temperatures high
D. a traditional theory of how dark galaxies formed is incorrect

Q5. Look at the four squares that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. Sentence to insert: Therefore, one might expect all galaxies to have a significant number of stars. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-07 Digital Media Writing

原文（Passage）

Digital Media S Influence On

Digital media’s rise has transformed writing styles, creating new genres and challenges. Unlike traditional print media, digital platforms enable instantaneous sharing, forcing writers to adapt their craft. [A] Blogs, tweets, and other forms prioritize brevity. [B]

A pivotal change is the heightened focus on audience interactivity. [C] Writers must now be mindful of how their work is received and discussed online, adjusting their style in response to audience feedback. [D] This can lead to more dynamic writing but requires constant shifts in tone and content. Interaction between writers and readers thus becomes a crucial element of modern writing.

Digital media also influences language evolution, introducing abbreviations, slang, and emojis as communication tools. Writers face the challenge of balancing informal language with clarity and professionalism. This language shift enriches writing but raises concerns about preserving linguistic standards.

Along with all the disruptions, digital media also offers avenues for innovation. Writers can seamlessly integrate multimedia elements, crafting immersive narratives that go beyond text. However, this integration calls for careful evaluation of how these elements impact the core message, which can sometimes be overshadowed by the allure of visual and auditory effects.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “pivotal” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. critical
B. unexpected
C. temporary

D. positive

Q2. The passage suggests that audience interactivity influences online writing styles by

A. making the tone of a written work more important than its content
B. allowing audiences to imitate the writing styles of their favorite authors
C. rewarding writers who produce more dynamic and responsive material
D. enabling authors to express complex ideas using simple and informal language

Q3. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as an effect of the rise of digital media?

A. The style of print media is becoming more formal.
B. Writers are getting to know their readers more directly.
C. Language has been acquiring new elements.
D. Online content is becoming less formal.

Q4. Which of the following is mentioned in the passage as a result of integrating multimedia elements in writing?

A. It helps maintain traditional writing styles.
B. It can become a distraction for the reader.
C. It guarantees improved reader comprehension.
D. It simplifies the writing process significantly.

Q5. On the other hand, such limitations can encourage greater creativity. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-06-07 Engineering Earth's Climate

原文（Passage）

Engineering Earth's Climate

Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM) focuses on manipulating Earth's processes to address environmental challenges. This field combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making to devise solutions for climate change and other issues. One method of ESEM is geoengineering, which involves deliberate intervention in Earth's climate system to counteract global warming.

Geoengineering techniques fall into two categories: solar radiation management (SRM) and carbon dioxide removal (CDR). SRM aims to reflect sunlight into space to cool the planet. Techniques include injecting aerosols into the stratosphere and deploying reflective mirrors. CDR focuses on reducing greenhouse gas concentrations through methods like afforestation, ocean fertilization, and direct air capture of CO2.

Implementing geoengineering presents challenges. [A] Technological feasibility is a concern, as many techniques are experimental. [B] There are ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions and how impacts are monitored. [C] Additionally, unintended consequences may arise, causing more harm than good. [D] Despite these challenges, ESEM offers solutions to mitigate climate change. Integrating engineering with environmental management can lead to innovative approaches for sustainability. Collaborative efforts between scientists, engineers, and policymakers are crucial to developing safe strategies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is true of Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM)?

A. It finds solutions for problems by allowing natural processes to work themselves out.
B. It uses the resources of multiple disciplines to accomplish its goals.
C. It focuses exclusively on counteracting global warming.
D. It is also known as geoengineering.

Q2. What is the basic difference between the two categories of geoengineering techniques?

A. SRM merely manages solar radiation, while CDR removes it altogether.
B. SRM injects aerosols into the stratosphere, while CDR deploys reflective mirrors.
C. SRM lowers greenhouse gas concentrations, while CDR directly captures CO2.
D. SRM reduces the effects of global warming, while CDR reduces its causes.

Q3. The word "feasibility" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. cost
B. workability
C. specialty
D. risk

Q4. What is one ongoing question raised by geoengineering?

A. What types of collaboration are required in order to develop safe strategies
B. Whether existing experimental techniques can be sustained
C. Who bears responsibility for implementing changes
D. Whether it can be integrated with environmental management

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Careful consideration is needed to assess the long-term impacts." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-06-07 Marketing Health Drinks

原文（Passage）

Marketing Health Drinks

You have probably seen advertisements for soft drinks (soda and other non-alcoholic beverages, typically sweetened) that feature the drink in brightly colored bottles. Producers rely on behavioral economics to influence customer choice, and for soft drinks, distinctive colors and memorable labels have been shown to generate customer interest. It is also no coincidence that, in supermarkets, soft drinks are often found at eye level in aisles and near checkout areas. These locations reliably boost spontaneous purchasing.

However, the same approaches often underperform when used to promote healthier beverage options like low-sugar drinks and sports beverages. What is the reason behind this discrepancy? While soft drinks are associated with pleasure, making them naturally align with the impulsive tendencies that behavioral economics seeks to activate, health-oriented beverages are often viewed as functional or even obligatory—associations that do not elicit the same automatic, emotion-driven response.

How, then, can producers boost sales figures of health-oriented drinks? Consider sunscreen. As a functional product designed to prevent harm, sunscreen tends to be evaluated by consumers using rational criteria such as duration of protection and safety. As a result, sunscreen advertising typically emphasizes clear, informational messaging. Emotional storytelling plays only a secondary role.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Paragraph 1 mentions all of the following techniques for selling soft drinks EXCEPT

A. using eye-catching packaging
B. designing easy-to-remember labels
C. giving discounts
D. placing products at easily noticeable locations

Q2. The word "discrepancy" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. success
B. promotion
C. strategy
D. difference

Q3. Which of the sentences below best expresses the essential information in the highlighted sentence in the passage? Incorrect choices change the meaning in important ways or leave out essential information.

A. While both soft drinks and health-oriented beverages are associated with pleasure, they do not align with impulsive tendencies in the same way.
B. When soft drinks are associated with both pleasure and function, they activate impulsive tendencies and elicit automatic, emotion-driven responses.
C. While soft drinks are associated with pleasure, behavioral economics seeks to align them with impulse and to activate automatic, emotion-driven responses in customers.
D. Soft drinks are seen as pleasurable and align with impulsive behavior, whereas health-oriented beverages are seen as functional and do not elicit the same response.

Q4. Why does the author discuss sunscreen?

A. To provide an example of a product that is difficult to advertise
B. To illustrate how health-oriented drinks might be successfully marketed
C. To explain why the sales figures of health-oriented products are typically low
D. To emphasize the importance of emotional storytelling in marketing

Q5. What does the author imply about marketing health-oriented drinks?

A. Producers should rely on the same impulse-driven packaging and placement tactics used for soft drinks.
B. Producers are more likely to succeed by emphasizing clear, informational messages based on rational product criteria.
C. Emotional storytelling should play the primary role in advertisements for health-oriented drinks.
D. Health-oriented drinks should be marketed mainly by associating them more strongly with pleasure.

2026-06-07 Plant Chemical Communication

原文（Passage）

Plant Communication

Plants were considered passive organisms, reacting to environmental changes rather than actively engaging with their surroundings. However, studies have shown that plants can send chemical signals through the soil.

These signals, often carried by root exudates (substances released by the plants' roots into the soil), can inform neighboring plants about threats like plant-eating animals or disease-causing agents. For instance, when a corn plant is attacked by caterpillars, it can release specific

chemicals that warn nearby corn plants. In response, the neighboring corn plants may release a chemical known as MBOA into their tissues, which makes them less palatable to the caterpillars. Plants also use electrical signals to respond rapidly to environmental changes. These signals travel through the plant, allowing it to adjust resource allocation. Some plants can even detect the presence of other plants through their roots. This allows them to alter their growth patterns to avoid direct competition.

Despite these discoveries, the study of plant communication is still in its infancy. Researchers are continuously uncovering new ways that plants interact with each other and their environment.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, there used to be a mistaken view that plants

A. often changed their behavior
B. released root exudates only in small amounts
C. were not significantly affected by ecological factors
D. did not actively interact with other plants

Q2. According to the passage, corn plants may release MBOA into their tissues in response to

A. harmful chemicals released by caterpillars
B. electrical signals in the soil
C. human activities that affect the environment
D. root exudates produced by other corn plants

Q3. What can be inferred to be the purpose of electrical signals that plants release?

A. To attract beneficial animals to the plants
B. To prevent attack by caterpillars on the plants
C. To help the plants make the best use of available resources
D. To communicate with other plants across long distances

Q4. Knowledge about the presence of other plants can help a plant to

A. change its growth in a way that reduces competition
B. prevent major damage to its roots
C. identify additional resources
D. determine which chemicals to release into the soil

Q5. The phrase "still in its infancy" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. highly controversial
B. in a difficult period
C. looking for funding
D. at an early stage

2026-06-07 Platonism in Modern Philosophy

原文（Passage）

Platonism In Modern Philosophy

Platonism, the philosophy founded by the ancient Greek thinker Plato, has significantly influenced modern philosophical thought. At its core, Platonism posits that abstract forms or ideas, such as concepts of beauty, justice, and equality, are the truest reality, more real than the physical objects we perceive. While a beautiful painting is a physical object, the abstract idea of beauty is a form that exists independently of any particular occurrence. Plato's theory of forms asserts that these forms are timeless and unchanging, unlike the fluctuating physical world.

Platonism has found renewed interest among contemporary philosophers, particularly in the philosophy of mathematics. Mathematical Platonists such as Kurt Gödel and Sir Roger Penrose argue that numbers and mathematical objects exist independently of human minds, akin to

physical objects. This perspective contrasts with nominalism, as advocated by philosophers such as Hartry Field, who argue that mathematical entities are mere symbols or constructs without any independent existence.

Platonism is not without its critics. Philosopher W. V. O. Quine argues that the belief in abstract forms lacks empirical evidence and is overly speculative. Critics also point to the challenge of explaining how these abstract forms interact with the physical world. Despite these criticisms, the enduring influence of Platonism is evident in various branches of philosophy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “posits” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. suggests
B. proves
C. agrees
D. determines

Q2. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that provides an example to help readers understand Plato's idea about abstract forms. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Platonism, the philosophy founded by the ancient Greek thinker Plato, has significantly influenced modern philosophical thought.
B. At its core, Platonism posits that abstract forms or ideas, such as concepts of beauty, justice, and equality, are the truest reality, more real than the physical objects we perceive.
C. While a beautiful painting is a physical object, the abstract idea of beauty is a form that exists independently of any particular occurrence.
D. Plato's theory of forms asserts that these forms are timeless and unchanging, unlike the fluctuating physical world.

Q3. Platonism makes all of the following claims about abstract forms EXCEPT:

A. They include ideas such as beauty, justice, and equality.
B. They are more real than physical objects.
C. They remain the same over time.
D. They influence how the changing physical world is perceived.

Q4. Which of the following can be inferred about nominalism?

A. It has fewer advocates than mathematical Platonism does.
B. It disagrees with the claims of mathematical Platonism.
C. It argues that mathematical objects are similar to physical objects.
D. It supports the independent existence of mathematical entities.

2026-06-07 Social Role Theory

原文（Passage）

Social Role Theory

Social role theory is a significant framework in theoretical sociology, explaining how individuals adopt roles based on societal expectations. Society is structured by roles, each with specific behaviors and norms.

[A] A key aspect of social role theory is role conflict, which occurs when the expectations of one role clash with those of another. For instance, a person who is both a parent and an employee might struggle to balance caring for their children and meeting work obligations. This conflict can lead to stress and decreased performance in one or both roles.

[B] Another important concept is role strain, which is stress within a single role due to competing demands or insufficient resources. An example is a teacher who feels overwhelmed by the need to manage classroom behavior while also keeping lessons engaging.

Social role theory also addresses how roles change over time. [C] As society evolves, the expectations attached to roles can shift. For example, the role of women in the workforce has changed dramatically, with increasing acceptance of women in leadership. Understanding these dynamics is crucial for analyzing how social structures impact individual behavior and societal change. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "norms" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. long histories
B. hidden benefits
C. practical effects
D. unwritten rules

Q2. Why does the passage mention "a person who is both a parent and an employee"?

A. To show how a person can balance multiple obligations
B. To imply that roles are not always rigidly defined
C. To illustrate the concept of role conflict
D. To emphasize the importance of good childcare

Q3. Why does the passage mention "a teacher"?

A. To support the idea that social role theory is often difficult to understand
B. To explain how a person might experience competing demands within a role
C. To imply that the resources provided to teachers are often insufficient
D. To demonstrate how behavioral issues make learning difficult for everyone

Q4. The phrase "these dynamics" in the passage refers to

A. the evolution of social roles over time
B. competition for leadership positions
C. interactions between men and women in the workforce
D. decreasing prestige of some social roles

Q5. Look at the four squares that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. Sentence to insert: For example, a parent is expected to offer affection and emotional stability to their children, while a soldier is expected to follow orders. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-06（20 套）

2026-06-06 Ancient Egyptian Medicine

原文（Passage）

Ancient Egyptian Medicine

Ancient Egyptian medicine was advanced for its time and laid the foundation for many modern practices. Egyptians believed the body was a system of channels similar to the Nile River. Illness was thought to be caused by blockages in these channels, like a blocked canal causing flooding. Treatments focused on unblocking channels using herbal remedies and physical interventions.

One significant contribution of Egyptian medicine was surgical techniques. Ancient texts describe procedures like the removal of tumors and the setting of broken bones. They also record practices like cleaning wounds and disinfecting medical instruments. This suggests that Egyptian

doctors understood the connection between cleanliness and preventing infections, a concept widely accepted only much later in history.
In addition to surgery, Egyptians were skilled in pharmacology. They used substances like honey and willow bark to treat ailments. Modern science has validated some ancient remedies; for example, willow bark contains salicin, a precursor to aspirin, with pain-relieving properties. While Egyptians demonstrated an impressive body of knowledge, Egyptian medicine was also intertwined with religion. Many treatments involved prayers and rituals to invoke the favor of the gods. This blend of empirical practice and spiritual belief shows the complexity of ancient Egyptian medicine.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The author mentions "a blocked canal causing flooding" to explain

A. the importance of the Nile River for Egyptian culture
B. the ancient Egyptians' idea of why humans became sick
C. the wide variety of illnesses common in ancient Egypt
D. the connection between agriculture and medicine

Q2. The passage suggests that which of the following was a surprising achievement of ancient Egyptian medicine?

A. Its procedures improved greatly over time.
B. It understood the importance of cleanliness in preventing infections.
C. Its use of Nile River water was often successful.
D. Its understanding of the cause of illnesses was largely accurate.

Q3. Why does the author discuss the use of willow bark?

A. To suggest that some ancient remedies could be harmful
B. To explain the invention of aspirin
C. To highlight the variety of natural remedies available in Egypt
D. To show that some ancient Egyptian remedies were effective

Q4. The word "invoke" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. request
B. understand
C. increase
D. express

Q5. What role did religion play in ancient Egyptian medicine?

A. Doctors were trained by religious authorities.
B. Religious beliefs limited the kinds of medicine that could be used.
C. Prayers and rituals were often a part of medical treatment.
D. Doctors were thought to have special connections to the gods.

2026-06-06 Ancient Roman Aqueducts

原文（Passage）

Aqueducts
Aqueducts were designed to transport water from distant sources into cities and agricultural areas, and they were crucial engineering feats in ancient civilizations. This engineering marvel allowed civilizations to thrive in otherwise inhospitable environments.
The Romans, in particular, mastered the construction of aqueducts, building extensive networks that supplied water to urban centers. These structures used a combination of gravity and meticulously calculated gradients to ensure a steady flow of water. Some Roman aqueducts, like the Pont du Gard in France, are still standing today, showcasing the Romans' remarkable

engineering skills. In addition to providing water for drinking and irrigation, aqueducts were integral to public health and sanitation. They supplied water to public baths, helping to maintain hygiene in densely populated urban areas. The availability of fresh water also supported the growth of cities and the expansion of the Roman Empire.
Building aqueducts was a complex and labor-intensive process. Workers had to carve channels through mountains and construct bridges over valleys. Despite these challenges, the benefits of aqueducts far outweighed the difficulties. The legacy of Roman aqueducts continues to influence modern water management systems, highlighting the importance of sustainable engineering practices.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "meticulously" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. inaccurately
B. precisely
C. vaguely
D. carelessly

Q2. What can be inferred about the workers who built the aqueducts?

A. They were not very skilled.
B. They faced significant physical challenges.
C. They primarily worked on bridges.
D. They were not aware of the aqueducts' importance.

Q3. Why does the author mention the Pont du Gard in France?

A. To illustrate how aqueducts were constructed
B. To give an example of a well-preserved aqueduct
C. To explain the importance of aqueducts in France
D. To describe the engineering techniques used by the Romans

Q4. What role did aqueducts play in the expansion of the Roman Empire?

A. They facilitated the transportation of goods.
B. They provided water for drinking and sanitation.
C. They helped in building bridges over valleys.
D. They enabled the construction of public baths.

Q5. What can be inferred about modern water management systems?

A. They no longer use principles from Roman engineering.
B. They are less efficient than Roman aqueducts.
C. They are influenced by Roman engineering practices.
D. They are not as labor-intensive as Roman aqueducts.

2026-06-06 Animal Mirror Test

原文（Passage）

The Mirror Test
Very young children cannot recognize themselves in a mirror; they usually achieve this milestone around 18 months of age. The ability to recognize oneself in the mirror is considered to be a key component of self-awareness and consciousness for humans. But what about animals?
For many years, scientists have known that members of the great ape family could recognize themselves in mirrors. They measured this by the "mirror test," which involved putting a colored mark on an ape's body, and then showing the ape its reflection in a mirror. If the ape tried to remove the mark on its own body, the scientists knew that the ape was recognizing its reflection.

Apes are close relatives of humans, but in recent years, scientists have discovered that other animals also pass the "mirror test." Elephants and dolphins have shown signs of self-recognition. These, like apes, are highly intelligent animals. But in a more recent experiment, a type of fish called the cleaner fish tried to scrape a mark off its body when it saw itself in the mirror. This suggests that even less intelligent animals may possess more self-awareness than previously suspected.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the passage mainly about?

A. Stages of early childhood development
B. Research on animal cognition
C. Differences between apes, elephants, and dolphins
D. Recent experiments on fish

Q2. The word "milestone" in the first sentence is closest in meaning to

A. accomplishment
B. distance
C. weight
D. discovery

Q3. Why did scientists put colored marks on animals' bodies?

A. It made it possible to track the animals' movements.
B. It helped them determine whether the animals recognized themselves.
C. It made it easier to tell the animals apart.
D. It showed whether some animals can detect color differences.

Q4. According to the passage, all of the following are true about elephants EXCEPT:

A. They can recognize themselves in mirrors.
B. They are highly intelligent animals.
C. They possess qualities in common with apes.
D. They understand certain signs from other animals.

Q5. Why does the author mention cleaner fish?

A. To suggest that a wide range of animals may possess self-awareness
B. To imply that ocean animals are highly intelligent
C. To demonstrate a flaw in a recent experiment
D. To provide an example of an animal that does not recognize itself

2026-06-06 Animal Sleep Patterns

原文（Passage）

Sleep Patterns

Sleep patterns vary considerably among different animal species. Some animals, like dolphins, have unique sleep methods. Dolphins practice unihemispheric slow-wave sleep, meaning one half of their brain sleeps while the other remains awake. This adaptation allows them to surface for air and stay alert for predators even while resting.

Birds also display interesting sleep behaviors. Many bird species can sleep while flying. [A] During long migratory flights, some birds may engage in unihemispheric sleep, similar to dolphins, enabling them to navigate and avoid threats. [B] Additionally, certain birds can sleep with both hemispheres of their brain but in short bursts, allowing them to maintain continuous flight for extended periods.

Sleep patterns have evolved based on environmental needs. [C] For example, grazing animals like cows and horses sleep minimally, often standing up, which helps them stay vigilant against

predators. [D] In contrast, predators such as lions and tigers can afford longer, deeper sleep because they face fewer threats. Understanding these varied sleep patterns provides insight into how animals have adapted to their habitats and survival challenges. The balance between rest and vigilance is crucial for survival, revealing the intricate adaptations across the animal kingdom.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "considerably" in the first paragraph is closest in meaning to

A. actively
B. significantly
C. predictably
D. consistently

Q2. According to the second paragraph, how do some birds sleep during migratory flights?

A. By flying in short bursts
B. By practicing unihemispheric sleep
C. By stopping regularly during flights
D. By sleeping deeply for long periods

Q3. Why do grazing animals like cows and horses sleep minimally?

A. To conserve energy
B. To maintain continuous flight
C. To stay alert against predators
D. To surface for air

Q4. Why does the author mention "predators such as lions and tigers"?

A. To illustrate how predators can afford longer sleep due to fewer threats
B. To highlight the sleep patterns of grazing animals
C. To emphasize the time it takes for certain animals to adapt their sleep patterns
D. To show that sleep patterns of predators can vary over time

Q5. There are four locations [ ] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. But what affects birds' sleep norms? Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [ ] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Birds also display interesting sleep behaviors. Many bird species can sleep while flying. [A] During long migratory flights, some birds may engage in unihemispheric sleep, similar to dolphins, enabling them to navigate and avoid threats.

B. During long migratory flights, some birds may engage in unihemispheric sleep, similar to dolphins, enabling them to navigate and avoid threats. [B] Additionally, certain birds can sleep with both hemispheres of their brain but in short bursts, allowing them to maintain continuous flight for extended periods.

C. Sleep patterns have evolved based on environmental needs. [C] For example, grazing animals like cows and horses sleep minimally, often standing up, which helps them stay vigilant against predators.

D. For example, grazing animals like cows and horses sleep minimally, often standing up, which helps them stay vigilant against predators. [D] In contrast, predators such as lions and tigers can afford longer, deeper sleep because they face fewer threats.

2026-06-06 Emotional Power Music

原文（Passage）

The Power of Music

Music is often hailed as a universal language. Philosophers and neuroscientists alike have explored music's power to convey emotions without words. While lacking the precision of spoken language, music uniquely evokes complex emotions, a phenomenon attributed to its simultaneous engagement of various brain regions. This interplay not only stirs emotions but also triggers memories and bodily responses, making music a profound medium of expression.
Historically, figures like the ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle argued for music's ethical influence, positing that different musical modes could either promote virtue or incite vice. Modern research, however, leans toward music's role in emotional regulation rather than moral alteration. Researchers have investigated how music interacts with human psychology beyond mere enjoyment. For instance, studies have shown that listening to slow-tempo classical music can reduce anxiety levels in patients before surgery, demonstrating music's therapeutic potential.
Surprisingly, the ability to perceive emotions in music transcends cultural contexts. Studies reveal that individuals worldwide can discern emotions like joy or sorrow in music, suggesting an innate human aptitude for musical expression. This universality has sparked inquiries into music's evolutionary role, raising questions about whether music is merely an art form or a crucial aspect of human development.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "interplay" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. interaction
B. interpretation
C. interval
D. intervention

Q2. It can be inferred that music is similar to language in that music

A. matches the precision of written language
B. engages only those areas of the brain that language engages
C. has rules that are very similar to the rules of spoken language
D. is a medium of expression that conveys complex emotions

Q3. Why does the author mention ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle?

A. To point out that music was once thought to have a significant moral influence
B. To support the point that music is a powerful tool for emotional regulation
C. To identify the person who founded the academic field known as music theory
D. To suggest that ancient philosophers had a more nuanced understanding of music than modern researchers do

Q4. Why does the author mention "patients before surgery"?

A. To demonstrate that the ancient Greek understanding of music was incorrect
B. To argue that emotional states affect the enjoyment of music
C. To provide an example of how music regulates emotions
D. To suggest that slow-tempo classical music can lead to anxiety

Q5. According to the passage, the existence of an innate human aptitude for musical expression suggests that

A. music should only be seen as a form of art
B. music may have played an important role in human development
C. music that expresses joy is more universally appreciated than music that expresses sorrow
D. music is not understood in the same way across different cultures

2026-06-06 Golden Age Television

原文（Passage）

The Golden Age of Television

The Golden Age of Television is often considered to have occurred during the 1950s and 1960s, when TV became a dominant cultural force. This era was marked by groundbreaking shows that experimented with new formats and storytelling techniques.

During this time period, TV saw the rise of anthology series, which presented different stories and characters in each episode, in contrast to traditional ongoing narratives. One influential anthology series was The Twilight Zone, which blended science fiction, horror, and drama in thought-provoking ways. Sitcoms reflecting everyday life, like I Love Lucy, became a cultural phenomenon. Despite its simple format, the show tackled complex social issues including gender roles and family dynamics. There was also a new focus on live broadcasts, providing viewers with real-time coverage of events and entertainers.

However, the Golden Age was not without challenges. TV networks navigated the balance between artistic innovation and commercial pressures. Advertisers sought to influence content to appeal to mass audiences, which sometimes clashed with creative visions. Nonetheless, the period left an indelible mark on the television industry, setting standards for future programming and contributing to the medium's evolution.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "dominant" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. relevant
B. favorite
C. leading
D. entertaining

Q2. Why does the author mention The Twilight Zone?

A. To illustrate the popularity of science fiction during the Golden Age
B. To highlight the innovative nature of anthology series
C. To discuss the impact of horror on television
D. To compare different types of TV formats

Q3. What does the author suggest about sitcoms like I Love Lucy?

A. They made TV less popular during the Golden Age.
B. They focused on people's daily lives.
C. They reduced the influence of advertisers.
D. They were more popular than anthology series.

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 expands on the challenges mentioned in paragraph 2.
B. Paragraph 3 provides examples of the formats discussed in paragraph 2.
C. Paragraph 3 introduces a new issue that was not covered in paragraph 2.
D. Paragraph 3 contradicts the success of TV shows mentioned in paragraph 2.

Q5. Why does the author mention advertisers in the passage?

A. To explain a challenge faced by TV networks
B. To point out how TV shows were funded at the time
C. To illustrate the role of commercials during live broadcasts
D. To criticize the quality of programming during the Golden Age

2026-06-06 Group Decision Making

原文（Passage）

Decision-Making in Groups

Group decision-making is often praised for its potential to foster creativity and innovation through diverse perspectives. However, this collaborative strength can paradoxically become a liability when the pursuit of consensus suppresses critical thinking. A well-known example is the phenomenon of "groupthink," whereby individuals, fearing conflict or exclusion, withhold dissenting opinions. This can result in decisions that are not only irrational but also poorly aligned with the group's original goals.

One might argue that groupthink is simply a failure of leadership or facilitation, yet even in well-structured environments, the pressure to conform can subtly influence behavior. Interestingly, some studies suggest that groups composed of individuals with varied backgrounds and viewpoints are less prone to groupthink, though this diversity can also introduce friction that slows decision-making. Alternatively, some theorists propose that the issue lies not in consensus-seeking itself, but in the lack of mechanisms to encourage constructive disagreement. For instance, assigning a "devil's advocate" role or using anonymous feedback tools can help surface hidden concerns.

Ultimately, while collaboration holds immense promise, its success depends on deliberate strategies to balance unity with intellectual rigor. Without such safeguards, the very process meant to enhance group cohesion may inadvertently undermine it.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions "well-structured environments" primarily to

A. highlight the role of leadership in fostering good organization
B. emphasize the difference between leadership and facilitation
C. describe groups in which there will be the least pressure to conform
D. show that good leadership does not eliminate social pressures

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about "individuals with varied backgrounds and viewpoints"?

A. They may help reduce the tendency to suppress dissenting opinions.
B. They are more likely to agree quickly on important decisions.
C. They tend to avoid conflict by deliberately seeking consensus.
D. They often struggle to be heard in structured environments.

Q3. The word "surface" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. promote
B. eliminate
C. question
D. identify

Q4. The passage suggests which of the following about "intellectual rigor"?

A. It emerges naturally in diverse groups without intervention.
B. It is less important than achieving consensus in decision-making.
C. It can be promoted by avoiding disagreement within the group.
D. It requires intentional strategies to be attained in collaborative settings.

Q5. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as a possible cause of groupthink?

A. Group members' fear of conflict or exclusion
B. Group members' pressure on each other to conform
C. Group members' lack of experience in decision-making
D. Group members' inability to promote constructive disagreement

2026-06-06 History of Photography

原文（Passage）

The History of Photography

The history of photography is marked by significant technological progress and artistic innovation. It began in the early nineteenth century with the invention of the camera obscura, a device that projected images onto a surface. The first permanent photograph was created by Joseph-Nicéphore Niépce in 1826 using a process called heliography, which required several hours of exposure to light.

Photography quickly evolved with the development of daguerreotypes, introduced by Louis Daguerre in 1839. This method produced detailed images on silver-plated copper, but daguerreotypes needed delicate handling, and the exposure times required, although much shorter, still remained impractical for recording images of moving objects. The invention of the calotype by William Henry Fox Talbot in the 1840s allowed for multiple copies of an image to be made from a single negative, revolutionizing the field. [D]

In the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, the introduction of film and roll cameras made photography more accessible to the public. [A] George Eastman's establishment of the Kodak company in 1888 played a crucial role in this democratization, as his cameras were simple to use and affordable. [B] Today, digital photography has further transformed the medium, allowing instant image capture and sharing. [C]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "innovation" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. success
B. advancement
C. activity
D. expression

Q2. What is suggested about daguerreotypes?

A. They were introduced by Joseph-Nicéphore Niépce.
B. They allowed for multiple copies of an image.
C. They required shorter exposure times than heliographs did.
D. They made it unnecessary to use silver-plated copper.

Q3. How did the calotype revolutionize photography?

A. By enabling instant image capture
B. By reducing the need for delicate handling
C. By providing detailed images on silver-plated copper
D. By allowing multiple copies from a single negative

Q4. Why does the author mention George Eastman's establishment of the Kodak company?

A. To highlight the role of Kodak in making photography accessible to the public
B. To criticize the challenges of early photographic methods
C. To explain how film was invented
D. To suggest that Kodak introduced digital photography

Q5. There are four locations [ ] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. These developments have rendered the use of film and many types of cameras obsolete. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [ ] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. In the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, the introduction of film and roll cameras made photography more accessible to the public. [A] George Eastman's establishment of the Kodak company in 1888 played a crucial role in this democratization, as his cameras were simple to use and affordable.

B. George Eastman's establishment of the Kodak company in 1888 played a crucial role in this democratization, as his cameras were simple to use and affordable. [B] Today, digital photography has further transformed the medium, allowing instant image capture and sharing.

C. Today, digital photography has further transformed the medium, allowing instant image capture and sharing. [C]

D. The invention of the calotype by William Henry Fox Talbot in the 1840s allowed for multiple copies of an image to be made from a single negative, revolutionizing the field. [D] In the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, the introduction of film and roll cameras made photography more accessible to the public.

2026-06-06 Human Microbiome Health

原文（Passage）

The Human Microbiome

The human microbiome consists of trillions of microorganisms living in and on our bodies. These include bacteria, viruses, fungi, and other microbes. They play a pivotal role in functions such as digestion, immunity, and mood regulation. For instance, gut bacteria help break down food and produce essential vitamins.

Recent studies show that the microbiome can be influenced by diet, lifestyle, and medication. Antibiotics, while effective against harmful bacteria, can disrupt the balance of beneficial microbes. This disruption can lead to health issues like digestive problems and weakened immunity. Researchers are exploring the connection between the microbiome and mental health. Certain gut bacteria produce neurotransmitters affecting brain function. An imbalance in these bacteria may be linked to conditions like depression and anxiety.

Maintaining a healthy microbiome involves eating a varied diet rich in fiber, reducing stress, and avoiding unnecessary antibiotics. Bacteria that aid digestion, known as probiotics and prebiotics, are also beneficial. As understanding of the microbiome grows, it may lead to breakthroughs in treating diseases and improving health.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "pivotal" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. very important

B. possible

C. combined

D. unwelcome

Q2. What is one way antibiotics can affect humans?

A. They enhance the production of neurotransmitters.

B. They can weaken immunity by harming beneficial microbes.

C. They can help relieve digestive problems.

D. They make it easier to produce essential vitamins.

Q3. What connection are researchers exploring regarding the microbiome?

A. The link between gut bacteria and immunity

B. The role of fungi in mood regulation

C. The role of viruses in digestion

D. The link between gut bacteria and mental health

Q4. All of the following help to maintain a healthy microbiome EXCEPT

A. eating a varied diet rich in fiber

B. lowering stress levels

C. avoiding sources of bacteria

D. reducing the use of antibiotics

Q5. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 challenges the ideas proposed in paragraph 2.

B. Paragraph 3 provides examples of the disruptions mentioned in paragraph 2.

C. Paragraph 3 specifies how to achieve a healthy microbiome based on the factors mentioned in paragraph 2.

D. Paragraph 3 elaborates on the benefits of antibiotics mentioned in paragraph 2.

2026-06-06 Jet Stream Dynamics

原文（Passage）

Jet Stream Dynamics

The jet stream is a fast-moving ribbon of air high in the atmosphere that affects global weather. Flowing west to east at speeds of up to 200 miles per hour, it forms due to the temperature contrast between cold polar air and warm tropical air, which creates pressure differences that generate strong winds. In the northern hemisphere, when the jet stream dips southward, it brings cold air and storms to lower latitudes.

The jet stream also influences cyclones and anticyclones, affecting precipitation and wind patterns. The jet stream's dynamics are influenced by factors like the Earth's rotation and uneven heating of its surface. Seasonal changes play a role; it's stronger in winter due to the greater temperature contrast between the poles and the equator. Understanding the jet stream's behavior helps meteorologists predict weather and plan for climate events.

Recent research shows that climate change is impacting the jet stream. The warming Arctic reduces the temperature difference between polar and tropical air masses, which may weaken the jet stream. A weaker jet stream can lead to slower-moving weather systems, resulting in prolonged periods of extreme weather, such as heatwaves or heavy rainfall.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What causes the formation of the jet stream?

A. The behavior of cyclones

B. The uneven heating of the Earth's surface

C. The difference in temperature between air masses

D. The temperature changes that occur seasonally

Q2. How does the jet stream affect weather systems in the northern hemisphere when it dips southward?

A. It brings warmer air to lower latitudes.

B. It leads to more stable conditions.

C. It brings storms to places further south.

D. It brings cyclones to higher latitudes.

Q3. What is one of the main factors influencing the jet stream's behavior?

A. The Earth's rotation

B. The presence of cyclones

C. The amount of precipitation

D. The direction of wind patterns

Q4. What does the author suggest about the impact of climate change on the jet stream?

A. It will have no significant effect on the jet stream.

B. It is reducing the temperature difference between polar and tropical air masses.

C. It is causing the jet stream to move faster.

D. It is increasing the temperature contrast between the poles and the equator.

Q5. The word "prolonged" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. extended
B. seasonal
C. rapid
D. short-term

2026-06-06 Magnetic Confinement Fusion

原文（Passage）

Magnetic Confinement Fusion

Magnetic confinement fusion is a promising approach for generating clean electricity. This technology fuses deuterium and tritium, heavy forms of hydrogen, to release energy while producing minimal radioactive waste when compared to current technologies to produce nuclear power. The basic principle was first demonstrated in 1957: powerful magnetic fields contain extremely hot plasma at temperatures reaching 150 million degrees Celsius--ten times hotter than the sun's core. Without magnetic containment, the plasma would instantly cool upon touching reactor walls, halting the fusion process.

Since those early breakthroughs, researchers have built increasingly sophisticated magnetic confinement reactors called tokamaks. The International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor (ITER), currently under construction, represents the culmination of decades of magnetic confinement research. ITER aims to demonstrate sustained fusion reactions that produce more energy than they consume--a critical milestone called net energy gain.

However, significant challenges remain before magnetic fusion can generate commercial electricity. Current experiments require enormous energy inputs to maintain plasma conditions, and the intense neutron radiation gradually damages reactor materials. Additionally, converting fusion energy into usable electricity requires developing efficient heat-to-power conversion systems. Despite these obstacles, successful demonstration of net energy gain could pave the way for fusion power.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what significant achievement in fusion research occurred in 1957?

A. Researchers successfully fused deuterium and tritium atoms for the first time.
B. Researchers demonstrated that magnetic fields could contain extremely hot plasma.
C. Researchers estimated the temperature of the sun's core to be 150 million degrees Celsius.
D. Researchers discovered the basic principle that explains the existence of heavy forms of hydrogen.

Q2. Why does the author mention plasma touching reactor walls?

A. To explain how the plasma is contained within the reactor
B. To point out how researchers cool plasma after heating it for experiments
C. To demonstrate the final step in achieving nuclear fusion
D. To clarify why magnetic confinement techniques are necessary

Q3. The word "sophisticated" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. advanced
B. large
C. expensive
D. successful

Q4. According to the passage, what is ITER's primary objective?

A. To generate commercial electricity for distribution to power grids

B. To demonstrate that magnetic confinement techniques are not environmentally sustainable
C. To prove that fusion reactions can produce more energy than they consume
D. To challenge decades of magnetic confinement research

Q5. Which of the following is mentioned as one factor that currently prevents magnetic fusion from generating commercial electricity?

A. Insufficient global supplies of reactor materials
B. Inability to achieve intense neutron radiation
C. High energy demands for plasma maintenance
D. Lack of magnetic fields that are powerful enough

2026-06-06 Mysteries of Opal

原文（Passage）

The Mysteries of Opal

Opal is a unique gemstone, known for its vibrant colors that shift as the stone moves. Unlike most gemstones, which form rigid, repeating crystalline structures, opals are amorphous, meaning they lack a fixed internal shape. This is due to the formation process, where silica-rich water seeps into cracks in rocks deep underground, leaving silica deposits when it evaporates. Tiny silica spheres create the internal structure of opals, and these spheres diffract light, separating it into colors, much like a prism does.

The color and brilliance of opals depends on the size and spacing of the silica spheres. Larger spheres produce reds and oranges, while smaller spheres result in blues and greens. Because of Australia's unique geological conditions, it is home to over 90 percent of the world's opals. Opals are also fragile. Their high water content and noncrystalline structure make them prone to cracking when exposed to sudden temperature changes. Modern jewelers use techniques such as laser cutting and humidity-controlled storage to better protect opals.

Ancient cultures believed opals had mystical properties and brought good luck. The Romans saw them as a symbol of hope and purity, while the Greeks thought they gave the gift of prophecy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following are mentioned as part of the formation process of opals EXCEPT:

A. Water flows into cracks in rocks.
B. The water dries up, leaving silica deposits behind.
C. Small spheres of silica create the structure of the gemstones.
D. The structure formed is rigid and non-varying.

Q2. Why does the author mention "a prism"?

A. To illustrate how an opal affects light
B. To explain how the internal structure of opals is created
C. To give an example of how scientists study opals
D. To argue that opals do not truly diffract light

Q3. What is one consequence of the internal structure of opals?

A. 90 percent of them are red or orange.
B. Relatively little ancient opal jewelry has survived.
C. They are easily damaged by water.
D. Jewelers must use special care to prevent opals from cracking.

Q4. What does the passage suggest about ancient cultures' view of opals?

A. They understood how opals were formed.
B. They found opals difficult to work with.
C. They believed opals had special qualities that benefited their owners.

D. They considered opals to be very durable.

Q5. The word "prophecy" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. long life
B. the ability to predict the future
C. happiness
D. high status

2026-06-06 Origins of Theater

原文（Passage）

The Origins of Theater

European theater has ancient roots, evolving from the rituals and storytelling of early societies. The earliest performances took place in ancient Greece, where festivals honoring the god Dionysus included dramatic contests. These performances were essential to communal life and aimed to convey moral lessons. The Greeks developed distinct genres: tragedy and comedy. Tragedies by Aeschylus and others explored themes of fate, justice, and suffering. Comedies, like those by Aristophanes, satirized society and politics. The structure of Greek theater, with its chorus and masks, had a lasting impact on later cultures.

The tradition of theater continued in the ancient Roman Empire, where it became popular entertainment. [A] Roman theater borrowed from Greek precedents but introduced new elements like elaborate stage designs including, for example, statues of heroes or portraits of the imperial family. [B] These added layers of meaning and context to the plays and helped to convey the themes and narratives more effectively. Despite its rich history, theater faced decline during the Middle Ages in Europe (the period between 500 and 1500 C.E.). [C] However, it saw a resurgence during the following Renaissance period, leading to the flourishing of theater that laid the groundwork for modern theater. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. A goal of the earliest theater performances in ancient Greece was to

A. tell stories about the ancient societies that Greece evolved from
B. honor important people in the community
C. bring people from different groups together
D. provide guidance on good and bad behavior

Q2. How did the plays of Aristophanes compare to those of Aeschylus?

A. They were in a different genre.
B. They were more focused on fate, justice, and suffering.
C. They were more popular among politicians and other important members of society.
D. They had a greater impact on later cultures.

Q3. What was one effect of the elaborate stage designs of Roman theater?

A. They added Greek elements to plays.
B. They directed attention to the plays' creators.
C. They increased the popularity of plays among members of the imperial family.
D. They improved the communication of the plays' themes and narratives to viewers.

Q4. The word "resurgence" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. change
B. debate
C. history
D. comeback

Q5. There are four locations [ ] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Few performances occurred around this time. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [ ] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. The tradition of theater continued in the ancient Roman Empire, where it became popular entertainment. [A] Roman theater borrowed from Greek precedents but introduced new elements like elaborate stage designs including, for example, statues of heroes or portraits of the imperial family.

B. Roman theater borrowed from Greek precedents but introduced new elements like elaborate stage designs including, for example, statues of heroes or portraits of the imperial family. [B] These added layers of meaning and context to the plays and helped to convey the themes and narratives more effectively.

C. Despite its rich history, theater faced decline during the Middle Ages in Europe (the period between 500 and 1500 C.E.). [C] However, it saw a resurgence during the following Renaissance period, leading to the flourishing of theater that laid the groundwork for modern theater.

D. However, it saw a resurgence during the following Renaissance period, leading to the flourishing of theater that laid the groundwork for modern theater. [D]

2026-06-06 Paradox of Choice

原文（Passage）

The Paradox of Choice

The paradox of choice, a concept popularized by psychologist Barry Schwartz, suggests that more options can lead to less satisfaction. While the freedom to choose is fundamental to consumer culture, an overabundance of choices-from groceries to electronics-can overwhelm individuals, causing anxiety and decision fatigue. This paradox implies that the vast array of possibilities available today might actually diminish consumer contentment, as the fear of making the wrong choice looms large.

Research supports this notion. In an experiment, psychologist Sheena Iyengar found that shoppers were more likely to purchase jam when offered 6 varieties instead of 24. The limited selection eased the decision process, reducing the pressure to find the 'perfect' option and making the experience more enjoyable. This phenomenon reveals that fewer choices can sometimes make consumers happier, which is a valuable insight for marketers and retailers aiming to boost satisfaction by curating their offerings.

The paradox also has broader implications. In individualistic cultures, where personal choice is highly valued, the burden of decision-making can be significant. Conversely, collectivist cultures, which often provide fewer choices, report higher levels of contentment. This dynamic suggests that understanding cultural differences in consumer psychology can help businesses optimize their product strategies and enhance overall well-being.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following best states a main idea of the passage?

A. Effective marketing strategies focus on increasing product options.

B. Modern consumer culture is driven by a demand for fewer products.

C. Individualism enhances consumer contentment.

D. Limiting consumer choices can lead to higher satisfaction.

Q2. What is one effect of decision fatigue as mentioned in the passage?

A. Desire to make the same choices as other consumers

B. Anxiety about making the wrong choice

C. Preference for consumer cultures

D. Enhanced freedom to choose

Q3. Why does the author mention Sheena Iyengar's experiment?

A. To highlight the effectiveness of marketing strategies
B. To explain the methodology used in consumer psychology
C. To provide evidence supporting the paradox of choice
D. To criticize the abundance of products in modern markets

Q4. The word "curating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. eliminating
B. organizing
C. increasing
D. changing

Q5. What can be inferred about consumers in collectivist cultures?

A. They tend to report lower levels of satisfaction.
B. They are more affected by the paradox of choice.
C. They generally have fewer choices available.
D. They prefer individual decision-making.

2026-06-06 Quantum Computing Challenges

原文（Passage）

Quantum Computing

Quantum computing promises to revolutionize technology by delivering unprecedented computational power. Traditional computers store data in binary bits, representing 0 or 1. Quantum computers use qubits, which can represent 0, 1, or both simultaneously (a state called superposition). This allows quantum computers to process vast amounts of data simultaneously, solving complex problems much faster than classical computers.

Quantum computing has promising applications in cryptography--techniques for encoding and decoding messages. Current encryption (encoding) methods rely on complex algorithms that classical computers struggle to break. Quantum computers could potentially break these encryption algorithms with ease, requiring new, quantum-resistant techniques. Researchers are exploring such methods to secure data in a post-quantum world.

One challenge to fully realizing quantum computing is that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances. [A] Maintaining coherence, the state needed by qubits to perform calculations, requires extremely low temperatures and isolation from environmental noise, such as magnetic or electric field fluctuations. [B] Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating. [C] Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues. [D] Quantum computing holds promise for advancements in fields like medicine, finance, and artificial intelligence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "revolutionize" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. simplify
B. transform
C. study
D. use

Q2. Why does the author discuss binary bits and qubits?

A. To explain why quantum computers are more powerful than classical computers are
B. To discuss the two ways in which quantum computers store data
C. To emphasize the fast pace at which computing technology is advancing

D. To explain what causes the state of superposition

Q3. According to the passage, new encryption techniques are needed in the post-quantum world because

A. quantum computers are less secure

B. quantum computers store more valuable data than classical computers do

C. quantum computers can break existing encryption

D. quantum computers cannot process current encryption algorithms

Q4. Why does the author mention "external disturbances"?

A. To point out that qubits can only function in certain environmental conditions

B. To introduce a similarity between quantum computing and traditional computing

C. To explain how quantum computing creates unwanted fluctuations in magnetic or electric fields

D. To suggest that quantum computing can be prohibitively expensive

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: Seeing progress, companies and governments have begun to invest heavily in quantum research, aiming to unlock its potential. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]

B. [B]

C. [C]

D. [D]

2026-06-06 Renaissance Art Techniques

原文（Passage）

Renaissance Art Techniques

During the European Renaissance (the period between the fourteenth and the seventeenth centuries), artists developed techniques that made their paintings appear more realistic. One technique, linear perspective, allowed the accurate depiction of three-dimensional space on a flat surface. Artists created the illusion of depth by using vanishing points on horizon lines, which are points in the background where parallel lines converge. Objects were depicted as increasingly smaller as they neared these points to appear farther from the viewer. This marked a significant departure from the flat, two-dimensional representations common in earlier European art.

Another innovation was chiaroscuro, the use of strong contrasts between light and dark to give the impression of volume. The Italian artist Leonardo da Vinci used this technique in such works as the Mona Lisa and The Virgin of the Rocks. In the latter, the illuminated main figures contrast with the deep brown shadows of the rocks and trees in the background. The technique added drama and emotional intensity, captivating viewers and drawing them into the scene.

Additionally, oil painting became popular during the Renaissance. Because oil paints dry more slowly than tempera paints, artists could use blending and layering to create more texture and richer colors.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What were artists able to achieve by using linear perspective?

A. Paintings that appeared to have depth

B. Paintings that could depict a wide variety of objects

C. The creation of more uniform representations

D. The creation of smaller artworks

Q2. The word "departure" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. practice
B. change
C. work
D. choice

Q3. Why does the author discuss Leonardo da Vinci's The Virgin of the Rocks?

A. To explain why much of Leonardo's art was so dark
B. To indicate that Leonardo often painted rocks and trees
C. To illustrate Leonardo's use of chiaroscuro
D. To show how Leonardo's style changed after he painted the Mona Lisa

Q4. What does the author suggest about the impact of chiaroscuro?

A. It made paintings more engaging to viewers.
B. It allowed artists to depict nighttime landscapes.
C. It reduced the need for linear perspective.
D. It led to the development of more colors.

Q5. What was one benefit of oil paints over tempera paints?

A. They were easier to make.
B. They could be applied in layers.
C. They were available in more realistic colors.
D. They could be easily removed if necessary.

2026-06-06 Sports Social Integration

原文（Passage）

The Impact of Sports on Social Integration

Sports can promote social integration by bridging gaps between people of various backgrounds. Participation in sports can lead to increased social cohesion and improved relationships among diverse groups.

For example, community soccer leagues often bring together people from different ethnicities, creating an environment where cultural differences are celebrated and mutual respect is cultivated. However, the impact of sports on social integration is not without challenges. Competitive environments can sometimes exacerbate social tensions, particularly when favoritism or exclusionary practices are present.

Despite these issues, many initiatives aim to use sports as a platform for social change. One such initiative is the Sport for Peace program, which focuses on conflict resolution through team-building activities and collaborative sports events. The role of sports in social integration extends beyond participation. Spectatorship and fandom also play significant roles in uniting people. Major international sports events like the Olympics or the World Cup serve as opportunities for nations to come together and share common goals. The visibility of athletes from diverse backgrounds during these events fosters a sense of global harmony. These events often highlight stories of athletes overcoming adversity, inspiring spectators and fostering a collective sense of achievement.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "cohesion" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. diversity
B. awareness
C. unity
D. celebration

Q2. In which of the following situations can sports have an especially negative impact on social integration?

A. When people from different ethnicities are brought together
B. When participants are unreasonably strict about the rules of competition
C. When the social environment is not favorable to competition
D. When social tensions are heightened by favoring or excluding certain participants

Q3. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 discusses ways of addressing a problem mentioned in paragraph 2.
B. Paragraph 3 contradicts a theory proposed in paragraph 2.
C. Paragraph 3 provides evidence for an idea presented in paragraph 2.
D. Paragraph 3 introduces a new challenge related to paragraph 2.

Q4. What does the passage suggest about the Sport for Peace program?

A. Its main goal is to eliminate favoritism in sports.
B. It primarily targets professional athletes.
C. It uses team-building exercises to address conflicts.
D. It is only effective in local communities.

Q5. Why does the author mention major international sports events like the Olympics and the World Cup?

A. To argue that these events have little impact on social integration
B. To illustrate how sports can unite people globally
C. To suggest that these events mainly benefit athletes
D. To highlight the competitive nature of these events

2026-06-06 Stretching Benefits Drawbacks

原文（Passage）

Stretching: Benefits and Drawbacks

Stretching has long been championed as integral to physical fitness, widely believed to enhance flexibility and reduce injury risk. However, research supports a more nuanced picture, with the distinction between dynamic and static stretching being particularly critical.

Dynamic stretching, involving controlled, fluid movements through a range of motion, apparently improves athletic performance by priming muscles for activity. In contrast, static stretching, the holding of a position for an extended period, seems to hinder performance of subsequent exercise. Related studies show that static stretching can temporarily reduce muscle strength, likely due to reduced muscle activation through the nervous system and a decrease in muscle stiffness, both of which can impair the ability to generate force. For example, athletes engaging in static pre-competition stretches often exhibit diminished sprint speed and vertical jump height. [A]

There is, however, a key qualification to this contrast: While static stretching may be detrimental before exertion, it remains valuable post-exercise, aiding in recovery and flexibility maintenance. [B] Meanwhile, dynamic stretching not only prepares the body physically but may also enhance coordination and neuromuscular efficiency. [C] The evolving understanding of these techniques challenges the one-size-fits-all approach to stretching, suggesting that timing, context, and type are essential variables in optimizing physical readiness and long-term fitness outcomes. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, dynamic stretching may result in all of the following EXCEPT

A. decreased range of motion
B. better performance in sports

C. improved coordination
D. more efficient communication between nerves and muscles

Q2. The word "impair" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. aid
B. reinforce
C. end
D. weaken

Q3. The passage implies that competitive athletes may most benefit from static stretching when they

A. need to increase muscle strength
B. have issues with muscle activation
C. have completed a training session
D. are preparing for a sprint

Q4. Why does the author refer to "timing, context, and type" in the passage?

A. To specify factors that must be considered when stretching
B. To list the variables that affect an athlete's performance
C. To refer to additional kinds of stretching developed by researchers
D. To underscore the complexity of factors influencing coordination

Q5. There are four locations [ ] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Elite swimmers often perform static stretches after intense training sessions to relieve muscle tightness in the shoulders and hips and prevent overuse injuries. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [ ] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. For example, athletes engaging in static pre-competition stretches often exhibit diminished sprint speed and vertical jump height. [A] There is, however, a key qualification to this contrast: While static stretching may be detrimental before exertion, it remains valuable post-exercise, aiding in recovery and flexibility maintenance.

B. There is, however, a key qualification to this contrast: While static stretching may be detrimental before exertion, it remains valuable post-exercise, aiding in recovery and flexibility maintenance. [B] Meanwhile, dynamic stretching not only prepares the body physically but may also enhance coordination and neuromuscular efficiency.

C. Meanwhile, dynamic stretching not only prepares the body physically but may also enhance coordination and neuromuscular efficiency. [C] The evolving understanding of these techniques challenges the one-size-fits-all approach to stretching, suggesting that timing, context, and type are essential variables in optimizing physical readiness and long-term fitness outcomes.

D. The evolving understanding of these techniques challenges the one-size-fits-all approach to stretching, suggesting that timing, context, and type are essential variables in optimizing physical readiness and long-term fitness outcomes. [D]

2026-06-06 Urbanization and Birds

原文（Passage）

The Effects of Urbanization on Bird Populations

Urbanization has had a profound impact on bird populations worldwide. As cities expand, natural habitats are replaced with buildings, roads, and other infrastructure. This leads to a significant reduction in the availability of nesting sites and food sources for birds.

Some species, such as pigeons and sparrows, have adapted well to urban environments, taking advantage of the new resources and structures. However, many other species struggle to survive in these altered landscapes. Therefore, it is imperative to find solutions that help birds adapt to

city life. One notable effect of urbanization is the change in bird song. Birds living in cities often sing at higher pitches and volumes than their rural counterparts. This adaptation helps them communicate over the noise of traffic and human activity. Additionally, the artificial lighting in cities can disrupt the natural circadian (daily time-related) rhythms of birds, affecting their breeding and feeding behaviors.

Conservationists are working to mitigate the negative effects of urbanization on birds. Initiatives such as creating urban green spaces, constructing bird-friendly buildings, and reducing light pollution are being implemented. These efforts aim to create a more hospitable environment for birds, allowing them to coexist with humans in urban settings.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "mitigate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. understand
B. analyze
C. communicate
D. reduce

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as an effect of urbanization on birds in the passage?

A. Reduced availability of nesting sites
B. Changes in bird song
C. Increased food sources
D. Disrupted circadian rhythms

Q3. Why does the author mention pigeons and sparrows?

A. To identify birds that struggle to survive in urban environments
B. To give examples of birds that have adjusted to living in urban settings
C. To highlight the diversity of urban bird species
D. To suggest that all birds can adapt to cities

Q4. What is one initiative mentioned in the passage to help birds in urban areas?

A. Introducing new bird species to urban areas
B. Providing human-made food sources to birds
C. Creating urban green spaces
D. Decreasing the amount of noise made by traffic

Q5. What can be inferred about the impact artificial lighting in cities has on birds?

A. It disrupts the natural behaviors of birds.
B. It allows birds to find food at night.
C. It helps birds to adapt to urban environments.
D. It increases the population of urban birds.

2026-06-06 Viking Sunstone Navigation

原文（Passage）

Mysterious Viking Sunstones

The Vikings, seafaring warriors from Scandinavia, are believed to have navigated their ships with remarkable precision across the North Atlantic during the medieval period (about 500-1500 C.E.). [A] One key to their navigational success may have been the use of so-called "sunstones," as described in Icelandic sagas (medieval Icelandic texts). Some argue the sagas' content is mythical, while others suggest these stones were real tools used by the Vikings, probably crystals, such as Iceland spar. Iceland spar is a transparent variety of calcite that possesses unique optical properties.

[B] It polarizes light by splitting light into two beams, creating a double image when the stone is held up to the sky. By rotating the crystal, the Vikings could determine the location of the sun in the sky on cloudy days, which would help them maintain their course.
[C] However, evidence of actual sunstone use remains scarce. Archaeologists have yet to uncover these stones in the remains of Viking settlements or ships. But an Iceland spar sunstone was recovered from a ship that sank in 1592, suggesting that this navigational tool was indeed used for quite some time. [D] The theoretical use of sunstones remains a fascinating example of Viking ingenuity.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does debate continue about the sunstones mentioned in Icelandic sagas?

A. The sagas describe other uses for sunstones.
B. Archaeologists have not found any such stones when examining Viking sites.
C. Research indicates that sunstones are not actually an effective navigation tool.
D. Researchers suspect that sunstones were not easy to obtain in the medieval period.

Q2. In what way was Iceland spar useful to Vikings?

A. It helped them predict when clouds would disappear.
B. It was used as a tool to help maintain ships.
C. It helped them figure out where the sun was when it could not be seen.
D. It was used to improve seafarers' vision.

Q3. Why does the author mention a ship that sank in 1592?

A. To explain how Elizabethans refined a technology invented by Vikings
B. To support the theory that Vikings used Iceland spar for navigation
C. To give an example of a more modern navigational tool
D. To provide information about archaeological methods

Q4. The word "ingenuity" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. education
B. cleverness
C. luck
D. fame

Q5. There are four locations [ ] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. This is all the more remarkable considering the lack of technology at the time. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location [ ] to add the sentence to the passage.

A. The Vikings, seafaring warriors from Scandinavia, are believed to have navigated their ships with remarkable precision across the North Atlantic during the medieval period (about 500-1500 C.E.). [A] One key to their navigational success may have been the use of so-called "sunstones," as described in Icelandic sagas (medieval Icelandic texts).

B. Iceland spar is a transparent variety of calcite that possesses unique optical properties. [B] It polarizes light by splitting light into two beams, creating a double image when the stone is held up to the sky.

C. By rotating the crystal, the Vikings could determine the location of the sun in the sky on cloudy days, which would help them maintain their course. [C] However, evidence of actual sunstone use remains scarce.

D. But an Iceland spar sunstone was recovered from a ship that sank in 1592, suggesting that this navigational tool was indeed used for quite some time. [D] The theoretical use of sunstones remains a fascinating example of Viking ingenuity.

2026-06-02（2 套）

2026-06-02 Flynn Effect Trends

原文（Passage）

The Flynn Effect

Researchers have observed a phenomenon known as the Flynn Effect: a consistent increase in Intelligence Quotient (IQ) scores from one generation to the next. This trend, named after intelligence researcher James Flynn, shows that average IQ scores have risen by about three points per decade in many parts of the world.

Various theories have been proposed to explain this trend. One hypothesis is that improvements in nutrition and healthcare have enhanced brain development, leading to higher IQ scores. Another theory suggests that the complexity of modern life, with its increased cognitive demands, has driven this rise. The widespread use of technology and a more stimulating environment could also be contributing factors.

[A] However, the Flynn Effect does not necessarily indicate that people are becoming more intelligent. [B] Some researchers argue that the rise in IQ scores reflects better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests, rather than a genuine increase in cognitive abilities. [C] Recent studies have shown that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or even reversing in some countries, challenging the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "consistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rapid
B. steady
C. large
D. impressive

Q2. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as possible contributors to the trend of IQ scores EXCEPT

A. better eating habits and medical care
B. improvements in parental care
C. the cognitive demands of contemporary life
D. the extensive use of technology

Q3. According to some researchers, the Flynn Effect may be a sign that

A. people are becoming better at taking tests
B. IQ tests have become easier over time
C. test-takers thrive in stimulating environments
D. school systems have developed better examinations

Q4. Why does the author mention that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or reversing in some countries?

A. To suggest that there may not be a global increase in intelligence
B. To argue that cognitive abilities are declining around the world
C. To show that the Flynn Effect requires further research
D. To argue that the challenges of modern life can have negative effects on intelligence

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: Changes in educational practices or shifts in societal values could account for the downturn. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]

B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-06-02 Quantum Computing Power

原文（Passage）

Quantum Computing

Quantum computing promises to revolutionize technology by delivering unprecedented computational power. Traditional computers store data in binary bits, representing 0 or 1. Quantum computers use qubits, which can represent 0, 1, or both simultaneously (a state called superposition). This allows quantum computers to process vast amounts of data simultaneously, solving complex problems much faster than classical computers.

Quantum computing has promising applications in cryptography--techniques for encoding and decoding messages. Current encryption (encoding) methods rely on complex algorithms that classical computers struggle to break. Quantum computers could potentially break these encryption algorithms with ease, requiring new, quantum-resistant techniques. Researchers are exploring such methods to secure data in a post-quantum world.

One challenge to fully realizing quantum computing is that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances. [A] Maintaining coherence, the state needed by qubits to perform calculations, requires extremely low temperatures and isolation from environmental noise, such as magnetic or electric field fluctuations. [B] Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating. [C] Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues. [D] Quantum computing holds promise for advancements in fields like medicine, finance, and artificial intelligence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "revolutionize" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. simplify
B. transform
C. study
D. use

Q2. Why does the author discuss binary bits and qubits?

A. To explain why quantum computers are more powerful than classical computers are
B. To discuss the two ways in which quantum computers store data
C. To emphasize the fast pace at which computing technology is advancing
D. To explain what causes the state of superposition

Q3. According to the passage, new encryption techniques are needed in the post-quantum world because

A. quantum computers are less secure
B. quantum computers store more valuable data than classical computers do
C. quantum computers can break existing encryption
D. quantum computers cannot process current encryption algorithms

Q4. Why does the author mention "external disturbances"?

A. To point out that qubits can only function in certain environmental conditions
B. To introduce a similarity between quantum computing and traditional computing
C. To explain how quantum computing creates unwanted fluctuations in magnetic or electric fields
D. To suggest that quantum computing can be prohibitively expensive

Q5. There are four locations [A], [B], [C], and [D] in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: Seeing progress, companies and governments have begun to invest heavily in quantum research, aiming to unlock its potential. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-05-30（4 套）

2026-05-30 Demographic Dynamics

原文（Passage）

Demographic Dynamics

The demographic transition model (DTM) illustrates the shifting patterns of birth and death rates as societies evolve from agrarian to industrialized economies. Initially, both rates are high, resulting in slow population growth due to limited access to healthcare and sanitation. As countries develop, death rates decline sharply with advances in medical care and improved living conditions. Yet, birth rates often remain high, spurring rapid population growth that can strain resources. This transition highlights the tension between demographic momentum and societal capability to meet the growing needs.

[A] A further decline in birth rates eventually occurs, influenced by greater access to education and changes in cultural norms. Families begin to view fewer children as advantageous, aligning with shifts toward economic and personal aspirations. [B] However, this stage brings its own challenges, including the potential for an aging population and workforce shortages. [C]

Some demographers postulate a fifth stage, characterized by persistently low birth rates that might lead to population contraction. The implications of this are complex, ranging from economic innovation driven by necessity to increased strain on social institutions and intergenerational support systems. [D] Understanding these transitions enables societies to better plan for future demographic realities, though the dynamic interplay of these factors is still unfolding.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, what does the demographic transition model primarily demonstrate?

A. Decreasing birth rates as societies industrialize
B. Changing rates of birth and death as economies develop
C. Differences in healthcare access among societies
D. Consequences of rising death rates in industrial societies

Q2. Which of the following can be inferred about agrarian societies?

A. They are more prosperous than industrialized societies.
B. They are an exception to the trends proposed by the demographic transition model.
C. They experience high birth rates and also high death rates.
D. They suffer sharp population declines as a result of high death rates.

Q3. The word "aspirations" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. goals
B. resources
C. changes
D. challenges

Q4. Which of the following is NOT mentioned about low birth rates?

A. Sustained low birth rates result in negative population growth.

B. Demographic changes brought about by low birth rates can lead to societal tensions.

C. Persistently low birth rates typically lead to economic decline.

D. Understanding demographic transitions linked to low birth rates helps societies plan for the future.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "As societies navigate this demographic shift, proactive policies and innovations become essential to sustain economic growth and promote well-being among older adults." Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1

B. Location 2

C. Location 3

D. Location 4

2026-05-30 Developmental Systems Theory

原文（Passage）

Developmental Systems Theory

Developmental Systems Theory (DST) is an approach within developmental biology that emphasizes the complex interactions between genetic, environmental, and epigenetic factors in shaping an organism's development. It challenges traditional views that either prioritize genes or environment in isolation. Instead, DST posits that development results from dynamic, reciprocal interactions among all these factors. Therefore, understanding an organism's development requires examining the full system rather than focusing on any single factor alone.

A key example highlighting DST involves the development of beak shapes in finches. Research indicates that while genetic factors play a significant role, environmental influences such as diet and climate are equally important. These interactions can lead to epigenetic changes--modifications in gene expression that do not alter the DNA sequence itself. For instance, finches consuming different diets may exhibit variations in beak shape due to changes in gene expression triggered by dietary components.

[A] DST also introduces the concept of developmental plasticity, which refers to the ability of an organism to alter its development in response to varying environmental conditions. [B] This adaptability is crucial for survival, especially in rapidly changing environments. [C] Certain amphibians, for example, can modify their growth patterns based on resource availability. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "reciprocal" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. mutual

B. important

C. active

D. necessary

Q2. Unlike the DST approach, traditional views of an organism's development

A. focus on single factors alone

B. maintain the superiority of genetic factors

C. study the full system of development

D. deny the role of epigenetic factors

Q3. According to the passage, the development of beak shapes in finches is influenced by all of the following EXCEPT

A. changes in the genes of the finches
B. the kind of food that the finches eat
C. the climate in which the finches live
D. changes in the DNA sequence of the finches

Q4. Why does the author discuss "developmental plasticity"?

A. To demonstrate that DST has its limitations
B. To explain an important aspect of DST
C. To argue that environmental conditions play little role in an organism's survival
D. To challenge the influence of resource availability on the growth patterns of amphibians

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Tadpoles of the Mexican spadefoot toad develop into omnivore morphs in nutrient-rich ponds with abundant plant material and into carnivore morphs in temporary ponds with plenty of animal prey." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-05-30 Discrete Geometry Structures

原文（Passage）

Hidden Structures in Discrete Geometry

Discrete geometry is a fascinating branch of mathematics that explores the hidden patterns formed by distinct geometric objects. Unlike continuous geometry—which deals with shapes and structures that are smooth and unbroken, like curves and surfaces—discrete geometry focuses on objects that are finite or countable like points, lines, and polygons. These distinct components reveal unexpected structures and relationships. Such revelations occur particularly in packing and tiling problems.

Packing problems involve finding the most efficient arrangement of objects in a given space. While this might sound like a simple exercise—such as fitting oranges into boxes—it has far-reaching applications in fields like computer-chip design, where components must be arranged to maximize performance and minimize space, and in data storage, where digital information is packed efficiently to save memory and speed up access. Researchers have discovered intriguing connections between the arrangement of shapes and space utilization, challenging assumptions about efficiency.

[A] Tiling problems further illustrate the depth of discrete geometry. [B] Penrose tiling, for instance, creates a pattern with non-repeating shapes that fill a plane, revealing underlying symmetrical properties. [C] The insights gained from such tiling patterns have influenced architectural designs and artworks. [D]

The challenging, abstract nature of discrete geometry can all too easily belie its practical value. Mathematicians continue to show how these hidden structures drive innovation across fields.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that contrasts two branches of mathematics.

A. Discrete geometry is a fascinating branch of mathematics that explores the hidden patterns formed by distinct geometric objects.
B. Unlike continuous geometry—which deals with shapes and structures that are smooth and unbroken, like curves and surfaces—discrete geometry focuses on objects that are finite or countable like points, lines, and polygons.

C. These distinct components reveal unexpected structures and relationships.
D. Such revelations occur particularly in packing and tiling problems.

Q2. Why does the author mention “fitting oranges into boxes”?

A. To help describe the historical development of packing problems
B. To help communicate the idea that packing problems are not as simple as they sound
C. To explain the basic principles of discrete geometry to nonspecialists
D. To highlight one of the challenges faced by researchers in discrete geometry

Q3. The study of computer chip design and data storage has revealed that

A. traditional assumptions about efficiency are still valid
B. the principles of continuous geometry are surprisingly relevant
C. there are interesting connections between how shapes are arranged and how spaces are used
D. there are new ways of enhancing the security of digital information

Q4. The word “belie” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. hide
B. confirm
C. enhance
D. undermine

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. For example, Penrose-inspired patterns have been used in mosaic art and floor designs to create visually striking compositions that evoke mathematical harmony. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-05-30 Parallel Algorithms

原文（Passage）

Parallel Algorithms From Challenges To

Parallel algorithms, a computing method common in modern computers, solve problems faster by dividing a task into smaller parts that run at the same time. Instead of checking every item in a huge database one by one as in a sequential algorithm, a parallel algorithm might split the job across multiple processor cores, each checking a portion of the data simultaneously.

In healthcare, parallel algorithms play a crucial role in analyzing large datasets quickly. When researchers simulate how a virus spreads through a population, they need to process millions of data points-like infection rates and demographics. Using parallel processing, these simulations can run in minutes instead of hours, helping public health officials make faster decisions during outbreaks. However, if too much data is sent to the processors at once without proper management, the system slows down.

One of the strengths of parallel algorithms is their versatility. [A] Developers can tailor them to work efficiently on different types of hardware, such as graphics processing units (GPUs), which are especially good at handling many tasks at once. [B] This is a big reason why deep learning-used in things like facial recognition-has advanced so quickly. [C] Training a deep learning model would be nearly impossible without parallel computing. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about sequential algorithms?

A. They are less efficient than parallel algorithms are.
B. They handle computational tasks in the same way that parallel algorithms do.
C. They can solve problems that parallel algorithms cannot.
D. They use more advanced hardware than parallel algorithms do.

Q2. Why does the author discuss the simulation of the spread of a virus?

A. To illustrate the challenges that public health officials face during disease outbreaks
B. To demonstrate the significance of parallel algorithms in healthcare
C. To highlight the data points that researchers focus on when a virus spreads through a population
D. To emphasize the risk of using small datasets for analysis during disease outbreaks

Q3. The word "tailor" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. direct
B. explore
C. adapt
D. prepare

Q4. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "In light of their many advantages, parallel algorithms will surely continue to drive innovation in diverse areas like climate modeling and financial analysis." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-05-27（5 套）

2026-05-27 Free Will Debate

原文（Passage）

Free Will and Determinism

The debate over free will asks whether our decisions come from independent thought or are shaped by factors beyond our control. Although we may feel like we choose freely, influences such as genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits suggest our freedom may be limited. The key question is whether these influences simply guide our choices or actually determine them. If they determine them, then our sense of control may be more of a story we tell ourselves after the fact than something that drives our actions.

Some philosophers maintain that even within a causally determined world, we can still act freely, so long as our choices reflect our own reasoning and desires. Yet this view raises questions about whether those desires are truly ours or merely the result of prior conditions. Others push further, suggesting that even our capacity to reflect on our actions is shaped by forces beyond our control, leaving little room for genuine autonomy. These tensions are not just theoretical; they shape how we think about responsibility in law, education, and relationships. If the assumption that someone might have acted differently begins to unravel, then our notions of accountability may need to be reimagined.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention genetics and upbringing in paragraph 1?

A. To name the factors that contribute to the unconscious habits people form
B. To list factors we may be unaware of that shape our decision-making
C. To argue that some people have more freedom to act than others do
D. To note two factors that contribute to the formation of people's personalities

Q2. What does the author suggest may be true of "our sense of control" over our choices?

A. It can drive our actions if we train ourselves to think independently.
B. It helps us develop narratives that shape our choices.
C. It is the product of unconscious habits.
D. It is nothing more than an illusion.

Q3. In the second paragraph, what is the relationship between sentence 1 and sentence 2?

A. Sentence 1 presents an argument, and sentence 2 restates it in simpler terms.
B. Sentence 1 makes a claim, and sentence 2 supports it with evidence.
C. Sentence 1 presents an idea, and sentence 2 challenges an assumption behind the idea.
D. Sentence 1 introduces a viewpoint, and sentence 2 considers its implications.

Q4. The word "unravel" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. fall apart
B. gather strength
C. form
D. evolve

Q5. According to the author, why is it important to consider questions about the meaning of free will?

A. Ideas about free will affect how we hold each other responsible for our actions.
B. Free will is an important part of what it means to be a modern human being.
C. The debate over free will and determinism is one of the fundamental questions of our time.
D. Without genuine autonomy, there is little value in institutions such as law and education.

2026-05-27 Theater Lighting Evolution

原文（Passage）

Theater Lighting Innovations

Theater lighting has evolved significantly over the centuries. Initially reliant on sunlight, performances were limited to daylight hours. Candles and oil lamps enabled evening shows but posed fire risks and offered limited control over illumination.

The introduction of gas lighting in the nineteenth century provided safer lighting that was brighter and more consistent. This advancement improved visibility on stage and allowed for more expressive acting. Lights that illuminated actors from below and the sides helped direct audience attention.

The emergence of electric lighting in the late nineteenth century was transformative. Designers began using gels and filters to create a wide range of colors of varying intensity. These and other innovations, including focused spotlights and dimming systems, fundamentally reshaped the visual and emotional stage landscape. For example, the angled light beams and shadows in Toller's 1919 play Transformation evoked the chaos and psychological unrest of post-war Germany.

Today's theaters leverage LED technology for energy efficiency and versatility, as it offers rapid color changes and programmable effects to create varied settings. Designers must now carefully balance technological prowess with artistic intent, ensuring that lighting supports rather than distracts from the narrative. Moreover, as lighting systems become increasingly complex, collaboration between lighting designers, directors, and technicians has become essential.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is the most accurate description of the passage's organization?

A. An introduction followed by a summary of the disadvantages of older theater lighting systems

B. A discussion of the theory of theater lighting followed by paragraphs detailing the different effects it can achieve

C. An introduction followed by a series of paragraphs on successive developments in theater lighting

D. A discussion of different theaters followed by a description of lighting technologies that complement each building

Q2. According to the passage, gas lighting was an improvement on candles and oil lamps in all of the following ways EXCEPT:

A. It was less likely to cause fires.

B. It produced a more constant light.

C. It could be directed at individual actors.

D. It produced a softer light.

Q3. The word "fundamentally" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. simply

B. thoroughly

C. surprisingly

D. permanently

Q4. Why does the author discuss Transformation?

A. To illustrate how skillful lighting can communicate a mood to the audience

B. To provide an example of a play that could have benefited from LED technology

C. To explain why electric lighting was not as powerful for creating moods as gas lighting

D. To argue that some plays relied too heavily on lighting effects

Q5. What does the passage imply about modern lighting technology?

A. It can sometimes shift the focus from the play to the lighting.

B. It requires directors who are skilled in computer programming.

C. Theaters must now allocate more money to technicians and less to actors.

D. Theaters must be redesigned to incorporate new lighting technology.

KPO 1 - Printing Press Impact

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Impact of the Printing Press

The invention of the mechanical movable type printing press by Johannes Gutenberg in the mid-15th century marked a profound turning point in European history. [A] Prior to this innovation, books were painstakingly copied by hand, primarily by monks in isolated monasteries. [B] This laborious process made texts incredibly rare and expensive, effectively restricting knowledge to the wealthy elite and the highest levels of the clergy. Gutenberg’s press, however, utilized durable metal type that could be rearranged, inked, and reused, drastically reducing the time and cost required to produce written works. [C] Consequently, literature became accessible to a much broader segment of the population, breaking the monopoly on information. [D]

The widespread availability of printed materials accelerated the dissemination of new ideas, fueling major cultural and intellectual movements such as the Renaissance and the Scientific Revolution. As books circulated more freely, literacy rates began to climb steadily across Europe. People were no longer entirely dependent on local authorities or oral traditions for information; they could independently study classical texts, scientific treatises, and political pamphlets. Furthermore, the printing press standardized languages, as regional dialects gradually gave way

to uniform printed languages. This linguistic unification ultimately fostered a stronger sense of national identity among populations that had previously been severely fragmented by local vernaculars.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the main purpose of the passage?

A. To describe the mechanical components of Gutenberg's printing press.
B. To explain how the printing press transformed European society and culture.
C. To compare the literacy rates of the 15th century with those of the modern era.
D. To argue that oral traditions were superior to printed texts.

Q2. The word "laborious" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. creative
B. mysterious
C. difficult
D. rapid

Q3. What can be inferred about Europe before the invention of the printing press?

A. Regional dialects were not commonly spoken by the wealthy elite.
B. Monasteries were the primary centers for mass-producing cheap books.
C. Most ordinary people relied on spoken communication or local leaders for information.
D. Scientific treatises were widely studied by the general public.

Q4. Why does the author mention the "Renaissance and the Scientific Revolution" in the second paragraph?

A. To identify the specific time periods when Johannes Gutenberg lived.
B. To provide examples of intellectual movements driven by the availability of printed materials.
C. To argue that scientific advancements were more important than cultural changes.
D. To explain why regional dialects began to disappear in Europe.

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], and [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

****This meant that a single machine could produce hundreds of copies of a page in the time it took a scribe to write just one.****

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 2 - Flipped Classroom Model

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

The Flipped Classroom Model

The traditional approach to education often involves teachers delivering lectures during class time and assigning problem sets or reading for homework. [A] In recent years, however, the "flipped classroom" model has gained traction as a popular alternative. [B] In a flipped classroom, the typical sequence is reversed: students encounter new material at home, usually through pre-recorded video lectures or assigned readings, and then use class time to apply that

knowledge through exercises, projects, or discussions. [C] This pedagogical shift aims to maximize the value of face-to-face interaction between students and instructors. [D]
One major advantage of the flipped classroom is that it promotes active learning. Rather than passively absorbing information, students engage in collaborative problem-solving while the teacher acts as a guide or facilitator. This allows instructors to identify and address student misconceptions immediately. Furthermore, students can learn at their own pace, pausing or rewinding instructional videos as needed to grasp complex concepts. However, the model is not without its challenges. It heavily relies on student self-regulation, as those who fail to complete the pre-class assignments will find themselves ill-prepared for in-class activities. Consequently, educators must carefully design accountability measures to ensure students are keeping up with the material.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what is the primary role of the teacher during class time in a flipped classroom?

A. To deliver comprehensive lectures on new material.
B. To guide and facilitate student problem-solving.
C. To record instructional videos for homework.
D. To grade problem sets completed by students at home.

Q2. The word "absorbing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. creating
B. questioning
C. taking in
D. passing on

Q3. It can be inferred from the second paragraph that a student who does not watch the pre-recorded videos will likely

A. be asked to teach the material to their peers.
B. struggle to participate effectively in class activities.
C. receive extra lecture time from the instructor.
D. learn the material at a faster pace than others.

Q4. All of the following are mentioned as benefits of the flipped classroom EXCEPT:

A. Instructors can correct misunderstandings right away.
B. Students can review instructional materials at their own speed.
C. Students engage in active problem-solving with their peers.
D. Educators spend less time preparing for their classes.

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], and [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

"As a result of this rearrangement, students no longer spend their class periods simply listening to a teacher talk."

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

KPO 3 - Academic Reading - Cephalopod Camouflage

来源：KPO

原文（Passage）

Cephalopod Camouflage

Cephalopods, a class of marine invertebrates encompassing octopuses, squids, and cuttlefish, are renowned for their remarkable ability to alter their appearance. This dynamic camouflage serves crucial functions, primarily predator avoidance, hunting, and intraspecies communication. The foundation of this rapid transformation lies in specialized skin cells known as chromatophores. These intricate organs contain elastic sacs of pigment surrounded by a network of tiny radial muscles. When the animal's nervous system sends a signal, these muscles contract, stretching the sac and exposing the pigment. [A] By independently controlling millions of chromatophores simultaneously, cephalopods can generate complex, shifting patterns in a fraction of a second. Beyond mere pigmentation, cephalopods utilize secondary cell types to perfect their optical illusions. Iridophores are structural cells that reflect light, creating iridescent greens, blues, and silvers that pigments alone cannot produce. [B] Beneath these lie leucophores, which act as a broad-spectrum reflector, scattering ambient light to help the animal match the brightness of its surroundings. [C] Furthermore, many benthic species possess dermal papillae—muscular projections on their skin that can be instantly raised or retracted. [D] This physical transformation allows them to mimic the three-dimensional texture of coral, rocks, or seaweed, rendering them virtually undetectable to both predators and unsuspecting prey.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to paragraph 1, how do chromatophores function to change a cephalopod's color?

A. They reflect ambient light to match the surrounding brightness.
B. They release chemicals that alter the skin's texture.
C. They use tiny muscles to stretch sacs containing pigment.
D. They produce iridescent colors like blue and green.

Q2. The word "encompassing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. surrounding
B. including
C. protecting
D. transforming

Q3. According to the passage, all of the following are mentioned as contributing to a cephalopod's camouflage EXCEPT:

A. Chromatophores that display pigments
B. Iridophores that produce iridescent colors
C. Leucophores that reflect ambient light
D. Photophores that generate bioluminescent light

Q4. Why does the author mention "coral, rocks, or seaweed" in the second paragraph?

A. To list the primary food sources of benthic cephalopods.
B. To provide examples of environments where cephalopods cannot survive.
C. To illustrate the types of physical textures cephalopods can imitate.
D. To explain why cephalopods need to communicate with one another.

Q5. Look at the four squares [A], [B], [C], and [D] that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage.

"This reflective base layer ensures that the animal does not stand out as a dark silhouette

against a bright ocean floor."

Where would the sentence best fit?

A. [A]
B. [B]
C. [C]
D. [D]

2026-05-19（1 套）

2026-05-19 Earth Core Dynamics

原文（Passage）

Unveiling Earth's Core

Geophysicists have long been intrigued by Earth's core (the center of Earth). When earthquakes occur, they send seismic waves through the planet, offering rare glimpses into this mysterious world. Interestingly, these waves sometimes slow down in unexpected ways, suggesting that the core's makeup may be more complex than just iron and nickel as previously believed. Some scientists suggest it might not be entirely solid, possibly containing molten layers or unusual elements that create a unique state of matter.

Advanced computer models now depict the core not as a homogeneous sphere, but as a layered structure with distinct regions. These models also propose phenomena like super-rotation, where the inner core (the inner part of Earth's core) spins slightly faster than the rest of the planet, and directional differences in wave behavior, known as anisotropies. Collectively, these findings portray a core in constant motion.

But is this picture complete? Some researchers argue that these models rely on overly simplified assumptions. Truly understanding the inner core demands cutting-edge technology and fresh perspectives. The limitations of current theories remind us that the deeper we explore planetary science, the more we challenge our understanding of it.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author discuss earthquakes in paragraph 1?

A. To demonstrate the fascination of geophysicists with Earth's core
B. To explain one way scientists gain insights into Earth's core
C. To highlight the destructive effects of seismic waves on Earth's core
D. To challenge the idea that Earth's core is a mysterious world

Q2. Why might seismic waves slow down when passing through Earth's core?

A. Because of the solid nature of the core
B. Because of the presence of iron and nickel
C. Because of the possible presence of molten layers or unusual elements
D. Because of the strength of the elements that make up the core

Q3. The word "Collectively" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. generally
B. together
C. somehow
D. interestingly

Q4. Advanced computer models suggest all of the following about Earth's core EXCEPT:

A. Earth's core has different layers.
B. The inner part of Earth's core rotates a little faster than other parts of Earth do.
C. Wave behavior in Earth's core shows directional differences.

D. The super-rotation of Earth's core is caused by anisotropies.

Q5. Identify the sentence in paragraph 3 that describes a specific criticism of computer models of the inner core.

A. But is this picture complete?

B. Some researchers argue that these models rely on overly simplified assumptions.

C. Truly understanding the inner core demands cutting-edge technology and fresh perspectives.

D. The limitations of current theories remind us that the deeper we explore planetary science, the more we challenge our understanding of it.

2026-05-13（2 套）

2026-05-13 Art of Conducting

原文（Passage）

The Art of Conducting

Orchestral conducting is often seen as a magical art form. With a baton and their hands, conductors shape an orchestra's performance. Their role is not just to keep time; they guide the interpretation and emotional delivery of a piece. This requires a deep understanding of music and the ability to inspire musicians.

One key aspect of conducting is communication. Conductors convey their intentions through gestures, facial expressions, and body language. This nonverbal communication is crucial during live performances. A slight baton movement can signal different tempo, dynamics, or mood. For example, a quick upward flick might indicate a sudden crescendo (gradual increase in volume), while a gentle circular motion could suggest a more legato (smooth and connected) passage.

Rehearsal technique is another important element. Conductors spend significant time with orchestras to fine-tune performances. This involves breaking down music, addressing challenges, and experimenting with interpretations. Rehearsals allow conductors to build a cohesive sound and align musicians with their vision.

While the conductor's role during performances might appear spontaneous, it is grounded in meticulous preparation. Conductors study scores in detail, learning every part of the orchestra's contribution. This understanding allows them to anticipate issues and react swiftly during concerts. Conductors often spend years refining their technique and adapting their style.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following are mentioned as aspects of the conductor's role EXCEPT

A. making sure that the musicians keep time

B. communicating a composer's intentions

C. guiding the way an orchestra interprets music

D. inspiring musicians to convey emotions through music

Q2. All of the following are mentioned about communication in orchestral conducting EXCEPT:

A. It is an important part of conducting.

B. It allows conductors to give instructions to musicians.

C. It typically takes the form of body movements.

D. It sometimes takes the form of spoken instructions.

Q3. What does the passage suggest about conductors during rehearsals?

A. They have difficulty addressing problems identified by orchestra members.

B. They rely heavily on musicians' interpretations of the music.

C. They ensure that musicians follow the conductors' musical interpretation.

D. They often play instruments to show musicians how to raise their performance levels.

Q4. The word "anticipate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. understand
B. expect
C. avoid
D. solve

Q5. Why does the author state that "Conductors often spend years refining their technique and adapting their style"?

A. To emphasize that conductors' performance is based firmly on careful preparation
B. To suggest that conductors should be more spontaneous during performances
C. To explain how quickly conductors react to issues during concerts
D. To highlight the physical challenges that conductors face

2026-05-13 Graphic Design Evolution

原文（Passage）

Evolutionary Trends in Graphic Design

Graphic design has transformed repeatedly throughout history, influenced by both cultural shifts and technological advancements. In Europe, during the Middle Ages (the fifth to fifteenth centuries), the creation of intricate manuscripts was predominant. The advent of the printing press in the fifteenth century altered these dynamics, facilitating mass production and broadening public access to designed materials. Such technological shifts not only changed the way art was produced but also how it was perceived.

By the mid-twentieth century, Swiss design emerged as a response to the chaotic visual landscape, introducing principles of minimalism and functionality. [A] Heavily influenced by the Bauhaus movement, designers like Josef Müller-Brockmann advocated for simplicity and rationality. [B] Their grid-based approach brought order and readability to what often seemed to be overwhelming visuals. [C] Some critics argue that the rigid structure, while effective, limited expressive possibilities and emotional resonance in design. [D]

Today, graphic design stands at the intersection of tradition and innovation. While digital tools democratize access and encourage experimentation, designers grapple with preserving artistic integrity. The challenge lies in blending the precision of technology with the warmth of human creativity. Thus, graphic design continues to evolve, reflecting broader cultural debates about art and technology.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about intricate manuscripts during the Middle Ages?

A. They were individually made.
B. They were produced using the printing press.
C. They were widely available to the general public.
D. They depicted mostly landscapes.

Q2. The phrase "advocated for" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. mentioned
B. promoted
C. debated
D. inspired

Q3. Why does the author discuss the "grid-based approach"?

A. To argue that the approach should be adopted more widely
B. To question the relevance of the approach in modern design
C. To show how the principles of minimalism and functionality were used by Swiss designers
D. To indicate how Swiss designers differed from the majority of Bauhaus designers

Q4. It can be inferred that many of today's graphic designers are concerned that digital tools

A. undermine the democratization of the arts

B. are not responsive to public debates in the arts

C. are not precise enough to be useful in the design process

D. do not always reflect the warmth of human creativity

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. However, this clarity sometimes came at the cost of creativity. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "By the mid-twentieth century, Swiss design emerged as a response to the chaotic visual landscape, introducing principles of minimalism and functionality."

B. After "Heavily influenced by the Bauhaus movement, designers like Josef Müller-Brockmann advocated for simplicity and rationality."

C. After "Their grid-based approach brought order and readability to what often seemed to be overwhelming visuals."

D. After "Some critics argue that the rigid structure, while effective, limited expressive possibilities and emotional resonance in design."

2026-05-09（6 套）

2026-05-09 Civic Education

原文（Passage）

The Importance Of Civic Education

A comprehensive civic education includes understanding the structure of a country's government, electoral processes, and system of laws. It equips citizens with knowledge about their rights and responsibilities, fostering informed participation in the political process.

Recent studies show a decline in civic knowledge among young people in the United States. Many are unfamiliar with even the most basic concepts. They struggle to describe how laws are made and name the roles of different government branches. Who is more likely to actively participate in the democratic process: a young person who knows how the government functions or one who does not? A successful democracy depends on active participation by its citizens.

Efforts to address the problem include integrating civic education into school curriculums with activities that students find fun and exciting. Teachers can organize mock legislatures or congresses, where students role-play as members of a legislative body and draft, debate, and vote on bills. Students can also learn about the legal system by conducting mock trials. However, it should be noted that factors such as socioeconomic background and access to resources may limit access to high-quality civic education.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "fostering" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. demanding

B. promoting

C. analyzing

D. limiting

Q2. Why does the author ask the question near the end of paragraph 2?

A. To suggest that recent studies about civic knowledge in the United States are wrong

B. To offer a solution for increasing civic knowledge in the United States

C. To suggest that participation in the democratic process increases civic knowledge

D. To highlight the importance of having civic knowledge

Q3. What does the author suggest about mock legislatures or congresses?

A. They have been a part of civic knowledge curriculums for many years.
B. They help students learn about different socioeconomic backgrounds.
C. They are more appropriate for the classroom than mock trials are.
D. They are an engaging way to teach civic knowledge.

Q4. Identify the sentence in paragraph 3 that describes a problem in conducting civic education. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Efforts to address the problem include integrating civic education into school curriculums with activities that students find fun and exciting.
B. Teachers can organize mock legislatures or congresses, where students role-play as members of a legislative body and draft, debate, and vote on bills.
C. Students can also learn about the legal system by conducting mock trials.
D. However, it should be noted that factors such as socioeconomic background and access to resources may limit access to high-quality civic education.

2026-05-09 Cooperative Education

原文（Passage）

Cooperative Education

Cooperative education ("co-ops") emerged in the United States in the early twentieth century, when engineering programs seeking stronger industry alignment began alternating academic terms with structured, paid work experience. Although the model was first formalized at the University of Cincinnati, its rapid adoption across institutions specializing in scientific and technical fields reflected broader recognition that technical fields required applied practice alongside theoretical coursework. Today, co-ops are most prevalent at universities with deep employer partnerships. At Northeastern University and Drexel University, most students complete co-ops (multi-month paid placements) in fields ranging from engineering to computing to design. These programs often involve multiple sequenced work terms with increasing responsibility and are integrated into degree requirements rather than treated as optional internships.

Proponents argue that co-ops cultivate professional maturity by requiring students to navigate real organizational structures, contribute to long-term projects, and build evidence-based portfolios before graduation. They also note that co-op graduates often report higher initial earnings and stronger job placement. Critics, however, contend that alternating semesters can disrupt academic continuity, extend time-to-degree, and disadvantage students who cannot relocate or afford breaks in campus employment. Despite these concerns, co-op education remains a defining form of work-integrated learning, especially in fields where applied expertise is essential.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage mentions all of the following about cooperative education programs EXCEPT:

A. Engineering departments at universities were some of the first to adopt them.
B. They are recommended for students who are experiencing difficulties in theoretical courses.
C. They are based on the idea that practical experience is necessary in certain technical fields.
D. They allow students to receive payment while learning.

Q2. What does the passage suggest about institutions such as Northeastern University and Drexel University?

A. They have worked closely with employers to establish comprehensive co-op programs.
B. They prefer to admit students who have already had extensive practical experience in their chosen fields.

C. They allow students who have completed multiple co-ops to graduate more quickly than they otherwise would.

D. They limit co-op placements to the top students in each field.

Q3. The word “cultivate” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. precede

B. highlight

C. demonstrate

D. promote

Q4. According to the passage, what is one potential drawback of co-ops?

A. Co-op students are less likely to graduate than students who do not participate in co-ops.

B. Co-op students perfect their practical skills at the expense of their theoretical knowledge.

C. Co-op students take longer to graduate than other students.

D. Co-op students overextend themselves by working at both their co-op placements and their regular campus jobs.

Q5. Which type of student is probably least likely to find cooperative education attractive?

A. A student who is most drawn to analyzing texts and doing academic research

B. A student who is pursuing a degree in computer science

C. A student who wants to have the best chance of finding a job after graduation

D. A student who wants to network with professionals in her chosen field

2026-05-09 Cybernetic Prosthetics

原文（Passage）

Cybernetic Prosthetics

Cybernetic prosthetics have revolutionized medical technology, offering hope to individuals who have lost limbs. Unlike traditional prosthetics, which are often cumbersome and limited in function, cybernetic versions are designed to integrate seamlessly with the human nervous system. This integration allows for more natural movement and even sensation. A key development in this field has been the use of myoelectric sensors, which detect electrical signals generated by muscle movements.

One example is a cybernetic hand that can perform delicate tasks such as picking up small objects or typing. This is achieved through advanced algorithms that translate muscle signals into controlled movements. Researchers are also exploring haptic feedback, which would enable users to feel textures and temperatures through their prosthetic limbs. It involves integrating sensors and actuators that mimic the sensation of touch by stimulating the user’s nerve endings or skin with electrical signals. This could significantly improve the quality of life for amputees. [A] The high cost of these prosthetics makes them inaccessible to many. [B] Additionally, the technology requires regular maintenance and updates, which can be a barrier. [C] Current battery life is another limitation, as it restricts the user’s ability to wear the prosthetic for extended periods. Researchers are continually working to make these devices more affordable and user-friendly. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "seamlessly" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. generally

B. smoothly

C. repeatedly

D. slowly

Q2. What can be inferred about myoelectric sensors?

A. They function less effectively in traditional prosthetics.
B. They rely less on electric signals than other types of sensors do.
C. They allow for more natural movement in cybernetic prosthetics.
D. They make cybernetic prosthetics somewhat cumbersome.

Q3. What does the passage indicate about cybernetic hands?

A. They are currently limited in their range of motion.
B. They rely on algorithms that turn muscle signals into movements.
C. They can cause skin irritation if worn for extended periods.
D. They are used mainly for typing.

Q4. According to the passage, using haptic feedback in artificial limbs involves each of the following EXCEPT

A. feeling textures through prosthetic limbs
B. changing the temperatures of objects
C. stimulating skin and nerve endings
D. using multiple sensors and actuators

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "To take full advantage of these amazing new technologies, a few obstacles need to be overcome." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-05-09 Italian Lute Songs

原文（Passage）

The Ascent Of The Italian

Some historians explain the mid-sixteenth-century surge of Italian lute songs as the product of technological innovation combined with shifting social tastes. Around 1500, Ottavio dei Petrucci developed a groundbreaking movable-type printing technique for music, making it easier and cheaper to produce books of lute music. Suddenly, amateur musicians from Naples to Venice could acquire fashionable arrangements of madrigals, villanellas, and solo ricercars. This ease of access dovetailed with an expanding culture of private performance in aristocratic homes. Other historians point to a different catalyst: courtly patronage. Alfonso d'Este, the duke of Ferrara, played a decisive role by commissioning virtuosos like Francesco da Milano and Antonio Valente, whose published collections set a high artistic benchmark.

Evidence for both theories emerges in extant manuscripts: Some contain personalized annotations indicating home practice, while lavish presentation copies bear heraldic emblems of noble households. Furthermore, stylistic borrowings from the Spanish vihuela and French lute idioms suggest a pan-European dialogue that reinforced Italian composers' ambitions. While the printing press democratized repertoire, it was the symbiosis of domestic enthusiasm and aristocratic sponsorship--each reinforcing the other--that, arguably, propelled the Italian lute song to its enduring prominence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?

A. Innovations in printing have emerged as the most likely cause of a surge in the composition of sixteenth-century Italian lute songs, replacing older, now disproven theories.

B. The increased availability of printed lute music, together with courtly patronage, fostered a flourishing culture of lute music in sixteenth-century Italy.

C. Italian lute songs became more sophisticated in the sixteenth century as a result of Italian musicians' incorporation of foreign influences.

D. As professional sixteenth-century Italian musicians began to offer more private performances in aristocratic homes, composers altered the kind of music written for the lute.

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about amateur musicians in sixteenth-century Italy?

A. Their repertoire prior to the sixteenth-century did not include compositions for the lute.

B. Their musical tastes influenced the types of compositions commissioned for the lute by patrons like Alfonso d'Este.

C. They performed in private homes alongside professional musicians invited by aristocratic patrons.

D. The extent to which they performed lute music in private homes was affected by an innovation in the printing industry.

Q3. The word "lavish" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. traditional

B. practical

C. fancy

D. common

Q4. The author mentions "heraldic emblems" primarily to

A. cite evidence of the influence of patronage on Italian lute music

B. provide evidence that printed lute music grew more complex over time

C. demonstrate that music written for the lute became very fashionable

D. indicate one way in which aristocrats personalized books of printed music

Q5. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as contributing to the mid-sixteenth-century surge of Italian lute songs?

A. The availability of printed lute music

B. Courtly patronage of virtuosos

C. Improvements in lute construction

D. Stylistic borrowings from the Spanish vihuela

2026-05-09 Platonism in Modern Philosophy

原文（Passage）

Platonism In Modern Philosophy

Platonism, the philosophy founded by the ancient Greek thinker Plato, has significantly influenced modern philosophical thought. At its core, Platonism posits that abstract forms or ideas, such as concepts of beauty, justice, and equality, are the truest reality, more real than the physical objects we perceive. While a beautiful painting is a physical object, the abstract idea of beauty is a form that exists independently of any particular occurrence. Plato's theory of forms asserts that these forms are timeless and unchanging, unlike the fluctuating physical world.

Platonism has found renewed interest among contemporary philosophers, particularly in the philosophy of mathematics. Mathematical Platonists such as Kurt Gödel and Sir Roger Penrose argue that numbers and mathematical objects exist independently of human minds, akin to physical objects. This perspective contrasts with nominalism, as advocated by philosophers such as Hartry Field, who argue that mathematical entities are mere symbols or constructs without any independent existence.

Platonism is not without its critics. [A] Philosopher W. V. O. Quine argues that the belief in abstract forms lacks empirical evidence and is overly speculative. [B] Critics also point to the challenge of explaining how these abstract forms interact with the physical world. [C] Despite these criticisms, the enduring influence of Platonism is evident in various branches of philosophy. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "Plato's discussions of justice and virtue remain influential in moral philosophy." Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-05-09 Synthetic Diamonds

原文（Passage）

Synthetic Diamonds

Traditionally, diamonds were extracted from mines, a process fraught with environmental concerns. Synthetic diamonds offer a promising alternative.

Creating synthetic diamonds involves replicating the conditions under which natural diamonds form. One popular method is High Pressure High Temperature (HPHT), where carbon is subjected to extreme heat and pressure. HPHT diamonds can be produced quickly and in large quantities, making them suitable for mass production. However, they may contain metallic inclusions from the catalysts used, which can affect clarity and color.

Another method is Chemical Vapor Deposition (CVD), which grows diamonds layer by layer from carbon-rich gases in a vacuum chamber. CVD diamonds typically have fewer impurities and offer greater control over clarity and size. Although CVD diamonds can be produced on a large scale, CVD production is often more technically demanding and slower, which may influence cost.

[A] Both HPHT and CVD methods produce diamonds that are chemically and physically identical to natural diamonds. [B] They share the same hardness, brilliance, and clarity, making them suitable for jewelry. [C] Consumers are often skeptical of synthetic diamonds, as they associate rarity and historical significance only with natural diamonds. [D] Nevertheless, the market for synthetic diamonds continues to grow, driven by their affordability, sustainability, and ethical appeal.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that one advantage of synthetic diamonds over natural diamonds is that

A. producing synthetic diamonds requires less heat than mining natural diamonds does
B. producing synthetic diamonds is less harmful to the environment than mining natural diamonds is
C. synthetic diamonds are physically and chemically superior to natural diamonds
D. synthetic diamonds are available in a greater variety than natural diamonds are

Q2. The word "replicating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. analyzing
B. recreating
C. altering
D. enhancing

Q3. According to the passage, what is one advantage of HPHT diamonds over CVD diamonds?

A. They are of higher quality.
B. They are easier to produce.
C. They can more readily be used for jewelry.
D. They have better clarity and color.

Q4. Why does the passage mention the "rarity and historical significance" of natural diamonds?

A. To emphasize that consumers should continue using natural diamonds for most purposes
B. To support the claim that the market for natural diamonds is growing
C. To explain why the acceptance of synthetic diamonds is somewhat limited
D. To highlight the affordability and sustainability of synthetic diamonds

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "And because of the controlled conditions in which they are produced, synthetic diamonds are actually preferred for industrial uses, such as in cutting tools and electronic devices." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-05-06（2 套）

2026-05-06 Health Informatics Impact

原文（Passage）

Revolutionizing Patient Care

Health informatics, which integrates information technology and data science to enhance healthcare outcomes, is fundamentally reshaping how care is delivered. The transition from paper-based records to electronic health systems has significantly improved access to patient information and coordination among providers. Physicians can retrieve medical histories instantly, reducing the likelihood of errors and enabling more timely interventions.

This efficiency, however, introduces new complexities. Some critics argue that the growing reliance on digital tools may have the unfortunate side effects of diminishing the role of clinicians' intuition and reducing access to individualized care. For instance, when predictive algorithms assess disease risk using large datasets, they may fail to account for lifestyle choices and other unique patient variables that fall outside standard models. A patient might be flagged as low-risk for diabetes based on age and body mass index, while critical factors like family history or dietary habits are overlooked.

In addition, the design of digital record systems can subtly influence how doctors think, drawing attention to whatever fits neatly into templates and downplaying things that may be harder to quantify. As a result, while informatics can streamline care, it also risks oversimplifying human health, challenging clinicians to stay alert to what the system might miss.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "integrates" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. improves
B. produces
C. requires
D. combines

Q2. The passage mentions all of the following as benefits of "efficiency" EXCEPT

A. improved communication among medical professionals
B. reduced reliance on the medical judgment of individuals
C. lower risk of medical mistakes
D. faster delivery of medical care

Q3. In the second paragraph, what is the relationship between sentence 1 and sentence 2?

A. Sentence 1 describes changes in health outcomes, and sentence 2 provides examples.
B. Sentence 1 presents a solution produced by health informatics, and sentence 2 describes flaws in that solution.
C. Sentence 1 warns of problems related to health informatics, and sentence 2 provides examples.
D. Sentence 1 notes a challenge that health informatics has solved, and sentence 2 describes new, unresolved challenges.

Q4. Why does the passage provide the example of a patient flagged as low-risk for diabetes?

A. To illustrate how an algorithm might provide an incomplete assessment
B. To show that body mass index is not a reliable health metric
C. To suggest that family history is becoming more relevant to modern medicine
D. To demonstrate the efficiency of digital diagnosis

Q5. According to the passage, the tendency of health informatics to emphasize data that "fits neatly into templates" should cause doctors to

A. watch closely for details that digital systems may not perceive
B. work harder to streamline medical care
C. participate in the design of digital records systems
D. carefully evaluate their own ability to read electronic health data

2026-05-06 Kessler Syndrome Debris

原文（Passage）

Space Debris: A Growing Concern

The Kessler Syndrome, proposed by NASA scientist Donald J. Kessler in 1978, hypothesizes a cascading effect in low Earth orbit (LEO) in which collisions between satellites and debris--defunct satellites, spent rocket stages, and fragments from earlier collisions--generate more fragments, exponentially increasing the likelihood of further collisions. This feedback loop could render certain orbital regions unusable for decades. While the model is compelling, some assumptions merit scrutiny. For instance, it presumes a uniform distribution of debris and constant collision probability, yet orbital mechanics suggest that debris clusters in specific altitudes and orbital paths, potentially limiting the scope of cascading events.

Moreover, technological advancements in debris tracking and active removal may mitigate the risk more effectively than Kessler originally envisioned. Critics argue that the syndrome underestimates the resilience of orbital infrastructure and overstates the inevitability of runaway collisions. Alternative explanations for observed debris growth include a greater number of satellite launches and fragmentation from aging spacecraft, rather than a self-sustaining cascade.

Nonetheless, the Kessler Syndrome remains a valuable heuristic for space policy, emphasizing the need for international cooperation and sustainable orbital practices. Its cautionary implications are profound--especially as commercial constellations dramatically increase the number of active satellites in LEO.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that one impact of the Kessler Syndrome would be

A. an increase in NASA space research

B. a limitation on where satellites could safely orbit
C. a greater number of satellite launches
D. an increased risk of debris falling to Earth

Q2. Why does the author mention the assertion that "debris clusters in specific altitudes and orbital paths"?

A. To provide a reason for an increase in collisions between satellites and debris
B. To illustrate a part of the feedback loop
C. To explain an objection to the Kessler Syndrome hypothesis
D. To emphasize the need for better debris tracking

Q3. The word "resilience" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. strength
B. threat
C. knowledge
D. supervision

Q4. According to the passage, some argue that the Kessler Syndrome will not occur for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

A. Space debris may not be spread out as evenly as the theory assumes.
B. New technology means that the removal of debris may be possible.
C. NASA has since developed new orbital infrastructure for avoiding collisions.
D. There may be other explanations for the observed growth in debris.

Q5. What does "Its cautionary implications" refer to in the passage?

A. The idea that one must assess the Kessler Syndrome carefully before accepting its predictions
B. The idea that there will be cascading collisions in LEO, making it difficult for satellites to remain intact
C. The suggestion that international cooperation will be more difficult to achieve as space becomes more cluttered
D. The suggestion that debris tracking and active removal may pose additional risks to satellites

2026-05-03（1 套）

2026-05-03 Great Smog London

原文（Passage）

The Great Smog of London

The Great Smog of London in 1952 was a pivotal event in environmental history. For five days in December, a thick layer of smog blanketed the city, caused by cold weather, windless conditions, and pollutants. The primary sources were coal-burning fires for heating homes and factories, releasing sulfur dioxide and other toxic chemicals.

As the smog settled, it became a health crisis. Visibility was reduced to a few meters, and transportation was disrupted. Many people abandoned their cars, and the ambulance service was severely impacted. Thousands developed respiratory problems, and the death rate surged. The Great Smog caused up to 12,000 premature deaths and countless illnesses. Hospitals were overwhelmed with patients, and morgues quickly reached capacity.

In response, the British government took action. New regulations aimed at reducing air pollution were established. The most significant was the Clean Air Act of 1956, which restricted coal burning in urban areas and promoted cleaner energy sources. [A]

Despite progress, air pollution remains a global challenge. [B] Many cities still struggle with poor air quality due to industrial activities, vehicle emissions, and other sources. [C] The Great Smog of

London serves as a stark reminder of the need to address environmental issues to protect public health. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about the 1952 Great Smog of London?

A. It affected several other European cities.
B. It resulted from multiple factors that occurred simultaneously.
C. It disrupted the normal activities of factories for five days.
D. It made residents switch to coal to heat their homes.

Q2. The word "premature" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. early
B. recorded
C. preventable
D. likely

Q3. Why was the Great Smog of London considered a pivotal event?

A. It lasted longer than usual.
B. It occurred at an unlikely time of the year.
C. It led to significant environmental regulations.
D. It caused the immediate closure of all factories.

Q4. Why does the author bring up the impact on the ambulance service?

A. To highlight one of the results of low visibility
B. To explain the main cause of the surging death rate
C. To suggest a reason why hospitals were overwhelmed
D. To indicate that authorities closed London roads for travel

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Local authorities created "smoke control areas" where only smokeless fuels could be burned. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "The most significant was the Clean Air Act of 1956, which restricted coal burning in urban areas and promoted cleaner energy sources."
B. After "Despite progress, air pollution remains a global challenge."
C. After "Many cities still struggle with poor air quality due to industrial activities, vehicle emissions, and other sources."
D. After "The Great Smog of London serves as a stark reminder of the need to address environmental issues to protect public health."

2026-04-29（5 套）

2026-04-29 Climate Change Impacts

原文（Passage）

The Impact of Climate Change on Coral Reefs

Coral reefs are among the most diverse and valuable ecosystems on Earth, providing habitat for countless marine species. However, climate change poses a severe threat to these vibrant underwater communities. Rising sea temperatures lead to coral bleaching, a phenomenon where corals lose their color and essential symbiotic algae, resulting in weakened corals that are more susceptible to disease.

In addition to temperature changes, climate change contributes to ocean acidification through increased atmospheric CO2 levels. Ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium

carbonate, a crucial component of coral skeletons. [A] As the acidity of seawater increases, corals struggle to maintain their structures, leading to diminished reef growth and stability. [B] Efforts to mitigate these impacts include developing coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification. [C] Scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as potential solutions. Furthermore, initiatives to reduce CO2 emissions globally aim to alleviate the stress on coral reefs. [D] The survival of coral reefs depends largely on addressing climate change comprehensively.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is coral bleaching?

A. An increase in coral growth
B. An effect of high temperatures that harms coral
C. A method of coral reproduction
D. A protective mechanism used by corals

Q2. What is the effect of ocean acidification on coral reefs?

A. It leads to temperature changes in the surrounding waters.
B. It can increase atmospheric CO2 levels, resulting in bleaching.
C. It reduces the availability of the calcium carbonate needed for coral structures.
D. It leads to more stability within existing reefs.

Q3. The word "mitigate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. research
B. alleviate
C. measure
D. predict

Q4. What is suggested in the passage about selective breeding and genetic modification?

A. They are the only solutions to coral bleaching.
B. They are potential methods to develop resilient coral species.
C. They are proven to reverse ocean acidification.
D. They help reduce CO2 emissions.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "The absence of calcium carbonate also reduces the ability of corals to support diverse marine life and protect coastal ecosystems." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-29 Evolution Of Choreography

原文（Passage）

The New Dimensions Of Choreography

Choreography (the composition and arrangement of dance), once a ceremonial and courtly discipline rooted in ritualistic precision, has undergone a profound metamorphosis shaped by cultural shifts and artistic redefinition. Initially governed by strict formalism—particularly in classical ballet—it emphasized symmetry, control, and hierarchy. However, the 20th century witnessed a radical departure from these conventions. Visionaries like Martha Graham redefined dance as a medium for emotional expression and psychological depth, challenging ballet’s aesthetic rigidity and introducing vocabularies of movement that embraced tension, release, and groundedness, which emphasizes a strong connection to the earth or floor. This evolution

marked a transition from spectacle to narrative, with choreography becoming a conduit for storytelling and social commentary.

Today, choreography increasingly reflects a decentralization of artistic authority. [A] Rather than a single choreographer dictating movement, many contemporary works emerge from collaborative processes among dancers, composers, designers, and digital artists. [B] This co-creative model not only democratizes authorship but also fosters performances that are adaptive and responsive—sometimes even improvised or altered in real time. The boundaries between creator and performer blur, yielding works that resist fixed interpretation. [C] In this context, choreography becomes less a finished product and more a living dialogue among disciplines, identities, and ideas. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “profound” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. gradual
B. permanent
C. complex
D. fundamental

Q2. Why does the author discuss Martha Graham’s approach to dance?

A. To illustrate an important shift from formalism to expressive movement
B. To highlight the continuity between ceremonial dance and modern techniques
C. To argue that ballet remains the dominant form of choreography
D. To suggest that Graham’s style was more technically demanding than ballet

Q3. What does the author suggest about the role of the choreographer in contemporary dance?

A. The choreographer’s role is increasingly shared with other contributors.
B. The choreographer is solely responsible for all artistic decisions.
C. The choreographer no longer participates in the creative process.
D. The choreographer’s relation to collaborators has become more hierarchical.

Q4. Which of the following best describes the evolution of choreography over time?

A. A shift from narrative to social commentary
B. A movement toward stricter formalism
C. A transformation from rigid constraints to flexibility
D. A return to ceremonial traditions

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "In many cases, contributors shape the thematic and emotional direction of a piece, influencing its development from within the creative process." Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-29 Great Smog of London

原文（Passage）

The Great Smog of London

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and pollutants. The primary sources were coal-burning fires for heating homes and factories, releasing sulfur dioxide and other toxic chemicals.
As the smog settled, it became a health crisis. Visibility was reduced to a few meters, and transportation was disrupted. Many people abandoned their cars, and the ambulance service was severely impacted. Thousands developed respiratory problems, and the death rate surged. The Great Smog caused up to 12,000 premature deaths and countless illnesses. Hospitals were overwhelmed with patients, and morgues quickly reached capacity.
In response, the British government took action. New regulations aimed at reducing air pollution were established. The most significant was the Clean Air Act of 1956, which restricted coal burning in urban areas and promoted cleaner energy sources. [A]
Despite progress, air pollution remains a global challenge. [B] Many cities still struggle with poor air quality due to industrial activities, vehicle emissions, and other sources. [C] The Great Smog of London serves as a stark reminder of the need to address environmental issues to protect public health. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about the 1952 Great Smog of London?

A. It affected several other European cities.
B. It resulted from multiple factors that occurred simultaneously.
C. It disrupted the normal activities of factories for five days.
D. It made residents switch to coal to heat their homes.

Q2. The word "premature" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. early
B. recorded
C. preventable
D. likely

Q3. Why was the Great Smog of London considered a pivotal event?

A. It lasted longer than usual.
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Q4. Why does the author bring up the impact on the ambulance service?

A. To highlight one of the results of low visibility
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A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-29 Sleep And Memory

原文（Passage）

Sleep And Memory

Sleep is not merely a passive period of rest; it plays an active role in the consolidation of memory, a process that has been extensively examined by neuroscientists over several decades. During sleep, distinct stages—most notably rapid-eye-movement (REM) sleep and deep sleep—contribute in different ways to how memories are stored and organized. Experimental research suggests that while REM sleep strengthens emotionally charged memories, deep sleep supports the retention of factual knowledge and the acquisition of skills.

Some researchers further propose that sleep functions as a kind of neural “data management” system. [A] While awake, the brain continuously forms new connections as it processes incoming information, creating a dense and potentially inefficient network. [B] During sleep, however, unnecessary connections are trimmed, whereas essential ones are reinforced, [C] a reorganization that enhances the brain’s ability to retrieve information accurately. [D]

Not surprisingly, sleep deprivation has been shown to impair memory retention and conceptual integration. Even a single night of lost sleep can reduce recall and interfere with learning. Nevertheless, studies also indicate that recovery sleep—particularly when it is deep and uninterrupted—can partially reverse these effects, suggesting that although sleep is critical for memory, the brain retains a limited capacity to adapt to disruption.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “retention” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. creation
B. replacement
C. transfer
D. preservation

Q2. REM sleep and deep sleep differ in which of the following ways?

A. Deep sleep is limited to the early stages of the sleep cycle, while REM sleep is not.
B. REM sleep is more important for skill development than deep sleep.
C. REM sleep involves less brain activity than deep sleep.
D. REM sleep and deep sleep are each linked to separate types of memory.

Q3. The passage suggests which of the following about the effect of sleep on memory?

A. Sleep improves memory primarily by increasing the total number of neural connections.
B. Sleep improves memory by selectively eliminating some neural connections.
C. Sleep affects the strength of memories only during the rapid-eye-movement (REM) stage.
D. Sleep strengthens the memory of emotionally charged events but not of factual information.

Q4. Why does the author use the phrase “Not surprisingly” to begin paragraph 3?

A. To suggest that the effects of sleep deprivation follow logically from earlier claims
B. To emphasize that people are often conscious of memory lapses after a period of poor sleep
C. To point out a reason for scientists' interest in establishing a link between sleep and memory
D. To acknowledge that sleep quality is as essential to memory retention as sleep quantity

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "This interpretation focuses on the vital role sleep plays in helping the brain function in an optimal way." Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-29 Synthetic Diamonds

原文（Passage）

Synthetic Diamonds

Traditionally, diamonds were extracted from mines, a process fraught with environmental concerns. Synthetic diamonds offer a promising alternative.

Creating synthetic diamonds involves replicating the conditions under which natural diamonds form. One popular method is High Pressure High Temperature (HPHT), where carbon is subjected to extreme heat and pressure. HPHT diamonds can be produced quickly and in large quantities, making them suitable for mass production. However, they may contain metallic inclusions from the catalysts used, which can affect clarity and color.

Another method is Chemical Vapor Deposition (CVD), which grows diamonds layer by layer from carbon-rich gases in a vacuum chamber. CVD diamonds typically have fewer impurities and offer greater control over clarity and size. Although CVD diamonds can be produced on a large scale, CVD production is often more technically demanding and slower, which may influence cost.

[A] Both HPHT and CVD methods produce diamonds that are chemically and physically identical to natural diamonds. [B] They share the same hardness, brilliance, and clarity, making them suitable for jewelry. [C] Consumers are often skeptical of synthetic diamonds, as they associate rarity and historical significance only with natural diamonds. [D] Nevertheless, the market for synthetic diamonds continues to grow, driven by their affordability, sustainability, and ethical appeal.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that one advantage of synthetic diamonds over natural diamonds is that

A. producing synthetic diamonds requires less heat than mining natural diamonds does
B. producing synthetic diamonds is less harmful to the environment than mining natural diamonds is
C. synthetic diamonds are physically and chemically superior to natural diamonds
D. synthetic diamonds are available in a greater variety than natural diamonds are

Q2. The word "replicating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. analyzing
B. recreating
C. altering
D. enhancing

Q3. According to the passage, what is one advantage of HPHT diamonds over CVD diamonds?

A. They are of higher quality.
B. They are easier to produce.
C. They can more readily be used for jewelry.
D. They have better clarity and color.

Q4. Why does the passage mention the "rarity and historical significance" of natural diamonds?

A. To emphasize that consumers should continue using natural diamonds for most purposes
B. To support the claim that the market for natural diamonds is growing
C. To explain why the acceptance of synthetic diamonds is somewhat limited
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Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "And because of the controlled conditions in which they are produced, synthetic diamonds are

actually preferred for industrial uses, such as in cutting tools and electronic devices." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-27（1 套）

2026-04-27 Dark Galaxy Mysteries

原文（Passage）

The Mystery of Dark Galaxies

Ultraviolet (UV) astronomy has unveiled numerous cosmic phenomena. An especially intriguing discovery is that of dark galaxies. Unlike typical galaxies (gravitationally bound systems of stars, gas, and other particles), dark galaxies emit little to no visible light, making them nearly impossible to detect using conventional optical telescopes. However, these galaxies emit UV radiation, providing astronomers with a unique window to study them. [A] Dark galaxies challenge our understanding of galaxy formation. [B] Traditional models suggest that galaxies form through gas accumulation and star formation. [C] But although dark galaxies contain vast amounts of gas, they have few, if any, stars. [D] This raises questions about the processes that inhibit star formation. Some researchers propose that turbulence within the gas clouds might prevent the gas from collapsing to form stars.

Observations from the Hubble Space Telescope and other UV-sensitive instruments have revealed that dark galaxies were more common in the early universe. These findings suggest that dark galaxies may represent a primordial phase in galaxy evolution. One hypothesis is that high levels of UV radiation in the early universe prevented the gas in dark galaxies from cooling and condensing into stars. Observations of regions with high UV radiation support this theory.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that astronomers discovered dark galaxies by

A. studying numerous cosmic phenomena caused by them
B. observing their gravitational effects on other galaxies
C. seeing them through conventional optical telescopes
D. detecting UV radiation emitted by them

Q2. What might prevent the formation of stars in dark galaxies?

A. The accumulation of too much gas
B. The turbulence inside gas clouds
C. The presence of nearby galaxies
D. The collapse of gas clouds

Q3. Observations from the Hubble Space Telescope and other UV-sensitive instruments indicate that

A. the number of dark galaxies in the universe increased over time
B. dark galaxies contain more gas than previously believed
C. dark galaxies emit more UV radiation than previously believed
D. dark galaxies represent an early stage in galaxy development

Q4. Observations of dark-galaxy regions with high UV radiation indicate that

A. dark galaxies evolved very slowly
B. stars in the early universe were fairly cool and dense
C. UV radiation in the early universe kept gas temperatures high

D. a traditional theory of how dark galaxies formed is incorrect

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Therefore, one might expect all galaxies to have a significant number of stars. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "However, these galaxies emit UV radiation, providing astronomers with a unique window to study them."

B. After "Dark galaxies challenge our understanding of galaxy formation."

C. After "Traditional models suggest that galaxies form through gas accumulation and star formation."

D. After "But although dark galaxies contain vast amounts of gas, they have few, if any, stars."

2026-04-22（2 套）

2026-04-22 Carthage Trade Network

原文（Passage）

Carthage's Trade Network

Carthage, founded by Phoenician merchants around 814 B.C.E., became a powerful city-state due to its strategic location on the Mediterranean. This position allowed Carthage to establish a vast trade network that extended across the Mediterranean and into Africa, Europe, and Asia. Carthaginian traders dealt in goods such as silver, gold, tin, and textiles.

The Carthaginians excelled in maritime technology, constructing advanced ships for long-distance journeys and bulky cargo transport. They developed efficient trade routes and set up colonies, expanding their economic reach. Their prowess in navigation and trade transformed Carthage into one of the wealthiest cities in the ancient world. Carthage's wealth was also built on innovations in agriculture. Carthaginian farmers employed advanced irrigation techniques and crop rotation, leading to abundant harvests that supported both local consumption and export.

However, Carthage's rise did not come without challenges. Its growing wealth and dominance in trade led to rivalry with Rome. The Punic Wars, a series of three wars fought against Rome from 264 to 146 B.C.E., were rooted in competition for control of Mediterranean trade routes. Despite initial successes, Carthage was ultimately defeated. The final blow came when the Romans launched a brutal siege on Carthage, culminating in the city's destruction.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following contributed to the status of Carthage as a wealthy and powerful city-state EXCEPT

A. its geographic position

B. its trade network across three continents

C. its large fishing industry

D. its ship-building technology

Q2. The passage indicates which of the following about Carthage's maritime technology?

A. Carthage's ships were designed primarily for the transport of small items of high value, such as silver and gold.

B. Carthage's ships were not as advanced as Roman ships.

C. Carthaginians developed a system of switching ships at colonial ports to go longer distances.

D. Carthaginians were skilled at navigating over long distances.

Q3. What can be concluded from the passage about Carthaginian agriculture?

A. It was far inferior to Carthaginian maritime technology.

B. It produced more than enough food to feed the Carthaginians.

C. Its innovations borrowed much from Roman technical knowledge.

D. It was transformed by farmers from Africa, Europe, and Asia.

Q4. What can be inferred about the consequences of Carthage's success?

A. It led to mutually beneficial relations with Rome.
B. It caused internal strife among Carthaginian traders.
C. It led to a neglect of the military.
D. It contributed to external conflicts.

Q5. The phrase "culminating in" in the final sentence is closest in meaning to

A. revealing
B. ending with
C. coinciding with
D. following

2026-04-22 Renewable Energy Engineering

原文（Passage）

Advancements in Renewable Energy Engineering

[A] Photovoltaic (PV) cells that convert sunlight into electricity are one innovative solution to harness renewable energy. [B] When sunlight hits the PV cell, it is absorbed by a semiconductor material, usually silicon. The energy from the light knocks electrons loose from atoms, creating a flow of electric current. This current is then captured and can be used to power electrical devices. A common misconception is that, at night, PV cells store energy like a battery. [C] In fact, they convert sunlight into electricity in real time; to store energy, a separate energy storage system, like a battery, is required. [D] Researchers are also developing what are called moonlight solar panels, which can generate electricity at night, during rain, and under overcast skies. They make renewable energy a more viable option in diverse environments.

Floating wind farms are another interesting innovation. Mounted on buoyant platforms tethered to the ocean floor, they can be deployed far from land, where wind speeds are often stronger and more consistent than those on land. Underwater cables transmit electricity they generate back to shore. While challenges such as maintenance and initial costs persist, the long-term benefits are substantial.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what does NOT occur inside PV cells?

A. Silicon or another material absorbs sunlight.
B. Electrons become less tightly bound to atoms.
C. A flow of electric current is captured.
D. Electricity is stored in a battery.

Q2. What does the author indicate about moonlight solar panels?

A. They are more efficient and cost-effective than traditional PV cells.
B. They can function in low-light conditions.
C. They can be used to store energy over a long period of time.
D. They do not convert energy in real time.

Q3. The word "viable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. practical
B. predictable
C. valuable
D. adaptable

Q4. The passage suggests that, compared to traditional wind farms, what is an advantage of floating wind farms?

A. They harness wind energy in larger amounts and more consistently.
B. They are easier to install and maintain.
C. They use underwater cables, which are more cost-effective than cables installed on land.
D. They last for a longer time.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. How do they work? Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "Photovoltaic (PV) cells that convert sunlight into electricity are one innovative solution to harness renewable energy."
B. After "Photovoltaic (PV) cells that convert sunlight into electricity are one innovative solution to harness renewable energy."
C. After "A common misconception is that, at night, PV cells store energy like a battery."
D. After "In fact, they convert sunlight into electricity in real time; to store energy, a separate energy storage system, like a battery, is required."

2026-04-19（2 套）

2026-04-19 Ancient Aqueduct Engineering

原文（Passage）

Ancient Aqueducts

Aqueducts are among the most impressive engineering feats of ancient civilizations. [A] Aqueducts are structures built to transport water from a distant source to cities and towns. [B] The Romans, in particular, perfected the construction of aqueducts, using gravity to carry water over long distances. [C] Roman aqueducts were made of stone, brick, and concrete and included tunnels, bridges, and pipes. [D] The aqueducts were essential to the growth and sustainability of Roman cities. They supplied water for public baths, fountains, households, and agriculture. One famous example is the Pont du Gard in France. Built in the first century A.D., it spans 50 kilometers and features a three-tiered bridge that remains standing today.

Aqueducts were not unique to the Roman Empire. Ancient Greece, Persia, and India also developed systems for water transport. Persian aqueducts, known as qanats, were underground channels tapping groundwater sources. These systems were exceptionally durable and could last for centuries. However, constructing and maintaining aqueducts required significant resources and labor. Despite these challenges, aqueducts were essential investments in ancient infrastructure and played a crucial role in development.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "feats" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. examples
B. achievements
C. skills
D. investments

Q2. Why does the author mention public baths, fountains, households, and agriculture?

A. To imply that the construction of Roman aqueducts required a lot of effort
B. To indicate that Roman cities needed more water than aqueducts could provide
C. To emphasize the rapid growth and impressive sustainability of Roman cities
D. To explain the usefulness of Roman aqueducts

Q3. What specific ancient structure is mentioned in the passage as still existing today?

A. A tunnel
B. A bridge

C. A fountain
D. A channel

Q4. What problem with ancient aqueducts is mentioned in the passage?

A. The environmental damage they caused by using groundwater
B. The limited amount of water they could provide
C. Their frequent lack of durability
D. The cost and effort of building and maintaining them

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. This meant that the source of the water had to be higher than the city to which it was brought. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "Aqueducts are among the most impressive engineering feats of ancient civilizations."
B. After "Aqueducts are structures built to transport water from a distant source to cities and towns."
C. After "The Romans, in particular, perfected the construction of aqueducts, using gravity to carry water over long distances."
D. After "Roman aqueducts were made of stone, brick, and concrete and included tunnels, bridges, and pipes."

2026-04-19 Medieval Philosophy Debates

原文（Passage）

Medieval European Philosophy

In the European medieval period (between the fifth and fifteenth centuries), philosophy was a major field of study. Scholars like Peter Abelard and Thomas Aquinas were influenced by ancient Greek philosophy but also had their own ideas. [A] A key focus was the nature of universals--whether abstract concepts like "beauty" or "justice" exist independently of the mind. Abelard, a twelfth-century philosopher, argued that universals are merely linguistic constructs, existing only in our language and thoughts. [B] This nominalist perspective contrasted sharply with the realism of ancient Greek scholars like Plato, who believed that universals exist in an independent realm. Abelard's views sparked intense debates among his contemporaries. [C] Thomas Aquinas, influenced by the ancient Greek philosopher Aristotle, offered a different approach. He suggested that universals exist both in the mind and in reality. [D] For Aquinas, the human mind perceives universals through experiences of particular things. Seeing a beautiful flower, for example, helps us grasp the idea of beauty itself. This theory, known as moderate realism, bridged the gap between nominalism and classical realism. Aquinas' synthesis of Aristotelian philosophy and nominalism had an enduring impact on medieval thought, and the debate over universals shaped the entire medieval intellectual landscape.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the passage mainly about?

A. A major historical event in medieval Europe
B. An argument about the nature of abstract concepts
C. A similarity between ancient Greek and medieval philosophies
D. A legacy of two major medieval European thinkers

Q2. According to the passage, which philosopher was a proponent of pure nominalism?

A. Abelard
B. Aquinas
C. Plato

D. Aristotle

Q3. Moderate realism claimed which of the following?

A. People can perceive universals by seeing particular objects.

B. The idea of beauty is too abstract for the human mind to grasp.

C. Nominalism focuses too much on people's personal experience.

D. Even particular things like flowers exist only in the human mind.

Q4. The word "synthesis" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. teaching

B. improvement

C. understanding

D. combination

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Did universals exist in reality or only in the language and mind? Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "Scholars like Peter Abelard and Thomas Aquinas were influenced by ancient Greek philosophy but also had their own ideas."

B. After "Abelard, a twelfth-century philosopher, argued that universals are merely linguistic constructs, existing only in our language and thoughts."

C. After "Abelard's views sparked intense debates among his contemporaries."

D. After "He suggested that universals exist both in the mind and in reality."

2026-04-15（2 套）

2026-04-15 Magnetic Confinement Fusion

原文（Passage）

Magnetic Confinement Fusion

Magnetic confinement fusion is a promising approach for generating clean electricity. This technology fuses deuterium and tritium, heavy forms of hydrogen, to release energy while producing minimal radioactive waste when compared to current technologies to produce nuclear power. The basic principle was first demonstrated in 1957: powerful magnetic fields contain extremely hot plasma at temperatures reaching 150 million degrees Celsius--ten times hotter than the sun's core. Without magnetic containment, the plasma would instantly cool upon touching reactor walls, halting the fusion process.

Since those early breakthroughs, researchers have built increasingly sophisticated magnetic confinement reactors called tokamaks. The International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor (ITER), currently under construction, represents the culmination of decades of magnetic confinement research. ITER aims to demonstrate sustained fusion reactions that produce more energy than they consume--a critical milestone called net energy gain.

However, significant challenges remain before magnetic fusion can generate commercial electricity. Current experiments require enormous energy inputs to maintain plasma conditions, and the intense neutron radiation gradually damages reactor materials. Additionally, converting fusion energy into usable electricity requires developing efficient heat-to-power conversion systems. Despite these obstacles, successful demonstration of net energy gain could pave the way for fusion power plants by the 2040s.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what significant achievement in fusion research occurred in 1957?

A. Researchers successfully fused deuterium and tritium atoms for the first time.

B. Researchers demonstrated that magnetic fields could contain extremely hot plasma.
C. Researchers estimated the temperature of the sun's core to be 150 million degrees Celsius.
D. Researchers discovered the basic principle that explains the existence of heavy forms of hydrogen.

Q2. Why does the author mention plasma touching reactor walls?

A. To explain how the plasma is contained within the reactor
B. To point out how researchers cool plasma after heating it for experiments
C. To demonstrate the final step in achieving nuclear fusion
D. To clarify why magnetic confinement techniques are necessary

Q3. The word "sophisticated" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. advanced
B. large
C. expensive
D. successful

Q4. According to the passage, what is ITER's primary objective?

A. To generate commercial electricity for distribution to power grids
B. To demonstrate that magnetic confinement techniques are not environmentally sustainable
C. To prove that fusion reactions can produce more energy than they consume
D. To challenge decades of magnetic confinement research

Q5. Which of the following is mentioned as one factor that currently prevents magnetic fusion from generating commercial electricity?

A. Insufficient global supplies of reactor materials
B. Inability to achieve intense neutron radiation
C. High energy demands for plasma maintenance
D. Lack of magnetic fields that are powerful enough

2026-04-15 Veganism in America

原文（Passage）

Veganism in the United States

Veganism, a dietary approach that excludes all animal-based foods, has experienced notable shifts in popularity in the United States. A study conducted in 2020 showed a dramatic increase in the number of Americans adopting a plant-based diet between 2004 and 2019. This growth was fueled by expanding awareness of animal welfare, environmental concerns linked to industrial agriculture, and increased emphasis on healthy eating. During the 2010s, companies began to market plant-based meat alternatives that became highly popular with both restaurants and home cooks.

By the mid-2020s, however, momentum began to level off. Surveys in 2025 indicated that only about three to four percent of Americans identified as vegan. Several factors contributed to this plateau. Preparing vegan meals can be more involved than preparing meat-based meals. For example, a vegan cheese substitute can be made with nuts, but the process is time-consuming. And while home cooks can buy commercially manufactured vegan foods, those foods are highly processed, raising concerns about their healthfulness. Additionally, some social media influencers have begun to promote increased protein consumption, sparking increased consumer demand for meat. American food trends come and go, but while some consumers adopt extreme diets, Americans overall seem to be favoring more flexibility in their eating habits.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The main purpose of this passage is to

A. describe the birth of veganism in the United States
B. list the benefits of a vegan diet
C. analyze some changes in Americans' attitudes toward veganism
D. identify trends in American consumer preferences

Q2. The author notes all of the following as factors driving the popularity of veganism EXCEPT

A. concern for animals
B. considerations about health
C. the high cost of consuming meat
D. a desire to protect the environment

Q3. The word "involved" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. unsatisfying
B. expensive
C. unpleasant
D. complicated

Q4. The author mentions "a vegan cheese substitute" primarily in order to

A. note a challenge inherent in preparing vegan meals
B. identify a popular item used in many vegan recipes
C. contrast the healthfulness of vegan and animal-based foods
D. describe a cooking process popularized by vegans

Q5. The passage suggests which of the following about commercial meat-alternative products?

A. They became increasingly popular with home cooks during the mid-2020s.
B. They are produced in a way that causes some people to doubt their healthfulness.
C. They are not popular with Americans concerned about food allergies.
D. They have greatly improved in flavor since their introduction.

2026-04-13（3 套）

2026-04-13 Feedback System Complications

原文（Passage）

Feedback Systems and Their Unintended Effects

Control engineering is a branch of engineering focused on designing systems that regulate themselves to achieve desired behaviors, often through feedback mechanisms. These systems monitor their output and adjust their input accordingly, forming closed-loop mechanisms that maintain stability and performance. While this self-regulating nature is a core strength, feedback loops can also introduce unexpected complications.

Consider how feedback controls temperature in a home heating system: A thermostat compares the current temperature to a set point and modifies the heating output based on the difference. However, time delays in this loop can cause overcorrections, resulting in temperature fluctuations. If the feedback response is not precisely calibrated, the system may oscillate continuously, failing to stabilize.

[A] In more complex systems, such as automated flight control or robotic motion, feedback mechanisms can behave unpredictably under certain conditions. [B] For example, small timing mismatches or overly sensitive sensors may cause a drone to overreact to minor disturbances, leading to erratic flight patterns. [C] This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior, reveals that feedback is not inherently stabilizing. [D] Instead, it demands careful tuning and predictive modeling. As control engineering advances, understanding and mitigating this unpredictability will be essential for ensuring reliability and precision, especially in high-stakes fields like aerospace and robotics.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what advantage do closed-loop feedback systems provide?

A. They can be easily adjusted using remote controls.
B. They continuously monitor their own performance.
C. They are less complicated than other feedback systems.
D. They assist engineers in creating more stable designs.

Q2. What happens when a home heating system is not precisely calibrated as described in paragraph 2?

A. The temperature in the house goes up and down rather than remaining at a constant level.
B. The temperature in the house remains well below the set point.
C. The thermostat is unable to correctly determine the current temperature in the house.
D. The home heating system is likely to break down under the stress of frequent oscillations.

Q3. Why does the author discuss drones in paragraph 3?

A. To argue that drones are so unstable that they pose a safety risk to the public
B. To suggest that controlling drones is easier than controlling robots
C. To provide an example of chaotic behavior in a feedback system
D. To explain how navigational sensors function during flight

Q4. The word "mitigating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. preventing
B. monitoring
C. decreasing
D. analyzing

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. A sudden gust of wind, for instance, might trigger an exaggerated correction, making the drone veer sharply or wobble midair instead of stabilizing smoothly. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "In more complex systems, such as automated flight control or robotic motion, feedback mechanisms can behave unpredictably under certain conditions."
B. Before "For example, small timing mismatches or overly sensitive sensors may cause a drone to overreact to minor disturbances, leading to erratic flight patterns."
C. Before "This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior, reveals that feedback is not inherently stabilizing."
D. Before "Instead, it demands careful tuning and predictive modeling."

2026-04-13 Music Therapy Power

原文（Passage）

The Power of Music Therapy

Music therapy is known for its powerful effects on mental health. By using musical interventions, therapists aim to improve people's emotional well-being and cognitive functioning.

The roots of music therapy trace back to ancient healing rituals, but its modern form appeared after World War II, when musicians played for veterans suffering from trauma. Research shows that music therapy can reduce anxiety and stress. Listening to calming music can lower heart rates and cortisol levels. [A] This is why music therapy is often used in hospitals. A study found that patients who listened to 30 minutes of music daily experienced significant reductions in anxiety. [B] Engaging with familiar music can also trigger pleasant memories and improve mood. Patients who participated in music therapy showed better memory recall and increased social

interaction. [C] A study demonstrated that Alzheimer's patients who listened to music from their youth had improved cognitive function.
Despite its benefits, music therapy is not a one-size-fits-all solution. Its effectiveness varies depending on the individual and type of music used. [D] Personal musical preferences, cultural background, and the context in which the music is played are crucial to the therapy's success.

题目（Questions）

Q1. How did music therapy in its modern form begin?

A. As a way to improve the cognitive functioning of soldiers
B. As a result of the careful study of ancient healing practices
C. As a means to treat people suffering from Alzheimer's disease
D. As a tool to help veterans cope with the effects of the war

Q2. The word "trigger" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. bring
B. shoot
C. heal
D. enjoy

Q3. Why does the author mention listening to music daily for 30 minutes?

A. To indicate how long a music therapy session should last
B. To support a claim about music therapy's effectiveness
C. To explain why a study was conducted in a hospital
D. To suggest that music therapy should be practiced at home

Q4. According to the passage, all of the following can affect the benefit of a music therapy session for a patient EXCEPT

A. what kind of music the patient prefers
B. which culture the patient is from
C. in what environment the music is played
D. how knowledgeable the patient is about music

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Both cognitive and social benefits persisted long after the treatment sessions had ended. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "This is why music therapy is often used in hospitals."
B. After "A study found that patients who listened to 30 minutes of music daily experienced significant reductions in anxiety."
C. Before "A study demonstrated that Alzheimer's patients who listened to music from their youth had improved cognitive function."
D. Before "Personal musical preferences, cultural background, and the context in which the music is played are crucial to the therapy's success."

2026-04-13 Quantum Computing Revolution

原文（Passage）

Quantum Computing
Quantum computing promises to revolutionize technology by delivering unprecedented computational power. Traditional computers store data in binary bits, representing 0 or 1. Quantum computers use qubits, which can represent 0, 1, or both simultaneously (a state called superposition). This allows quantum computers to process vast amounts of data simultaneously, solving complex problems much faster than classical computers.

Quantum computing has promising applications in cryptography--techniques for encoding and decoding messages. Current encryption (encoding) methods rely on complex algorithms that classical computers struggle to break. Quantum computers could potentially break these encryption algorithms with ease, requiring new, quantum-resistant techniques. Researchers are exploring such methods to secure data in a post-quantum world.

One challenge to fully realizing quantum computing is that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances. [A] Maintaining coherence, the state needed by qubits to perform calculations, requires extremely low temperatures and isolation from environmental noise, such as magnetic or electric field fluctuations. [B] Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating. [C] Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues. [D] Quantum computing holds promise for advancements in fields like medicine, finance, and artificial intelligence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "revolutionize" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. simplify
B. transform
C. study
D. use

Q2. Why does the author discuss binary bits and qubits?

A. To explain why quantum computers are more powerful than classical computers are
B. To discuss the two ways in which quantum computers store data
C. To emphasize the fast pace at which computing technology is advancing
D. To explain what causes the state of superposition

Q3. According to the passage, new encryption techniques are needed in the post-quantum world because

A. quantum computers are less secure
B. quantum computers store more valuable data than classical computers do
C. quantum computers can break existing encryption
D. quantum computers cannot process current encryption algorithms

Q4. Why does the author mention "external disturbances"?

A. To point out that qubits can only function in certain environmental conditions
B. To introduce a similarity between quantum computing and traditional computing
C. To explain how quantum computing creates unwanted fluctuations in magnetic or electric fields
D. To suggest that quantum computing can be prohibitively expensive

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Seeing progress, companies and governments have begun to invest heavily in quantum research, aiming to unlock its potential. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "One challenge to fully realizing quantum computing is that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances."
B. Before "Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating."
C. Before "Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues."
D. Before "Quantum computing holds promise for advancements in fields like medicine, finance, and artificial intelligence."

2026-04-12（1 套）

2026-04-12 Genetically Modified Foods

原文（Passage）

Genetically Modified Foods

The use of genetically modified organisms (GMOs) in foods has raised a number of concerns, yet genetic modification (GM) technology can provide solutions to many persistent problems facing humanity.

For instance, by engineering crops to resist pests, tolerate drought, or grow in nutrient-poor soil, farmers can produce more food with fewer resources. This can be especially valuable in regions facing food insecurity or harsh environmental conditions. GM technology can also enhance nutritional content. Rice, for example, can be enriched with vitamin A to combat malnutrition. Furthermore, reduced reliance on chemical pesticides benefits both the environment and farm workers.

Yet some critics anticipate harm from GMOs. One major issue is ecological impact. Genetically modified plants may crossbreed with wild species, potentially disrupting ecosystems or reducing biodiversity. GM critics also worry about long-term health effects, even though current scientific consensus finds GM foods safe to eat. Additionally, GM technology has economic effects: Patented GM seeds can increase farmers' dependence on large biotech companies, raising questions about fairness and control within the food system. Public skepticism remains strong, fueled by limited transparency and the rapid pace of technological change. If GM foods are to serve the public good, thoughtful regulation, candid communication, and ongoing research will be essential.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The primary purpose of the passage is to

A. outline some benefits of GM technology and advocate for its adoption
B. argue that GM technology is too dangerous and should be discontinued
C. summarize some potential benefits and drawbacks related to the use of GM technology
D. propose a set of steps toward resolving the debate over the use of GM technology

Q2. The word "persistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. disastrous
B. long-lasting
C. inconvenient
D. technical

Q3. According to the author, GM technology can do all of the following EXCEPT

A. improve the fertility of soil
B. boost agricultural productivity
C. improve human nutrition
D. protect the health of agricultural workers

Q4. The passage suggests which of the following about "Patented GM seeds"?

A. They can sometimes alter the nutrients in crops in ways that harm human health.
B. Their use can benefit farmers when profits are shared by biotech companies.
C. Their adoption could potentially subject farmers to unfair control by businesses.
D. Their widespread use in agriculture could help to expand and protect biodiversity.

Q5. The author mentions "the rapid pace of technological change" in order to

A. acknowledge the promise that GM technology holds for farmers
B. suggest why research on the health effects of GM technology has lagged

C. question one argument used to advocate for expanded use of GM technology
D. explain some of the resistance to implementation of GM technology

2026-04-11（5 套）

2026-04-11 Behavioral Economics

原文（Passage）

Behavioral Economics

Behavioral economics merges psychology and economics to understand financial decisions. Traditional theories assume individuals act rationally based on logical analysis. However, behavioral economists find human behavior often deviates from these expectations. Cognitive biases, emotions, and social factors can lead to irrational choices.

[A] One key concept is "loss aversion," where people prefer avoiding losses rather than acquiring gains. [B] For example, individuals might avoid selling a declining stock in the hope of recovering their losses, even when the stock is unlikely to rebound. [C] Rational theory would suggest selling the stock to minimize further losses. [D]

Another concept is "anchoring," where individuals rely too heavily on the first piece of information they receive (the "anchor") when making decisions. For example, if an investor learns a stock was priced at $100 last month but has dropped to $80, they might perceive the lower price as a bargain, regardless of the stock's actual value. The company's earnings may have dropped significantly, making $80 a fair or even high price. Anchoring can thus lead to suboptimal investment choices.

Behavioral economics has implications for financial markets and investment strategies. By understanding psychological factors, economists can design better tools to help people make informed choices.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that one key assumption underlying behavioral economics is that

A. social factors enhance responsible decision-making in financial matters
B. traditional theories of financial decision-making rely too heavily on cognitive biases
C. humans sometimes act irrationally in making financial decisions
D. decisions involving financial matters are usually based on logical analysis

Q2. The word "deviates" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. benefits
B. differs
C. stems
D. distracts

Q3. Which of the following is mentioned in the passage as an example of loss aversion?

A. Buying a stock because it is priced lower than it was the previous month
B. Selling a declining stock to avoid further losses
C. Keeping a declining stock in the misguided hope that it will go up in value
D. Investing in a stock based solely on trends in financial markets

Q4. According to the passage, which of the following could be considered anchoring?

A. An investor prefers to invest in companies whose earnings are dropping.
B. An investor consults multiple sources about a stock’s price before investing in it.
C. An investor mistrusts the initial information they receive about a stock.
D. An investor makes an investment decision based on the first piece of information they receive.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "This behavior is based primarily on emotion." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-11 Echoes Of The Deep

原文（Passage）

Echoes Of The Deep

Cetaceans—a group of mammals that includes whales, dolphins, and porpoises—use echolocation to navigate and hunt in waters too deep for sunlight to penetrate. [A] Many cetaceans emit clicks, producing sound waves that bounce off objects and return as echoes. Echolocation techniques vary among species, depending on their environments and needs. [B] Dolphins, for instance, produce more frequent and higher-pitched clicks than do larger cetaceans like sperm whales. [C] Although high frequency sounds do not travel as far as low frequencies do, high frequencies with very short wavelengths help dolphins locate small objects and pick out fine detail—the higher the frequencies, the better the detail. [D] This enables dolphins to find and track small, agile fish that make up their diet. Sperm whales, on the other hand, dive deep to hunt prey such as giant squid and use lower-frequency clicks that travel farther in the deep ocean.

Noise pollution can interfere with the echolocation signals used by cetaceans. Human-made sounds—such as those from sonar and ship engines—can make it difficult for whales and dolphins to locate prey, orient themselves, or communicate with others. The disruption can cause stress and disorientation, increasing the risk of collisions and strandings, and it can also induce changes in behavior or habitat.

题目（Questions）

Q1. One of the main themes of the passage is

A. differences between cetaceans and other species
B. vulnerability of cetaceans to disruptive sounds
C. surprising properties of sound waves
D. biological adaptations behind echolocation

Q2. The passage suggests that compared to dolphins, sperm whales hunt

A. slower prey
B. for shorter periods
C. in shallower waters
D. less often

Q3. The word "track" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. follow
B. consume
C. see
D. attack

Q4. The passage suggests that one reason a cetacean may become stranded is

A. lack of light in deep waters
B. difficulty in locating prey
C. sounds from passing ships
D. inability to find a new habitat

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added: "In such environments, hearing is more important than sight." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-11 Sedimentary Rock Formation

原文（Passage）

Formation of Sedimentary Rocks

Sedimentary rocks form through deposition, compaction, and cementation of materials like mineral particles, organic matter, and chemical precipitates. These sediments accumulate in layers, often in bodies of water like rivers, lakes, and oceans. As layers are deposited, the weight of the overlying layers exerts pressure on the sediments below, reducing their volume and ejecting water, a process known as compaction. Cementation occurs when dissolved minerals leave groundwater and fill the spaces between compacted particles, binding them together. This dual process is called lithification, transforming loose sediments into solid rock.

Sedimentary rocks are classified into three primary categories: clastic, chemical, and organic. Clastic sedimentary rocks, such as sandstone and shale, are composed of fragments of pre-existing rocks. Chemical sedimentary rocks, including limestone and gypsum, form from dissolved minerals leaching out of water. Organic sedimentary rocks, like coal, develop from the accumulation and lithification of plant and animal matter.

The study of sedimentary rocks offers insights into Earth's history. These rocks often contain fossils, which are preserved remains of ancient organisms. Fossils can reveal much about past environments, climate conditions, and evolutionary processes. Additionally, the layering of sedimentary rocks can indicate significant geological events, such as volcanic eruptions or changes in sea level.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "ejecting" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. combining with
B. heating
C. forcing out
D. accumulating

Q2. What is the primary process involved in the formation of solid sedimentary rock?

A. Erosion
B. Lithification
C. Fragmentation
D. Evaporation

Q3. What is the role of groundwater in sedimentary rock formation?

A. It provides the compaction needed for the sedimentation process.
B. It eventually dissolves the particles in sedimentary rocks.
C. It carries sediments to new locations.
D. It deposits minerals that bind sediments together.

Q4. Pieces of other types of rock are most likely to be found in which of the following?

A. Sandstone
B. Limestone

C. Coal
D. Fossils

Q5. Why does the author mention fossils in sedimentary rocks?

A. To provide details on the preservation of ancient organisms
B. To introduce an explanation of the types of materials found in sedimentary rocks
C. To highlight the use of fossils in understanding Earth's history
D. To add to an explanation of how past climate conditions are studied

2026-04-11 The Discovery of Vitamins

原文（Passage）

The Discovery of Vitamins

The first vitamin discovered was thiamine (vitamin B_1). It is found in pork, legumes, and rice bran—the outer layer of brown rice that is removed during the milling process to make white rice. Around 1900, researchers realized that rice bran could cure a disease called beriberi. In 1912, Casimir Funk isolated an extract from rice bran that he determined to be an amine (a type of nitrogen compound). Funk proposed that the absence of certain amines in the diet can cause beriberi as well as other diseases. Because these amines were essential for life (vita in Latin), Funk coined the term vitamine. The predominant belief about disease at the time was that it was caused by toxins or infections. The idea that disease could arise from the absence of nutrients was revolutionary.

Thiamine was indeed an amine whose absence can cause beriberi, but Funk's extract likely contained a mixture of substances, and his chemical analysis was incomplete. [A] Only later did researchers successfully isolate thiamine in its pure form.

[B] Additional life-essential nutrients were soon discovered. [C] The problem was that many of them were not amines. [D] The final e was thus dropped from vitamine to make the term less misleading.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about rice bran?

A. It is present in white rice.
B. It is more nutritious than pork and legumes.
C. It contains a life-essential nutrient.
D. It contains chemicals that cause disease.

Q2. Why does the author mention "The predominant belief about disease at the time"?

A. To cite a widely held belief about the importance of vitamins
B. To point out why Casimir Funk held a wrong assumption
C. To suggest that toxins or infections may cause the loss of nutrients
D. To explain why Casimir Funk's proposal was revolutionary

Q3. According to the passage, Casimir Funk was wrong about

A. whether thiamine was present in rice bran
B. whether thiamine was an amine
C. whether the absence of thiamine could cause beriberi
D. whether the substance he extracted was in its pure form

Q4. The passage supports all of the following statements about the term vitamine EXCEPT:

A. It was invented by Casimir Funk.
B. It was a combination of the words vita and amine.
C. It was changed after scientists discovered that not all vitamins were essential for life.
D. It was considered inaccurate because of its association with amines.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Vitamin C, for example, is an acid and contains no nitrogen at all." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-04-11 Urartu Ironworking

原文（Passage）

Early Ironworking In Urartu

The kingdom of Urartu in southwest Asia became a center of iron innovation during the 9th–6th centuries B.C.E. One explanation for Urartu's importance proposes that Urartians' mastery in locating, extracting, and processing local deposits of magnetite—an iron-rich material—accelerated their shift from bronze to iron. This geological explanation is supported by archaeological evidence, including evidence of metalworking at excavated workshops near the fortified city of Teishebaini and analysis of iron artifacts showing unusually low phosphorus content, a sign of high-quality local ore. An alternate view focuses on external pressures: Inscriptions suggest that Urartian kings funded iron foundries in order to produce chariots faster than neighboring Assyria could. Critics argue that this second theory assumes centralized control over raw materials and ignores small village forges identified by satellite surveys.

The geological and military explanations do share this important premise: that large fortresses show the full scale of Urartian industry. Questioning this idea has led scholars to consider rural production alongside royal support as joint drivers of early ironworking. In this light, Urartu appears to have been a society in transition from bronze to iron thanks in part to a complex network of miners, smiths, and planners whose cooperation sparked one of history's key metallurgical revolutions.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the passage?

A. Local magnetite deposits were critical to Urartian iron innovation.
B. Urartu innovated rapidly in spite of military pressure from its neighbors.
C. Innovative iron production by Urartu was likely driven by a range of factors.
D. The discovery of small village forges significantly changed scholarly views about Urartu's iron industry.

Q2. Why does the author provide the information that iron artifacts discovered in Urartu show "unusually low phosphorus content"?

A. To suggest that the high quality of local ore meant that innovations in processing were not important
B. To highlight the idea that the workshops excavated near Teishebaini used iron brought in from elsewhere
C. To help explain why Urartian kings felt the need to fund new, more modern iron foundries
D. To help establish that nearby mineral resources played a role in advancing Urartian metalworking

Q3. Paragraph 1 suggests that which of the following is true of the Urartian-Assyrian relationship?

A. The Assyrians had developed iron foundries long before the Urartians produced iron.
B. The Urartians and Assyrians were military rivals.

C. Assyrian iron foundries relied on Urartian geological deposits.
D. Urartian kings funded ironworking mainly to strengthen trade with Assyria.

Q4. Why does the author provide the information that satellite surveys have identified "small village forges" in Urartu?

A. To introduce the idea that the Urartian iron industry included rural production
B. To support the claim that Urartian kings increased centralized control over raw materials
C. To provide evidence that large fortresses show the full scale of Urartian industry
D. To suggest that Urartian industry was transitioning from urban to rural production

Q5. The word "premise" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. problem
B. assumption
C. detail
D. effect

2026-04-07（2 套）

2026-04-07 Chatbot Technology Evolution

原文（Passage）

Evolution of Chatbots

The evolution of chatbots has revolutionized human-computer interaction. Early chatbots, like ELIZA, developed in the 1960s, followed simple scripts to mimic conversation. However, these early models often failed to understand context, making interactions feel artificial.

Recent advancements in natural language processing (NLP) have significantly improved chatbot capabilities. NLP allows chatbots to interpret and generate human-like responses by understanding context and nuances. This development has enabled chatbots to handle complex queries, provide customer support, and even engage in small talk.

The latest iterations employ generative artificial intelligence (AI) embedded in chatbot systems that train on massive amounts of language data. Their ability to generate coherent and contextually accurate responses has set a new standard for chatbots. Despite these advancements, ensuring that chatbots do not generate harmful or biased content remains a significant concern. According to researchers, the vast amount of data used to train these models can sometimes reflect societal biases, leading to unintended output in chatbot interactions.

Moreover, integrating emotional intelligence into chatbots is an ongoing challenge. Emotional intelligence enables chatbots to recognize and respond appropriately to users' emotions, enhancing the user experience. Researchers are exploring various methods, such as sentiment analysis, to address this issue.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "mimic" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. imitate
B. produce
C. hold
D. control

Q2. According to the passage, what was a limitation of early chatbots like ELIZA?

A. They could not be programmed to follow conversational scripts.
B. Their programming was too complex for most simple interactions.
C. Their communication seemed unnatural.
D. They could not be improved past the early 1960s.

Q3. What is true about recent advancements in natural language processing (NLP)?

A. They eliminate the need for processing large quantities of data.
B. They have allowed chatbots to manage sophisticated inquiries.
C. They have made chatbots easier for technologists to develop.
D. They have occurred mostly in the area of sentiment analysis.

Q4. Why does the author mention generative AI in the passage?

A. To explain what drives the most recent large advance in chatbot systems
B. To highlight the drawbacks of earlier chatbots
C. To provide details about the development of language models
D. To discuss the emotional capabilities of chatbots

Q5. Which of the following challenges is mentioned in the passage regarding the future development of chatbots?

A. Lowering the cost of creating chatbots
B. Preventing chatbots from producing biased output
C. Creating new standards for chatbot development
D. Avoiding negative user sentiment about interacting with chatbots

2026-04-07 Data Visualization Trends

原文（Passage）

Data Visualization in Action

Data visualization is transforming how we interpret complex datasets, moving beyond traditional charts, such as static charts and graphs, to dynamic graphical representations, such as heat maps, time-lapse animations, and network graphs. This shift allows for the discovery of patterns and anomalies otherwise hidden in raw data. For example, when studying climate change impacts, a time-lapse heat map might reveal unexpected temperature shifts over decades that spreadsheets alone could not capture.

A significant development in this field is the use of interactive dashboards. These tools not only display data but also allow users to manipulate variables to explore different scenarios. In the business sector, decision-makers use dashboards to simulate market conditions, adjusting factors like demand and supply to forecast outcomes. However, the effectiveness of these dashboards often hinges on the user's ability to interpret complex visual cues, which can be overwhelming.

In the realm of public health, data visualization has proven invaluable in tracking disease spread. [A] The combination of geographical maps and timelines helps analysts predict outbreak hot spots. [B] Nonetheless, this predictive power depends heavily on the quality of data inputs. [C] Still, data visualization tools help public health officials to act before a situation becomes unmanageable. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "anomalies" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. irregularities
B. indications
C. solutions
D. links

Q2. What does the passage suggest about traditional data charts?

A. They reveal some important features hidden in raw data.
B. They are limited in how effectively they convey complex information.
C. They are especially helpful in capturing data related to climate change.
D. They include heat maps, time-lapse animations, and network graphs.

Q3. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that highlights a limitation of interactive dashboards. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. A significant development in this field is the use of interactive dashboards.

B. These tools not only display data but also allow users to manipulate variables to explore different scenarios.

C. In the business sector, decision-makers use dashboards to simulate market conditions, adjusting factors like demand and supply to forecast outcomes.

D. However, the effectiveness of these dashboards often hinges on the user's ability to interpret complex visual cues, which can be overwhelming.

Q4. The passage mentions all the following about interactive dashboards EXCEPT:

A. They represent an important development in data analysis tools.

B. They let users change variables to see different outcomes.

C. They can be used to explore how markets might behave.

D. They help business leaders interact more effectively with one another.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Incomplete or biased data can lead to misleading conclusions, potentially hampering response efforts. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "In the realm of public health, data visualization has proven invaluable in tracking disease spread."

B. After "The combination of geographical maps and timelines helps analysts predict outbreak hot spots."

C. After "Nonetheless, this predictive power depends heavily on the quality of data inputs."

D. After "Still, data visualization tools help public health officials to act before a situation becomes unmanageable."

2026-04-06（2 套）

2026-04-06 Courtroom Video Evidence

原文（Passage）

Video Evidence in U.S. Courts

In the United States, as in some other countries, video evidence has become integral to the criminal justice system as technological advances have made cameras nearly ubiquitous. Police officers often wear body cameras, security cameras monitor public areas, and nearly everyone carries a smartphone capable of recording high-quality videos. While such recordings are widely seen as reliable evidentiary tools, they have certain limitations.

For example, videos are usually taken from a single vantage point, potentially giving viewers a misleading impression of events. A single camera angle might fail to capture what occurs just outside the frame, leading observers to misinterpret what they see. Additionally, video footage has no way of conveying interpersonal and emotional context: A person's actions might appear antagonistic even if the person was acting in self-defense.

Despite these limitations, legal experts emphasize that video evidence plays a significant role in courtrooms. Jurors (people chosen to consider evidence and decide a case) might dismiss eyewitness testimonies as unreliable or perceive oral accounts as inconsistent, while videos show events more directly. When multiple recordings are available from different angles, an even more reliable sense of an incident can emerge. Nevertheless, courts often remind jurors to evaluate video evidence cautiously.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the relationship between the first sentence and the second sentence of the passage?

A. The first sentence makes a generalization, and the second sentence introduces exceptions to the generalization.

B. The first sentence presents one view of a subject, and the second sentence presents a contrasting view.

C. The first sentence makes a claim, and the second sentence provides examples to illustrate that claim.

D. The first sentence introduces a question, and the second sentence offers possible answers to the question.

Q2. The passage suggests which of the following about viewers of videos?

A. They are more likely to trust the accuracy of a video recorded on a police officer's body camera than one taken with a smartphone.

B. They may not find a video recording of an incident as revealing as an eyewitness account of the event.

C. They may not see actions that are critical to understanding an incident because of the way the video is framed.

D. They are likely to regard video recordings skeptically because they know that videos can be manipulated.

Q3. What does the author point out when discussing "context"?

A. The setting in which a video is viewed may affect the way viewers perceive the recorded events.

B. People may draw incorrect conclusions about others' motivations from what they observe in a video.

C. Video recordings can be used either to defend an individual's actions or to depict the individual as an aggressor.

D. The reliability of video recordings of events should be compared to the reliability of oral accounts of those events.

Q4. The passage indicates that "legal experts" hold which of the following views?

A. Jurors are likely to accept videos as objective depictions of events whereas they view witness testimony with skepticism.

B. Recent improvements in technology have made it so easy to display video evidence to jurors that other kinds of evidence may be neglected.

C. Video recordings should not be used as evidence in courtrooms unless multiple recordings taken from different vantage points can be shown.

D. Courts should not undermine jurors' abilities by overemphasizing the possibility of misinterpreting videos.

Q5. The word "cautiously" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. reluctantly

B. carefully

C. decisively

D. confidently

2026-04-06 Social Network Influence

原文（Passage）

Social Networks and Influence

In today's digital age, social networks play a significant role in shaping opinions and behaviors. The influence of these networks is not merely about the number of connections one might have, but about the quality and nature of those interactions. Sociologists have long been interested in how individuals within a network can influence the group's overall dynamics. This concept is sometimes referred to as social capital.

The structure of a network can determine the flow of information. An individual positioned at the intersection of various groups, known as a bridge, often plays a crucial role in disseminating information. This person can introduce new ideas and perspectives to different parts of the network, thereby influencing opinions and possibly altering behaviors. Another factor is homophily, where individuals are more likely to form connections with others who are similar to themselves in terms of opinions, values, or social status. While homophily can reinforce existing beliefs, it can also create echo chambers, limiting exposure to diverse perspectives. The presence of influential individuals, often termed opinion leaders, can amplify or mitigate the effects of network structures by means of their social skills or charisma. Sociologists aim to uncover the nuanced ways social networks shape collective behavior.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, social capital refers to

A. how networks shape social interactions in the digital age
B. the number of social connections an individual has
C. the impact that individuals have on social networks
D. the data sociologists use to make claims about digital networks

Q2. What does the passage imply about homophily?

A. It ensures the dissemination of diverse ideas.
B. It promotes similarity and continuity within groups.
C. It emphasizes opinion leaders over network structures.
D. It makes it unnecessary to have bridges across networks.

Q3. Why does the author mention "echo chambers"?

A. To highlight the risks of networks composed of like-minded individuals
B. To introduce the role of opinion leaders in amplifying network structures
C. To elaborate on the role of bridges in altering behaviors
D. To identify one advantage of networks that connect various social classes

Q4. The word "nuanced" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. many
B. complex
C. powerful
D. general

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. However, spreading information is not the only way to exert influence. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "The structure of a network can determine the flow of information."
B. Before "An individual positioned at the intersection of various groups, known as a bridge, often plays a crucial role in disseminating information."
C. Before "This person can introduce new ideas and perspectives to different parts of the network, thereby influencing opinions and possibly altering behaviors."
D. Before "Another factor is homophily, where individuals are more likely to form connections with others who are similar to themselves in terms of opinions, values, or social status."

2026-04-05（3 套）

2026-04-05 Coral Reef Restoration

原文（Passage）

Coral Reef Restoration

Coral reefs are defined as an underwater ecosystem formed by colonies of tiny marine animals called coral polyps. They are among the most diverse ecosystems on Earth; however, they are facing severe threats from climate change, pollution, and overfishing. These threats have led to widespread coral bleaching, where corals lose their vibrant colors and turn white. Bleaching weakens corals, making them more susceptible to disease and ultimately leading to their death. Scientists and environmentalists are working on various restoration techniques to combat this decline. These efforts highlight the urgency of finding effective solutions to protect these vital ecosystems. One promising method is coral gardening, where fragments of healthy coral are grown in underwater nurseries and then transplanted onto damaged reefs. This technique has shown significant success in certain areas, helping to rebuild reef structures and promote biodiversity. Another innovative approach involves using electricity to stimulate coral growth. This method, known as Biorock™ technology, creates an electric field that encourages the deposition of minerals found in seawater, accelerating coral growth.

Despite these efforts, challenges remain. Restoration projects are often expensive and labor-intensive, and the long-term success of these techniques is still uncertain. Continuous research and adaptive management strategies are crucial for ensuring the resilience of coral reefs in the face of ongoing environmental changes.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about coral bleaching in the first paragraph?

A. It makes corals more colorful.
B. It is caused by underwater nurseries.
C. It is a sign that corals are unhealthy.
D. It helps coral growth.

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a threat to coral reefs in the passage?

A. Climate change
B. Pollution
C. Overfishing
D. Tourism

Q3. Why does the author mention Biorock™ technology in the second paragraph?

A. To describe one cause behind coral bleaching
B. To introduce an innovative method for coral restoration
C. To explain how electricity affects coral health
D. To criticize traditional restoration methods

Q4. What is one challenge associated with coral reef restoration mentioned in the last paragraph?

A. It requires a lot of water.
B. It is costly and requires a lot of work.
C. It damages healthy corals.
D. It reduces biodiversity.

Q5. What can be inferred about the long-term success of coral restoration techniques?

A. It is guaranteed with current methods.
B. It depends on reducing tourism.

C. It is unaffected by environmental changes.
D. It is still not guaranteed.

2026-04-05 Creative Thinking Skills

原文（Passage）

Thinking Outside the Box

Does the expression “thinking outside the box” mean what we think it does? This mantra instructs us to consciously dispense with constraints, but what if the box itself prevents us from thinking creatively?

“Creativity,” as the theorist Edward de Bono notes, “is about bringing into being something that was not there before.” He asserts that creative thinking is not a rare biological gift but a skill that enables us to bring new ideas into the world. Our brains obtain information by connecting new input to patterns of previously stored data, so we retain thoughts and ideas that match with what is already in our mental database. By changing our thought processes, we can block these habitual neural networks from getting activated and alter the self-organizing patterns in our heads. Forcing our minds into taking new routes and abandoning our box is what leads to innovative thinking. To achieve this, we can do exercises such as asking what-if questions and changing our angle of observation.

Real innovation requires approaching challenges without boxes. Perhaps the best way to eliminate the box is to “set the box on fire.” Once you do, you may be amazed by what innovative ideas come to mind.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the purpose of the first paragraph?

A. To suggest readers reconsider a popularly held belief
B. To ask readers to avoid overusing an expression
C. To raise concerns about outdated instruction methods
D. To question the importance of thinking creatively

Q2. The word “mantra” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. a well-respected teacher
B. a very popular song
C. a rule that is rarely disobeyed
D. a phrase that is repeated often

Q3. What does Edward de Bono suggest about creative thinking?

A. It is crucial for achieving success in life.
B. It is a skill that can be developed.
C. It is a gift that not all people have.
D. It is taught by family members.

Q4. What can be inferred from the passage about neural networks?

A. They are responsible for the way we organize information.
B. They have the capacity to store a limited amount of data.
C. They have a pattern that scientists do not yet understand.
D. They are unable to block our negative thought processes.

Q5. At the end of the passage, what does the author recommend that readers do?

A. Ask for help with new challenges
B. Get rid of typical ways of thinking
C. Avoid tasks that are too difficult
D. Write down innovative ideas

2026-04-05 Cybernetic Prosthetic Technology

原文（Passage）

Cybernetic Prosthetics

Cybernetic prosthetics have revolutionized medical technology, offering hope to individuals who have lost limbs. Unlike traditional prosthetics, which are often cumbersome and limited in function, cybernetic versions are designed to integrate seamlessly with the human nervous system. This integration allows for more natural movement and even sensation. A key development in this field has been the use of myoelectric sensors, which detect electrical signals generated by muscle movements.

One example is a cybernetic hand that can perform delicate tasks such as picking up small objects or typing. This is achieved through advanced algorithms that translate muscle signals into controlled movements. Researchers are also exploring haptic feedback, which would enable users to feel textures and temperatures through their prosthetic limbs. It involves integrating sensors and actuators that mimic the sensation of touch by stimulating the user's nerve endings or skin with electrical signals. This could significantly improve the quality of life for amputees. [A] The high cost of these prosthetics makes them inaccessible to many. [B] Additionally, the technology requires regular maintenance and updates, which can be a barrier. [C] Current battery life is another limitation, as it restricts the user's ability to wear the prosthetic for extended periods. Researchers are continually working to make these devices more affordable and user-friendly. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “seamlessly” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. generally
B. smoothly
C. repeatedly
D. slowly

Q2. What can be inferred about myoelectric sensors?

A. They function less effectively in traditional prosthetics.
B. They rely less on electric signals than other types of sensors do.
C. They allow for more natural movement in cybernetic prosthetics.
D. They make cybernetic prosthetics somewhat cumbersome.

Q3. What does the passage indicate about cybernetic hands?

A. They are very similar in appearance to natural human limbs.
B. They are currently limited in their range of motion.
C. They rely on algorithms that turn muscle signals into movements.
D. They can cause skin irritation if worn for extended periods.

Q4. According to the passage, using haptic feedback in artificial limbs involves each of the following EXCEPT

A. detecting electrical signals from muscles
B. sensing the temperatures of objects
C. stimulating skin and nerve endings
D. using multiple sensors and actuators

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? To take full advantage of these amazing new technologies, a few obstacles need to be overcome. Locations in the passage:

A. Before “The high cost of these prosthetics makes them inaccessible to many.”
B. After “The high cost of these prosthetics makes them inaccessible to many.”

C. Before “Current battery life is another limitation, as it restricts the user's ability to wear the prosthetic for extended periods.”

D. After “Researchers are continually working to make these devices more affordable and user-friendly.”

2026-04-01（2 套）

2026-04-01 Landscape Connectivity

原文（Passage）

Landscape Connectivity

Landscape connectivity refers to how easily organisms can move across a landscape to access resources, find mates, disperse seeds, or migrate. This concept is crucial in landscape ecology, as it significantly impacts the survival and movement of wildlife. Fragmentation of habitats due to human activities, such as urbanization and agriculture, can reduce connectivity, leading to isolated populations and, in turn, decreased biodiversity.

One approach to enhancing landscape connectivity is through the creation of wildlife corridors. These corridors are strips of natural habitat that connect isolated patches, allowing animals to move more freely. For example, bridges and underpasses designed specifically for wildlife can mitigate the effects of roads and highways.

Recent studies have shown that landscape connectivity benefits wildlife and has positive effects on ecosystem services. [A] Improved connectivity can enhance pollination, seed dispersal, and pest control, which are vital for healthy ecosystems. [B] Additionally, connecting habitats can help species adapt to climate change by providing migration pathways.

However, creating wildlife corridors is not without challenges. It requires careful planning and consideration of various factors, such as the specific needs of target species, the existing landscape features, and potential human-wildlife conflicts. [C] Despite these challenges, efforts to improve landscape connectivity are crucial for the conservation of biodiversity and the stability of ecosystems. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The phrase "in turn" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. in all cases

B. as a later consequence

C. unfortunately

D. before that

Q2. What is suggested about roads and highways?

A. They are often used by animals as wildlife corridors.

B. They have a positive effect on ecosystems.

C. They cannot be modified to enhance landscape connectivity.

D. They interfere with the free movement of animals.

Q3. How does paragraph 3 relate to paragraph 2?

A. Paragraph 3 provides examples of the benefits mentioned in paragraph 2.

B. Paragraph 3 contradicts the ideas presented in paragraph 2.

C. Paragraph 3 contrasts recent solutions with the older solutions mentioned in paragraph 2.

D. Paragraph 3 introduces a new topic unrelated to paragraph 2.

Q4. Which of the following is NOT an effect of improved landscape connectivity mentioned in the passage?

A. Improved ability to pollinate

B. Stronger separation of wildlife groups

C. Increased species diversity
D. Better pest control

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Shifts in wildlife habitats due to climate change can, unfortunately, also outpace efforts to establish corridors, requiring their locations to be adaptable. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After "Recent studies have shown that landscape connectivity benefits wildlife and has positive effects on ecosystem services."
B. Before "Additionally, connecting habitats can help species adapt to climate change by providing migration pathways."
C. Before "Despite these challenges, efforts to improve landscape connectivity are crucial for the conservation of biodiversity and the stability of ecosystems."
D. After "Despite these challenges, efforts to improve landscape connectivity are crucial for the conservation of biodiversity and the stability of ecosystems."

2026-04-01 Urban Resilience

原文（Passage）

Urban Resilience

Urban resilience refers to the ability of cities to absorb, recover from, and prepare for shocks such as natural disasters, economic crises, and social upheavals. This concept is becoming increasingly important as more people move into urban areas and face the challenges that come with densely populated areas. Cities are implementing various strategies to enhance resilience. For instance, green infrastructure, like parks and green roofs, can help manage stormwater and reduce flooding. Renewable energy sources, such as solar and wind, reduce dependence on non-renewable resources and improve energy security.

Community engagement is another critical component of urban resilience. Local governments are involving residents in planning and decision-making processes to ensure that the needs of the community are met. This participatory approach fosters a sense of ownership and accountability among citizens, improving the effectiveness of resilience strategies. Technology also plays a role, with smart city initiatives using data and sensors to monitor infrastructure and predict potential problems. [A]

Nonetheless, building urban resilience is not without obstacles. [B] Budget constraints and political disagreements can hinder the implementation of necessary measures. [C] Additionally, the integration of new technologies requires substantial investment and training. [D] Despite these obstacles, the pursuit of urban resilience is essential for the sustainable development of cities worldwide.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the purpose of green infrastructure like parks and green roofs?

A. To increase urban density
B. To prevent flooding
C. To foster community engagement
D. To generate renewable energy

Q2. The word "fosters" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. describes
B. neglects
C. encourages
D. replaces

Q3. What does the passage suggest is essential for resilience strategies to be fully effective?

A. Discouraging the uncontrolled growth of urban populations

B. The involvement of local government and citizens

C. Less reliance on smart technology

D. Limiting the number of structures in urban areas

Q4. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge for urban resilience?

A. Financial limitations

B. Political disagreements

C. Integration of new technologies

D. Community participation

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. For example, Singapore's Intelligent Transport System incorporates artificial intelligence (AI) to predict real-time traffic conditions, effectively manage road congestion, and optimize routes. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After "Technology also plays a role, with smart city initiatives using data and sensors to monitor infrastructure and predict potential problems."

B. Before "Budget constraints and political disagreements can hinder the implementation of necessary measures."

C. Before "Additionally, the integration of new technologies requires substantial investment and training."

D. Before "Despite these obstacles, the pursuit of urban resilience is essential for the sustainable development of cities worldwide."

2026-03-29（5 套）

2026-03-29 Animal Culture Debate

原文（Passage）

The Question Of Animal Cultures

Can animals be said to possess culture? Many scientists argue that certain species do exhibit cultural traits, defining culture broadly as behaviors learned socially and transmitted across generations. Classic examples include chimpanzees using tools in ways distinctive to their local community, or whales developing group-specific songs that evolve over time. These patterns suggest that at least some animals maintain traditions not rooted solely in genetics or instinct.

Others argue that applying the term "culture" to animals risks stretching the concept beyond usefulness. Human cultures involve symbolic meaning and cumulative innovation—the ability to build on previous discoveries so that knowledge and practices become more sophisticated over generations. Nonhuman species have not convincingly demonstrated these abilities. Animal behaviors that appear cultural may instead reflect adaptation to environmental pressures or simple imitation, not deeper shared understandings.

A middle position acknowledges that while animals may not possess culture in the sense humans do, they can still display rudimentary cultural phenomena. This view emphasizes a continuum rather than a strict divide, suggesting that cultural capacities evolved gradually and appear in varying degrees across species.

Ultimately, whether animals have culture depends on how culture is defined, but growing evidence of socially transmitted behaviors challenges long-held assumptions about the uniqueness of human societies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests which of the following about the songs of whales?

A. They can best be understood as instinctive behaviors related to aspects of whales' environments.
B. They evolve over time in ways that are not typical of behaviors generally accepted as cultural.
C. They are considered by some to be cultural phenomena because they are not uniform across whale groups.
D. They differ from tool use by chimpanzees, in that they reflect the influence of genetics on behavior.

Q2. The author mentions "cumulative innovation" primarily to

A. characterize one view about how culture should be defined
B. explain how some animal behaviors evolve over generations
C. specify which human abilities are shared by some animal species
D. cite one way in which some species adapt to environmental pressures

Q3. The passage indicates that those holding the "middle position"

A. have been accused of stretching the meaning of culture too far
B. differ from most scientists in their view of which behaviors are instinctive
C. consider symbolic meaning to be an essential element of cultures
D. recognize some elements of cultural phenomena in animal behavior

Q4. The word "rudimentary" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. distinct
B. basic
C. productive
D. interesting

Q5. The author would most likely agree that the "long-held assumptions" mentioned in the final paragraph

A. have largely been abandoned by scientists today
B. uphold a definition of culture that is too rigid
C. are supported by recent findings about animal behavior
D. reveal something important about socially transmitted behaviors

2026-03-29 Film Festival Economics

原文（Passage）

How Film Festivals Reshape Local

Recent analyses of the impacts of major film festivals reveal a pattern that surprises experts: small communities like Locarno or Telluride often report more durable, neighborhood-level economic gains than global hubs. Independent restaurants and boutique retailers in these towns see elevated sales months later, while larger cities observe sharp increases that quickly dissipate. This is unusual because big markets have deeper hospitality capacity, stronger brand recognition, and vast visitor pipelines; according to orthodox thinking, larger cities should capitalize best on high-profile events.

One explanation is that festivals in smaller communities function as concentrated place-branding campaigns. The temporary influx of filmmakers, journalists, and audiences increases a town's visibility, converting one-time visitors into repeat tourists and remote promoters. Local governments, compelled by the spotlight, accelerate street improvements and cultural programming that persist after the festival, seeding arts projects and year-round film screenings that encourage local spending.

Yet this account has weaknesses. Persistent gains may partly reflect measurement artifacts—small baselines make percentage increases look dramatic. Benefits can be uneven, with national

chains capturing much of the surge while higher rents pose issues for long-standing businesses. Moreover, reliance on festival-driven identity risks event dependency: if sponsorship wanes or programming slips, the fragile ecosystem can unravel, leaving communities with sunk costs and muted returns.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what is an unexpected impact of major film festivals?

A. Global hubs experience economic gains at the neighborhood level rather than in the downtown district.

B. Small towns frequently experience longer-lasting economic benefits than large cities do.

C. Restaurants experience more growth than small stores do.

D. Retailers attract more visitors at the beginning of film festivals than in the closing days.

Q2. What does the passage suggest about film festivals in smaller towns?

A. They lead to increased government spending on infrastructure and the arts.

B. They primarily draw one-time visitors like film directors and journalists.

C. They add a considerable amount of wear and tear to community streets.

D. They do not have large enough audiences to satisfy promoters.

Q3. Why does the author mention "measurement artifacts" and "small baselines"?

A. To indicate that measuring the economic benefits of festivals in communities requires new measurement tools

B. To explain that the economic benefits of film festivals in smaller communities may appear larger than they actually are

C. To argue that larger communities have better ways of measuring economic activity than smaller ones do

D. To suggest that the rent surges discussed are not as large as they seem

Q4. The word "wanes" is closest in meaning to

A. continues

B. disappears

C. shifts

D. decreases

Q5. According to the third paragraph, all of the following are possible consequences associated with film festivals EXCEPT:

A. Large chain stores sometimes benefit more from visitors than local businesses.

B. Local businesses find it difficult to pay increased rents.

C. An influx of tourists often involves damage to the local environment.

D. Festivals may slip in quality or size, leaving communities with lower-than-expected earnings.

2026-03-29 Great Smog of London

原文（Passage）

The Great Smog Of London

The Great Smog of London in 1952 was a pivotal event in environmental history. For five days in December, a thick layer of smog blanketed the city, caused by cold weather, windless conditions, and pollutants. The primary sources were coal-burning fires for heating homes and factories, releasing sulfur dioxide and other toxic chemicals.

As the smog settled, it became a health crisis. Visibility was reduced to a few meters, and transportation was disrupted. Many people abandoned their cars, and the ambulance service was severely impacted. Thousands developed respiratory problems, and the death rate surged.

The Great Smog caused up to 12,000 premature deaths and countless illnesses. Hospitals were overwhelmed with patients, and morgues quickly reached capacity.
In response, the British government took action. New regulations aimed at reducing air pollution were established. The most significant was the Clean Air Act of 1956, which restricted coal burning in urban areas and promoted cleaner energy sources. [A]
Despite progress, air pollution remains a global challenge. [B] Many cities still struggle with poor air quality due to industrial activities, vehicle emissions, and other sources. [C] The Great Smog of London serves as a stark reminder of the need to address environmental issues to protect public health. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about the 1952 Great Smog of London?

A. It affected several other European cities.
B. It resulted from multiple factors that occurred simultaneously.
C. It disrupted the normal activities of factories for five days.
D. It made residents switch to coal to heat their homes.

Q2. The word "premature" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. early
B. recorded
C. preventable
D. likely

Q3. Why was the Great Smog of London considered a pivotal event?

A. It lasted longer than usual.
B. It occurred at an unlikely time of the year.
C. It led to significant environmental regulations.
D. It caused the immediate closure of all factories.

Q4. Why does the author bring up the impact on the ambulance service?

A. To highlight one of the results of low visibility
B. To explain the main cause of the surging death rate
C. To suggest a reason why hospitals were overwhelmed
D. To indicate that authorities closed London roads for travel

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Local authorities created "smoke control areas" where only smokeless fuels could be burned." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-03-29 Smart Textiles

原文（Passage）

Smart Textiles
Smart textiles are revolutionizing the fashion industry by integrating advanced digital technology into fabrics. These textiles can respond to environmental changes, monitor physical activity, and even generate energy. One example is phase-change materials that adapt to temperature fluctuations, providing warmth when it is cold and cooling when it is hot. Another innovation is textiles embedded with sensors that track health metrics such as heart rate and body temperature. These developments offer promising applications for athletes and medical patients.

Researchers are also exploring textiles that harvest energy from movement. These fabrics utilize piezoelectric materials that generate electricity when subjected to mechanical stress. [A] Envision clothing that can charge your smartphone simply through your daily activities. [B] Moreover, smart textiles can be designed to change color or pattern based on electrical stimuli, opening up new possibilities for both fashion and interior design. [C]
Yet, integrating technology into textiles presents challenges. [D] Durability, washability, and cost are significant concerns. Since their initial cost will be higher than traditional fabrics, ensuring that smart textiles can withstand regular use without degrading is essential for their widespread adoption. Protecting privacy is another concern of many: smart textiles could collect vast amounts of user data that must be properly secured.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What are phase-change materials designed to do?

A. Generate electricity from movement
B. Adapt to changes in temperature
C. Monitor heart rate and body temperature
D. Change color based on electrical stimuli

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge for smart textiles?

A. Washability
B. Cost
C. Durability
D. Availability

Q3. The word "harvest" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. grow
B. collect
C. spin
D. discover

Q4. What is the main purpose of paragraph 3?

A. To present obstacles to the ideas previously introduced
B. To expand on the benefits mentioned in paragraph 2
C. To provide information on the future applications of smart textiles
D. To summarize the main points of the reading

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Imagine being able to change the appearance of your furnishings depending on your mood or the season." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-03-29 The Flynn Effect

原文（Passage）

The Flynn Effect

Researchers have observed a phenomenon known as the Flynn Effect: a consistent increase in Intelligence Quotient (IQ) scores from one generation to the next. This trend, named after intelligence researcher James Flynn, shows that average IQ scores have risen by about three points per decade in many parts of the world.

Various theories have been proposed to explain this trend. One hypothesis is that improvements in nutrition and healthcare have enhanced brain development, leading to higher IQ scores. Another theory suggests that the complexity of modern life, with its increased cognitive demands, has driven this rise. The widespread use of technology and a more stimulating environment could also be contributing factors.
[A] However, the Flynn Effect does not necessarily indicate that people are becoming more intelligent. [B] Some researchers argue that the rise in IQ scores reflects better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests, rather than a genuine increase in cognitive abilities. [C] Recent studies have shown that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or even reversing in some countries, challenging the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "consistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rapid
B. large
C. steady
D. recent

Q2. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as possible contributors to the trend of IQ scores EXCEPT

A. better eating habits and medical care
B. improvements in parental care
C. the cognitive demands of contemporary life
D. the extensive use of technology

Q3. According to some researchers, the Flynn Effect may be a sign that

A. people are becoming better at taking tests
B. IQ tests have become easier over time
C. test-takers thrive in stimulating environments
D. school systems have developed better examinations

Q4. Why does the author mention that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or reversing in some countries?

A. To suggest that there may not be a global increase in intelligence
B. To argue that cognitive abilities are declining around the world
C. To show that the Flynn Effect requires further research
D. To argue that the challenges of modern life can have negative effects on intelligence

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Changes in educational practices or shifts in societal values could account for the downturn." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-03-28（2 套）

2026-03-28 AI and Employment

原文（Passage）

Artificial Intelligence and Future Jobs

Artificial intelligence (AI) is changing industries and job markets. Technologies like machine learning and robotics automate tasks once done by humans.
[A] Proponents of AI argue that it can create new employment opportunities. AI will drive demand for roles in software development, data analysis, and system maintenance. Companies need professionals to design, implement, and monitor these systems.
Critics warn of job losses and potentially difficult transitions. [B] Jobs in manufacturing and routine sectors are especially vulnerable. Employees may need new skills to stay relevant in an AI-driven economy. [C] Transitioning to an AI-focused job market could be challenging, requiring significant investment in education and training.
Some countries are addressing these challenges. Germany and Singapore have launched initiatives to retrain workers for tech-focused roles. [D] These programs aim to equip employees with skills needed to thrive in a future where AI is prevalent. Despite these efforts, the impact of AI on employment remains uncertain, and the balance between job creation and job displacement continues to be debated.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the passage mention the need for "professionals to design, implement, and monitor" systems?

A. To emphasize the challenges related to AI
B. To explain how AI can create employment opportunities
C. To identify a problem with an argument that proponents of AI make
D. To imply that job losses from AI can be monitored and controlled

Q2. The word "vulnerable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. practical
B. profitable
C. growing
D. at risk

Q3. What potentially difficult transition is discussed in the passage?

A. Increasing manufacturing
B. Finding investment for developing new machines
C. Moving from one type of AI technology to another
D. Teaching workers new skills

Q4. Which of the following best expresses the essential information in the highlighted sentence? "Despite these efforts, the impact of AI on employment remains uncertain, and the balance between job creation and job displacement continues to be debated."

A. Despite these efforts, the impact of AI on continuing debates remains uncertain.
B. Despite these efforts, it is uncertain whether the jobs created by AI will be more than the jobs displaced by it.
C. Despite these efforts, the balance between job creation and job displacement remains unchanged.
D. Despite these efforts, some employees remain uncertain about the impact of AI on their jobs.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. This increases efficiency but raises concerns about job displacement. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After "Technologies like machine learning and robotics automate tasks once done by humans."
B. Before "Jobs in manufacturing and routine sectors are especially vulnerable."

C. Before "Transitioning to an AI-focused job market could be challenging, requiring significant investment in education and training."

D. Before "These programs aim to equip employees with skills needed to thrive in a future where AI is prevalent."

2026-03-28 Ecological Systems Theory

原文（Passage）

Understanding Ecological Systems Theory

Ecological Systems Theory, introduced by Urie Bronfenbrenner, revolutionized our perception of human psychological development. [A] It posits that individuals are shaped by interactions among multiple overlapping environmental systems. [B] This theory reshaped developmental research, offering a multifaceted lens that surpasses earlier, linear models. [C] By considering the dynamic interplay between a person and their environment, it highlights the multifactorial nature of psychological growth. [D]

The theory delineates several environmental layers, beginning with the microsystem, which refers to the institutions and groups that most directly impact the child's development, such as family and school. The mesosystem encompasses the relationships among the microsystems, such as the impact of a teacher's communication with parents on a child's education. Beyond these, the exosystem consists of indirect influences like a parent's workplace stress subtly affecting the home environment. The macrosystem, encompassing broader cultural and societal contexts, frames these interactions with underlying norms and policies.

While Bronfenbrenner's model offers an intricate framework, it is not without critique. Some argue that the model underestimates the role of technology, which has created virtual microsystems that transcend geographical limits. Despite these critiques, the theory remains influential in fields ranging from education to public policy, prompting continuous exploration of its applications and adaptations.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention "a teacher's communication with parents" in paragraph 2?

A. To illustrate the interactions among microsystems that characterize the mesosystem

B. To support the claim that the institutions of the microsystem affect children directly

C. To show that Bronfenbrenner's theory is primarily linear

D. To suggest that microsystems are more important than the mesosystem

Q2. The phrase "subtly affecting" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. affecting in harmless but unpredictable ways

B. affecting in long-lasting ways

C. affecting in ways both positive and negative

D. affecting in small, barely noticeable ways

Q3. The passage suggests that criticisms of Bronfenbrenner's model call for which of the following?

A. Its replacement with a less intricate framework

B. Its modification to include virtual interactions

C. Its replacement with a model that gives greater consideration to geographical boundaries

D. Its exclusion from fields such as education and public policy

Q4. Which of the following best describes the influence of Ecological Systems Theory?

A. It has had little impact on psychology but has unexpectedly affected other fields.

B. It revolutionized the field of human psychology but is not taken seriously in other fields.

C. It changed the way human psychology is understood and continues to influence other fields.

D. It has gone mostly unnoticed among psychologists and has had little impact on other fields.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Each one plays a distinct role in shaping behavior. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After "Ecological Systems Theory, introduced by Urie Bronfenbrenner, revolutionized our perception of human psychological development."

B. After "It posits that individuals are shaped by interactions among multiple overlapping environmental systems."

C. Before "By considering the dynamic interplay between a person and their environment, it highlights the multifactorial nature of psychological growth."

D. After "By considering the dynamic interplay between a person and their environment, it highlights the multifactorial nature of psychological growth."

2026-03-23（2 套）

2026-03-23 Beyond Philosophy's Borders

原文（Passage）

Beyond Philosophy's Borders

Metaphilosophy is a field that looks critically at whether philosophical inquiry can truly transcend cultural and linguistic boundaries. While traditional philosophy often aims to uncover universal truths, metaphilosophy questions whether such truths are even accessible across diverse contexts. Language, far from being a neutral vessel, shapes and limits how ideas are expressed and understood. A concept that resonates deeply in one culture may carry entirely different connotations--or none at all--in another. This raises concerns about the global applicability of philosophical frameworks developed in specific cultural milieus. Are we uncovering truths, or merely reinforcing culturally contingent assumptions?

Some insist that despite linguistic and cultural variation, certain philosophical concerns--like suffering, justice, or mortality--are shared across societies, suggesting a basis for universality. Yet even these themes may be interpreted through culturally specific lenses. Metaphilosophy doesn't deny the possibility of cross-cultural dialogue but cautions against assuming it is seamless. It encourages philosophers to examine how their methods and assumptions travel--or fail to--across contexts.

Critics worry this reflexivity may stall progress, but others see it as essential for avoiding intellectual overreach. By foregrounding these tensions, metaphilosophy aims not to dilute philosophy's aims, but to sharpen them through greater self-awareness and methodological rigor.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, metaphilosophy challenges which of the following basic assumptions of philosophical inquiry?

A. The world can be understood through logical analysis.

B. Argumentation is a suitable tool for analyzing ideas.

C. Human experience is a good source of philosophical insight.

D. The conceptual tools that philosophy provides are universal.

Q2. Why does the author note that concepts may carry different connotations across different cultures?

A. To support the claim that philosophical frameworks apply globally

B. To illustrate the idea of crossing cultural and linguistic boundaries

C. To provide a justification for metaphilosophical investigations

D. To challenge the claim that language affects how ideas are expressed

Q3. The word "milieus" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. environments

B. categories

C. centers

D. identities

Q4. Which of the following is one criticism of metaphilosophy mentioned in the passage?

A. It fails to challenge existing philosophical frameworks.

B. It may prevent philosophy from accomplishing its mission.

C. It is used by some philosophers to keep new ideas from becoming established.

D. It is incapable of evaluating ideas from diverse traditions.

Q5. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that describes an argument against the claims of metaphilosophy. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Some insist that despite linguistic and cultural variation, certain philosophical concerns--like suffering, justice, or mortality--are shared across societies, suggesting a basis for universality.

B. Yet even these themes may be interpreted through culturally specific lenses.

C. Metaphilosophy doesn't deny the possibility of cross-cultural dialogue but cautions against assuming it is seamless.

D. It encourages philosophers to examine how their methods and assumptions travel--or fail to--across contexts.

2026-03-23 Coastal Erosion Solutions

原文（Passage）

Coastal Erosion Solutions

Coastal erosion poses a significant threat to communities worldwide, especially in low-lying and densely populated coastal zones. This natural phenomenon causes the gradual wearing away of coastlines. Human activities such as construction, sand mining, and deforestation, along with sea level rise and increased storm intensity due to climate change, exacerbate the problem. Engineers and scientists are developing innovative solutions to combat this issue and protect vulnerable areas.

One popular method is beach nourishment, which involves adding sand to eroding beaches. This temporary solution can be costly and requires regular maintenance, but it helps to restore a beach's natural barrier against waves. Additionally, the installation of structures like groynes and seawalls offers another approach. Groynes are barriers built perpendicular to the coastline, trapping sand carried by longshore drift. Seawalls, on the other hand, are constructed parallel to the shore to protect the land from wave impact.

Apart from structural interventions, some approaches focus on ecological solutions. [A] Living shorelines, for instance, use native vegetation to stabilize the coast. [B] These natural buffers absorb wave energy, reducing erosion while providing habitats for marine life. [C] Despite their ecological benefits, living shorelines can take time to establish and may not be suitable for all areas. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "vulnerable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. certain

B. at-risk

C. affected

D. exposed

Q2. Identify the sentence in paragraph 1 that explains why coastal erosion is becoming worse. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Coastal erosion poses a significant threat to communities worldwide, especially in low-lying and densely populated coastal zones.

B. This natural phenomenon causes the gradual wearing away of coastlines.

C. Human activities such as construction, sand mining, and deforestation, along with sea level rise and increased storm intensity due to climate change, exacerbate the problem.

D. Engineers and scientists are developing innovative solutions to combat this issue and protect vulnerable areas.

Q3. According to the passage, all of the following are true about beach nourishment EXCEPT:

A. It adds sand to eroding beaches.

B. It is expensive and needs to be maintained on a regular basis.

C. It helps beaches to combat waves.

D. It involves the installation of groynes.

Q4. Why does the author discuss "groynes and seawalls" in the passage?

A. To demonstrate the effectiveness of solutions to coastal erosion

B. To identify some structural solutions to coastal erosion

C. To explain the significance of combating coastal erosion

D. To suggest that solutions to coastal erosion vary in construction and maintenance costs

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. They also contribute to climate resilience by mitigating the impacts of sea level rise and storm surges. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "Living shorelines, for instance, use native vegetation to stabilize the coast."

B. Before "These natural buffers absorb wave energy, reducing erosion while providing habitats for marine life."

C. Before "Despite their ecological benefits, living shorelines can take time to establish and may not be suitable for all areas."

D. After "Despite their ecological benefits, living shorelines can take time to establish and may not be suitable for all areas."

2026-03-17（3 套）

2026-03-17 Computational Drug Discovery

原文（Passage）

Computational Chemistry in Drug Discovery

Computational chemistry has transformed drug discovery by providing tools to model and predict molecular behavior. Traditionally, drug discovery involved labor-intensive trial and error. Now, with advanced algorithms and powerful computers, researchers can test interactions between drug candidates and biological targets via computer simulations before moving to the lab.

One major advantage of computational methods is their ability to analyze vast chemical spaces. For example, machine learning algorithms can predict the binding affinity of millions of compounds to a target protein, narrowing down candidates for testing. This speeds up the discovery process and reduces costs. In one case, researchers identified a promising compound for treating a rare disease in weeks, a task that would have taken years using traditional methods.

Moreover, computational chemistry optimizes drug properties. By simulating different modifications to a molecular structure, researchers can predict changes in a drug's efficacy and

safety. Repeating and refining this process fine-tunes drug candidates to achieve optimal therapeutic profiles. [A] For example, modifying a molecule to enhance stability in the bloodstream can prevent it from breaking down too quickly, ensuring it reaches its target. [B] Computational predictions must be validated experimentally, as computer models can sometimes produce false positives. [C] Accurately simulating the human body's complex environment remains a formidable task. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that, unlike traditional drug discovery, drug discovery based on computational chemistry

A. is far less time-consuming overall
B. is significantly more expensive to conduct
C. eliminates the need for lab work
D. requires a greater number of researchers

Q2. According to the passage, how do machine learning algorithms speed up the drug discovery process?

A. By narrowing the size of the chemical spaces that need to be analyzed
B. By helping to eliminate compounds that are not promising for testing
C. By increasing the number of proteins that can be targeted by compounds
D. By providing a comprehensive list of drug candidates

Q3. According to the passage, what is the purpose of repeatedly simulating various modifications to a molecular structure?

A. To create new biological targets
B. To reduce the number of simulations needed in the long run
C. To enhance the therapeutic profiles of drug candidates
D. To eliminate the need for experimental validation

Q4. The word "formidable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. very challenging
B. very exciting
C. urgent
D. manageable

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Despite these advancements, challenges remain. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "For example, modifying a molecule to enhance stability in the bloodstream can prevent it from breaking down too quickly, ensuring it reaches its target."
B. Before "Computational predictions must be validated experimentally, as computer models can sometimes produce false positives."
C. Before "Accurately simulating the human body's complex environment remains a formidable task."
D. After "Accurately simulating the human body's complex environment remains a formidable task."

2026-03-17 Floating Wind Turbines

原文（Passage）

Floating Wind Turbines

Wind turbines are large devices with long blades that capture wind energy and convert it into electricity. Floating wind turbines are a special type of wind turbines because they are not fixed

to the seabed but are anchored using advanced mooring systems, allowing placement in deeper waters where winds are more consistent. In this context, anchoring refers to securing the turbine in place using cables or chains connected to weighted structures or anchors on the ocean floor, ensuring stability despite the lack of a fixed foundation. The deeper placement means the wind turbines can harness untapped wind resources that traditional turbines cannot access.
Engineering floating turbines involves unique challenges. They rely on buoyancy principles rather than on solid ground, making their design and maintenance complex. Despite the increased costs, their ability to reduce visual and noise pollution makes them an attractive option for distant offshore locations. However, their long-term viability is threatened by harsh marine conditions that can accelerate wear and tear.
[A] Research continues to explore solutions for these problems. [B] Some experts are investigating materials and designs to enhance durability. [C] As efforts to capitalize on deeper offshore wind resources persist, floating turbines represent both a promising opportunity and a complex engineering puzzle. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "harness" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. limit
B. distribute
C. release
D. exploit

Q2. What unique advantage do floating wind turbines have over traditional turbines?

A. They are larger in size and have longer blades.
B. They require less maintenance.
C. They can be placed in deeper waters.
D. They are easier to design.

Q3. Why does the author mention "buoyancy principles"?

A. To point out a challenge of creating floating turbines
B. To suggest a new area for future research into floating turbines
C. To emphasize the greater flexibility of floating turbines compared with traditional turbines
D. To provide an example of cost-saving measures related to floating turbines

Q4. What can be inferred about the acceleration of "wear and tear" in floating turbines?

A. Any attempts to reduce it will likely prove to be unsuccessful.
B. Scientists are working to control it through better designs and materials.
C. It is prompting engineers to place floating wind turbines closer to shore.
D. It makes floating turbines especially unattractive to look at.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Others assess economic models that might offset higher initial expenses. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "Research continues to explore solutions for these problems."
B. Before "Some experts are investigating materials and designs to enhance durability."
C. Before "As efforts to capitalize on deeper offshore wind resources persist, floating turbines represent both a promising opportunity and a complex engineering puzzle."
D. After "As efforts to capitalize on deeper offshore wind resources persist, floating turbines represent both a promising opportunity and a complex engineering puzzle."

2026-03-17 Microseisms and Vibrations

原文（Passage）

Microseisms: The Earth's Subtle Vibrations

The Earth is constantly vibrating, even when there are no earthquakes. These subtle vibrations, known as microseisms, are typically caused by ocean waves. When waves collide, they create pressure variations that travel through the water and into the sea floor. This energy transfer generates seismic waves detectable by seismometers worldwide. Interestingly, microseisms are strongest during storms when ocean waves are more powerful.

Researchers have found these vibrations can provide important information about the Earth's interior. Microseisms travel through the Earth's crust and mantle, revealing details about the geological structures they pass through, including variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures. Another compelling use of microseisms is in climate studies. Scientists analyze historical data on these vibrations to reconstruct past ocean conditions and storm activities. This helps improve climate models and understand long-term weather patterns. Additionally, microseisms are used in oil and gas exploration. They identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures without more invasive techniques.

Studying microseisms is challenging. The mild signals are easily masked by other seismic noises. Advanced data analysis techniques and state-of-the-art equipment are essential for accurately interpreting microseisms. Researchers often employ filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "subtle" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. faint
B. quick
C. strong
D. constant

Q2. It can be inferred that microseisms are strongest during ocean storms because

A. the Earth's crust and mantle are more active during such storms
B. ocean waves are larger and collide more vigorously during such storms
C. seismometers are designed to work most effectively during such storms
D. the details of geological structures become more apparent during such storms

Q3. Why does the author mention "variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures"?

A. To suggest that more research is needed to understand the relationship between microseisms and earthquakes
B. To identify the most important features of Earth's crust and mantle
C. To help explain how microseisms can alter the geological structures that they pass through
D. To highlight the kinds of information microseisms can provide about Earth's interior

Q4. According to the passage, how can microseisms help in oil and gas exploration?

A. By providing historical data on ocean conditions
B. By pinpointing potential drilling sites
C. By measuring the strength of seismic waves
D. By reducing the need for seismometers

Q5. What does the author suggest about "filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers"?

A. They are techniques used to study microseisms.
B. They demonstrate the outdatedness of seismometers.
C. They are popular ways of studying various types of seismic noises.
D. They highlight a flaw in current research methods.

2026-03-15（2 套）

2026-03-15 Artificial Expert Systems

原文（Passage）

Expert Systems

Expert systems are a branch of artificial intelligence designed to mimic the decision-making abilities of human experts. These systems use a knowledge base of specialized information and rules to solve specific problems. Their goal is to replicate the expertise and reasoning of professionals in fields like medicine and engineering.

An early expert system is MYCIN, developed in the 1970s to diagnose bacterial infections and recommend antibiotics. MYCIN used rules provided by medical experts to analyze patient data, infer diagnoses, and suggest treatments. MYCIN often performed as well as human specialists; however, MYCIN's system needed constant updates, requiring extensive input from medical professionals.

[A] Despite their potential, expert systems have limitations; since they rely on static knowledge databases, they can become outdated without ongoing input from human experts. The process of updating the system can be labor-intensive. [B] Advancements in machine learning and natural language processing could address these issues. [C] By integrating these technologies, expert systems could learn from new data and adapt, improving accuracy and relevance. Researchers are optimistic that these advancements will transform expert systems, enabling them to tackle a wider range of challenges and operate more independently. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “mimic” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. replace
B. combine
C. imitate
D. challenge

Q2. How did MYCIN diagnose bacterial infections?

A. It used a human specialist to evaluate patient data.
B. It applied set rules to analyze patient data.
C. It used data on infection rates to infer the probability of a particular type of bacteria.
D. It relied on information provided directly by the patients.

Q3. What is a major limitation of current expert systems mentioned in the passage?

A. They are unable to process large datasets.
B. They often provide incorrect results.
C. They need frequent updating.
D. They use databases that are always changing.

Q4. What can be inferred about the future of expert systems?

A. They will probably be limited to use in medical applications.
B. They will one day be able to update themselves without human input.
C. They will become less accurate as the amount of new data increases.
D. They will soon be replaced by more relevant technologies.

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Additionally, their performance may decline in unfamiliar or rapidly changing environments where new information is constantly emerging.
Locations in the passage:

A. Before “Despite their potential, expert systems have limitations; since they rely on static knowledge databases, they can become outdated without ongoing input from human experts.”

B. After “The process of updating the system can be labor-intensive.”
C. Before “By integrating these technologies, expert systems could learn from new data and adapt, improving accuracy and relevance.”
D. After “Researchers are optimistic that these advancements will transform expert systems, enabling them to tackle a wider range of challenges and operate more independently.”

2026-03-15 Social Role Theory

原文（Passage）

Social Role Theory
Social role theory is a significant framework in theoretical sociology, explaining how individuals adopt roles based on societal expectations. Society is structured by roles, each with specific behaviors and norms.
[A] A key aspect of social role theory is role conflict, which occurs when the expectations of one role clash with those of another. For instance, a person who is both a parent and an employee might struggle to balance caring for their children and meeting work obligations. This conflict can lead to stress and decreased performance in one or both roles.
[B] Another important concept is role strain, which is stress within a single role due to competing demands or insufficient resources. An example is a teacher who feels overwhelmed by the need to manage classroom behavior while also keeping lessons engaging.
Social role theory also addresses how roles change over time. [C] As society evolves, the expectations attached to roles can shift. For example, the role of women in the workforce has changed dramatically, with increasing acceptance of women in leadership. Understanding these dynamics is crucial for analyzing how social structures impact individual behavior and societal change. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “norms” in the passage is closest in meaning to
A. long histories
B. hidden benefits
C. practical effects
D. unwritten rules

Q2. Why does the passage mention “a person who is both a parent and an employee”?
A. To show how a person can balance multiple obligations
B. To imply that roles are not always rigidly defined
C. To illustrate the concept of role conflict
D. To emphasize the importance of good childcare

Q3. Why does the passage mention “a teacher”?
A. To support the idea that social role theory is often difficult to understand
B. To explain how a person might experience competing demands within a role
C. To imply that the resources provided to teachers are often insufficient
D. To demonstrate how behavioral issues make learning difficult for everyone

Q4. The phrase “these dynamics” in the passage refers to
A. the evolution of social roles over time
B. competition for leadership positions
C. interactions between men and women in the workforce
D. decreasing prestige of some social roles

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? For example, a parent is expected to offer affection and emotional stability to their children, while a soldier is expected to follow orders. Locations in the passage:

A. After “Society is structured by roles, each with specific behaviors and norms.”
B. After “This conflict can lead to stress and decreased performance in one or both roles.”
C. Before “As society evolves, the expectations attached to roles can shift.”
D. After “Understanding these dynamics is crucial for analyzing how social structures impact individual behavior and societal change.”

2026-03-14（3 套）

2026-03-14 Ancient Stoic Philosophy

原文（Passage）

Stoicism in Ancient Philosophy

Stoicism, an ancient philosophical school founded in Athens by Zeno of Citium in the early third century B.C.E., emphasizes rationality and self-control as the path to a virtuous life. Stoics believe that the universe is governed by reason, and understanding this helps individuals align with nature, achieving inner tranquility. Central to Stoic philosophy is the dichotomy of control. Some things are within our control while others are not. Stoics argue that focusing on what can be controlled, such as actions and thoughts, leads to a peaceful and contented life. Events outside one's control should be accepted with equanimity.

A phrase that is commonly used today is "Stoic pause." [A] It refers to the internal deliberation to insert a moment of reflection before reacting emotionally, a handy trick employed by business leaders in high-stakes negotiations. [B] Stoic principles are also incorporated into cognitive-behavioral therapy, where patients are encouraged to learn to identify and challenge irrational thoughts so that they can change their emotional responses. [C] For example, people who fear public speaking can be taught to reframe their anxiety by focusing on preparing for their speech and to expect realistic outcomes. [D] They are taught to approach their fear rationally and ignore what is outside their control.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does Stoicism encourage?

A. Focusing on the root cause of external events
B. Determining what factors lead to one's discontent
C. Concentrating only on what one is able to control
D. Recognizing that nothing can be truly controlled

Q2. The word "equanimity" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. meaning to
B. concern
C. calmness
D. exceptions

Q3. Why does the author mention public speaking?

A. To provide an example of taking a "Stoic pause" in high-stakes situations
B. To show how cognitive-behavioral therapy incorporates Stoic ideas
C. To illustrate the contrast between rational and irrational thoughts from the Stoic point of view
D. To suggest that Stoics believe certain emotions can be beneficial

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraph 2 and 1?

A. Paragraph 2 discusses an alternative theory to the one presented in paragraph 1.

B. Paragraph 2 explains a concept introduced in paragraph 1.
C. Paragraph 2 describes solutions to an issue presented in paragraph 1.
D. Paragraph 2 discusses the modern applications of the principles discussed in paragraph 1.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Taking a step back to analyze the situation helps you react in a more measured and mindful way. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After "A phrase that is commonly used today is \"Stoic pause.\""
B. Before "Stoic principles are also incorporated into cognitive-behavioral therapy, where patients are encouraged to learn to identify and challenge irrational thoughts so that they can change their emotional responses."
C. Before "For example, people who fear public speaking can be taught to reframe their anxiety by focusing on preparing for their speech and to expect realistic outcomes."
D. Before "They are taught to approach their fear rationally and ignore what is outside their control."

2026-03-14 Libertarian Political Philosophy

原文（Passage）

Libertarianism and Personal Freedom

Libertarianism is a political philosophy emphasizing individual liberty, minimal government intervention, and free markets. It advocates personal freedom, arguing that individuals should make choices without undue state interference. This ideology has gained traction in recent years among those who value economic freedom.

A central tenet of libertarianism is self-ownership, which asserts that individuals own their bodies and labor. Libertarians argue that people should control their lives and property and be free from coercive forces. For instance, libertarians often oppose taxation, viewing it as involuntary servitude that infringes on autonomy.

Libertarianism champions free markets as the most efficient means of allocating resources. [A] By allowing supply and demand to dictate prices, free markets encourage innovation and competition, leading to better products and services. [B] Government regulations are seen as impediments that stifle economic growth and limit freedom. [C] Libertarians believe that a laissez-faire approach creates an environment where businesses can thrive and individuals can pursue their economic interests without constraints. [D]

Critics of libertarianism argue that a lack of regulation can lead to social inequality and exploitation. Some contend that public goods, like education and healthcare, require government involvement to ensure equitable access. Balancing personal freedoms with the need of social welfare and infrastructure has been an issue of heated debate even among Libertarians themselves. Some supports wide-scale privatization of all social services, while others acknowledges the necessity of a certain degree of government involvement. Still, as the foundation for last century's economic globalization, libertarianism will remain a popular school of thought in the foreseeable future.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following are true about libertarianism EXCEPT:

A. It emphasizes free markets.
B. It champions personal freedom.
C. It supports state involvement in people's lives.
D. It has recently grown in popularity.

Q2. Libertarians might consider taxation immoral because it violates

A. the principle of self-ownership
B. laws against use of coercive force
C. legal standards about bodily autonomy
D. conventions of liberal society

Q3. The word "impediments" in the passage is closest in meaning to:

A. rules
B. barriers
C. measures
D. costs

Q4. Libertarians themselves do not agree with one another about whether

A. the libertarian approach creates educational opportunities
B. a laissez-faire approach is good for businesses
C. healthcare requires more government involvement than education
D. personal freedom should be balanced against the need for social welfare

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Such intervention constrains innovation and can lead to inefficiency. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "By allowing supply and demand to dictate prices, free markets encourage innovation and competition, leading to better products and services."
B. Before "Government regulations are seen as impediments that stifle economic growth and limit freedom."
C. Before "Libertarians believe that a laissez-faire approach creates an environment where businesses can thrive and individuals can pursue their economic interests without constraints."
D. After "Libertarians believe that a laissez-faire approach creates an environment where businesses can thrive and individuals can pursue their economic interests without constraints."

2026-03-14 Sociocybernetics and Systems

原文（Passage）

Sociocybernetics: Understanding Complex Social Systems

Sociocybernetics is a field that provides tools to analyze complex social systems, merging sociology and cybernetics. [A] By applying principles of feedback, control, and communication from cybernetics, sociologists can understand how societies function. [B] A key concept in sociocybernetics is self-organization. [C] This is the process in which social systems develop ordered patterns without centralized control. [D]

Feedback loops are crucial in sociocybernetics. Positive feedback amplifies changes, leading to rapid social transformations. Negative feedback stabilizes systems, maintaining equilibrium. In economic systems, positive feedback can result in booming markets, while negative feedback can prevent financial crises. Recognizing these mechanisms helps sociologists predict and influence social dynamics.

Communication is another critical aspect. Effective communication channels within social systems impact their stability and adaptability. Misinformation or communication breakdowns can disrupt social cohesion and lead to chaos. Sociocybernetic models highlight the importance of transparent information flow in maintaining healthy social systems. These models also explore how digital technologies influence communication patterns.

Sociocybernetics is important to urban planning. Cities are complex systems with numerous interacting components. Using sociocybernetic principles, urban planners design more resilient

cities by modeling traffic patterns, resource distribution, and emergency response strategies. This approach helps create sustainable urban environments that better respond to changes.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "amplifies" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. delays
B. increases
C. simplifies
D. suggests

Q2. Which of the following can be inferred about positive and negative feedback?

A. Positive feedback leads to outcomes that are more beneficial than those from negative feedback.
B. Negative feedback is easier for sociologists to recognize than positive feedback.
C. Positive and negative feedback both provide systems with beneficial information.
D. Positive feedback is more common in progressive social systems than negative feedback.

Q3. According to sociocybernetic models, effective communication is important for

A. preventing misinformation
B. maintenance of social cohesion
C. transparent information flow
D. providing successful digital technologies

Q4. What is an aspect of urban environments that makes them a suitable object of study for sociocybernetics?

A. They involve many interacting components.
B. They can be made more resilient when designed using scientific principles.
C. They feature ideal traffic patterns.
D. They respond better to changes when they are more sustainable.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. The latter is concerned with the comparative study of automatic control systems, such as the nervous system. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. After "Sociocybernetics is a field that provides tools to analyze complex social systems, merging sociology and cybernetics."
B. Before "A key concept in sociocybernetics is self-organization."
C. Before "This is the process in which social systems develop ordered patterns without centralized control."
D. After "This is the process in which social systems develop ordered patterns without centralized control."

2026-03-11（2 套）

2026-03-11 Quantum Dot Technology

原文（Passage）

Quantum Dots

Quantum dots are tiny semiconductor particles with unique optical properties, making them valuable in display technology. When exposed to light, these nanoparticles emit bright, pure colors that can be finely tuned by varying their size. This allows for more vibrant and accurate colors in screens, surpassing traditional display technologies. Their application in displays has revolutionized the consumer electronics industry. For example, quantum dot-enhanced televisions offer a broader color spectrum and energy conservation compared to conventional light-emitting diode (LED) displays because they require less backlighting.

Environmental benefits are another advantage. Traditional displays often use harmful heavy metals like cadmium and lead. Quantum dots can be made from less toxic materials, and researchers are working on cadmium-free quantum dots to further reduce environmental impact.

The manufacture of quantum dots requires extreme precision. As a result, challenges remain in scaling up production. However, this is a worthwhile endeavor because quantum dots potentially have many applications outside of electronics, such as in biological research. Their small size and bright emission are ideal for tagging and tracking molecules in living organisms. This allows for long-term observation of dynamic biological processes.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The color of quantum dots can be controlled by changing

A. their size after exposure to light
B. the direction in which they are displayed
C. the amount of light they are exposed to
D. the color of the light they are exposed to

Q2. What makes quantum dot technology in televisions efficient?

A. The vibrancy of the colors
B. The reduced need for backlighting
C. The larger color spectrum
D. The size of the particles

Q3. What is identified as an environmental benefit of quantum dots?

A. The ability to make cadmium more pure
B. The ability to remove lead from living organisms
C. Limiting environmental impacts to small areas
D. Less use of some poisonous substances

Q4. Why does the passage state that the "manufacture of quantum dots requires extreme precision"?

A. To imply that quantum dots' environmental impact might increase
B. To praise the hard work of quantum dot manufacturers
C. To challenge the claim that using quantum dots is worthwhile
D. To explain why the production of quantum dots is difficult to increase

Q5. How can biologists use quantum dots?

A. For studying very small living organisms
B. For observing the movement of molecules
C. For including electronic tools in research
D. For making some biological processes more dynamic

2026-03-11 Urban Noise Control

原文（Passage）

Noise Control in Urban Areas

[A] Urban areas across the globe are grappling with the challenge of noise pollution. [B] This type of pollution can severely impact health, leading to sleep disturbances and cardiovascular problems. [C] It has many causes. [D]

Innovative solutions to control noise pollution, from traffic to concerts, are emerging. One such solution is green walls, vertical gardens installed on building facades. Green walls can absorb, reflect, or deflect sound waves, reducing the noise that enters a building. Additionally, they offer benefits like air purification and temperature regulation--thus not only reducing noise but also

improving the environment. They work by enhancing indoor air quality and helping regulate interior temperatures by acting as natural insulation.
Another approach involves quiet zones. These zones are designated areas where noisy activities are restricted, often including parks, residential neighborhoods, and hospital areas. The goal is to provide residents with periods of peace and tranquility. Some European cities have seen a decrease in stress-related health issues among residents in quiet zones.
Advancements in technology have also led to the creation of noise cancelling materials. Such materials are often used on buildings or road surfaces. They work by actively reducing sound vibrations. Urban planners can use these materials to design cities more effectively, by strategically placing these structures to combat the noise problem.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "grappling" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. Identifying
B. Interfering
C. Struggling
D. Experimenting

Q2. How do green walls help control noise pollution?

A. By purifying the air around buildings
B. By disrupting the path of sound waves
C. By making building facades more attractive
D. By reducing temperatures inside buildings

Q3. What can be inferred about noise pollution in the European cities mentioned in the passage?

A. It was likely a factor in causing stress-related health issues among residents.
B. It has not been as effectively managed there as it has been in other places.
C. It has been controlled most successfully by adding green walls to buildings.
D. It has been funded primarily through the efforts of urban planners.

Q4. Identify the sentence in paragraph 4 that names specific architectural elements built with noise-cancelling materials.

A. Advancements in technology have also led to the creation of noise cancelling materials.
B. Such materials are often used on buildings or road surfaces.
C. They work by actively reducing sound vibrations.
D. Urban planners can use these materials to design cities more effectively, by strategically placing these structures to combat the noise problem.

Q5. Look at the four choices that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. One common source is traffic, which includes cars, buses, motorcycles, and trucks. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "Urban areas across the globe are grappling with the challenge of noise pollution."
B. Before "This type of pollution can severely impact health, leading to sleep disturbances and cardiovascular problems."
C. Before "It has many causes."
D. After "It has many causes."

2026-03-08（6 套）

2026-03-08 Antimicrobial Resistance Challenges

原文（Passage）

Antimicrobial Resistance Challenges

Antimicrobial resistance (AMR)—the ability of microorganisms to withstand drugs that once killed them—threatens to reverse decades of medical advancement, posing an urgent public health challenge globally. In particular, the widespread and often indiscriminate use of antibiotics in medicine and agriculture has accelerated the emergence of resistant bacteria. Recognizing the gravity of AMR, the World Health Organization classifies it among the top global health threats, underscoring the critical need for immediate action.

Bacteria develop resistance through a multitude of mechanisms, including genetic mutations and the sharing of genes, which allow them to survive antibiotic treatment and proliferate. Unfortunately, the pharmaceutical industry has been slow to produce new antibiotics, hampered by both scientific obstacles and economic disincentives. Antibiotics often yield lower financial returns compared to medications for chronic diseases. Therefore, they receive less investment.

Addressing AMR requires a comprehensive and coordinated international strategy. Implementing stringent regulations on antibiotic prescriptions can curb misuse but might not eliminate it completely. Financial incentives for pharmaceutical companies could stimulate the development of novel antibiotics. However, this approach remains contentious due to the varying perspectives on economic feasibility. Public health campaigns aimed at educating communities about judicious antibiotic use are vital, but experts continue to debate the most effective strategy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention the “indiscriminate use of antibiotics”?

A. To make a distinction between how antibiotics are used in healthcare and agriculture
B. To argue that the World Health Organization has underestimated the extent of the problem
C. To suggest that the AMR crisis can be easily solved
D. To explain why AMR is becoming a global health challenge

Q2. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that explains how antimicrobial resistance works. Select the sentence to make your choice.

A. Bacteria develop resistance through a multitude of mechanisms, including genetic mutations and the sharing of genes, which allow them to survive antibiotic treatment and proliferate.
B. Unfortunately, the pharmaceutical industry has been slow to produce new antibiotics, hampered by both scientific obstacles and economic disincentives.
C. Antibiotics often yield lower financial returns compared to medications for chronic diseases.
D. Therefore, they receive less investment.

Q3. Which obstacle to the development of new antibiotics is mentioned in the passage?

A. Insurance companies do not support the necessary investment.
B. Antibiotics are typically less profitable than some other drugs.
C. Medications for chronic diseases are less complex to produce.
D. The pace of bacterial gene mutation is too rapid to keep up with.

Q4. The word “comprehensive” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. understandable
B. well-researched
C. thorough
D. cost-effective

Q5. The passage mentions each of the following strategies for addressing antimicrobial resistance EXCEPT

A. increasing investment in measures for preventing infections
B. strengthening regulations that govern antibiotic prescriptions
C. offering financial incentives to drugmakers to develop new antibiotics
D. educating people worldwide about limiting the use of antibiotics

2026-03-08 Biochemical Systems Theory

原文（Passage）

Biochemical Systems Theory: Challenges and Implications

Biochemical systems theory, a potent framework for simulating biochemical processes, hinges on mathematical models for predicting the interactions of molecules within cells. The theory's ability to predict metabolic pathways regulated by enzymes (proteins facilitating and managing chemical reactions) offers significant potential for advancements in biotechnology. However, constructing accurate models demands a profound grasp of biology and mathematics, posing significant challenges to researchers.

While the theory enables simulations of complex cellular behavior, it is reliant on precise data inputs. Erroneous data can skew predictions, underscoring the delicate balance between mathematical precision and biological variability. That interplay raises questions about the theory's reliability, particularly in drug development, where predicting compounds' effects on metabolic pathways is crucial yet fraught with uncertainty.

Furthermore, biochemical systems theory has sparked debates over its ethical implications. [A] By scrutinizing biological systems, researchers identify processes ripe for intervention. [B] Yet this provokes concerns about the manipulation of life at a granular level, including the possibility that interventions could have unintended consequences or adversely affect future generations. [C] As the field evolves, ethical discussions are as dynamic as the biochemical networks themselves. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "hinges" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. focuses
B. builds
C. acts
D. depends

Q2. Which statement best summarizes the relationship between paragraphs 1 and 2?

A. Paragraph 2 describes a shortcoming of the concept introduced in paragraph 1.
B. Paragraph 2 proposes a solution to a problem discussed in paragraph 1.
C. Paragraph 2 proposes an alternative to the theory presented in paragraph 1.
D. Paragraph 2 illustrates the successful application of the theory described in paragraph 1.

Q3. Why does the author discuss drug development?

A. To emphasize the importance of using accurate data when constructing models
B. To give an example of an industry that has been transformed by biochemical systems theory
C. To demonstrate that questions about the theory's reliability have been largely resolved
D. To suggest that the theory's reliability is less important than discovering industrial applications that work

Q4. What does the passage imply about the ethical concerns raised by biochemical systems theory?

A. They have been dismissed by most ethicists as unjustified.
B. They are far from being completely resolved as of today.
C. They have been eased thanks to more precise modeling.
D. They are causing researchers to abandon the theory.

Q5. Look at the four choices that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. Ethicists worry that these actions may blur the line between healing and redesigning biological systems. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before "By scrutinizing biological systems, researchers identify processes ripe for intervention."
B. Before "Yet this provokes concerns about the manipulation of life at a granular level, including the possibility that interventions could have unintended consequences or adversely affect future generations."
C. Before "As the field evolves, ethical discussions are as dynamic as the biochemical networks themselves."
D. After "As the field evolves, ethical discussions are as dynamic as the biochemical networks themselves."

2026-03-08 Hollywood Golden Age

原文（Passage）

The Dynamics of Hollywood's Golden Age

Hollywood's Golden Age, from the 1920s to the 1960s, was a transformative period in cinema history. Under the studio system, major companies like RKO controlled film production, creating an efficient assembly-line process that produced stars such as Humphrey Bogart and Katharine Hepburn. While this system ensured a steady output of films, it often limited creative freedom for directors and actors tied to restrictive contracts. Yet this very constraint led to unexpected innovation as filmmakers sought new ways to tell compelling stories within set boundaries.

A pivotal change during this era was the introduction of sound, forever altering cinematic storytelling. Silent film stars had to adapt or risk obsolescence, while new genres like musicals capitalized on sound technology's possibilities. This shift pushed directors to experiment with narrative structures, often blurring the lines between genres to captivate audiences.

The decline of the studio system began with a 1948 Supreme Court ruling that dismantled studios' monopolies over theaters. This ruling opened the door for independent filmmakers, whose diverse and unconventional stories began gaining traction in theaters. However, the legacy of the studio system's efficiency and star-making machinery still influences Hollywood's operations today.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which aspect of the studio system encouraged filmmakers to innovate?
A. The demand for more silent films
B. The freedom to create experimental films
C. The inefficiency of film production
D. The boundaries imposed by restrictive contracts

Q2. The word "compelling" in the passage is closest in meaning to
A. modern
B. astonishing
C. fascinating
D. complex

Q3. Why does the author mention the introduction of sound in films?
A. To highlight a development that led to new, creative narrative techniques
B. To emphasize the former popularity of silent films
C. To discuss how sound renewed the careers of silent film stars
D. To identify the event that started the decline of the studio system

Q4. What inference can be made about the 1948 Supreme Court ruling?
A. It led to a temporary increase in studio profits.
B. It allowed independent films to be seen and become popular.

C. It caused studios to develop more large-scale musical productions.
D. It had no effect on Hollywood's operations.

Q5. What does the passage imply about the Hollywood film industry today?

A. Modern studios have completely abandoned all practices from the Golden Age period.
B. Contemporary films commonly use the storytelling techniques developed during the 1920s-1960s.
C. Independent filmmakers have entirely replaced the studio system's influence on cinema.
D. The assembly-line process of the studio system still impacts current Hollywood operations.

2026-03-08 Modern Detective Fiction

原文（Passage）

The Roots Of Modern Detective

Modern detective fiction emerged in the nineteenth century, a time of rapid social change, new technologies, and shifting ideas about crime and human psychology. Its roots lie partly in the rise of urbanization: As cities like London and Paris expanded, crime became more visible and more sensational, creating public fascination with both criminals and their pursuers. This environment helped inspire Edgar Allan Poe's "The Murders in the Rue Morgue" (1841), which introduced the archetype of the brilliant, analytical investigator.

Equally important was the development of professional policing. France's first investigative bureau, the Sûreté, was established in 1812 and London's Metropolitan Police in 1829, inspiring writers with real models of investigative procedures. Advances in forensic science—fingerprinting, photography, and early criminology—reinforced the idea that crime could be solved through observation and logic. By the time Sir Arthur Conan Doyle introduced Sherlock Holmes in 1887, readers were primed for a detective who embodied scientific reasoning and methodical deduction.

Cultural anxieties also played a role. Industrialization created both social disorder and a longing for narratives in which chaos was ultimately overcome. Detective fiction met that need, offering intellectual pleasure and moral reassurance. Together, these forces spawned a genre that continues to evolve, feeding our fascination with mysteries and their resolution.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage indicates that urbanization

A. was a factor in generating public interest in criminals
B. led to significant changes in forensic science
C. helped to increase the market for contemporary fiction
D. created conditions in which criminal organizations grew bolder

Q2. The word "sensational" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. mysterious
B. shocking
C. understandable
D. commonplace

Q3. The author mentions "The Murders in the Rue Morgue" primarily to

A. cite a work responsible for increasing the demand for detective fiction
B. highlight a way in which fiction reflected rapid social change
C. distinguish Poe's story from later works of detective fiction
D. note the invention of a particular type of character

Q4. The passage suggests that a distinctive characteristic of nineteenth-century detective fiction was

A. the depiction of criminals as individuals driven by cultural anxieties
B. the depiction of the detective as an inventor of new forensic techniques
C. the incorporation of details taken from newspaper accounts of real crimes
D. the celebration of logic and reasoning as counterforces to social disorder

Q5. The passage indicates which of the following about detective fiction?

A. It quickly became more popular with readers than other types of fiction.
B. It contributed to the notoriety of certain real-life criminals.
C. It met a psychological need common to many members of the public.
D. It was often written by authors who had professional policing experience.

2026-03-08 Parallel Computing Algorithms

原文（Passage）

Parallel Algorithms: From Challenges to Opportunities

Parallel algorithms, a computing method common in modern computers, solve problems faster by dividing a task into smaller parts that run at the same time. Instead of checking every item in a huge database one by one as in a sequential algorithm, a parallel algorithm might split the job across multiple processor cores, each checking a portion of the data simultaneously.

In healthcare, parallel algorithms play a crucial role in analyzing large datasets quickly. When researchers simulate how a virus spreads through a population, they need to process millions of data points-like infection rates and demographics. Using parallel processing, these simulations can run in minutes instead of hours, helping public health officials make faster decisions during outbreaks. However, if too much data is sent to the processors at once without proper management, the system slows down.

One of the strengths of parallel algorithms is their versatility. [A] Developers can tailor them to work efficiently on different types of hardware, such as graphics processing units (GPUs), which are especially good at handling many tasks at once. [B] This is a big reason why deep learning-used in things like facial recognition-has advanced so quickly. [C] Training a deep learning model would be nearly impossible without parallel computing. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about sequential algorithms?

A. They are less efficient than parallel algorithms are.
B. They handle computational tasks in the same way that parallel algorithms do.
C. They can solve problems that parallel algorithms cannot.
D. They use more advanced hardware than parallel algorithms do.

Q2. Why does the author discuss the simulation of the spread of a virus?

A. To illustrate the challenges that public health officials face during disease outbreaks
B. To demonstrate the significance of parallel algorithms in healthcare
C. To highlight the data points that researchers focus on when a virus spreads through a population
D. To emphasize the risk of using small datasets for analysis during disease outbreaks

Q3. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that indicates that parallel algorithms have challenges.

A. In healthcare, parallel algorithms play a crucial role in analyzing large datasets quickly.
B. When researchers simulate how a virus spreads through a population, they need to process millions of data points-like infection rates and demographics.
C. Using parallel processing, these simulations can run in minutes instead of hours, helping public health officials make faster decisions during outbreaks.

D. However, if too much data is sent to the processors at once without proper management, the system slows down.

Q4. The word "tailor" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. direct
B. explore
C. adapt
D. prepare

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "In light of their many advantages, parallel algorithms will surely continue to drive innovation in diverse areas like climate modeling and financial analysis." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-03-08 Smart Textiles

原文（Passage）

Smart Textiles

Smart textiles are revolutionizing the fashion industry by integrating advanced digital technology into fabrics. These textiles can respond to environmental changes, monitor physical activity, and even generate energy. One example is phase-change materials that adapt to temperature fluctuations, providing warmth when it is cold and cooling when it is hot. Another innovation is textiles embedded with sensors that track health metrics such as heart rate and body temperature. These developments offer promising applications for athletes and medical patients.

Researchers are also exploring textiles that harvest energy from movement. These fabrics utilize piezoelectric materials that generate electricity when subjected to mechanical stress. [A] Envision clothing that can charge your smartphone simply through your daily activities. [B] Moreover, smart textiles can be designed to change color or pattern based on electrical stimuli, opening up new possibilities for both fashion and interior design. [C]

Yet, integrating technology into textiles presents challenges. [D] Durability, washability, and cost are significant concerns. Since their initial cost will be higher than traditional fabrics, ensuring that smart textiles can withstand regular use without degrading is essential for their widespread adoption. Protecting privacy is another concern of many: smart textiles could collect vast amounts of user data that must be properly secured.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What are phase-change materials designed to do?

A. Generate electricity from movement
B. Adapt to changes in temperature
C. Monitor heart rate and body temperature
D. Change color based on electrical stimuli

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge for smart textiles?

A. Washability
B. Cost
C. Durability
D. Availability

Q3. The word "harvest" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. grow

B. collect
C. spin
D. discover

Q4. What is the main purpose of paragraph 3?

A. To present obstacles to the ideas previously introduced
B. To expand on the benefits mentioned in paragraph 2
C. To provide information on the future applications of smart textiles
D. To summarize the main points of the reading

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Imagine being able to change the appearance of your furnishings depending on your mood or the season." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-03-04（3 套）

2026-03-04 Spicy Cuisine Advantages

原文（Passage）

A Unique Advantage of Spicy Cuisine

Are you fond of spicy food? Spices have been used for thousands of years to enhance the flavor of food, originally in cultures where spice plants were native to the area. Today, spice use is widespread across cultures, though certain spices are more prevalent in some cuisines. Indeed, scientists have suggested that hot-climate cuisines feature a greater amount and variety of spices. For example, a recent study found that the number of different spices was much greater in traditional recipes from Southeast Asian countries than in those from northern Europe.

Why do hot-climate cuisines feature more spices? Some believe that spice consumption is related to cultural preferences. While culture certainly plays a part, scientists have recently suggested that the antimicrobial properties of spices, which prevent the growth of dangerous foodborne microorganisms, ensured their widespread use in hot climates. In such climates, food spoilage was a concern before the availability of refrigeration. Spices with greater antimicrobial or antibacterial properties, such as allspice, cinnamon, cumin, garlic, and onions, were frequently featured in the traditional recipes of hot-climate cuisines and in different combinations. Scientists concluded that food safety precipitated the use of many and multiple spices in hot regions.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the purpose of the passage?

A. To share research findings related to spice use
B. To promote the widespread use of specific spices
C. To describe an outdated theory about spice use
D. To contrast traditional and contemporary spice consumption

Q2. What data were likely collected for the study?

A. The number of spices used in a variety of countries
B. The types of microorganisms on different spices
C. The food preferences of customers at traditional restaurants
D. The number of traditional Southeast Asian recipes used in Europe

Q3. According to the passage, what is suggested about spice usage in food?

A. It can conceal the odor of spoiled food.
B. It has caused a rise in demand for native plants.
C. It may prevent bacteria on food from developing.
D. It has decreased substantially in Southeast Asia.

Q4. All of the following are mentioned about spices EXCEPT:

A. Spices are derived from plant products.
B. Spices require refrigeration to maintain their function.
C. Spice usage is associated with cultural practices.
D. Spice usage varies considerably by cuisine.

Q5. The word “precipitated” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. threw
B. separated
C. caused
D. rained

2026-03-04 Urban Resilience Strategies

原文（Passage）

Urban Resilience

Urban resilience refers to the ability of cities to absorb, recover from, and prepare for shocks such as natural disasters, economic crises, and social upheavals. This concept is becoming increasingly important as more people move into urban areas and face the challenges that come with densely populated areas. Cities are implementing various strategies to enhance resilience. For instance, green infrastructure, like parks and green roofs, can help manage stormwater and reduce flooding. Renewable energy sources, such as solar and wind, reduce dependence on non-renewable resources and improve energy security.

Community engagement is another critical component of urban resilience. Local governments are involving residents in planning and decision-making processes to ensure that the needs of the community are met. This participatory approach fosters a sense of ownership and accountability among citizens, improving the effectiveness of resilience strategies. Technology also plays a role, with smart city initiatives using data and sensors to monitor infrastructure and predict potential problems. [A]

Nonetheless, building urban resilience is not without obstacles. [B] Budget constraints and political disagreements can hinder the implementation of necessary measures. [C] Additionally, the integration of new technologies requires substantial investment and training. [D] Despite these obstacles, the pursuit of urban resilience is essential for the sustainable development of cities worldwide.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the purpose of green infrastructure like parks and green roofs?

A. To increase urban density
B. To prevent flooding
C. To foster community engagement
D. To generate renewable energy

Q2. The word “fosters” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. describes
B. neglects
C. encourages
D. replaces

Q3. What does the passage suggest is essential for resilience strategies to be fully effective?

A. Discouraging the uncontrolled growth of urban populations

B. The involvement of local government and citizens

C. Less reliance on smart technology

D. Limiting the number of structures in urban areas

Q4. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge for urban resilience?

A. Financial limitations

B. Political disagreements

C. Integration of new technologies

D. Community participation

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? For example, Singapore's Intelligent Transport System incorporates artificial intelligence (AI) to predict real-time traffic conditions, effectively manage road congestion, and optimize routes. Locations in the passage:

A. After “Technology also plays a role, with smart city initiatives using data and sensors to monitor infrastructure and predict potential problems.”

B. Before “Budget constraints and political disagreements can hinder the implementation of necessary measures.”

C. Before “Additionally, the integration of new technologies requires substantial investment and training.”

D. Before “Despite these obstacles, the pursuit of urban resilience is essential for the sustainable development of cities worldwide.”

2026-03-04 Wind Ensemble Conducting

原文（Passage）

Wind Ensemble Conducting

In the world of classical music, wind ensemble conducting requires a blend of artistry and precision, demanding a conductor who can shape diverse musicians into a cohesive unit. [A] Unlike orchestral conductors, who often lead ensembles centered around strings, wind ensemble conductors primarily work with woodwinds, brass, and percussion, requiring a different set of interpretive and technical skills. [B]

One challenge of wind ensemble conducting is balancing the ensemble. [C] Wind instruments produce a wide range of dynamics and timbres, making it essential for conductors to ensure that no single section overpowers the others. [D] For example, the brassy sound of trumpets can dominate if not carefully managed. Conductors must use gestures and cues to achieve balance, considering the acoustics of the performance space.

Interpreting the score is another crucial aspect. Wind ensemble pieces often include compositions from modern and contemporary composers, which can be complex and unconventional. Conductors need to interpret these scores carefully and convey their vision to the musicians. This involves precise beat patterns and expressive gestures to communicate dynamic contrasts and phrasing.

Wind ensemble conductors collaborate closely with composers, which can lead to unique performances that reflect the composer's original intent. Conductors may need to adjust their style to suit different compositions and settings.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “cohesive” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. integrated

B. outstanding

C. proficient
D. performing

Q2. According to the passage, balancing the ensemble is a challenge for wind ensemble conductors because

A. woodwind sections typically need more rehearsal time than brass sections do
B. wind instruments create a wide variety of sound qualities and volume levels
C. the cues and gestures used by wind ensemble conductors are limited
D. most performance spaces have poor acoustics

Q3. What is the main purpose of paragraph 3?

A. To highlight the role of composers in wind ensemble conducting
B. To discuss the history of wind ensemble music
C. To explore the challenges of working with complex modern compositions
D. To describe the physical techniques used by conductors

Q4. What can be inferred about wind ensemble conductors' collaboration with composers?

A. It often leads to arguments.
B. It leads to greater uniformity in performances.
C. It is strictly professional and reserved in tone.
D. It requires flexibility and openness to new ideas.

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? In light of their area of expertise, wind ensemble conductors face a unique set of difficulties. Locations in the passage:

A. After “In the world of classical music, wind ensemble conducting requires a blend of artistry and precision, demanding a conductor who can shape diverse musicians into a cohesive unit.”
B. After “Unlike orchestral conductors, who often lead ensembles centered around strings, wind ensemble conductors primarily work with woodwinds, brass, and percussion, requiring a different set of interpretive and technical skills.”
C. After “One challenge of wind ensemble conducting is balancing the ensemble.”
D. After “making it essential for conductors to ensure that no single section overpowers the others.”

2026-03-02（2 套）

2026-03-02 Education Growth Mindset

原文（Passage）

Growth Mindset in Education

The concept of a growth mindset has gained attention in educational psychology. Coined by Carol Dweck, the phrase “growth mindset” refers to the belief that abilities and intelligence can be developed through dedication and hard work. This contrasts with a fixed mindset, where individuals believe their abilities are static.

Research suggests that students with a growth mindset are more likely to embrace challenges, persevere through difficulties, and see effort as a path to mastery. For example, a student who struggles with math but believes they can improve with practice is displaying a growth mindset. This belief encourages resilience and a positive attitude towards learning.

Educators play a crucial role in fostering a growth mindset in their students. Techniques such as praising effort rather than innate ability and providing constructive feedback can help students develop this mindset. Creating a classroom environment that celebrates mistakes as learning opportunities can reinforce the growth mindset philosophy.

[A] However, implementing growth mindset strategies is not without challenges. [B] Some students may find it difficult to change how they view their abilities, especially if they have been

accustomed to a fixed mindset for a long time. [C] Additionally, educators themselves must genuinely believe in the growth mindset principles to effectively convey them to their students. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “persevere” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. hurry
B. change
C. hesitate
D. persist

Q2. According to the passage, which of the following is true about students with a growth mindset?

A. They believe their intelligence is unchangeable.
B. They avoid challenges.
C. They view effort as a means to improve.
D. They are naturally talented.

Q3. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as ways educators can foster a growth mindset EXCEPT by

A. commending students' efforts
B. praising students' innate abilities
C. giving constructive feedback
D. using mistakes as learning opportunities

Q4. According to the passage, the implementation of growth mindset strategies may be challenging because of

A. difficulty in changing students' attitudes
B. lack of support from students' parents
C. insufficient research on growth mindset
D. overemphasis on academic performance

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? This reluctance can be further compounded by a lack of immediate, visible progress, which may discourage continued effort. Locations in the passage:

A. Before “However, implementing growth mindset strategies is not without challenges.”
B. After “However, implementing growth mindset strategies is not without challenges.”
C. After “Some students may find it difficult to change how they view their abilities, especially if they have been accustomed to a fixed mindset for a long time.”
D. After “Additionally, educators themselves must genuinely believe in the growth mindset principles to effectively convey them to their students.”

2026-03-02 Urban Green Spaces

原文（Passage）

Urban Green Spaces

Urban green spaces, such as parks and community gardens, enhance city life for residents. The contrast between green spaces and the surrounding concrete and glass structures can be a visual respite; such spaces also provide residents with a place to relax and connect with nature, which can significantly improve mental health, reduce stress, and encourage physical activity. [A] Urban green spaces also contribute to environmental sustainability. [B] They provide a cooler spot within the concrete heat traps surrounding them, absorb rainwater and reduce flooding, and increase biodiversity by providing habitats for various species. [C]

Recent initiatives have focused on creating more green spaces in underserved areas. [D] Some cities are converting abandoned lots into community gardens or small parks. These projects not only provide green spaces but also involve community members in the planning and maintenance of them, fostering a sense of ownership and responsibility.
While urban green spaces offer a host of benefits, they are not without drawbacks. When parks and gardens are added in city neighborhoods, they often increase the value of nearby properties. This can unintentionally lead to the displacement of longtime residents who can no longer afford rising rents or property taxes. Another challenge is preserving these spaces--it can be difficult to secure the funding necessary to maintain them.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “respite” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. break
B. addition
C. symbol
D. surprise

Q2. What is the relationship between paragraphs 1 and 2?

A. Paragraph 2 describes a new benefit beyond what is mentioned in paragraph 1.
B. Paragraph 2 contradicts the ideas presented in paragraph 1.
C. Paragraph 2 gives a solution to a problem discussed in paragraph 1.
D. Paragraph 2 provides a summary of the detailed information offered in paragraph 1.

Q3. How can cities improve neighborhood residents' sense of responsibility to local green spaces?

A. By asking residents to help find funding for them
B. By asking professional gardeners to plant vegetation
C. By inviting area residents to help maintain them
D. By arranging for residents to own the land used for them

Q4. Why does the author mention rising rents for neighborhood residents?

A. To illustrate how urban green spaces increase a neighborhood's desirability
B. To explain where the funding for building green spaces comes from
C. To show that green spaces are especially needed in underserved urban areas
D. To point out one of the disadvantages of urban green spaces

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Some even integrate playgrounds, sports fields, and exercise stations, making such activity accessible and fun for local residents. Locations in the passage:

A. After “which can significantly improve mental health, reduce stress, and encourage physical activity.”
B. After “Urban green spaces also contribute to environmental sustainability.”
C. After “and increase biodiversity by providing habitats for various species.”
D. Before “Some cities are converting abandoned lots into community gardens or small parks.”

2026-02-28（3 套）

2026-02-28 Feedback System Complications

原文（Passage）

Feedback Systems and Their Unintended Effects
Control engineering is a branch of engineering focused on designing systems that regulate themselves to achieve desired behaviors, often through feedback mechanisms. These systems monitor their output and adjust their input accordingly, forming closed-loop mechanisms that

maintain stability and performance. While this self-regulating nature is a core strength, feedback loops can also introduce unexpected complications.

Consider how feedback controls temperature in a home heating system: A thermostat compares the current temperature to a set point and modifies the heating output based on the difference. However, time delays in this loop can cause overcorrections, resulting in temperature fluctuations. If the feedback response is not precisely calibrated, the system may oscillate continuously, failing to stabilize.

[A] In more complex systems, such as automated flight control or robotic motion, feedback mechanisms can behave unpredictably under certain conditions. [B] For example, small timing mismatches or overly sensitive sensors may cause a drone to overreact to minor disturbances, leading to erratic flight patterns. [C] This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior, reveals that feedback is not inherently stabilizing. [D] Instead, it demands careful tuning and predictive modeling. As control engineering advances, understanding and mitigating this unpredictability will be essential for ensuring reliability and precision, especially in high-stakes fields like aerospace and robotics.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, what advantage do closed-loop feedback systems provide?

A. They can be easily adjusted using remote controls.
B. They continuously monitor their own performance.
C. They are less complicated than other feedback systems.
D. They assist engineers in creating more stable designs.

Q2. What happens when a home heating system is not precisely calibrated as described in paragraph 2?

A. The temperature in the house goes up and down rather than remaining at a constant level.
B. The temperature in the house remains well below the set point.
C. The thermostat is unable to correctly determine the current temperature in the house.
D. The home heating system is likely to break down under the stress of frequent oscillations.

Q3. Why does the author discuss drones in paragraph 3?

A. To argue that drones are so unstable that they pose a safety risk to the public
B. To suggest that controlling drones is easier than controlling robots
C. To provide an example of chaotic behavior in a feedback system
D. To explain how navigational sensors function during flight

Q4. The word "mitigating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. preventing
B. monitoring
C. decreasing
D. analyzing

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. A sudden gust of wind, for instance, might trigger an exaggerated correction, making the drone veer sharply or wobble midair instead of stabilizing smoothly. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "In more complex systems, such as automated flight control or robotic motion, feedback mechanisms can behave unpredictably under certain conditions."
B. Before "For example, small timing mismatches or overly sensitive sensors may cause a drone to overreact to minor disturbances, leading to erratic flight patterns."
C. Before "This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior, reveals that feedback is not inherently stabilizing."

D. Before "Instead, it demands careful tuning and predictive modeling."

2026-02-28 Music Therapy Power

原文（Passage）

The Power of Music Therapy

Music therapy is known for its powerful effects on mental health. By using musical interventions, therapists aim to improve people's emotional well-being and cognitive functioning.

The roots of music therapy trace back to ancient healing rituals, but its modern form appeared after World War II, when musicians played for veterans suffering from trauma. Research shows that music therapy can reduce anxiety and stress. Listening to calming music can lower heart rates and cortisol levels. [A] This is why music therapy is often used in hospitals. A study found that patients who listened to 30 minutes of music daily experienced significant reductions in anxiety. [B] Engaging with familiar music can also trigger pleasant memories and improve mood. Patients who participated in music therapy showed better memory recall and increased social interaction. [C] A study demonstrated that Alzheimer's patients who listened to music from their youth had improved cognitive function.

Despite its benefits, music therapy is not a one-size-fits-all solution. Its effectiveness varies depending on the individual and type of music used. [D] Personal musical preferences, cultural background, and the context in which the music is played are crucial to the therapy's success.

题目（Questions）

Q1. How did music therapy in its modern form begin?

A. As a way to improve the cognitive functioning of soldiers
B. As a result of the careful study of ancient healing practices
C. As a means to treat people suffering from Alzheimer's disease
D. As a tool to help veterans cope with the effects of the war

Q2. The word "trigger" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. bring
B. shoot
C. heal
D. enjoy

Q3. Why does the author mention listening to music daily for 30 minutes?

A. To indicate how long a music therapy session should last
B. To support a claim about music therapy's effectiveness
C. To explain why a study was conducted in a hospital
D. To suggest that music therapy should be practiced at home

Q4. According to the passage, all of the following can affect the benefit of a music therapy session for a patient EXCEPT

A. what kind of music the patient prefers
B. which culture the patient is from
C. in what environment the music is played
D. how knowledgeable the patient is about music

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Both cognitive and social benefits persisted long after the treatment sessions had ended. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "This is why music therapy is often used in hospitals."

B. After "A study found that patients who listened to 30 minutes of music daily experienced significant reductions in anxiety."
C. Before "A study demonstrated that Alzheimer's patients who listened to music from their youth had improved cognitive function."
D. Before "Personal musical preferences, cultural background, and the context in which the music is played are crucial to the therapy's success."

2026-02-28 Quantum Computing Revolution

原文（Passage）

Quantum Computing

Quantum computing promises to revolutionize technology by delivering unprecedented computational power. Traditional computers store data in binary bits, representing 0 or 1. Quantum computers use qubits, which can represent 0, 1, or both simultaneously (a state called superposition). This allows quantum computers to process vast amounts of data simultaneously, solving complex problems much faster than classical computers.

Quantum computing has promising applications in cryptography--techniques for encoding and decoding messages. Current encryption (encoding) methods rely on complex algorithms that classical computers struggle to break. Quantum computers could potentially break these encryption algorithms with ease, requiring new, quantum-resistant techniques. Researchers are exploring such methods to secure data in a post-quantum world.

One challenge to fully realizing quantum computing is that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances. [A] Maintaining coherence, the state needed by qubits to perform calculations, requires extremely low temperatures and isolation from environmental noise, such as magnetic or electric field fluctuations. [B] Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating. [C] Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues. [D] Quantum computing holds promise for advancements in fields like medicine, finance, and artificial intelligence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "revolutionize" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. simplify
B. transform
C. study
D. use

Q2. Why does the author discuss binary bits and qubits?

A. To explain why quantum computers are more powerful than classical computers are
B. To discuss the two ways in which quantum computers store data
C. To emphasize the fast pace at which computing technology is advancing
D. To explain what causes the state of superposition

Q3. According to the passage, new encryption techniques are needed in the post-quantum world because

A. quantum computers are less secure
B. quantum computers store more valuable data than classical computers do
C. quantum computers can break existing encryption
D. quantum computers cannot process current encryption algorithms

Q4. Why does the author mention "external disturbances"?

A. To point out that qubits can only function in certain environmental conditions
B. To introduce a similarity between quantum computing and traditional computing

C. To explain how quantum computing creates unwanted fluctuations in magnetic or electric fields

D. To suggest that quantum computing can be prohibitively expensive

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Seeing progress, companies and governments have begun to invest heavily in quantum research, aiming to unlock its potential. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. After "One challenge to fully realizing quantum computing is that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances."

B. Before "Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating."

C. Before "Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues."

D. Before "Quantum computing holds promise for advancements in fields like medicine, finance, and artificial intelligence."

2026-02-25（2 套）

2026-02-25 Generational Identity Study

原文（Passage）

Generational Identity

Some researchers studying the United States population posit that Generation Z (born roughly between 1997 and 2012) is not merely an extension of millennials (born roughly between 1981 and 1996) but a distinct cohort shaped by fundamentally different sociotechnological conditions. While millennials came of age during the rise of the Internet and social media, Gen Z has never known a world without smartphones, automated content filtering, and pervasive digital surveillance. This has led to claims that Gen Z exhibits higher digital literacy but lower trust in institutions and media than millennials do.

However, this theory faces objections. For instance, the assumption that technological immersion leads to skepticism may overlook other factors, such as economic precarity or political polarization, which also influence trust. Moreover, while some studies suggest that Gen Z is more pragmatic and financially cautious than millennials are, this could be attributed not to generational identity but to life-stage effects--young adults often exhibit similar traits regardless of cohort.

Other scholars believe that generational differences are overstated and that intragenerational diversity (e.g., socioeconomic class, race, or geography) is more significant than intergenerational contrasts. Thus, while the Gen Z vs. millennials dichotomy is useful as a cultural shorthand, its explanatory power may be limited.

题目（Questions）

Q1. In the first paragraph, what is the relation between sentence 2 and sentence 3?

A. Sentence 2 raises a question, and sentence 3 presents a plausible answer.

B. Sentence 2 identifies a problem, and sentence 3 proposes a solution.

C. Sentence 2 states a fact, and sentence 3 points to a possible consequence.

D. Sentence 2 describes an empirical discovery, and sentence 3 clarifies its context.

Q2. The word "precarity" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. insecurity

B. status

C. difference

D. dependence

Q3. According to the passage, what is one way Generation Z is believed to differ from the millennial generation?

A. Gen Z is more comfortable using social media.
B. Gen Z is less concerned about spending money.
C. Gen Z is more used to being constantly observed.
D. Gen Z has lower intragenerational diversity.

Q4. What does the passage suggest about the potential impact of "technological immersion" on Gen Z?

A. It is significant, but other factors are important as well.
B. It will gradually diminish as Gen Z individuals grow older.
C. It is less pronounced in Gen Z than in the millennial generation.
D. It causes a lack of trust between Gen Z and earlier generations.

Q5. The passage suggests which of the following about generational differences?

A. The societal impact of technology on generational cohorts may be difficult to measure precisely.
B. Differences between Gen Z and millennials may be exaggerated.
C. Gen Z and millennials themselves do not accept the dichotomy between their generations.
D. Research is needed to explain why the belief in generational differences is so persistent.

2026-02-25 Parallel Computing Algorithms

原文（Passage）

Parallel Algorithms: From Challenges to Opportunities

Parallel algorithms, a computing method common in modern computers, solve problems faster by dividing a task into smaller parts that run at the same time. Instead of checking every item in a huge database one by one as in a sequential algorithm, a parallel algorithm might split the job across multiple processor cores, each checking a portion of the data simultaneously.

In healthcare, parallel algorithms play a crucial role in analyzing large datasets quickly. When researchers simulate how a virus spreads through a population, they need to process millions of data points--like infection rates and demographics. Using parallel processing, these simulations can run in minutes instead of hours, helping public health officials make faster decisions during outbreaks. However, if too much data is sent to the processors at once without proper management, the system slows down.

One of the strengths of parallel algorithms is their versatility. [A] Developers can tailor them to work efficiently on different types of hardware, such as graphics processing units (GPUs), which are especially good at handling many tasks at once. [B] This is a big reason why deep learning--used in things like facial recognition--has advanced so quickly. [C] Training a deep learning model would be nearly impossible without parallel computing. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the passage indicate about sequential algorithms?

A. They are less efficient than parallel algorithms are.
B. They handle computational tasks in the same way that parallel algorithms do.
C. They can solve problems that parallel algorithms cannot.
D. They use more advanced hardware than parallel algorithms do.

Q2. Why does the author discuss the simulation of the spread of a virus?

A. To illustrate the challenges that public health officials face during disease outbreaks
B. To demonstrate the significance of parallel algorithms in healthcare

C. To highlight the data points that researchers focus on when a virus spreads through a population

D. To emphasize the risk of using small datasets for analysis during disease outbreaks

Q3. Identify the sentence in paragraph 2 that indicates that parallel algorithms have challenges.

A. In healthcare, parallel algorithms play a crucial role in analyzing large datasets quickly.

B. When researchers simulate how a virus spreads through a population, they need to process millions of data points--like infection rates and demographics.

C. Using parallel processing, these simulations can run in minutes instead of hours, helping public health officials make faster decisions during outbreaks.

D. However, if too much data is sent to the processors at once without proper management, the system slows down.

Q4. The word "tailor" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. direct

B. explore

C. adapt

D. prepare

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. In light of their many advantages, parallel algorithms will surely continue to drive innovation in diverse areas like climate modeling and financial analysis. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "Developers can tailor them to work efficiently on different types of hardware, such as graphics processing units (GPUs), which are especially good at handling many tasks at once."

B. After "Developers can tailor them to work efficiently on different types of hardware, such as graphics processing units (GPUs), which are especially good at handling many tasks at once."

C. Before "Training a deep learning model would be nearly impossible without parallel computing."

D. After "Training a deep learning model would be nearly impossible without parallel computing."

2026-02-23（3 套）

2026-02-23 Coral Reef Restoration

原文（Passage）

Coral Reef Restoration

Coral reefs are defined as an underwater ecosystem formed by colonies of tiny marine animals called coral polyps. They are among the most diverse ecosystems on Earth; however, they are facing severe threats from climate change, pollution, and overfishing. These threats have led to widespread coral bleaching, where corals lose their vibrant colors and turn white. Bleaching weakens corals, making them more susceptible to disease and ultimately leading to their death. Scientists and environmentalists are working on various restoration techniques to combat this decline. These efforts highlight the urgency of finding effective solutions to protect these vital ecosystems. One promising method is coral gardening, where fragments of healthy coral are grown in underwater nurseries and then transplanted onto damaged reefs. This technique has shown significant success in certain areas, helping to rebuild reef structures and promote biodiversity. Another innovative approach involves using electricity to stimulate coral growth. This method, known as Biorock technology, creates an electric field that encourages the deposition of minerals found in seawater, accelerating coral growth.

Despite these efforts, challenges remain. Restoration projects are often expensive and labor-intensive, and the long-term success of these techniques is still uncertain. Continuous research and adaptive management strategies are crucial for ensuring the resilience of coral reefs in the face of ongoing environmental changes.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What can be inferred about coral bleaching in the first paragraph?

A. It makes corals more colorful.
B. It is caused by underwater nurseries.
C. It is a sign that corals are unhealthy.
D. It helps coral growth.

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a threat to coral reefs in the passage?

A. Climate change
B. Pollution
C. Overfishing
D. Tourism

Q3. Why does the author mention Biorock™ technology in the second paragraph?

A. To describe one cause behind coral bleaching
B. To introduce an innovative method for coral restoration
C. To explain how electricity affects coral health
D. To criticize traditional restoration methods

Q4. What is one challenge associated with coral reef restoration mentioned in the last paragraph?

A. It requires a lot of water.
B. It is costly and requires a lot of work.
C. It damages healthy corals.
D. It reduces biodiversity.

Q5. What can be inferred about the long-term success of coral restoration techniques?

A. It is guaranteed with current methods.
B. It depends on reducing tourism.
C. It is unaffected by environmental changes.
D. It is still not guaranteed.

2026-02-23 Philosophical Value Theory

原文（Passage）

Value Theory

Value theory investigates the nature of values and the principles that determine what is worth pursuing, both individually and collectively. Central questions include: What makes something good? Are values objective features of the world or subjective preferences? A key distinction in value theory is between intrinsic value, which denotes value something has in itself, and instrumental value, which refers to the value of something as a means to an end.

One influential theory within this domain is utilitarianism, which posits that the moral worth of actions is determined by their consequences, specifically the maximization of overall happiness or utility. This consequentialist framework has shaped ethical reasoning in fields ranging from public policy to economics. However, critics argue that utilitarianism's aggregation of happiness can negate individual rights and seemingly justify morally troubling trade-offs. For example, allocating limited healthcare resources to benefit the majority may disadvantage those with rare or costly conditions, raising concerns about fairness and equity.

Contemporary value theorists often endorse value pluralism, the view that multiple, sometimes conflicting values--such as autonomy, justice, and compassion--are irreducibly important. This pluralistic approach emphasizes the complexity of ethical decision-making and the need to navigate competing goods instead of reducing them to a single metric.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, value theory is concerned with all of the following EXCEPT

A. how to determine what is good
B. whether values are personal preferences
C. how to distinguish between values and principles
D. the difference between intrinsic and instrumental value

Q2. What does the phrase "This consequentialist framework" refer to?

A. The view that the consequences of an action determine its morality
B. Theories that foreground the happiness of the individual in assigning value
C. The underlying view that theories of value have an impact on making life decisions
D. The debate about how best to balance competing outcomes of happiness and utility

Q3. The word "allocating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. distributing
B. acquiring
C. increasing
D. tracking

Q4. According to the passage, what is one main criticism of utilitarianism?

A. Its implementation may benefit public policy, but it is less helpful for economic decisions.
B. Its priority of making healthcare more accessible creates higher costs for most people.
C. In its efforts to benefit large numbers of people, it may harm some individuals.
D. There is little evidence that it leads to improved healthcare for the majority.

Q5. What does the passage suggest about value pluralism?

A. It was a popular system for making decisions until quite recently.
B. It gives primary consideration to compassion while autonomy plays a secondary role.
C. It states that ethical decisions require the input of multiple decision-makers.
D. It argues that ethical decisions should not be based on just one criterion.

2026-02-23 Synthetic Diamond Production

原文（Passage）

Synthetic Diamonds

Traditionally, diamonds were extracted from mines, a process fraught with environmental concerns. Synthetic diamonds offer a promising alternative.

Creating synthetic diamonds involves replicating the conditions under which natural diamonds form. One popular method is High Pressure High Temperature (HPHT), where carbon is subjected to extreme heat and pressure. HPHT diamonds can be produced quickly and in large quantities, making them suitable for mass production. However, they may contain metallic inclusions from the catalysts used, which can affect clarity and color.

Another method is Chemical Vapor Deposition (CVD), which grows diamonds layer by layer from carbon-rich gases in a vacuum chamber. CVD diamonds typically have fewer impurities and offer greater control over clarity and size. Although CVD diamonds can be produced on a large scale, CVD production is often more technically demanding and slower, which may influence cost.

[A] Both HPHT and CVD methods produce diamonds that are chemically and physically identical to natural diamonds. [B] They share the same hardness, brilliance, and clarity, making them

suitable for jewelry. [C] Consumers are often skeptical of synthetic diamonds, as they associate rarity and historical significance only with natural diamonds. [D] Nevertheless, the market for synthetic diamonds continues to grow, driven by their affordability, sustainability, and ethical appeal.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that one advantage of synthetic diamonds over natural diamonds is that

A. producing synthetic diamonds requires less heat than mining natural diamonds does
B. producing synthetic diamonds is less harmful to the environment than mining natural diamonds is
C. synthetic diamonds are physically and chemically superior to natural diamonds
D. synthetic diamonds are available in a greater variety than natural diamonds are

Q2. The word "replicating" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. analyzing
B. recreating
C. altering
D. enhancing

Q3. According to the passage, what is one advantage of HPHT diamonds over CVD diamonds?

A. They are of higher quality.
B. They are easier to produce.
C. They can more readily be used for jewelry.
D. They have better clarity and color.

Q4. Why does the passage mention the "rarity and historical significance" of natural diamonds?

A. To emphasize that consumers should continue using natural diamonds for most purposes
B. To support the claim that the market for natural diamonds is growing
C. To explain why the acceptance of synthetic diamonds is somewhat limited
D. To highlight the affordability and sustainability of synthetic diamonds

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. And because of the controlled conditions in which they are produced, synthetic diamonds are actually preferred for industrial uses, such as in cutting tools and electronic devices. Where would the sentence best fit? Select a location to add the sentence to the passage.

A. Before "Both HPHT and CVD methods produce diamonds that are chemically and physically identical to natural diamonds."
B. Before "They share the same hardness, brilliance, and clarity, making them suitable for jewelry."
C. Before "Consumers are often skeptical of synthetic diamonds, as they associate rarity and historical significance only with natural diamonds."
D. Before "Nevertheless, the market for synthetic diamonds continues to grow, driven by their sustainability and affordability."

2026-02-10（5 套）

2026-02-10 Artificial Expert Systems

原文（Passage）

Article - Expert Systems
Expert Systems

Expert systems are a branch of artificial intelligence designed to mimic the decision-making abilities of human experts. These systems are built to solve complex problems by applying a set of rules to solve specific problems. Their goal is to replicate the expertise and reasoning of professionals in fields like medicine and engineering.
An early expert system is MYCIN, developed in the 1970s to diagnose bacterial infections and recommend antibiotics. MYCIN worked by asking a series of questions about a patient's data, inferring diagnoses and suggesting treatments. MYCIN often performed as well as human specialists; however, MYCIN's system needed constant updates, requiring extensive input from medical professionals.
[A] Despite their potential, expert systems have limitations, since they rely on pre-programmed rules and cannot adapt without ongoing input from human experts. The process of updating the system can be labor-intensive. [B] Advancements in machine learning and natural language processing could address these issues. [C] By integrating these technologies, expert systems could learn from new data and adapt, improving accuracy and relevance. Researchers are optimistic that these advancements will transform expert systems, enabling them to tackle a wider range of challenges and operate more independently. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "mimic" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. replace
B. combine
C. imitate
D. challenge

Q2. How did MYCIN diagnose bacterial infections?

A. It used a human specialist to evaluate patient data.
B. It applied set rules to analyze patient data.
C. It used an infection rates to infer the probability of a particular type of bacteria.
D. It relied on information provided directly by the patients.

Q3. What is a major limitation of current expert systems mentioned in the passage?

A. They are unable to process large datasets.
B. They often provide incorrect results.
C. They need frequent updating.
D. They use databases that are always changing.

Q4. What can be inferred about the future of expert systems?

A. They will probably be limited to use in medical applications.
B. They will one day be able to update themselves without human input.
C. They will become less accurate as the amount of new data increases.
D. They will soon be replaced by more relevant technologies.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Additionally, their performance may decline in unfamiliar or rapidly changing environments where new information is constantly emerging. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before the sentence "Despite their potential, expert systems have limitations, since they rely on pre-programmed rules and cannot adapt without ongoing input from human experts."
B. After the sentence "The process of updating the system can be labor-intensive."
C. Before the sentence "By integrating these technologies, expert systems could learn from new data and adapt, improving accuracy and relevance."

D. After the sentence "Researchers are optimistic that these advancements will transform expert systems, enabling them to tackle a wider range of challenges and operate more independently."

2026-02-10 Artificial Photosynthesis Technology

原文（Passage）

Article - Artificial Photosynthesis

Artificial Photosynthesis

Artificial photosynthesis is a developing technology designed to replicate the natural process plants use to convert sunlight into energy. Scientists believe this innovation could address multiple global challenges, such as energy sustainability and climate change.

Unlike traditional solar panels, which convert sunlight directly into electricity, artificial photosynthesis uses sunlight to produce chemical fuels that can be stored and used later. The process involves mimicking plants' ability to absorb sunlight and split water molecules into hydrogen and oxygen. The hydrogen can then be combined with carbon dioxide to produce hydrocarbons, which are combustible fuels. This approach has some advantages, since chemical fuels generated through artificial photosynthesis can be stored for longer periods than electricity from solar panels, which requires immediate use or expensive battery storage.

But despite its promise, the technology faces significant hurdles. One major challenge is developing efficient and durable catalysts that can sustain the reactions required for artificial photosynthesis; many degrade quickly. Additionally, researchers must find ways to scale the technology for widespread use, which involves addressing economic and infrastructure barriers.

Nonetheless, ongoing advances in materials science and nanotechnology provide hope that artificial photosynthesis could become a viable solution for future energy needs.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Why does the author mention traditional solar panels?

A. To highlight the limitations of artificial photosynthesis

B. To discuss their role in climate change

C. To explain why they are more popular

D. To compare their energy conversion methods with artificial photosynthesis

Q2. What advantage of artificial photosynthesis over solar panels does the writer emphasize?

A. It can immediately convert sunlight into electricity.

B. It generates fuels that can be stored for longer periods.

C. It requires less sunlight to operate.

D. It produces cheaper energy.

Q3. The word "viable" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. inexpensive

B. workable

C. renewable

D. easy

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 explains a concept introduced in paragraph 2.

B. Paragraph 3 provides extended details of a technological process described in paragraph 2.

C. Paragraph 3 introduces the challenges of the technology covered in paragraph 2.

D. Paragraph 3 provides examples of successful implementations of the technology discussed in paragraph 2.

Q5. Why does the author mention catalysts in the passage?

A. To illustrate a difficulty with developing artificial photosynthesis
B. To explain the role of hydrogen in the process
C. To highlight the cost of artificial photosynthesis
D. To discuss the environmental impact of the technology

2026-02-10 Binary Star Formation

原文（Passage）

Article - Twin Stars

Twin Stars

Stars form in the relatively dense, egg-shaped cores of molecular clouds made of dust and gases. Scientists mapping these dense cores must use radio waves to penetrate the dust and gases that prevent light from escaping molecular clouds; satellite images of these regions show nothing but large, black areas of space.

Recent observations of the Perseus molecular cloud may have surprising implications for previously accepted conclusions about the Sun. A radio wave sweep of the Perseus cloud's dense cores revealed that the youngest stars existing in the cloud all occurred in pairs, or binary twins, orbiting a common point. Stars of older binary systems, of which there were fewer, appeared closer together than stars of younger binary systems.

Scientists used current knowledge about stellar growth, decay, and destruction to predict the paths along which binary stars traveled throughout the molecular cloud. Their estimates would align with current understandings only if all stars approximately the same size as the Sun had begun as members of a binary system that first moved closer to each other and later separated. This rule would also apply to the Sun, whose twin likely separated following approximately one million years of coexistence.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following best summarizes the main point of the passage?

A. Binary stars alternate between separating and getting closer over time.
B. Star development takes place in the dense cores of molecular clouds.
C. The Sun formed in the same way that the Perseus molecular cloud did.
D. Stars the size of the Sun begin their development with a binary twin.

Q2. The word "penetrate" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. push aside
B. break apart
C. pass through
D. travel around

Q3. Which of the following was most likely one of the "previously accepted conclusions" about the Sun?

A. It did not have a binary twin.
B. It is larger than most other stars.
C. It did not form in a molecular cloud.
D. It developed faster than most other stars did.

Q4. What do the "estimates" discussed in the passage refer to?

A. The rate at which stars grow in the molecular cloud
B. The course that stars move along within the molecular cloud
C. The number of binary star systems found in the molecular cloud
D. The number of stars that have formed within the molecular cloud

Q5. What can be inferred from the passage about the Sun?

A. It is following a unique development pattern.
B. It moved closer to a binary twin early in its development.
C. It was too far from its twin to maintain the binary system.
D. Its twin decayed before separating from the binary system.

2026-02-10 Mathematical Approximation Theory

原文（Passage）

Approximation Theory

Approximation theory is a part of mathematics that helps us simplify complex problems. Instead of working with difficult functions directly, scientists use simpler ones that are "close enough" to get useful results. These simplified functions are often used to build algorithms--step-by-step procedures that solve problems efficiently. This is especially helpful in fields like computer science, where exact calculations can take too much time or power.

One common method is polynomial approximation, which uses basic math expressions (polynomials) to stand in for more complicated functions. A special type, called the Taylor series, breaks a function into an infinite sum based on its behavior at a single point. This helps us work with functions that are otherwise hard to handle.

Another key tool is the Fourier series, which decomposes repeating patterns--like sound waves--into a mix of sine and cosine waves. This is widely used in signal processing; engineers use Fourier series to filter out noise and enhance data quality.

While these methods are powerful, they are not perfect. Accuracy remains a challenge. The difference between the original and the simplified version--called the error--needs to be as small as possible. New techniques, like adaptive approximation, adjust the level of detail based on how accurate the result needs to be.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, simpler functions help scientists

A. achieve exact calculations
B. avoid relying on algorithms
C. tackle difficult functions more effectively over time
D. develop steps for solving problems relatively quickly

Q2. What is indicated about polynomial approximation in the passage?

A. It varies in behavior from one point to another.
B. It is less accurate than the Fourier series.
C. It cannot handle infinite sums of terms as well as the Taylor series can.
D. It uses simple math expressions to make complex functions easier to work with.

Q3. The word “decomposes” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. runs
B. breaks down
C. mixes
D. enters

Q4. What is one application of Fourier series mentioned in the passage?

A. Simplifying sine and cosine waves
B. Removing unwanted noise from signals
C. Compressing images
D. Modeling heat distribution

Q5. Why does the author mention “the error”?

A. To help illustrate the issue of accuracy as it relates to approximation theory

B. To add another explanation of how polynomial approximation works
C. To demonstrate an additional benefit of the Fourier series
D. To suggest that new approximation techniques have so far been inadequate

2026-02-10 Urban Green Spaces

原文（Passage）

Urban Green Spaces

Urban green spaces, such as parks and community gardens, enhance city life for residents. The contrast between green spaces and the surrounding concrete and glass structures can be a visual respite. Such spaces also provide residents with a place to relax and connect with nature, which can significantly improve mental health, reduce stress, and encourage physical activity. [A]

Urban green spaces also contribute to environmental sustainability. [B] They provide a cooler spot within the concrete heat traps surrounding them, absorb rainwater and reduce flooding, and increase biodiversity by providing habitats for various species. [C]

Recent initiatives have focused on creating more green spaces in underserved areas. [D] Some cities are converting abandoned lots into community gardens or small parks. These projects not only provide green spaces but also involve community members in the planning and maintenance of these, fostering a sense of ownership and responsibility.

While urban green spaces offer a host of benefits, they are not without drawbacks. When parks and gardens are added in city neighborhoods, they often increase the value of nearby properties. This can unintentionally lead to the displacement of longtime residents who can no longer afford rising rents or property taxes. Another challenge is preserving these spaces--it can be difficult to secure the funding necessary to maintain them.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “respite” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. break
B. addition
C. symbol
D. surprise

Q2. What is the relationship between paragraphs 1 and 2?

A. Paragraph 2 describes a new benefit beyond what is mentioned in paragraph 1.
B. Paragraph 2 contradicts the ideas presented in paragraph 1.
C. Paragraph 2 gives a solution to a problem discussed in paragraph 1.
D. Paragraph 2 provides a summary of the detailed information offered in paragraph 1.

Q3. How can cities improve neighborhood residents' sense of responsibility to local green spaces?

A. By asking residents to help find funding for them
B. By asking professional gardeners to plant vegetation
C. By inviting area residents to help maintain them
D. By arranging for residents to own the land used for them

Q4. Why does the author mention rising rents for neighborhood residents?

A. To illustrate how urban green spaces increase a neighborhood's desirability
B. To explain where the funding for building green spaces comes from
C. To show that green spaces are especially needed in underserved urban areas
D. To point out one of the disadvantages of urban green spaces

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Some even integrate playgrounds, sports fields, and exercise stations, making such activity accessible and fun for local residents. Locations in the passage:

A. After “which can significantly improve mental health, reduce stress, and encourage physical activity.”

B. After “Urban green spaces also contribute to environmental sustainability.”

C. After “and increase biodiversity by providing habitats for various species.”

D. Before “Some cities are converting abandoned lots into community gardens or small parks.”

2026-02-08（6 套）

2026-02-08 Climate and Reefs

原文（Passage）

The Impact of Climate Change on Coral Reefs

Coral reefs are among the most diverse and valuable ecosystems on Earth, providing habitat for countless marine species. However, climate change poses a severe threat to these vibrant underwater communities. Rising sea temperatures lead to coral bleaching, a phenomenon where corals lose their color and essential symbiotic algae, resulting in weakened corals that are more susceptible to disease.

In addition to temperature changes, climate change contributes to ocean acidification through increased atmospheric CO2 levels. Ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium carbonate, a crucial component of coral skeletons. [A] As the acidity of seawater increases, corals struggle to maintain their structures, leading to diminished reef growth and stability. [B]

Efforts to mitigate these impacts include developing coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification. [C] Scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as potential solutions. Furthermore, initiatives to reduce CO2 emissions globally aim to alleviate the stress on coral reefs. [D] The survival of coral reefs depends largely on addressing climate change comprehensively.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is coral bleaching?

A. An increase in coral growth

B. An effect of high temperatures that harms coral

C. A method of coral reproduction

D. A protective mechanism used by corals

Q2. What is the effect of ocean acidification on coral reefs?

A. It leads to temperature changes in the surrounding waters.

B. It can increase atmospheric CO2 levels, resulting in coral bleaching.

C. It reduces the availability of the calcium carbonate needed for coral structures.

D. It leads to more stability within existing reefs.

Q3. The word “mitigate” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. research

B. alleviate

C. measure

D. predict

Q4. What is suggested in the passage about selective breeding and genetic modification?

A. They are the only solutions to coral bleaching.

B. They are potential methods to develop resilient coral species.

C. They are proven to reverse ocean acidification.

D. They help reduce CO2 emissions.

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? The absence of calcium carbonate also reduces the ability of corals to support diverse marine life and protect coastal ecosystems. Locations in the passage:

A. After “Ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium carbonate, a crucial component of coral skeletons.”

B. After “As the acidity of seawater increases, corals struggle to maintain their structures, leading to diminished reef growth and stability.”

C. After “Efforts to mitigate these impacts include developing coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification.”

D. After “Furthermore, initiatives to reduce CO2 emissions globally aim to alleviate the stress on coral reefs.”

2026-02-08 Earth Climate Engineering

原文（Passage）

Engineering Earth's Climate

Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM) focuses on manipulating Earth's processes to address environmental challenges. This field combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making to devise solutions for climate change and other issues. One method of ESEM is geoengineering, which involves deliberate intervention in Earth's climate system to counteract global warming.

Geoengineering techniques fall into two categories: solar radiation management (SRM) and carbon dioxide removal (CDR). SRM aims to reflect sunlight into space to cool the planet. Techniques include injecting aerosols into the stratosphere and deploying reflective mirrors. CDR focuses on reducing greenhouse gas concentrations through methods like afforestation, ocean fertilization, and direct air capture of CO2.

Implementing geoengineering presents challenges. [A] Technological feasibility is a concern, as many techniques are experimental. [B] There are ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions and how impacts are monitored. [C] Additionally, unintended consequences may arise, causing more harm than good. [D] Despite these challenges, ESEM offers solutions to mitigate climate change. Integrating engineering with environmental management can lead to innovative approaches for sustainability. Collaborative efforts between scientists, engineers, and policymakers are crucial to developing safe strategies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is true of Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM)?

A. It finds solutions for problems by allowing natural processes to work themselves out.

B. It uses the resources of multiple disciplines to accomplish its goals.

C. It focuses exclusively on counteracting global warming.

D. It is also known as geoengineering.

Q2. What is the basic difference between the two categories of geoengineering techniques?

A. SRM merely manages solar radiation, while CDR removes it altogether.

B. SRM injects aerosols into the stratosphere, while CDR deploys reflective mirrors.

C. SRM lowers greenhouse gas concentrations, while CDR directly captures CO2.

D. SRM reduces the effects of global warming, while CDR reduces its causes.

Q3. The word “feasibility” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. cost

B. workability

C. specialty
D. risk

Q4. What is one ongoing question raised by geoengineering?

A. What types of collaboration are required in order to develop safe strategies
B. Whether existing experimental techniques can be sustained
C. Who bears responsibility for implementing changes
D. Whether it can be integrated with environmental management

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Careful consideration is needed to assess the long-term impacts. Locations in the passage:

A. After “Implementing geoengineering presents challenges.”
B. After “Technological feasibility is a concern, as many techniques are experimental.”
C. After “There are ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions and how impacts are monitored.”
D. After “Additionally, unintended consequences may arise, causing more harm than good.”

2026-02-08 Electromagnetic Bone Healing

原文（Passage）

Electromagnetic Healing

Advances in traumatology have highlighted the potential of electromagnetic fields (EMFs) in promoting bone healing. EMFs, invisible areas of energy produced by electrically charged objects, are recognized for their therapeutic benefits. Researchers have found that specific EMF frequencies can stimulate cellular activity, enhancing bone repair. Unlike traditional treatments such as metal implants and bone grafts, EMF therapy is non-invasive and produces few side effects. In clinical studies, patients with non-healing fractures exposed to EMFs showed significant improvement. One study showed that EMFs reduced recovery time by accelerating healing by up to 50 percent, a significant difference for patients with conditions that impede natural healing.

[A] Multiple mechanisms driven by EMFs have been identified as contributing to bone healing, yet the complete picture is not fully understood. [B] Some scientists believe that EMFs enhance the production of substances known as growth factors, which include essential proteins for cell growth and repair. [C] Others note that EMFs improve blood circulation to the damaged area, facilitating nutrient delivery and waste removal. Researchers are uncertain of how the mechanisms interact, the optimal parameters (frequency, intensity, duration) for therapies, and the relation between the amount of a treatment and the magnitude of the effect it produces. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “promoting” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. delaying
B. supporting
C. preventing
D. observing

Q2. What does the passage suggest about traditional treatments for bone injury?

A. They produce significant side effects.
B. They are generally non-invasive.
C. They require metal implants more often than they require bone grafts.
D. They stimulate cellular activity more effectively than does EMF therapy.

Q3. Why does the author discuss “One study”?

A. To point out that EMF therapy has been used in 50 percent of cases in which bone healing was needed
B. To demonstrate that EMF therapy is relatively effective
C. To show how the effects of EMF therapy change over time
D. To suggest that patients with unusual conditions might prefer traditional treatments

Q4. The passage mentions which of the following as being unknown about the EMF-driven mechanisms that contribute to bone healing?

A. Whether growth factors include proteins for cell repair
B. How improved blood circulation facilitates nutrient delivery
C. How the mechanisms interact to achieve their effect
D. What impedes the mechanisms from working

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? They also disagree about why responses vary among individual patients and what the long-term effects of EMF therapies may be. Locations in the passage:

A. Before “Multiple mechanisms driven by EMFs have been identified as contributing to bone healing, yet the complete picture is not fully understood.”
B. After “Multiple mechanisms driven by EMFs have been identified as contributing to bone healing, yet the complete picture is not fully understood.”
C. After “Some scientists believe that EMFs enhance the production of substances known as growth factors, which include essential proteins for cell growth and repair.”
D. After “Researchers are uncertain of how the mechanisms interact, the optimal parameters (frequency, intensity, duration) for therapies, and the relation between the amount of a treatment and the magnitude of the effect it produces.”

2026-02-08 Green Chemistry Innovations

原文（Passage）

Green Chemistry Innovations

Green chemistry, an area of study within organic chemistry, aims to design products and processes that reduce or eliminate hazardous substances. This field promotes sustainable practices and renewable resources in chemical production. One breakthrough is biodegradable plastics. Traditional plastics are derived from petroleum, a non-renewable resource, and can take centuries to decompose. Biodegradable plastics, made from renewable materials like corn starch, can break down in months under composting conditions, reducing pollution and landfill burden. Another advancement is the use of catalysis to increase reaction efficiency.

Catalysts speed up chemical reactions without being consumed and can often replace hazardous chemicals. Researchers have developed metal-organic frameworks (MOFs) that serve as efficient catalysts in various organic reactions. For example, they can be applied in the process of degrading pollutants into harmless compounds, which can aid in water and air purification. In addition to catalysts, green chemistry also studies solvents. A solvent is a liquid that dissolves other substances and provides a medium for these substances to react. For example, using water as a solvent instead of organic solvents, which are often toxic, creates safer and more sustainable processes. Additionally, reactions in water can sometimes proceed faster than in organic solvents.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The phrase "This field" in the passage refers to

A. green chemistry
B. organic chemistry

C. resource management
D. conservation biology

Q2. The word "breakthrough" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. source
B. damage
C. advancement
D. revision

Q3. What is one difference between traditional plastics made from petroleum and plastics made from corn starch?

A. The types of products they can be used for
B. The conditions needed for their production
C. The length of time it can take for them to break down
D. The amount of catalysts used in their production

Q4. What use of MOFs is mentioned in the passage?

A. Identifying hazardous chemicals
B. Combining with other catalysts
C. Stopping harmful chemical reactions
D. Making water and air cleaner

Q5. The passage indicates that using water as a solvent is beneficial for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

A. It can produce catalysts more safely.
B. It can reduce the need for toxic solvents.
C. It can result in more sustainable processes.
D. It can increase the speed of reactions.

2026-02-08 Mathematical Approximation Theory

原文（Passage）

Approximation Theory

Approximation theory is a part of mathematics that helps us simplify complex problems. Instead of working with difficult functions directly, scientists use simpler ones that are "close enough" to get useful results. These simplified functions are often used to build algorithms--step-by-step procedures that solve problems efficiently. This is especially helpful in fields like computer science, where exact calculations can take too much time or power.

One common method is polynomial approximation, which uses basic math expressions (polynomials) to stand in for more complicated functions. A special type, called the Taylor series, breaks a function into an infinite sum based on its behavior at a single point. This helps us work with functions that are otherwise hard to handle.

Another key tool is the Fourier series, which decomposes repeating patterns--like sound waves--into a mix of sine and cosine waves. This is widely used in signal processing; engineers use Fourier series to filter out noise and enhance data quality.

While these methods are powerful, they are not perfect. Accuracy remains a challenge. The difference between the original and the simplified version--called the error--needs to be as small as possible. New techniques, like adaptive approximation, adjust the level of detail based on how accurate the result needs to be.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, simpler functions help scientists

A. achieve exact calculations

B. avoid relying on algorithms
C. tackle difficult functions more effectively over time
D. develop steps for solving problems relatively quickly

Q2. What is indicated about polynomial approximation in the passage?
A. It varies in behavior from one point to another.
B. It is less accurate than the Fourier series.
C. It cannot handle infinite sums of terms as well as the Taylor series can.
D. It uses simple math expressions to make complex functions easier to work with.

Q3. The word “decomposes” in the passage is closest in meaning to
A. runs
B. breaks down
C. mixes
D. enters

Q4. What is one application of Fourier series mentioned in the passage?
A. Simplifying sine and cosine waves
B. Removing unwanted noise from signals
C. Compressing images
D. Modeling heat distribution

Q5. Why does the author mention “the error”?
A. To help illustrate the issue of accuracy as it relates to approximation theory
B. To add another explanation of how polynomial approximation works
C. To demonstrate an additional benefit of the Fourier series
D. To suggest that new approximation techniques have so far been inadequate

2026-02-08 Smart Textile Technology

原文（Passage）

Smart Textiles

Smart textiles are revolutionizing the fashion industry by integrating advanced digital technology into fabrics. These textiles can respond to environmental changes, monitor physical activity, and even generate energy. One example is phase-change materials that adapt to temperature fluctuations, providing warmth when it is cold and cooling when it is hot. Another innovation is textiles embedded with sensors that track health metrics such as heart rate and body temperature. These developments offer promising applications for athletes and medical patients.

Researchers are also exploring textiles that harvest energy from movement. These fabrics utilize piezoelectric materials that generate electricity when subjected to mechanical stress. [A] Envision clothing that can charge your smartphone simply through your daily activities. [B] Moreover, smart textiles can be designed to change color or pattern based on electrical stimuli, opening up new possibilities for both fashion and interior design. [C]

Yet, integrating technology into textiles presents challenges. [D] Durability, washability, and cost are significant concerns. Since their initial cost will be higher than traditional fabrics, ensuring that smart textiles can withstand regular use without degrading is essential for their widespread adoption. Protecting privacy is another concern of many: smart textiles could collect vast amounts of user data that must be properly secured.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What are phase-change materials designed to do?
A. Generate electricity from movement
B. Adapt to changes in temperature

C. Monitor heart rate and body temperature
D. Change color based on electrical stimuli

Q2. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a challenge for smart textiles?

A. Washability
B. Cost
C. Durability
D. Availability

Q3. The word "harvest" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. grow
B. collect
C. spin
D. discover

Q4. What is the main purpose of paragraph 3?

A. To present obstacles to the ideas previously introduced
B. To expand on the benefits mentioned in paragraph 2
C. To provide information on the future applications of smart textiles
D. To summarize the main points of the reading

Q5. There are four locations in the passage where the following sentence could be added: "Imagine being able to change the appearance of your furnishings depending on your mood or the season." Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Location 1
B. Location 2
C. Location 3
D. Location 4

2026-02-04（2 套）

2026-02-04 Earth Climate Engineering

原文（Passage）

Engineering Earth's Climate

Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM) focuses on manipulating Earth's processes to address environmental challenges. This field combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making to devise solutions for climate change and other issues. One method of ESEM is geoengineering, which involves deliberate intervention in Earth's climate system to counteract global warming.

Geoengineering techniques fall into two categories: solar radiation management (SRM) and carbon dioxide removal (CDR). SRM aims to reflect sunlight into space to cool the planet. Techniques include injecting aerosols into the stratosphere and deploying reflective mirrors. CDR focuses on reducing greenhouse gas concentrations through methods like afforestation, ocean fertilization, and direct air capture of CO2.

Implementing geoengineering presents challenges. [A] Technological feasibility is a concern, as many techniques are experimental. [B] There are ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions and how impacts are monitored. [C] Additionally, unintended consequences may arise, causing more harm than good. [D] Despite these challenges, ESEM offers solutions to mitigate climate change. Integrating engineering with environmental management can lead to innovative approaches for sustainability. Collaborative efforts between scientists, engineers, and policymakers are crucial to developing safe strategies.

题目（Questions）

Q1. Which of the following is true of Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM)?

A. It finds solutions for problems by allowing natural processes to work themselves out.

B. It uses the resources of multiple disciplines to accomplish its goals.

C. It focuses exclusively on counteracting global warming.

D. It is also known as geoengineering.

Q2. What is the basic difference between the two categories of geoengineering techniques?

A. SRM merely manages solar radiation, while CDR removes it altogether.

B. SRM injects aerosols into the stratosphere, while CDR deploys reflective mirrors.

C. SRM lowers greenhouse gas concentrations, while CDR directly captures CO2.

D. SRM reduces the effects of global warming, while CDR reduces its causes.

Q3. The word “feasibility” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. cost

B. workability

C. specialty

D. risk

Q4. What is one ongoing question raised by geoengineering?

A. What types of collaboration are required in order to develop safe strategies

B. Whether existing experimental techniques can be sustained

C. Who bears responsibility for implementing changes

D. Whether it can be integrated with environmental management

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Careful consideration is needed to assess the long-term impacts. Locations in the passage:

A. After “Implementing geoengineering presents challenges.”

B. After “Technological feasibility is a concern, as many techniques are experimental.”

C. After “There are ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions and how impacts are monitored.”

D. After “Additionally, unintended consequences may arise, causing more harm than good.”

2026-02-04 Mathematical Approximation Theory

原文（Passage）

Approximation Theory

Approximation theory is a part of mathematics that helps us simplify complex problems. Instead of working with difficult functions directly, scientists use simpler ones that are "close enough" to get useful results. These simplified functions are often used to build algorithms--step-by-step procedures that solve problems efficiently. This is especially helpful in fields like computer science, where exact calculations can take too much time or power.

One common method is polynomial approximation, which uses basic math expressions (polynomials) to stand in for more complicated functions. A special type, called the Taylor series, breaks a function into an infinite sum based on its behavior at a single point. This helps us work with functions that are otherwise hard to handle.

Another key tool is the Fourier series, which decomposes repeating patterns--like sound waves--into a mix of sine and cosine waves. This is widely used in signal processing; engineers use Fourier series to filter out noise and enhance data quality.

While these methods are powerful, they are not perfect. Accuracy remains a challenge. The difference between the original and the simplified version--called the error--needs to be as small as possible. New techniques, like adaptive approximation, adjust the level of detail based on how accurate the result needs to be.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, simpler functions help scientists

A. achieve exact calculations
B. avoid relying on algorithms
C. tackle difficult functions more effectively over time
D. develop steps for solving problems relatively quickly

Q2. What is indicated about polynomial approximation in the passage?

A. It varies in behavior from one point to another.
B. It is less accurate than the Fourier series.
C. It cannot handle infinite sums of terms as well as the Taylor series can.
D. It uses simple math expressions to make complex functions easier to work with.

Q3. The word “decomposes” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. runs
B. breaks down
C. mixes
D. enters

Q4. What is one application of Fourier series mentioned in the passage?

A. Simplifying sine and cosine waves
B. Removing unwanted noise from signals
C. Compressing images
D. Modeling heat distribution

Q5. Why does the author mention “the error”?

A. To help illustrate the issue of accuracy as it relates to approximation theory
B. To add another explanation of how polynomial approximation works
C. To demonstrate an additional benefit of the Fourier series
D. To suggest that new approximation techniques have so far been inadequate

2026-02-03（3 套）

2026-02-03 Climate and Reefs

原文（Passage）

The Impact of Climate Change on Coral Reefs

Coral reefs are among the most diverse and valuable ecosystems on Earth, providing habitat for countless marine species. However, climate change poses a severe threat to these vibrant underwater communities. Rising sea temperatures lead to coral bleaching, a phenomenon where corals lose their color and essential symbiotic algae, resulting in weakened corals that are more susceptible to disease.

In addition to temperature changes, climate change contributes to ocean acidification through increased atmospheric CO2 levels. Ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium carbonate, a crucial component of coral skeletons. [A] As the acidity of seawater increases, corals struggle to maintain their structures, leading to diminished reef growth and stability. [B]

Efforts to mitigate these impacts include developing coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification. [C] Scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as potential solutions. Furthermore, initiatives to reduce CO2 emissions globally aim to alleviate the stress on coral reefs. [D] The survival of coral reefs depends largely on addressing climate change comprehensively.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is coral bleaching?

A. An increase in coral growth

B. An effect of high temperatures that harms coral

C. A method of coral reproduction

D. A protective mechanism used by corals

Q2. What is the effect of ocean acidification on coral reefs?

A. It leads to temperature changes in the surrounding waters.

B. It can increase atmospheric CO2 levels, resulting in coral bleaching.

C. It reduces the availability of the calcium carbonate needed for coral structures.

D. It leads to more stability within existing reefs.

Q3. The word “mitigate” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. research

B. alleviate

C. measure

D. predict

Q4. What is suggested in the passage about selective breeding and genetic modification?

A. They are the only solutions to coral bleaching.

B. They are potential methods to develop resilient coral species.

C. They are proven to reverse ocean acidification.

D. They help reduce CO2 emissions.

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? The absence of calcium carbonate also reduces the ability of corals to support diverse marine life and protect coastal ecosystems. Locations in the passage:

A. After “Ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium carbonate, a crucial component of coral skeletons.”

B. After “As the acidity of seawater increases, corals struggle to maintain their structures, leading to diminished reef growth and stability.”

C. After “Efforts to mitigate these impacts include developing coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification.”

D. After “Furthermore, initiatives to reduce CO2 emissions globally aim to alleviate the stress on coral reefs.”

2026-02-03 Dinosaur Feather Evolution

原文（Passage）

Dinosaur Feathers

Paleontologists once thought dinosaurs were completely covered in scales. Recent discoveries have overturned this idea. Fossils found in China reveal some dinosaurs had feathers. These fossils, dating back approximately 126 million years, show traces of feathers around skeletons. The feathers were not for flight but likely for insulation or display.

One significant find was the feathered dinosaur Sinosauropteryx. This small, meat-eating dinosaur had simple, hairlike feathers on its body. This discovery showed that feathers were more common among dinosaurs than previously thought. Another discovery involved the larger, more complex feathers of Caudipteryx. These feathers were similar to those of modern birds, suggesting that feathers evolved in stages, becoming more sophisticated over time.

[A] Researchers are now studying how feathered dinosaurs might have used their plumage. [B] Some theories suggest that feathers helped regulate body temperature, while other theories

propose that feathers were used for mating displays or camouflage. [C] Understanding feather function in dinosaurs provides insights into their behavior and evolution. [D]
The idea that birds are direct descendants of dinosaurs has gained support from the findings about feathers. Fossil evidence reveals that many theropod dinosaurs, such as Velociraptor, had feathers similar to those of modern birds. These similarities in feather structures, including quill knobs and complex branching patterns, strengthen the theory that birds evolved from theropod dinosaurs.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “traces” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. development
B. signs
C. copies
D. shadows

Q2. The discovery of Sinosauropteryx suggested which of the following?

A. Not all dinosaurs were relatively small meat-eaters.
B. Many dinosaurs likely had feathers on their bodies.
C. Dinosaur fossils are more likely to be found in China than in other parts of the world.
D. Feathered dinosaurs were generally smaller than those without feathers.

Q3. Why does the author provide information about Caudipteryx?

A. To show another example of a dinosaur with hairlike feathers
B. To suggest that Sinosauropteryx likely evolved from Caudipteryx
C. To make the point that dinosaur feathers likely became more complex over time
D. To show that there is less variety among types of dinosaur feathers than has been commonly assumed

Q4. What is the relationship between paragraphs 2 and 3?

A. Paragraph 3 provides an example to support the general point about feathers introduced in paragraph 2.
B. Paragraph 3 challenges an idea about feathers proposed in paragraph 2.
C. Paragraph 3 focuses on the roles played by the feathers described in paragraph 2.
D. Paragraph 3 summarizes the ideas about feathers presented in paragraph 2.

Q5. Where would the sentence best fit? Dinosaurs may have also used their feathers to protect their eggs. Locations in the passage:

A. Before “Researchers are now studying how feathered dinosaurs might have used their plumage.”
B. After “Researchers are now studying how feathered dinosaurs might have used their plumage.”
C. After “Some theories suggest that feathers helped regulate body temperature, while other theories propose that feathers were used for mating displays or camouflage.”
D. After “Understanding feather function in dinosaurs provides insights into their behavior and evolution.”

2026-02-03 Microseisms Earth Vibrations

原文（Passage）

Microseisms: The Earth's Subtle Vibrations
The Earth is constantly vibrating, even when there are no earthquakes. These subtle vibrations, known as microseisms, are typically caused by ocean waves. When waves collide, they create pressure variations that travel through the water and into the sea floor. This energy transfer

generates seismic waves detectable by seismometers worldwide. Interestingly, microseisms are strongest during storms when ocean waves are more powerful.
Researchers have found these vibrations can provide important information about the Earth's interior. Microseisms travel through the Earth's crust and mantle, revealing details about the geological structures they pass through, including variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures. Another compelling use of microseisms is in climate studies. Scientists analyze historical data on these vibrations to reconstruct past ocean conditions and storm activities. This helps improve climate models and understand long-term weather patterns. Additionally, microseisms are used in oil and gas exploration. They identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures without more invasive techniques.
Studying microseisms is challenging. The mild signals are easily masked by other seismic noises. Advanced data analysis techniques and state-of-the-art equipment are essential for accurately interpreting microseisms. Researchers often employ filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word “subtle” in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. faint
B. quick
C. strong
D. constant

Q2. It can be inferred that microseisms are strongest during ocean storms because

A. the Earth's crust and mantle are more active during such storms
B. ocean waves are larger and collide more vigorously during such storms
C. seismometers are designed to work most effectively during such storms
D. the details of geological structures become more apparent during such storms

Q3. Why does the author mention “variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures”?

A. To suggest that more research is needed to understand the relationship between microseisms and earthquakes
B. To identify the most important features of Earth's crust and mantle
C. To help explain how microseisms can alter the geological structures that they pass through
D. To highlight the kinds of information microseisms can provide about Earth's interior

Q4. According to the passage, how can microseisms help in oil and gas exploration?

A. By providing historical data on ocean conditions
B. By pinpointing potential drilling sites
C. By measuring the strength of seismic waves
D. By reducing the need for seismometers

Q5. What does the author suggest about “filtering methods and cross-referencing data from multiple seismometers”?

A. They are techniques used to study microseisms.
B. They demonstrate the outdatedness of seismometers.
C. They are popular ways of studying various types of seismic noises.
D. They highlight a flaw in current research methods.

2026-02-02（2 套）

2026-02-02 Mysteries of Opal

原文（Passage）

The Mysteries of Opal

Opal is a unique gemstone, known for its vibrant colors that shift as the stone moves. Unlike most gemstones, which form rigid, repeating crystalline structures, opals are amorphous, meaning they lack a fixed internal shape. This is due to the formation process, where silica-rich water seeps into cracks in rocks deep underground, leaving silica deposits when it evaporates. Tiny silica spheres create the internal structure of opals, and these spheres diffract light, separating it into colors, much like a prism does.

The color and brilliance of opals depends on the size and spacing of the silica spheres. Larger spheres produce reds and oranges, while smaller spheres result in blues and greens. Because of Australia's unique geological conditions, it is home to over 90 percent of the world's opals. Opals are also fragile. Their high water content and noncrystalline structure make them prone to cracking when exposed to sudden temperature changes. Modern jewelers use techniques such as laser cutting and humidity-controlled storage to better protect opals.

Ancient cultures believed opals had mystical properties and brought good luck. The Romans saw them as a symbol of hope and purity, while the Greeks thought they gave the gift of prophecy.

题目（Questions）

Q1. All of the following are mentioned as part of the formation process of opals EXCEPT:

A. Water flows into cracks in rocks.
B. The water dries up, leaving silica deposits behind.
C. The structure formed is rigid and non-varying.
D. Tiny silica spheres form the internal structure.

Q2. Why does the author compare the opal to a prism?

A. To illustrate how an opal affects light
B. To explain how the internal structure of opals is created
C. To give an example of how scientists study opals
D. To argue that opals do not truly diffract light

Q3. What is one consequence of the internal structure of opals?

A. 90 percent of them are red or orange.
B. Relatively little ancient opal jewelry has survived.
C. Jewelers must use special care to prevent opals from cracking.
D. They are always less valuable than crystalline gemstones.

Q4. What does the passage suggest about ancient cultures' view of opals?

A. They understood how opals were formed.
B. They found opals difficult to work with.
C. They associated opals with special powers or good fortune.
D. They considered opals to be very durable.

Q5. The word "prophecy" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. long life
B. the ability to predict the future
C. happiness
D. high status

2026-02-02 Shifting Playwriting Art

原文（Passage）

The Shifting Art of Playwriting

Innovative playwriting techniques have transformed the theatrical landscape by challenging linear storytelling and passive spectatorship. Nonlinear narratives, seen in plays like Harold

Pinter's Betrayal, disrupt chronological order to reflect the fragmented nature of memory and emotion. This structure invites audiences to actively reconstruct the story, deepening their engagement.

Another innovation is the so-called breaking of the fourth wall, where characters directly address the audience. Used by Bertolt Brecht in Mother Courage and Her Children, this technique encourages viewers to reflect critically rather than become absorbed in illusion. Fully interactive theater, exemplified by the British production Sleep No More, goes further by allowing viewers to physically move through the performance space, personalizing the experience and making each viewing unique.

These techniques suggest a broader hypothesis: that theatrical form is not merely a container for content but a vital part of creating meaning. By reshaping narrative structure and audience dynamics, playwrights can evoke new emotional and intellectual responses, revealing complex aspects of the human condition.

Of course, such innovations may confuse rather than enlighten more traditional-minded theater audiences and also disrupt their emotional immersion, and fragment the narrative. Thus, while these techniques can serve as powerful tools, their success depends on thoughtful execution and a clear artistic purpose.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is the passage mainly about?

A. The influence of traditional theater on modern audience

B. The role of audience participation in theatrical performances

C. New approaches to theatrical storytelling and audience involvement

D. The challenges of interpreting nonlinear narratives in drama

Q2. According to the passage, what is a key difference between Mother Courage and Her Children and Sleep No More?

A. Mother Courage and Her Children uses audience interaction to create emotional immersion, while Sleep No More avoids direct engagement.

B. Mother Courage and Her Children involves some interaction with the audience, while Sleep No More involves actual audience participation.

C. Mother Courage and Her Children presents a fragmented narrative, while Sleep No More follows a linear storyline.

D. Mother Courage and Her Children is based on historical events while Sleep No More is entirely fictional.

Q3. What is the function of paragraph 3?

A. It offers a conjecture about what new playwriting techniques mean for theater.

B. It summarizes the historical development of experimental theater techniques.

C. It critiques the effectiveness of audience-centered performance styles.

D. It introduces a counterargument to the use of nonlinear narratives in drama.

Q4. The word "evoke" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. measure

B. produce

C. compare

D. anticipate

Q5. The passage introduces all of the following innovative approaches to playwriting EXCEPT

A. presenting events out of order

B. characters speaking directly to the audience

C. viewers walking onto the stage

D. playwrights joining the cast

2026-02-01（2 套）

2026-02-01 AI Disease Diagnosis

原文（Passage）

The Role of AI in Diagnosing Diseases

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is transforming health informatics, particularly in diagnosing diseases. AI algorithms can analyze medical images, detecting abnormalities in X-rays, MRIs, and CT scans with accuracy comparable to trained radiologists. By processing vast amounts of data quickly, AI helps radiologists identify conditions that might be missed during routine examinations.

[A] AI predicts disease outbreaks by analyzing data from social media, search engines, and health records. [B] AI systems track the spread of infectious diseases by identifying patterns and trends human analysts might overlook. [C] This predictive capability allows for faster responses and better allocation of medical resources. [D]

Moreover, AI personalizes treatment plans. By considering an individual's genetic makeup, lifestyle, and medical history, AI can recommend tailored treatments that improve patient outcomes. This approach is beneficial in managing chronic diseases like diabetes and hypertension.

Despite these advancements, integrating AI into healthcare presents challenges. Concerns about data privacy, the need for large datasets to train algorithms, and the potential for algorithmic bias need to be addressed. Algorithmic bias happens when AI systems learn from data that doesn't fully represent all groups of people, which can lead to unfair or inaccurate results for some patients. Ensuring the ethical use of AI, particularly in maintaining patient confidentiality and mitigating bias, is crucial.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What is one advantage of using AI in medical diagnostics?

A. AI eliminates the need for radiologists.

B. AI reduces the number of medical images needed for diagnosis.

C. AI is capable of analyzing large datasets efficiently.

D. AI can predict patient outcomes based solely on diagnoses.

Q2. Why does the author mention social media and search engines?

A. To suggest that they are more effective sources of information for AI than health records are

B. To help explain how AI gathers the data it needs to predict disease outbreaks

C. To show how human analysts identify the patterns that AI systems need to function effectively

D. To highlight the growing popularity of AI technologies among users of social media

Q3. The word "tailored" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. personalized

B. advanced

C. reliable

D. precise

Q4. What does the passage suggest is a potential problem with the datasets used to train algorithms?

A. The datasets are extremely expensive to build.

B. The datasets may not represent all people equally.

C. The datasets are often procured through unethical means.

D. The datasets must be manipulated to protect privacy.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. AI's capabilities extend beyond image analysis. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before the sentence "AI predicts disease outbreaks by analyzing data from social media, search engines, and health records."

B. Before the sentence "AI systems track the spread of infectious diseases by identifying patterns and trends human analysts might overlook."

C. Before the sentence "This predictive capability allows for faster responses and better allocation of medical resources."

D. After the sentence "This predictive capability allows for faster responses and better allocation of medical resources."

2026-02-01 Behavioral Economics Concepts

原文（Passage）

Behavioral Economics

Behavioral economics merges psychology and economics to understand financial decisions. Traditional theories assume individuals act rationally based on logical analysis. However, behavioral economists find human behavior often deviates from these expectations. Cognitive biases, emotions, and social factors can lead to irrational choices.

[A] One key concept is "loss aversion," where people prefer avoiding losses rather than acquiring gains. [B] For example, individuals might avoid selling a declining stock in the hope of recovering their losses, even when the stock is unlikely to rebound. [C] Rational theory would suggest selling the stock to minimize further losses. [D]

Another concept is "anchoring," where individuals rely too heavily on the first piece of information they receive (the "anchor") when making decisions. For example, if an investor learns a stock was priced at $100 last month but has dropped to $80, they might perceive the lower price as a bargain, regardless of the stock's actual value. The company's earnings may have dropped significantly, making $80 a fair or even high price. Anchoring can thus lead to suboptimal investment choices.

Behavioral economics has implications for financial markets and investment strategies. By understanding psychological factors, economists can design better tools to help people make informed choices.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage suggests that one key assumption underlying behavioral economics is that

A. social factors enhance responsible decision-making in financial matters

B. traditional theories of financial decision-making rely too heavily on cognitive biases

C. humans sometimes act irrationally in making financial decisions

D. decisions involving financial matters are usually based on logical analysis

Q2. The word "deviates" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. benefits

B. differs

C. stems

D. distracts

Q3. Which of the following is mentioned in the passage as an example of loss aversion?

A. Buying a stock because it is priced lower than it was the previous month

B. Selling a declining stock to avoid further losses

C. Keeping a declining stock in the misguided hope that it will go up in value

D. Investing in a stock based solely on trends in financial markets

Q4. According to the passage, which of the following could be considered anchoring?

A. An investor prefers to invest in companies whose earnings are dropping.

B. An investor consults multiple sources about a stock's price before investing in it.

C. An investor mistrusts the initial information they receive about a stock.

D. An investor makes an investment decision based on the first piece of information they receive.

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. This behavior is based primarily on emotion. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before the sentence "One key concept is \"loss aversion,\" where people prefer avoiding losses rather than acquiring gains."

B. Before the sentence "For example, individuals might avoid selling a declining stock in the hope of recovering their losses, even when the stock is unlikely to rebound."

C. Before the sentence "Rational theory would suggest selling the stock to minimize further losses."

D. After the sentence "Rational theory would suggest selling the stock to minimize further losses."

2026-01-28（1 套）

2026-01-28 Flynn Effect

原文（Passage）

The Flynn Effect

Researchers have observed a phenomenon known as the Flynn Effect: a consistent increase in Intelligence Quotient (IQ) scores from one generation to the next. This trend, named after intelligence researcher James Flynn, shows that average IQ scores have risen by about three points per decade in many parts of the world.

Various theories have been proposed to explain this trend. One hypothesis is that improvements in nutrition and healthcare have enhanced brain development, leading to higher IQ scores. Another theory suggests that the complexity of modern life, with its increased cognitive demands, has driven this rise. The widespread use of technology and a more stimulating environment could also be contributing factors.

[A] However, the Flynn Effect does not necessarily indicate that people are becoming more intelligent. [B] Some researchers argue that the rise in IQ scores reflects better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests, rather than a genuine increase in cognitive abilities. [C] Recent studies have shown that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or even reversing in some countries, challenging the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "consistent" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. rapid

B. steady

C. large

D. impressive

Q2. All of the following are mentioned in the passage as possible contributors to the trend of IQ scores EXCEPT

A. better eating habits and medical care

B. improvements in parental care

C. the cognitive demands of contemporary life

D. the extensive use of technology

Q3. According to some researchers, the Flynn Effect may be a sign that

A. people are becoming better at taking tests

B. IQ tests have become easier over time

C. test-takers thrive in stimulating environments

D. school systems have developed better examinations

Q4. Why does the author mention that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or reversing in some countries?

A. To suggest that there may not be a global increase in intelligence

B. To argue that cognitive abilities are declining around the world

C. To show that the Flynn Effect requires further research

D. To argue that the challenges of modern life can have negative effects on intelligence

Q5. There are four locations in the passage that indicate where the following sentence could be added. Changes in educational practices or shifts in societal values could account for the downturn. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before the sentence "However, the Flynn Effect does not necessarily indicate that people are becoming more intelligent."

B. Before the sentence "Some researchers argue that the rise in IQ scores reflects better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests, rather than a genuine increase in cognitive abilities."

C. Before the sentence "Recent studies have shown that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or even reversing in some countries, challenging the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence."

D. After the sentence "Recent studies have shown that the Flynn Effect may be slowing down or even reversing in some countries, challenging the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence."

2026-01-27（2 套）

2026-01-27 Bird Migration Patterns

原文（Passage）

Bird Migration

Every year, millions of birds travel huge distances to wintering grounds, and then back to breeding grounds when warmer weather returns there. Bird migration evolved in response to climatic changes. During the Ice Age, when average temperatures were frigid, migrating birds had a survival advantage, and the behavior became widespread.

Migration is also linked to resource availability. Arctic terns, which undertake the longest migrations of any animal by flying from their summer breeding grounds in Earth's north polar (Arctic) regions to their wintering grounds in Earth's south polar regions, feed primarily on small fish and other small marine animals. This prey is most abundant when increased sunlight results in the increased availability of algae, the microscopic marine plantlike organisms that are food for the tiny marine animals known as zooplankton, which are in turn consumed by terns' prey.

Not all birds migrate. Rock ptarmigans also live in Arctic and sub-Arctic regions. Instead of flying to warmer climes in winter, they shelter in snow burrows and reduce activity to conserve energy. They feed on plants like birch and willow trees, which are available in their habitat year-round. The divergence between migratory and sedentary species represents different adaptations to environmental pressures.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The passage implies that bird migration began when

A. wintering grounds were closer to breeding grounds than they are now
B. areas suitable for breeding were smaller than they are now
C. there were many more birds than there are now
D. climates were generally much colder than they are now

Q2. What is the passage explaining when it mentions that "increased sunlight results in the increased availability of algae"?

A. Why terns' migrations result in increased food availability for them
B. Why some tiny marine organisms migrate for long distances
C. Why terns depend on sunlight while traveling long distances
D. Why terns benefit from the migration of zooplankton

Q3. The passage supports all of the following statements about Arctic terns EXCEPT:

A. They take different migration routes depending on resource availability.
B. They migrate over longer distances than all other birds do.
C. They spend much of their lives in regions around Earth's poles.
D. They eat mostly small animals living in sea water.

Q4. Why does the passage provide information about rock ptarmigans?

A. To emphasize the usefulness of snow burrows in their habitat
B. To contrast their behavior to that of Arctic terns
C. To show that birch and willow trees provide food to both migratory and sedentary birds
D. To provide another example of migratory birds

Q5. The word "shelter" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. move
B. land
C. seek food
D. take protection

2026-01-27 Harmonic Analysis Structures

原文（Passage）

Harmonic Analysis: Unveiling the Hidden Structures

Harmonic analysis studies how functions or signals can be represented as combinations of basic waves, typically sine and cosine functions. This field has applications in signal processing, quantum mechanics, and data compression. One intriguing aspect is its ability to reveal hidden structures within complex signals, such as identifying the fundamental frequencies in a musical piece or detecting anomalies in financial data.

The Fourier transform is a key tool in harmonic analysis, breaking down functions into their constituent frequencies. For example, in signal processing, it isolates different frequency components, making it easier to filter out noise and enhance signal clarity. This decomposition is also crucial in quantum mechanics, where wave functions are expressed as combinations of base states, allowing for the analysis and prediction of quantum systems.

Wavelet transforms offer precise localization of signals in both time and frequency domains, making them highly effective for analyzing transient or non-stationary signals. [A] Their ability to adapt to various signal characteristics makes them versatile tools in numerous applications. [B] These methods are particularly useful in data compression. [C] In image processing, wavelet transforms facilitate efficient encoding of information, allowing for enhanced image reconstruction and feature extraction. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "anomalies" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. falsehoods

B. gaps

C. inconsistencies

D. patterns

Q2. All of the following are mentioned about harmonic analysis EXCEPT:

A. It involves the way functions and signals are represented.

B. It has practical uses in several areas.

C. It can reveal unseen structures in complex signals.

D. It is more effective in music than in finance.

Q3. In which of the following ways does the Fourier transform benefit signal processing?

A. By making signals travel far

B. By making signals clearer

C. By protecting signals from noise

D. By increasing the frequency of signals

Q4. Why does the author discuss "quantum mechanics" in paragraph 2?

A. To explain why the Fourier transform is a key tool of harmonic analysis

B. To illustrate an application of breaking down functions into their constituent frequencies

C. To highlight an important difference between signal processing and quantum mechanics

D. To demonstrate the challenge of analyzing and predicting quantum systems

Q5. Look at the four locations that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. They enable the reduction of file sizes without significant loss of quality. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before sentence "Their ability to adapt to various signal characteristics makes them versatile tools in numerous applications."

B. Before sentence "These methods are particularly useful in data compression."

C. Before sentence "In image processing, wavelet transforms facilitate efficient encoding of information, allowing for enhanced image reconstruction and feature extraction."

D. After sentence "In image processing, wavelet transforms facilitate efficient encoding of information, allowing for enhanced image reconstruction and feature extraction."

2026-01-21（4 套）

2026-01-21 Augmented Reality Training

原文（Passage）

Augmented Reality for Training

Augmented reality (AR) has emerged as a groundbreaking tool in the field of human performance technology, particularly in training environments. AR overlays digital information on the real world, providing immersive experiences that enhance learning and skill acquisition. For example, AR can simulate complex machinery operations, allowing trainees to interact with virtual components as if they were physically present. This hands-on approach helps learners understand intricate processes without the risks associated with real-world practice.

The adaptability of AR makes it suitable for various industries. In medicine, AR can project 3D models of human anatomy, guiding surgeons through complex procedures. In aviation, pilots use AR to practice emergency protocols, offering a safe yet realistic training environment. Studies have shown that these AR applications significantly improve retention rates and performance outcomes. Moreover, AR's ability to customize training scenarios based on individual needs further enhances its effectiveness.

However, integrating AR into training programs presents challenges. The technology requires substantial investment in hardware and software development. Additionally, creating accurate and responsive AR content demands expertise that many organizations may lack. Despite these hurdles, the benefits of AR in boosting human performance are undeniable. As the technology continues to evolve, it promises even more sophisticated and effective training solutions.

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "groundbreaking" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. educational
B. practical
C. revolutionary
D. interesting

Q2. What is the function of AR as described in the passage?

A. AR artificially enhances human performance.
B. AR produces realistic experiences in a learning environment.
C. AR enables unskilled humans to interact with complex machines.
D. AR produces a digital record of real-world content.

Q3. AR reduces which of the following problems associated with traditional training environments?

A. Their inability to simulate authentic experiences
B. Their physical dangers
C. Their inaccessibility to many learners
D. Their high financial costs

Q4. Why does the author cite studies showing that AR improves retention rates?

A. To demonstrate its usefulness when practicing emergency protocols
B. To provide an example of its adaptability
C. To explain why fields outside medicine and aviation are slower to adopt it
D. To support the claim that it is useful to industries

Q5. What is one problem the passage mentions related to the use of AR?

A. The costs associated with making it useful to particular clients
B. Disagreement among experts regarding its accuracy
C. A lack of measurable benefits in its present stage of development
D. The absence of existing training programs into which it may be integrated

2026-01-21 Green Roof Benefits

原文（Passage）

Green Roof Benefits

Green roofs, or living roofs, are gaining prominence in urban areas due to their environmental benefits. These are roofs covered with vegetation to help manage stormwater by absorbing rainfall, decreasing runoff, and minimizing flooding risks.

Another advantage of green roofs is their ability to improve air quality. Plants on the roof filter pollutants and capture dust. Additionally, green roofs reduce the urban heat island effect. Conventional roofs absorb and radiate heat, increasing urban temperatures. In contrast, green roofs keep buildings cooler by providing insulation and emitting moisture through their plants and soil.

Green roofs offer energy-efficiency benefits. The insulation provided by soil and plants reduces the need for heating in winter and cooling in summer, leading to energy savings. Green roofs can

also extend the lifespan of the roof by shielding materials from UV radiation and extreme temperatures, keeping the underlying structure sound for longer.
Finally, green roofs support urban biodiversity. Their vegetative layers create habitats for insects and birds in cities where green spaces are limited. These microhabitats help sustain pollinator populations and promote ecological balance. [A] Green roofs can even be designed to grow food, contributing to food security in urban environments.
[B] Despite these advantages, green roofs can be costly to install. [C] However, many cities offer incentives to encourage their adoption. [D]

题目（Questions）

Q1. The word "minimizing" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. monitoring
B. postponing
C. controlling
D. lowering

Q2. What is suggested about the urban heat island effect?

A. The characteristics of traditional roofs add to the problem.
B. Plants on roofs are not able to combat the problem effectively.
C. The problem is also starting to affect rural areas around the world.
D. The problem affects only the exterior spaces between buildings.

Q3. How do green roofs contribute to energy efficiency?

A. By eliminating the need for heating and air conditioning
B. By creating microhabitats for pollinators
C. By offering natural insulation and releasing moisture
D. By absorbing most of the Sun's UV radiation

Q4. Why does the author mention vegetative layers?

A. To support the claim that pollinator populations in cities are increasing
B. To show how insect and bird populations can be supported by green roofs
C. To discuss one potential way to provide access to food for urban residents
D. To address the concern that green roofs may be too costly to maintain

Q5. Look at the four locations that indicate where the following sentence could be added to the passage. Additionally, green roofs require ongoing maintenance to ensure proper drainage, plant health, and structural integrity. Where would the sentence best fit?

A. Before sentence "Green roofs can even be designed to grow food, contributing to food security in urban environments."
B. Before sentence "Despite these advantages, green roofs can be costly to install."
C. Before sentence "However, many cities offer incentives to encourage their adoption."
D. After sentence "However, many cities offer incentives to encourage their adoption."

2026-01-21 Plant Chemical Communication

原文（Passage）

Plant Communication
The discovery that plants use communication has changed our understanding of plant behavior and ecology. Traditionally, plants were considered passive organisms, reacting to environmental changes rather than actively engaging with their surroundings. However, studies have shown that plants can send chemical signals through the soil.
These signals, often carried by root exudates (substances released by the plants' roots into the soil), can inform neighboring plants about threats like plant-eating animals or disease-causing

agents. For instance, when a corn plant is attacked by caterpillars, it can release specific chemicals that warn nearby corn plants. In response, the neighboring corn plants may release a chemical known as MBOA into their tissues, which makes them less palatable to the caterpillars. Plants also use electrical signals to respond rapidly to environmental changes. These signals travel through the plant, allowing it to adjust resource allocation. Some plants can even detect the presence of other plants through their roots. This allows them to alter their growth patterns to avoid direct competition.

Despite these discoveries, the study of plant communication is still in its infancy. Researchers are continuously uncovering new ways that plants interact with each other and their environment.

题目（Questions）

Q1. According to the passage, there used to be a mistaken view that plants

A. often changed their behavior
B. released root exudates only in small amounts
C. were not significantly affected by ecological factors
D. did not actively interact with other plants

Q2. According to the passage, corn plants may release MBOA into their tissues in response to

A. harmful chemicals released by caterpillars
B. electrical signals in the soil
C. human activities that affect the environment
D. root exudates produced by other corn plants

Q3. What can be inferred to be the purpose of electrical signals that plants release?

A. To attract beneficial animals to the plants
B. To prevent attack by caterpillars on the plants
C. To help the plants make the best use of available resources
D. To communicate with other plants across long distances

Q4. Knowledge about the presence of other plants can help a plant to

A. change its growth in a way that reduces competition
B. prevent major damage to its roots
C. identify additional resources
D. determine which chemicals to release into the soil

Q5. The phrase "still in its infancy" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. highly controversial
B. in a difficult period
C. looking for funding
D. at an early stage

2026-01-21 Radio Astronomy Perspective

原文（Passage）

Radio Astronomy: A New Perspective

Radio astronomy is the study of celestial objects using radio waves rather than visible light. Unlike optical telescopes, radio telescopes can detect signals from sources obscured by dust or too faint to be seen with traditional instruments. This branch of astronomy has led to transformative discoveries, including the detection of cosmic microwave background radiation, a faint glow left over from the Big Bang, which has enabled scientists to reconstruct the universe's early conditions.

One of the most famous radio astronomy discoveries was the identification of pulsars in 1967. These rapidly spinning neutron stars, the dense remnants of massive stars that have exploded,

emit beams of radio waves at regular intervals. Observing pulsars helps scientists understand the end stages of stellar life and the behavior of matter under extreme conditions.
However, radio astronomy faces growing challenges due to technological interference. Devices like mobile phones, wireless routers, and satellites emit radio frequencies that can overwhelm the faint cosmic signals astronomers seek to detect. This "radio frequency pollution" makes it increasingly difficult to isolate genuine astronomical data. To combat this, observatories are often located in remote areas and protected by radio quiet zones, but the global spread of wireless technology continues to pose a serious threat.

题目（Questions）

Q1. What does the comparison of optical and radio telescopes suggest?

A. Traditional instruments are more susceptible to damage.
B. Dust often interferes with the optical detection of objects in space.
C. Radio telescopes are best for detecting massive stars.
D. Optical telescopes were the first to detect cosmic microwave background radiation.

Q2. The word "transformative" in the passage is closest in meaning to

A. groundbreaking
B. exciting
C. concerning
D. startling

Q3. According to the passage, radio astronomy helps scientists study all of the following EXCEPT

A. the beginnings of the universe
B. how to prevent the explosions of large stars
C. the last stages of stars
D. the way matter behaves under extreme conditions

Q4. Why does the author mention "the global spread of wireless technology"?

A. To suggest that the issue of technological interference is not likely to end soon
B. To argue that technological interference is not as severe as was once thought
C. To support the argument that optical telescopes are more reliable than radio telescopes
D. To highlight the sophisticated tools astronomers use to detect cosmic signals

Q5. According to the passage, what is one way to address the issue of technological interference?

A. Revive the use of optical telescopes
B. Limit wireless routers to certain frequencies
C. Place observatories far away from urban areas
D. Mandate specific quiet times when the use of wireless technology is prohibited

参考答案（Correct Answers）

2026-08-06 Traffic Psychology

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly discusses personality traits, social influences, and environmental conditions as factors affecting driving behavior, but it never mentions vehicle maintenance.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, 'vigilant' means 'watchful' or alert, describing a responsible passenger whose attentive presence encourages safer driving habits.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text states that peers can encourage risky driving but responsible passengers can promote safer driving, supporting the inference that a passenger's influence can be positive, though not always.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that 'some researchers argue' structural factors might have a stronger influence on safety than personality, showing that their relative importance is a subject of debate.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase 'These findings' refers back to the preceding examples of how environments and external cues alter driving behavior, making [D] the logical placement to conclude the paragraph's argument about personality.

2026-09-19 Animal Cultures

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage cites whales developing "group-specific songs" as a classic example of animal culture, supporting the inference that the variation of songs across different whale groups is exactly what leads some to classify them as cultural phenomena.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The phrase "cumulative innovation" is used to outline the strict criteria that some skeptics use to define culture, thereby arguing that the term should not be applied to nonhuman species.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly states that the middle position acknowledges animals "can still display rudimentary cultural phenomena," directly matching the recognition of some cultural elements in animal behavior.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In this context, "rudimentary" means elementary or basic, contrasting the less developed, foundational cultural phenomena observed in animals with the more sophisticated cultures of humans.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that growing evidence challenges assumptions about human uniqueness, which aligns with the text's earlier criticism of a "strict divide" and suggests these traditional assumptions rely on an overly rigid definition of culture.

2026-09-19 The Getty Kouros

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that supporters of the statue's authenticity cite chemical changes on its surface as being "consistent with long-term burial," which suggests an ancient origin.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The phrase is introduced by "Some scholars also argue that peculiar inconsistencies in the statue's style... could reflect," demonstrating that it is a theory used by certain experts to explain the statue's mixed features.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Skeptics doubt the statue's authenticity because it "incorporates features from different regions and periods" and combines traits "in a way that appears too eclectic to be genuine."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly states that "scientists recognize that modern forgers can artificially age marble."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage focuses on the debate over the statue's inconsistent, eclectic style and concludes that because neither side has decisive proof, its authenticity "remains unresolved."

2026-09-13 Graphic Design Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage contrasts the Middle Ages with the later advent of the printing press, which facilitated "mass production." This contrast supports the inference that the earlier intricate manuscripts were not mass-produced, but rather individually made.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, "advocated for" means to publicly support or recommend a particular cause or policy. Since the designers were pushing for simplicity and rationality, "promoted" is the closest meaning.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that the "grid-based approach brought order and readability to what often seemed to be overwhelming visuals." This provides a direct example of how designers increased structural order and clarity.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage explains that Swiss design emerged to counter a "chaotic visual landscape" and brought "order and readability to what often seemed to be overwhelming visuals." This confirms the design style was an attempt to make complex visuals easier to comprehend.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The printing press is described as altering production dynamics, while digital tools are noted for continuing to drive the evolution of graphic design. Mentioning both serves to illustrate the opening statement that graphic design is repeatedly transformed by technological advancements.

Passage - Expert Systems

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly states that expert systems reach conclusions by relying on a 'knowledge base' containing 'specialized information' and a 'set of rules' to determine how facts are applied.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author introduces MYCIN as a prominent 'early expert system' to provide a concrete example demonstrating that computers could successfully apply 'highly specialized knowledge' to a specific, complex problem.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, 'static' is defined by the immediately following clause stating that the systems 'do not automatically revise what they know,' meaning their knowledge remains fixed unless manually altered.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：While the passage directly states that unmaintained systems become less useful, it implies this outcome specifically occurs when specialists fail to fulfill their required role to 'continually add, remove, or modify information and rules.'

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence uses 'Consequently' to connect the 'time and effort' of experts mentioned just before the first square to the requirement for 'continued human attention.' It logically

precedes the next sentence, which details the negative results when a system is 'not regularly maintained' by humans.

Passage - Graphic Design Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that the advent of the printing press altered the dynamics of the Middle Ages by 'facilitating mass production.' This implies that prior to the printing press, intricate manuscripts were not mass-produced but instead individually made.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, 'advocated for' means to publicly support or recommend a particular idea, which accurately describes how designers promoted the principles of simplicity and rationality.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author mentions the 'grid-based approach' specifically to explain how designers 'brought order and readability' to chaotic visuals, providing a direct example of Swiss design's functional principles.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that critics felt the 'rigid structure, while effective, limited expressive possibilities and emotional resonance,' directly matching the claim that it restricted expressive qualities.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence's reference to 'This emphasis on structure' refers back to the 'grid-based approach' that brought 'order and readability' mentioned in the preceding sentence. Placing it at the third square also logically sets up the subsequent sentence, which introduces critics' arguments against such a 'rigid structure.'

2026-09-12 Demographic Dynamics

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that the demographic transition model 'illustrates the shifting patterns of birth and death rates as societies evolve from agrarian to industrialized economies.'

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage notes that as societies evolve from agrarian to industrialized economies, 'Initially, both rates are high,' supporting the inference that agrarian societies at the start of this transition experience high birth and death rates.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of families aligning their family size with their economic and personal desires, 'aspirations' refers to people's ambitions or 'goals'.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage states that persistently low birth rates might lead to 'economic innovation driven by necessity,' making the claim that they typically lead to 'economic decline' the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence's mention of 'this demographic shift' and the need to 'promote well-being among older adults' logically follows and addresses the 'strain on social institutions and intergenerational support systems' described immediately before location [D].

2026-09-12 Gamma-Ray Astronomy

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that gamma rays "do not penetrate Earth's atmosphere," which logically implies that ground-based observation is impossible and space telescopes must be used.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "confined to" means restricted or "limited to," indicating that gamma-ray bursts occur both inside and outside our galaxy.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that the Compton Gamma Ray Observatory allowed scientists "to pinpoint the locations of GRBs and study their properties in detail."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that "many questions remain" regarding whether GRBs result from merging neutron stars or hypernovae, indicating that the exact processes creating them are still unknown.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The author introduces the Fermi telescope in the final sentence as a new instrument that "may help astronomers uncover more secrets" and answer lingering scientific questions.

2026-09-06 Coastal Erosion

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, "exacerbate" means to worsen or increase the severity of a problem, as demonstrated by storms abruptly reshaping coastlines.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author introduces these countries immediately before explaining that for nations with extensive coastlines, managing erosion involves significant economic and social consequences rather than just environmental ones.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that beach nourishment requires "frequent replenishment" because it only provides short-term benefits, meaning ongoing maintenance is necessary.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that man-made structures like seawalls can unintentionally accelerate erosion in nearby areas, while natural approaches are described as "more sustainable," implying they are less likely to cause such collateral damage.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that coastal erosion itself threatens transportation, but it never claims that erosion-control measures disrupt transportation, making this the unsupported exception.

2026-09-06 Kintsugi Repair

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that kintsugi is associated with wabi-sabi, which is defined as an aesthetic outlook treating imperfection and transience as natural conditions.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text explains that the visibly altered state of the repaired object acts as a metaphor for resilience, demonstrating that "recovery need not erase the event that made recovery necessary."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "transience" refers to a temporary nature or the inevitability of change, which the wabi-sabi aesthetic embraces alongside aging and imperfection.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author contrasts "simply the decorative application of gold paint" with the "material knowledge, patience, and repeated curing" required, highlighting the difference between superficial imitation and a demanding authentic craft.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence contains the phrase "That metaphorical appeal," which refers back to the third paragraph's discussion of kintsugi as a metaphor for resilience. Placing it at square [D] provides a cohesive transition into the final paragraph, which describes the "demanding material process" of traditional kintsugi.

2026-09-05 Language in Primates

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：After describing Kanzi's linguistic skills, the passage states that "such abilities in nonhuman primates emerge only through intensive training and do not naturally evolve," supporting the inference that his communication required human intervention.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that nonhuman primates' linguistic abilities "emerge only through intensive training" by humans and "do not naturally evolve in primate communities," which eliminates the possibility that they teach each other basic grammar.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：In this context, "tethered to" means tied or limited to, indicating that nonhuman primates' communication is strictly "focused on" their immediate needs rather than producing novel ideas.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author acknowledges this shared social trait to indicate a common prerequisite for language development before contrasting it with the unique superiority of human communication.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces a contrast to the preceding claim that social hierarchies drove language development, providing a logical bridge to the following sentence which observes that despite being social creatures, nonhuman primates lack human-level language.

2026-09-05 Wartime Women Workforce

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of a labor shortage caused by millions of men suddenly leaving for military service, the word "acute" means extreme or severe.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author lists these specific tasks immediately after noting that "women were recruited into industrial jobs" to provide concrete examples of the heavy industrial work they began to undertake.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states that "Government campaigns framed this shift as both patriotic and temporary," indicating the government only expected women to do this work while men were away.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The second paragraph explains that some historians view the wartime transformation as a "lasting break" with traditional roles, while the third paragraph counters that others "stress the short-lived nature of the change."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that when the war ended and men returned home, women were dismissed and their labor-force participation fell sharply. From this direct statement, it can be reasonably inferred that the returning men took back the industrial jobs women had been performing.

KPO 32 - Microseism Applications

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, 'subtle' refers to something slight or difficult to detect, which matches 'faint.' This is further supported by the third paragraph, which describes these vibrations as 'mild signals.'

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that microseisms are generated by the pressure variations of colliding ocean waves and notes they are strongest when storms make these waves 'more powerful.' From this, it can be logically inferred that stronger waves transfer more energy, creating stronger seismic waves.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author lists these features immediately after stating that microseisms reveal 'details about the geological structures they pass through.' They serve as specific examples of the geological information scientists can uncover.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly states that in oil and gas exploration, microseisms help 'identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures.'

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage introduces filtering and cross-referencing right after noting that the 'mild signals are easily masked by other seismic noises.' This establishes that these methods are employed to isolate the subtle microseismic data from the surrounding background noise.

Animal Cultures

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that whales develop "group-specific songs" which some scientists cite as evidence of cultural traits. From this, it can be inferred that because these songs vary by group rather than being uniform across the species, they are considered cultural traditions rather than purely genetic instincts.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author introduces "cumulative innovation" as a hallmark of human culture to explain why some critics resist applying the term "culture" to animals. This reference characterizes a stricter view of how culture should be defined.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that the middle position acknowledges that animals "can still display rudimentary cultural phenomena," supporting the fact that this group recognizes basic cultural elements in nonhuman behavior.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In the context of a continuum where cultural capacities evolve gradually, "rudimentary" refers to an early, primitive, or foundational stage, making "basic" the closest in meaning.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage states that growing evidence of socially transmitted animal behaviors challenges "long-held assumptions about the uniqueness of human societies." This suggests the author views these traditional assumptions as upholding an overly rigid definition of culture that strictly excludes nonhuman species.

Polarized Light Applications

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, "invaluable" means extremely useful, as the passage emphasizes how polarized light provides critical insights into hidden material properties that normal light cannot reveal.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that polarized light helps uncover cell details (D), reveals crystal properties (B), and reduces glare in sunglasses (A), but it never mentions using the light to physically alter cell structures.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：While the text does not explicitly use the word "diagnose," stating that polarized light identifies "an indication of Alzheimer's disease" supports the inference that it can help doctors diagnose illnesses.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that pilots may avoid polarized lenses in aviation because the lenses can obscure critical visual cues such as instrument readings.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The sentence logically fits at [A] because it serves as a cohesive transition from the first paragraph's discussion of inorganic crystals to the second paragraph's focus on the organic, biological world.

Two Lizards

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：Because the passage states that green anoles were "displaced upward" into the treetops by aggressive brown anoles, it can be logically inferred that green anoles inhabited lower, ground-level areas before this forced shift.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author provides the example of "larger toe pads and more lamellae" immediately after introducing the theory of "rapid evolutionary changes" to illustrate how green anoles physically adapted to navigate thinner branches.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "scales" refers to the flat, rigid plates covering a reptile's skin, making "plates" the closest matching synonym.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly notes that brown anoles "exposed to higher predation" developed shorter limbs to "improve maneuverability in dense vegetation," which directly connects the adaptation to evading predators.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage concludes that observing these adaptations offers "a real-time glimpse into evolutionary change," demonstrating the value of seeing evolutionary mechanisms operate over just a few generations.

2026-08-29 Ancient Mars Climate

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage first outlines geologic evidence that liquid water once existed on Mars and then explains the "faint young Sun paradox," a climate-related problem this evidence creates.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that counting craters "gives the relative age, and allows one to determine which surfaces are older and which are younger."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：In this context, "luminosity" means brightness, which is directly supported by the passage's subsequent description of the Sun as being "fainter" during this period.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that the solution to the paradox probably lies in climate science but explicitly concludes that "the issue has not been entirely settled," indicating that scientists still lack a definitive explanation.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The author lists river channels and valley networks as specific examples of the "abundant geologic evidence" showing that liquid water once flowed on the Martian surface.

2026-08-29 Polarized Light Applications

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, "invaluable" means having incalculable worth, indicating that polarized light is "extremely useful" for revealing hidden properties in scientific research.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage mentions reducing glare, studying crystals, and assessing cellular composition as applications, but it states that biological materials alter the polarization of light, not that polarized light alters cell structure.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that polarized light helps identify plaques indicative of Alzheimer's disease; from this specific example, we can reasonably infer the broader medical application that it helps doctors diagnose diseases.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that in aviation, polarized lenses can obscure critical visual cues like instrument readings, which directly supports the fact that they make it difficult to see aircraft instruments.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence contrasts the "inorganic world" with a new topic, providing a perfect logical transition from the first paragraph's discussion of inorganic crystals to the second paragraph's focus on biological cells and tissues at position [A].

2026-08-25 Ancient Glacier Air

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：This sentence directly describes the physical mechanism of preservation, detailing how accumulating and compressing snow traps air bubbles to form atmospheric snapshots.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of the growing impact of human activity on greenhouse gases, the word "escalating" means increasing or intensifying.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage states that ice cores record evidence of severe environmental events like volcanic eruptions and forest fires; it never mentions that the layers are destroyed by these events.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author compares ice cores to tree rings to help the reader visualize how the cylindrical layers of ice correspond sequentially to distinct time periods.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The final paragraph notes the increasing risk that melting glaciers will destroy invaluable climate data, concluding that scientists must "race against time" to study and preserve these records.

2026-08-25 Person-Centered Therapy

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "prevailing" means dominant or widespread, describing the most commonly accepted view of therapists as diagnostic experts before Rogers introduced his alternative approach.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：While the passage states that earlier approaches relied on therapists for diagnosis and Rogers centered the patient's personal growth, it never suggests that patients were expected to have their own diagnostic expertise. The other options are explicitly supported by mentions of a "nonjudgmental environment," "listening actively," and taking "steps toward personal growth."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author includes these actions between em dashes immediately following the word "reflection" to provide concrete examples that define and clarify what reflection means in person-centered therapy.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage contrasts Rogers' new method of acting as an "empathetic facilitator" with earlier clinical approaches that strictly "foregrounded issues and behaviors" and diagnosis, implying that the older models did not prioritize empathy.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：This sentence explicitly outlines the end goals of the therapy for the client, specifically stating that the intended results are to "gain the self-awareness and self-acceptance needed to grow personally and resolve issues."

KPO 14 - American Women at War

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In the context of a labor shortage that resulted in factories urgently needing additional workers, the word "acute" means intense or "severe."

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage lists welding aircraft frames alongside operating heavy machinery and inspecting munitions to provide specific examples of the previously unsuitable industrial jobs women entered during the war.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 states that government officials "described this work as temporary" and suggested that women would return to domestic life when the wartime emergency ended.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explains that historians disagree about the "long-term significance" of this period, debating whether wartime employment permanently expanded women's economic opportunities or if women were just forced back out of the workforce.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states in paragraph 3 that after the war, "male workers replaced women in the very positions women had held successfully" in many factories.

KPO 15 - Stretching Benefits

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that dynamic stretching can raise body temperature, increase blood flow, and improve performance, making choice D the only unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "impair" strength and power means to negatively affect or diminish them, which matches the meaning of "weaken."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly notes that trainers recommend static stretching after exercise, when muscles are warm and the goal is recovery.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author lists these factors to highlight the specific variables that dictate whether stretching will have a beneficial or detrimental effect in a given situation.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence contrasts with the preceding description of how dynamic stretching prepares the body for exercise, logically bridging the shift to static stretching at location [B].

KPO 16 - Visual Perception

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage uses sudden movement versus stationary objects as an example to illustrate how the brain filters incoming signals to prioritize "information that may matter for survival."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In paragraph 2, "its presence" logically refers back to the "blind spot" introduced in the preceding sentence, which most people are unaware of because the brain fills in the visual gap.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The word "simultaneously" means "at the same time," describing how a person might overlook other objects that are present in the room alongside the target object.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the brain emphasizes "color, shape, and location" when searching for a green book, but it never mentions increased sensitivity to objects in shadows.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 2 describes how the brain actively reconstructs the blind spot, and paragraph 3 explains selective attention. Both provide examples supporting the text's main theme that vision is a complex, active process rather than passive recording.

KPO 17 - Data Visualization

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In the context of discovering hidden details in raw data, "anomalies" refers to things that deviate from what is expected, making "irregularities" the correct meaning.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states in the first paragraph that traditional charts "are often limited when the information contains many variables or changes over time."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The phrase "these tools" refers back to the interactive dashboard applications just described for city planners and business analysts; placing it at [C] logically introduces the need for good design before the final sentence introduces the need for user comprehension.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly mentions that dashboards allow users to adjust variables, filter categories, and compare scenarios, but it never mentions improving communication among company leaders.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The overarching focus of the passage is introducing modern data visualization techniques and explaining how they help uncover hidden patterns in large, complex datasets.

KPO 18 - American Veganism

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage traces the trajectory of veganism in the United States, from a sharp rise in popularity driven by various concerns to a later shift toward a "more complicated public attitude." This structural flow supports the main purpose of analyzing how American views and behaviors regarding veganism have evolved.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly lists animal welfare, environmental effects of industrial agriculture, and health benefits as reasons people were drawn to vegan diets. The passage never mentions the high cost of meat as a motivating factor, making it the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "involved" means complex or "complicated," as it describes a production process that requires multiple intricate steps such as "processing, flavoring, and added ingredients."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author introduces vegan cheese substitutes to show "how difficult it can be to reproduce familiar animal-based foods." This serves to illustrate a specific practical challenge in creating plant-based versions of traditional foods.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 2 directly connects the complex production methods of commercial meat substitutes to consumer skepticism, noting that "some consumers began to question whether such products were as healthy as they first appeared."

KPO 19 - Smart Buildings

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, the word "static" means unchanging, which contrasts directly with the passage's description of designers using data to adjust building systems in real time.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that data science monitors energy use, improves comfort, and adjusts building systems in real time. It never mentions any requirement for architects to receive specialized training in data analysis, making this the exception.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text states that sensors may track movement and room use, collecting information that building users might "not recognize or approve of," which raises privacy concerns.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Hospitals and office spaces are used as specific examples to illustrate the diverse ways smart HVAC data systems can benefit and improve different types of infrastructure.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly states that one of the benefits of these technologies is that they can "reduce the environmental impact of buildings."

KPO 20 - Floating Wind Turbines

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, to "harness" untapped wind resources means to utilize or "exploit" them for energy production.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the anchoring systems of floating turbines allow "placement in deeper waters" to access wind resources that traditional turbines cannot.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author notes that floating turbines rely on "buoyancy principles," which makes their design and maintenance complex, thereby illustrating the unique engineering challenges they present.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage states that harsh marine conditions accelerate wear and tear, and immediately follows up by noting that experts are investigating "materials and designs to enhance durability," which implies active efforts to control this damage.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "Others assess..." logically parallels "Some experts are investigating..." in the preceding sentence. Placing it at [C] seamlessly continues the discussion of various research solutions being explored to address the turbines' problems.

KPO 21 - GMO Foods

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage outlines the agricultural and nutritional advantages of genetically modified foods in the first two paragraphs before detailing the ecological and social concerns raised by critics in the final paragraph.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, "persistent" describes crops that can survive difficult environmental conditions for a "longer period," meaning long-lasting.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that genetic modification can create crops that resist insects, tolerate drought, and contain enhanced nutrients, but it never mentions improving the natural fertility of soil.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that patented seeds force farmers to buy from large companies yearly, which gives these corporations "considerable influence over agricultural choices."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The rapid pace of technological change is cited as a concern of critics because new varieties may be introduced too quickly for proper evaluation, illustrating one reason why some people resist the technology.

KPO 22 - Quilt Artistry

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly focuses on the "distinction between craft and art," explaining how quilts have traditionally been classified as household crafts rather than fine art.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts the quilts' practical origins with formal art institutions, emphasizing that despite sharing visual qualities with modernist paintings, the quilts emerged from daily life.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "operate as" means to function or "serve as," indicating that the practical quilts also act as historical records of community and labor.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage states that because quilts were classified as everyday domestic crafts rather than fine art, "their artistic value was frequently overlooked" by critics and museums.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The final sentence concludes the passage by explicitly stating that the quilts "offer another choice beyond the rigid division between craft and art," proving that practical objects can possess aesthetic value.

KPO 23 - Wartime Women

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "acute" means severe, describing the intense labor shortage created when millions of men left the workforce for military service.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author provides the example of welding aircraft frames to illustrate the specific types of jobs, traditionally performed by men, that women entered during the war.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that government campaigns described women's industrial employment as a "temporary response to wartime conditions."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage concludes by stating that the historical debate centers on "how permanent those changes were," indicating disagreement over the lasting effects of wartime employment.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The text explains that once the war ended, employers dismissed or reassigned female workers so that returning men could resume their former jobs.

KPO 24 - Stretching Effects

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that dynamic stretching can raise muscle temperature, prepare the body for rapid changes in direction, and take joints through a useful range of motion. Reducing the range of motion is never mentioned, making it the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of reducing maximum strength or explosive power prior to demanding exercise, the word "impair" means to weaken or diminish.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that static stretching "may be useful after training, when an immediate reduction in force production matters less."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author lists these factors to explain that the effects of stretching depend on specific variables rather than treating the practice as "universally beneficial or harmful."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This temporary effect" refers directly back to the preceding sentence's claim that static stretching may "temporarily impair maximum strength or explosive power." Placing the sentence at [B] logically introduces the impact on force production before the next sentence further elaborates on the scale and duration of "The effect."

KPO 25 - Visual Processing

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage contrasts sudden movement with stationary objects as an example of how specialized neural pathways "give priority to signals" that might be important for immediate action or survival.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In paragraph 2, the pronoun "its" in the phrase "register its presence" logically refers back to the "unexpected object" mentioned in the preceding sentence.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of multiple colors, shapes, and objects competing for a person's attention, the word "simultaneously" means happening "at the same time."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 mentions shapes, competing objects, and visual context elements like lighting and location, making the unmentioned "special sensitivity to green objects in shadows" the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 2 describes how selectivity causes gaps in awareness during intense experimental tasks, while paragraph 3 illustrates how selective attention affects ordinary searches, demonstrating that both paragraphs provide different examples of selective visual processing.

KPO 26 - Data Visualization

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "anomalies" pairs with "patterns" to describe unusual or unexpected data points, meaning it is closest to "irregularities."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that static formats "become less effective when a data set contains many interacting variables or changes rapidly over time."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author lists these actions as specific examples immediately following the claim that interactive dashboards allow users to "manipulate what they see," illustrating how exploration occurs.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：While the passage notes that a business manager could use a dashboard to "explore sales," it never claims that dashboards improve how business leaders communicate, making this the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence elaborates on a "problem" involving competing visual signals, which directly links back to the preceding sentence before [B] about a viewer being overwhelmed by "too many controls, colors, moving elements, or overlapping graphics."

KPO 27 - U.S. Veganism

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage traces the history of veganism in the United States, from its rapid growth and the development of substitutes in the early 21st century to the slowing trend and changing consumer attitudes by the mid-2020s.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly lists animal welfare, environmental effects, and health benefits as motivations for adopting vegan diets. High meat prices are never mentioned in the text, making it the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "involved" means complex or intricate, as the following sentences describe the highly "complex interactions" required to reproduce the taste and texture of conventional cheese.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author uses conventional and vegan cheese to provide a specific example of how "involved" and complex it is to recreate the texture and flavor of animal products using completely different ingredients.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The final paragraph explicitly states that some consumers "questioned whether highly processed commercial meat substitutes were necessarily healthy."

KPO 28 - Smart Buildings

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In the context of conventional buildings running on predetermined schedules regardless of room occupancy, the word 'static' means fixed or 'unchanging'.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage states that smart systems can reveal unusual patterns of electricity use, respond to room occupancy, and identify failing equipment to schedule maintenance. It never mentions that architects are required to receive specialized data-analysis training.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly states that because sensors can track where individuals spend time and how they move, the technology raises significant privacy concerns.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author provides hospitals and office buildings as specific examples to illustrate the broader point that smart systems and data science can improve urban infrastructure.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The final sentence of the second paragraph directly states that smart-building systems can improve urban infrastructure while 'reducing operating costs and environmental impact.'

KPO 29 - Floating Wind Turbines

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, to "harness" wind resources means to utilize or exploit them for energy production.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that floating turbines can be installed farther from shore, allowing them to access stronger and more consistent wind resources in deeper waters.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author mentions "buoyancy principles" as a specific example of the "new engineering problems" designers must solve to keep platforms stable while safely moving with waves.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage details that to combat the accelerated wear and tear caused by saltwater and cyclic stress, engineers are investigating resistant materials, protective coatings, and improved platform designs.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage is structured to first introduce the main benefit of floating turbines in accessing deeper waters, followed by a detailed discussion of the engineering and durability challenges that must be overcome for their success.

KPO 30 - Genetically Modified Foods

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage first outlines the advantages of genetically modified crops, such as pest resistance and improved nutrition, before dedicating the subsequent paragraphs to the ecological and economic concerns surrounding the technology.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In the context of environmental effects that are described as being 'difficult to reverse,' the word 'persistent' means enduring or long-lasting.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that GM crops can improve nutritional value, resist insects, and decrease the amount of pesticide needed, making direct soil fertility improvement the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explains that patented seeds restrict farmers from saving and replanting seeds, which critics worry gives large companies excessive control and leaves farmers dependent on a few suppliers.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The author notes the rapid change in genetic technologies to explain that it makes it difficult for regulations and public understanding to keep pace, thereby complicating the technology's implementation and fueling ongoing debate.

KPO 31 - Quilt Artistry

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 contrasts household crafts, which are evaluated according to function and technique, with works of art like painting and sculpture, which are treated as expressions of individual creativity.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author notes the practical, everyday origins of the quilts to set up a contrast with the subsequent sentence, which reveals that the quilts also display bold features resembling modernist painting.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of quilts functioning or being treated like works of art in a museum setting, the phrase "operate as" means to "serve as" or function as.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly states that critics argue the distinction between craft and art "has historically caused visually innovative objects to be overlooked by museums and art historians."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The author lists these striking aesthetic features to demonstrate that the quilts possess visual qualities admired in modernist art, thereby justifying their classification as artworks rather than mere practical crafts.

2026-08-21 Arts Education Benefits

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "foster" means to encourage or promote the development of something, indicating that arts programs "support" children's cognitive development.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly mentions improvements in reading and math, emotional growth, and positive learning environments, but it never claims that children develop lasting artistic abilities.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The original sentence establishes a causal chain where collaboration in arts builds motivation and engagement, which in turn drive academic achievement, a relationship accurately captured by this choice.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text states that correlational studies show a relationship between arts participation and academic success "without proving that arts programs cause academic success."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly links "mixed findings in the literature" to the fact that some arts programs are "too brief or inconsistently delivered to produce measurable academic effects."

2026-08-20 Gamma Ray Astronomy

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage states that gamma rays "do not penetrate Earth's atmosphere." This supports the inference that space telescopes are required because the physical characteristics of the rays prevent them from being observed from the ground.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "confined to" means restricted or "limited to," indicating that gamma-ray bursts occur outside of our galaxy as well.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly notes that the Compton Gamma Ray Observatory allowed scientists to "pinpoint the locations of GRBs and study their properties in detail," which directly matches finding out where they occur and learning more about them.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that "many questions remain" and presents competing hypotheses about whether GRBs result from merging neutron stars or hypernovae, showing that the specific processes that give rise to them are still unresolved.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The author mentions this telescope immediately after discussing unresolved hypotheses to illustrate how new observational tools "may help astronomers uncover more secrets" about gamma-ray bursts.

2026-08-20 Gravitational Physics Applications

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage attributes the making of predictions that were only confirmed by later observation (such as black holes and gravitational waves) to Einstein's theory of general relativity, making it the unsupported exception for Newton's law.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author introduces gravitational lensing as an example of a phenomenon that Einstein's model successfully explained but Newton's model could not, illustrating the superiority of Einstein's newer theory.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of microgravity environments aboard the space station, the word minimized means that the interfering effects of gravity are reduced to a very small amount.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that mapping the atomic structure of crystals is crucial for rational drug design because it allows scientists to develop medications that precisely target disease-related proteins.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence begins with the phrase 'For instance' and describes crystals growing unevenly, which provides a direct example of the preceding sentence's claim that Earth's gravity interferes with uniform crystal growth. Therefore, it logically belongs at insertion point [B].

2026-08-20 Passage - Thermodynamics and Ecosystems

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The sentence in choice B uses the word 'Yet' to pivot from familiar mechanical examples, introducing the unexpected idea that the laws of thermodynamics also apply to complex biological systems like ecosystems.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：This phrase is used to provide a concrete biological example of the first law of thermodynamics, demonstrating how energy transformation drives natural food chains.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage identifies the second law of thermodynamics—that entropy or disorder increases—as the fundamental constraint that explains why energy becomes less available for productive work as ecosystems mature.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The word 'disparity' points back to the preceding sentence's sharp contrast between the efficient energy conversion of simple organisms and the significant energy loss of larger animals, making 'difference' the correct meaning.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Although the text directly states that complexity typically breeds energy loss, it notes some top predators as surprising exceptions, which supports the inference that they can be metabolically more efficient than the prey they consume.

2026-08-15 Medieval Town Origins

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage first introduces the rise of medieval towns and then dedicates the remainder of the text to outlining and evaluating three different scholarly theories regarding their origins.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that the new class of artisans and merchants "came from the peasantry" and "were landless younger sons of large families, driven away by land shortage."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, to say that merchants "gravitated toward favorable spots" means that they were naturally drawn or attracted to these locations for trading purposes.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage supports this inference by noting that while Pirenne's theory accurately describes certain Flemish towns, it "does not fit the course of development in the Italian cities" and fails to account for local trade.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The author mentions monasteries and cathedrals explicitly to illustrate the "third explanation" for town origins, demonstrating how economic demand from these religious establishments drew traders and merchants to settle nearby.

2026-08-15 Modern Choreography

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of describing a metamorphosis, the word "profound" means a deep, complete, and "fundamental" transformation in the nature of choreography.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author introduces Martha Graham as a visionary who challenged the "aesthetic rigidity" of ballet in order to demonstrate the transition toward "emotional expression and psychological depth."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that in contemporary dance, "many contemporary works emerge from collaborative processes" rather than being dictated by a single choreographer.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text contrasts early choreography, which was governed by "strict formalism" and "aesthetic rigidity," with modern works that are "adaptive and responsive," demonstrating a shift from rigidity to flexibility.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the list of collaborative professionals (composers, designers, etc.) by referring to them as "contributors," and the following sentence's reference to "This co-creative model" perfectly encapsulates their active role in shaping the piece.

2026-08-12 Acting Gestures

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In the context of revealing a character's emotions without being obvious or explicit, the word "overt" means direct.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author introduces silent films to illustrate how actors relied on visual communication before sound, supporting the paragraph's opening claim that gestures have always been an integral tool in acting.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 states that modern gestures enhance realism, add layers of meaning, and reveal emotional transitions, but it never mentions that they are particularly important for weaker actors.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 2 explains that contemporary acting uses deliberate, subtle gestures to complement dialogue and reflect a "shift toward naturalism… where authenticity is paramount."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 3 emphasizes that a gesture might be interpreted differently across cultures, so skilled actors must anticipate these differences and "adapt and modify their gestures to resonate with diverse audiences."

2026-08-12 Anole Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that green anoles were displaced upward to the tree canopy due to competition, supporting the inference that they originally inhabited lower, ground-level areas before this habitat shift.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The development of larger toe pads and lamellae is cited as evidence of rapid evolutionary changes triggered by the environmental pressure of being forced into thinner branches.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of reptile anatomy, scales refer to the small, rigid, flat structures covering the skin, making plates the closest synonymous meaning.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly links shorter limbs to improved maneuverability in dense vegetation for brown anoles exposed to higher predation, which helps them escape predators.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The concluding sentence states that observing these adaptations offers a real-time glimpse into evolutionary change, matching the idea of witnessing evolutionary mechanisms at work.

2026-08-12 Behavioral Economics

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The phrase "This behavior" directly refers to the irrational action of avoiding selling a declining stock described in the preceding sentence. Placing the sentence at location [C] logically connects this emotionally driven action to the contrast with what "Rational theory would suggest" in the following sentence.

2026-08-12 Cybernetic Prosthetics

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The word "seamlessly" refers to parts combining perfectly without any disruptions or gaps, meaning the prosthetics integrate "smoothly" with the human nervous system.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage attributes the ability to achieve "more natural movement" to the seamless integration with the nervous system, and immediately identifies myoelectric sensors as a "key development" facilitating this process. Therefore, it can be inferred that these sensors are what enable the natural movement.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that the ability of a cybernetic hand to perform delicate tasks is "achieved through advanced algorithms that translate muscle signals into controlled movements."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that haptic feedback allows users to "feel textures and temperatures," but it does not mention anything about actively "changing" the temperatures of the objects themselves.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces the concept of "obstacles" that need to be overcome, making it the perfect introductory sentence at location [A] before the passage lists specific barriers like high cost, maintenance, and limited battery life.

2026-08-12 Gestures in Acting

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explains that silent films required actors to use exaggerated gestures to communicate complex narratives, demonstrating their essential role in conveying meaning before spoken dialogue.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "overt" refers to something obvious or explicit, contrasting with the "nuanced" and subtle gestures that convey meaning without "direct" expression.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 directly states that a subtle or nuanced gesture, like the arch of an eyebrow, can reveal a character's inner conflict or emotional transitions.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explains that a gesture's meaning can change between cultures, prompting actors to adapt and modify their gestures to avoid misinterpretation by diverse audiences.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage traces the role of gestures from exaggerated movements in silent films to subtle, naturalistic actions in modern theater, illustrating their enduring importance as expressive tools in acting.

2026-08-12 Kintsugi Art Repair

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The text explicitly states that kintsugi is associated with wabi-sabi, an aesthetic outlook that treats "imperfection, age, and transience as natural conditions."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that a visibly restored object serves as a metaphor for resilience, showing that "recovery need not erase the event that made recovery necessary."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：By listing the material knowledge, patience, and curing required, the author contrasts the rigorous traditional craft with superficial, purely decorative imitations.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Grouped with "imperfection" and "age," the word "transience" refers to the temporary, ever-changing nature of physical objects over time.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "That metaphorical appeal" refers back to the themes of resilience and renewal in paragraph 3, while "the demanding material process discussed next" logically introduces the craft techniques detailed in paragraph 4.

2026-08-12 Linguistic Structural Diversity

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that most languages conform to a 'limited set' of dominant word orders, but it never states that there are exactly three basic structural patterns across all languages.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The author uses the comprehension benefits of placing the subject first as an example of the 'cognitive efficiency' that explains why most languages conform to a limited set of word orders.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly contrasts Turkish, which uses 'extensive inflection' (high morphological complexity), with Mandarin Chinese, which 'relies more on word order and context' (lower morphological complexity).

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：In this context, 'pressures' refers to the functional forces or 'influences' that drive linguistic evolution and dictate how languages balance morphology and syntax.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The demonstrative phrase 'Such changes' directly refers back to the 'contact with other languages and cultural shifts' mentioned in the preceding sentence, providing perfect cohesion at location [C].

2026-08-12 Music Education Benefits

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：对。强化注意和处理相关神经通路解释了音乐改善认知技能的一种机制。

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：对。独自用平静音乐安抚自己不需要合作，最不可能促进社会发展。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：对。文章提到倾听、非语言沟通和合作，没有提用高表演标准促进社交。

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：对。音乐被视为非核心学科，因此比核心课程更容易被削减经费。

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：对。holistic 指同时涵盖认知、社会和情绪的全面作用，对应 comprehensive。

2026-08-12 Octopus Intelligence

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that building shelters indicates "foresight, since the octopus must carry and later arrange the objects in a different context." This need to anticipate and prepare for future needs directly supports the idea that they are capable of complex planning.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In the context of opening jars and escaping enclosures, "manipulating" latches refers to physically handling, moving, or "operating" the mechanisms in order to unlock them.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：While paragraph 2 states that octopuses interpret visual information to instantly match their surroundings and evade predators, it contains no evidence that they actually understand the cognitive or visual processes of how predators perceive color, making it the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The text explains that despite a deep evolutionary separation from vertebrates, octopuses developed similar intelligence, showing that "complex cognition can arise through very different biological pathways."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "separate model of intelligence" is used to explain that studying octopuses is "expanding our understanding of how minds can develop," demonstrating how it provides researchers with fresh perspectives on cognitive evolution.

2026-08-12 Origins of Agriculture

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces the question of why people became farmers and subsequently outlines multiple theories, including environmental pressure, cultural evolution, and increasing population density.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly notes that during previous glaciations, people "moved in response to environmental changes rather than staying put and adapting to a new ecosystem."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "hospitable" refers to environments that are welcoming or favorable for survival, which explains why less hospitable conditions created an "environmental squeeze" for early people.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 states that growing populations developed the intensive practices of agriculture "[o]nce there was no more productive territory to colonize," supporting the inference that farming was adopted because groups could no longer expand into new lands.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：By listing multiple geographically distinct regions, the author demonstrates that the shift to agriculture was a widespread phenomenon rather than an isolated event tied to a single location.

2026-08-12 The Discovery Of Vitamins

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that rice bran contains thiamine, which Funk classified as an amine that is "essential for life," demonstrating that rice bran contains a vital nutrient.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts the prevailing medical assumption that toxins or infections caused illnesses with Funk's theory about nutrient deficiency, establishing the context for why Funk's idea was considered "revolutionary."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly points out that Funk's extract "likely contained a mixture of substances" and that thiamine was isolated in its pure form "only later," indicating Funk did not extract a pure substance.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage states that the final 'e' was dropped from "vitamine" because many newly discovered life-essential nutrients "were not amines," contradicting the claim that the name change occurred because the nutrients were not essential for life.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence provides a specific example of a vitamin that lacks nitrogen, which illustrates the preceding sentence's claim that "many of them were not amines." Placing it at Location 4 creates a logical bridge to the final sentence about dropping the 'e' from the term.

2026-08-12 Video Evidence in Courts

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The first sentence claims that technological advances have made cameras nearly ubiquitous, and the second sentence illustrates this claim by listing examples such as police body cameras, security cameras, and smartphones.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text states that a single camera angle "might fail to capture what occurs just outside the frame," which directly supports the idea that viewers may miss critical actions due to how the video is framed.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explains that because videos lack "interpersonal and emotional context," an observer might misinterpret a person's defensive actions as antagonistic.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：According to the passage, legal experts emphasize that jurors might "dismiss eyewitness testimonies as unreliable" while viewing videos as showing events "more directly."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：In this context, to evaluate evidence "cautiously" means to do so "carefully," since jurors must be mindful of the potential limitations and misleading angles of video recordings.

2026-08-09 Social Network Influence

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：Sentence C provides a specific example of the phenomenon by illustrating how regular chats with friends about climate change can lead an individual to adopt those same beliefs.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly notes that computational sociology researchers "now look more closely at how frequent interactions shape behavior."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the phrase "incredibly complex," the word "incredibly" acts as an intensifier meaning "extremely," emphasizing the high degree of difficulty involved in predicting human behavior.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The final sentence says the real challenge is understanding how the many subtle factors interact to produce large-scale changes in behavior.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence contrasts "bottom up" influence with "top down" imposition. This logically bridges the preceding claim that powerful people do not always have the biggest impact and the following example of everyday coworker conversations being highly influential.

2026-08-09 Thermodynamics and Ecosystems

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Sentence B introduces the unexpected application of thermodynamics by stating that these laws "extend far beyond mechanical systems" to interpret complex phenomena like energy flow in ecosystems.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The phrase is used to demonstrate how the first law of thermodynamics, which states that energy is only transformed, operates practically within biological food chains.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage identifies the second law of thermodynamics—entropy tends to increase—as the principle that explains why ecosystem energy use becomes less efficient.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The word "disparity" refers to a noticeable inequality or difference, which in this context describes the contrast in energy conversion efficiency between simple organisms and larger animals.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that some top predators are exceptions to the general rule that larger, complex animals lose much of their energy intake, implying they possess a surprisingly high metabolic efficiency compared to organisms at lower trophic levels.

2026-08-08 Diane Arbus

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces Arbus's unconventional portraits and primarily focuses on the differing critical interpretations and ongoing debates her work provokes.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that Arbus turned her camera toward people at the margins of mainstream society, including those whose identities were difficult to classify.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Susan Sontag is mentioned in the second paragraph as a critic who felt Arbus's images created an uneasy relationship and could be viewed as cold or exploitative.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In this context, "ambiguity" means "uncertainty," referring to the complex, unsettled, and contradictory feelings viewers experience when looking at Arbus's subjects.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Because the subjects' direct gaze leaves the viewer feeling unsettled and provokes debate about the "ethics of looking," it can be inferred that the photos compel viewers to examine their own role and reactions as observers.

2026-08-08 Expert Systems

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage outlines the mechanics of expert systems, provides MYCIN as an example, and concludes by asserting their historical importance in demonstrating that computer programs can apply expert knowledge.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph contrasts expert systems with modern AI by stating that instead of learning from massive data, they rely on a knowledge base supplied by specialists and a rule system.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：MYCIN is introduced in the second paragraph as "One famous early example" of an expert system to illustrate how such systems were practically applied to diagnose infections and recommend medical treatments.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In this context, making reasoning "explicit" means making it clearly stated and overt, which pairs with the subsequent word "consistent" as a strength of the system.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The third paragraph directly identifies the weakness of expert systems, noting that "they required extensive input from experts and constant updating as knowledge changed."

2026-08-08 Feedback Systems

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces how feedback systems regulate inputs and outputs to maintain stability, while the second paragraph details how timing issues like delays can cause control problems.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The first sentence of the passage explicitly states that a feedback system monitors the output of a process and uses it to adjust future input.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states directly in the second paragraph that if there is a delay between measurement and correction, the feedback system may overcorrect.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of contrasting with negative feedback which reduces deviation, "amplifies" means that positive feedback increases or magnifies the change.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly indicates that negative feedback "reduces deviation from a target and promotes stability."

2026-08-08 Music Education

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The first two paragraphs focus on how studying music supports cognitive development, while the third paragraph explains how cooperative musical activities encourage social development.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The final sentence of paragraph 1 explicitly states that reading musical notation involves "translating visual signs into coordinated physical actions and sounds."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of students receiving long-term musical training that leads to cognitive improvements, the word "sustained" means ongoing or continued.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author mentions ensemble performance in paragraph 3 to illustrate how music education encourages social development by requiring students to cooperate and build "patience, discipline, and social awareness."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states that music lessons "do not automatically produce academic success," but supports the inference that benefits occur because musical training "overlaps with skills used in other domains."

2026-08-08 Origami

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage outlines the historical origins of origami in the first paragraph, describes its cultural and symbolic significance in the second, and discusses its technological applications in the third.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that folded-paper objects became more common in the Edo period because "paper became less expensive and more widely available."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "distinctive" means having characteristic qualities that make something easily recognizable, indicating that Japanese paper folding developed its own unique identity separate from its Chinese origins.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author lists these modern inventions to provide concrete examples of how engineers and designers use origami principles to solve practical problems involving compact storage.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：While the passage does not explicitly state how the crane was initially perceived, it notes that the paper crane "later became a symbol of peace and hope" and that these symbolic meanings helped the art form remain culturally important, implying its lasting value came from these associations.

2026-08-08 Power of Music

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage outlines music's impact on mood and physical responses, details how it engages the brain emotionally, and describes its role in building social trust. Together, these points serve the primary purpose of explaining why music has powerful emotional and social effects.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly notes that music engages "multiple areas of the brain at the same time," concluding that this broad mental and physical engagement makes it highly effective at capturing attention.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of the phrase "coordinate group activity," the word "coordinate" means to bring multiple people or elements into harmonious operation, which matches the meaning of organizing together.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author provides group singing, dancing, and drumming as examples of activities that require coordinated action in order to illustrate the preceding claim that music "can also strengthen social bonds."

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The final sentence directly states that while the "specific functions of music vary from one culture to another," its ability to connect emotion and social behavior is "widespread." This supports the logical inference that despite differing specific uses, music's emotional and social power is a universal characteristic across societies.

2026-08-08 Urban Resilience

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage defines urban resilience and systematically explores its key components, specifically redundant physical systems, flexible urban planning, and strong social cooperation.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that if a city relies on a single system for its needs, "a failure in that one system can create widespread problems."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of the passage, "redundancy" means having "backup capacity," as the text subsequently describes using multiple routes and backup power systems to reduce a city's vulnerability.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Public spaces that can double as emergency shelters are cited as a specific example to illustrate the previously mentioned strategy of "flexibility" in urban design.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Because the text states that strong local networks allow communities to "recover more quickly," it can be logically inferred that the broader concept of social resilience accelerates a city's recovery from disruptions.

2026-08-08 Vitamin Discovery

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage outlines how observing dietary deficiencies led to Casimir Funk's isolation of vitamins (paragraphs 1 and 2) and how this breakthrough established nutrition as a modern scientific field (paragraph 3).

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 states that the process of polishing removed the grain's outer layers, leaving those who ate mostly polished rice without an essential nutrient.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, the word "coined" means created or "invented," describing how Funk formed a new word by combining "vita" and "amine."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：According to paragraph 2, the shorter term "vitamin" was kept in use because scientists discovered that "not all vitamins are amines."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 3 explains that Funk's work led scientists to realize that "small quantities of particular substances were necessary" and linked the absence of these nutrients to specific deficiency diseases.

2026-08-06 Placebo Effect

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that the placebo effect challenges conventional ideas because a patient's condition can improve simply through the belief that they are receiving an effective treatment, which can sometimes rival the results of real medications.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly states that when patients anticipate positive effects, their brains can release chemicals like endorphins, linking the placebo effect to complex brain chemistry.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "deliberately" means intentionally or "on purpose," describing the researchers' proposal to purposefully utilize the placebo effect to improve therapeutic results.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author brings up autonomy and transparency to illustrate the ethical dilemmas and potential violations of informed consent that occur when a placebo is administered without a patient's full knowledge.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "this phenomenon" refers back to the placebo effect's ability to rival real medications mentioned just before location [C]. Furthermore, placing the sentence here provides a logical transition into the following paragraph, which begins exploring the biological "mechanisms" behind the effect.

2026-08-05 Diane Arbus Portraits

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "stark" describes portraits that are harsh, unadorned, or uncompromisingly blunt, which aligns with the meaning of "severe."

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that Sontag considered Arbus's gaze "predatory" and claimed she turned people into "spectacles of oddity," which strongly implies she viewed the photography as exploitive.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author uses this phrase to describe the perspective of writers who argue that Arbus was an empathetic artist, directly countering Susan Sontag's earlier negative criticism.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that Arbus's style has been interpreted positively by some as a method that "strips away artifice to expose deeper truths," which matches the idea of revealing an authentic reality.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The author concludes that Arbus's photographs "remain powerful precisely because they refuse to resolve these tensions," supporting the inference that the unresolved disagreements are a fundamental source of the artwork's impact.

2026-08-05 Glacier Climate Records

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Sentence B directly describes the physical mechanism of preservation, detailing how snow accumulating and compressing over centuries traps air bubbles to form atmospheric snapshots.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the phrase 'escalating impact', the word 'escalating' means growing or increasing in magnitude, referring to the rising influence of human activity on the climate.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：While the text indicates that ice cores contain physical and chemical markers of severe environmental events like volcanic eruptions and forest fires, it never states that these events destroy the ice layers.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author compares ice cores to tree rings as an analogy to help readers visualize how the ice forms in distinct layers that correspond to different chronological periods.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：Because the passage notes that melting glaciers threaten the loss of invaluable climate data and states that scientists are in a 'race against time,' it can be inferred that researchers must urgently collect these ice cores before they disappear.

2026-07-29 Ancient Mars Climate

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage first details the geologic evidence that liquid water once flowed on Mars, and then explores the "faint young Sun paradox," which presents a scientific difficulty regarding how early Mars could have been warm enough to sustain that water.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states in the second paragraph that crater counting "gives the relative age, and allows one to determine which surfaces are older and which are younger."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage describes a lower "luminosity" by immediately apposing it with the phrase "the Sun fainter," meaning that luminosity refers to the star's brightness.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The final sentence notes that the solution to the paradox "has not been entirely settled," which supports the inference that scientists still lack a definitive explanation.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The author lists features like river channels and valley networks specifically as "evidence of past flows" to provide concrete geologic examples proving that liquid water once existed on the Martian surface.

2026-07-29 Civic Education

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The inserted sentence directly builds upon the concept of "rights and responsibilities" introduced in the preceding sentence. Placing it at Location [A] provides a seamless transition by expanding on how this knowledge benefits citizens' participation in society.

2026-07-29 Climate Change and Corals

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly defines coral bleaching as a phenomenon caused by rising sea temperatures that results in weakened corals, making it a harmful effect of high temperatures.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text directly states that ocean acidification reduces the availability of calcium carbonate, which is a crucial component needed for coral skeletons.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of addressing the severe threats posed by climate change, "mitigate" means to lessen or "alleviate" those harmful impacts.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as potential solutions to develop coral species that are more resilient to temperature and acidification.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence describes additional consequences of "the absence of calcium carbonate," making it logically follow the sentences preceding location [B] that discuss reduced calcium carbonate availability and its impact on coral structures.

2026-07-29 Domestication of Maize

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The author contrasts a wild grass with "limited utility" against its later form as a "globally significant staple" to highlight the striking and remarkable nature of its transformation.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage notes that early cultivators selectively bred plants to develop "larger kernels." This supports the inference that the original wild teosinte must have had smaller kernels.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that the multiregional model suggests "subsequent hybridization with other species of the Zea genus across Central America contributed to maize's eventual diversity."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In this context, "subsequent" contrasts with "initial" domestication to describe events that happened afterward, making "later" the closest in meaning.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：According to the passage, the protracted domestication hypothesis highlights the possibility that "early foragers managed wild-growing teosinte long before fully domesticated maize emerged."

2026-07-29 Gestures in Acting

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The author uses the example of silent films, where actors "relied on exaggerated gestures," to support the paragraph's opening claim that gestures "have always been integral to acting."

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "overt" means explicit, obvious, or direct, contrasting with the "subtler" and "nuanced" gestures modern actors use to express inner conflict.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage notes that gestures in modern acting enhance realism, add layers of meaning, and complement spoken dialogue, but it contains no mention of gestures being particularly necessary for weaker actors.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that in modern theater, "authenticity is paramount" and "even the smallest gesture is deliberate," indicating that contemporary actors use gestures thoughtfully to achieve genuine emotion.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The text states that because a gesture might be "misinterpreted in another [culture] as offensive," actors must possess the skill to anticipate these differences and "adapt and modify their gestures to resonate with diverse audiences."

2026-07-29 Green Roof Benefits

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of managing stormwater and decreasing runoff, "minimizing" refers to reducing flooding risks to the lowest possible level. Therefore, "lowering" is the most accurate synonym.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that "conventional roofs absorb and radiate heat, increasing urban temperatures," demonstrating that traditional roof characteristics worsen the urban heat island problem.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explains that green roofs "keep buildings cooler by providing insulation and emitting moisture," which subsequently "reduces the need for heating... and cooling" to yield energy savings.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author introduces "vegetative layers" to elaborate on how green roofs support urban biodiversity, specifically by creating "habitats for insects and birds in cities."

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The transitional word "Additionally" introduces a second drawback (maintenance) that logically adds to the first drawback (high installation cost). Placing the sentence at location [C] groups these two challenges together right before "However" introduces the mitigating factor of city incentives.

2026-07-29 Polarized Light Applications

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, "invaluable" describes evidence that is highly valuable or "extremely useful" because it reveals material details that ordinary illumination cannot.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that living tissues alter the polarization of light, not that polarized light changes the internal structure of the cells. Options A, B, and D are explicitly mentioned as applications in paragraphs 1, 2, and 3.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage notes that polarized images "guide analysis by showing where tissue structure differs," but cautions that "those differences may have several causes." This implies the images highlight abnormal areas that require closer examination to determine the specific cause.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 4 explicitly states that if a pilot's polarized lenses conflict with electronic flight displays, "the screen may darken or disappear at certain angles," making the displays difficult to see.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The reference phrase "This limitation" logically points back to the caveat immediately preceding location [D], which notes that structural differences revealed in tissue "may have several causes."

2026-07-29 Spider Silk Medicine

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, "remarkable" means worthy of attention or striking, which matches "extraordinary" as it describes spider silk's impressive strength and elasticity.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：This sentence explicitly provides the definition of the term biocompatibility as "a material's ability to interact with the human body without causing adverse reactions."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage highlights the strength, elasticity, and biocompatibility of spider silk sutures, but it does not provide any information about their cost relative to traditional sutures.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：While the passage notes that spider silk dressings accelerate recovery, retain moisture, and enable localized drug delivery, it never claims that they are simple to prepare and apply.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence begins with "By contrast," comparing easy-to-manage silkworms to the territorial and cannibalistic spiders described in the preceding sentence. Therefore, it logically fits at location [■2] to directly complete this comparison.

2026-07-29 The Getty Kouros

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：对。表面化学变化符合长期埋藏，可能说明大理石具有古老来源。

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：对。“过渡时期”是支持者解释雕像混合风格为何仍可能真实的理由。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：对。雕像混合多个地区和时期的风格，过于杂糅，因此真实性受质疑。

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：对。文中明确说现代造假者能够让大理石看起来被人工老化。

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：对。科学和风格分析都无定论，所以雕像不典型且真伪仍未确定。

2026-07-25 Climate Geoengineering

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that Earth systems engineering and management (ESEM) "combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making," which supports the fact that it utilizes multiple disciplines.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text explains that SRM aims to "cool the planet" by reflecting sunlight (mitigating the heating effect of global warming), whereas CDR focuses on reducing "greenhouse gas concentrations" (addressing the actual cause of the warming).

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "feasibility" refers to the practicality or possibility of successfully executing an action, making "workability" the correct synonym when discussing experimental techniques.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage highlights "ethical and governance issues, such as who controls these interventions," which directly translates to ongoing questions about who bears the responsibility for implementing such changes.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the warning at location [C] that "unintended consequences may arise," providing a necessary precaution to assess long-term impacts before summarizing "these challenges" at location [D].

2026-07-25 Polarized Light Applications

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of providing crucial evidence about materials that ordinary illumination cannot reveal, "invaluable" means extremely useful or indispensable.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage notes that living tissues alter polarized light to reveal their structural organization, but it does not claim that polarized light changes the internal structure of the cells themselves.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage states that polarized light can "guide analysis by showing where tissue structure differs" even though it cannot pinpoint the exact cause, which logically supports the inference that it highlights specific areas requiring further investigation.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly mentions that if the filtering direction of polarized lenses conflicts with a flight display, "the screen may darken or disappear at certain angles."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This limitation" refers directly to the preceding sentence's warning that observed structural differences "may have several causes," making location [D] the logical place to conclude that supplementary evidence is needed.

2026-07-25 Psychology Of Laughter

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：对。笑会释放改善情绪和韧性的内啡肽，这构成其进化优势的生物证据。

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：对。社交场合中笑声传播并强化共同身份，说明共享体验能加强社会联结。

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：对。straightforward 在此表示含义并非总是清楚直接，对应 clear。

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：对。紧张时的笑声可能掩盖真实情绪，观察者会误以为是在开心。

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：对。全文同时讨论生物机制与社会情境，强调笑的意义由两者共同决定。

2026-07-25 The Flynn Effect

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, the word "consistent" refers to something that is steady or regular, describing the continuous and stable increase of average IQ scores by about three points per decade.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage lists nutrition, healthcare, cognitive demands of modern life, and technology as potential contributing factors, but it never mentions parental care.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly notes that some researchers argue the rise in IQ scores reflects "better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author notes the slowing down or reversing of the Flynn Effect specifically to show that it challenges "the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence offers an explanation for a "downturn," which directly refers back to the "slowing down or even reversing" of the Flynn Effect mentioned in the sentence immediately preceding Location D.

2026-07-22 Adaptive Optics Revolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage states that adaptive optics, developed in the late 1980s, counteracts atmospheric distortion to enable observations with "exceptional clarity." This implies that prior to its development, atmospheric distortion caused the images from ground-based telescopes to be unclear.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly states that proponents argue "the potential discoveries outweigh environmental concerns." This demonstrates their belief that the scientific usefulness of the technology is more significant than its negative environmental drawbacks.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the phrase "environmental stewardship," the word "stewardship" refers to the responsible management or supervision of resources.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The author introduces algorithm optimization in the context of researchers finding ways to balance scientific advancement with environmental concerns. This optimization reduces computations to directly address and lower the high energy consumption of the observatories.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence uses the phrase "this phenomenon," which requires a prior antecedent. Placing it at [▪2] perfectly connects it to the preceding sentence's description of the "shimmering effect that distorts" light waves, using heat waves as a familiar comparison.

2026-07-22 Biofertilizer Dynamics

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of nutrients remaining available for plant "uptake," the word refers to the process by which plants take in or absorb these nutrients from the soil.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that "Biofertilizers use living microorganisms to improve soil fertility," indicating that the presence of these microorganisms is a key difference from traditional fertilizers.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage states that microorganisms in biofertilizers "enhance aeration" by binding soil particles, which directly improves the movement of air through the soil.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The last paragraph mentions that "the regulatory landscape for biofertilizers is still developing, affecting their market presence," which implies that governmental rules influence their use and availability.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The last paragraph primarily discusses "hurdles" such as farmer skepticism, concerns about cost and availability, and developing regulatory landscapes, all of which are barriers to the adoption of biofertilizers.

2026-07-22 Building Data Science

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage describes buildings as "Once static structures," which then become "dynamic systems" due to data science, indicating that "static" means unchanging or not moving, in contrast to dynamic.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that building data science "enables architects and planners to make informed decisions" but does not mention any requirement for special training in data analysis for architects.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage states, "Monitoring space usage may conflict, however, with occupants' privacy concerns and dislike of being tracked without their consent," identifying privacy concerns as a drawback of sensor use.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author mentions "optimizing the layouts of hospitals for better patient flow or using occupancy data to redesign underutilized office spaces" as applications that exemplify how building data science can improve urban infrastructure.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage states that studies show buildings using these systems can "reduce energy consumption by up to 30 percent, making them attractive for sustainable development," which directly relates to reducing environmental impact.

2026-07-22 Courtroom Video Evidence

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The first sentence states that video evidence has become integral to the criminal justice system due to technological advances, and the second sentence then provides specific examples of these advances: body cameras, security cameras, and smartphones, thereby illustrating the claim made in the first sentence.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that a "single camera angle might fail to capture what occurs just outside the frame, leading observers to misinterpret what they see," directly suggesting that viewers may miss critical actions due to video framing.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author explains that "video footage has no way of conveying interpersonal and emotional context: A person's actions might appear antagonistic even if the person was acting in self-defense," which indicates that viewers might incorrectly infer motivations from observed actions without full context.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage states that legal experts emphasize the role of video evidence because "Jurors... might dismiss eyewitness testimonies as unreliable or perceive oral accounts as inconsistent, while videos show events more directly," suggesting jurors trust videos more than witness testimony.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The word "cautiously" refers to evaluating video evidence with care, implying that jurors should be careful and thoughtful in their assessment, which is best captured by "carefully".

2026-07-22 Gravitational Physics Applications

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage attributes predictions that were 'later confirmed by observation' to Einstein's theory of general relativity, not to Newton's law of universal gravitation, making this choice the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author introduces gravitational lensing as an example of a phenomenon that 'Newton's model could not' explain, illustrating how Einstein's theory accounted for things that Newton's could not.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of microgravity environments like the International Space Station, 'minimized' means that the effects of gravity are significantly reduced or brought to a very low level.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that mapping atomic structure is crucial because it allows scientists to 'develop medications that precisely target disease-related proteins.'

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence begins with 'For instance' and describes crystals growing 'unevenly.' This logically follows the sentence before [■2], which introduces the idea that 'gravity interferes with the uniform growth of crystals.'

2026-07-22 Medieval Town Origins

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces the rise of medieval towns and primarily focuses on detailing and evaluating three basic historical theories proposed to explain their origins.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that the new class of artisans and merchants "came from the peasantry" and were often "landless younger sons of large families."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of merchants moving "toward favorable spots" for long-distance trade, the word "gravitated" means that they were naturally drawn to those advantageous locations.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that Pirenne's interpretation accurately describes certain Flemish towns but "does not fit the course of development in the Italian cities or in such centers as London," allowing the inference that his theory only partially explains urban development.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The author references monasteries and cathedrals directly after introducing a "third explanation," using them to illustrate how the economic demands of religious establishments spurred the development of nearby towns.

2026-07-22 Passage - Coastal Erosion Challenges

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of strong storms worsening the problem of coastal erosion, the word "exacerbate" means to intensify or "increase" its severity.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author introduces Bangladesh and the Netherlands to directly illustrate the claim that managing erosion is "not only an environmental issue but also an economic and social one."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that while beach nourishment offers short-term benefits, "frequent replenishment is required," demonstrating the need for an ongoing commitment to maintain its advantages.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage contrasts "more sustainable" natural approaches with man-made solid structures that can "unintentionally accelerate erosion in nearby areas," supporting the inference that natural approaches avoid these unintended harms to surrounding shorelines.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：While the passage mentions that coastal erosion itself threatens transportation, it never states that erosion-control measures disrupt transportation, making this the unsupported exception.

2026-07-22 Passage - Person-Centered Therapy

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, the "prevailing" view refers to the most common or "dominant" perspective held by professionals at the time.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：While the passage notes that Rogers viewed therapy as a collaborative interaction where the patient plays a key role in personal growth, it never suggests that patients were expected to provide their own diagnostic expertise, making this the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author lists "paraphrasing, summarizing, and clarifying" immediately following the word "reflection" in order to define and illustrate that specific therapeutic technique.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage contrasts Rogers' new approach, which emphasized empathy and a nonjudgmental environment, with earlier clinical models that focused strictly on therapists diagnosing issues and prescribing treatments, implying that empathy was not previously central to therapy.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：This sentence explicitly identifies the intended results of Rogers' approach, stating that it enables individuals to "gain the self-awareness and self-acceptance needed to grow personally and resolve issues."

2026-07-22 Passage - Traffic Psychology

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage discusses personality traits, social influences, and environmental conditions as factors influencing road safety. It does not mention vehicle maintenance as a factor.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of a 'vigilant passenger,' the word 'vigilant' means being watchful or attentive, as such a passenger can 'counteract impulsive tendencies and promote safer driving.'

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states that young drivers may engage in riskier maneuvers with peers, but also that 'the presence of a vigilant passenger—such as a parent or responsible friend—can counteract impulsive tendencies and promote safer driving,' indicating a positive influence that is not universal.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage states, 'Some researchers argue that focusing too heavily on personality overlooks structural factors like road design or traffic law enforcement, which may exert a stronger influence on safety outcomes,' indicating that the importance of structural factors is a subject of debate among researchers.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The sentence 'These findings suggest that drivers' behavior is not solely rooted in personality' best fits at [■4] because it summarizes the preceding points that show how individual traits interact with environmental cues, which is a nuanced perspective beyond just personality.

2026-07-22 Roman Political Legacy

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, "fostered" means encouraged or promoted the development of a condition, as the text describes decentralization causing chronic instability.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 introduces a "widely accepted hypothesis" that the loss of Roman administrative structures caused power to decentralize into a mosaic of local kingdoms.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The Carolingian Renaissance is introduced with "For instance" to provide evidence that localized rule following the empire's fall could still lead to cultural and intellectual flourishing.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：While the passage states that the Byzantine Empire retained Roman governance in the East, it never mentions an expansion into Western Europe. The other choices are explicitly cited in the text as consequences of the empire's collapse.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The phrase "Such developments" logically connects back to the preceding sentence about monastic communities preserving classical knowledge and fostering educational continuity, making [▪1] the correct insertion point.

2026-07-18 Origins Of Agriculture

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces the historical transition to farming and then outlines multiple theories for this shift, including environmental pressures, cultural evolution, and population density.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that during previous glaciations, "people moved in response to environmental changes rather than staying put and adapting to a new ecosystem."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The word "hospitable" generally describes a welcoming environment; in the context of an "environmental squeeze" on early people, less hospitable conditions are those that are less favorable for survival.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that people originally handled population growth by moving, and they developed intensive practices like agriculture only "once there was no more productive territory to colonize." This supports the inference that farming became a necessity only when geographic expansion was no longer an option.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The author lists Mesopotamia, northern China, and Mesoamerica to show that, regardless of the exact underlying cause, the transition to agriculture occurred across multiple distinct geographic regions rather than in just one isolated area.

2026-07-18 Passage - Circadian Rhythm Disruption

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The author introduces the "higher prevalence of metabolic disorders" as an additional negative consequence linked to circadian misalignment, which is caused by the increased artificial light of urban environments.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly connects the potential for informing human therapies to the fact that nocturnal animals have evolved mechanisms "for thriving in conditions that disrupt human circadian rhythms."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text states that experiments have demonstrated disrupted rhythms "can be realigned by the simulation of natural light cycles," implying that it successfully restores sleep patterns for many, even if it is "not universally effective."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 2 evaluates the specific, focused approach of manipulating light exposure to reset clocks, whereas paragraph 3 expands on broader challenges like temperature and diet, and points to comprehensive solutions like therapeutic drugs.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：In the context of exploring therapeutic drugs to treat disruptions to rhythmic cycles, the word "rectify" means to correct, fix, or remedy, which is closest in meaning to relieving those disruptions.

2026-07-18 Passage - Decision-Making in Groups

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage contrasts "well-structured environments" with a "failure of leadership" to demonstrate that the subtle pressure to conform exists even when leadership or facilitation is strong.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage states that groups with "varied backgrounds and viewpoints are less prone to groupthink," meaning they are less likely to withhold dissenting opinions.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：In the context of dealing with "hidden concerns," the word "surface" means to bring to light or make known, which is closest in meaning to "identify."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The text states that successfully balancing unity with "intellectual rigor" depends on "deliberate strategies," showing that this rigor requires intentional efforts rather than emerging automatically.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage cites fear of conflict, pressure to conform, and a lack of mechanisms for constructive disagreement as factors contributing to groupthink, but it never mentions a lack of experience in decision-making.

2026-07-18 Social Network Influence

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：This sentence provides a specific illustration of how chatting with a group of friends (social network dynamics) can cause a person to gradually adopt similar views (affecting personal beliefs).

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that instead of just drawing connection diagrams, computational sociology researchers now look closely at "how frequent interactions shape behavior."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the phrase "incredibly complex," the word "incredibly" functions as an intensifier that is synonymous with "extremely."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The text points out that predicting human behavior is complex because it is hard to understand "how all these subtle factors interact," specifically referring to culture, social norms, and personal experiences.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence's contrast between "bottom up" and "top down" influence perfectly bridges the preceding sentence about powerful people lacking the biggest impact and the following sentence regarding the power of everyday conversations.

2026-07-16 Passage - Thermoelectricity

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that thermoelectricity converts "waste heat into usable electrical energy" and lists "industrial exhaust or even body heat" as sources, allowing the inference that waste heat is an otherwise unused byproduct of these activities.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "ensuing" refers to the temperature difference that is "resulting" from the process of heating one side of the device and cooling the other.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The automotive industry is discussed to demonstrate how recovering heat from exhaust to power electronics serves as a practical, successful application of thermoelectric technology.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly identifies rare materials, toxic elements, and relatively low electricity yields as drawbacks, but it never mentions the cost of converting existing infrastructure.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence provides specific percentages comparing the energy conversion rates of different technologies, which directly supports and logically follows the statement before [■3] that thermoelectric electricity production is "relatively low compared to other energy technologies."

2026-07-16 Power Of Placebos

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage states that a patient's condition can improve simply because they believe they are receiving effective treatment, an effect that can sometimes rival the results of real medications.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 2 explains that anticipating positive effects from a placebo can cause the brain to release chemicals such as endorphins, leading to genuine physiological changes.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of researchers proposing to use the placebo effect "deliberately" to enhance therapy outcomes, the word means intentionally or "on purpose."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author mentions autonomy and transparency to illustrate the ethical concerns and potential violations of informed consent that arise from deceiving patients with placebos.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The insertion best fits at [■3] because "this phenomenon" refers back to the placebo effect described in the first paragraph, and it smoothly transitions into the next paragraph's discussion of the brain mechanisms behind it.

2026-07-08 Ancient Written Records

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explores how written historical records answer important social questions for archaeologists, while also cautioning against the biases and limitations caused by preservation accidents and literal interpretations.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that the clay tablets of Mycenaean Greece were, without exception, primarily used as records of commercial transactions at the palaces.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of texts being "now lost to us" because of the materials they were written on, "perishable" refers to substances that decay or do not last long, making "impermanent" the closest meaning.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Because the author notes that writing had specific functions in early societies and that "accidents of preservation" dictate what survives, we can infer that the remaining records are a direct reflection of the durable materials chosen for specific functional purposes.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The author introduces the idea of lost perishable materials to illustrate that "accidents of preservation" may limit our understanding, implying that the surviving commercial clay tablets do not represent the entirety of Mycenaean writing.

2026-07-08 Basic Income Debate

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that UBI is "gaining attention worldwide" and has been tested in limited pilot programs, supporting the idea that it is an interesting concept tried only on a small scale.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In this context, an "unconditional" sum of money means that the funds are given to citizens without them having to meet any specific obligations or requirements.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that a two-year pilot program in Finland resulted in a "modest increase in employment."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage discusses concerns regarding UBI's cost to public finances, its negative impact on economic productivity, and its potential effect on prices, but it never mentions international trade.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage explains that because pilot programs were "limited in scale," they did not inject enough money into the economy to meaningfully test UBI's true effect on inflation.

2026-07-05 Floating Wind Turbines

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, to "harness" means to utilize or exploit natural resources, such as wind, in order to generate power.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that floating wind turbines are anchored in a way that allows "placement in deeper waters," giving them access to wind resources that traditional, fixed turbines cannot reach.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author mentions "buoyancy principles" immediately after introducing the "unique challenges" of engineering floating turbines, using it to explain why their design and maintenance are so complex.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage states that harsh marine conditions accelerate wear and tear, but follows this by noting that "Research continues to explore solutions" and that experts are investigating "materials and designs to enhance durability." This supports the inference that scientists are actively working to mitigate this degradation.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence begins with "Others assess," which creates a direct structural and logical parallel to "Some experts are investigating" in the preceding sentence. Placing it at [C] logically groups the examples of ongoing research before the concluding summary.

2026-07-04 Computational Fluid Dynamics

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：This sentence explicitly describes the mechanism behind computational fluid dynamics, noting that it 'uses algorithms to simulate complex fluid interactions.'

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：Choice D is the unsupported exception because while the passage states CFD offers insights previously limited to physical models like wind tunnels, it never claims CFD has entirely replaced physical experimentation.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author introduces 'improved turbine placement' immediately after stating that CFD is invaluable to renewable energy, serving as a concrete example of its application in that field.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：In this context, 'alleviate' means to reduce or lessen. The passage suggests that AI can help decrease the heavy computational demands that otherwise limit the use of CFD.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage states that the reliability of these models in 'accurately reflecting physical phenomena is still a topic of ongoing research.' From this direct statement, it can be inferred that they currently face ongoing challenges in simulating real-world physical systems without yielding misleading results.

2026-07-04 Consumer Rationality Myth

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage concludes by asserting that acknowledging consumer irrationality and psychological biases paves the way for more effective approaches to understanding and predicting market dynamics.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In the phrase describing consumers having access to information, the word "armed" metaphorically means being provided or "equipped" with the necessary tools to make decisions.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage states that traditional economic models assumed near-perfect rationality; it was only recent behavioral economics research that introduced psychological biases like anchoring to challenge those traditional models.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly defines the anchoring bias as a tendency that causes consumers to "rely too heavily on the first piece of information they come across," which directly supports the idea of clinging to initial impressions.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Kahneman and Thaler are explicitly introduced as scholars whose behavioral economics studies have "put this idealized vision of the rational consumer into doubt," demonstrating that they challenged long-held economic assumptions.

2026-07-04 Green Roof Benefits

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of decreasing runoff and preventing flooding, the word "minimizing" refers to reducing something to the smallest possible amount or degree, making "lowering" the exact equivalent.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that "conventional roofs absorb and radiate heat, increasing urban temperatures," which indicates that traditional roof designs contribute directly to the urban heat island effect.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text explains that green roofs lead to energy savings because the soil and plants provide natural insulation and emit moisture, which reduces the need for indoor heating and cooling.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author introduces "vegetative layers" to explain how green roofs create microhabitats for insects and birds, illustrating exactly how these roofs support urban biodiversity.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The transition word "Additionally" signals the introduction of a second drawback (maintenance), which logically follows the first drawback about high installation costs at location C, just before the passage mentions incentives to offset such burdens.

2026-07-04 Guardians Of Time

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：正确。第一段说过去是损坏显现后再修，并对照当代把劣化当可管理风险而非必然；可推知过去默认物件会随时间劣化。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：正确。calibrate light 在语境中是调节/校准光线强度，adjust 最贴近。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：正确。quietly successful 后接“更少侵入性处理、原表面得以保存”，并与后文“无事的岁月”呼应：成功不易被常人察觉。

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：正确。第二段提到除湿、防护涂料、隔离盐分暴露以阻止锈蚀扩散，可推知湿气/盐分相关因素是劣化关键来源。

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：正确。成功被定义为“无事的岁月”，而非戏剧性抢救；言下之意，需要戏剧性抢救说明预防性守护不足。

2026-07-04 Kintsugi Art Repair

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 2 directly states that kintsugi is associated with "wabi-sabi, an aesthetic outlook that regards imperfection, age, and transience as natural conditions."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 3 notes that the visibly altered object acts as a "metaphor for resilience," demonstrating that "recovery need not erase the event that made recovery necessary."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author contrasts "the decorative application of gold paint" with authentic kintsugi, which "demands material knowledge, patience, and repeated curing," to emphasize the rigor and complexity of the true craft.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of an aesthetic that accepts age and change as natural, "transience" means the fleeting or temporary nature of existence.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "That metaphorical appeal" refers back to the discussion of resilience and renewal in paragraph 3, while "the demanding material process discussed next" introduces the physical requirements of traditional kintsugi detailed in paragraph 4, making Location D the perfect transitional placement.

2026-06-27 Class Size Effects

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that smaller classes can enhance student learning by "reducing classroom disruptions," supporting the idea that fewer students leads to decreased disruptions.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author uses this phrase to qualify the previous sentence, pointing out the limitation that the academic improvements from smaller classes are actually "modest" and come with high financial costs.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that evidence about class size effects "remains incomplete" because most investigations focus too narrowly on the academic outcomes discussed in paragraph 1.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that reducing class size causes financial costs (A), allows for more individualized attention (B), and improves academic performance (D), but it never mentions the effect on teachers' job satisfaction.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：In this context, "nuanced" means "refined" or carefully targeted, referring to an approach that strategically lowers class sizes only in specific situations, such as early education or high-poverty areas, rather than a broad, general reduction.

2026-06-27 Complex Vision System

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The author introduces sudden motion and still objects with the transition "For example" to illustrate the preceding claim that visual pathways prioritize elements necessary for survival.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The pronoun "its" refers back to the primary subject of the paragraph, "the blind spot," which is a region most people are unaware exists in their visual field.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The word "simultaneously" means happening at the same time, describing how the visual system suppresses red or blue wavelengths at the exact moment it amplifies green ones.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Choice D is the unsupported exception because the passage explicitly states that heightened sensitivity reduces tolerance for variation, which is "why you might overlook a green object that falls under shadow."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Following the first paragraph's introduction to the complex processes of vision, paragraph 2 provides one example by explaining how the brain compensates for the blind spot, and paragraph 3 introduces another example by discussing the role of attention.

2026-06-27 Discrete Geometry Structures

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The selected sentence explicitly uses the word 'Unlike' to contrast 'continuous geometry,' which deals with smooth shapes, against 'discrete geometry,' which focuses on finite or countable objects.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author mentions the everyday example of 'fitting oranges into boxes' to acknowledge that packing problems might initially seem like a simple exercise before detailing their complex, real-world applications.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that in fields like computer-chip design and data storage, researchers have 'discovered intriguing connections between the arrangement of shapes and space utilization.'

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In this context, 'belie' means to conceal or give a false impression of, indicating that the highly abstract nature of the field hides its actual practical value.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides specific examples ('mosaic art and floor designs') to illustrate the preceding sentence's claim that tiling patterns have influenced 'architectural designs and artworks.' Placing it at location D ensures strong logical cohesion by immediately following the concept it exemplifies.

2026-06-27 Green Chemistry Innovations

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The preceding sentence introduces "Green chemistry" as "an area of study," so the phrase "This field" refers back to green chemistry as the primary subject being discussed.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In this context, a "breakthrough" refers to a major achievement or positive development, which matches the meaning of "advancement." Furthermore, the passage explicitly uses "Another advancement" to describe a parallel innovation later in the paragraph.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage contrasts the two materials by stating that traditional petroleum plastics "can take centuries to decompose," whereas biodegradable corn starch plastics "can break down in months."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly states that MOFs can be used to degrade pollutants, "which can aid in water and air purification."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that water reduces the need for toxic solvents, creates more sustainable processes, and can increase reaction speed. However, it does not mention using water as a solvent to produce catalysts, making this the unsupported exception.

2026-06-27 Whale Strandings

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：对。下文说科学家几十年仍 little is understood，说明 perplexing 取“令人困惑/费解”义，与 puzzling 最近。

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：对。第一段写 several theories suggest possible reasons，同时又说 little is understood；末段也说 reasons are complex，说明有多种假说但无定论。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：对。第一段写 disruptions to Earth's magnetic field may interfere with marine mammals' navigational abilities，直接支持导航可能对磁场波动敏感。

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：对（EXCEPT）。原文说鲸鱼 travel in pods，声呐会让它们迷失并可能把同伴引向岸边，并未说声呐阻止结群。

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：对。critical areas 出现在“要求船只降低音量或避开关键区域”的监管措施里，用来举例说明监管如何降低对鲸鱼的威胁。

2026-06-23 Gene Editing Ethics

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that gene editing allows scientists to enhance crop traits "without introducing foreign DNA," which distinguishes it from traditional genetic modification.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author introduces soybeans engineered to produce healthier oil (reduced saturated fat and increased oleic acid) as a specific example of how gene editing can be used to improve a crop's nutritional content.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text mentions reduced resilience to environmental stress (decreased ability to survive harsh conditions) and vulnerability to pests and diseases, but it does not mention harm to the wider environment, making this the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In the context of conducting comprehensive testing to "mitigate" risks before commercial release, the word means to "lessen" or reduce the severity of those risks.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a historical example (the Irish Potato Famine) of the dangers of genetic uniformity, which directly illustrates the claim in the preceding sentence that diminished genetic diversity makes crops more vulnerable to pests and diseases. Therefore, it fits perfectly at [C].

2026-06-23 Thermoelectricity Energy

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that thermoelectric materials convert "waste heat into usable electrical energy" and provides examples like "industrial exhaust or even body heat," supporting the inference that waste heat is an otherwise unused byproduct of these processes.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, the "ensuing" temperature difference refers to the difference that occurs as a result of heating one side and cooling the other, meaning "resulting."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The automotive industry is cited to show how thermoelectric generators have been successfully integrated into hybrid and electric vehicles to recover exhaust heat and improve efficiency.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage identifies drawbacks such as reliance on rare elements, environmental harm, and relatively low electricity production, but it never mentions the cost of converting existing infrastructure as a drawback.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides specific efficiency percentages that directly illustrate and support the claim made just before [C] that thermoelectric electricity production is "relatively low compared to other energy technologies."

2026-06-22 Bird Migration Patterns

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly connects the evolution and widespread adoption of bird migration to the Ice Age, a period when average temperatures were frigid, meaning the climate was much colder than today.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The text traces a food chain where sunlight increases algae, which feeds zooplankton, which in turn feeds the terns' prey, explaining why the terns' migration to polar summers guarantees abundant food.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage states that Arctic terns undertake the longest migrations (B), live in Earth's north and south polar regions (C), and eat small marine animals (D), but it never mentions them taking different migration routes based on resource availability.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author introduces rock ptarmigans immediately after noting that "Not all birds migrate" to provide an example of a sedentary species whose stationary winter adaptation contrasts with the long flights of migratory birds like the Arctic tern.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：In the context of hiding in snow burrows to avoid flying to warmer climates, the word "shelter" means to take protection from the harsh winter environment.

2026-06-22 Gravitational Physics Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage attributes later-confirmed predictions, such as black holes and gravitational waves, to Einstein's theory of general relativity rather than Newton's law. Therefore, choice D is the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author cites gravitational lensing as an example of a phenomenon that Einstein's theory could explain but Newton's could not, illustrating why Einstein's model was superior.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of a microgravity environment where there is very little gravity, "minimized" means that gravitational effects are significantly decreased or "reduced."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that mapping the atomic structure of crystals is crucial because it allows scientists to "develop medications that precisely target disease-related proteins."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence begins with "For instance" and describes how settling components cause shape distortions, providing a specific example of the preceding sentence's claim that gravity interferes with uniform crystal growth. Inserting it at [B] maintains this logical flow before the text shifts to microgravity environments.

2026-06-20 Microseisms Earth Vibrations

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "subtle" describes vibrations that are faint or mild. This is confirmed later in the text when the author notes that these "mild signals are easily masked by other seismic noises."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that microseisms are caused by colliding ocean waves and are strongest during storms when waves are more powerful. This supports the logical inference that the stronger vibrations are the result of these more powerful, vigorously colliding waves.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The author provides "variations in rock density and the presence of faults or fractures" as specific examples of the "important information" and "details" about the Earth's interior that microseisms can reveal.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly states that microseisms are used in oil and gas exploration to "identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage indicates that because microseisms are "mild signals" that are challenging to study, researchers employ these specific data analysis techniques to accurately interpret them.

2026-06-20 Polarized Light Applications

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, "invaluable" means extremely useful or indispensable, as polarized light provides critical insights into the hidden properties of materials that normal light cannot reveal.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：While the passage mentions that polarized light reduces glare (Choice A), reveals crystal properties (Choice B), and uncovers cellular organization (Choice D), it never states that it is used to actually alter the physical structure of cells.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text states that polarized light helps identify amyloid plaques, which are an indication of Alzheimer's disease, supporting the inference that it can assist doctors in diagnosing medical conditions.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that pilots avoid polarized lenses because they can obscure critical visual cues, specifically pointing out that they can interfere with seeing instrument readings.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence serves as a logical transition by shifting the focus from the inorganic world, such as the crystals discussed in the first paragraph, to the organic applications introduced in the paragraph beginning "In biology."

2026-06-20 Shifting Playwriting Art

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage focuses on how innovative techniques, such as nonlinear narratives and breaking the fourth wall, have transformed both theatrical storytelling and how audiences engage with performances.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that in Mother Courage characters directly address the audience, whereas Sleep No More takes this further by allowing viewers to physically move through the performance space as active participants.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly introduces a "broader hypothesis" regarding how the restructuring of narrative and audience dynamics creates meaning, thereby offering a conjecture about the significance of these new techniques.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In the context of the passage, to "evoke" means to bring forth or produce new emotional and intellectual responses from the audience.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly discusses presenting events out of order, characters addressing the audience, and viewers moving through the space, but it never mentions playwrights acting in the performance, making this the unsupported exception.

KPO 13 - Ocean Acidification Impacts

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states in paragraph 3 that acidic water makes it difficult for corals to maintain their calcium carbonate skeletons, leading to "weakened structures and increased vulnerability to erosion and breakage."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 4 explicitly states that mollusks "struggle to develop their shells in acidic conditions," which negatively affects their survival rates.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 introduces the general impacts of ocean acidification on shell-building marine life, and paragraph 3 builds upon this introduction by detailing the specific negative effects on coral reefs.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：In the final paragraph, "researching adaptive strategies for marine life" is listed alongside reducing emissions and protecting areas as part of the broader "efforts to mitigate ocean acidification," illustrating a potential solution for affected organisms.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage structurally begins by defining the chemical causes of ocean acidification, then details its specific impacts on corals, mollusks, and plankton, and finally concludes by outlining potential mitigation efforts.

TPO1 - Agricultural Economics Shifts

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of using technology to positively affect crop yields, the word "enhance" means to improve or increase.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that organic farming responds to a preference for sustainable products by avoiding synthetic chemicals and focusing on biological pest control and composting.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text notes that nations depend on global trade to meet domestic needs, but this interdependency creates economic vulnerability when international supply chains are disrupted.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author cites political instability and natural disasters as examples of events that disrupt global supply chains, illustrating how relying on international trade can lead to economic vulnerability.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：High technological costs, threats to food security from lower outputs, and risks from global market fluctuations are all explicitly cited as challenges in the final paragraph. Environmental problems are the exception because the passage notes that practices like organic farming actually provide environmental benefits.

TPO1 - Power Of Music

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of reducing stress and improving health, the word "alleviate" means to relieve or make pain less severe, which is synonymous with "ease."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that neurotransmitters like dopamine and serotonin are released when listening to music, providing the biological mechanism for how music regulates pleasure and mood.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly connects upbeat workout playlists to the fact that "fast-paced music can energize us."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text directly states that in the context of social interactions, music "can strengthen bonds," meaning it makes the connections between people more powerful.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The author provides the examples of chanting and singing in protests and rallies to illustrate how music can "influence social movements" by motivating and unifying participants.

TPO2 - Cognitive Mapping Process

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly defines cognitive mapping as the mental process by which individuals process information about their spatial environment.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "crucial" means significant or highly important, emphasizing the vital function the hippocampus serves in the brain's mapping process.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The second paragraph states that the hippocampus becomes highly active when people navigate through unfamiliar environments, indicating its function in new surroundings.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The third paragraph notes that cognitive maps are not static; rather, they are dynamic and evolve by incorporating new experiences and information.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：Beginning with the transition word "Moreover," the third paragraph introduces a new characteristic of cognitive mapping by explaining its dynamic ability to evolve over time.

TPO2 - Nineteenth Century Urbanization

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of industrialization drawing people to cities for work, "proliferation" refers to the rapid growth or increase in the number of factories.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage states that industrialization drew people away from rural areas to cities, directly supporting the conclusion that rural populations decreased as a result.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author uses these diseases as specific examples to illustrate the severe health challenges caused by substandard housing and poor sanitation in overcrowded urban areas.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly notes that despite various challenges, urbanization "brought significant advancements in public transportation."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 2 describes the difficult living conditions and rapid physical expansion of cities, while Paragraph 3 explains the subsequent social and cultural changes, such as a new middle class advocating to reform those very conditions.

TPO2 - Vibrio Bacteria Risks

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "prevalent" describes how the bacteria thrive and are commonly found across tropical and subtropical regions, which matches the meaning of "widespread".

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that infections range "from mild gastroenteritis to severe wound infections," which directly contradicts the claim that all species cause severe infections, making this choice the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that "one of the most concerning aspects" of the bacteria is that some strains are developing a resistance to commonly used antibiotics.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author introduces climate change to explain how rising sea temperatures and altering salinity levels have caused these bacterial infections to multiply and spread to "regions previously unaffected."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：This sentence explicitly names "rising sea temperatures and changing salinity levels" as the specific environmental conditions causing the bacteria to multiply.

TPO3 - Indigenous Cultural Adaptation

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states in the second paragraph that agroforestry "helps maintain soil fertility and supports biodiversity, providing habitats for various species."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：According to the second paragraph, adopting agroforestry allows communities to remain in one location for longer periods, directly aiding in "preserving traditional knowledge tied to specific locations."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：In this context, "resilience" refers to the indigenous communities' ability to withstand adversity and adapt to new agricultural challenges, which is closest in meaning to "toughness."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The author notes that "modern tools improve yields and reduce labor" in order to explain the practical reasons why agroforestry has become a viable economic alternative.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 3 outlines the economic benefits and factors encouraging the shift to agroforestry, whereas paragraph 4 introduces the educational and cultural challenges that complicate this transition.

TPO3 - Prehistoric Cave Art

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of artworks presenting animals, human figures, and abstract symbols, the word 'depict' means to visually represent or show them.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that the Lascaux Cave in France and the Altamira Cave in Spain 'are among the most famous sites' for prehistoric cave art.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage mentions that cave art is found 'across Europe, Asia, and Africa,' but it does not state that it is found mostly in Europe, making this choice the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 2 details theories about why the art was made, such as for hunting rituals or religious significance, while paragraph 3 explains the tools and natural pigments used to create it.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The author explicitly states that 'The placement of the art in hard-to-reach areas suggests creating these images was a deliberate act.'

TPO4 - Bioluminescent Organisms

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of producing light, "emission" refers to the act of sending out or discharging, which closely matches the meaning of "release".

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that "Fireflies use bioluminescence to communicate, facilitating mating and deterring predators."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that "The exact mechanisms of bioluminescence are still not fully understood," making the claim that it is fully understood the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：While the text directly describes the ghost fungus, it can be logically inferred that the paragraph's structural purpose is to provide a specific example of bioluminescence occurring in non-animal organisms.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：Medical imaging is cited as an example of the "new technologies" that scientists study bioluminescent proteins to develop, illustrating a potential practical application of this research.

TPO4 - Understanding Risk Perception

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage states that people often fear flying because of a mental shortcut called the availability heuristic, in which "memorable events, such as incidents involving planes, dominate our thoughts."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In the context of misjudging risks as the exact opposite of "underestimating" them, "exaggerating" means overstating or expanding their perceived magnitude.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly notes that cultural factors shape risk perception by forming societal attitudes, with some societies embracing risk-taking while others prioritize safety and caution.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 2 explores how cultural factors and economic backgrounds shape attitudes toward risk, whereas paragraph 3 introduces media coverage as an additional, separate influence that alters risk perception.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states that public campaigns and education counteract distorted, media-driven perceptions of risk by "providing balanced information."

TPO5 - Stealth Technology Advancements

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that the complexity and cost of stealth technology limit its availability to only a few countries, which directly contradicts the claim in the exception that it is affordable for many countries.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the F-117 Nighthawk, developed in the 1970s, was the first operational stealth aircraft.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author mentions submarines immediately after stating that stealth technology extends beyond aircraft to provide an example of how the technology is utilized in other types of military vehicles.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：In the context of future military applications, "potentially" means "possibly," indicating that ongoing research could allow its usage to expand.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The third paragraph highlights the high cost and complexity of stealth technology, along with concerns about an escalating arms race and ethical implications, outlining the negative consequences and drawbacks of these advancements.

TPO6 - Fungi In Ecosystems

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that mycorrhizal fungi extend the root systems of plants, which allows the plants to access water and nutrients more efficiently.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In the context of the passage, "indispensable" means absolutely necessary or "essential" for maintaining healthy ecosystems.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage states that fungi decompose organic matter, release nitrogen and phosphorus, and form symbiotic relationships with roots, but explicitly notes that "fungi do not photosynthesize" to produce their own food, making it the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text states that understanding the diverse roles of fungi helps scientists leverage their benefits for environmental sustainability, supporting the inference that this diversity is crucial for the ongoing health of the environment.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：While the passage directly states that mycorrhizal fungi extend root systems to allow plants to "access water and nutrients more efficiently," this naturally supports the broader inference that these fungi actively help plants absorb nutrients.

TPO6 - Renewable Energy Sources

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly states that the environmental benefits of renewable energy technologies include "reduced greenhouse gas emissions."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The second paragraph identifies the intermittency of solar and wind energy as a major challenge, noting that their production "can be inconsistent depending on weather conditions."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The third paragraph notes that researchers are addressing the challenges of renewable energy by "developing more efficient solar panels and energy storage systems."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of utilizing non-renewable resources for power, "reliance" refers to a "dependence" on those fossil fuels to meet energy needs.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The author introduces "recent innovations" in the third paragraph to demonstrate how researchers and companies are actively "addressing these issues," which refers to finding solutions for the previously mentioned challenges of intermittency and cost.

2026-06-15 Free Will Debate

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states in the first sentence that the core of the free will debate is whether our decisions are independent or shaped by factors beyond our control.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author directly notes that influences like genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits are what suggest our freedom may be limited.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The author introduces law, education, and relationships to illustrate that the tensions of the free-will debate are not just theoretical, but actually shape practical ideas about accountability.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of a foundational assumption breaking down to the point where notions of accountability must be reimagined, the word 'unravel' means to fall apart or fail.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：Because the text states that philosophical tensions over free will shape our views on responsibility in law, education, and relationships, it can be logically inferred that the author views the debate as having significant practical consequences rather than merely theoretical ones.

2026-06-15 Free Will Debate

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：正确：原文 "influences such as genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits suggest our freedom may be limited"——列举我们可能没意识到、却左右我们决定的因素。

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author directly notes that influences like genetics, upbringing, and unconscious habits are what suggest our freedom may be limited.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：正确：第 1 句给出"在因果决定的世界里依然能自由"的观点，第 2 句质疑"那些 desire 是否真属于自己"，挑战其前提。

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of a foundational assumption breaking down to the point where notions of accountability must be reimagined, the word 'unravel' means to fall apart or fail.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：正确：原文 "they shape how we think about responsibility in law, education, and relationships"——free will 概念影响我们如何让彼此承担责任。

2026-06-15 Linguistic Typology Study

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage primarily discusses how linguistic typology investigates and compares structural features like word order and morphological complexity across different languages.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "conform" to a limited set of dominant word orders means to "follow" or adhere to those specific structural patterns.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Because the text states that languages with minimal inflection "depend on fixed word order to maintain clarity," it can be inferred that strict syntax is a necessary requirement to make up for the absence of morphological markers.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author contrasts Turkish, which uses extensive inflection, with Mandarin Chinese, which relies on word order, to provide concrete examples of how languages differ in marking grammatical roles.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This trade-off" points back to the preceding sentences, which explain how languages balance their reliance on morphological complexity (inflection) and syntax (word order) based on their structural needs.

KPO 10 - The Little Ice Age

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage first outlines the climatic shift's underlying causes, such as decreased solar activity and volcanic eruptions, and then details its devastating agricultural and socio-economic consequences for Northern Europe.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of a "pronounced cooling phase," the word "pronounced" means noticeable or distinct, indicating that the drop in global temperatures was clearly evident and significant.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that the Maunder Minimum was a period of "low solar activity" that "severely reduced the amount of solar energy reaching the Earth," which logically supports the inference that it directly limited solar radiation and contributed to the cooling.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author notes that advancing glaciers "swallowed entire villages and traditional farmlands" to provide a vivid, concrete example of how the severe cooling directly damaged human settlements and disrupted agriculture.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This combination of reduced sunlight and blocked heat" directly summarizes the two phenomena described just before this point: the reduction of solar energy reaching Earth and the reflection of solar radiation by volcanic aerosols. Placing the sentence at [C] logically connects these atmospheric causes to their global climatic result before the next paragraph details the regional socio-economic impacts.

KPO 11 - Neolithic Revolution Paradox

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph describes how the transition to agriculture led to a decline in individual health, while the second paragraph explains how the resulting food surplus enabled massive population growth and the development of complex societies.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of surplus resources causing the development of specialized labor, the word "catalyzed" means stimulated or brought about.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that agricultural surpluses allowed farmers to "support significantly larger populations than nomadic groups could sustain" due to an "abundance of stored calories," which logically implies that nomadic hunter-gatherers lacked the stored food necessary for rapid demographic expansion.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author lists these specific professions immediately following the statement that surplus resources led to the development of specialized labor, using them as concrete examples of this newly specialized workforce.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence fits perfectly at [B] because it defines the "surprising paradox" mentioned just before it and logically introduces the specific evidence of a "notable decline in overall health" described in the sentence immediately following it.

KPO 12 - Infantile Amnesia Enigma

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the high rate of neurogenesis "disrupts existing neural circuits," which causes memories to be overwritten or rendered inaccessible before they can be consolidated into long-term storage.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of discussing major scientific theories, the word "prominent" means leading or most notable. It describes the primary and most widely discussed biological explanation for infantile amnesia.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that older children develop a "language-dependent memory system" that makes early nonverbal memories impossible to retrieve. From this, we can logically infer that adult autobiographical memories are also primarily stored in this language-reliant format.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author introduces the nonverbal nature of early experiences to set up the sentence that immediately follows it. It provides the foundational reason why toddlers, lacking vocabulary, cannot mentally structure these impressions into cohesive, retrievable stories.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "this narrative framework" refers directly to the toddlers' inability to "narrate their experiences" and "structure these events into cohesive, retrievable stories" mentioned right before insertion point [C]. Placing the sentence here establishes cohesion, logically connecting the fading of sensory details with the subsequent development of linguistic skills.

KPO 4 - The Core Accretion Model

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the inner planets remained small and rocky because the metal and rock they were formed from are "relatively scarce" inside the frost line.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "scarce" means not plentiful or abundant, which directly corresponds to "rare" and logically explains why the available materials could only form small planets.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage states that a planetary embryo's gravity only becomes strong enough to capture hydrogen and helium once it reaches "about ten times the mass of Earth," supporting the inference that a specific amount of mass is required to hold these gases.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author introduces "hot Jupiters" as an example of "new complexities" that complicate the core accretion model, requiring the additional explanation that these gas giants migrated inward after forming.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This early advantage" directly refers back to the ability of solid planetesimals to "accumulate mass much more rapidly" mentioned just before square [C]. Placing the sentence here logically bridges this rapid growth to the core reaching the enormous size described in the following sentence.

KPO 5 - Forest Mycorrhizal Networks

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces the hidden, cooperative dynamic of mycorrhizal networks and details how symbiotic fungi enable trees to share resources like carbon and minerals, demonstrating that forests are integrated communities.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of chemical markers not remaining 'confined' to the original host, the word means limited or restricted, as the passage explains that the markers subsequently traveled to neighboring trees.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Because older hub trees must channel surplus carbon to seedlings in 'heavily shaded areas' to boost their survival, it can be inferred that the lack of sunlight prevents these shaded seedlings from photosynthesizing enough carbohydrates on their own.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author notes that researchers used carbon isotopes as chemical markers to 'track nutrient flow', providing observable proof that resources are transferred from one tree to another through the fungal network.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The transitional word 'Instead' creates a direct contrast with the preceding sentence's claim that the chemical markers did not remain confined to the original host. It logically belongs at [B] to explain where the isotopes actually went before providing the specific example of older hub trees.

KPO 6 - Deciphering Linear B

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states in paragraph 1 that scholars spent decades assuming the texts were written in an unknown language that was completely unrelated to Greek.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, 'deduced' means to arrive at a fact or decision by applying logical reasoning, making 'concluded' the best synonym.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text states that the tablets are 'Bronze Age texts' and that their decipherment proved Greek-speaking populations were present in the Aegean much earlier, allowing us to infer that Greek was spoken there during the Bronze Age.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author provides the phrase directly after the word 'syllabary' to define it and clarify its specific nature for the reader.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase 'This false assumption' refers directly back to the preceding sentence, which describes the scholars' mistaken belief that the texts represented a language completely unrelated to Greek.

KPO 7 - Convergent Evolution of Echolocation

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage focuses on introducing echolocation in bats and whales as a prime example of convergent evolution, detailing both their physical adaptations to different environments and their shared genetic mutations.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In the context of the highly specialized vocal cord modifications that bats rely on to overcome the rapid attenuation of sound, the word "intricate" means detailed and complex.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：Because the passage explicitly states that sound travels faster in water than in air, it can be logically inferred that echoes return to aquatic toothed whales with a shorter time delay compared to airborne bats.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The "melon" is introduced as an organ that whales use to focus sounds, providing a concrete example of a biological adaptation tailored specifically to the physical demands of their aquatic environment.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence explains how "these sound waves" and "bounc[ing] back" are used to locate prey, which perfectly refers back to and builds upon the mention of emitting sound waves and interpreting echoes immediately preceding square [C].

KPO 8 - The Messinian Salinity Crisis

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the sea level dropped drastically because tectonic movements closed the connection to the Atlantic Ocean and the region experienced high evaporation rates with limited freshwater runoff.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of severe evaporation, dropping sea levels, and the formation of massive salt deposits, "desiccated" means completely dried out.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text notes the discovery of "deeply incised river canyons" on the exposed sea floor; because the sea level was drastically lower, one can infer that rivers flowing into the basin carved much deeper channels to reach the newly lowered water level.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author introduces "deeply incised river canyons" alongside terrestrial fossils as concrete evidence "indicating that large portions of the sea floor were exposed as dry land."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence elaborates on the immediate consequence of the severed Atlantic connection mentioned just before square [A], seamlessly bridging the initial drop in sea level with the long-term desiccation described in the following sentence.

KPO 9 - The Roman Architectural Revolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces how Roman engineers "revolutionized building practices" by using the arch and concrete to overcome earlier structural limits, ultimately achieving feats like expansive aqueducts and massive interior spaces.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of concrete hardening underwater, "facilitated" means that this unique property made possible, or "enabled," the construction of bridge foundations and harbors in deep rivers.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the post-and-lintel system "strictly limited the amount of open interior space" because stretched stone beams would snap, supporting the inference that builders were structurally prevented from creating wide rooms.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author cites the Pantheon specifically as a notable example of the "vast, uninterrupted interior spaces" that Roman architectural innovations made possible without the use of pillars.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence explains that builders could form the material into any design, providing a logical elaboration of the preceding claim before square [C] that Roman concrete was "incredibly adaptable." The subsequent sentence then illustrates this by describing how it was poured into specifically shaped wooden molds.

2026-06-13 Carthage Maritime Trade

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage cites Carthage's strategic geographic position, its vast trade network across three continents, and its advanced ship-building technology as sources of its wealth. However, it makes no mention of a fishing industry, making choice C the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly credits Carthaginians with constructing advanced ships for 'long-distance journeys' and highlights their 'prowess in navigation.' This directly connects to the fact that they were highly skilled at navigating over long distances.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states that agricultural innovations led to abundant harvests supporting 'both local consumption and export.' From this direct statement, it can be logically inferred that Carthage produced a surplus of food beyond what was needed to feed its own population.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage explains that Carthage's 'growing wealth and dominance in trade led to rivalry with Rome' and ultimately triggered the Punic Wars. This supports the inference that the city's tremendous economic success provoked severe external conflicts.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：In this context, 'culminating in' refers to an event reaching its final climax or result, meaning the brutal Roman siege ultimately resulted in or was 'ending with' the city's destruction.

2026-06-13 Coastal Erosion Solutions

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "vulnerable" describes areas that are susceptible to harm or "at-risk" from environmental threats before being made even more exposed.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly lists the factors that worsen erosion in the sentence beginning with "Rising sea levels, stronger storm surges, and human activities..."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage introduces the installation of groynes as a separate structural intervention, meaning it is not a part of beach nourishment.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：Paragraph three directly credits wetlands, dunes, and mangrove forests with the ability to "stabilize the coast and absorb wave energy."

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The pronoun "They" in the inserted sentence refers back to the "wetlands, dunes, and mangrove forests" introduced in the preceding sentence, logically linking their coastal stabilization to climate resilience.

2026-06-13 Ecological Systems Theory

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The author uses a teacher's communication with parents as a direct example of the "relationships among the microsystems" that define the mesosystem.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In the context of indirect influences, "subtly" refers to things that act in understated, indirect, or barely noticeable ways.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage highlights that critics believe the model underestimates the role of technology, implying that the framework needs to account for modern "virtual microsystems."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly states that the theory "revolutionized our perception of human psychological development" and "remains influential in fields ranging from education to public policy."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The pronoun phrase "Each one" logically refers back to the "multiple overlapping environmental systems" introduced in the preceding sentence, providing a cohesive elaboration before the passage discusses the theory's overall impact.

2026-06-13 Roman Political Legacy

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph establishes the passage's central theme by stating that the political legacy of the Roman Empire, including its ideas about citizenship and law, shaped and influenced later governments.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The author introduces the concept of written laws to explain that it was a core principle which later legal systems adapted to build their own codes, courts, and civic rights.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that Roman administration left a structural model for organizing large territories using infrastructure like roads, officials, and taxation.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In this context, "flexible" means adaptable, as it describes a set of ideas that could be selectively changed and applied by later societies rather than functioning as a rigid, fixed system.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：Because the text notes that the Roman legacy was "not copied without change" and that later societies "selected the parts that served their own needs," it can be inferred that these societies deliberately reshaped Roman ideas to fit their specific purposes.

2026-06-10 Building Data Science

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of being contrasted with "dynamic systems," the word "static" means fixed or unchanging.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that building data science uses IoT devices (Choice A) and enables architects to make decisions during a building's design (Choice C) and operation (Choice D). It never mentions that architects need special training in data analysis, making Choice B the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that monitoring space usage can conflict with "occupants' privacy concerns and dislike of being tracked without their consent," which supports the idea that some occupants may disapprove of sensor use.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author provides hospitals and office spaces as examples of "other applications" immediately after noting that building data science is key to creating adaptable spaces as urban populations grow, demonstrating its role in improving urban infrastructure.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage indicates that building data science can "reduce energy consumption by up to 30 percent, making them attractive for sustainable development," which directly aligns with reducing a building's environmental impact.

2026-06-10 Dark Galaxy Mysteries

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that dark galaxies emit UV radiation, providing astronomers with a unique window to study them despite being undetectable by conventional optical telescopes.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text notes that some researchers propose "turbulence within the gas clouds" as the mechanism preventing gas from collapsing and forming stars.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage states that Hubble Space Telescope observations found dark galaxies to be more common in the early universe, suggesting they "represent a primordial phase in galaxy evolution."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage links observations of high UV radiation to the theory that such radiation prevented gas in dark galaxies from cooling, meaning it maintained high temperatures that inhibited star formation.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence draws a logical conclusion from the traditional models of star formation mentioned right before insertion point [C]. Placing it at [C] sets up a clear contrast with the subsequent sentence, which reveals that dark galaxies actually have very few stars.

2026-06-10 Free Will Debate

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The author uses genetics and upbringing as examples of "influences" beyond our control to illustrate hidden factors that shape and potentially limit our freedom of choice.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage states that if external influences determine our choices, our sense of control is just "a story we tell ourselves after the fact," indicating that it is likely an illusion rather than a true driver of action.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：Sentence 1 presents the philosophical idea that free action is based on our own desires, while sentence 2 challenges the underlying assumption of this idea by questioning whether those desires are actually our own.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of an assumption losing its validity and forcing society to rethink its concepts of responsibility, the word "unravel" means to fail or "fall apart."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The text explicitly states that these debates matter because our ideas about free will "shape how we think about responsibility in law, education, and relationships."

2026-06-10 Linguistic Structural Diversity

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage discusses diversity and universality, word order aiding comprehension, and differences in morphological complexity. Choice C is the unsupported exception because the text notes languages conform to a "limited set of dominant word orders" but never specifies exactly three basic structural patterns.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The author provides the example of subject-first placement to illustrate "cognitive efficiency." This reasoning helps explain the preceding claim that most languages conform to a "limited set of dominant word orders."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text directly contrasts the two languages by stating that "Turkish uses extensive inflection to express subtle distinctions, whereas Mandarin Chinese relies more on word order and context," demonstrating that Turkish is more morphologically complex.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：In the context of the passage, functional "pressures" refer to the cognitive constraints and social factors that shape how languages evolve. Thus, the word means "influences" that drive these structural linguistic changes.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "Such changes" in the inserted sentence directly refers back to the "contact with other languages and cultural shifts" mentioned in the preceding sentence. Placing it at this location establishes strong cohesion by explaining the long-term linguistic effects of those specific social factors.

2026-06-07 Dark Galaxy Mysteries

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The text explicitly states that although dark galaxies emit little visible light, they emit UV radiation, which provides 'astronomers with a unique window to study them.'

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage directly notes that some researchers propose 'turbulence within the gas clouds might prevent the gas from collapsing to form stars.'

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text states that telescope observations revealing dark galaxies were more common in the early universe 'suggest that dark galaxies may represent a primordial phase in galaxy evolution.'

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes observations support the hypothesis that high UV radiation in the early universe 'prevented the gas in dark galaxies from cooling,' which means it kept the gas temperatures too high to form stars.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces the expectation that all galaxies should have stars, which logically connects the traditional model of star formation mentioned right before square [C] to the surprising lack of stars in dark galaxies mentioned immediately after.

2026-06-07 Digital Media Writing

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, the word "pivotal" means "critical," describing a central or highly important shift toward focusing on audience interactivity.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that adjusting writing styles in response to audience feedback "can lead to more dynamic writing."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：While the passage notes that digital media introduces informal language and new elements like emojis, it never mentions that traditional print media is becoming more formal as a result.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage warns that when multimedia elements are integrated, the core message "can sometimes be overshadowed by the allure of visual and auditory effects," meaning it can distract readers.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase "such limitations" refers directly back to the requirement to "prioritize brevity" mentioned in the preceding sentence, logically connecting the constraint to a positive outcome at Location B.

2026-06-07 Engineering Earth's Climate

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 states that ESEM "combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making" to solve environmental issues, directly supporting the fact that it relies on multiple disciplines.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that SRM reflects sunlight to cool the planet (mitigating the heating effect), while CDR reduces greenhouse gas concentrations (addressing the root cause of global warming).

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of techniques being "experimental," the word "feasibility" refers to whether these methods can actually be successfully executed or put into practice, making "workability" the closest match.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly mentions ongoing ethical and governance issues, "such as who controls these interventions," which aligns with the question of who bears responsibility for implementing the changes.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence mentions assessing "long-term impacts," which logically follows the warning about "unintended consequences" arising and causing harm right before location [D]. Furthermore, it smoothly precedes the phrase "Despite these challenges," adding to the list of challenges just discussed.

2026-06-07 Marketing Health Drinks

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly mentions using brightly colored bottles (eye-catching packaging), memorable labels, and placing items at eye level or near checkout areas. It never mentions giving discounts, making it the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In this context, "discrepancy" refers to the "difference" in effectiveness when the same marketing approaches are applied to soft drinks versus health-oriented beverages.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The highlighted sentence contrasts soft drinks, which trigger impulsive responses due to their association with pleasure, with health beverages, which are viewed as functional and do not elicit the same automatic responses. Choice D captures this primary contrast accurately without altering the original meaning.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author introduces sunscreen immediately after asking how producers can boost sales of health-oriented drinks in order to provide a successful model for marketing functional products.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：While the passage directly states that sunscreen advertising relies on clear, informational messaging based on rational criteria, the author uses this as an example to imply that functional health-oriented drinks should be marketed using this exact same strategy.

2026-06-07 Plant Chemical Communication

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph notes that plants were previously considered passive organisms that reacted to changes rather than actively engaging with their surroundings.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that when attacked, a corn plant releases specific warning chemicals (root exudates) into the soil, prompting neighboring corn plants to release MBOA in response.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that electrical signals allow a plant to adjust resource allocation, which supports the inference that these signals help plants optimize their use of available resources.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly states that detecting the presence of other plants allows them to alter their growth patterns to avoid direct competition.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "still in its infancy" means being at an early stage of development, which makes sense in the context that researchers are just beginning to uncover new ways plants interact.

2026-06-07 Platonism in Modern Philosophy

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "posits" means to put forward an idea or propose a theory, making "suggests" the most accurate synonym. The passage uses it to introduce the core argument of Platonism.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：This sentence explicitly uses a "beautiful painting" as a concrete example to help clarify the difference between a physical object and the abstract form of beauty.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly supports choices A, B, and C by stating that forms include concepts like beauty and justice, are truer than physical objects, and are timeless. Choice D is the exception because the passage never discusses abstract forms influencing our perception of the physical world.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage states in paragraph 2 that nominalism "contrasts with" the perspective of mathematical Platonists, directly supporting the inference that it disagrees with their claims.

2026-06-07 Social Role Theory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, "norms" refers to the customary standards or unwritten rules of behavior that society expects individuals to follow in their given roles.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage introduces this person immediately after defining "role conflict" and uses the phrase "For instance" to provide a concrete example of two roles clashing.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The teacher is provided as a direct example of "role strain," which the preceding sentence defines as stress occurring within a single role due to competing demands.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The phrase "these dynamics" points back to the processes described in the preceding sentences, specifically how societal expectations and roles shift and change as society evolves.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides concrete examples of roles and their expected behaviors (a parent offering affection, a soldier following orders), which logically expands upon the preceding statement that roles feature "specific behaviors and norms."

2026-06-06 Ancient Egyptian Medicine

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage compares illness, which was believed to be caused by blockages in the body's channels, to a blocked canal causing flooding. This analogy directly illustrates the ancient Egyptians' understanding of why humans became sick.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text notes that Egyptian doctors' understanding of the connection between cleanliness and preventing infections was a concept "widely accepted only much later in history," making it a remarkable achievement for its time.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The author mentions willow bark as an example of an ancient remedy that "modern science has validated." This demonstrates that some of the Egyptians' pharmacological treatments were scientifically effective.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of performing prayers and rituals to gain the favor of the gods, the word "invoke" means to appeal to or request.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states that Egyptian medicine was intertwined with religion, noting that "many treatments involved prayers and rituals" to gain the gods' favor.

2026-06-06 Ancient Roman Aqueducts

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of calculating gradients to ensure a steady flow of water, "meticulously" means doing so with great care and accuracy, which is closest in meaning to "precisely."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage describes the construction as a "labor-intensive process" where workers had to "carve channels through mountains," strongly supporting the inference that they endured severe physical challenges.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author introduces the Pont du Gard as a specific example of a Roman aqueduct that is "still standing today," demonstrating its durability and well-preserved state.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text directly states that the "availability of fresh water" supplied by aqueducts for drinking and sanitation supported the growth of cities and the expansion of the Roman Empire.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage states that the "legacy of Roman aqueducts continues to influence modern water management systems," supporting the conclusion that today's systems are still shaped by Roman engineering practices.

2026-06-06 Animal Mirror Test

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage focuses broadly on how scientists use the mirror test to study self-awareness across various species, making research on animal cognition the primary topic.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of children acquiring the ability to recognize themselves, a 'milestone' refers to a significant developmental achievement or accomplishment.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that scientists used colored marks to see if an animal would try to remove the mark after seeing its reflection, which indicated that it recognized itself.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that elephants pass the mirror test and are highly intelligent like apes, but it never mentions their ability to understand signs from other animals.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The cleaner fish is introduced to illustrate the author's concluding point that even less intelligent animals may possess self-awareness, showing this trait exists across a wide range of species.

2026-06-06 Animal Sleep Patterns

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "considerably" means to a large degree or "significantly," describing the wide variation in sleep patterns among different animal species.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly states that during long migratory flights, some birds "engage in unihemispheric sleep" to navigate and avoid threats.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The third paragraph explains that grazing animals like cows and horses sleep minimally in order to "stay vigilant against predators."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author contrasts grazing animals with predators like lions and tigers to illustrate that animals with fewer threats can afford longer, deeper sleep.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence asks a question about what influences birds' sleep patterns, making it a perfect transition right before the sentence that provides "long migratory flights" as a specific situation that affects how they sleep.

2026-06-06 Emotional Power Music

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In the context of the simultaneous engagement of various brain regions, the word "interplay" refers to the "interaction" or combined action of these regions.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：While the passage notes that music lacks the precision of spoken language, it explicitly identifies both as mediums that can convey complex emotions and act as profound forms of expression.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Aristotle is cited as a historical figure who argued for music's "ethical influence" and its ability to "promote virtue or incite vice," illustrating a past belief in its moral power.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author introduces patients before surgery with the phrase "For instance," using them as a specific example to support the preceding claim about music's role in emotional regulation and therapeutic anxiety reduction.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The final sentence directly links the universal, innate ability to discern musical emotions to inquiries about whether music served as an evolutionary, "crucial aspect of human development."

2026-06-06 Golden Age Television

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of television becoming a primary and most influential cultural force, the word "dominant" means principal or most important, which matches the meaning of "leading".

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author introduces The Twilight Zone immediately after mentioning the rise of anthology series to serve as a specific, influential example of how these shows innovatively blended genres in thought-provoking ways.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage directly states that sitcoms like I Love Lucy were "reflecting everyday life," which demonstrates their focus on people's daily routines and interactions.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：While paragraph 2 details the successful and innovative programming formats of the era, paragraph 3 pivots to introduce the previously unmentioned challenges of balancing artistic vision with commercial and advertiser pressures.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：Advertisers are introduced immediately after the passage states that the Golden Age had its "challenges," specifically illustrating the commercial pressures that clashed with networks' creative visions.

2026-06-06 Group Decision Making

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that "even in well-structured environments, the pressure to conform can subtly influence behavior," which refutes the idea that groupthink is merely a failure of leadership.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The text states that groups with diverse backgrounds are "less prone to groupthink," a phenomenon defined earlier as individuals withholding their dissenting opinions.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：In this context, to "surface" hidden concerns means to bring them to light or identify them so that they can be openly addressed by the group.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The final paragraph explicitly states that achieving a balance between unity and intellectual rigor "depends on deliberate strategies," showing that it does not happen without intentional effort.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage cites the fear of conflict, the pressure to conform, and a lack of mechanisms for constructive disagreement as factors contributing to groupthink, but it never mentions members' lack of experience as a cause.

2026-06-06 History of Photography

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "innovation" refers to the introduction of new or improved artistic methods and ideas, which best matches the meaning of "advancement."

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that the exposure times for daguerreotypes were "much shorter" than the several hours required by the previously mentioned heliography process.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly notes that the calotype revolutionized the field of photography because it "allowed for multiple copies of an image to be made from a single negative."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author uses Eastman's Kodak company as an example of what drove the "democratization" of photography, highlighting how it provided simple and affordable cameras to the general public.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "These developments" refers directly to the rise of "digital photography" and "instant image capture and sharing" mentioned in the sentence immediately preceding location [C].

2026-06-06 Human Microbiome Health

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "pivotal" means crucial or very important, as the passage emphasizes that these microorganisms are essential for critical bodily functions like digestion and immunity.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly states that antibiotics can disrupt the balance of beneficial microbes, which in turn can lead to weakened immunity.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage directly notes that researchers are investigating the connection between the microbiome and mental health, specifically how certain gut bacteria affect brain function and conditions like depression.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage recommends a varied diet rich in fiber, reducing stress, and avoiding unnecessary antibiotics to maintain a healthy microbiome, making the avoidance of bacteria the unsupported exception because certain bacteria are actually described as beneficial.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：Paragraph 2 discusses how diet, lifestyle, and medications like antibiotics can disrupt the microbiome, while paragraph 3 logically follows by outlining specific actions to manage those factors and maintain microbiome health.

2026-06-06 Jet Stream Dynamics

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that the jet stream forms because of the temperature contrast between cold polar air and warm tropical air.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly notes that when the jet stream dips southward in the northern hemisphere, it brings cold air and storms to lower latitudes.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage identifies the Earth's rotation, along with the uneven heating of its surface, as a key factor that influences the jet stream's dynamics.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author explains that climate change is warming the Arctic, which directly reduces the temperature difference between polar and tropical air masses.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：In the context of slower-moving weather systems causing extreme weather events to last for a longer duration, "prolonged" means extended.

2026-06-06 Magnetic Confinement Fusion

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the basic principle demonstrated in 1957 was that "powerful magnetic fields contain extremely hot plasma."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author explains that without magnetic containment, plasma would touch the walls and cool instantly, emphasizing the necessity of magnetic confinement techniques to keep the fusion process going.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of developing increasingly complex and capable reactors over time, the word "sophisticated" means highly developed or "advanced."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that ITER's goal is to demonstrate "sustained fusion reactions that produce more energy than they consume," which defines net energy gain.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The text identifies the "enormous energy inputs to maintain plasma conditions" as one of the significant challenges currently preventing the commercial generation of electricity from magnetic fusion.

2026-06-06 Mysteries of Opal

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that opals are amorphous and lack a fixed internal shape, which directly contradicts the claim that their structure is rigid and non-varying.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author compares the opal to a prism to help the reader visualize how the gemstone's internal silica spheres diffract and separate light into different colors.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text explains that the opal's noncrystalline internal structure makes it fragile and prone to cracking, prompting modern jewelers to use specific protective techniques like humidity-controlled storage.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that ancient cultures believed opals possessed mystical properties, brought good luck, and granted gifts such as hope and prophecy, all of which are beneficial special qualities.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：In the context of ancient mystical beliefs, "prophecy" refers to the supernatural ability to foresee or predict the future.

2026-06-06 Origins of Theater

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage states that the earliest performances in ancient Greece "aimed to convey moral lessons," which directly matches the goal of providing guidance on good and bad behavior.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The text explains that the Greeks developed distinct genres, specifically identifying the works of Aeschylus as tragedies and those of Aristophanes as comedies.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：According to the passage, the elaborate stage designs introduced in Roman theater "helped to convey the themes and narratives more effectively."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：In this context, a "resurgence" contrasts with the previous "decline" and leads to the "flourishing" of theater, meaning a revival or comeback.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "around this time" logically refers back to the Middle Ages mentioned in the preceding sentence. Placing the inserted text here successfully connects the historical decline of theater to the scarcity of performances before the subsequent sentence introduces a "resurgence."

2026-06-06 Paradox of Choice

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces the paradox of choice to explain how an overabundance of options causes decision fatigue, emphasizing throughout that fewer choices can actually increase consumer happiness.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly links decision fatigue to anxiety, noting that consumers become overwhelmed because the fear of making the wrong choice looms large.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The experiment is introduced directly after the phrase 'Research supports this notion,' serving as empirical evidence to demonstrate that consumers are more satisfied with a limited selection.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In the context of retailers boosting satisfaction by limiting and managing their product selections, 'curating' means organizing and carefully selecting their offerings.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly states that collectivist cultures 'often provide fewer choices' and report higher contentment, which directly supports the conclusion that consumers in these societies generally face a more limited selection.

2026-06-06 Quantum Computing Challenges

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of delivering unprecedented computational power and changing how computers process data, "revolutionize" means to completely change or "transform" technology.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts traditional binary bits with qubits to illustrate that qubits can represent multiple states simultaneously, allowing quantum computers to solve complex problems much faster than classical ones.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that because quantum computers could potentially break current encryption algorithms with ease, new quantum-resistant techniques are required to secure data.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author states that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances to introduce the challenge of maintaining coherence, which requires extreme isolation and specific environmental conditions to function.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence begins with "Seeing progress," which logically follows the statement preceding location [C] that "progress is accelerating."

2026-06-06 Renaissance Art Techniques

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that linear perspective allowed artists to accurately depict three-dimensional space and create "the illusion of depth" on a flat surface.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, a "departure" refers to a significant shift or "change" away from the flat, two-dimensional styles of earlier European art.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The author introduces The Virgin of the Rocks to provide a concrete example of how Leonardo da Vinci applied chiaroscuro, contrasting illuminated figures with dark shadows.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：According to the passage, chiaroscuro added emotional intensity and drama, "captivating viewers and drawing them into the scene."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The text explains that because oil paints dry more slowly than tempera paints, artists were able to use "blending and layering" to build texture and color.

2026-06-06 Sports Social Integration

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, "cohesion" means unity, aligning with the passage's description of how sports participation helps in bridging gaps and improving relationships among diverse groups.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that sports can exacerbate social tensions "particularly when favoritism or exclusionary practices are present."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 2 identifies challenges such as competitive environments causing social tensions, while paragraph 3 introduces initiatives like the Sport for Peace program designed to resolve such conflicts.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text directly states that the Sport for Peace program "focuses on conflict resolution through team-building activities."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The author cites the Olympics and the World Cup as examples of how spectatorship unites people by serving as "opportunities for nations to come together and share common goals."

2026-06-06 Stretching Benefits Drawbacks

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage states that dynamic stretching moves the body "through a range of motion" and improves athletic performance, coordination, and neuromuscular efficiency, making a decrease in range of motion the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In this context, "impair" means to weaken or hinder, as the passage describes how reduced muscle activation and decreased muscle stiffness negatively impact the body's ability to generate force.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that static stretching is "valuable post-exercise, aiding in recovery," which supports the conclusion that athletes benefit most from it after completing a training session.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author lists these variables to challenge a "one-size-fits-all approach," thereby specifying the essential factors that must be considered when determining how and when to stretch.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a concrete example of elite swimmers performing static stretches for recovery after intense training, logically placing it immediately after the general claim that static stretching remains "valuable post-exercise."

2026-06-06 Urbanization and Birds

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, to 'mitigate' means to make something less severe or harmful. Conservationists are working to 'reduce' the negative impacts of urbanization by implementing helpful initiatives like green spaces.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly mentions a reduction in nesting sites, changes in bird songs, and disrupted circadian rhythms as effects of urbanization. However, it notes a 'significant reduction' rather than an increase in food sources, making it the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author explicitly introduces pigeons and sparrows as examples of species that 'have adapted well to urban environments.' This illustrates the point that certain birds can successfully adjust to and utilize new city resources.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The final paragraph explicitly lists 'creating urban green spaces,' alongside constructing bird-friendly buildings and reducing light pollution, as specific initiatives implemented to mitigate negative urban effects on birds.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The text directly states that artificial lighting alters birds' circadian rhythms and affects their breeding and feeding routines. From these specific physiological and daily routine changes, we can logically infer the broader conclusion that urban lighting disrupts their natural behaviors.

2026-06-06 Viking Sunstone Navigation

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that "evidence of actual sunstone use remains scarce" because archaeologists "have yet to uncover these stones in the remains of Viking settlements or ships."

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text explains that by rotating the crystal, Vikings could "determine the location of the sun in the sky on cloudy days," allowing them to figure out where the sun was when it was hidden by clouds.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author notes that an Iceland spar was recovered from a 1592 shipwreck, which suggests that "this navigational tool was indeed used" and provides indirect support for the theory that Vikings also utilized it.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In this context, "ingenuity" refers to the Vikings' inventive and resourceful problem-solving skills, which is synonymous with "cleverness."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The pronoun "This" in the inserted sentence refers directly back to the Vikings navigating "with remarkable precision" described in the preceding sentence, making location [A] the most cohesive and logical placement.

2026-06-02 Flynn Effect Trends

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, a 'consistent' increase refers to one that continues at a steady, reliable rate, matching the passage's description of scores rising by a predictable three points per decade.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly lists nutrition, healthcare, the cognitive demands of modern life, and technology as contributing factors, making parental care the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text directly supports this answer by stating that some researchers believe the rise in scores 'reflects better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented in IQ tests.'

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author notes the slowing or reversing of the trend specifically to challenge 'the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence.'

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence attempts to explain the cause of a 'downturn.' It must be placed at location [D] so that 'downturn' cohesively refers back to the slowing down or reversing of the Flynn Effect mentioned in the immediately preceding sentence.

2026-06-02 Quantum Computing Power

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of delivering unprecedented computational power and changing how computers process data, "revolutionize" means to completely change or "transform" technology.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts traditional binary bits with qubits to illustrate that qubits can represent multiple states simultaneously, allowing quantum computers to solve complex problems much faster than classical ones.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that because quantum computers could potentially break current encryption algorithms with ease, new quantum-resistant techniques are required to secure data.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author states that qubits are highly sensitive to external disturbances to introduce the challenge of maintaining coherence, which requires extreme isolation and specific environmental conditions to function.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence begins with "Seeing progress," which logically follows the statement preceding location [C] that "progress is accelerating."

2026-05-30 Demographic Dynamics

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：对。DTM 展示经济发展过程中出生率和死亡率如何变化。

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：对。农业社会最初同时具有高出生率和高死亡率。

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：对。aspirations 指家庭追求的经济和个人目标，对应 goals。

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：对。文章没有断言低出生率通常必然造成经济衰退，反而提到可能推动创新。

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：对。该句总结应对老龄化和人口收缩的政策需求，放在影响之后、总结规划之前，即位置4。

2026-05-30 Developmental Systems Theory

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：正确：reciprocal interactions 指相互、双向的作用，与 mutual 同义。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：正确：原文 "It challenges traditional views that either prioritize genes or environment in isolation"——传统视角孤立地考察单一因素。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：正确：原文 "epigenetic changes—modifications in gene expression that do not alter the DNA sequence itself"——影响 beak 形状的是基因表达变化，不是 DNA 序列变化。

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：正确：developmental plasticity 被作为 DST 的重要概念引出，是对 DST 的扩展说明。

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：正确：Location 4 在 amphibian 总论之后，作为具体例子（Mexican spadefoot toad）补充最自然。

2026-05-30 Discrete Geometry Structures

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Sentence B uses the word 'Unlike' to explicitly compare and contrast the focus of 'continuous geometry' with that of 'discrete geometry.'

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author uses the example of 'fitting oranges into boxes' to illustrate a seemingly 'simple exercise,' immediately contrasting it with the complex, 'far-reaching applications' of packing problems to show they are not as simple as they sound.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly states that through applications like computer-chip design and data storage, researchers have 'discovered intriguing connections between the arrangement of shapes and space utilization.'

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In the context of describing how the highly abstract nature of discrete geometry can easily disguise or cover up its real-world usefulness, the word 'belie' means to hide or misrepresent.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides specific examples of how Penrose patterns are used in 'mosaic art and floor designs.' Therefore, it logically follows location [D], immediately after the broad statement that such tiling patterns have influenced 'architectural designs and artworks.'

2026-05-30 Parallel Algorithms

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that parallel algorithms solve problems faster than sequential algorithms, which must check every item in a database one by one, making sequential algorithms less efficient.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author uses the virus simulation as a specific example to support the preceding claim that parallel algorithms play a crucial role in the healthcare sector by analyzing large datasets quickly.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：In this context, to "tailor" algorithms to work on different types of hardware means to modify or "adapt" them for specific needs.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The inserted sentence summarizes the "many advantages" discussed in the preceding text and looks forward to future innovations, making it a perfect concluding thought at Location D.

2026-05-27 Free Will Debate

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The author lists genetics and upbringing as examples of influences beyond our control to demonstrate how our freedom in decision-making might actually be limited.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage states that if our choices are predetermined, our sense of control is merely "a story we tell ourselves after the fact," implying that this sense of control is essentially an illusion.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：Sentence 1 presents the philosophical idea that acting on our desires allows us to be free, while sentence 2 challenges this idea by questioning the assumption that these desires are truly our own.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In this context, "unravel" means to fall apart, referring to the breakdown or collapse of the assumption that individuals could have acted differently.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that the debate over free will is not merely theoretical because it directly shapes our notions of accountability and responsibility in law, education, and relationships.

2026-05-27 Theater Lighting Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage introduces early lighting methods and then uses successive paragraphs to trace chronological developments, from nineteenth-century gas lighting to late nineteenth-century electric lighting and modern LED technology.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that gas lighting was "brighter," which directly contradicts the unsupported claim that it produced a softer light. The other choices are all supported by the text's descriptions of gas lighting being safer, more consistent, and used to illuminate actors.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "fundamentally" means completely or "thoroughly," describing how deeply electric lighting innovations reshaped the visual and emotional landscape of the stage.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The play Transformation is cited as a specific example of how electric lighting techniques, such as angled beams and shadows, successfully evoked an emotional mood of "chaos and psychological unrest."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that designers must ensure modern lighting "supports rather than distracts from the narrative," which logically implies that these advanced effects have the potential to shift the audience's focus away from the play itself.

KPO 1 - Printing Press Impact

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage broadly discusses the impact of the printing press on literature accessibility, intellectual movements, literacy rates, and national identity, illustrating a major societal and cultural transformation.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In the context of monks painstakingly copying books by hand, "laborious" describes a process requiring a significant amount of hard work and effort, making "difficult" the closest synonym.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage states that after the printing press, people were "no longer entirely dependent on local authorities or oral traditions," which supports the inference that prior to the press, ordinary people relied heavily on these spoken sources.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author explicitly mentions the Renaissance and the Scientific Revolution as examples of the "major cultural and intellectual movements" that were fueled by the accelerated dissemination of new ideas through printed books.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence explicitly contrasts the speed of the machine with that of a scribe, logically following the sentence that introduces the time-reducing benefits of Gutenberg's reusable metal type and leading into the subsequent point about literature's new accessibility.

KPO 2 - Flipped Classroom Model

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that during class time, students engage in problem-solving while the teacher "acts as a guide or facilitator."

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In the context of passively receiving instruction from a teacher, "absorbing" means "taking in" information.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage directly states that students who skip pre-class assignments will be "ill-prepared for in-class activities," which logically supports the inference that they will struggle to participate effectively.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Choice D is the unsupported exception because reduced preparation time for educators is never mentioned, whereas choices A, B, and C are explicitly stated benefits of the flipped classroom.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "this rearrangement" refers back to the reversed learning sequence described in the sentence preceding [C], making it the most cohesive and logical placement.

KPO 3 - Academic Reading - Cephalopod Camouflage

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly states that chromatophores contain elastic sacs of pigment surrounded by tiny radial muscles that contract to stretch the sac and expose the pigment.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, "encompassing" means including or comprising, as it introduces octopuses, squids, and cuttlefish as specific examples within the class of cephalopods.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage details how chromatophores, iridophores, and leucophores aid in camouflage, but photophores and bioluminescence are never mentioned in the text.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author provides "coral, rocks, or seaweed" as specific examples of the three-dimensional textures that cephalopods can physically mimic using their dermal papillae.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This reflective base layer" logically refers back to the leucophores described in the preceding sentence, which lie beneath other cells and act as a broad-spectrum reflector.

2026-05-19 Earth Core Dynamics

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that earthquakes send seismic waves that offer "rare glimpses" into the core, demonstrating how they provide scientists with a method to study this mysterious region.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly links the unexpected slowing of seismic waves to the idea that the core might not be entirely solid, as it could possibly contain "molten layers or unusual elements."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "collectively" means "together," referring to how the various model findings combine as a whole to portray the core in constant motion.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：While the passage states that computer models propose a layered structure, super-rotation, and directional differences called anisotropies, it never claims that anisotropies cause super-rotation.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The specific criticism of the computer models is explicitly stated in the sentence noting that researchers argue they "rely on overly simplified assumptions."

2026-05-13 Art of Conducting

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that conductors keep time, guide interpretation, and inspire emotional delivery, but it notes that they convey their own intentions rather than those of a composer.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text focuses entirely on nonverbal communication through gestures, facial expressions, and body language during performances, and does not mention the use of spoken instructions.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage states that rehearsals allow conductors to "align musicians with their vision," demonstrating that they direct the musicians to follow their specific musical interpretation.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In the context of studying scores to react swiftly during concerts, "anticipate" means to foresee or "expect" issues before they arise.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：This detail is provided to support the paragraph's core argument that a conductor's seemingly spontaneous performance is actually grounded in meticulous, long-term preparation.

2026-05-13 Graphic Design Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage contrasts the Middle Ages with the fifteenth-century advent of the printing press, which facilitated "mass production." This supports the inference that earlier intricate manuscripts were not mass-produced, but rather individually made.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In the context of designers supporting the use of simplicity and rationality in their work, "advocated for" means they actively recommended or "promoted" these concepts.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The "grid-based approach" is discussed as the specific method that brought order and readability to visuals, illustrating exactly how Swiss designers applied their new principles of minimalism and functionality.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage states that modern designers face the challenge of "blending the precision of technology with the warmth of human creativity." This supports the inference that while digital tools are precise, designers worry they may lack this essential human warmth.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "this clarity" directly refers back to the "order and readability" established by the grid-based approach in the preceding sentence. Placing the inserted text here also creates a logical bridge to the following sentence, which details critics' concerns about "limited expressive possibilities."

2026-05-09 Civic Education

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "fostering" means encouraging or promoting the development of something, specifically indicating that equipping citizens with knowledge promotes their informed participation in the political process.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author uses a rhetorical question comparing an informed young person to an uninformed one to emphasize that understanding government functions leads to active democratic participation, thereby highlighting the critical importance of civic knowledge.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage introduces mock legislatures as an example of integrating civic education into curriculums through "activities that students find fun and exciting," which supports the idea that they are an engaging teaching method.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The final sentence of the paragraph explicitly identifies a challenge, stating that "socioeconomic background and access to resources may limit access to high-quality civic education."

2026-05-09 Cooperative Education

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：对。文章没有说 co-op 专门推荐给理论课有困难的学生。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：对。两校拥有深厚 employer partnerships，并把多阶段 co-op 纳入学位要求。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：对。cultivate professional maturity 表示促进专业成熟，对应 promote。

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：对。交替学期可能延长完成学位的时间，这是文中明确的缺点。

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：对。偏爱文本分析和学术研究的学生最不需要以实践工作为核心的 co-op。

2026-05-09 Cybernetic Prosthetics

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "seamlessly" means flawlessly or smoothly, describing how cybernetic prosthetics integrate with the human nervous system without noticeable disruption.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that seamlessly integrating prosthetics with the nervous system allows for "more natural movement," and identifies myoelectric sensors as a "key development in this field," supporting the inference that these sensors facilitate such movement.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the delicate actions of a cybernetic hand are "achieved through advanced algorithms that translate muscle signals into controlled movements."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage mentions that haptic feedback allows users to "feel textures and temperatures," but it does not state that it involves changing the actual temperatures of objects, making this the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence introduces the idea that "a few obstacles need to be overcome," making Location [A] the logical placement since the subsequent sentences immediately list these exact obstacles: high cost, maintenance requirements, and limited battery life.

2026-05-09 Italian Lute Songs

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：正确。全文先讲印刷让鲁特琴音乐更易获得，再讲 courtly patronage，最后总结两者共同推动 Italian lute song 的兴盛。

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：正确。印刷技术让鲁特琴乐谱更便宜、更易获得，这种 access 与私人家庭演奏文化扩大相契合。

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：正确。lavish presentation copies 指制作讲究、华丽的赠呈本，接近 fancy。

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：正确。heraldic emblems of noble households 出现在赠呈本上，是贵族家庭参与和赞助鲁特琴音乐的证据。

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：正确。文章没有提到鲁特琴制作或结构改良。

2026-05-09 Platonism in Modern Philosophy

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a specific example of Platonism's influence in a particular branch of philosophy (moral philosophy). It logically follows the preceding sentence at location D, which introduces the idea that Platonism's enduring influence is evident in various branches of philosophy.

2026-05-09 Synthetic Diamonds

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph states that extracting natural diamonds is "fraught with environmental concerns" and introduces synthetic diamonds as a "promising alternative," indicating they avoid these environmental harms.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "replicate" the extreme heat and pressure of diamond formation means to reproduce or recreate those exact natural conditions in a laboratory.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage contrasts the two methods by stating that HPHT diamonds can be produced "quickly," whereas CVD production is "slower" and "more technically demanding," showing that HPHT is easier to produce.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The phrase is used to explain the preceding clause, "Consumers are often skeptical of synthetic diamonds," demonstrating the psychological barriers limiting public acceptance of lab-grown gems.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence begins with "And" and introduces "industrial uses," which logically builds on the preceding sentence's mention of their suitability for "jewelry." It fits perfectly at location C, contrasting these practical applications with the consumer skepticism described in the following sentence.

2026-05-06 Health Informatics Impact

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of bringing together information technology and data science, "integrates" means to merge or combine.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Improved coordination, reduced errors, and timely interventions are explicitly stated as benefits of digital health systems. Conversely, diminishing clinicians' intuition is presented as a negative criticism or "unfortunate side effect" of this efficiency, making it the unsupported exception.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：Sentence 1 introduces the idea that digital efficiency creates "new complexities" or problems. Sentence 2 elaborates by providing specific examples of these complexities, namely the diminishing role of intuition and a reduction in individualized care.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The diabetes example immediately follows and illustrates the claim that predictive algorithms "may fail to account for" unique patient variables, serving as evidence of how digital tools can produce incomplete medical assessments.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The final sentence concludes that because digital systems focus on rigid templates and downplay hard-to-quantify details, they challenge clinicians to "stay alert to what the system might miss."

2026-05-06 Kessler Syndrome Debris

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the feedback loop of cascading collisions "could render certain orbital regions unusable for decades," which directly supports the limitation on where satellites can safely orbit.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The author provides this detail to challenge Kessler's assumption of uniform debris distribution, serving as a scientific objection that potentially limits the scope of the predicted cascading events.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "resilience" refers to the strength or durability of orbital infrastructure to withstand space debris without inevitably succumbing to runaway collisions.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage mentions uneven debris distribution, new removal technology, and alternative explanations for debris growth as arguments against the syndrome's inevitability. However, it never states that NASA has developed new orbital infrastructure to avoid collisions, making this the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase refers back to the core warning of the Kessler Syndrome introduced in the first paragraph: the dangerous hypothesis of exponential, cascading collisions in low Earth orbit that threaten satellites.

2026-05-03 Great Smog London

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the thick layer of smog was caused by a combination of "cold weather, windless conditions, and pollutants," supporting the inference that multiple factors happened at the same time.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of people dying from respiratory problems caused by the smog before their natural time, "premature" means "early."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text demonstrates the event's importance by detailing the government's response, specifically that "new regulations aimed at reducing air pollution were established," such as the Clean Air Act.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The severe impact on the ambulance service is listed directly after stating that "visibility was reduced to a few meters, and transportation was disrupted," serving as an example of how the low visibility affected daily life and emergency services.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a specific example of how the new laws were implemented, making it logically fit directly after the sentence introducing the Clean Air Act's restriction on coal burning and promotion of cleaner energy.

2026-04-29 Climate Change Impacts

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that "rising sea temperatures lead to coral bleaching," a phenomenon that weakens corals and leaves them susceptible to disease, confirming it is a harmful effect of high temperatures.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The second paragraph directly states that ocean acidification "reduces the availability of calcium carbonate," which is explicitly identified as a "crucial component of coral skeletons."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "mitigate" means to lessen the severity of the negative impacts of climate change on coral reefs. This is synonymous with "alleviate," a word used later in the same paragraph to describe reducing stress on the reefs.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explains that scientists are exploring "selective breeding and genetic modification as potential solutions" specifically as part of the effort to develop "coral species that are more resilient to temperature fluctuations and acidification."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence discusses the further consequences of the "absence of calcium carbonate." Placing it at location [B] logically builds upon the preceding sentences in the paragraph, which introduce the reduction of calcium carbonate and its direct effect on reef growth and stability.

2026-04-29 Evolution Of Choreography

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：对。profound 表示编舞发生根本性转变，对应 fundamental。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：对。Martha Graham 的例子说明编舞从严格形式主义转向情感表达。

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：对。当代作品由舞者、作曲家、设计师等共同创造，编舞者的权力被分享。

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：对。编舞从严格规范发展到合作、即兴和实时变化，体现从刚性到灵活。

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：对。该句具体说明 contributors 的作用，应接在列出协作者之后，即位置 2。

2026-04-29 Great Smog of London

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage directly states that the smog was caused by cold weather, windless conditions, and pollutants. From this combination of causes, it can be logically inferred that the event resulted from multiple factors occurring at the same time.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of the health crisis, a "premature" death is one that happens before a person's expected natural lifespan, making "early" the closest match in meaning.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text links the historical importance of the Great Smog to the government's response, specifically the establishment of new regulations like the Clean Air Act of 1956.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The severe impact on the ambulance service is detailed immediately after the passage notes that visibility was reduced to a few meters and transportation was disrupted, illustrating the dangerous consequences of the low visibility.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence elaborates on how coal burning was restricted by introducing "smoke control areas." It logically coheres at Location A, directly following the introduction of the Clean Air Act of 1956 and its promotion of cleaner energy sources.

2026-04-29 Sleep And Memory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：对。retention 在这里指把事实知识保存下来，对应 preservation。

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：对。REM 强化情绪记忆，深睡支持事实和技能，两者关联不同类型的记忆。

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：对。睡眠会修剪不必要的连接并强化重要连接，因此通过选择性删除连接改善记忆。

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：对。前文已说明睡眠帮助记忆，所以缺觉损害记忆是顺理成章的结果。

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：对。该句概括 neural data management 这一解释，放在提出该解释后的位置信息最连贯，即位置 1。

2026-04-29 Synthetic Diamonds

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph states that extracting natural diamonds from mines is a process 'fraught with environmental concerns,' making synthetic diamonds a promising, less harmful alternative.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, 'replicating' means duplicating or 'recreating' the exact physical conditions required for natural diamonds to form.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text notes that HPHT diamonds 'can be produced quickly and in large quantities,' whereas CVD production is 'more technically demanding and slower,' demonstrating that HPHT is easier.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：These qualities are cited as the reason 'consumers are often skeptical of synthetic diamonds,' which explains why public acceptance of them remains somewhat limited.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces industrial applications using the transition 'And,' which logically follows the previous sentence's discussion of synthetic diamonds being 'suitable for jewelry' before the passage shifts to consumer skepticism at Location C.

2026-04-27 Dark Galaxy Mysteries

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that because dark galaxies emit UV radiation, this provides astronomers with "a unique window to study them," overcoming the inability to detect them with optical telescopes.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text directly points to the proposal by some researchers that "turbulence within the gas clouds might prevent the gas from collapsing to form stars."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage explains that Hubble telescope findings showing dark galaxies were common in the early universe suggest they "represent a primordial phase in galaxy evolution," which corresponds to an early stage in development.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage states that observations support the hypothesis that "high levels of UV radiation in the early universe prevented the gas in dark galaxies from cooling," which means the UV radiation kept the gas temperatures high.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the explanation that traditional models involve "star formation," drawing the conclusion that one would expect galaxies to have many stars. The sentence immediately following the insertion point contrasts this expectation by revealing that dark galaxies actually have very few stars.

2026-04-22 Carthage Trade Network

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage cites Carthage's strategic geographic location, its intercontinental trade network, and its advanced ship-building technology as sources of its wealth and power, but it never mentions a fishing industry.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly states that the Carthaginians constructed advanced ships for "long-distance journeys" and possessed great "prowess in navigation."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage notes that Carthaginian agriculture yielded abundant harvests that supported "both local consumption and export," which logically implies they produced a surplus of food beyond what their own population needed.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The text explains that Carthage's growing wealth and dominance in trade "led to rivalry with Rome" and eventually the Punic Wars, indicating that its success sparked major external conflicts.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase "culminating in" means reaching a final result or climax, which in this context indicates that the brutal Roman siege ultimately ended with the city's destruction.

2026-04-22 Renewable Energy Engineering

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly identifies energy storage within PV cells as a 'common misconception,' noting that a separate system like a battery is required. The other options describe the actual real-time conversion process detailed in the text.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author states that moonlight solar panels 'can generate electricity at night, during rain, and under overcast skies,' which directly supports their ability to function in low-light conditions.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of making renewable energy a feasible choice in diverse environments, 'viable' means 'practical'.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The text points out that floating wind farms are deployed far from land, where 'wind speeds are often stronger and more consistent,' providing the advantage of greater and steadier energy production.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The pronoun 'they' refers to the 'Photovoltaic (PV) cells' introduced in the preceding sentence. The inserted question logically sets up the subsequent sentences, which provide a step-by-step description of how the cells generate electricity.

2026-04-19 Ancient Aqueduct Engineering

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "feats" refers to remarkable accomplishments or achievements in the field of engineering.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author lists these locations immediately after stating that aqueducts were essential to Roman cities in order to provide specific examples of the water system's varied usefulness.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the Pont du Gard aqueduct features a "three-tiered bridge that remains standing today."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The text points out a specific challenge by stating that "constructing and maintaining aqueducts required significant resources and labor."

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence begins with "This meant," which logically refers back to the preceding sentence's mention of "using gravity to carry water." It cohesively explains the physical requirement of relying on gravity by stating the source had to be higher than the city.

2026-04-19 Medieval Philosophy Debates

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage centers on the philosophical debate between scholars like Abelard and Aquinas regarding the nature of universals, which the text defines as abstract concepts.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly describes Abelard's argument that universals are merely linguistic constructs as a "nominalist perspective."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that in Aquinas's theory of moderate realism, "the human mind perceives universals through experiences of particular things."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：In this context, "synthesis" means combination, referring to how Aquinas integrated elements of Aristotelian philosophy and nominalism into a single theory.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted question introduces the central debate regarding universals, providing a logical transition from the mention of the scholars' original ideas to the passage's detailed focus on this specific philosophical problem.

2026-04-15 Magnetic Confinement Fusion

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the basic principle of using powerful magnetic fields to contain extremely hot plasma was first demonstrated in 1957.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author notes that without magnetic containment, plasma would cool against the walls and halt the fusion process, which illustrates exactly why magnetic confinement is required.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "sophisticated" describes the highly complex and technologically advanced nature of the modern reactors researchers have built.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text clearly states that ITER's goal is to achieve "net energy gain," which means demonstrating that sustained fusion reactions can produce more energy than they consume.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage identifies the "enormous energy inputs" required to "maintain plasma conditions" as one of the significant challenges delaying commercial fusion electricity.

2026-04-15 Veganism in America

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage traces the rise in popularity of veganism between 2004 and 2019 and its subsequent plateau in the mid-2020s, explaining the various factors driving these shifting dietary attitudes.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage cites animal welfare, environmental concerns, and healthy eating as reasons for veganism's growth, but it never mentions the cost of meat as a contributing factor.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：In this context, "involved" means complicated, which is logically supported by the passage's subsequent example of a time-consuming process for making a vegan cheese substitute.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author provides the example of making a vegan cheese substitute to illustrate the preceding claim that preparing vegan meals can be an "involved" or time-consuming challenge.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states that commercially manufactured vegan foods "are highly processed, raising concerns about their healthfulness."

2026-04-13 Feedback System Complications

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 states that these closed-loop mechanisms "monitor their output and adjust their input accordingly," which directly supports the advantage of continuously monitoring their own performance.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that if the feedback response is not precisely calibrated, the system "may oscillate continuously, failing to stabilize," which means the temperature goes up and down.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The author uses the drone overreacting to minor disturbances as a specific illustration of unpredictable responses, explicitly referring to it in the next sentence as "This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：In the context of dealing with unpredictability to ensure reliability, "mitigating" means reducing or decreasing the negative effects of that unpredictability.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a concrete illustration of a drone overreacting to a minor disturbance (a gust of wind), making it the logical continuation of the preceding sentence that introduces erratic flight patterns in drones. The following sentence then correctly summarizes these examples as "This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior."

2026-04-13 Music Therapy Power

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the modern form of music therapy appeared after World War II when musicians played to help traumatized veterans.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "trigger" means to cause or bring about, as engaging with familiar music brings up pleasant memories for the patient.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author cites the 30-minute daily music study as empirical evidence to support the preceding claim that music therapy successfully reduces anxiety and stress.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage lists personal musical preferences, cultural background, and the context of the music as crucial factors for therapy success, making the patient's level of musical knowledge the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence refers to "Both cognitive and social benefits," which logically and cohesively follows the preceding sentence detailing how patients showed "better memory recall and increased social interaction."

2026-04-13 Quantum Computing Revolution

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "revolutionize" means to completely change or transform, which matches the passage's description of how quantum computing will dramatically alter technology by delivering unprecedented power.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts the binary bits of traditional computers with the qubits of quantum computers to explain the underlying mechanism that makes quantum computing vastly faster and more powerful.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that new, quantum-resistant techniques will be required because quantum computers "could potentially break these encryption algorithms with ease."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author mentions "external disturbances" to introduce a major operational challenge, pointing out that qubits require strict environmental conditions like extremely low temperatures and isolation to function properly.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The sentence begins with "Seeing progress," so it logically follows "Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating." It therefore belongs before "Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues," which is choice C.

2026-04-12 Genetically Modified Foods

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage first outlines how genetic modification can provide agricultural and nutritional solutions, and then details ecological, health, and economic concerns, effectively summarizing both the benefits and drawbacks of the technology.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In the context of problems facing humanity, "persistent" means enduring or continuing for a long time, making "long-lasting" the closest match.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：While the passage notes that GM crops can be engineered to grow in nutrient-poor soil, it never claims that the technology actually improves the fertility of the soil itself.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that patented GM seeds can increase farmers' dependence on large biotech companies, which directly supports the idea that farmers could be subjected to unfair control by businesses.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The author notes that this rapid pace has "fueled" strong public skepticism, thereby explaining one of the main reasons for public resistance to GM technology.

2026-04-11 Behavioral Economics

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：Choice C is supported by the passage's statement that cognitive biases, emotions, and social factors can 'lead to irrational choices,' contrasting with traditional theories of rational action.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, 'deviates' means to depart from an established standard, matching 'differs' as human behavior is shown to vary from traditional rational expectations.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly illustrates 'loss aversion' with the example of individuals who 'avoid selling a declining stock in the hope of recovering their losses,' even when a rebound is unlikely.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage defines anchoring as a situation where individuals 'rely too heavily on the first piece of information they receive,' which directly matches the investor's action in the correct choice.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase “This behavior” refers to the preceding example of irrationally holding a declining stock in hopes of recovering losses. Location 3 is best because the sentence then directly contrasts this emotion-driven behavior with the rational-theory recommendation that follows.

2026-04-11 Echoes Of The Deep

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：对。全文围绕鲸豚类如何使用回声定位、不同物种如何适应不同环境，以及噪音如何干扰这种适应能力展开。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：对。题目要求和 dolphins 对比：海豚定位 small, agile fish，而抹香鲸 dive deep to hunt prey such as giant squid；由这个对比可推出抹香鲸捕猎的对象不是小而敏捷的鱼，四个选项里 slower prey 最符合。

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：对。原句说 dolphins find and track small, agile fish，意思是发现并追踪这些鱼，所以 track 最接近 follow。

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：对。文中说 sonar and ship engines 等人为声音会干扰回声定位，这种 disruption 会造成 stress and disorientation，并增加 strandings 的风险。

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：对。such environments 指前一句 waters too deep for sunlight to penetrate；先说明在这种环境下听觉比视觉重要，再接 many cetaceans emit clicks，逻辑最顺。

2026-04-11 Sedimentary Rock Formation

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of the passage, pressure from overlying layers reduces sediment volume by squeezing or "forcing out" the water between particles.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the dual process of compaction and cementation, called lithification, transforms loose sediments into solid rock.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text explains that during cementation, dissolved minerals leave the groundwater to fill the spaces between particles, effectively binding them together.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage states that clastic sedimentary rocks, specifically giving the example of sandstone, are composed of fragments of pre-existing rocks.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：Fossils are mentioned to support the paragraph's opening claim that studying sedimentary rocks offers valuable insights into Earth's history and past environments.

2026-04-11 The Discovery of Vitamins

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that rice bran contains thiamine, which Casimir Funk identified as a nutrient "essential for life."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts the prevailing belief that diseases were caused by toxins or infections with Funk's idea that diseases could result from nutrient deficiency, highlighting exactly why Funk's proposal was considered revolutionary.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The text explains that Funk's extract was likely a "mixture of substances" and that researchers only later managed to successfully isolate thiamine "in its pure form."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the spelling was changed because scientists discovered many of these nutrients were not amines, not because they lacked importance; in fact, it calls them "Additional life-essential nutrients."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：This sentence provides a specific example of a nutrient lacking nitrogen, which logically follows the preceding statement that many newly discovered nutrients "were not amines" (defined in paragraph 2 as nitrogen compounds).

2026-04-11 Urartu Ironworking

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage outlines both geological (local ores) and military (competition with Assyria) theories before concluding that early ironworking was driven by a combination of rural production, royal support, and a complex network of laborers.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The author cites the low phosphorus content as proof of "high-quality local ore" in order to support the geological theory that the extraction of local mineral deposits drove Urartu's iron innovation.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states that Urartian kings funded foundries to build chariots faster than Assyria due to "external pressures," which directly points to a competitive military rivalry between the two kingdoms.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The discovery of "small village forges" is used to challenge the idea of strict centralized control, highlighting that rural production also played a significant role in the region's metallurgical revolution.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：In this context, a "premise" means an underlying assumption; the passage explicitly equates this word with an "idea" that scholars are now questioning.

2026-04-07 Chatbot Technology Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In the context of early chatbots following simple scripts to simulate human interaction, the word "mimic" means to copy or "imitate" conversation.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that early models like ELIZA failed to understand context, "making interactions feel artificial," which supports the idea that their communication seemed unnatural.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：According to the passage, natural language processing (NLP) has "enabled chatbots to handle complex queries," which directly translates to managing sophisticated inquiries.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Generative AI is introduced to explain the technology behind the "latest iterations" of chatbots, detailing how it drives the newest advancements that have "set a new standard."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states that a significant ongoing concern is "ensuring that chatbots do not generate harmful or biased content."

2026-04-07 Data Visualization Trends

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "anomalies" refers to unexpected or unusual data points that deviate from normal patterns, making "irregularities" the closest match.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage contrasts traditional charts with dynamic graphical representations, noting that the latter reveal patterns and unexpected shifts that traditional static tools like spreadsheets "could not capture."

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The final sentence of the paragraph explicitly introduces a limitation by using the word "However" and explaining that complex visual cues "can be overwhelming" for users.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage states that interactive dashboards are a significant development (Choice A), allow users to manipulate variables (Choice B), and are used to simulate market conditions (Choice C). However, it never mentions that these tools improve interpersonal communication among business leaders, making Choice D the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the statement about the "quality of data inputs," as it provides specific examples of poor data quality (incomplete or biased data) and explains how they negatively impact predictions.

2026-04-06 Courtroom Video Evidence

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The first sentence claims that technological advances have made cameras nearly ubiquitous, and the second sentence provides examples of this ubiquity, such as police body cameras, security cameras, and smartphones.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text states that a single camera angle might fail to capture what occurs outside the frame, leading viewers to misinterpret the event because they miss those unseen actions.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author explains that because videos lack interpersonal and emotional context, viewers might misjudge someone's motivations, such as incorrectly viewing an act of self-defense as antagonistic.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that legal experts find jurors tend to dismiss eyewitness testimonies as unreliable while trusting videos to show events more directly.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：In the context of reminding jurors to be aware of the limitations and potential misinterpretations of video evidence, 'cautiously' means 'carefully'.

2026-04-06 Social Network Influence

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly connects the concept of social capital to "how individuals within a network can influence the group's overall dynamics."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：Because homophily involves connecting with similar individuals and can "reinforce existing beliefs," it can be logically inferred that it promotes similarity and continuity rather than diversity.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The term "echo chambers" is used to describe a negative consequence of homophily, specifically highlighting how networks of similar people limit exposure to diverse perspectives.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In this context, "nuanced" refers to the subtle and intricate details of a situation, making "complex" the closest match for describing the ways social networks shape behavior.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence contrasts with the preceding discussion about individuals "disseminating information" and provides a cohesive transition into "Another factor is homophily," which introduces a different method of influence.

2026-04-05 Coral Reef Restoration

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that bleaching weakens corals and makes them more susceptible to disease and death, allowing us to infer that bleached corals are in an unhealthy state.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly lists climate change, pollution, and overfishing as severe threats to coral reefs, making tourism the only unmentioned exception.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author introduces Biorock™ technology right after stating 'Another innovative approach,' using it to exemplify a novel method being developed for coral restoration.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The final paragraph explicitly notes that restoration projects are 'often expensive and labor-intensive,' directly matching the challenge of being costly and requiring a lot of work.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：Because the final paragraph clearly states that 'the long-term success of these techniques is still uncertain,' it can be inferred that long-term successful outcomes are not yet guaranteed.

2026-04-05 Creative Thinking Skills

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph asks whether the expression "thinking outside the box" actually means what we think it does, prompting readers to reconsider their understanding of this widely held concept.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In this context, the word "mantra" refers to a frequently repeated phrase or expression, specifically the popular saying "thinking outside the box."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly states that de Bono considers creative thinking to be "not a rare biological gift but a skill" that people can use to produce new ideas.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage explains that blocking "habitual neural networks" allows us to alter the "self-organizing patterns in our heads," supporting the inference that these networks control how we automatically organize mental data.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The author recommends that readers "set the box on fire," which metaphorically means entirely eliminating traditional boundaries and typical ways of thinking.

2026-04-05 Cybernetic Prosthetic Technology

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of technology integrating with the human nervous system to allow natural movement, 'seamlessly' means 'smoothly' or without noticeable gaps or flaws.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage identifies myoelectric sensors as a key development in the cybernetic integration with the nervous system, an integration that is explicitly stated to allow 'for more natural movement.'

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the cybernetic hand's ability to perform delicate tasks is 'achieved through advanced algorithms that translate muscle signals into controlled movements.'

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Detecting electrical signals generated by muscle movements is described in the first paragraph as a function of myoelectric sensors, making it the unsupported exception for haptic feedback, which instead stimulates the skin and nerve endings.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence introduces the idea of 'obstacles' that need to be overcome, providing a logical transition into the final paragraph which lists specific challenges like high cost, maintenance requirements, and limited battery life.

2026-04-01 Landscape Connectivity

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The phrase "in turn" refers to something happening as a result in a sequence, indicating here that isolated populations subsequently cause a decrease in biodiversity.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The passage states that wildlife bridges and underpasses are created to "mitigate the effects of roads and highways," implying that these structures normally block or interfere with the free movement of animals.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 expands on the positive outcomes of the wildlife corridors discussed in paragraph 2 by listing specific examples of their benefits, such as enhanced pollination and pest control.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly associates isolated or separated wildlife groups with habitat fragmentation, making "stronger separation of wildlife groups" a negative consequence of reduced connectivity, not an effect of improved connectivity.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence describes an additional difficulty regarding the adaptability of corridor locations, which logically fits at [C] to complete the list of challenges right before the concluding sentence summarizes them as "these challenges."

2026-04-01 Urban Resilience

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that green infrastructure, such as parks and green roofs, can help manage stormwater and reduce flooding.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "foster" means to promote or encourage, as the participatory approach helps develop a sense of ownership and accountability among citizens.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The text indicates that when local governments involve residents in planning and decision-making processes, it fosters accountability and improves the effectiveness of resilience strategies.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Financial limitations ("budget constraints"), political disagreements, and integrating new technologies are all explicitly listed as obstacles, whereas community participation is described as a beneficial component rather than a challenge.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a specific example of a smart city initiative using technology to predict issues, making it a logical continuation of the preceding sentence at [A] which introduces using data and sensors to predict potential problems.

2026-03-29 Animal Culture Debate

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：正确。第一段说鲸鱼发展出 group-specific songs，并以此说明至少部分动物维持非纯遗传/本能的传统。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：正确。第二段用 cumulative innovation 来刻画“人类文化”的定义标准，从而说明为何有人反对把文化用于动物。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：正确。第三段说中间立场承认动物虽未必有人类意义上的文化，仍可显示初级文化现象。

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：正确。rudimentary cultural phenomena 指初级、基本的文化现象，basic 最贴近。

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：正确。这些长期假设把文化绑在人类独特性上；结合全文，作者认为过严的定义会被社会传递证据挑战。

2026-03-29 Film Festival Economics

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：对。开篇模式就是小社区 more durable… gains than global hubs，而大城市增幅很快 dissipate。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：对。第二段写地方政府 accelerate street improvements and cultural programming… seeding arts projects and year-round film screenings，即基建与艺术投入增加。

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：对。small baselines make percentage increases look dramatic，说明小社区收益可能看起来比实际更大。

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：对。if sponsorship wanes 表示赞助减少/减弱，与 decreases 最近。

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：对（EXCEPT）。第三段谈测量假象、收益不均与活动依赖，没有提环境破坏。

2026-03-29 Great Smog of London

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage states that the smog was "caused by cold weather, windless conditions, and pollutants," supporting the inference that multiple environmental and human factors aligned at the same time to create the event.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of people dying before their natural expected lifespan due to poor air quality, "premature" means happening before the normal time, making "early" the correct synonym.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage identifies the smog as a "pivotal event in environmental history" and explains this significance in the third paragraph by detailing how it spurred the British government to establish the Clean Air Act and other regulations.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author mentions the severe impact on ambulances immediately following the statement that "visibility was reduced to a few meters, and transportation was disrupted," using it as a concrete example of the consequences of the thick smog.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence provides an additional detail about local anti-pollution regulations, making it a logical continuation at Location [A] immediately following the discussion of the Clean Air Act's restrictions on coal burning.

2026-03-29 Smart Textiles

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly states that phase-change materials "adapt to temperature fluctuations, providing warmth when it is cold and cooling when it is hot."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly lists durability, washability, and cost as significant concerns for smart textiles, making availability the unmentioned exception.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the phrase "harvest energy from movement," the word "harvest" means to gather or collect the generated electricity for practical use.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 begins by stating that integrating technology "presents challenges," effectively shifting the passage's focus to outline obstacles like durability, cost, and privacy issues.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence asks the reader to imagine changing the appearance of furnishings, which logically follows and illustrates the mention of "interior design" immediately preceding location [C].

2026-03-29 The Flynn Effect

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, a "consistent" increase means a "steady" rise in IQ scores that continues reliably from one generation to the next.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage lists nutrition, healthcare, cognitive demands of modern life, and technology as possible contributing factors, but it never mentions improvements in parental care.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The text directly states that some researchers attribute the rise in IQ scores to "better test-taking skills or familiarity with the types of tasks presented" rather than a true increase in cognitive abilities.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author notes the slowing or reversing of the Flynn Effect specifically to show that it challenges "the notion of a universal and perpetual increase in intelligence."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "the downturn" in the inserted sentence directly refers to the Flynn Effect "slowing down or even reversing" mentioned in the preceding sentence, making location [D] the logical placement.

2026-03-28 AI and Employment

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage mentions the need for professionals to design and monitor systems immediately after stating that AI 'can create new employment opportunities.' This detail serves as a specific example explaining how AI generates those new jobs.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In the context of critics warning about 'job losses' and difficult transitions, describing manufacturing jobs as 'vulnerable' means they are susceptible to harm or 'at risk' of being eliminated by automation.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage identifies the transition to an AI-focused job market as potentially challenging specifically because employees 'need new skills,' which requires a 'significant investment in education and training.'

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The original sentence states that AI's impact is 'uncertain' because the 'balance between job creation and job displacement' is still being debated. The keyed choice accurately captures this core meaning by noting it remains unknown whether created jobs will outnumber displaced ones.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The pronoun 'This' in the inserted sentence refers directly back to the fact that technologies 'automate tasks once done by humans' in the preceding sentence. Placing the text here logically connects the automation process to the broader debate over job creation and displacement that follows.

2026-03-28 Ecological Systems Theory

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The author provides "a teacher's communication with parents" immediately after defining the mesosystem as an example to illustrate how relationships among microsystems function.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：In the context of "indirect influences" from a parent's workplace, "subtly affecting" means having an impact in small, indirect, or barely noticeable ways.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that critics argue the model underestimates the role of technology in creating "virtual microsystems," pointing to a need for incorporating these virtual interactions into the framework.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The first paragraph states that the theory "revolutionized our perception of human psychological development," and the final paragraph notes that it "remains influential in fields ranging from education to public policy."

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase "Each one" refers directly back to the "multiple overlapping environmental systems" mentioned in the preceding sentence, making location [B] the logical place to connect the systems to their distinct roles in shaping behavior.

2026-03-23 Beyond Philosophy's Borders

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage states that metaphilosophy questions whether the "universal truths" sought by traditional philosophy are actually accessible across diverse cultural and linguistic contexts.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The varying connotations of concepts across cultures are mentioned to highlight the potential limits of global philosophical frameworks, thereby justifying metaphilosophy's investigation into culturally contingent assumptions.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of frameworks developed in "specific cultural milieus," the word "milieus" refers to the social or cultural environments in which these ideas originate.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text states that "critics worry this reflexivity may stall progress," indicating the concern that metaphilosophical questioning might hinder philosophy from advancing its aims.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：This sentence presents a counterargument to metaphilosophy's skepticism by claiming that certain philosophical concerns are shared across societies, providing a basis for universality.

2026-03-23 Coastal Erosion Solutions

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "vulnerable" describes coastal areas that are susceptible to damage or harm from erosion, meaning they are at-risk.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：Sentence C explicitly lists human activities and climate change as factors that "exacerbate the problem," directly explaining why coastal erosion is becoming worse.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage introduces the installation of groynes as an entirely separate structural approach, making it the unsupported exception because it is not part of the sand-adding beach nourishment method.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage introduces groynes and seawalls immediately after mentioning the installation of structures, serving to identify them as specific structural solutions to coastal erosion.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The pronoun "They" refers back to "These natural buffers" (living shorelines), logically adding another positive effect just before the final sentence contrasts these benefits with the drawbacks of establishment time.

2026-03-17 Computational Drug Discovery

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that computational methods speed up discovery, citing an example where a compound was identified in weeks rather than the years it would have taken using traditional methods.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text states that machine learning algorithms predict the binding affinity of compounds to target proteins, thereby "narrowing down candidates for testing" by eliminating less promising options.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly mentions that simulating modifications and repeating the process "fine-tunes drug candidates to achieve optimal therapeutic profiles."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：In this context, a "formidable" task refers to one that is very difficult or demanding, which accurately describes the complex challenge of simulating the human body.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The sentence introduces a shift from the benefits and successes of computational methods to their limitations, making it the perfect transition right before the final paragraph discusses false positives and validation challenges.

2026-03-17 Floating Wind Turbines

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, to "harness" wind resources means to capture and make use of them, making "exploit" the closest match in meaning.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph directly states that floating wind turbines use advanced mooring systems, "allowing placement in deeper waters where winds are more consistent."

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author notes that floating turbines rely on buoyancy principles rather than solid ground, using this fact to explain why their design and maintenance are complex engineering challenges.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that marine conditions accelerate wear and tear, and immediately adds that experts are "investigating materials and designs to enhance durability." From this, it can be logically inferred that scientists are actively attempting to control this deterioration.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The pronoun "Others" and the verb "assess" logically follow the preceding sentence about "Some experts... investigating," creating a cohesive parallel structure about different research solutions before the paragraph's conclusion.

2026-03-17 Microseisms and Vibrations

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "subtle" means faint or delicate, which aligns with the passage's later description of these vibrations as "mild signals" that are easily masked by other noises.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly connects the creation of microseisms to colliding ocean waves and notes they are strongest when storms make these waves "more powerful," supporting the inference that vigorous wave collisions generate stronger vibrations.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The author provides these geological features as specific examples of the "details" that microseisms reveal, illustrating exactly what kind of important information these vibrations provide about the Earth's interior.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text directly states that in oil and gas exploration, microseisms are utilized to "identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The author introduces filtering and cross-referencing as necessary "advanced data analysis techniques" that researchers must employ to overcome the challenge of isolating and studying the mild signals of microseisms.

2026-03-15 Artificial Expert Systems

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In this context, to "mimic" means to copy or "imitate" the abilities of human experts, which is supported by the subsequent statement that the systems' goal is to "replicate" professional expertise.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that "MYCIN used rules provided by medical experts to analyze patient data, infer diagnoses, and suggest treatments."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text points out that because expert systems rely on static knowledge databases, they "can become outdated without ongoing input" and updating them is a "labor-intensive" process.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：While not directly stated, the passage notes that future systems could "learn from new data and adapt" to "operate more independently," supporting the inference that they will eventually be able to update themselves without human intervention.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The transitional word "Additionally" signals the introduction of another limitation, placing the sentence logically after the description of labor-intensive updates and immediately before the mention of how new technologies could address "these issues."

2026-03-15 Social Role Theory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of societal expectations and behaviors, "norms" refers to the customary standards or unwritten rules that govern how individuals in specific roles should act.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage introduces the parent and employee immediately after defining "role conflict," using the phrase "For instance" to provide a direct example of this concept in action.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The teacher is introduced as "An example" of role strain, which the preceding sentence defines as experiencing stress "within a single role due to competing demands."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The phrase "these dynamics" refers back to the processes described in the preceding sentences, specifically how "society evolves" and how the expectations and definitions of roles shift over time.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence provides specific examples of different roles (parent and soldier) and their expected behaviors, logically following the statement at [A] that "Society is structured by roles, each with specific behaviors and norms."

2026-03-14 Ancient Stoic Philosophy

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that Stoics believe focusing on things within one's control, such as actions and thoughts, leads to a peaceful and contented life.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In the context of the passage, "equanimity" means calmness, which aligns with the Stoic ideal of accepting uncontrollable events with inner tranquility.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author introduces public speaking with the phrase "For example" immediately after explaining that cognitive-behavioral therapy uses Stoic principles to help patients challenge irrational thoughts.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 1 establishes the foundational principles of ancient Stoicism, while paragraph 2 explores modern applications of these ideas through examples like the "Stoic pause" and cognitive-behavioral therapy.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the explanation of the "Stoic pause," as "taking a step back" directly expands upon the preceding idea of inserting a "moment of reflection before reacting emotionally."

2026-03-14 Libertarian Political Philosophy

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly defines libertarianism as emphasizing 'minimal government intervention' and freedom from 'undue state interference,' making choice C the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that libertarians oppose taxation because it acts as 'involuntary servitude that infringes on autonomy,' which is a direct violation of their central tenet of 'self-ownership.'

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of government regulations that 'stifle economic growth and limit freedom,' the word 'impediments' means obstacles or 'barriers' to economic progress.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The final paragraph explicitly states that 'balancing personal freedoms with the need of social welfare and infrastructure has been an issue of heated debate even among Libertarians themselves.'

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase 'Such intervention' must refer back to 'Government regulations' introduced in the preceding sentence, making the position immediately following that sentence the only logical placement.

2026-03-14 Sociocybernetics and Systems

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "amplifies" means to increase or intensify, as the passage notes that positive feedback magnifies changes to cause rapid social transformations.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage states that positive feedback can create booming markets and negative feedback can prevent financial crises. This allows for the inference that both types of feedback contribute beneficial stabilizing or growth outcomes to systems, even though this is not directly stated as a general rule.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that communication breakdowns can disrupt social cohesion, which directly supports the fact that effective communication is essential for maintaining that cohesion.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The passage states that sociocybernetics provides tools to analyze complex systems, and explicitly describes cities as "complex systems with numerous interacting components."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The phrase "The latter" refers directly to "cybernetics," which is the second of the two disciplines mentioned at the end of the first sentence ("sociology and cybernetics"). Placing the sentence here logically defines cybernetics just before the text discusses applying its specific principles.

2026-03-11 Quantum Dot Technology

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that when these nanoparticles are exposed to light, they emit colors that can be finely tuned by varying their size.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text attributes the energy conservation of quantum dot-enhanced televisions to the fact that they require less backlighting compared to conventional displays.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The passage highlights that while traditional displays use harmful heavy metals, quantum dots provide an environmental benefit because they can be made from less toxic materials.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The author notes the requirement for extreme precision as the direct cause for the remaining challenges in "scaling up" or increasing the production of quantum dots.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：According to the passage, the small size and bright emission of quantum dots make them ideal for tagging and tracking molecules in living organisms.

2026-03-11 Urban Noise Control

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of facing a difficult challenge like noise pollution, the word 'grappling' means struggling to deal with or overcome the issue.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that green walls 'can absorb, reflect, or deflect sound waves,' which explains how they disrupt the path of sound to reduce noise.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Because the creation of quiet zones led to a 'decrease in stress-related health issues' in some European cities, it can be inferred that noise pollution was previously contributing to those health problems.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：This sentence specifically names 'buildings or road surfaces' as the architectural elements where these noise-cancelling materials are used.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The new sentence gives an example of a specific noise source ('One common source is traffic'), which logically follows and supports the broad statement 'It has many causes.'

2026-03-08 Antimicrobial Resistance Challenges

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：对。不加选择地使用抗生素加速耐药菌出现，解释了 AMR 为何成为全球威胁。

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：对。第 1 句说明基因突变和基因共享让细菌存活繁殖，直接解释耐药机制。

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：对。抗生素比慢性病药物回报低，因此药企缺乏投资动力。

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：对。comprehensive 指覆盖多方面的协调策略，对应 thorough。

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：对。文章列出管制处方、药企激励和公众教育，没有提出加大感染预防投资。

2026-03-08 Biochemical Systems Theory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In this context, the word "hinges" means "depends," indicating that the biochemical systems theory relies entirely upon mathematical models to predict molecular interactions.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 introduces biochemical systems theory and its potential benefits, while paragraph 2 highlights a major shortcoming by explaining how the theory's reliance on precise data can lead to uncertain and skewed predictions.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author discusses drug development as a specific example where "erroneous data can skew predictions," highlighting the crucial need for accurate data when constructing these complex mathematical models.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：While the passage does not explicitly state the current status of the ethical debates, the description of these discussions as being "as dynamic as the biochemical networks themselves" implies that the concerns are continuously evolving and far from being resolved.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The phrase "these actions" provides a cohesive reference back to the researchers' identification of "processes ripe for intervention" in the preceding sentence. Placing the sentence here logically introduces the specific ethical worries that provoke the broader concerns detailed in the subsequent text.

2026-03-08 Hollywood Golden Age

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the system often limited creative freedom with "restrictive contracts," but "this very constraint led to unexpected innovation" as filmmakers adapted to these boundaries.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In this context, a "compelling" story is one that is highly engaging and powerfully captures the audience's attention, making "fascinating" the most accurate synonym.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The author notes that the introduction of sound was a pivotal change that "pushed directors to experiment with narrative structures," illustrating how the technology fostered new cinematic storytelling techniques.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage states that the ruling dismantled studio monopolies over theaters, thereby opening the door for independent filmmakers' stories to begin "gaining traction in theaters."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The passage infers this ongoing impact by concluding that the "legacy of the studio system's efficiency and star-making machinery," which was earlier defined as an "assembly-line process," continues to influence Hollywood today.

2026-03-08 Modern Detective Fiction

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：对。城市化使 crime became more visible and more sensational, creating public fascination with both criminals and their pursuers。

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：对。more visible and more sensational 与公众 fascinate 相连，指耸人听闻/令人震惊，与 shocking 最近。

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：对。which introduced the archetype of the brilliant, analytical investigator，点明引入了一类人物原型。

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：对。第二段强调 observation and logic / scientific reasoning；第三段写叙事克服 chaos、提供 moral reassurance，合起来即逻辑推理对抗社会失序。

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：对。第三段写 industrialization 带来对克服混乱叙事的 longing，Detective fiction met that need，即满足大众心理需求。

2026-03-08 Parallel Computing Algorithms

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 contrasts sequential algorithms, which check data "one by one," with parallel algorithms that "solve problems faster," indicating that sequential algorithms are less efficient.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author uses the virus simulation as a specific example to support the preceding claim that "parallel algorithms play a crucial role" in the field of healthcare.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The final sentence of paragraph 2 identifies a specific challenge or limitation, explicitly stating that "the system slows down" when too much data is processed without proper management.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：In this context, to "tailor" means to customize or modify algorithms so they work efficiently on specific hardware, which perfectly aligns with the meaning of "adapt."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence summarizes the "many advantages" discussed throughout the text and broadens the scope to future applications, making it a logical concluding statement at the very end of the passage (Location D).

2026-03-08 Smart Textiles

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly states that phase-change materials "adapt to temperature fluctuations, providing warmth when it is cold and cooling when it is hot."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly lists "Durability, washability, and cost" as significant concerns, making availability the only option that is not mentioned as a challenge in the passage.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of the phrase "harvest energy from movement," the word "harvest" means to gather or collect the generated electricity.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 3 shifts the passage's focus from the benefits and innovations of smart textiles to the "challenges" and "concerns" of integrating this technology, such as durability, cost, and privacy.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence gives an example of changing "furnishings," which directly connects to and elaborates on the "new possibilities for both fashion and interior design" mentioned immediately before location [C].

2026-03-04 Spicy Cuisine Advantages

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage primarily discusses recent scientific studies and scientists' conclusions regarding why hot-climate cuisines feature a greater amount and variety of spices.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly describes a study that compared the number of different spices found in traditional recipes from Southeast Asian countries versus those from northern Europe.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage states that scientists have pointed to the "antimicrobial properties of spices, which prevent the growth of dangerous foodborne microorganisms."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage mentions that food spoilage in hot climates was a major concern before the availability of refrigeration, but it never claims that spices themselves require refrigeration to maintain their antimicrobial function.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：In the context of the sentence stating that food safety led to the widespread use of spices in hot regions, the word "precipitated" means brought about or caused.

2026-03-04 Urban Resilience Strategies

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that green infrastructure, such as parks and green roofs, helps to "manage stormwater and reduce flooding."

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "foster" a sense of ownership and accountability means to promote or encourage those feelings among citizens.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage explains that local governments involving residents creates a "participatory approach" that improves "the effectiveness of resilience strategies."

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：Budget constraints, political disagreements, and the integration of new technologies are all listed in the final paragraph as obstacles, whereas community participation is described as a beneficial component rather than a challenge.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a specific real-world example of using artificial intelligence to monitor systems and predict traffic problems, making it logically follow the sentence introducing smart city initiatives and sensor technology.

2026-03-04 Wind Ensemble Conducting

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, forming diverse musicians into a "cohesive" unit means bringing them together into a unified or "integrated" whole.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that balancing the ensemble is challenging because "wind instruments produce a wide range of dynamics and timbres," which translates to a wide variety of sound qualities and volume levels.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 focuses on the need to interpret scores accurately, specifically emphasizing the difficulty of conveying the vision behind complex and unconventional modern compositions.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage states that conductors working with composers "may need to adjust their style to suit different compositions and settings," supporting the inference that the process requires flexibility and an openness to new ideas rather than being uniform or argumentative.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence introduces the idea that these conductors face a "unique set of difficulties," which perfectly bridges the first paragraph's mention of their specific "interpretive and technical skills" and the second paragraph's introduction of "One challenge of wind ensemble conducting."

2026-03-02 Education Growth Mindset

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of facing and working through difficulties, the word 'persevere' means to persist or continue making an effort despite obstacles.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that students with a growth mindset 'see effort as a path to mastery' and believe they can 'improve with practice'.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states that educators can foster a growth mindset by 'praising effort rather than innate ability,' which makes praising innate abilities the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The text points out that one of the challenges in implementing these strategies is that 'Some students may find it difficult to change how they view their abilities.'

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The demonstrative phrase 'This reluctance' in the inserted sentence directly refers back to students finding it 'difficult to change how they view their abilities,' providing a cohesive link when placed immediately after that statement.

2026-03-02 Urban Green Spaces

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, a "respite" refers to a rest or relief, meaning the green spaces offer a visual break from the surrounding concrete and glass structures.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 focuses on how green spaces benefit residents' health and well-being, while paragraph 2 introduces a new set of benefits regarding environmental sustainability.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly states that involving community members in the planning and maintenance of green spaces fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The author introduces rising rents as a direct result of increased property values, providing an example of the "drawbacks" or disadvantages associated with creating urban green spaces.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence describes facilities like playgrounds and sports fields that make activity accessible, providing a logical continuation of the preceding sentence's point about how green spaces "encourage physical activity."

2026-02-28 Feedback System Complications

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 states that these closed-loop mechanisms "monitor their output and adjust their input accordingly," which directly supports the advantage of continuously monitoring their own performance.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 2 explicitly states that if the feedback response is not precisely calibrated, the system "may oscillate continuously, failing to stabilize," which means the temperature goes up and down.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The author uses the drone overreacting to minor disturbances as a specific illustration of unpredictable responses, explicitly referring to it in the next sentence as "This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：In the context of dealing with unpredictability to ensure reliability, "mitigating" means reducing or decreasing the negative effects of that unpredictability.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a concrete illustration of a drone overreacting to a minor disturbance (a gust of wind), making it the logical continuation of the preceding sentence that introduces erratic flight patterns in drones. The following sentence then correctly summarizes these examples as "This phenomenon, known as chaotic behavior."

2026-02-28 Music Therapy Power

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the modern form of music therapy appeared after World War II when musicians played to help traumatized veterans.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "trigger" means to cause or bring about, as engaging with familiar music brings up pleasant memories for the patient.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author cites the 30-minute daily music study as empirical evidence to support the preceding claim that music therapy successfully reduces anxiety and stress.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage lists personal musical preferences, cultural background, and the context of the music as crucial factors for therapy success, making the patient's level of musical knowledge the unsupported exception.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence refers to "Both cognitive and social benefits," which logically and cohesively follows the preceding sentence detailing how patients showed "better memory recall and increased social interaction."

2026-02-28 Quantum Computing Revolution

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "revolutionize" means to completely change or transform, which matches the passage's description of how quantum computing will dramatically alter technology by delivering unprecedented power.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author contrasts the binary bits of traditional computers with the qubits of quantum computers to explain the underlying mechanism that makes quantum computing vastly faster and more powerful.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that new, quantum-resistant techniques will be required because quantum computers "could potentially break these encryption algorithms with ease."

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author mentions "external disturbances" to introduce a major operational challenge, pointing out that qubits require strict environmental conditions like extremely low temperatures and isolation to function properly.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The sentence begins with "Seeing progress," so it logically follows "Despite the challenges, progress is accelerating." It therefore belongs before "Scientists are developing error-correcting codes and stable qubit designs to address these issues," which is choice C.

2026-02-25 Generational Identity Study

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：Sentence 2 states the factual circumstances of Gen Z's technological upbringing, while sentence 3 describes the potential consequence, noting that 'this has led to claims' about their digital literacy and skepticism.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In the context of economic conditions that might negatively influence trust, 'precarity' refers to insecurity, instability, or vulnerability.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that unlike millennials, Gen Z has never known a world without 'pervasive digital surveillance,' indicating they are more accustomed to constant observation.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The text notes that focusing solely on technological immersion as the cause of Gen Z's skepticism 'may overlook other factors,' such as economic instability and political polarization, that also influence their trust.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The final paragraph points out that 'scholars believe that generational differences are overstated' and that the explanatory power of the Gen Z versus millennial dichotomy 'may be limited.'

2026-02-25 Parallel Computing Algorithms

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that parallel algorithms "solve problems faster" by checking multiple portions of data simultaneously, rather than checking items "one by one as in a sequential algorithm," indicating that sequential algorithms are slower and less efficient.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The example of simulating a virus's spread is introduced immediately after stating that "In healthcare, parallel algorithms play a crucial role," serving to illustrate this exact point.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The final sentence of the paragraph introduces a limitation or challenge, explaining that without proper management, sending too much data to the processors causes the system to slow down.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：In this context, "tailor" means to customize or alter something for a specific purpose, which aligns with "adapt" as developers modify algorithms to work on specific hardware.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence summarizes the "many advantages" of parallel algorithms and makes a concluding prediction about future innovations, making it a logical concluding sentence at the very end of the passage.

2026-02-23 Coral Reef Restoration

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that coral bleaching weakens corals and increases their susceptibility to disease and death, supporting the inference that bleached corals are in an unhealthy state.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The first paragraph explicitly lists climate change, pollution, and overfishing as severe threats to coral reefs, leaving tourism as the only unmentioned exception.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author introduces Biorock technology to provide a specific example of "another innovative approach" used by scientists to stimulate coral growth and restore reefs.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The final paragraph explicitly notes that a major challenge is that restoration projects are "expensive and labor-intensive," which directly means they are costly and require significant work.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：Because the passage explicitly states that the long-term success of restoration techniques is "still uncertain," it can be logically inferred that this success is not yet guaranteed.

2026-02-23 Philosophical Value Theory

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that value theory investigates what makes something good, whether values are subjective preferences, and the difference between intrinsic and instrumental value, making choice C the only unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The phrase refers directly back to the preceding sentence's definition of utilitarianism, which posits that the moral worth of actions is determined by their consequences.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In the context of dividing and dispensing limited healthcare resources to populations, the word "allocating" means distributing or apportioning.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text states that critics believe utilitarianism's focus on the happiness of the majority can "negate individual rights" and disadvantage specific people, such as those with rare conditions.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The passage states that value pluralism emphasizes navigating multiple competing goods rather than "reducing them to a single metric," indicating that ethical decisions should not be based on just one criterion.

2026-02-23 Synthetic Diamond Production

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph states that extracting natural diamonds is "fraught with environmental concerns" and introduces synthetic diamonds as a "promising alternative," indicating they are less harmful to the environment.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In the context of producing synthetic diamonds by copying the extreme heat and pressure under which natural diamonds form, "replicating" means recreating.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage notes that HPHT diamonds "can be produced quickly and in large quantities," whereas CVD production is "more technically demanding and slower," supporting the idea that HPHT diamonds are easier to produce.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The author cites the "rarity and historical significance" associated with natural diamonds as the reason why consumers are "often skeptical of synthetic diamonds," explaining a limitation in their market acceptance.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence adds industrial uses to the discussion of synthetic diamond applications, providing a logical continuation immediately after the preceding sentence explains their suitability for jewelry. Placing it before the next sentence ensures a smooth transition before the text shifts to consumer skepticism.

2026-02-10 Artificial Expert Systems

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of artificial intelligence designed to replicate human decision-making abilities, the word "mimic" means to copy or "imitate."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explains that expert systems generally apply "a set of rules" to solve problems, and that MYCIN specifically inferred diagnoses by asking questions about "a patient's data."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text explicitly notes that a major limitation is that these systems "needed constant updates" and "cannot adapt without ongoing input from human experts."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：Because the text states that future systems integrating machine learning could "learn from new data and adapt" to "operate more independently," it can be inferred that they will eventually update themselves without human intervention.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The transition word "Additionally" introduces another drawback, logically following the preceding sentences that detail limitations like labor-intensive updates, and adding to "these issues" that machine learning could subsequently address.

2026-02-10 Artificial Photosynthesis Technology

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The author contrasts traditional solar panels, which generate electricity directly, with artificial photosynthesis, which produces storable chemical fuels. This comparison clarifies the unique energy conversion method of the new technology.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly states that chemical fuels produced by artificial photosynthesis offer an advantage because they "can be stored for longer periods than electricity from solar panels."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of providing a realistic or practical answer to future energy needs despite technical barriers, "viable" means capable of working successfully, which matches "workable."

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：Paragraph 2 describes how the technology functions and its promising advantages, while paragraph 3 contrasts this by outlining the "significant hurdles" and challenges preventing its widespread use.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The author identifies the need for durable catalysts as "one major challenge" facing the technology, using it to illustrate the significant hurdles in sustaining the required chemical reactions.

2026-02-10 Binary Star Formation

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage focuses on recent observations of the Perseus molecular cloud, which led to the conclusion that stars similar in size to the Sun initially form as part of a binary pair.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In this context, to "penetrate" the dust and gases means to pass through them, allowing scientists to map the dense cores using radio waves.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage notes that discovering all young stars form in pairs has "surprising implications" for the Sun, indicating that scientists previously believed the Sun did not form with a binary twin.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The word "estimates" refers directly back to the scientists' predictions in the preceding sentence regarding "the paths along which binary stars traveled" within the molecular cloud.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：While the text does not explicitly narrate the Sun's early movements, it applies a general rule to the Sun that binary stars "first moved closer to each other and later separated," which strongly supports the inference that the Sun moved closer to a twin early in its development.

2026-02-10 Mathematical Approximation Theory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explains that simplified functions are used to build algorithms, which are explicitly defined as "step-by-step procedures that solve problems efficiently."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text directly states that polynomial approximation "uses basic math expressions... to stand in for more complicated functions."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of separating repeating patterns into individual sine and cosine waves, the word "decomposes" means "breaks down."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage specifically notes that engineers use the Fourier series in signal processing "to filter out noise."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The author defines "the error" as the difference between original and simplified functions immediately after stating that accuracy is a challenge, illustrating the difficulty of achieving precise approximations.

2026-02-10 Urban Green Spaces

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, a 'respite' refers to a visual break or relief from the overwhelming concrete and glass structures of the city.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 1 focuses on the health and recreational benefits for residents, while Paragraph 2 introduces an additional benefit by discussing their contribution to environmental sustainability.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The third paragraph explicitly states that involving community members in the planning and maintenance of green spaces fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The author introduces rising rents immediately after stating that green spaces are 'not without drawbacks,' using it as a specific example of a disadvantage that displaces residents.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides specific examples of facilities that support 'such activity,' which refers directly back to the 'physical activity' mentioned at the end of the first paragraph.

2026-02-08 Climate and Reefs

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage defines coral bleaching as a phenomenon caused by rising sea temperatures that results in weakened corals, demonstrating that it is a harmful effect of high heat.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly states that ocean acidification "reduces the availability of calcium carbonate," which is a crucial component needed for building coral skeletons.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of addressing the harmful effects of climate change on reefs, "mitigate" means to lessen or "alleviate" the severity of these negative impacts.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as "potential solutions" to help develop coral species that are resilient to temperature and acidity changes.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces broader ecological consequences of the lack of calcium carbonate, signaled by the phrase "also reduces." It logically follows the preceding sentence's description of the direct physical effects on coral structures, building upon the ideas of diminished reef growth and stability.

2026-02-08 Earth Climate Engineering

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that ESEM combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making to devise solutions, demonstrating that it relies on multiple disciplines to accomplish its goals.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text explains that SRM aims to cool the planet by reflecting sunlight, mitigating the effects of global warming, whereas CDR directly targets the cause by reducing greenhouse gas concentrations.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "feasibility" refers to the workability or practical viability of the technology, which is a concern because many of the proposed techniques are still experimental.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage highlights ethical and governance issues by asking "who controls these interventions," which directly corresponds to the ongoing question of who bears responsibility for implementing these changes.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the warning about unintended consequences causing more harm than good, as it suggests that careful assessment of long-term impacts is necessary to avoid such harm.

2026-02-08 Electromagnetic Bone Healing

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In the context of the passage, 'promoting' means encouraging or aiding a process, making 'supporting' the correct synonym for how EMFs help bone healing.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage contrasts EMF therapy with traditional treatments by stating that EMF therapy is 'non-invasive and produces few side effects,' which implies that traditional treatments likely produce more side effects.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The author cites a study showing that EMFs accelerate healing by up to 50 percent to provide concrete evidence demonstrating the effectiveness of the therapy.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly states that 'Researchers are uncertain of how the mechanisms interact,' which directly supports the idea that the interaction between EMF-driven mechanisms remains unknown.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The pronoun 'They' refers back to the 'Researchers' mentioned in the preceding sentence. The phrase 'also disagree' logically builds upon the previous sentence's list of things researchers are already 'uncertain of,' making the final position the most coherent placement.

2026-02-08 Green Chemistry Innovations

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：The preceding sentence introduces 'Green chemistry, an area of study within organic chemistry,' making 'This field' a direct reference to green chemistry as the primary subject being described.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：In this context, a 'breakthrough' refers to a significant scientific discovery or success, which means an 'advancement.' This is confirmed later in the text when the author introduces the next point with 'Another advancement is...'

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly contrasts the decomposition times, stating that traditional plastics 'can take centuries to decompose' while plastics made from corn starch 'can break down in months.'

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The text states that MOFs degrade pollutants into harmless compounds, 'which can aid in water and air purification,' supporting the idea that they make water and air cleaner.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage states that using water as a solvent replaces toxic solvents (B), creates more sustainable processes (C), and can make reactions proceed faster (D). It does not mention using water to produce catalysts, making choice A the unsupported exception.

2026-02-08 Mathematical Approximation Theory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explains that simplified functions are used to build algorithms, which are explicitly defined as "step-by-step procedures that solve problems efficiently."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text directly states that polynomial approximation "uses basic math expressions... to stand in for more complicated functions."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of separating repeating patterns into individual sine and cosine waves, the word "decomposes" means "breaks down."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage specifically notes that engineers use the Fourier series in signal processing "to filter out noise."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The author defines "the error" as the difference between original and simplified functions immediately after stating that accuracy is a challenge, illustrating the difficulty of achieving precise approximations.

2026-02-08 Smart Textile Technology

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：Paragraph 1 explicitly states that phase-change materials 'adapt to temperature fluctuations, providing warmth when it is cold and cooling when it is hot.'

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly lists durability, washability, and cost as significant concerns, but it does not mention availability as a challenge for smart textiles.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of 'harvest energy from movement,' the word 'harvest' means to collect or gather energy to be used as electricity.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：After the first two paragraphs describe the innovative benefits of smart textiles, paragraph 3 pivots to present the practical obstacles to their widespread adoption, such as cost and privacy concerns.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a concrete example of changing the appearance of furnishings, which logically follows and expands upon the mention of textiles changing color or pattern for 'interior design' just before location [C].

2026-02-04 Earth Climate Engineering

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that ESEM combines engineering, environmental science, and policy-making to devise solutions, demonstrating that it relies on multiple disciplines to accomplish its goals.

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text explains that SRM aims to cool the planet by reflecting sunlight, mitigating the effects of global warming, whereas CDR directly targets the cause by reducing greenhouse gas concentrations.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In this context, "feasibility" refers to the workability or practical viability of the technology, which is a concern because many of the proposed techniques are still experimental.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage highlights ethical and governance issues by asking "who controls these interventions," which directly corresponds to the ongoing question of who bears responsibility for implementing these changes.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence logically follows the warning about unintended consequences causing more harm than good, as it suggests that careful assessment of long-term impacts is necessary to avoid such harm.

2026-02-04 Mathematical Approximation Theory

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage explains that simplified functions are used to build algorithms, which are explicitly defined as "step-by-step procedures that solve problems efficiently."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text directly states that polynomial approximation "uses basic math expressions... to stand in for more complicated functions."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of separating repeating patterns into individual sine and cosine waves, the word "decomposes" means "breaks down."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage specifically notes that engineers use the Fourier series in signal processing "to filter out noise."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The author defines "the error" as the difference between original and simplified functions immediately after stating that accuracy is a challenge, illustrating the difficulty of achieving precise approximations.

2026-02-03 Climate and Reefs

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage defines coral bleaching as a phenomenon caused by rising sea temperatures that results in weakened corals, demonstrating that it is a harmful effect of high heat.

Q2. 正确答案：C

Q2. 解析：The text explicitly states that ocean acidification "reduces the availability of calcium carbonate," which is a crucial component needed for building coral skeletons.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：In the context of addressing the harmful effects of climate change on reefs, "mitigate" means to lessen or "alleviate" the severity of these negative impacts.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The passage notes that scientists are exploring selective breeding and genetic modification as "potential solutions" to help develop coral species that are resilient to temperature and acidity changes.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces broader ecological consequences of the lack of calcium carbonate, signaled by the phrase "also reduces." It logically follows the preceding sentence's description of the direct physical effects on coral structures, building upon the ideas of diminished reef growth and stability.

2026-02-03 Dinosaur Feather Evolution

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, 'traces' refers to the surviving marks or signs of feathers found alongside the skeletal fossils.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that the discovery of Sinosauropteryx 'showed that feathers were more common among dinosaurs than previously thought.'

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The author mentions Caudipteryx's complex, bird-like feathers to support the idea 'that feathers evolved in stages, becoming more sophisticated over time.'

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：While paragraph 2 describes the physical evidence and structure of feathers on specific dinosaurs, paragraph 3 focuses on the possible functions and roles those feathers played.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The insertion sentence introduces an additional function for feathers, signaled by the word 'also', making it logically follow the other proposed uses like regulating temperature, mating displays, and camouflage.

2026-02-03 Microseisms Earth Vibrations

Q1. 正确答案：A

Q1. 解析：In this context, "subtle" describes vibrations that are later referred to as "mild signals" easily masked by noise, making "faint" the closest meaning.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage states that microseisms are caused by colliding ocean waves and are strongest during storms when waves are more powerful, supporting the inference that the vigorous collision of larger waves generates the stronger signals.

Q3. 正确答案：D

Q3. 解析：The author lists variations in rock density and faults as specific examples of the "details about the geological structures" that microseisms reveal, illustrating the kind of important information they provide about the Earth's interior.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explicitly states that in oil and gas exploration, microseisms are used to "identify potential drilling sites by highlighting subsurface structures."

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The passage notes that accurately studying microseisms is challenging, and researchers specifically employ these filtering and cross-referencing techniques to interpret the subtle signals.

2026-02-02 Mysteries of Opal

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage states that unlike most gemstones, opals are amorphous and 'lack a fixed internal shape.' Therefore, the claim that their structure is rigid and non-varying is the unsupported exception.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The author notes that silica spheres in opals diffract light and separate it into colors 'much like a prism does,' using the prism to illustrate the stone's effect on light.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text explains that the noncrystalline structure of opals makes them fragile and prone to cracking, which consequently requires jewelers to use techniques like laser cutting and humidity-controlled storage to protect them.

Q4. 正确答案：C

Q4. 解析：The passage explicitly states that ancient cultures believed opals had 'mystical properties and brought good luck,' directly supporting the idea that they associated the stones with special powers and good fortune.

Q5. 正确答案：B

Q5. 解析：In the context of mystical properties, 'prophecy' refers to the supernatural ability to foresee or predict the future, which the ancient Greeks believed opals granted.

2026-02-02 Shifting Playwriting Art

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage primarily discusses how innovative techniques, such as nonlinear narratives and interactive performances, are reshaping narrative structures and deepening audience engagement.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The text notes that in "Mother Courage," characters simply address the audience directly, whereas "Sleep No More" goes further by allowing viewers to physically move through the performance space to participate.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：Paragraph 3 explicitly introduces a "broader hypothesis" about the discussed techniques, offering a theoretical conjecture that theatrical form itself is a vital part of creating meaning.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：In the context of bringing about new emotional and intellectual responses from the audience, the word "evoke" means to bring forth or elicit, which is closest in meaning to "produce."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The passage mentions presenting events out of order (nonlinear narratives), characters speaking to the audience (breaking the fourth wall), and viewers moving through the space, but it never mentions playwrights acting in their own plays.

2026-02-01 AI Disease Diagnosis

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The passage explicitly states that AI helps medical professionals by "processing vast amounts of data quickly," highlighting its efficiency in handling large datasets.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The author lists social media and search engines as specific sources of data that AI analyzes in order to predict disease outbreaks and track infectious diseases.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：In this context, "tailored" means customized or personalized, as the treatments are specifically designed to fit an individual's unique genetic makeup, lifestyle, and medical history.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The text explains that algorithmic bias occurs when AI systems are trained on data that "doesn't fully represent all groups of people," indicating a lack of equal representation.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence provides a logical transition between the first paragraph, which focuses entirely on medical image analysis, and the second paragraph, which introduces AI's distinct ability to predict disease outbreaks from textual data.

2026-02-01 Behavioral Economics Concepts

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：The first paragraph establishes that unlike traditional theories assuming rationality, behavioral economics is based on the finding that cognitive biases, emotions, and social factors can lead individuals to make irrational choices.

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：In this context, "deviates" means departs or differs from the rational expectations proposed by traditional economic theories.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly illustrates loss aversion with the example of individuals who hold onto a declining stock in the hope of recovering their losses, even when a rebound is unlikely.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The passage defines "anchoring" as a concept where individuals rely too heavily on the very first piece of information they receive when making a decision.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The phrase "This behavior" refers back to the illogical action of holding onto a declining stock described in the preceding sentence. Placing the inserted sentence here effectively contrasts this emotional response with the objective "Rational theory" introduced in the following sentence.

2026-01-28 Flynn Effect

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：In this context, "consistent" describes an increase that happens regularly and reliably across generations, which is closest in meaning to "steady."

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly mentions improvements in nutrition and healthcare, cognitive demands of modern life, and the use of technology as contributing factors, making choice B the only unmentioned exception.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly states that some researchers believe the rise in IQ scores reflects "better test-taking skills" rather than an actual increase in cognitive abilities.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author notes that the Flynn Effect might be slowing down or reversing in order to challenge the idea of a "universal and perpetual increase in intelligence."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "the downturn" in the inserted sentence directly refers back to the idea that the Flynn Effect is "slowing down or even reversing," making it a logical continuation after the final sentence.

2026-01-27 Bird Migration Patterns

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage states that bird migration evolved and became widespread "[d]uring the Ice Age, when average temperatures were frigid," indicating that the behavior began when global climates were much colder.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The statement outlines the food chain from algae to zooplankton to small marine animals, which explains how increased sunlight in polar summer regions results in abundant prey for migrating Arctic terns.

Q3. 正确答案：A

Q3. 解析：The passage describes the terns' record-breaking migration distance, their polar habitats, and their diet of small marine animals, but it never mentions them taking different routes depending on resource availability, making this the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：Rock ptarmigans are introduced immediately after the statement "Not all birds migrate," serving as an example of a sedentary species whose behavior contrasts with the migratory adaptations of Arctic terns.

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：In the context of retreating into snow burrows to avoid winter weather and conserve energy, the word "shelter" means to take protection.

2026-01-27 Harmonic Analysis Structures

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of detecting irregularities or hidden structures in financial data, "anomalies" refers to deviations from the norm, which is best matched by the word "inconsistencies."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：While the first paragraph notes that harmonic analysis is used to identify musical frequencies and detect financial anomalies, it never claims that the method is more effective in music than it is in finance.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The second paragraph explicitly states that in signal processing, the Fourier transform isolates frequency components, "making it easier to filter out noise and enhance signal clarity."

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author discusses quantum mechanics immediately after signal processing to provide a second concrete example of how the Fourier transform's ability to decompose functions is applied.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence explains the mechanism of "data compression" by describing the reduction of file sizes, so it logically fits right after compression is introduced and just before the specific application in "image processing."

2026-01-21 Augmented Reality Training

Q1. 正确答案：C

Q1. 解析：In the context of describing a highly innovative and transformative new tool in human performance technology, "groundbreaking" means pioneering or "revolutionary".

Q2. 正确答案：B

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that AR overlays digital information on the real world to provide "immersive experiences that enhance learning and skill acquisition."

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The first paragraph notes that AR allows trainees to learn intricate processes "without the risks associated with real-world practice," indicating that it minimizes physical dangers.

Q4. 正确答案：D

Q4. 解析：The author references studies showing improved retention and performance to provide evidence that AR applications are highly effective and beneficial across various industries, such as medicine and aviation.

Q5. 正确答案：A

Q5. 解析：The final paragraph highlights that AR integration requires "substantial investment in hardware and software development" and specialized expertise, reflecting the high costs of tailoring the technology for specific organizational needs.

2026-01-21 Green Roof Benefits

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：In the context of absorbing rainfall and decreasing runoff, "minimizing" means reducing or "lowering" the risks of flooding.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：The passage explicitly states that "conventional roofs absorb and radiate heat, increasing urban temperatures," which indicates that traditional roofs contribute to the urban heat island problem.

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The text notes that green roofs keep buildings cooler by "providing insulation and emitting moisture," and that this insulation reduces the need for heating and cooling to create energy savings.

Q4. 正确答案：B

Q4. 解析：The author references vegetative layers to explain how green roofs "create habitats for insects and birds," providing evidence for the paragraph's main point about supporting urban biodiversity.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The inserted sentence introduces a second drawback (ongoing maintenance) using the transition word "Additionally," so it logically follows the first drawback about installation costs and precedes the contrasting sentence beginning with "However."

2026-01-21 Plant Chemical Communication

Q1. 正确答案：D

Q1. 解析：The passage states that traditionally, plants were considered "passive organisms" that merely reacted to environmental changes rather than "actively engaging with their surroundings."

Q2. 正确答案：D

Q2. 解析：The text explains that attacked corn plants release specific warning chemicals, which are identified earlier in the paragraph as being "carried by root exudates."

Q3. 正确答案：C

Q3. 解析：The passage explicitly notes that electrical signals travel through the plant to allow it "to adjust resource allocation," which logically infers the purpose of optimizing the use of available resources.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：According to the third paragraph, detecting the presence of other plants through their roots allows plants to "alter their growth patterns to avoid direct competition."

Q5. 正确答案：D

Q5. 解析：The phrase "still in its infancy" metaphorically means that the study of plant communication is at an early stage of development, supported by the following sentence stating researchers are continuously uncovering new interactions.

2026-01-21 Radio Astronomy Perspective

Q1. 正确答案：B

Q1. 解析：The passage notes that radio telescopes, unlike optical ones, can detect signals from sources obscured by dust, indicating that dust blocks optical detection.

Q2. 正确答案：A

Q2. 解析：In this context, "transformative" describes major discoveries that fundamentally changed our understanding of the universe, which makes "groundbreaking" the best fit.

Q3. 正确答案：B

Q3. 解析：The passage states that radio astronomy helps scientists study the universe's early conditions, the end stages of stellar life, and matter under extreme conditions, making the prevention of star explosions the unsupported exception.

Q4. 正确答案：A

Q4. 解析：The author mentions the global spread of wireless technology to emphasize that despite protective measures like quiet zones, technological interference remains a persistent and growing threat.

Q5. 正确答案：C

Q5. 解析：The passage explicitly states that to combat radio frequency pollution, observatories are often located in remote areas to distance them from technological interference.